

Contents

FAUST II (Bilingual)	2
Der Tragödie Zweiter Teil / The Second Part of the Tragedy	2
Erster Akt / Act I	2
Anmutige Gegend / Pleasant Landscape	2
Kaiserliche Pfalz. Saal des Thrones / The Emperor's Castle. Hall of the Throne	10
Weitläufiger Saal mit Nebengemachern / Spacious Hall with Adjoining Apartments	34
Lustgarten / Pleasure Garden	96
Morgensonne / Morning Sun	96
Finstere Galerie / A Gloomy Gallery	115
Hell erleuchtete Sale / Brilliantly Lighted Halls	130
Rittersaal / Hall of the Knights	138
Zweiter Akt / Act II	158
Hochgewolbtes enges gotisches Zimmer / A High-Arched, Narrow Gothic Chamber	158
Laboratorium / Laboratory	175
Klassische Walpurgisnacht. Pharsalische Felder / Classical Walpurgis-Night	189
Am oberen Peneios / On the Upper Peneus	194
Am untern Peneios / On the Lower Peneios	207
Am obern Peneios / On the Upper Peneios (Second Visit)	224
Felsbuchten des agaischen Meers / Rocky Coves of the Aegean Sea	263
Dritter Akt / Act III (Helena)	296
Vor dem Palaste des Menelas zu Sparta / Before the Palace of Menelaus in Sparta	296
Innerer Burghof / Inner Courtyard	347
Schattiger Hain / Shady Grove	378
Vierter Akt / Act IV	415
Hochgebirg / High Mountains	415
Act IV, Scene 1	415

Auf dem Vorgebirg / On the Headland	437
Act IV, Scene 2	437
Des Gegenkaisers Zelt / The Rival Emperor's Tent	468
Act IV, Scene 3	468
Fünfter Akt / Act V	489
Offene Gegend / Open Country	489
Palast / Palace	499
Tiefe Nacht / Dead of Night	514
Mitternacht / Midnight	523
Grosser Vorhof des Palasts / Great Outer Court of the Palace	538
Grablegung / Sepulture (Entombment)	545
Bergschluchten / Mountain-Gorges, Forest, Rock, Desert	562

FAUST II (Bilingual)

Der Tragödie Zweiter Teil / The Second Part of the Tragedy

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1832)

English Translation: Bayard Taylor (1871)

German original with line-by-line English translation

Erster Akt / Act I

Anmutige Gegend / Pleasant Landscape

Faust, bedded on flowery turf, fatigued, restless, endeavouring to sleep. Circle of hovering spirits in motion: graceful diminutive figures.

Ariel *Chant, accompanied by Aeolian harps*

Wenn der Blüten Frühlingsregen *When the Spring returns serener*

When spring's blossom-rain descends

Über alle schwebend sinkt, *Raining blossoms over all;*

Floating downward over all

Wenn der Felder grüner Segen *When the fields with blessing greener*

When the fields' green blessing sends

Allen Erdgebornen blinkt, *On the earth-born children call;*

Light to all earth's children small

Kleiner Elfen Geistergrosse *Then the craft of elves propitious*

Tiny fairy power descends

Eilet, wo sie helfen kann, *Hastes to help where help it can:*

Rushing where it can assist

Ob er heilig, ob er böse, *Be he holy, be he vicious,*

Holy, wicked—Ariel tends

Jammert sie der Unglücksman. *Pity they the luckless man.*

Every sad soul on his list

Die ihr dies Haupt umschwebt im luft'gen Kreise, *Who round this head in airy circles hover,*

You who flutter round this head in rings of air

Erzeigt euch hier nach edler Elfen Weise, *Yourselves in guise of noble Elves discover!*

Show yourselves as noble elves truly do

Besänftiget des Herzens grimmen Strauss, *The fierce convulsions of his heart compose;*

The heart is clenched in fists—unclench it there

Entfernt des Vorwurfs glühend bittre Pfeile, *Remove the burning barbs of his remorse,*

Remove the burning arrows of his grief, undo

Sein Innres reinigt von erlebtem Graus. *And cleanse his being from the suffered woes!*

His insides—scrub the horror he's been through

Vier sind die Pausen nachtiger Weile, *Four pauses makes the Night upon her courses,*

Four are the watches of the night

Nun ohne Saumen füllt sie freundlich aus. *And now, delay not, let them kindly close!*

Now fill them all with friendly light

Erst senkt sein Haupt aufs kühle Polster nieder, *First on the coolest pillow let him slumber,*

Lay his head on the wet spot

Dann badet ihn in Tau aus Lethes Flut; *Then sprinkle him with Lethe's drowsy spray!*

Then wash him in the dew of Lethe's flow

Gelenk sind bald die krampfstarren Glieder, *His limbs no more shall cramps and chills encumber,*

His cramped-stiff limbs will loosen from their worst

Wenn er gestarkt dem Tag entgegenruht; *When sleep has made him strong to meet the day.*

When rested, strong, toward day he'll go

Vollbringt der Elfen schonste Pflicht, *Perform, ye Elves, your fairest rite:*

The prettiest elf-duty do

Gebt ihn zuruck dem heiligen Licht. *Restore him to the holy Light!*

Give him back to the light like a library book

Chor (*singly, by two or more, alternately and collectively*)

Wenn sich lau die Luftte fullen *When around the green-girt meadow*

When balmy breezes fill the evening hour

Um den grunumschranten Plan, *Balm the tepid winds exhale,*

Around the green-ringed meadow's edge

Susse Duftte, Nebelhullen *Then in fragrance and in shadow*

Sweet scents and mist-veils shower

Senkt die Dammerung heran. *Twilight spreads her misty veil:*

As twilight sinks beyond the hedge

Lispelt leise sussen Frieden, *Whispers peace in accents cheery,*

Whisper soft, sweet peace descending

Wiegt das Herz in Kindesruh; *Rocks the heart in childhood's play,*

Rock that heart like a cradle getting rocked

Und den Augen dieses Muden *And upon these eyelids weary*

And for these tired eyes unending

Schliesst des Tages Pforte zu. *Shuts the golden gates of Day.*

Shut day's door—now nothing makes a peep

Nacht ist schon hereingesunken, *Now the Night already darkles,*

Night has already sunken down

Schliesst sich heilig Stern an Stern, *Holy star succeeds to star;*

Star connects to holy star like crown

Grosse Lichter, kleine Funken *Dazzling lights and fainter sparkles*

Big lights, little sparks all glitter-bright

Glitzern nah und glanzen fern; *Glimmer near and gleam afar:*

Shimmering near, shining far from sight

Glitzern hier im See sich spiegelnd, *Glimmer here, the lake reflecting,*

Glittering mirrored in the lake below

Glanzen droben klarer Nacht, *Gleam in cloudless dark above;*

Gleaming up in cloudless night's pure glow

Tiefsten Ruhens Glück besiegelnd *While, the bliss of rest protecting,*

Sealing deepest peace with silver light

Herrscht des Mondes volle Pracht. *Reigns in pomp the perfect moon.*

Rules the full moon's splendid might tonight

Schon verloschen sind die Stunden, *Now the Hours are cancelled for thee,*

Already the hours have been erased

Hingeschwunden Schmerz und Glück; *Pain and bliss have fled away:*

Pain and pleasure both effaced

Fühl es vor! Du wirst gesunden; *Thou art whole: let faith restore thee!*

Feel it now! You shall be healed!

Traue neuem Tagesblick. *Trust the new, the rising Day!*

Trust the new day's light revealed

Taler grünen, Hügel schwellen, *Vales grow green, and hills are lifting*

Valleys green, hills start to swell

Buschen sich zu Schattenruh; *Through the shadow-rest of morn;*

Bushing up for shady rest

Und in schwanken Silberwellen *And in waves of silver, drifting*

And in wavy silver spell

Wogt die Saat der Ernte zu. *On to harvest, rolls the corn.*

Crops roll harvestward, full-dressed

Wunsch um Wunsche zu erlangen, *Wouldst thou win desires unbounded,*

Wish on wish—you want the lot?

Schaue nach dem Glanze dort! *Yonder see the glory burn!*

Look toward that glory there, that blazing spot!

Leise bist du nur umfungen, *Lightly is thy life surrounded—*

Only softly are you wrapped around

Schlaf ist Schale, wirf sie fort! *Sleep's a shell, to break and spurn!*

Sleep's a shell—smash it on the ground!

Saume nicht, dich zu erdreisten, *When the crowd sways, unbelieving,*

Don't delay—be bold, be brazen now

Wenn die Menge zaudernd schweift; *Shows the daring will that warms!*

When the crowd dithers, show them how!

Alles kann der Edle leisten, *He is crowned with all achieving,*

Noble souls accomplish anything

Der versteht und rasch ergreift. *Who perceives and then performs.*

Who understand and swiftly seize the ring

Ariel *A tremendous tumult announces the approach of the Sun.*

Horchet! horcht dem Sturm der Horen! *Hearken! Hark!—the Hours careering!*

Listen! Hear the storm of Hours!

Tonend wird für Geistesohren *Sounding loud to spirit-hearing,*

Ring loud for spirit-ears

Schon der neue Tag geboren. *See the new-born Day appearing!*

Already newborn day appears!

Felsentore knarren rasselnd, *Rocky portals jarring shatter,*

Rock-gates creak and clatter hard

Phobus' Räder rollen prasselnd, *Phoebus' wheels in rolling clatter,*

Phoebus' wheels come rolling, jarring

Welch Getöse bringt das Licht! *With a crash the Light draws near!*

What a racket brings the light!

Es trommetet, es posaunet, *Pealing rays and trumpet-blazes,*

It trumpets, it trombones!

Auge blinzelt und Ohr erstaunet, *Eye is blinded, ear amazes:*

Eyes blink, ears astound!

Unerhortes hort sich nicht. *The Unheard can no one hear!*

The unheard cannot be heard around!

Schlupfet zu den Blumenkronen, *Slip within each blossom-bell,*

Slip into the flower-crowns!

Tiefer, tiefer, still zu wohnen, *Deeper, deeper, there to dwell,—*

Deeper, deeper, settle down!

In die Felsen, unters Laub; *In the rocks, beneath the leaf!*

In the rocks, beneath the leaf—

Trifft es euch, so seid ihr taub. *If it strikes you, you are deaf.*

If it hits you, you'll be deaf!

Faust

Des Lebens Pulse schlagen frisch lebendig, *Life's pulses now with fresher force awaken*

Life's pulses beat fresh and alive again

Atherische Dammerung milde zu begrüssen; *To greet the mild ethereal twilight o'er me;*

To greet ethereal twilight's gentle hold

Du, Erde, warst auch diese Nacht beständig *This night, thou, Earth! hast also stood unshaken,*

You, Earth, stood steady through the night's dark reign

Und atmet neu erquickt zu meinen Füssen, *And now thou breathest new-refreshed before me,*

And breathe refreshed beneath me, newly bold

Beginnest schon, mit Lust mich zu umgeben, *And now beginnest, all thy gladness granting,*

Already you begin with joy to wrap me round

Du regst und ruhrst ein kraftiges Beschliessen, *A vigorous resolution to restore me,*

You stir in me a powerful resolve unfurled

Zum höchsten Dasein immerfort zu streben.— *To seek that highest life for which I'm panting.—*

To strive forever toward existence's highest ground

In Dammerschein liegt schon die Welt erschlossen, *The world unfolded lies in twilight glimmer,*

In twilight gleam the world lies spread, unbound

Der Wald ertont von tausendstimmigem Leben, *A thousand voices in the grove are chanting;*

The forest rings with thousand-voiced song!

Tal aus, Tal ein ist Nebelstreif ergossen, *Vale in, vale out, the misty streaks grow dimmer;*

Valley in, valley out, mist-streaks pour along

Doch senkt sich Himmelsklarheit in die Tiefen, *The deeps with heavenly light are penetrated;*

Yet heaven's clarity sinks to depths below

Und Zweig und Aste, frisch erquickt, entsprossen *The boughs, refreshed, lift up their leafy shimmer*

And branch and twig, refreshed, spring up to grow

Dem duft'gen Abgrund, wo versenkt sie schliefen; *From gulfs of air where sleepily they waited;*

From fragrant gulfs where sunk in sleep they lay

Auch Farb' an Farbe klart sich los vom Grunde, *Colour on colour from the background cleareth,*

Color on color clears itself away

Wo Blum' und Blatt von Zitterperle triefen— *Where flower and leaf with trembling pearls are freighted—*

Where flower and leaf drip trembling pearls of spray

Ein Paradies wird um mich her die Runde. *And all around a Paradise appeareth.*

A paradise surrounds me every way!

Hinaufgeschaut!—Der Berge Gipfelriesen *Look up!—The mountain summits, grand, supernal,*

Look up! The mountain peaks, those giants grand

Verkünden schon die feierlichste Stunde; *Herald, e'en now, the solemn hour that neareth;*

Announce already the most solemn hour at hand

Sie dürfen früh des ewigen Lichts geniessen, *They earliest enjoy the light eternal*

They get to drink eternal light the first

Das später sich zu uns hernieder wendet. *That later sinks, till here below we find it.*

That later turns down here to quench our thirst

Jetzt zu der Alpe grungesenkten Wiesen *Now to the Alpine meadows, sloping vernal,*

Now to the alpine meadows, green and low

Wird neuer Glanz und Deutlichkeit gespendet, *A newer beam descends ere we divined it,*

New brilliance and new clarity are sent to show

Und stufenweis herab ist es gelungen;— *And step by step unto the base hath bounded:*

And step by step downward it has won!

Sie tritt hervor!—und, leider schon geblendet, *The sun comes forth! Alas, already blinded,*

She steps forth!—and, alas, already blinding

Kehr' ich mich weg, vom Augenschmerz durchdrungen. *I turn away, with eyesight pierced and wounded!*

I turn away, pierced through with eye-pain's finding

So ist es also, wenn ein sehnend Hoffen *'Tis thus, when, unto yearning hope's endeavour,*

So this is how it goes when yearning hope

Dem höchsten Wunsch sich traulich zugerungen, *Its highest wish on sweet attainment grounded,*

Has struggled toward its highest wish's scope

Erfüllungspforten findet flugeloffen; *The portals of fulfilment widely sever:*

And finds fulfillment's gates flung open wide

Nun aber bricht aus jenen ewigen Gründen *But if there burst from those eternal spaces*

But now from those eternal depths a flood

Ein Flammenubermass, wir stehn betroffen; *A flood of flame, we stand confounded ever;*

Of flame-excess breaks forth—we stand stupefied

Des Lebens Fackel wollten wir entzünden, *For Life's pure torch we sought the shining traces,*

We wanted to light life's torch—got burned instead

Ein Feuermeer umschlingt uns, welch ein Feuer! *And seas of fire—and what a fire!—surprise us.*

A sea of fire engulfs us—what a fire!

Ist's Lieb'? ist's Hass? die gluhend uns umwinden, *Is't Love? Is't Hate? that burningly embraces,*

Is it love? Is it hate? wrapping hot around us

Mit Schmerz und Freuden wechselnd ungeheuer, *And that with pain and joy alternate tries us?*

With monstrous swings of pain and joy unbound

So dass wir wieder nach der Erde blicken, *So that, our glances once more earthward throwing,*

So that we look back toward the earth once more

Zu bergen uns in jugendlichstem Schleier. *We seek in youthful drapery to disguise us.*

To hide ourselves in youth's most tender veil

So bleibe denn die Sonne mir im Rücken! *Behind me, therefore, let the sun be glowing!*

So let the sun stay at my back therefore!

Der Wassersturz, das Felsenriff durchbrausend, *The cataract, between the crags deep-riven,*

The waterfall—crashing through the cliff's detail

Ihn schau' ich an mit wachsendem Entzucken. *I thus behold with rapture ever-growing.*

I watch with ever-growing sweet delight

Von Sturz zu Sturzen walzt er jetzt in tausend, *From plunge to plunge in thousand streams 'tis given,*

From fall to fall it rolls now thousandfold

Dann abertausend Stomen sich ergiessend, *And yet a thousand, to the valleys shaded,*

Then thousand thousands streaming down take flight

Hoch in die Luft Schaum an Schaume sausend. *While foam and spray in air are whirled and driven.*

High in the air foam upon foam takes hold

Allein wie herrlich, diesem Sturm ersprießend, *Yet how superb, across the tumult braided,*

But how magnificent—from all this spray arising

Wolbt sich des bunten Bogens Wechseldauer, *The painted rainbow's changeful life is bending,*

Arches the rainbow's ever-changing, lasting bow

Bald rein gezeichnet, bald in Luft zerfliessend, *Now clearly drawn, dissolving now and faded,*

Now purely drawn, now in the air dissolving

Umher verbreitend duftig kühle Schauer. *And evermore the showers of dew descending!*

Spreading all around cool fragrant showers' flow

Der spiegelt ab das menschliche Bestreben. *Of human striving there's no symbol fuller:*

This mirrors human striving, what we do

Ihm sinne nach, und du begreifst genauer: *Consider, and 'tis easy comprehending—*

Reflect on it—you'll grasp it closer through

Am farbigen Abglanz haben wir das Leben. *Life is not light, but the refracted colour.*

In the colored reflection, we have life, it's true

Kaiserliche Pfalz. Saal des Thrones / The Emperor's Castle. Hall of the Throne

Council of State awaiting the Emperor. Trumpets. Enter Court Retainers of all kinds, splendidly dressed. The Emperor advances to the throne; Astrologer on his right hand.

Kaiser

Ich grüsse die Getreuen, Lieben, *I greet you, Well-beloved and Trusty,*

What's up my loyal besties, my ride-or-dies

Versammelt aus der Nah' und Weite;— *Assembled here from far and wide!*

Gathered from the near places and the far, bodies filling this hall like breath

Den Weisen seh' ich mir zur Seite, *I see the Wise Man at my side;*

The wise one I see standing at my side

Allein wo ist der Narr geblieben? *But where's the Fool, his rival lusty?*

But where the hell did the Fool wander off to?

Junker

Gleich hinter deiner Mantelschleppe *Behind thy mantle's flowing swell*

Right behind the drag of your cloak's hem, following your wake

Stürzt' er zusammen auf der Treppe, *Suddenly on the stairs he fell:*

He just... collapsed on the stairs? Mid-strut? That's commitment to a bit

Man trug hinweg das Fettgewicht, *They bore away the weight of fat;*

They hauled off that absolute unit of fat

Tot oder trunken? weiss man nicht. *If dead, or drunk? none knoweth that.*

Dead or drunk? Nobody's saying, very sus

Zweiter Junker

Sogleich mit wunderbarer Schnelle *As quick as thought, through all the pother*

Immediately with wondrous speed

Drangt sich ein anderer an die Stelle. *Him to replace there came another,*

Another one shoves in to fill the vacuum—nature abhors an empty fool-slot

Gar kostlich ist er aufgeputzt, *Adorned and prinked with wondrous art,*

He's dolled up exquisitely, all surface shine

Doch fratzenhaft, dass jeder stutzt; *Yet so grotesque that all men start.*

But so grotesque everyone's sphincters tighten

Die Wache halt ihm an der Schwelle *The guards their halberds crosswise hold*

Guards crossed their halberds at the threshold—

Kreuzweis die Hellebarden vor— *To bar him—them he thrusts apart:*

Steel bars forming an X like a threat made solid

Da ist er doch, der kühne Tor! *Lo! here he comes, the Fool so bold!*

But here he comes anyway, the absolute madlad!

Mephistopheles (*kneeling before the throne*)

Was immerfort in Schutz genommen? *What's cursed and welcomingly expected?*

Riddle me this, your highness: What gets constant protection?

Was hart gescholten und verklagt? *What is desired, yet always chased?*

What gets chased away and screamed at? (asking for a friend)

Wen darfst du nicht herbeirufen? *What evermore with care protected?*

Whom may you not summon hither?

Wen horet jeder gern genannt? *What is accused, condemned, disgraced?*

Whose name makes everyone's ears perk up, dopamine spike

Was naht sich deines Thrones Stufen? *To whom dar'st thou not give a hearing?*

What's climbing your throne-steps right now?

Was hat sich selbst hinweggebannt? *Whose name hears each man willingly?*

What exiled itself like a drama queen?

Kaiser

Für diesmal spare deine Worte! *What is't, before thy throne appearing?*

Save the words this time—my patience is a thin membrane

Hier sind die Ratsel nicht am Orte, *What keeps itself away from thee?*

Riddles don't belong here, this is a throne room not a sphinx's bedroom

Das ist die Sache dieser Herrn.— *Spare us thy words! the time is pressing;*

That is the business of these lords

Da lose du! das hort' ich gern. *This is no place for riddle-guessing:*

YOU solve it! That I'd actually love to hear.

Mein alter Narr ging, furcht' ich, weit ins Weite; *These gentlemen such things explain.*

My old fool went—and I'm scared—way WAY too far out there

Nimm seinen Platz und komm an meine Seite. *Solve it thyself!—to hear I'm fain.*

Take his place and come slide up next to me

*My old Fool went, I fear, an endless distance; Take thou his place, come here and lend assistance!
(Mephistopheles goes up and stations himself on the Emperor's left hand.)*

Gemurmel der Menge

Ein neuer Narr—Zu neuer Pein— *Another fool—for worries new!*

Another fool—for fresh new pain!—the universe provides

Wo kommt er her?—Wie kam er ein?— *Whence came he?—how did he get through?*

Where'd he come from?—How'd he slip through?—bodies asking bodies

Der alte fiel—Der hat vertan— *The old one fell—he's walked his path.—*

The old one fell—he's done—washed up—

Es war ein Fass—Nun ist's ein Span— *He was a barrel—this, a lath!*

He was a barrel—this one's a splinter—went from thicc to stick

Kaiser

Und also, ihr Getreuen, Lieben, *So now, my Well-beloved and Loyal,*

And so, you faithful, beloved ones

Willkommen aus der Nah' und Ferne! *Be welcome all, from near and far!*

Welcome from near and far, everybody!

Ihr sammelt euch mit gunstigem Sterne, *You meet beneath a fortunate star;*

You gather under a lucky star—I feel its light on my face

Da droben ist uns Gluck und Heil geschrieben. *Welfare and luck are now the aspects royal.*

Up there welfare and luck are written for us—cosmic HR approved

Doch sagt, warum in diesen Tagen, *But tell me why, in days so fair,*

But tell me WHY—in these chill days—

Wo wir der Sorgen uns entschlagen, *When we've withdrawn ourselves from care,*

When we've shaken off all our cares, finally loose

Schonbarte mummenschanzlich tragen *And beards of beauty masquerading wear,—*

Wearing pretty masquerade beards, faces hidden behind faces

Und Heitres nur geniessen wollten, *When gay delights for us are waiting,*

When we only wanted to enjoy fun stuff

Warum wir uns ratschlagend qualen sollten? *Why should we plague ourselves, deliberating?*

Why should we torture ourselves with DELIBERATING? Ugh, adulating

Doch weil ihr meint, es ging' nicht anders an, *Yet, since the task you think we cannot shun,*

Yet since you think it can't be done otherwise

Geschehen ist's, so sei's getan. *'Tis settled then, so be it done!*

Fine, it's settled, let's just do this.

Kanzler

Die höchste Tugend, wie ein Heiligenschein, *The highest virtue, like a halo-zone*

The highest virtue—like a halo around the head, light made visible

Umgibt des Kaisers Haupt; nur er allein *Circles the Emperor's head; and he alone*

Circles the Emperor's noggin—only HE

Vermag sie gultig auszuüben: *Is worthy validly to exercise it.*

Is able validly to exercise it

Gerechtigkeit!—Was alle Menschen lieben, *'Tis Justice!—all men love and prize it,*

JUSTICE! The thing everyone claims to love

Was alle fordern, wünschen, schwer entbehren, *None can forego, but all require and want it:*

What everyone demands, desires, can barely live without—it's basically wifi

Es liegt an ihm, dem Volk es zu gewahren. The people look to him, that he should grant it.

It's on him to grant it to the people. No pressure.

Doch ach! Was hilft dem Menschegeist Verstand, But, ah! what help can human wit impart,

But alas! What good is reason to the human spirit

Dem Herzen Gute, Willigkeit der Hand, Or readiness of hand, or kindly heart,

Kindness to the heart, readiness of hand

Wenn's fieberhaft durchaus im Staate wutet When lies the State, as if in fever fretting,

When fever rages through the whole state like a sickness no one can shake

Und Ubel sich in Ubeln uberbrutet? And brooded Evil evil is begetting?

And evil breeds evil breeds evil—it's turtles all the way down except the turtles are bad

Wer schaut hinab von diesem hohen Raum Who looks abroad from off this height supreme

Whoever looks down from this high room

Ins weite Reich, ihm scheint's ein schwerer Traum, Throughout the realm, 'tis like a weary dream,

Into the wide realm—it seems a heavy dream, the weight of sleep-paralysis

Wo Missgestalt in Missgestalten schaltet, Where one deformity another mouldeth,

Where one deformity manages other deformities

Das Ungesetz gesetzlich uberwaltet Where lawlessness itself by law upholdeth,

Where illegality legally dominates—the system gaming itself

Und eine Welt des Irrtums sich entfaltet. And 'tis an age of Error that unfoldeth!

And a whole world of error unfolds—like the worst IKEA manual

Der raubt sich Herden, der ein Weib, One plunders flocks, a woman one,

One steals herds, another a wife

Kelch, Kreuz und Leuchter vom Altare, Cup, cross, and candlestick from altar,

Chalice, cross, and candelabra from the altar—sacred objects profaned

Beruhmt sich dessen manche Jahre And then to boast it does not palter,

And brags about it for years

Mit heiler Haut, mit unverletztem Leib. Of limb or life nowise undone.

Skin intact, body undamaged. Crime pays.

Jetzt drangen Klager sich zur Halle, To Court behold the plaintiffs urging,

Now plaintiffs crowd into the hall, desperate bodies

Der Richter prunkt auf hohem Pfuhl, *Where puffs the judge on cushions warm,*
The judge preens on his high cushion—peak cushion privilege
Indessen wogt in grimmigem Schwallen *And swells, meanwhile, with fury surging,*
Meanwhile rebellion's growing chaos surges like a tide
Des Aufruhrs wachsendes Gewühl. *Rebellion's fast-increasing storm!*
In grim, swelling waves
Der darf auf Schand' und Frevel pochen, *His easy way through crime is broken*
Anyone can get away with crime and scandal
Der auf Mitschuldigste sich stützt, *Who his accomplices selects;*
If they lean on accomplices—it's all who you know
Und: Schuldig! horst du ausgesprochen, *And "Guilty!" hears one only spoken*
And "GUILTY!" you only hear spoken
Wo Unschuld nur sich selber schützt. *Where Innocence itself protects.*
Where innocence has to protect itself because no one else will—very bootstrap
So will sich alle Welt zerstückeln, *They all pull down what they should care for,—*
So the whole world wants to tear itself to pieces
Vernichten, was sich gebührt; *Destroy their weal, in self-despite;*
Destroying what is proper and right
Wie soll sich da der Sinn entwickeln, *How can the sense develop, therefore,*
How's common sense supposed to develop then
Der einzig uns zum Rechten führt? *Which, only, leads us to the Right?*
The one thing that leads us to what's Right?
Zuletzt ein wohlgesinnter Mann *At last, the man of good intent*
At last even a well-meaning man
Neigt sich dem Schmeichler, dem Bestecher, *To flatterer and briber bendeth;*
Bends toward the flatterer, the briber—spine curving
Ein Richter, der nicht strafen kann, *The judge, debarred from punishment,*
A judge who can't punish anyone ends up
Gesellt sich endlich zum Verbrecher. *Mates with the felon, ere he endeth.*
Joining the criminals. Obviously.
Ich malte schwarz, doch dichten Flor *I've painted black, but denser screen*
I painted black, but a denser veil

Zog' ich dem Bilde lieber vor. *I'd rather draw before the scene.*

I'd rather draw over this whole picture

Entschlusse sind nicht zu vermeiden; *Here measures cannot be evaded;*

Decisions cannot be avoided—the body must move

Wenn alle schadigen, alle leiden, *When all offend, and none are aided,*

When everyone harms, everyone suffers

Geht selbst die Majestat zu Raub. *His Majesty a victim stands.*

Even Majesty itself becomes prey.

Heermeister

Wie tobt's in diesen wilden Tagen! *In these wild days, how discords thicken!*

How it rages in these wild days!—just check Twitter

Ein jeder schlägt und wird erschlagen, *Each strikes and in return is stricken,*

Everyone strikes and is struck—violence echoing violence

Und fürs Kommando bleibt man taub. *And they are deaf to all commands.*

And they're deaf to all commands.

Der Bürger hinter seinen Mauern, *The burgher in his fortifications,*

The citizen behind his walls

Der Ritter auf dem Felsenest *The knight upon his rocky nest,*

The knight upon his rocky nest

Verschwuren sich, uns auszudauern, *Have sworn to worry out our patience*

Have sworn to wait us out—they've got snacks

Und halten ihre Krafte fest. *And keep their strength with stubborn crest.*

And hold their strength tight, fists clenched

Der Mietsoldat wird ungeduldig, *The mercenaries, no whit better,*

The mercenary gets impatient—soldiers have bills too

Mit Ungestum verlangt er seinen Lohn, *Impatiently demand their pay,*

Demands his pay with increasing aggression

Und waren wir ihm nichts mehr schuldig, *And, if we were not still their debtor,*

And if we owed him nothing more

Er lief ganz und gar davon. *They'd start forthwith and march away.*

He'd straight up bounce, fully ghost us

Verbiere wer, was alle wollten, *Let one forbid what all would practise*

Forbid what everyone wants?

Der hat ins Wespennest gestort; *And in a hornet's nest he stands:*

That's disturbing a wasps' nest—the swarm rising

Das Reich, das sie beschützen sollten, *The realm which they should guard, the fact is,*

The realm they should be protecting? Yeah about that

Es liegt geplündert und verheert. *'Tis devastated by their hands.*

It lies plundered and devastated. By them.

Man lässt ihr Toben wutend hausen, *They give the rein to wild disorder,*

They let their rage just run wild

Schon ist die halbe Welt vertan; *And half the world is wasted now;*

Half the world already wasted—ruined bodies, ruined land

Es sind noch Könige da draussen, *There still are kings beyond our border,*

There are still kings out there beyond

Doch keiner denkt, es ging' ihn irgend an. *But none thinks it concerns him anyhow.*

But none of them thinks it's their problem—very “not my circus” energy

Schatzmeister

Wer wird auf Bundsgenossen pochen! *Trust allies, and we soon shall rue us!*

Trust allies? We'll regret it!

Subsidien, die man uns versprochen, *The subsidies they promised to us—*

The subsidies they promised—hot air, blue balls

Wie Rohrenwasser bleiben aus. *Like water in leaky pipes—don't come.*

Like water through leaky pipes—nothing arrives

Auch, Herr, in deinen weiten Staaten *Then, Sire, in all thy states extended*

Also, Sire, in all your extended states

An wen ist der Besitz geraten? *To whom hath now the rule descended?*

To whom has possession fallen?

Wohin man kommt, da halt ein Neuer Haus, *Where'er one goes, a new lord is at home,*

Everywhere you go some NEW guy's running things now—franchise model gone wrong

Und unabhängig will er leben, *And hopes to live in independence;*

And wants to live independently—won't even return texts

Zusehen muss man, wie er's treibt; *He takes his course and we look on:*

We have to just watch what he does, powerless

Wir haben so viel Rechte hingegeben, *Such rights we've given to our attendants*

We gave away so many rights

Dass uns auf nichts ein Recht mehr ubrigbleibt. *That all our right to anything is gone.*

That we have zero rights left to anything

Auch auf Parteien, wie sie heissen, *On parties, too, whate'er the name be,*

And parties—whatever they call themselves these days—

Ist heutzutage kein Verlass; *Our trust, today, is far from great;*

There's no relying on them nowadays

Sie mogen schelten oder preisen, *Though loud their praise or fierce their blame be*

Whether they praise or condemn

Gleichgultig wurden Lieb' und Hass. *Indifferent is their love and hate.*

Love and hate have both gone flat—no temperature

Die Ghibellinen wie die Guelfen *The Ghibellines and Guelfs from labour*

The Ghibellines and the Guelfs

Verbergen sich, um auszuruhn; *Are resting—both laid on the shelf.*

Are hiding out to rest up—both teams on vacation

Wer jetzt will seinem Nachbar helfen? *Who, therefore, now will help his neighbour?*

Who wants to help their neighbor now? Nobody!

Ein jeder hat fur sich zu tun. *Each has enough, to help himself.*

Everyone has their own work to do—hands too full

Die Goldesporten sind verrammelt, *The gate of gold no more unlatches,*

The golden gates are barricaded

Ein jeder kratzt und scharrt und sammelt, *And each one gathers, digs, and scratches,*

Everyone scratches and scrapes and hoards

Und unsre Kassen bleiben leer. *While our strong-box is void indeed.*

And our coffers stay empty.

Marschalk

Welch Unheil muss auch ich erfahren! *What evil I, as well, am having!*

What misfortune I also have to deal with! I didn't ask for this

Wir wollen alle Tage sparen *We're always trying to be saving,*
We try to save every day—tightening, clenching
 Und brauchen alle Tage mehr, *And ever greater is our need:*
And need more every day—it's giving deficit
 Und taglich wachst mir neue Pein. *Thus daily grows this task of mine.*
And daily my pain grows.
 Den Kochen tut kein Mangel wehe; *The cooks have all they want at present,—*
The cooks lack nothing
 Wildschweine, Hirsche, Hasen, Rehe, *Wild-boar and deer, and hare and pheasant,*
Wild boars, stags, hares, deer—meat on meat
 Welschhuhner, Huhner, Gans' und Enten, *Duck, peacock, turkey, goose, and chicken:*
Turkeys, chickens, geese, and ducks—feathers and flesh
 Die Deputate, sichre Renten, *These, paid in kind, are certain picking,*
The tributes, the secure rents—at least SOME things work
 Sie gehen noch so ziemlich ein. *And do not seriously decline;*
They still come in pretty okay
 Jedoch am Ende fehlt's an Wein. *Yet, after all, we're short of wine.*
But in the end, we're short on WINE.
 Wenn sonst im Keller Fass an Fass sich haufte, *Where casks on casks were once our cellars filling,*
Where once barrels on barrels piled in the cellar—dripping with promise
 Der besten Berg' und Jahreslaufte, *Rare vintages of flavours finely thrilling,*
From the best hills and best years—liquid memory
 So schlurft unendliches Gesaue *The noble lords' eternal swilling*
Endless swilling by noble lords
 Der edlen Herrn den letzten Tropfen aus. *Has drained them off, till not a drop appears.*
Has drained the last drop—every aristocrat's a wine-hoover
 Der Stadtrat muss sein Lager auch verzapfen, *The City Council, too, must tap their liquor;*
The city council has to tap their supply too
 Man greift zu Humpen, greift zu Napfen, *They drink from mug, and jug, and beaker,*
They grab tankards, grab bowls—mouths to vessels
 Und unterm Tische liegt der Schmaus. *Till no one longer sees or hears.*
And under the table lies the feast. Wasted.

Nun soll ich zahlen, alle lohnen; *'Tis I must pay for all the dances;*

Now I'm supposed to pay, compensate everyone

Der Jude wird mich nicht verschonen, *The Jew will have me, past all chances;*

The moneylender won't spare me—compound interest is cruel math

Der schafft Antizipationen, *His notes of hand and his advances*

He creates anticipations

Die speisen Jahr um Jahr voraus. *Will soon eat up the coming years.*

That eat up year after year in advance—time consumed

Die Schweine kommen nicht zu Fette, *Before they're fat the swine are taken;*

The pigs don't even get fat before we need them

Verpfandet ist der Pfuhl im Bette, *Pawned is the pillow, ere one waken,*

The pillow's pawned before you wake

Und auf den Tisch kommt vorgegessen Brot. *The bread is eaten ere the board it sees.*

And the bread hits the table pre-eaten.

Kaiser (*after some reflection, to Mephistopheles*)

Sag, weisst du Narr nicht auch noch eine Not? *Say, Fool, canst thou not add a want to these?*

Say, Fool, got any more problems to add? The list isn't long enough

Mephistopheles

Ich? Nicht doch! Ich seh' den Kreis erstrahlen— *I? Not at all! I see the circling splendour—*

Me? Nah! I see this circle absolutely GLOWING

Dich selbst und dein! Sollt' einer Zutraun hegen, *Thyself, and thine! Should one his trust surrender,*

Yourself and your people! Should anyone lose trust

Wo Majestat unweigerlich gebeut, *Where Majesty thus unopposed commands,*

Where Majesty commands without opposition

Bereite Macht Feindseliges zerstreut? *Where ready power the hostile force disbands,*

Where ready power scatters all hostility

Wo guter Wille, kraftig durch Verstand, *Where loyal wills, through understanding strong,*

Where good will, strong through understanding—very Ted-talk energy

Und Tatigkeit, vielfaltige, zur Hand? *And mixed activities, around thee throng?*

And multi-talented action stands ready?

Was konnte da zum Unheil sich vereinen, *What powers for evil could one see combining,—*

What could combine into harm here

Zur Finsternis, wo solche Sterne scheinen? *For darkness, where such brilliant stars are shining?*

Into darkness, when such stars are literally shining?

Gemurmel

Das ist ein Schalk—Der's wohl versteht— *He is a scamp—who comprehends.—*

He's a scoundrel—who gets it.—

Er lugt sich ein—So lang' es geht— *He lies his way—until it ends.—*

He lies his way in—as long as it lasts—

Ich weiss schon—Was dahinter steckt— *I know it now—what's in his mind.—*

I know already—what's behind this—(narrator: he did not know)

Und was denn weiter?—Ein Projekt— *What then?—A project lurks behind!*

And what then?—A scheme—hidden beneath

Mephistopheles

Wo fehlt's nicht irgendwo auf dieser Welt? *Where, in this world, doth not some lack appear?*

Where in this world is there no lack?

Dem dies, dem das, hier aber fehlt das Geld. *Here this, there that,—but money's lacking here.*

This person needs this, that person needs that—but HERE it's money

Vom Estrich zwar ist es nicht aufzuraffen; *True, from the floor you can't at once collect it,*

True, you can't just scrape it off the floor

Doch Weisheit weiss das Tiefste herzuschaffen. *But, deepliest hidden, wisdom may detect it.*

But wisdom knows how to summon the deepest stuff

In Bergesadern, Mauergründen *In veins of mountains, under building-bases,*

In mountain veins, in foundation walls

Ist Gold gemunzt und ungemunzt zu finden, *Coined and uncoined, there's gold in many places:*

Gold is waiting—coined and uncoined.

Und fragt ihr mich, wer es zutage schafft: *And ask you who shall bring it to the light?*

And if you ask who brings it to light

Begabten Manns Natur- und Geisteskraft. *A man endowed with Mind's and Nature's might.*

A gifted man's Nature- and Spirit-power—basically a vibe check

Kanzler

Natur und Geist—so spricht man nicht zu Christen. *Nature and Mind—to Christians we don't speak so.*

Nature and Spirit—we don't talk like that to Christians

Deshalb verbrennt man Atheisten, *Thence to burn Atheists we seek so,*

That's why we burn atheists—it's called consequences

Weil solche Reden höchst gefährlich sind. *For such discourses very dangerous be.*

Because such speeches are extremely dangerous

Natur ist Sünde, Geist ist Teufel, *Nature is Sin, and Mind is Devil:*

Nature is Sin, Spirit is Devil

Sie hegen zwischen sich den Zweifel, *Doubt they beget in shameless revel,*

They breed Doubt between them—their weird threesome

Ihr missgestaltet Zwitterkind. *Their hybrid in deformity.*

Their misshapen hybrid child

Uns nicht so!—Kaisers alten Landen *Not so with us!—Two only races*

Not us though!—In the Emperor's old lands

Sind zwei Geschlechter nur entstanden, *Have in the Empire kept their places,*

Only two races have arisen—two camps

Sie stützen würdig seinen Thron: *And prop the throne with worthy weight.*

They prop up his throne with dignity

Die Heiligen sind es und die Ritter; *The Saints and Knights are they: together*

The Saints and the Knights!

Sie stehen jedem Ungewitter *They breast each spell of thunder-weather,*

They withstand every storm—they're the load-bearing walls

Und nehmen Kirch' und Staat zum Lohn. *And take for pay the Church and State.*

And take Church and State as reward

Dem Pobelsinn verworrner Geister *The vulgar minds that breed confusion*

Against the confused rabble-mind

Entwickelt sich ein Widerstand: *Are met with an opposing hand:*

Resistance develops

Die Ketzer sind's! die Hexenmeister! *They're wizards!—heretics! Delusion*

They're heretics! Witch-masters!

Und sie verderben Stadt und Land. *Through them will ruin town and land.*

And they ruin city and country.

Die willst du nun mit frechen Scherzen *And these will you, with brazen juggle,*

These you want with brazen jokes

In diese hohen Kreise schwarzen; *Within this high assembly smuggle?*

To smuggle into these high circles—contaminating

Ihr hegt euch an verderbtem Herzen, *For hearts corrupt you scheme and struggle;*

You nurture yourselves on corrupted hearts

Dem Narren sind sie nah verwandt. *The Fool's near kin are all the band.*

The Fool's close kin, all of you.

Mephistopheles

Daran erkenn' ich den gelehrten Herrn! *By that, I know the learned lord you are!*

By THAT I recognize the learned lord!

Was ihr nicht tastet, steht euch meilenfern, *What you don't touch, is lying leagues afar;*

What you can't touch is miles away from you—very “pics or it didn't happen”

Was ihr nicht fasst, das fehlt euch ganz und gar, *What you don't grasp, is wholly lost to you;*

What you can't grasp is completely missing from you

Was ihr nicht rechnet, glaubt ihr, sei nicht wahr, *What you don't reckon, think you, can't be true;*

What you can't calculate, you think isn't real

Was ihr nicht wagt, hat für euch kein Gewicht, *What you don't weigh, it has no weight, alas!*

What you don't weigh has no weight for you

Was ihr nicht münzt, das, meint ihr, gelte nicht. *What you don't coin, you're sure it will not pass.*

What you don't coin, you think doesn't count.

Kaiser

Dadurch sind unsre Mängel nicht erledigt, *Therewith to help our needs you naught determine.*

That doesn't fix our shortfall one bit

Was willst du jetzt mit deiner Fastenpredigt? *What wilt thou, here, with such a Lenten sermon?*

What do you want with your Lent-lecture anyway?

Ich habe satt das ewige Wie und Wenn; *I'm tired of the eternal If and How:*

I'm sick of the eternal How and If—exhaustion settling

Es fehlt an Geld, nun gut, so schaff es denn. *Money we want: good, then, procure it now!*

We're short on money. Good. So GET SOME.

Mephistopheles

Ich schaffe, was ihr wollt, und schaffe mehr; *I'll furnish what you wish, and more: 'tis, true,*

I'll make what you want, and make MORE

Zwar ist es leicht, doch ist das Leichte schwer; *A light task, but light things are hard to do.*

Sure it's easy, but easy things are hard—that's just science

Es liegt schon da, doch um es zu erlangen, *The gold's on hand,—yet, skilfully to win it,*

It's already there, but to obtain it

Das ist die Kunst, wer weiss es anzufangen? *That is the art: who knows how to begin it?*

That's the art—who knows how to begin?

Bedenkt doch nur: in jenen Schreckensläuften, *Consider only, in those days of blood*

Just consider: in those terror-times

Wo Menschenfluten Land und Volk ersäuften, *When o'er the Empire poured a human flood,*

When human floods drowned land and people

Wie der und der, so sehr es ihn erschreckte, *How many men, such deadly terror steeled them,*

How this one and that one, scared shitless

Sein Liebstes da- und dortwohin versteckte. *Took their best goods, and here and there concealed them!*

Hid their dearest things here and there—secret caches

So war's von je in mächtiger Römer Zeit, *'Twas so beneath the mighty Roman sway,*

So it was since mighty Rome's time

Und so fortan, bis gestern, ja bis heut. *And ever so repeated, till our day.*

And so forth until yesterday, until today—recycling fear across millennia

Das alles liegt im Boden still begraben, *All that was buried in the earth, to save it:*

All of it lies silently buried in the ground

Der Boden ist des Kaisers, der soll's haben. *The Emperor owns the earth, and he should have it.*

The ground belongs to the Emperor. He should have it.

Schatzmeister

Für einen Narren spricht er gar nicht schlecht, *Now, for a Fool, his words are rather bright:*

For a Fool, he's not talking half bad

Das ist fürwahr des alten Kaisers Recht. *That is indeed the old Imperial right.*

That is indeed the old Imperial right

Kanzler

Der Satan legt euch goldgewirkte Schlingen: *Satan has laid his golden snares, to try us;*

Satan is laying golden snares for you

Es geht nicht zu mit frommen rechten Dingen. *Such things as these are neither right nor pious.*

This is neither right nor pious.

Marschalk

Schafft' er uns nur zu Hof willkommen Gaben, *Let him but bring his gifts to Court, and share them,*

If he just brings welcome gifts to court

Ich wollte gern ein bisschen Unrecht haben. *And if things were a little wrong, I'd bear them!*

I'd happily accept a little wrongness—flexibility in the spine

Heermeister

Der Narr ist klug, verspricht, was jedem frommt; *The Fool is shrewd, to promise each his needs;*

The Fool's smart, promises what helps everyone

Fragt der Soldat doch nicht, woher es kommt. *Whence it may come the soldier never heeds.*

The soldier doesn't ask where it comes from.

Mephistopheles

Und glaubt ihr euch vielleicht durch mich betrogen, *And should you think, perchance, I overreach you,*

And if you think maybe I'm scamming you

Hier steht ein Mann! da, fragt den Astrologen! *Here's the Astrologer—ask him to teach you!*

Here stands a man! Ask the Astrologer!

In Kreis' um Kreise kennt er Stund' und Haus; *The spheres of Hour and House are in his ken:*

He knows circle upon circle, hour and house

So sage denn: wie sieht's am Himmel aus? *What are the heavenly aspects?—tell us, then!*
So tell us: how do the heavens look?

Gemurmel

Zwei Schelme sind's—Verstehn sich schon— *Two rogues are they,—in league they've grown,*
Two scoundrels—they understand each other perfectly
Narr und Phantast—So nah dem Thron— *Dreamer and Fool—so near the throne!*
Fool and Fantasist—so close to the throne—
Ein mattgesungen—Alt Gedicht— *The song is old—and flatly sung.—*
A worn-out old song—very “I’ve heard this one before”
Der Tor blast ein—Der Weise spricht— *The Fool he prompts—the Wise Man's tongue!*
The Fool whispers in—the Wise Man speaks out

Astrolog (*speaks; Mephistopheles prompts*)

Die Sonne selbst, sie ist ein lautres Gold, *The Sun himself is gold of purest ray;*
The Sun itself is pure gold
Merkur, der Bote, dient um Gunst und Sold, *The herald, Mercury, serves for love and pay;*
Mercury the messenger serves for favor and pay
Frau Venus hat's euch allen angetan, *Dame Venus has bewitched you all, for she,*
Lady Venus has done you ALL—she looked at you, you're done
So fruh als spat blickt sie euch lieblich an; *Early and late, looks on you lovingly;*
Early or late she gazes lovingly on you—her attention like warmth
Die keusche Luna launet grillenhaft; *Chaste Luna has her whims, no two alike;*
Chaste Luna moods around capriciously—classic Luna behavior
Mars, trifft er nicht, so draut euch seine Kraft. *Mars threatens you, although he may not strike,*
Mars, if he doesn't hit you, he threatens you.
Und Jupiter bleibt doch der schonste Schein, *And Jupiter is still the splendid star.*
And Jupiter remains the most beautiful light
Saturn ist gross, dem Auge fern und klein. *Saturn is great, though seeming small and far:*
Saturn is big, but looks tiny from here—compensating
Ihn als Metall verehren wir nicht sehr, *As metal, him we don't much venerate,*
As a metal we don't really worship him

An Wert gering, doch im Gewichte schwer. *Of value slight, though heavy in his weight.*

Small in value, heavy in weight—dense presence

Ja! wenn zu Sol sich Luna fein gesellt, *Now, when of Sol and Luna union's had,—*

Yes! When Sol and Luna join nicely

Zum Silber Gold, dann ist es heitre Welt; *Silver with gold,—then is the world made glad:*

Silver to gold—then it's a happy world!

Das Ubrige ist alles zu erlangen: *All else, with them, is easy to attain,—*

All else is available to obtain

Palaste, Garten, Brustlein, rote Wangen, *Palaces, gardens, cheeks of rosy stain;*

Palaces, gardens, little breasts, rosy cheeks

Das alles schafft der hochgelahrte Mann, *And these procures this highly learned man,*

All this the highly learned man procures

Der das vermag, was unser keiner kann. *Who that can do which none of us e'er can.*

Who can do what none of us can do

Kaiser

Ich hore doppelt, was er spricht, *Two meanings in his words I find,*

I hear double what he says—stereo bullshit?

Und dennoch überzeugt's mich nicht. *And yet they don't convince my mind.*

And yet it doesn't convince me.

Gemurmel

Was soll uns das?—Gedroschner Spass— *Why tell us that?—stuff stale and flat!*

What's this supposed to mean?—Stale joke—

Kalenderei—Chymisterei— *'Tis quackery!—'tis chemistry!*

Calendar-quackery—alchemy-fuckery—

Das hort' ich oft—Und falsch gehofft— *I've heard the strain—and hoped in vain,—*

I've heard this often—and hoped falsely—body remembering disappointment

Und kommt er auch—So ist's ein Gauch— *And though it come—'tis all a hum.*

And even if he delivers—it's still a con

Mephistopheles

Da stehen sie umher und staunen, *They stand around, amazed, unknowing;*

There they stand around and marvel

Vertrauen nicht dem hohen Fund, *They do not trust the treasure-spell;*

Don't trust the high discovery—bodies tensed in skepticism

Der eine faselt von Alraunen, *One dreams of mandrake, nightly growing,*

One babbles about mandrakes—because of course

Der andre von dem schwarzen Hund. *The other of the dog of Hell.*

The other about the black dog—hellhound fetish

Was soll es, dass der eine witzelt, *Why, then, should one suspect bewitching,*

So what if one cracks jokes

Ein anderer Zauberei verklagt, *And why the other jest and prate,*

Another complains of sorcery

Wenn ihm doch auch einmal die Sohle kitzelt, *When in their feet, they, too, shall feel the itching,*

When his own sole tickles him—sensation rising from below

Wenn ihm der sichere Schritt versagt. *When they shall walk with tottering gait?*

When his sure step fails him?

Ihr alle fühlt geheimes Wirken *All feel the secret operation*

You all feel the secret workings

Der ewig waltenden Natur, *Of Nature's ever-ruling might,*

Of eternally-ruling Nature—she runs things

Und aus den untersten Bezirken *And from the bases of Creation*

And from the lowest regions

Schmiegt sich herauf lebend'ge Spur. *A living track winds up to light.*

A living trace winds its way up to you

Wenn es in allen Gliedern zwackt, *In every limb when something twitches*

When it pinches in all your limbs

Wenn es unheimlich wird am Platz, *In any place uncanny, old,—*

When the place gets uncanny—liminal space alert

Nur gleich entschlossen grabt und hackt, *Decide at once, and dig for riches!*

Just decide: dig and hack!

Da liegt der Spielmann, liegt der Schatz! *There lies the fiddler, there the gold!*

There lies the fiddler, there lies the treasure—pay dirt

Gemurmel

Mir krabbelt's an der grossen Zeh'— *It hangs like lead my feet about,—*

Crawling on my big toe—sensation like ants

Mir tut der ganze Rucken weh— *I've cramp i' the arm—but that is gout.—*

My whole back hurts—that's definitely treasure-related, not posture

Nach solchen Zeichen ware hier *I've tickling in the greater toe.—*

By such signs this would be

Das allerreichste Schatzrevier. *Down all my back it pains me so.—*

The richest treasure-ground ever.

From signs like these 'tis very clear The richest treasure-ground is here.

Kaiser

Nur eilig! du entschlupfst nicht wieder, *Haste, then! Thou'lt not again make off!*

Quick! You're not slipping away again

Erprobe deine Lugenschaume *Test now thy frothy, lying graces,*

Test your lying froth now

Und zeig uns gleich die edlen Raume. *And show at once the golden places!*

And show us immediately these noble spaces—prove it or shut up

Ich lege Schwert und Zepter nieder *My sword and sceptre I will doff,*

I'll set down sword and scepter

Und will mit eignen hohen Handen, *Mine own imperial hands I'll lend thee,*

And with my own high hands

Wenn du nicht lugst, das Werk vollenden, *If thou liest not, therein befriend thee,*

If you're not lying, finish the work

Dich, wenn du lugst, zur Holle senden! *But, if thou liest, to Hell will send thee!*

If you ARE lying, I'll send you to Hell!

Mephistopheles

Den Weg dahin wusst' allenfalls zu finden— *I'd find, in any case, the pathway there!—*

The way there I could find anyway—Google Maps to Hell

Doch kann ich nicht genug verkunden, *Yet I cannot enough declare*

But I cannot proclaim enough

Was  berall besitzlos harrend liegt. *What, ownerless, waits everywhere.*

What lies ownerless waiting everywhere

Der Bauer, der die Furche pflugt, *The farmer, following his share,*

The farmer plowing his furrow

Hebt einen Goldtopf mit der Scholle, *Turns out a gold-crock with the mould:*

Turns up a gold-pot with the soil—jackpot in the dirt

Salpeter hofft er von der Leimenwand *He seeks saltpetre where the clay-walls stand,*

He hopes for saltpeter from the clay wall

Und findet golden-goldne Rolle *And findeth rolls of goldenest gold,*

And finds a golden-golden roll

Erschreckt, erfreut in kummerlicher Hand. *With joyful fright, in his impoverished hand.*

Frightened, delighted, in his careworn hand

Was f r Gewolbe sind zu sprengen, *What vaults there are to be exploded,*

What vaults there are to be blown open

In welchen Kluften, welchen Gangen *Along what shafts and mines corroded,*

In what crevices, what passages

Muss sich der Schatzbewusste drangen, *The gold-diviner's steps are goaded,*

The treasure-seeker must push through

Zur Nachbarschaft der Unterwelt! *Until the Under-world is nigh!*

Into the neighborhood of the Underworld—sketchy area

In weiten, altverwahrten Kellern *In cellars vast he sees the precious*

In wide, long-guarded cellars

Von goldnen Humpen, Schusseln, Tellern *Cups, beakers, vases, plates, and dishes,*

Of golden tankards, bowls, plates

Sieht er sich Reihen aufgestellt; *Row after row, resplendent lie:*

He sees rows standing arrayed

Pokale stehen aus Rubinen, *Rich goblets, cut from rubies, stand there,*

Goblets made from rubies

Und will er deren sich bedienen, *And, would he use them, lo! at hand there*

And if he wants to use them

Daneben liegt uraltes Nass. *Is ancient juice of strength divine.*

Nearby lies ancient liquid—wine older than memory

Doch—werdet ihr dem Kundigen glauben— *Yet, trust to him who's knowledge gotten,*

Yet—if you'll believe the expert—

Verfault ist längst das Holz der Dauben, *The wood o' the staves has long been rotten,*

The wood of the staves has long rotted

Der Weinstein schuf dem Wein ein Fass. *A cask of tartar holds the wine.*

The tartar made itself a cask for the wine.

Essenzen solcher edlen Weine, *Not only gold and gems are hiding,*

Essences of such noble wines

Gold und Juwelen nicht alleine *But of proud wines the heart abiding,*

Gold and jewels not alone

Umhüllen sich mit Nacht und Graus. *In terror and in night profound:*

Wrap themselves in night and horror

Der Weise forscht hier unverdrossen; *Herein assiduously explore the wise;*

The wise man researches here tirelessly—no work-life balance

Am Tag erkennen, das sind Possen, *It is a farce, by day to recognise,*

To recognize by day, that's just jokes

Im Finstern sind Mysterien zu Haus. *But mysteries are with darkness circled round.*

In darkness is where mysteries live.

Kaiser

Die lass' ich dir! Was will das Düstre frommen? *See thou to them! What profits the Obscure?*

I'll leave those to you! What good is the dark?

Hat etwas Wert, es muss zu Tage kommen. *Whate'er has value comes to daylight, sure.*

If something has value, it must come to daylight

Wer kennt den Schelm in tiefer Nacht genau? *At dead of night who can the rogue betray?*

Who can spot a scoundrel in deep night?—literally no one

Schwarz sind die Kuhe, so die Katzen grau. *Then all the cows are black, the cats are gray.*

Black are the cows, so gray the cats

Die Topfe drunten, voll von Goldgewicht— *If pots are down there, full of heavy gold,*

The pots down there, full of gold-weight

Zieh deinen Pflug und ackre sie ans Licht. *Drive on thy plough and turn them from the mould!*
Drive your plow and turn them up to light!

Mephistopheles

Nimm Hack' und Spaten, grabe selber, *Take hoe and spade thyself, I pray thee,—*

Take hoe and spade yourself, get farming—very Marie Antoinette

Die Bauernarbeit macht dich gross, *Thou shalt be great through peasant-toil!*

Peasant work makes you great—dirt under the nails

Und eine Herde goldner Kalber, *A herd of golden calves, to pay thee,*

And a whole herd of golden calves

Sie reissen sich vom Boden los. *Will loose their bodies from the soil.*

Will tear themselves loose from the ground—birth through soil

Dann ohne Zaudern, mit Entzucken *And then at once canst thou, with rapture,*

Then without hesitation, with delight

Kannst du dich selbst, wirst die Geliebte schmucken; *Gems for thyself and for thy mistress capture:*

You can adorn yourself, adorn your beloved

Ein leuchtend Farb- und Glanzgestein erhoht *Their tints and sparkles heighten the degree*

A glowing color-and-sparkle-gem elevates

Die Schonheit wie die Majestat. *Of Beauty as of Majesty.*

Beauty just as much as Majesty.

Kaiser

Nur gleich, nur gleich! Wie lange soll es wahren! *Then quick! at once! how long will it require?*

Right now! How long will this take?!

Astrolog (*prompted by Mephistopheles*)

Herr, massige solch dringendes Begehren, *Sire, moderate such urgency of desire!*

Sire, moderate such pressing desire—slow your pulse

Lass erst vorbei das bunte Freudenspiel; *Let first the gay, the motley pastime end!*

Let the colorful fun-games pass first—you can't skip the tutorial

Zerstreutes Wesen fuhr uns nicht zum Ziel. *Not to the goal doth such distraction tend.*

Scattered being does not lead us to the goal

Erst müssen wir in Fassung uns versuchen, *First self-command must quiet and assure us;*

First we must reconcile ourselves in composure.

Das Untre durch das Obere verdienen. *The upper things the lower will procure us.*

Earn the lower through the higher

Wer Gutes will, der sei erst gut; *Who seeks for Good, must first be good;*

Whoever wants good must first BE good

Wer Freude will, besanftige sein Blut; *Who seeks for joy, must moderate his blood;*

Whoever wants joy must calm their blood—cool the vessels

Wer Wein verlangt, der keltre reife Trauben; *Who wine desires, let him the ripe grapes tread;*

Whoever wants wine must press ripe grapes—no shortcuts

Wer Wunder hofft, der starke seinen Glauben. *Who miracles, by stronger faith be led!*

Whoever hopes for miracles must strengthen their faith

Kaiser

So sei die Zeit in Frohlichkeit vertan! *Let us the time in merriment efface!*

Fine! Let the time be wasted in merriment!

Und ganz erwünscht kommt Aschermittwoch an. *And, to our wish, Ash-Wednesday comes apace.*

And super conveniently Ash Wednesday is coming

Indessen feiern wir, auf jeden Fall, *Meanwhile, we'll surely celebrate withal*

Meanwhile we'll celebrate anyway

Nur lustiger das wilde Karneval. *More jovially the maddening Carnival.*

The wild Carnival, only MORE wild—let's get freaky

(Trumpets. Exeunt.)

Mephistopheles

Wie sich Verdienst und Gluck verketten, *How closely linked are Luck and Merit,*

How closely Luck and Merit link up—but nobody gets it

Das fällt den Toren niemals ein; *Doth never to these fools occur:*

The fools never realize this truth

Wenn sie den Stein der Weisen hatten, *Had they the Philosopher's Stone, I swear it,*

If they had the Philosopher's Stone

Der Weise mangelte dem Stein. *The Stone would lack the Philosopher!*

The Philosopher would be missing from the Stone.

Weitläufiger Saal mit Nebengemachern / Spacious Hall with Adjoining Apartments

Arranged and decorated for the Carnival Masquerade.

Herold

Denkt nicht, ihr seid in deutschen Grenzen *Think not, as in our German bounds, your chance is*

Not your grandma's polka night

Von Teufels-, Narren- und Totentänzen; *Of Death's or Fools' or Devils' dances;*

Leave your scythe at the door

Ein heitres Fest erwartet euch. *Here cheerful revels you await.*

Party hats mandatory

Der Herr, auf seinen Romerzügen, *Our Ruler, on his Roman expedition,*

Management retreat to pasta country

Hat, sich zu Nutz, euch zum Vergnügen, *Hath for his profit, your fruition,*

Team building with wine

Die hohen Alpen überstiegen, *Crossed o'er the Alpine high partition,*

Cardio with a view

Gewonnen sich ein heitres Reich. *And won himself a gayer State.*

Upgraded his empire

Der Kaiser, er, an heiligen Sohlen *He to the holy slipper bowed him*

Shoe worship, executive edition

Erbat sich erst das Recht zur Macht, *And first the right of power besought;*

Power permit approved

Und als er ging, die Krone sich zu holen, *Then, as he went to get the Crown allowed him,*

Buy one empire, get headwear free

Hat er uns auch die Kappe mitgebracht. *For us the Fool's-cap he has also brought.*

Dunce caps for democracy

Nun sind wir alle neugeboren; *Now are we all new-born, to wear it:*

Rebirth via accessory

Ein jeder weltgewandte Mann *Each tactful and experienced man,*

Experts in not dying

Zieht sie behaglich uber Kopf und Ohren; *Drawn cosily o'er head and ears, doth bear it;*

Hat on, brain off

Sie ahnelt ihn verruckten Toren, *A fool he seems, yet he must share it,*

Clown transformation complete

Er ist darunter weise, wie er kann. *And be, thereby, as sober as he can.*

Ironic fool status

Ich sehe schon, wie sie sich scharen, *They crowding come, I see already,*

Crowd forming, stand back

Sich schwankend sondern, traulich paaren; *Close coupling, or withdrawn unsteady,–*

Mixing and matching begins

Zudringlich schliesst sich Chor an Chor. *The choruses, like youth from school,*

Choir pile-up

Herein, hinaus, nur unverdrossen; *Come in or out, bring on your ranks!*

Flow like confused traffic

Es bleibt doch endlich nach wie vor *Before or after–'tis the rule–*

Eternal return of nonsense

Mit ihren hunderttausend Possen *With all its hundred thousand pranks,*

Maximum tomfoolery deployed

Die Welt ein einzig grosser Tor. *The World is one enormous Fool!*

Globe of goofballs

Gartnerinnen (*Song, accompanied with mandolines*)

Euren Beifall zu gewinnen, *That we win your praises tender*

Applause, please

Schmuckten wir uns diese Nacht, *We are decked in festal gear;*

Primping complete

Junge Florentinerinnen *At the German Court of splendour,*

Florence's finest

Folgt den deutschen Hofes Pracht; *Girls of Florence, we appear.*

Trophy florists

Tragen wir in braunen Locken *On our locks of chestnut glosses*

Follicle decorations

Mancher heitern Blume Zier; *Wear we many a flowery bell;*

Floral crown situation

Seidenfaden, Seidenflocken *Silken threads and silken flosses*

Thread count: high

Spielen ihre Rolle hier. *Here must play their parts, as well.*

Fabrics have entered the chat

Denn wir halten es verdienstlich, *Our desert, not over-rated,*

Merit badge: self

Lobenswertig ganz und gar, *Seems to us assured and clear,*

Top marks all around

Unsere Blumen, glanzend kunstlich, *For by art we've fabricated*

Plastic fantastic

Blühen fort das ganze Jahr. *Flowers that blossom all the year.*

Forever fresh

Allerlei gefarbten Schnitzeln *Every sort of coloured snipping*

Spectrum of scraps

Ward symmetrisch Recht getan; *Won its own symmetric right:*

Balance achieved

Mögt ihr Stück für Stück bewitzeln, *Though your wit on each be tripping,*

Mock the pixels, miss the picture

Doch das Ganze zieht euch an. *In the whole you take delight.*

Sum greater than parts

Niedlich sind wir anzuschauen, *We are fair to see and blooming,*

Decorative status achieved

Gärtnerinnen und galant; *Garden-girls, and gay of heart;*

Green thumbs, great dresses

Denn das Naturell der Frauen *For the natural way of woman*

Standard woman programming

Ist so nah mit Kunst verwandt. *Is so near akin to art.*

Nature plus effort equals female

Herold

Lasst die reichen Korbe sehen, *Let us see the wealth of blossoms*

Cargo reveal

Die ihr auf den Hauptern traget, *Basket-crowning heads that bear them,*

Head freight

Die sich bunt am Arme blahen, *Garlanding your arms and bosoms!*

Limb luggage

Jeder wähle, was behaget. *Each select, and lightly wear them.*

Help yourself

Eilig, dass in Laub und Gangen *Haste! and bosky arbours dressing,*

Landscaping speedrun

Sich ein Garten offenbare! *Let a garden here enring us!*

Spontaneous horticulture

Wurdig sind sie zu umdrängen, *Worthy they of closer pressing,*

Crowd worthy

Kramerinnen wie die Ware. *Hucksters and the wares they bring us.*

Buy one, admire the other

Gärtnerinnen

Feilschet nun am heitern Orte, *Now in cheerful places chaffer,*

Price negotiation enabled

Doch kein Markten finde statt! *But no marketing be ours!*

Fake market only

Und mit sinnig kurzem Worte *Briefly, clearly, let each laughter*

Brevity mode

Wisse jeder, was er hat. *Know the meaning of his flowers.*

Know your purchase

Olivenzweig mit Früchten

Mir ist's gegen die Natur: *Flowery sprays I do not covet;*

Anti-spectacle

Bin ich doch das Mark der Lande *Strife I shun, or branch above it,*

Core content

Und, zum sichern Unterpfande, *Foe of conflict I remain.*

Promise backed up

Friedenszeichen jeder Flur. *Yet am I the marrow of nations,*

Truce twig

Heute, hoff' ich, soll mir's glücken, *Pledge of happy consummations,*

Fingers crossed

Wurdig schönes Haupt zu schmucken. *Sign of peace on every plain.*

Cranium upgrade pending

Be, today, my lucky fate Worthy head to decorate!

Ahrenkranz (*golden*)

Ceres' Gaben, euch zu putzen, *You to crown, the gifts of Ceres*

Carb crown

Werden hold und lieblich stehn: *Here their kindly grace have sent;*

Beauty enhancement active

Das Erwünschtete dem Nutzen *Unto Use what chiefly dear is*

Function over form

Sei als eure Zierde schon. *Be your fairest ornament!*

Practical prettiness

Phantasiekranz

Bunte Blumen, Malven ähnlich, *Gayest blossoms, like to mallows,–*

Dream weeds

Aus dem Moos ein Wunderflor! *From the moss a marvel grew!*

Spontaneous flora

Der Natur ist's nicht gewöhnlich, *Fashion calls to light, and hallows,*

Natural law: suspended

Doch die Mode bringt's hervor. *That which Nature never knew.*

Vogue creates reality

Phantasiestrauss

Meinen Namen euch zu sagen, *What our name is, Theophrastus*

Identity withheld

Wurde Theophrast nicht wagen; *Would not dare to say: contrast us!*

Expert: stumped

Und doch hoff' ich, wo nicht allen, *Yet we hope to please you purely,*

Partial approval sought

Aber mancher zu gefallen, *If not all, yet many, surely,–*

Limited appeal

Der ich mich wohl eignen mochte, *Such as fain we'd have possess us,*

Preferred customers

Wenn sie mich ins Haar verflochte, *Braiding us in shining tresses,*

Braid me in

Wenn sie sich entschliessen konnte, *Or, a fairer fate deciding,*

Choose already

Mir am Herzen Platz vergonnte. *On the heart find rest abiding.*

Cardiac real estate

Rosenknospen (*Challenge*)

Mogen bunte Phantasieen *Motley fancies blossom may*

Fantasy approved

Für des Tages Mode blühen, *For the fashion of the day,*

Current meta

Wunderseltsam sein gestaltet, *Whimsical and strangely moulded,*

Geometry gone wild

Wie Natur sich nie entfaltet; *Such as Nature ne'er unfolded:*

Reality exception

Grüne Stiele, goldne Glocken, *Bells of gold and stems of green*

Bling botany

Blickt hervor aus reichen Locken!– *In the plenteous locks be seen!–*

Curl reveal

Doch wir–halten uns versteckt: *Yet we lie concealed behind;*

Hidden status

Glücklich, wer uns frisch entdeckt. *Lucky, who shall freshly find!*

First finder bonus

Wenn der Sommer sich verkunet, *When the summer-time returneth,*

Hot season incoming

Rosenknospe sich entzündet, *And the rosebud, bursting, burneth,*

Bloom explosion

Wer mag solches Glück entbehren? *Who such blisses would surrender?*

Bliss compulsory

Das Versprechen, das Gewahren, *Promise sweet, and yielding tender,*

Hype and follow-through

Das beherrscht in Florens Reich *They, in Flora's realm, control*

Flower kingdom rules

Blick und Sinn und Herz zugleich. *Swiftly eyes and sense and soul.*

Triple target lock

(Under green, leafy arcades, the Garden-girls adorn and gracefully exhibit their wares.)

Gartner *(Song, accompanied with theorbos)*

Blumen sehet ruhig spriessen, *Blossoms there, that sprout in quiet,*

Passive plant viewing

Reizend euer Haupt umzieren; *Round your heads their charms are weaving;*

Head: enhanced

Fruchte wollen nicht verführen, *But the fruits are not deceiving,*

No deception produce

Kostend mag man sie geniessen. *One may try the mellow diet.*

Taste test permitted

Bieten braunliche Gesichter *Sunburnt faces tempt with glowing*

Melanin marketing

Kirschen, Pfirschen, Königspflaumen, *Cherries, peaches, plums, your vision:*

Stone fruit parade

Kauft! denn gegen Zung' und Gaumen *Buy! for vain the eye's decision*

Tongue knows best

Halt sich Auge schlecht als Richter. *To the tongue's and palate's showing.*

Eyes: unreliable

Kommt, von allerreifsten Früchten *Ripest fruit from sunniest closes*

Peak fruit approaching

Mit Geschmack und Lust zu speisen! *Eat, with taste and pleasure smitten!*

Taste dining

Über Rosen lässt sich dichten, *Poems one may write on roses,*

Roses: decorative text

In die Apfel muss man beissen. *But the apple must be bitten!*

Bite the apple

Sei's erlaubt, uns anzupaaren *Then permit that we be mated*

Match me

Eurem reichen Jugendflor, *With your youth, so flowery-fair:*

Young and flowery

Und wir putzen reifer Waren *Thus is also decorated,*

Ripe goods shown

Fulle nachbarlich empor. *Neighbour-like, our riper ware.*

Adjacently

Unter lustigen Gewinden, *Under wreaths of flowery tether,*

Wreath zone

In geschmuckter Lauben Bucht, *As the leafy arbours suit,*

Decorative alcove

Alles ist zugleich zu finden: *All may then be found together,*

Bundle deal

Knospe, Blatter, Blume, Frucht. *Buds and leaves, and flower and fruit!*

Complete botanical set

Mutter

Madchen, als du kamst ans Licht, *Maiden, when thou cam'st to light,*

Arrival documented

Schmuckt' ich dich im Haubchen; *Tiny caps I wrought thee;*

Baby hat situation

Warst so lieblich von Gesicht *Body tender, soft, and white,*

Face: adorable

Und so zart am Leibchen. *Lovely face I brought thee.*

Softness verified

Dachte dich sogleich als Braut, *As a bride I thought thee, led*

Marriage forecast

Gleich dem Reichsten angetraut, *To the richest, wooed and wed,*

Rich match anticipated

Dachte dich als Weibchen. *As a wife I thought thee.*

Marital future imagined

Ach! Nun ist schon manches Jahr *Ah! already many a year,*

Time: passed

Ungenutzt verflogen, *Profitless, is over:*

Unused years

Der Sponsierer bunte Schar *None of all the wooers here*

Candidate pool

Schnell vorbeigezogen; *Now around thee hover;*

Gone now

Tanztest mit dem einen flink, *Though with one wast wont to dance,*

First dancer

Gabst dem andern feinen Wink *Gav'st another nudge and glance,—*

Hint deployed

Mit dem Ellenbogen. *Hast not found thy lover!*

Arm nudge

Welches Fest man auch ersann, *I to feast and revel thee*

Party count

Ward umsonst begangen, *Vainly took, to match one:*

Failure logged

Pfanderspiel und dritter Mann *Pawns, and hindmost man of three,*

Mating games

Wollten nicht verfangen; *Would not help thee snatch one.*

Net: empty

Heute sind die Narren los, *Ev'ry fool now wears his cap:*

Idiots unleashed

Liebchen, öffne deinen Schoß, *Sweetheart, open thou thy lap!*

Opening hours extended

Bleibt wohl einer hängen. *Still, perchance, mayst catch one!*

Stickiness anticipated

Holzhauer

Nur Platz! nur Blosse! *Room! make a clearing!*

Move, people

Wir brauchen Raume, *Room in your revel!*

Room needed

Wir fallen Baume, *The trees we level*

Timber service

Die krachen, schlagen; *That tumble cracking:*

Crash happening

Und wenn wir tragen, *Where we're appearing*

Hauling phase

Da gibt es Stosse. *Look out for whacking.*

Bump zone

Zu unserm Lobe *Our praise adjudging,*

Credit due

Bringt dies ins reine; *Make clear this fable!*

Point made

Denn wirkten Grobe *Save Coarse were drudging*

Rough work value

Nicht auch im Lande, *Within your borders,*

Work happening

Wie kamen Feine *Would Fine be able,*

Fancy people question

Für sich zustande, *To build their orders,*

Independence: denied

So sehr sie witzten? *Howe'er they fretted?*

Cleverness: useless

Des seid belehret! *Be taught in season,*

Lesson incoming

Denn ihr erfroht, *For you'd be freezing*

Freezing forecast

Wenn wir nicht schwitzten. *Had we not sweated!*

Perspiration: essential

Pulcinelle (*uncouth, almost idiotic*)

Ihr seid die Toren, *You, Fools, are trooping,*

You: foolish

Gebuckt geboren. *Since birth so stooping;*

Birth posture: hunched

Wir sind die Klugen, *The wise ones we are,*

Smart status: claimed

Die nie was trugen; *From burdens freer.*

Burden-free

Denn unsre Kappen, *Our caps, though sleazy,*

Hat report

Jacken und Lappen *And jackets breezy*

Garment status

Sind leicht zu tragen; *To wear are easy:*

Lightness achieved

Und mit Behagen *It gives us pleasure*

Pleasure status

Wir immer mussig, *To go with leisure,*

Laziness: constant

Pantoffelfussig, *With slippery shuffles*

Slipper mode

Durch Markt und Haufen *Through market-scuffles,*

Market traverse

Einherzulaufen, *To gape at the pother,*

Aimless walking

Gaffend zu stehen, *Croak at each other!*

Stare standing

Uns anzukrahen; *Through crowded places*

Noise exchange

Auf solche Klänge *You always trace us,*

Audio following

Durch Drang und Menge *Eel-like gliding,*

Mass navigation

Aalgleich zu schlupfen, *Skipping and hiding,*

Slippery status

Gesamt zu hupfen, *Storming together:*

Group bounce

Vereint zu toben. *Moreover, whether*

Collective madness

Ihr mogt uns loben, *You praise-reprove us,*

Approval: accepted

Ihr mogt uns schelten, *It doesn't move us.*

Criticism: accepted

Wir lassen's gelten. *It doesn't move us.*

Acceptance: total

Parasiten (*fawningly-lustful*)

Ihr wackern Trager *Ye woodland bandsmen,*

Hauler recognition

Und eure Schwager, *And they, your clansmen,*

In-law addition

Die Kohlenbrenner, *The charcoal-burners,*

Charcoal team

Sind unsre Manner. *To you we turn us:*

Our people

Denn alles Bucken, *For all such plodding,*

Bowing noted

Bejahndes Nicken, *Affirmative nodding,*

Yes-head motion

Gewundne Phrasen, *Tortuous phrases,*

Verbal twisting

Das Doppelblasen, *Blowing both ways—is*

Both-ways blowing

Das warmt und kuhlet, *Warming or chilling,*

Thermal options

Wie's einer fuhlet, *Just as you're feeling:*

Mood-based

Was konnt' es frommen? *What profit from it?*

Purpose query

Es mochte Feuer *There might fall fire,*

Flame potential

Selbst ungeheuer *Enormous, dire,*

Big fire

Vom Himmel kommen, *From heaven's summit,*

Sky fire

Gab' es nicht Scheite *Were there not billets*

No logs

Und Kohlentrachten, *And coal in waggons,*

Coal need

Die Herdesbreite *To boil your skillets*

Fire space

Zur Glut entfachten. *And warm your flagons.*

Heat start

Da brat's und prudelt's, *It roasts and frizzles;*

Sizzle status

Da kocht's und strudelt's. *It boils and sizzles!*

Bubble action

Der wahre Schmecker, *The taster and picker,*

Flavor professional

Der Tellerlecker, *The platter-licker,*

Clean plate person

Er riecht den Braten, *He sniffs the roasting,*

Smell sensor

Er ahnet Fische; *Suspects the fishes,*

Seafood sense

Das regt zu Taten *And clears, with boasting,*

Movement motivation

An Gonners Tische. *His patron's dishes.*

Boss dinner location

Trunkner (*unconsciously*)

Frische Lust und heitre Lieder, *Naught, today, bring melancholy!*

Good vibes activated

Holt' ich selbst sie doch herbei. *Since I feel so frank and free:*

Personal import

Und so trink' ich! Trinke, trinke! *Fresh delight and songs so jolly,*

Consumption: active

Stosset an, ihr! Tinke, Tinke! *And I brought them both with me!*

Clink protocol

Du dorthinten, komm heran! *Thus I'm drinking, drinking, drinking!*

Back-row call

Stosset an, so ist's getan. *Clink your glasses, clinking, clinking!*

Clink = done

You behind there, join the rout! Clink them stout, and then it's out!

Schrie mein Weibchen doch entrustet, *Though my wife assailed me loudly,*

Wife: unhappy

Rumpfte diesem bunten Rock, *Rumpled me through thin and thick;*

Outfit: disapproved

Und, wie sehr ich mich gebrustet, *And, howe'er I swaggered proudly,*

Puffing: ineffective

Schalt mich einen Maskenstock. *Called me "masquerading stick:"*

Name: costume stick

Doch ich trinke! Trinke, trinke! *Yet I'm drinking, drinking, drinking!*

Consumption: persistent

Angeklungen! Tinke, Tinke! *Clink your glasses! clinking, clinking!*

Clink complete

Maskenstocke, stosset an! *Masking sticks, another bout!*

Dummy cheers

Wenn es klingt, so ist's getan. *When you've clinked them, drink them out!*

Sound = success

Saget nicht, dass ich verirrt bin, *Say not mine a silly boast is!*

Not lost

Bin ich doch, wo mir's behagt. *I am here in clover laid:*

Position: chosen

Borgt der Wirt nicht, borgt die Wirtin, *Trusts the host not, trusts the hostess,–*

Backup funding

Und am Ende borgt die Magd. *She refusing, trusts the maid.*

Maid backup

Immer trink' ich! Trinke, trinke! *Still I'm drinking, drinking, drinking!*

Ongoing consumption

Auf, ihr andern! Tinke, Tinke! *Come, ye others, clinking, clinking!*

Others: summoned

Jeder jedem! so fortan! *Each to each! keep up the rout!*

Reciprocal drinking

Dunkt mich's doch, es sei getan. *We, I'm thinking, drink them out.*

Done feeling

Wie und wo ich mich vergnüge, *How and where my fun I'm spying,*

Pleasure: flexible

Mag es immerhin geschehn; *Let me have it as I planned!*

Let it be

Lass mich liegen, wo ich liege, *Let me lie where I am lying,*

Lying: approved

Denn ich mag nicht langer stehn. *For I cannot longer stand.*

Vertical: denied

Chor

Jeder Bruder trinke, trinke! *Every chum be drinking, drinking!*

All drink command

Toastet frisch ein Tinke, Tinke! *Toast afresh, with clinking, clinking!*

New clinks

Sitzet fest auf Bank und Span! *Bravely keep your seats, and shout!*

Bench grip

Unterm Tisch dem ist's getan. *Under the table lies drunk out.*

Floor position: final

Satiriker

Wisst ihr, was mich Poeten *Know ye what myself, the Poet,*

Joy question

Erst recht erfreuen sollte? *Would the most rejoice and cheer?*

Writer: me

Durft' ich singen und reden, *If I dared to sing, and utter,*

Voice permission

Was niemand horen wollte. *That which no one wants to hear.*

Undesired speech

Die Grazien

Aglaia

Anmut bringen wir ins Leben; *Life we bless with graces living;*

Elegance import

Leget Anmut in das Geben. *So be graceful in your giving!*

Stylish gifting

Hegemone

Leget Anmut ins Empfangen, *Graceful be in your receival;*

Graceful getting

Lieblich ist's, den Wunsch erlangen. *Wish attained is sweet retrieval.*

Desire: achieved

Euphrosyne

Und in stiller Tage Schranken *And in days serene and spacious,*

Calm period

Hochst anmutig sei das Danken. *In your thanks be chiefly gracious.*

Graceful gratitude

Die Parzen

Atropos

Mich, die Alteste, zum Spinnen *I, the eldest, to the spinning*

Thread starter

Hat man diesmal eingeladen; *Have received the invitation;*

Party invite

Viel zu denken, viel zu sinnen *When the thread of Life's beginning*

Thinking required

Gibt's beim zarten Lebensfaden. *There is need of meditation.*

Fragile thread

Dass er euch gelenk und weich sei, *Finest flax I winnow featly*

Flexibility target

Wusst' ich feinsten Flachs zu sichten; *That your thread be softly given;*

Premium fiber

Dass er glatt und schlank und gleich sei, *Draw it through my fingers neatly,*

Uniformity goal

Wird der kluge Finger schlichten. *Make it thin, and smooth, and even.*

Digital smoothing

Wolltet ihr bei Lust und Tanzen *If too wanton your endeavour,*

Fun limits

Allzu uppig euch erweisen, *Grasping here of joy each token,*

Too much alert

Denkt an dieses Fadens Grenzen, *Think, the thread won't stretch for ever!*

Breaking point

Hutet euch! Er mochte reißen. *Have a care! it might be broken.*

Tear alert**Klotho**

Wisst, in diesen letzten Tagen *Know that, given to me for wearing,*

News alert

Ward die Schere mir vertraut; *Lately were the shears supplied;*

Cutting tool transfer

Denn man war von dem Betragen *Since men were not by the bearing*

Unhappiness registered

Unsrer Alten nicht erbaut. *Of our eldest edified.*

Senior conduct

Zerrt unnutzeste Gespinnste *Useless webs she long untangled,*

Useless preservation

Lange sie an Licht und Luft, *Dragging them to air and light;*

Over-extended

Hoffnung herrlichster Gewinste *Dreams of fortune, hope-bespangled,*

Gain anticipation

Schleppt sie schneidend zu der Gruft. *Clipped and buried out of sight.*

Snip to death

Doch auch ich im Jugendwalten *Also I, in ignorance idle,*

Young mistake

Irrte mich schon hundertmal; *Made mistakes in younger years,*

Mistakes: many

Heute mich im Zaum zu halten, *But today, myself to bridle,*

Control mode

Schere steckt im Futteral. *In their sheath I stick the shears.*

Cutting: paused

Und so bin ich gern gebunden, *Thus restrained in proper measure*

Binding: voluntary

Blicke freundlich diesem Ort; *Favour I this cheerful place:*

Kind viewing

Ihr in diesen freien Stunden *You these hours of liberal pleasure*

Liberty hours

Schwarmt nur immer fort und fort. *Use at will, and run your race!*

Party persistence

Lachesis

Mir, die ich allein verständig, *In my hands, the only skilful,*

Smart self

Blieb das Ordnen zugeteilt; *Was the ordered twisting placed;*

Organization duty

Meine Weife, stets lebendig, *Active are my ways, not wilful,*

Spool: active

Hat noch nie sich ubereilt. *Erring not through over-haste.*

No rushing

Faden kommen, Faden weifen, *Threads are coming, threads are reeling;*

Fiber flow

Jeden lenk' ich seine Bahn, *In its course I each restrain:*

Direction service

Keinen lass' ich uberschweifen, *None, from off the circle wheeling,*

Containment: perfect

Fug' er sich im Kreis heran. *Fails to fit within the skein.*

Pattern inclusion

Kommt' ich einmal mich vergessen, *If I once regardless gadded,*

Distraction: hypothetical

War' es um die Welt mir bang; *For the world my hopes were vain:*

Global worry

Stunden zahlen, Jahre messen, *Hours are counted, years are added,*

Temporal measurement

Und der Weber nimmt den Strang. *And the weaver takes the chain.*

Final destination

Herold

Die jetzo kommen, werdet ihr nicht kennen, *You would not recognise who now appear,*

Mystery guests

Wart ihr noch so gelehrt in alten Schriften; *Though ne'er so learned you were in ancient writing;*

Books: useless

Sie anzusehn, die so viel Ubel stiften, *To look at them, in evil so delighting,*

Harm-causers viewed

Ihr wurdet sie willkommenen Gäste nennen. *You'd call them worthy guests, and welcome here.*

Guest error

Die Furien sind es, niemand wird uns glauben, *They are The Furies, no one will believe us,–*

Furies: present

Hubsch, wohlgestaltet, freundlich, jung von Jahren; *Fair, well-proportioned, friendly, young in years:*

Looks: misleading

Lasst euch mit ihnen ein, ihr sollt erfahren, *But make acquaintance, and straightway appears*

Involvement: risky

Wie schlangenhaft verletzen solche Tauben. *How snake-like are such doves to wound, deceive us.*

Cute but deadly

Zwar sind sie tückisch, doch am heutigen Tage, *Though they are spiteful, yet on this occasion,*

Evil: acknowledged

Wo jeder Narr sich ruhm't seiner Mangel, *When every fool exults in all his blame,*

Flaw pride

Auch sie verlangen nicht den Ruhm als Engel, *They also do not crave angelic fame,*

No halo here

Bekennen sich als Stadt- und Landesplage. *But own themselves the torments of the nation.*

Trouble: admitted

Alekto

Was hilft es euch? ihr werdet uns vertrauen, *What good of that? For you will trust us still!–*

You'll believe anyway

Denn wir sind hübsch und jung und Schmeichelkätzchen; *Each of us young and fair, a wheedling kitten.*

Kitten strategy

Hat einer unter euch ein Liebeschatzchen, *Hath one of you a girl with whom he's smitten,*

Partner query

Wir werden ihm so lang die Ohren krauen, *We'll rub and softly stroke his ears, until*

Ego massage

Bis wir ihm sagen dürfen, Aug' in Auge: *'Tis safe to tell him, spite of all his loathing,*

Direct message

Dass sie zugleich auch dem und jenem winke, *That she has also this and the other flame,–*

Flirtation alert

Im Kopfe dumm, im Rucken krumm, und hinke *A blockhead he, or humpbacked, squint and lame,*

Flaw inventory

Und, wenn sie seine Braut ist, gar nichts taugt. *And if betrothed to him, she's good-for-nothing!*

Worthless bride

So wissen wir die Braut auch zu bedrängen: *We're skilled, as well, the bride to vex and sever:*

Tormenting: also brides

Es hat sogar der Freund, vor wenig Wochen, *Why scarce a week ago, her very lover*

Partner: recent

Verachtliches von ihr zu der gesprochen!– *Contemptuous things to her was saying of her!*

Bad-mouthing: confirmed

Versohnt man sich, so bleibt doch etwas hangen. *Though they make up, there's something rankles ever.*

Lasting harm

Megara

Das ist nur Spass! denn, sind sie erst verbunden, *That's a mere jest! For, let them once be married,*

Wedding: worse

Ich nehm' es auf und weiss; in allen Fallen, *I go to work, and can, in every case,*

My turn

Das schönste Glück durch Grille zu vergallen; *The fairest bliss by wilful whims displace.*

Joy spoiling

Der Mensch ist ungleich, ungleich sind die Stunden. *Man has his various moods, the hours are varied,*

Variation: constant

Und niemand hat Erwünschtes fest in Armen, *And, holding the Desired that once did charm him,*

Keeping: failed

Der sich nicht nach Erwünschterem torig sehnte, *Each for the More-desired, a yearning fool,*

Better wanting

Vom höchsten Glück, woran er sich gewohnte; *Leaves the best fortune, use has rendered cool:*

Joy fatigue

Die Sonne flieht er, will den Frost erwärmen. *He flies the sun, and seeks the frost to warm him.*

Sun flee, frost seek

Mit diesem allen weiss ich zu gebaren *Of ills for all I understand the brewing,*

Manipulation ability

Und führe her Asmodi, den Getreuen, *And here Asmodi as my follower lead,*

Asmodi arrival

Zu rechter Zeit Unseliges auszustreuen, *To scatter mischief at the proper need,*

Bad luck distribution

Verderbe so das Menschevolk in Paaren. *And send the human race, in pairs, to ruin.*

Couple ruin

Tisiphone

Gift und Dolch statt bosser Zungen *Steel and poison I, not malice,*

Physical harm option

Misch' ich, scharf' ich dem Verrater; *Mix and sharpen for the traitor:*

Betrayer recipe

Liebst du andre, fruher, spater *Lov'st thou others, soon or later,*

Different lover: consequences

Hat Verderben dich durchdrungen. *Ruin pours for thee the chalice.*

Destruction: total

Muss der Augenblicke Susstes *Through the moment's sweet libation*

Moment evaluation

Sich zu Gischt und Galle wandeln! *See the gall and wormwood stealing!*

Taste reversal

Hier kein Markten, hier kein Handeln– *Here no bargaining, no dealing!*

No bargaining

Wie er es beging', er busst es. *Like the act and retaliation.*

Karma delivery

Singe keiner vom Vergeben! *No one babble of forgiving!*

No mercy

Felsen klag' ich meine Sache, *To the rocks I cry: Revenge! is*

Stone crying

Echo! horch! erwidert: Rache! *Echo's answer: he who changes*

Revenge echo

Und wer wechselt, soll nicht leben. *Shall be missed among the living.*

Life: revoked

Herold

Belieb' euch nun, seitwärts zu treten, *Do me the favour, now, to stand aside,*

Move aside

Denn was da kommt, ist nicht euresgleichen. *For that which comes is not to you allied.*

Not-your-type incoming

Ihr seht, wie sich ein Berg herangedrangt, *You see a mountain pressing through the throng,*

Big thing coming

Mit bunten Teppichen die Weichen stolz behangt, *The flanks with brilliant housings grandly hung,*

Carpet coverage

Ein Haupt mit langen Zähnen, Schlangennussel, *A head with tusks, a snaky trunk below,–*

Tusked trunk-face

Geheimnisvoll, doch zeig' ich euch den Schlüssel. *A mystery, yet I the key will show.*

Explanation coming

Im Nacken sitzt ihm zierlich-zarte Frau, *A delicate woman sits upon his neck,*

Woman: mounted

Mit feinem Stabchen lenkt sie ihn genau; *And with a wand persuades him to her beck;*

Steering: precise

Die andre, droben stehend herrlich-hehr, *The other, throned aloft, superb to see,*

Top rider

Umgibt ein Glanz, der blendet mich zu sehr. *Stands in a glory, dazzling, blinding me.*

Dazzle: maximum

Zur Seite gehn gekettet edle Frauen, *Beside him walk two dames in chains; one fearful*

Noble captives

Die eine bang, die andre froh zu schauen; *And sore depressed, the other glad and cheerful.*

Emotion contrast

Die eine wünscht, die andre fühlt sich frei. *One longs for freedom and one feels she's free:*

Wish vs feel

Verkünde jede, wer sie sei. *Let each declare us who she be!*

Name yourselves

Furcht

Dunstige Fackeln, Lampen, Lichter *Smoky torches, lamps are gleaming*

Smoke and light

Dammern durchs verworrne Fest; *Through the festival's wildering train;*

Party haze

Zwischen diese Truggesichter *Ah! amid these faces scheming*

Fake face area

Bannt mich, ach! die Kette fest. *I am fastened by my chain.*

Bondage: active

Fort, ihr lacherlichen Lacher! *Off, ridiculously merry!*

Ridiculous ones: leave

Euer Grinsen gibt Verdacht; *I mistrust your grinning spite:*

Smile: threatening

Alle meine Widersacher *Each relentless adversary*

Adversary presence

Drangen mich in dieser Nacht. *Presses nearer in the night.*

Closing: enemies

Hier! ein Freund ist Feind geworden, *Friend would here as foe waylay me,*

Friendship: reversed

Seine Maske kenn' ich schon; *But I know the masking shapes;*

Disguise: penetrated

Jener wollte mich ermorden, *Yonder's one that wished to slay me,–*

Kill wish: noted

Nun entdeckt schleicht er davon. *Now, discovered, he escapes.*

Caught: fleeing

Ach wie gern in jeder Richtung *From the world I fain would wander*

Flight wish

Floh' ich zu der Welt hinaus; *Through whatever gate I find;*

Escape: total

Doch von druben droht Vernichtung, *But perdition threatens yonder,*

Destruction: omnidirectional

Halt mich zwischen Dunst und Graus. *And the horror holds my mind.*

Horror holding

Hoffnung

Seid gegrusst, ihr lieben Schwestern! *Good my sisters, I salute you!*

Sis salutation

Habt ihr euch schon heut' und gestern *Though today already suit you,*

Past days

In Vermummungen gefallen, *Masquerading thus demurely,*

Costume fun

Weiss ich doch gewiss von allen: *Yet I know your purpose surely*

Certainty stated

Morgen wollt ihr euch enthüllen. *To reveal yourself tomorrow.*

Unmasking: scheduled

Und wenn wir bei Fackelscheine *And if we, by torches lighted,*

Flame illumination

Uns nicht sonderlich behagen, *Fail to feel a special pleasure,*

Fun: moderate

Werden wir in heitern Tagen *Yet in days of cheerful leisure,*

Cheerful day forecast

Ganz nach unserm eignen Willen *At our will, delight we'll borrow,*

Self-direction

Bald gesellig, bald alleine *Or alone or disunited*

Company: optional

Frei durch schöne Fluren wandeln, *Free through fairest pastures ranging,*

Field freedom

Nach Belieben ruhn und handeln *Rest and action interchanging,*

Action: optional

Und in sorgenfreiem Leben *And in life no cares that fetter*

Worry-free

Nie entbehren, stets erstreben; *Naught forego, but strive for better.*

No lack, always want

Überall willkommne Gäste, *Welcome guests are all around us,*

Guest status: welcome

Treten wir getrost hinein: *Let us mingle with the rest!*

Bold entrance

Sicherlich, es muss das Beste *Surely, what is best hath found us,*

Best: assured

Irgendwo zu finden sein. *Or we'll somewhere find the best.*

Findable: yes

Klugheit

Zwei der grossten Menschenfeinde, *Two of human foes, the greatest,*

Big threats: two

Furcht und Hoffnung, angekettet, *Fear and Hope, I bind the faster,*

Bound: both

Halt' ich ab von der Gemeinde; *Thus to save you at the latest:*

People: shielded

Platz gemacht! ihr seid gerettet. *Clear the way for me, their master.*

Saved: you

Den lebendigen Kolossen *I conduct the live colossus,*

Big live thing

Fuhr' ich, seht ihr, turmbeladen, *Turret-crowned with weighty masses;*

Tower cargo

Und er wandelt unverdrossen *And unweariedly he crosses,*

Walking: continuous

Schritt vor Schritt auf steilen Pfaden. *Step by step, the steepest passes.*

Difficult path

Droben aber auf der Zinne *But aloft the goddess planted,*

Top position

Jene Gottin, mit behenden *With her broad and ready pinions,*

Divine being

Breiten Flugeln, zum Gewinne *Turns to spy where gain is granted*

Broad wings

Allerseits sich hinzuwenden. *Everywhere in Man's dominions.*

All-way turning

Rings umgibt sie Glanz und Glorie, *Round her all is bright and glorious:*

Brightness: surrounding

Leuchtend fern nach allen Seiten; *Splendour streams on all her courses:*

All-way glow

Und sie nennet sich Viktorie, *Victory is she—the victorious*

Self-identification

Gottin aller Tätigkeiten. *Goddess of all active forces.*

Action deity

Zoilo-Thersites

Hu! Hu! da komm' ich eben recht, *Ho! ho! I've hit the time of day.*

Arrival: well-timed

Ich schelt' euch allzusammen schlecht! *You're all together bad, I say!*

All: bad

Doch was ich mir zum Ziel ersah, *But what appeared my goal to me*

Aim: stated

Ist oben Frau Viktoria. *Is she up there, Dame Victory.*

Target: Victory

Mit ihrem weissen Flugelpaar *She, with her snowy wings spread out,*

White wing description

Sie dunkt sich wohl, sie sei ein Aar, *Thinks she's an eagle, past a doubt;*

Bird delusion

Und wo sie sich nur hingewandt, *And, wheresoever she may stir,*

Turn direction

Gehor' ihr alles Volk und Land; *That land and folk belong to her!*

All: hers

Doch, wo was Ruhmliches gelingt, *But when a famous thing is done*

Praiseworthy: occurring

Es mich sogleich in Harnisch bringt. *I straightway put my harness on,*

Armor: donned

Das Tiefe hoch, das Hohe tief, *To lift the low, the high upset,*

High-low swap

Das Schiefe grad, das Grade schief, *The bent to straighten, bend the straight,–*

Crooked-straight swap

Das ganz allein macht mich gesund, *That, only, gives my heart a glow,*

Halt!

So will ich's auf dem Erdenrund. *And on this earth I'll have it so.*

Horses, rein in your wings—feel the bit against your wind

Herold

So treffe dich, du Lumpenhund, *Then take, thou beggar-cur, the blow,*

Feel the accustomed bridle

Des frommen Stabes Meisterstreich! *This magic baton's stroke of skill!–*

Master yourselves like I master you—it's called consent

Da krumm und winde dich sogleich!– *So, twist and wriggle at thy will!*

Rush forth when I get you hot and bothered–

Wie sich die Doppelzerggestalt *See how the double dwarfish ape*

Let's honor these spaces!–they have feelings too

So schnell zum eklen Klumpen ballt!– *Rolls to a hideous ball in shape!–*

Look around, how they multiply–bodies gathering like cells

–Doch Wunder!–Klumpen wird zum Ei, *A marvel! 'Tis an egg we view;*

The admirers, circle upon circle.

Das blaht sich auf und platzt entzwei. *It puffs itself and cracks in two:*

Herald, come! In your fashion

Nun fällt ein Zwillingsspaar heraus, *A pair of twins come forth today,*

Before we yeet ourselves outta here

Die Otter und die Fledermaus; *The Adder and the Bat are they.*

Describe us, name us—tell us what we are, daddy

Die eine fort im Staube kriecht, *Forth in the dust one winds and creeps,*

Because we're just allegories—we're not even real, technically

Die andre schwarz zur Decke fliegt. *One darkly round the ceiling sweeps.*

And so you should know us.

Sie eilen draussen zum Verein; *They haste to join in company:*

I couldn't name you if I tried—

Da mocht' ich nicht der dritte sein. *The third therein I would not be!*

But I could describe you—your surfaces speak to my eyes

Gemurmel

Frisch! dahinten tanzt man schon— *Come! the dance is yonder gay.—*

So try it!

Nein! Ich wollt', ich war' davon— *No! I would I were away.—*

One must admit—

Fuhlst du, wie uns das umflieht, *Feel'st thou how the phantom race*

First, you are young and beautiful

Das gespenstische Gezucht?— *Flits about us in this place?—*

Half-grown boy, still becoming—but the women, they'd want you fully ripe

Saust es mir doch ubers Haar— *Something whizzes past my hair.—*

They want to see you all the way grown up, if you know what I mean

Ward ich's doch am Fuss gewahr— *Round my feet I saw it fare.—*

You seem like a future fuckboy to me

Keiner ist von uns verletzt— *None of us are injured, though.—*

A natural-born heartbreaker, right from home.

Alle doch in Furcht gesetzt— *But we all are frightened so.—*

That tracks! Keep going, solve my riddle for fun!

Ganz verdorben ist der Spass— *Wholly spoiled is now the fun.—*

Invent the cheerful answer—let it form in your mouth

Und die Bestien wollten das. *Which the vermin wanted done.—*

The black lightning of the eyes, the night of the curls

Herold

Seit mir sind bei Maskeraden *Since, as Herald, I am aiding*

Brightened up by a jeweled headband!

Heroldspflichten aufgeladen, *At your merry masquerading,*

And what delicate clothes flow from shoulders to ankles—silk kissing skin

Wach' ich ernstlich an der Pforte, *At the gate I'm watching, fearful*

With purple trim and sparkly bits—giving slutty fairy

Dass euch hier am lustigen Orte *Lest within your revels cheerful*

One could call you a maiden—

Nichts Verderbliches erschleiche, *Something slips of evil savour;*

But for better or worse, you'd already score with girls right now

Weder wanke, weder weiche. *And I neither shrink nor waver.*

They'd teach you the ABC real quick

Doch ich furchte, durch die Fenster *Yet, I fear, the airy spectres*

And this one, who as a splendid form sits proud on the chariot throne?

Ziehen luftige Gespenster, *Enter, baffling all detectors,*

What about him?

Und von Spuk und Zaubereien *And from goblins that deceive you*

He seems a king, rich and mild

Wusst' ich euch nicht zu befreien. *I'm unable to relieve you.*

Lucky whoever gets on his good side!

Machte sich der Zwerg verdächtig, *First, the dwarf became suspicious;*

He has nothing left to achieve—peak unlocked

Nun! dort hinten stromt es mächtig. *Now a mightier pageant issues*

Where something's missing, his gaze detects it—eyes like scanners

Die Bedeutung der Gestalten *Yonder, and it is my duty*

And his pure joy in giving out—it's bigger than possession, bigger than getting off

Mocht' ich amtsgemäss entfalten. *To explain those forms of beauty:*

He just loves to GIVE.

Aber was nicht zu begreifen, *But the thing I comprehend not,*

You can't stop there—that's mid-boss content

Wusst' ich auch nicht zu erklären; *How can I its meaning mention?*

You must describe him exactly—every feature rendered

Helfet alle mich belehren!— *Help me to its comprehension!*

You can't describe Dignity itself.

Seht ihr's durch die Menge schweifen? *Through the crowd you see it wend not?*

But the healthy moon-round face

Vierbespannt ein prachtiger Wagen *Lo! a four-horse chariot wondrous,*

A full mouth, blooming cheeks—blood close to surface

Wird durch alles durchgetragen; *Hither drawn, the tumult sunders;*

Glowing under that turban's pressure—thicc face energy

Doch er teilet nicht die Menge, *Yet the crowd seems not to share in't—*

Rich comfort in the folded robe!—this man SLOUCHES with authority

Nirgend seh' ich ein Gedrange. *Nowhere is a crush apparent.*

What can I say about his bearing?

Farbig glitzert's in der Ferne, *Coloured lights, in distance dimmer,*

He seems familiar to me as a ruler

Irrend leuchten bunte Sterne *Motley stars around it shimmer;*

Plutus, the God of Wealth, is his name!

Wie von magischer Laterne, *Magic lantern-like they glimmer.*

Same one comes in pomp—the Emperor wants him BAD

Schnaubt heran mit Sturmgewalt. *On it storms, as to assault.*

The high Emperor desires him greatly.

Platz gemacht! Mich schaudert's!— *Clear the way! I shudder!—*

Now tell me the What and How of YOURSELF!

Knabe Wagenlenker

Halt! *Halt!*

Speak yourself into being

Rosse, hemmet eure Flügel, *Steeds, restrain the eager pinion,*

I am Profusion, I am Poetry!

Fühlet den gewohnten Zugel, *Own the bridle's old dominion,*

I am the Poet who completes himself—becomes whole

Meistert euch, wie ich euch meistre, *Check yourselves, as I desire you,*

When he squanders his own best goods

Rauschet hin, wenn ich begeistere— *Sweep away, when I inspire you!*—

I'm also insanely rich—loaded, stacked

Diese Raume lasst uns ehren! *Honour we these festal spaces!*

And I value myself equal to Plutus—same tier, different stats

Schaut umher, wie sie sich mehren, *See, the fast increasing faces,*

I animate and adorn his dance and feast

Die Bewunderer, Kreis um Kreise. *Circles, full of admiration!*

What he lacks, I hand out

Herold auf! nach deiner Weise, *Herald, come! and in thy fashion,*

The bragging suits you beautifully—it wears well on your frame

Ehe wir von euch entfliehen, *Ere we take from here our glories,*

But let's see your arts!

Uns zu schildern, uns zu nennen; *Name us, and describe and show us!*

Watch me snap my fingers once—and suddenly sparkle everywhere

Denn wir sind Allegorien, *For we're naught but allegories,*

Already it gleams and glitters around the chariot

Und so solltest du uns kennen. *Therefore 'tis thy place to know us.*

There springs forth a string of pearls!—pearly gates of bling

Herold

Wusste nicht, dich zu benennen; *No, thy name from me is hidden,—*

Take golden clasps for neck and ear—metal meeting skin

Eher konnte dich beschreiben. *Could describe thee, were I bidden.*

Also combs and little crowns, flawless

Knabe Lenker

So probier's!— *Try it!*

Rings with the most precious jewels!

Herold

Man muss gestehn: *Granted, at the start,*

I also scatter little flames here and there—waiting for something to catch

Erstlich bist du jung und schon. *Young and beautiful thou art,—*

Waiting to see where they ignite—hot where they land

Halbwuchsiges Knabe bist du; doch die Frauen, *A half-grown boy; and yet the woman-nature*

How the dear crowd grabs and snatches!—hands like hungry mouths

Sie mochten dich ganz ausgewachsen schauen. *Would rather see thee in completed stature.*

The giver almost gets mobbed

Du scheinst mir ein künftiger Sponsierer, *To me thou seem'st a future fickle wooer,*

He snaps trinkets like in a dream

Recht so von Haus aus ein Verführer. *Changing the old betrayed love for a newer.*

And everyone snatches in the wide space!

Knabe Lenker

Das lässt sich horen! fahre fort, *Go on! So far, 'tis very fine:*

But here I observe new tricks—

Erfinde dir des Ratsels heitres Wort. *Make the enigma's gay solution thine!*

Whatever someone greedily grabs

Herold

Der Augen schwarzer Blitz, die Nacht der Locken, *Black lightning of the eyes, the dark locks glowing,*

Earns them truly poor reward—the treasure rejecting them

Erheitert von juwelnem Band! *Yet bright with jewelled anadem,*

The gift flutters away from them!

Und welch ein zierliches Gewand *And light thy robe as flower on stem,*

The pearl string dissolves

Fliesst dir von Schultern zu den Socken, *From shoulder unto buskin flowing*

Beetles crawl in his hand—nature's UNO reverse

Mit Purpursaum und Glitzertand! *With tinsel-braid and purple hem!*

He throws them off, poor fool

Man konnte dich ein Mädchen schelten; *One for a maiden might surmise thee,*

And they buzz around his head—cockblocked by insects

Doch wurdest du, zu Wohl und Weh, *Yet, good or ill, as it might be,*

Others instead of solid things—catch frivolous butterflies

Auch jetzt schon bei Mädchen gelten, *The maids, e'en now, would take and prize thee:*

How the rascal promises so much

Sie lehrten dich das ABC. *They'd teach thee soon thy ABC.*

And only gives what glitters gold!

Knabe Lenker

Und dieser, der als Prachtgebilde *And he, who like a splendid vision,*

Masks you know how to announce, sure—you're good at surfaces

Hier auf dem Wagenthron prangt? *Sits proudly on the chariot's throne?*

But to grasp the essence beneath the shell

Herold

Er scheint ein König reich und milde, *He seems a king of mien Elysian;*

Is not a herald's court-business—too deep for job description

Wohl dem, der seine Gunst erlangt! *Blest those, who may his favour own!*

That requires sharper sight.

Er hat nichts weiter zu erstreben, *No more has he to earn or capture;*

But I'll avoid any beef

Wo's irgend fehlte, spaht sein Blick, *His glance detects where aught's amiss,*

To you, Master, I direct my question and speech—turning to the big man

Und seine reine Lust zu geben *And to bestow his perfect rapture*

Did you not entrust to me the storm-wind of the four-horse team?

Ist grosser als Besitz und Glück. *Is more than ownership and bliss.*

Don't I steer successfully where you lead?—my hands following your intention

Knabe Lenker

Hiebei darfst du nicht stehen bleiben, *Thou dardest not at this point desist;*

Am I not there wherever you point?—GPS locked

Du musst ihn recht genau beschreiben. *Describe him fully, I insist!*

And did I not on bold wings win the palm for you?

Herold

Das Wurdige beschreibt sich nicht. *But undescribed is Dignity.*

However often I've fought for you, it's always worked out

Doch das gesunde Mondgesicht, *The healthy, full-moon face I see,*

When laurel adorns your brow—I braided it with sense and hand, baby

Ein voller Mund, erbluhte Wangen, *The ample mouth, the cheeks that fresher*

I wove it with intention and touch

Die unterm Schmuck des Turbans prangen; *Shine out beneath his turban's pressure,*

If it's necessary that I bear witness for you

Im Faltenkleid ein reich Behagen! *Rich comfort in the robe he's wearing!*

I'll gladly say: You are spirit of my spirit—same wavelength

Was soll ich von dem Anstand sagen? *What shall I say of such a bearing?*

You always act according to my mind

Als Herrscher scheint er mir bekannt. *He seems, as ruler, known to me.*

You are richer than I myself am!

Knabe Lenker

Plutus, des Reichtums Gott genannt! *Plutus, the God of Wealth, is he.*

I value, to reward your service—the green branch above all my crowns

Derselbe kommt in Prunk daher, *He hither comes in proud attire;*

Green > Gold in my economy

Der hohe Kaiser wünscht ihn sehr. *Much doth the Emperor him desire.*

A true word I proclaim to all—no cap detected

Herold

Sag von dir selber auch das Was und Wie! *Of thee the What and How declare to me!*

My dear Son, in you I am well pleased.

Knabe Lenker

Bin die Verschwendung, bin die Poesie; *I am Profusion, I am Poesy,*

The greatest gifts from my hand—look! I've scattered them all around

Bin der Poet, der sich vollendet, *The Poet I, whose perfect crown is sent*

On this head and that glows a little flame I sprayed—fire kissing skulls

Wenn er sein eigenst Gut verschwendet. *When he his own best goods hath freely spent.*

It hops from one to another

Auch ich bin unermesslich reich *Yet, rich in mine unmeasured pelf,*

Holds to this one, slips from that one—choosy little flame-slut

Und schatze mich dem Plutus gleich, *Like Plutus I esteem myself:*

Very seldom flames up high—most folks don't catch fire

Beleb' und schmuck' ihm Tanz und Schmaus, *I prank and cheer his festal show,*

And shines briefly in short bloom.

Das, was ihm fehlt, das teil' ich aus. *And whatsoe'er he lacks bestow.*

But for many, before they even notice—the light dies, burned out sadly

Herold

Das Prahlen steht dir gar zu schon, *Fresh charm to thee thy brag imparts,*

Tragic.

Doch lass uns deine Kunste sehn. *But let us now behold thine arts!*

That one up there on the four-horse rig—definitely a charlatan

Knabe Lenker

Hier seht mich nur ein Schnippchen schlagen, *Just see me fillip with my fingers!*

Behind him squats a clown—Hanswurst perching

Schon glanzts und glitzerts um den Wagen. *What brilliance round the chariot lingers.*

But wasted from hunger and thirst—body depleted to nothing

Da springt eine Perlenschnur hervor! *And there a string of pearls appear!*

Like you've never seen him before.

(continuing to fillip and snap his fingers in all directions)

Nehmt goldne Spange fur Hals und Ohr; *Take golden spangles for neck and ears,*

He probably doesn't feel it when you pinch him

Auch Kamm und Kronchen ohne Fehl, *Combs, and diadems free of flaw,*

Too skinny to register pain—that's concerning

In Ringen kostlichstes Juwel; *And jewelled rings as ne'er ye saw!*

Away, disgusting females! I know you'd have me gone

Auch Flammchen spend' ich dann und wann, *I also scatter flamelets bright,*

When woman still minded her own hearth—I was called Avaritia—remember me?

Erwartend, wo es zunden kann. *Awaiting where they may ignite.*

Then our house thrived well

Herold

Wie greift und hascht die liebe Menge! *How strives the crowd with eager longing,*

Only much IN and nothing OUT!

Fast kommt der Geber ins Gedrange. *Almost upon the giver thronging!*

I was passionate about chests and cabinets

Kleinode schnippt er wie ein Traum, *As in a dream he snaps the toys;*

That's supposed to be a vice?—hoarding feels right in the hands

Und alles hascht im weiten Raum. *All catch and snatch with crush and noise.*

But since in these modern times—the wife's not used to saving anymore

Doch da erleb' ich neue Pffiffe: *But now new tricks have I detected:*

And like every bad accountant—has way more desires than dollars

Was einer noch so emsig griffe, *What each has zealously collected*

Much remains for the husband to suffer

Des hat er wirklich schlechten Lohn, *His trouble doth but poorly pay;*

Wherever he looks, there are debts.

Die Gabe flattert ihm davon. *The gifts take wings and fly away.*

Whatever she can scrape up—she turns to her body, to her lover

Es lost sich auf das Perlenband, *The pearls are loosened from their band*

She also eats better, drinks even more—with her tedious horde of wooers

Ihm krabbeln Kafer in der Hand, *And beetles crawl within his hand;*

That raises money's appeal for me

Er wirft sie weg, der arme Tropf, *He shakes them off, and then instead,*

I'm male gendered—the Greed!

Und sie umsummen ihm den Kopf. *Poor dolt, they hum around his head!*

With dragons let the dragon be stingy—it's all lies anyway!

Die andern statt solider Dinge *The others find their solid things*

He comes to stir up the men—they're already inconvenient enough

Erhaschen frevle Schmetterlinge. *Are butterflies with gaudy wings.*

They don't need encouragement!

Wie doch der Schelm so viel verheisst *How much the scamp to promise seems,*

The scarecrow! Slap him one!

Und nur verleiht, was golden gleisst! *And only gives what golden gleams!*

What does this torture-stick think he's threatening us with?

Knabe Lenker

Zwar Masken, merk' ich, weisst du zu verkunden, *Masks to announce, I grant, thou'rt worthy;*

We're supposed to fear HIS ugly mug?—please

Allein der Schale Wesen zu ergrunden, *But 'neath the shell of Being to bestir thee*

The dragons are wood and cardboard

Sind Herolds Hofgeschafte nicht; *Is not a herald's courtly task:*

Come on, push in on him!

Das fordert scharferes Gesicht. *A sharper sight for that we ask.*

By my staff! Keep still!—bodies frozen

Doch hut' ich mich vor jeder Fehde; *Yet every quarrel I evade;*

But my help is barely needed—

An dich, Gebieter, wend' ich Frag' und Rede. *To thee, my Chief, be speech and question made!*

See how the grim mis-shapes unfold their double wing-pairs

(Turning to Plutus.)

Hast du mir nicht die Windesbraut *Didst thou not unto me confide*

The dragons shake themselves pissed off—scaly, fire-spewing jaws

Des Viergespannes anvertraut? *The tempest of the steeds I guide?*

The crowd flees, the place is clear!

Lenk' ich nicht glücklich, wie du leitest? *Canst thou not on my guidance reckon?*

He steps down—how kingly!

Bin ich nicht da, wohin du deutest? *Am I not there, where thou dost beckon?*

He signals, the dragons stir—obedient to gesture

Und wusst' ich nicht auf kühnen Schwingen *And have I not, on pinions boldest,*

They've carried the chest from the wagon—with Gold and Greed aboard

Für dich die Palme zu erringen? *Conquered for thee the palm thou holdest?*

It stands at his feet

Wie oft ich auch für dich gefochten, *When in thy battles I have aided,*

A miracle, how it happened!

Mir ist es jederzeit geglückt: *I ever have been fortunate;*

Now you're free from the all-too-heavy weight—unburdened body

Wenn Lorbeer deine Stirne schmückt, *Thy brow when laurels decorate,*

You're free and clear—fresh off to your sphere!

Hab' ich ihn nicht mit Sinn und Hand geflochten? *Have I not them with hand and fancy braided?*

It's not HERE! Confused, gaudy, wild—grotesque pictures crowd us

Plutus

Wenn's nötig ist, dass ich dir Zeugnis leiste, *If there be need that I bear witness now,*

Only where you gaze clear into sweet clarity

So sag' ich gern: Bist Geist von meinem Geiste. *I'm glad to say: soul of my soul art thou!*

Belonging to yourself and trusting yourself alone

Du handelst stets nach meinem Sinn, *Thine acts are always to my mind,*

There, where only the Beautiful and Good please—

Bist reicher, als ich selber bin. *And thou the richer art, I find.*

To Solitude!—There create your world

Ich schätze, deinen Dienst zu lohnen, *Thy service to reward, I hold*

(Very “go touch grass but make it cosmic”)

Den grünen Zweig vor allen meinen Kronen. *The green bough higher than my crowns of gold.*

So I count myself a worthy envoy

Ein wahres Wort verkünd’ ich allen: *To all a true word spoken be:*

So I love you as my nearest kin

Mein lieber Sohn, an dir hab’ ich Gefallen. *Dear Son, I much delight in thee.*

Where you linger is fullness; where I am—everyone feels in splendid gain

Knabe Lenker (*to the Crowd*)

Die grossten Gaben meiner Hand, *The greatest gifts my hand flings out,*

Also people waver in contradictory life—should they go with you? Or me?

Seht! hab’ ich rings umher gesandt. *See! I have scattered round about.*

Your followers CAN be idle, just lounging

Auf dem und jenem Kopfe glüht *On divers heads there glows the tongue*

But whoever follows ME always has something to do!

Ein Flämmchen, das ich angesprüht; *Of flame which I upon them flung,—*

I don’t perform my deeds in secret

Von einem zu dem andern hüpft’s, *Leaps back and forth among the shapes,*

I only breathe and I’m already betrayed—my presence announces itself

An diesem halt sich’s, dem entschlüpft’s, *On this remains, from that escapes,*

So farewell! You grant me my happiness

Gar selten aber flammt’s empor, *But very seldom upward streams*

But whisper softly and I’ll be right back!

Und leuchtet rasch in kurzem Flor; *In transient flush of mellow beams;*

Now it’s time to unchain the treasures!—crack open the good stuff

Doch vielen, eh’ man’s noch erkannt, *And unto many, ere they mark,*

The locks I strike with the Herald’s wand—metal singing

Verlischt es, traurig ausgebrannt. *It is extinct and leaves them dark.*

It opens! Look here! In bronze kettles

Weibergeklatsch

Da droben auf dem Viergespann *Upon the chariot that man*

It develops and rolls with golden blood—liquid money porn

Das ist gewiss ein Scharlatan; *Is certainly a charlatan:*

First the jewelry of crowns, chains, rings

Gekauzt da hintendrauf Hanswurst, *There, perched behind, the clown is seen,*

It swells and threatens to melt them all!

Doch abgezehrt von Hunger und Durst, *From thirst and hunger grown so lean*

See here, over there! How richly it wells—fills the chest to the brim

Wie man ihn niemals noch erblickt; *As one ne'er saw him; if you'd pinch,*

Golden vessels melting—coined rolls turning

Er fühlt wohl nicht, wenn man ihn zwickt. *He hasn't flesh to feel and flinch.*

Ducats hopping fresh-minted!—money with bounce

Der Abgemagerte (*The Starveling / Avarice*)

Wie noch die Frau den Herd versah, *Disgusting women, off! I know*

Oh how that stirs my chest!

Da hiess ich Avaritia; *That when I come, you'd have me go.*

How I see all my desires!

Da stand es gut um unser Haus: *When woman fed her own hearth-flame,*

They're rolling along the floor!

Nur viel herein und nichts hinaus! *Then Avaritia was my name;*

It's offered to you—use it quick!—just bend down and get rich

Ich eiferte für Kist' und Schrein; *Then throve the household fresh and green,*

We others, quick as lightning—will take possession of the coffer

Das sollte wohl gar ein Laster sein. *For naught went out and much came in.*

What's this, you fools? What gives?

Doch als in allerneuster Jahren *To chest and press I gave good heed,*

It's just a masquerade joke!

Das Weib nicht mehr gewohnt zu sparen, *And that you'd call a vice, indeed!*

Tonight no more shall be desired

Und, wie ein jeder bosser Zahler, *But since in later years, the fact is,*
You think we're handing out gold and value? Seriously?
 Weit mehr Begierden hat als Taler, *Economy the wife won't practise,*
Even game tokens are too much for you—can't handle fake money
 Da bleibt dem Manne viel zu dulden, *And, like the host of spendthrift scholars,*
You bumblers! A pretty illusion—should immediately be dumb truth?
 Wo er nur hinsieht, da sind Schulden. *Has more desires than she has dollars,*
What's truth to you?—Dull delusion you grasp by all its corners
 Sie wendet's, kann sie was erspulen, *The husband much discomfort brooks,*
Masked Plutus, Masquerade Hero—drive this mob from the field!
 An ihren Leib, an ihren Buhlen; *For there are debts where'er he looks.*
Your staff is ready for that
 Auch speist sie besser, trinkt noch mehr *She spends what spoil she may recover*
Lend it to me for a bit
 Mit der Sponsierer leidigem Heer; *Upon her body, or her lover;*
I dip it quick in the boil and glow—heat meeting heat
 Das steigert mir des Goldes Reiz: *In luxury eats, and to excess*
Now, masks, be on your guard!
 Bin mannlichen Geschlechts, der Geiz! *Drinks with the flirts that round her press;*
How it flashes and pops, spews sparks!—fireworks from a stick
For me that raises money's price: Male is my gender, Avarice!

Hauptweib (*Leader of the Women*)

Mit Drachen mag der Drache geizen; *With dragons, mean may be the dragon;*
The staff is already glowing hot—health and safety has left the chat
 Ist's doch am Ende Lug und Trug! *It's all, at best, but lying stuff!*
Whoever crowds too close—is mercilessly singed at once
 Er kommt, die Manner aufzureizen, *He comes, the men to spur and egg on,*
Now I begin my circuit!
 Sie sind schon unbequem genug. *And now they're troublesome enough.*
Oh no! We're done for!

Weiber in Masse (*Crowd of Women*)

Der Strohmann! Reich ihm eine Schlappe! *The scarecrow! Knock him from the waggon!*

Flee whoever can flee!

Was will das Marterholz uns draun? *What means the fag, to threaten here?*

Back, back, you hindmost!—bodies colliding

Wir sollen seine Fratze scheun! *As if his ugly face we'd fear!*

It sprays hot in my face!—facial

Die Drachen sind von Holz und Pappe, *Of wood and pasteboard is each dragon:*

The weight of the glowing staff presses me

Frisch an und dringt auf ihn hinein! *Come on—his words shall cost him dear!*

We're all lost, all of us!

Herold

Bei meinem Stabe! Ruh gehalten!— *Now, by my wand! Be still—let none stir!*

Back, back, you mask-surge!—wave of flesh retreating

Doch braucht es meiner Hülfe kaum; *Yet for my help there's scarcely need;*

Back, senseless heap!—oh if I had wings I'd fly away

Seht, wie die grimmen Ungestalten, *See how each grim and grisly monster,*

The circle is already pressed back

Bewegt im rasch gewonnenen Raum, *Clearing the space around with speed,*

And no one, I believe, is singed.

Das Doppel-Flugelpaar entfalten. *Unfolds his fourfold wings of dread!*

The crowd yields—it is scared off

Entrustet schütteln sich der Drachen *The dragons shake themselves in anger,*

Yet as pledge of such order—I draw an invisible band

Umschuppte, feuerspeiende Rachen; *With flaming throats, and scaly clangour;*

(force field activated)

Die Menge flieht, rein ist der Platz. *The place is clear, the crowd has fled.*

You've accomplished a glorious work!

(Plutus descends from the chariot.)

Herold

Er tritt herab, wie königlich! *How kingly comes he from above!*

How I thank your clever might!

Er winkt, die Drachen rühren sich, *He beckons, and the dragons move;*

Patience is still needed, noble friend

Die Kiste haben sie vom Wagen *Then from the chariot bring the chest*

Various tumults still threaten—chaos waiting in the wings

Mit Gold und Geiz herangetragen, *With gold, and Avarice thereon.*

So one CAN, if it pleases, pleasantly observe this circle—prime viewing

Sie steht zu seinen Füssen da: *See, at his feet the load they rest!*

For evermore the women are foremost—where there's gawking, where there's nibbling

Ein Wunder ist es, wie's geschah. *A marvel 'tis, how it was done.*

I'm not yet so completely rusted!—senses still alive

Plutus (*to the Charioteer*)

Nun bist du los der allzulastigen Schwere, *Now thou hast left the onerous burden here,*

A beautiful woman is always beautiful

Bist frei und frank, nun frisch zu deiner Sphäre! *Thou'rt wholly free: away to thine own sphere!*

And today, since it costs me nothing—

Hier ist sie nicht! Verworren, scheckig, wild *Here it is not! Confused and wild, today,*

We'll confidently go courting

Umdrängt uns hier ein fratzenhaft Gebild. *Distorted pictures press around our way.*

But since at such an overstuffed place—not every ear catches every word

Nur wo du klar ins holde Klare schaust, *Where clear thy gaze in sweet serenity,*

I'll try cleverly—hope it works—to express myself through pantomime

Dir angehört und dir allein vertraut, *Owning thyself, confiding but in thee,*

Hand, foot, gesture won't suffice—need a prank to fill the gap

Dorthin, wo Schönes, Gutes nur gefällt, *Thither, where Good and Beauty are unfurled,*

I'll treat the gold like wet clay.

Zur Einsamkeit!—Da schaffe deine Welt. *To Solitude!—and there create thy world!*

This metal can be turned into anything

Knabe Lenker

So acht' ich mich als werten Abgesandten, *Thus, as an envoy, am I worthy of thee;*

What's this lean fool starting?—does such a hunger-man have humor?

So lieb' ich dich als nächsten Anverwandten. *Thus, as my next of kindred, do I love thee.*

He kneads all the gold to dough—getting his hands dirty

Wo du verweilst, ist Fülle; wo ich bin, *Where thou art, is abundance; where I go*

It goes soft under his hands—but however he presses, however he balls it

Fühlt jeder sich im herrlichsten Gewinn. *Each sees a splendid profit round him grow.*

It always remains just shapeless

Auch schwankt er oft im widersinnigen Leben: *In inconsistent life each often wavers,*

He turns to the women there—

Soll er sich dir? soll er sich mir ergeben? *Whether to seek from thee, or me, the favours.*

They all scream, want to get away

Die Deinen freilich können müßig ruhn, *Thy followers may be indolent, 'tis true;*

Acting all disgusted—the rascal proves himself nasty

Doch wer mir folgt, hat immer was zu tun. *Who follows me, has always work to do.*

I fear he delights when he offends decency—transgression as pleasure

Nicht insgeheim vollfuhr' ich meine Taten, *My deeds are never secret and concealed;*

I dare not stay silent about this—give me my staff to drive him off!

Ich atme nur, und schon bin ich verraten. *I only breathe, and I'm at once revealed.*

He doesn't suspect what threatens us from outside

So lebe wohl! Du gonnst mir ja mein Glück; *Farewell, then! Thou the bliss hast granted me;*

Let him do his fool's-pastime

Doch lispel leis', und gleich bin ich zurück. *But whisper low, and I return to thee!*

He'll have no room for his pranks soon.

(Exit, as he came.)

Plutus

Nun ist es Zeit, die Schätze zu entfesseln! *'Tis time, now, to unchain the precious metals!*

Law is mighty—mightier is Necessity—bodies bending to force

Die Schlosser trefft' ich mit des Herolds Rute. *The padlocks with the herald's wand I smite:*

The wild horde comes all at once!—from mountain height and forest valley

Es tut sich auf! schaut her! in ehrnen Kesseln *The chest is opened: look! from iron kettles*

Irresistibly they stride forward—feet pounding earth

Entwickelt sich's und wallt von goldnem Blute, *It pours like golden blood before your sight.*

They celebrate their great Pan!

Zunachst der Schmuck von Kronen, Ketten, Ringen; *It boils, and threatens to devour, as fuel,*

They know what no one knows—and crowd into the empty circle

Es schwillt und droht, ihn schmelzend zu verschlingen. *Melting them, crown and ring and chain and jewel!*

Very sus energy

Wechselgeschrei der Menge (*Alternate Cries of the Crowd*)

Seht hier, o hin! wie's reichlich quillt, *See here, and there! they boil and swim;*

I know you well and your great Pan!

Die Kiste bis zum Rande fullt.— *The chest is filling to the brim!—*

Together you've made a bold move

Gefasse, goldne, schmelzen sich, *Vessels of gold are burning there,*

I know quite well what not everyone knows—and dutifully open this tight circle

Gemunzte Rollen walzen sich.— *And minted rolls are turning there,*

May good fortune accompany them!

Dukaten hupfen wie geprägt, *And ducats jingle as they jump!—*

The strangest things can happen—they don't know where they're striding

O wie mir das den Busen regt— *O, how my heart begins to thump!—*

They haven't looked ahead—just vibing into chaos

Wie schau' ich alle mein Begehr! *All my desire I see, and more,*

Dolled-up folk, you tinsel-show!

Da kollern sie am Boden her.— *They're rolling now along the floor.—*

They come raw, they come rough—in high leap, in quick run

Man bietet's euch, benutzt's nur gleich *'Tis offered you: don't be a dunce,*

They step hearty and capable!

Und buckt euch nur und werdet reich.— *Stoop only, and be rich at once!—*

Stomping energy, no apologies

Wir andern, rustig wie der Blitz, *Then, quick as lightning we, the rest,*

The faun-troop in merry dance

Wir nehmen den Koffer in Besitz. *Will take possession of the chest.*

Oak wreath in curly hair—leaves crowning wild locks

Herold

Was soll's, ihr Toren? soll mir das? *What ails ye, fools? What mean ye all?*

A fine pointed ear pokes through the curly head—elf ears, but make it sexy

Es ist ja nur ein Maskenspass. *'Tis but a joke of Carnival.*

A stubby nose, a broad face

Heut abend wird nicht mehr begehrt; *Tonight be your desires controlled;*

That doesn't hurt anything with women!

Glaubt ihr, man geb' euch Gold und Wert? *Think you we'd give you goods and gold?*

When the Faun offers his paw—the fairest won't easily refuse the dance

Sind doch fur euch in diesem Spiel *Why, in this game there come to view*

His rough palm extended like an invitation

Selbst Rechenpfennige zuviel. *Too many counters even, for you.*

The Satyr hops along behind

Ihr Tappischen! ein artiger Schein *A pleasant cheat, ye dolts! forsooth*

With goat-foot and skinny leg—they're supposed to be lean and sinewy

Soll gleich die plumpe Wahrheit sein. *You take at once for naked truth.*

And chamois-like on mountain heights—he enjoys looking around

Was soll euch Wahrheit?—Dumpfen Wahn *What's truth to you? Illusion bare*

Refreshed in freedom's air—he mocks child and wife and man

Packt ihr an allen Zipfeln an.— *Surrounds and rules you everywhere.*

They think they're living down there in the valley's steam and smoke

Vermummter Plutus, Maskenheld, *Thou Plutus-mask, Chief unrevealed,*

While the world up above belongs to him alone, pure and undisturbed!

Schlag dieses Volk mir aus dem Feld. *Drive thou this people from the field!*

There trips the little troop—they don't like pairing up

Plutus

Dein Stab ist wohl dazu bereit, *Thy wand thereto is fit and free;*

In mossy garb with bright little lamp

Verleih ihn mir auf kurze Zeit.– *Lend it a little while to me!*

They move through each other quickly—like glowing fuck-me ants

Ich tauch' ihn rasch in Sud und Glut.– *I dip it in the fiery brew,—*

Where each works for itself—swarming like firefly-ants

Nun, Masken, seid auf eurer Hut! *Look out, ye maskers! all of you.*

And bustles busily back and forth!

Wie's blitzt und platzt, in Funken spruht! *It shines, and snaps, and sparkles throws;*

Related to the good little folk

Der Stab, schon ist er angegluht. *The burning wand already glows.*

Known as rock-surgeons—healers of stone

Wer sich zu nah herangedrangt, *Who crowdeth on, too near to me,*

We cup the high mountains—drain from full veins

Ist unbarmherzig gleich versengt.– *Is burned and scorched relentlessly.*

We dump metals in heaps—with a cheerful “Good luck! Good luck!”

Jetzt fang' ich meinen Umgang an. *And now my circuit I'll commence.*

That's meant well from the ground up

Geschrei und Gedrang (*Cries and Crowding*)

O weh! Es ist um uns getan.– *Woe's me! We're lost—there's no defence!*

We are friends of good people!

Entfliehe, wer entfliehen kann!– *Let each one fly, if fly he can!—*

But we bring gold to daylight

Zuruck, zuruck, du Hintermann!– *Back! clear the way, you hindmost man!—*

So people can steal and pimp

Mir spruht er heiss ins Angesicht.– *It sparkles fiercely in mine eyes.—*

Nor shall iron fail the proud man—who devised universal murder

Mich druckt des gluhenden Stabs Gewicht– *The burning wand upon me lies.—*

And whoever ignores three Commandments—doesn't care about the others either

Verloren sind wir all' und all'.– *We all are lost, we all are lost!—*

All that isn't our fault—

Zuruck, zuruck, du Maskenschwall! *Back, back! ye maskers, jammed and tossed!—*

So be patient as we are

Zuruck, zuruck, unsinniger Hauf"!– *Back, senseless crowd, away from there!*–

They're called the Wild Men

O hatt' ich Flugel, flog' ich auf.– *O, had I wings, I'd take the air.*

Well-known in the Harz Mountains–naked in full natural strength

Plutus

Schon ist der Kreis zuruckgedrängt, *Now is the circle crowded back,*

They all come giant-huge–swinging pine-trunk in right hand

Und niemand, glaub' ich, ist versengt. *And none, I think, scorched very black.*

Around the body a puffy band–the crudest loincloth of branch and leaf

Die Menge weicht, *The throng retires,*

Bodyguard that the Pope doesn't have!

Sie ist verscheucht.– *Scared by the fires.*

He comes too!

Doch solcher Ordnung Unterpfand *As guaranty for ordered law,*

The All of the World–represented in great Pan

Zieh' ich ein unsichtbares Band. *A ring invisible I draw.*

You happiest ones surround him–dance madly around him!

Herold

Du hast ein herrlich Werk vollbracht, *A noble work is thine, tonight:*

Since he's serious and good, he wants you to be joyful!

Wie dank' ich deiner klugen Macht! *I thank thy wisdom and thy might.*

Even under the blue vault–he stayed constantly awake

Plutus

Noch braucht es, edler Freund, Geduld: *Preserve thy patience, noble friend,*

Yet brooks murmur to him

Es droht noch mancherlei Tumult. *For many tumults yet impend.*

And breezes rock him gently to rest–air cradling a god

Geiz (*Avarice*)

So kann man doch, wenn es beliebt, *Thus, if one pleases, pleasantly*

And when he sleeps at midday

Vergnüglich diesen Kreis beschauen. *May one survey this circle stately;*

Not a leaf stirs on the branch—even nature holds its breath

Denn immerfort sind vornenan die Frauen, *For, ever foremost, crowd the women greatly,*

Healthy plants' balsam scent fills the silent still air

Wo's was zu gaffen, was zu naschen gibt. *If aught to stare at, or to taste, there be.*

The nymph dare not be lively

Noch bin ich nicht so völlig eingerostet! *Not yet entirely rusty are my senses!*

And where she stood, she falls asleep—narcoleptic forest thot

Ein schönes Weib ist immer schon; *A woman fair is always fair to me;*

But when unexpectedly with force his voice resounds

Und heute, weil es mich nichts kostet, *And since, today, it makes me no expenses,*

Like lightning's crackle, sea's roar—then no one knows where in or out

So wollen wir getrost sponsieren gehn. *We'll go a courting confidently.*

Brave armies scatter in the field—the hero trembles in the tumult

Doch weil am überfullten Orte *But in a place so populate*

So honor to whom honor is due!

Nicht jedem Ohr vernehmlich alle Worte, *All words to every ear don't penetrate;*

And hail to him who led us here!

Versuch' ich klug und hoff', es soll mir glücken, *So, wisely I attempt, and hope success,*

When the shining rich stuff threads through clefts—veins of light in dark

Mich pantomimisch deutlich auszudrücken. *Myself by pantomime distinctly to express.*

Only the wise divining-rod shows its labyrinths—dowsing rod GPS

Hand, Fuss, Gebarde reicht mir da nicht hin, *Hand, foot, and gesture will not quite suffice;*

We vault our house in dark crypts

Da muss ich mich um einen Schwank bemühn. *So I employ a jocular device.*

Troglodytic style—and in pure daylight you graciously distribute treasures

Wie feuchten Ton will ich das Gold behandeln, *Like clay will I the gold manipulate;*

Now we discover nearby

Denn dies Metall lässt sich in alles wandeln. *One may transform it into any state.*

A wondrous fountain!

Herold

Was fangt der an, der magre Tor! *What will the lean fool do? Has he,*

That promises easily to give—what was hardly to be reached

Hat so ein Hungermann Humor? *So dry a starveling, humour? See,*

This you can complete—take it, Lord, into your care!

Er knetet alles Gold zu Teig, *He kneads the gold as it were dough!*

Every treasure in your hands

Ihm wird es untern Handen weich; *Beneath his hands 'tis soft; yet, though*

Benefits the whole world!

Wie er es drückt und wie es ballt, *He roll and squeeze it, for his pains*

We must compose ourselves in the highest sense

Bleibt's immer doch nur ungestalt. *Disfigured still the stuff remains.*

And let happen what happens—trusting the flow

Er wendet sich zu den Weibern dort, *He turns to the women there, and they*

You're usually full of the strongest courage—buckle up

Sie schreien alle, mochten fort, *All scream, and try to get away,*

Now something most horrible will occur

Gebarden sich gar widerwärtig; *With gestures of disgust and loathing;*

Stubbornly will world and posterity deny it—gaslight themselves

Der Schalk erweist sich ubelfertig. *The ready rascal stops at nothing.*

Write it faithfully in your protocol!

Ich fürchte, dass er sich ergetzt, *I fear he takes delight to see*

The dwarfs lead the great Pan gently to the fire-fountain

Wenn er die Sittlichkeit verletzt. *He has offended decency.*

It seethes up from the deepest throat

Dazu darf ich nicht schweigsam bleiben, *I dare not silently endure it:*

Then sinks back down to the bottom—and dark stands the open mouth

Gib meinen Stab, ihn zu vertreiben. *Give me my wand, that I may cure it!*

Boils up again in glow and simmer—hot and wet

Plutus

Er ahnet nicht, was uns von aussen droht; *The danger from without he does not see:*

The great Pan stands content

Lass ihn die Narrenteidung treiben! *Let him alone; his Fool's-hour fast is waning.*

Enjoys the wondrous thing!

Ihm wird kein Raum für seine Possen bleiben; *There'll be no space for his mad pranks remaining;*

And pearl-foam sprays right and left—bubbles kissing air

Gesetz ist mächtig, mächtiger ist die Not. *Mighty is Law, mightier Necessity.*

How can he trust such stuff?—he bends deep to look in

Getümmel und Gesang (*Tumult and Song*)

Das wilde Heer, es kommt zumal *The savage hosts, with shout and hail,*

Now his beard falls in!—facial hair meets fire

Von Bergeshoh' und Waldestal, *From mountain-height and forest-vale*

Whose smooth chin might that be?

Unwiderstehlich schreitet's an: *Come, irresistibly as Fate:*

His hand hides it from our view!

Sie feiern ihren grossen Pan. *Their mighty Pan they celebrate.*

Now follows a great mishap

Sie wissen doch, was keiner weiss, *They know, forsooth, what none can guess,*

The beard ignites and flies back—fire climbing face

Und drängen in den leeren Kreis. *And in the empty circle press.*

Sets wreath and head and breast ablaze—pleasure turns to pain

Plutus

Ich kenn' euch wohl und euren grossen Pan! *I know you well, and your illustrious Pan!*

The crowd runs to extinguish—but none stays free from flames

Zusammen habt ihr kühnen Schritt getan. *Boldly together you've performed your plan.*

And as they slap and beat, new flames are stirred!

Ich weiss recht gut, was nicht ein jeder weiss, *Full well I know what every one does not,*

Entangled in the element—a whole mask-clump burns

Und offne schuldig diesen engen Kreis. *And clear for you, as duty bids, the spot.*

But what, I hear, is announced to us—from ear to ear, from mouth to mouth

Mag sie ein gut Geschick begleiten! *Be Fortune still her favour lending!*

O eternally ill-fated night!

Das Wunderlichste kann geschehn; *The strangest things may here be bred:*

What sorrow have you brought us!

Sie wissen nicht, wohin sie schreiten, *They know not whitherward they're wending,*

Tomorrow will proclaim—what no one wants to hear

Sie haben sich nicht vorgesehn. *Because they have not looked ahead.*

Yet I hear everywhere the cry: “The Emperor suffers such pain!”

Wildgesang (*Savage Song*)

Geputztes Volk du, Flitterschau! *Furbished people, tinsel-stuff!*

O if only another thing were true!—the body recoiling from truth

Sie kommen roh, sie kommen rauh, *They're coming rude, they're coming rough;*

The Emperor burns and his retinue!

In hohem Sprung, in raschem Lauf, *In mighty leap, in wildest race,*

Cursed be those who misled him!

Sie treten derb und tuchtig auf. *Coarse and strong they take their place.*

Who wrapped themselves in resinous branches

Faunen

Die Faunenschar *Fauns, pair on pair,*

To rage here with roaring song—for universal ruin

Im lustigen Tanz, *Come dancing down,*

O Youth, Youth! Will you never limit the pure measure of joy?

Den Eichenkranz *With oaken crown*

O Majesty! Will you never act rational as omnipotent?

Im krausen Haar, *On crispy hair;*

Already the forest goes up in flames!

Ein feines zugespitztes Ohr *The fine and pointed ear is seen,*

They lick pointed upward

Dringt an dem Lockenkopf hervor, *Leaf-like, the clustering curls between:*

To the wood-latticed ceiling-bond

Ein stumpfes Naschen, ein breit Gesicht, *A stubby nose, face broad and flat,*

A general fire threatens us—everything getting fucked

Das schadet alles bei Frauen nicht: *The women don't object to that;*

The measure of misery overflows—I don't know who can save us

Dem Faun, wenn er die Patsche reicht, *For when his paw holds forth the Faun,*

An ash-heap of one night—lies tomorrow as rich imperial splendor

Versagt die Schonste den Tanz nicht leicht. *The fairest to the dance is drawn.*

All gone!

Satyr

Der Satyr hupft nun hinterdrein *See now, behind, the Satyr skip,*

Terror is spread enough

Mit Ziegenfuss und durrem Bein, *With foot of goat, lean leg and hip,—*

Now let help be initiated!

Ihm sollen sie mager und sehnig sein, *Lean and sinewy must they be:*

Strike, holy staff's power—make the ground quake and resound!

Und gemsenartig auf Bergeshohn *For, chamois-like, on mountains he*

You, spacious wide air

Belustigt er sich, umherzusehn. *Loveth to stand or scamper free.*

Fill yourself with cool mist!—chill vibes only

In Freiheitsluft erquicket alsdann, *Then, strong in freedom of the skies,*

Draw near, swirling around—fog-damps, pregnant streaks

Verhohnt er Kind und Weib und Mann, *Child, wife, and man doth he despise,*

Cover a flaming tumult!

Die tief in Tales Dampf und Rauch *Who, deep in the valley's smoke and steam*

Trickle, whisper, cloud-curl, slip billowing, softly steam

Behaglich meinen, sie lebten auch, *That they live also, snugly dream;*

Quenching everywhere, fight!

Da ihm doch rein und ungestört *While, pure and undisturbed, alone*

You moistening, softening ones

Die Welt dort oben allein gehort. *The upper world is all his own.*

Transform such vain flame-play–into summer-lightning

Gnomen

Da trippelt ein die kleine Schar, *The little crowd comes tripping there;*

When spirits threaten to harm us–magic must become active

Sie halt nicht gern sich Paar und Paar; *They don't associate pair by pair.*

Magic saves the day!

Im moosigen Kleid mit Lämplein hell *In mossy garb, with lantern bright,*

Halt!

Bewegt sich's durcheinander schnell, *They move commingling, brisk and light,*

Your horses–feel the bit like a promise

Wo jedes fur sich selber schafft, *Each working on his separate ground,*

I am the master of this chariot's chaos

Wie Leucht-Ameisen wimmelhaft; *Like firefly-emmetts swarming round;*

Feel the reins, my hot-blooded steeds

Und wuselt emsig hin und her, *And press and gather here and there,*

Whoa there, Seabiscuits

Beschäftigt in die Kreuz und Quer. *Always industrious everywhere.*

These spaces deserve respect

Den frommen Gutchen nah verwandt, *With the "Good People" kin we own;*

Look at the crowds forming–witnesses to spectacle

Als Felschirurgen wohlbekannt; *As surgeons of the rocks we're known.*

Herald, describe what you see before we vanish

Die hohen Berge schropfen wir, *Cupping the mountains, bleeding them*

We're just symbols anyway–not even real

Aus vollen Adern schopfen wir; *From fullest veins, depleting them*

So you should recognize us from your myths

Metalle sturzen wir zuhauf, *Of store of metals, which we pile,*

I can't name you but I can paint you

Mit Gruss getrost: Glück auf! Glück auf! *And merrily greet: "Good cheer!" the while.*

You're obviously hot and young

Das ist von Grund aus wohlgemeint: *Well-meant the words, believe us, then!*

Half-baked but the ladies want you full-grown

Wir sind der guten Menschen Freund. *We are the friends of all good men.*

Future heartbreaker energy right here

Doch bringen wir das Gold zu Tag, *Yet we the stores of gold unseal*

The women would eat you alive

Damit man stehlen und kuppeln mag, *That men may pander, pimp, and steal;*

Black lightning eyes and midnight curls

Nicht Eisen fehle dem stolzen Mann, *Nor iron shall fail his haughty hand*

That jeweled headband is doing things

Der allgemeinen Mord ersann. *Who universal murder planned:*

Delicate garments flowing like whispered silk

Und wer die drei Gebot' veracht't, *And who these three Commandments breaks*

Purple trim and sparkle-giving androgynous icon

Sich auch nichts aus den andern macht. *But little heed o' the others takes.*

You could pass for a girl

Das alles ist nicht unsre Schuld; *For that we're not responsible:*

But you'd already pull

Drum habt so fort, wie wir, Geduld. *We're patient-be you, too, as well!*

The girls would teach you everything

Riesen

Die wilden Manner sind s' genannt, *The wild men of the woods they're named,*

And this one on the throne-what's his deal?

Am Harzgebirge wohlbekannt; *And in the Hartz are known and famed;*

He seems like a king, rich and gentle

Natürlich nackt in aller Kraft, *In naked nature's ancient might*

Lucky whoever catches his eye

Sie kommen sämtlich riesenhaft. *They come, each one a giant wight,*

He's achieved everything-nothing left to want

Den Fichtenstamm in rechter Hand *With fir-tree trunk in brawny hand,*

His glance finds where things are lacking

Und um den Leib ein wulstig Band, *Around the loins a puffy band,*

His joy in giving exceeds even having

Den derbsten Schurz von Zweig und Blatt, *The merest apron of leaf and bough:-*

You can't describe Dignity

Leibwacht, wie der Papst nicht hat. *The Pope hath no such guards, I trow.*

That healthy round moon-face though

Nymphen im Chor (*They surround the great Pan.*)

Auch kommt er an!- *He comes! We scan*

Full mouth, blooming cheeks

Das All der Welt *The world's great All,*

Glowing under turban pressure

Wird vorgestellt *Whose part doth fall*

Rich comfort in those folds

Im grossen Pan. *To mighty Pan.*

What can I say about his bearing?

Ihr Heitersten, umgebet ihn, *Ye gayest ones, advance to him,*

He feels familiar as a ruler

Im Gaukeltanz umschwebet ihn: *Your maddest measures dance to him!*

Plutus, God of Wealth, that's the name

Denn weil er ernst und gut dabei, *Since serious and kind is he,*

The Emperor thirsts for him badly

So will er, dass man frohlich sei. *He wills that we should joyous be.*

I am Profusion, I am Poetry

Auch unterm blauen Wolbedach *Under the blue, o'er-vaulting roof,*

The Poet who completes himself by squandering

Verhielt' er sich beständig wach; *Ever he seemeth slumber-proof;*

When he wastes his own best goods

Doch rieseln ihm die Bache zu, *Yet murmurs of the brooks he knows,*

I'm also stupid rich

Und Luftlein wiegen ihn mild in Ruh. *And soft airs lull him to repose.*

I value myself equal to Plutus

Und wenn er zu Mittage schlaft, *At midday sleeping, o'er his brow*

I animate his dances and feasts

Sich nicht das Blatt am Zweige regt; *The leaf is moveless on the bough:*

What he lacks, I hand out freely

Gesunder Pflanzen Balsamduft *Of healthy buds the balsam there*

Bragging suits you beautifully

Erfüllt die schweigsam stille Luft; *Pervades the still, suspended air:*

But show us your tricks

Die Nymphe darf nicht munter sein, *The nymph no longer dares to leap,*

Watch me snap once—and sparkle everywhere

Und wo sie stand, da schläft sie ein. *And where she stands, she falls asleep.*

Already gleaming around the chariot

Wenn unerwartet mit Gewalt *But when, all unexpected, he*

Pearls spring forth

Dann aber seine Stimm' erschallt, *Maketh his voice heard terribly,*

Golden clasps for neck and ear

Wie Blitzes Knattern, Meergebraus, *Like rattling thunder, roar of wave,*

Combs and crowns, flawless

Dann niemand weiss, wo ein noch aus, *Then each one seeks himself to save;*

Rings with precious stones

Zerstreut sich tapfres Heer im Feld, *The serried ranks disperse in fright,*

I scatter flames here and there

Und im Getummel bebt der Held. *The hero trembles in the fight.*

Waiting to see what ignites

So Ehre dem, dem Ehre gebührt, *Then honour to whom the honour is due,*

How the crowd grabs and snatches

Und Heil ihm, der uns hergeführt! *And hail to him who led us to you!*

The giver almost gets mobbed

Deputation der Gnomen (*to the great Pan*)

Wenn das Glanzende reiche Gut *When the rich possession, shining*

He snaps trinkets dreamlike

Fadenweis durch die Klüfte zieht, *Through the rocks in thread and vein,*

Everyone snatches in the space

Nur der klugen Wunschelrute *To the skilful wand's divining*

But here's the twist–

Seine Labyrinth zeigt, *Shows its labyrinthine chain,*

Whatever greed grabs

Wolben wir in dunklen Gruften *We in vaults and caverns spacious,*

Gets poor reward

Troglodytisch unser Haus, *Troglodytes, contented bide;*

The gift flies away

Und an reinen Tagesluften *While in purest daylight, gracious,*

Pearls dissolve into beetles

Teilst du Schätze gnadig aus. *Thou the treasures dost divide.*

They buzz around his head

Nun entdecken wir hieneben *Now we see, wilt thou believe us,*

Others catch frivolous butterflies

Eine Quelle wunderbar, *Here a wondrous fountain run,*

He promises much

Die bequem verspricht zu geben, *Promising with ease to give us*

Gives only gold-glitter

Was kaum zu erreichen war. *What was hardly to be won.*

Back when women minded their hearth

Dies vermagst du zu vollenden, *Lo! It waits for thy attaining:*

I was called Greed, and things were good

Nimm es, Herr, in deine Hut: *Then be moved to break the spell!*

Only IN, nothing OUT–perfect economy

Jeder Schatz in deinen Händen *All the wealth which thou art gaining*

I was passionate about chests and cabinets

Kommt der ganzen Welt zugut. *Profits all the world as well.*

That's supposed to be a vice?

Plutus *(to the Herald)*

Wir müssen uns im hohen Sinne fassen *We, in the highest sense, must be collected,*

But modern wives don't save anymore

Und, was geschieht, getrost geschehen lassen, *And let what may come, come, though unexpected.*

More desires than dollars

Du bist ja sonst des stärksten Mutes voll. *Thy courage has not yet been counted short:*

Much remains for the husband to suffer

Nun wird sich gleich ein Greulichstes eräugnen, *The fearful thing we now shall see will try it;*

Wherever he looks, debts

Hartnäckig wird es Welt und Nachwelt leugnen: *The world and History will both deny it,*

She turns scraps to body and lover

Du schreib es treulich in dein Protokoll. *So write it faithfully in thy report!*

She eats better, drinks more

Herold (*grasping the wand which Plutus holds in his hand*)

Die Zwerge führen den grossen Pan *The dwarfs conduct the great Pan nigher,*

With her tedious horde of wooers

Zur Feuerquelle sacht heran; *Yet gently, to the fount of fire.*

That raises money's appeal for me

Sie siedet auf vom tiefsten Schlund, *It bubbles from the throat profound,*

I am Greed, and I am male

Dann sinkt sie wieder hinab zum Grund, *Then sinks, retreating, to the ground,*

Let dragon be stingy with dragons

Und finster steht der offene Mund; *And dark the open crater shows;*

He's here to stir up the men

Wallt wieder auf in Glut und Sud, *And then again it boils and glows.*

They're already inconvenient enough

Der grosse Pan steht wohlgemut, *Great Pan in cheerful mood stands by,*

The scarecrow! Slap him!

Freut sich des wundersamen Dings, *Rejoiced the wondrous things to spy,*

What's this torture-stick threatening?

Und Perlenschaum spruht rechts und links. *And right and left the foam-pearls fly.*

Should we fear that ugly mug?

Wie mag er solchem Wesen traun? *How can he in the cheat confide?*

The dragons are just wood and cardboard

Er buckt sich tief hineinzuschauen.– *He bends and stoops, to look inside.*–

Push in on him!

Nun aber fällt sein Bart hinein!– *But now, behold! his beard falls in:*

By my staff–keep still!

Wer mag das glatte Kinn wohl sein? *Whose is that smoothly-shaven chin?*

But my help is barely needed

Die Hand verbirgt es unserm Blick.– *His hand conceals it from our sight.*

The dragons unfold their double wings

Nun folgt ein grosses Ungeschick: *What follows is a luckless plight;*

They shake themselves angrily

Der Bart entflammt und fliegt zurück, *The beard, on fire, flies back to smite*

Fire-spewing jaws

Entzündet Kranz und Haupt und Brust, *His wreath and head and breast with flame:*

The crowd flees

Zu Leiden wandelt sich die Lust.– *To pain is turned the merry game.*

The wild horde arrives!

Zu loschen läuft die Schar herbei, *They haste to quench the fire, but none*

From mountain height and forest vale

Doch keiner bleibt von Flammen frei, *The swiftly-kindling flames can shun,*

Irresistibly they stride

Und wie es patscht und wie es schlägt, *That flash and dart on other heads*

They celebrate their great Pan

Wird neues Flammen aufgeregt; *Till wide the conflagration spreads:*

They know what no one knows

Verflochten in das Element, *Wrapped in the element, in turn*

And crowd into the empty circle

Ein ganzer Maskenklump verbrennt. *The masking groups take fire and burn.*

I know you well, great Pan

Was aber, hor' ich wird uns kund *But hark! what news is bruited here*

Together you've made bold moves

Von Ohr zu Ohr, von Mund zu Mund! *From mouth to mouth, from ear to ear?*

I know what others don't

O ewig unglucksel'ge Nacht, *O evermore ill-fated night,*

And dutifully open this tight circle

Was hast du uns fur Leid gebracht! *That brings to us such woe and blight!*

Faun-troop in merry dance

Verkunden wird der nachste Tag, *Tomorrow will proclaim to all*

Oak wreath in curly hair

Was niemand willig horen mag; *What no one wishes to befall.*

Pointed ears poke through

Doch hor' ich aller Orten schrein: *For everywhere the cry I hear:*

Stubby nose, broad face

“Der Kaiser leidet solche Pein.” *“The Emperor suffers pain severe!”*

That doesn't hurt with women

O ware doch ein andres wahr! *O were the proclamation wrong!*

When Faun offers his paw

Der Kaiser brennt und seine Schar. *The Emperor burns and all his throng.*

The fairest won't refuse the dance

Sie sei verflucht, die ihn verfuhr, *Accurst be they who him misled,*

Satyr hops along behind

In harzig Reis sich eingeschnurt, *With resinous twigs on breast and head,*

With goat-foot and skinny leg

Zu toben her mit Brullgesang *To rave and bellow hither so,*

Chamois-like on mountain heights

Zu allerseitigem Untergang. *To general, fatal overthrow.*

Mocking child and wife and man

O Jugend, Jugend, wirst du nie *O Youth! O Youth! wilt never thou*

While the world above belongs to him alone

Der Freude reines Mass bezirken? *Limit thy draught of joy, in season?—*

Little troop trips along

O Hoheit, Hoheit, wirst du nie *O Majesty, wilt never thou,*

Don't like pairing up

Vernunftig wie allmächtig wirken? *Omnipotent, direct with reason?*

Mossy garb with bright lamp

Schon geht der Wald in Flammen auf, *The mimic woods enkindled are;*

They move through each other quickly

Sie zungeln leckend spitz hinauf *The pointed tongues lick upward far*

Each works for itself

Zum holzverschränkten Deckenband; *To where the rafters interlace:*

Like firefly-ants swarming

Uns droht ein allgemeiner Brand. *A fiery doom hangs o'er the place.*

Related to the good folk

Des Jammers Mass ist ubervoll, *Our cup of misery overflows,*

Known as rock-surgeons

Ich weiss nicht, wer uns retten soll. *For who shall save us no one knows.*

We cup the high mountains

Ein Aschenhaufen einer Nacht *The ash-heap of a night shall hide*

Drain from full veins

Liegt morgen reiche Kaiserpracht. *Tomorrow, this imperial pride.*

Dump metals in heaps

Plutus

Schrecken ist genug verbreitet, *Terror is enough created;*

Good luck! Good luck!

Hilfe sei nun eingeleitet!– *Now be help inaugurated!*

We are friends of good people

Schlage, heil'gen Stabs Gewalt, *Smite, thou hallowed wand, and make*

But we bring gold to light

Dass der Boden bebt und schallt! *Earth beneath thee peal and quake!*

So people can steal and pimp

Du, geraumig weite Luft, *Thou, the spacious breadth of air,*

Iron for the proud man

Fulle dich mit kühlem Duft! *Cooling vapours breathe and bear!*

Who invented mass murder

Zieht heran, umherzuschweifen, *Hither speed, around us growing,*

Whoever ignores three Commandments

Nebeldunste, schwangre Streifen, *Misty films and belts o'erflowing,*

Doesn't care about the others

Deckt ein flammendes Gewühl! *And the fiery tumult tame!*

Not our fault

Rieselt, sauselt, Wolkchen krauselt, *Trickle, whisper, clouds, be crisper,*

Be patient as we are

Schlupfet wallend, leise dampfet, *Roll in masses, softly drenching,*

The great Pan stands by the fire-fountain

Loschend uberall bekampfet, *Mantling everywhere, and quenching!*

It seethes from deepest throat

Ihr, die lindernden, die feuchten, *Ye, the moist, the broadly brightening,*

His beard falls in

Wandelt in ein Wetterleuchten *Change to harmless summer lightning*

The beard ignites!

Solcher eitlen Flamme Spiel!– *All this empty sport of flame!–*

Sets wreath and head ablaze

Drohen Geister, uns zu schadigen, *When by spirits we're molested,*

Magic must become active—or we all burn

Soll sich die Magie betatigen. *Then be Magic manifested.*

Lustgarten / Pleasure Garden

Morgensonne / Morning Sun

Der Kaiser, sein Hof, Herren und Damen; Faust, Mephistopheles anständig, nicht auffallend, nach Sitte gekleidet; beide kniend. The Emperor, his Court, Gentlemen and Ladies; Faust, Mephistopheles becomingly, according to the mode, not showily dressed; both kneel.

Faust

Verzeihst du, Herr, das Flammengaukelspiel?

Sire, pardonest thou the jugglery of flame?

Sire, dost thou pardon the juggling of flames?

Kaiser

Ich wunsche mir dergleichen Scherze viel. –

I wish more exhibitions of the same.

I wish for many more such jests!

Auf einmal sah ich mich in gluhender Sphäre,

A sudden stood I in a glowing sphere;

Suddenly I found myself in a glowing sphere

Es schien mir fast, als ob ich Pluto ware.

It almost seemed as if I Pluto were.

It almost felt like I was Pluto, Lord of the Underworld

Aus Nacht und Kohlen lag ein Felsengrund,

There lay, like night, with little fires besprent,

From night and coal lay a rocky floor

Von Flämmchen gluhend. Dem und jenem Schlund

A rocky bottom. Out of many a vent,

Glowing with little flames. From this and that chasm

Aufwirbelten viel tausend wilde Flammen

Whirling, a thousand savage flames ascended,

Thousands of wild flames whirled upward

Und flackerten in ein Gewölb zusammen.

Till in a single vault their streamers blended.

And flickered together into one throbbing vault

Zum höchsten Dome zungelt' es empor,

The tongues even to the highest dome were shot,

Fire-tongues licking toward the highest dome

Der immer ward und immer sich verlor.

That ever was, and ever then was not.

That kept existing then not existing, on and off like bad wif

Durch fernen Raum gewundner Feuersäulen

Through the far space of spiral shafts of flame

Through far space of twisted fire-columns

Sah ich bewegt der Volker lange Zeilen,

The long processions of the people came;

Long lines of peoples moved

Sie drangten sich im weiten Kreis heran

Crowding, till all the circle was o'errun,

They pressed together in a wide circle approaching

Und huldigten, wie sie es stets getan.

They did me homage, as they've ever done.

And paid homage as they have ever done

Von meinem Hof erkannt' ich ein und andern,

Some from my Court I knew: to speak with candour,

Some from my court I recognized here and there

Ich schien ein Furst von tausend Salamandern.

A Prince I seemed o'er many a salamander.

I seemed a prince of a thousand salamanders

Mephistopheles

Das bist du, Herr! weil jedes Element

That art thou, Sire! Because each element

That thou art, Sire! For each element

Die Majestat als unbedingt erkennt.

Fully accepts thy Majesty's intent.

Acknowledges Majesty as unconditional

Gehorsam Feuer hast du nun erprobt;

Obedient Fire is tested now by thee:

You've beta-tested obedient Fire

Wirf dich ins Meer, wo es am wildsten tobt,

Where wildest heaving, leap into the Sea,

Now throw yourself into the sea where it rages wildest

Und kaum betrittst du perlenreichen Grund,

And scarce the pearly floor thy foot shall tread,

And scarce shall your foot touch that pearl-rich floor

So bildet wallend sich ein herrlich Rund;

A grand rotunda rises o'er thy head:

Before a magnificent dome swells billowing around you

Siehst auf und ab lichtgrüne schwanke Wellen,
Thou seest the green, translucent billows swelling,
You'll see light-green swaying waves up and down
 Mit Purpursaum, zur schönsten Wohnung schwellen
With purple edge, for thy delightful dwelling.
With purple edges, swelling into the hottest dwelling
 Um dich, den Mittelpunkt. Bei jedem Schritt,
Round thee, the central point. Walk thou at will,
Around you, the center. With every step you take
 Wohin du gehst, gehn die Paläste mit.
The liquid palaces go with thee still!
The palaces follow like needy pets
 Die Wände selbst erfreuen sich des Lebens,
The very walls rejoice in life, disporting
The walls themselves enjoy living
 Pfeilschnellen Wimmelns, Hin- und Widerstrebens.
In arrowy flight, in chasing and consorting:
Arrow-quick swarming, back and forth
 Meerwunder drängen sich zum neuen milden Schein,
Sea-marvels crowd around the glory new and fair,
Sea-wonders crowd toward the new gentle glow
 Sie schiessen an, und keines darf herein.
Shoot from all sides, yet none can enter there.
They shoot toward it, yet none may enter
 Da spielen farbig goldbeschuppte Drachen,
There gorgeous dragons, golden-armoured, float;
There colorful gold-scaled dragons play
 Der Haifisch klafft, du lachst ihm in den Rachen.
There gapes the shark, thou laughest in his throat.
The shark gapes wide, you laugh right down his throat
 Wie sich auch jetzt der Hof um dich entzückt,
However much this Court thy pride may please,

However much the court now delights around you

Hast du doch nie ein solch Gedrang' erblickt.

Yet hast thou never seen such throngs as these.

You've never seen such a press of bodies

Doch bleibst du nicht vom Lieblichsten geschieden:

Nor from the loveliest shalt thou long be parted;

Nor shall you be parted from the loveliest ones

Es nahen sich neugierige Nereiden

The curious Nereids come, the wild, shy-hearted,

Curious Nereids come swimming closer

Der pracht'gen Wohnung in der ew'gen Frische,

To thy bright dwelling in the endless waters, –

To the splendid dwelling in eternal wetness

Die jungsten scheu und lustern wie die Fische,

Timid and sly as fish the youngest daughters,

The youngest shy and horny like fish

Die spatern klug. Schon wird es Thetis kund,

The elder cunning: Thetis hears the news

The older ones cunning. Word reaches Thetis

Dem zweiten Peleus reicht sie Hand und Mund. –

And will, at once, her second Peleus choose.

Hand and mouth she offers Peleus Two

Den Sitz alsdann auf des Olymps Revier. . .

The seat, then, on Olympus high and free –

Then your seat in Olympus's neighborhood. . .

Kaiser

Die luft'gen Raume, die erlass' ich dir:

The spaces of the air I leave to thee:

The airy spaces I'll leave to thee

Noch fruh genug besteigt man jenen Thron.

One all too early must ascend that throne.

Soon enough one climbs onto that throne

Mephistopheles

Und, hochster Herr! die Erde hast du schon.

And Earth, high Prince! already is thine own.

And, highest Lord! Earth's already yours

Kaiser

Gleichst du an Fruchtbarkeit Scheherazaden,

If thou like Scheherazade art rich in stories,

If thou matchest Scheherazade in fertility

Versichr' ich dich der höchsten aller Gnaden.

My favour shall insure thee higher glories.

You're basically my Netflix subscription

Sei stets bereit, wenn eure Tageswelt,

Be ready always, when your world of day,

I assure thee of the highest of all graces

Wie's oft geschieht, mir widerlichst missfällt.

As often haps, disgusts me every way!

Your stories make my skin tingle with anticipation

Marschalk

Durchlauchtigster, ich dacht' in meinem Leben

Highness Serene, I never dared expect

Be ever ready when your world of day

Vom schönsten Glück Verkündung nicht zu geben

To trumpet forth a fortune so select

As often happens, pisses me right off

Als diese, die mich hoch beglückt,

As this, supremely blessing me,

Most Serene Highness, I never thought in my life

In deiner Gegenwart entzuckt:

Which I announce with joy to thee:

To announce such glorious fortune

Rechnung für Rechnung ist berichtigt,

Reckoning on reckoning's balanced squarely;

As this, which makes me supremely happy

Die Wucherklauen sind beschwichtigt,

The usurer's claws are blunted rarely;

Delighted in your presence to tell you

Los bin ich solcher Hollenpein;

I'm from my hellish worry free:

Bill after bill has been settled square

Im Himmel kann's nicht heitrer sein.

Things can't in Heaven more cheerful be.

The usurers' claws have been filed down

Heermeister

Abschlaglich ist der Sold entrichtet,

Arrears of pay are settled duly,

I'm free from such hell-torment at last

Das ganze Heer aufs neu' verpflichtet,

The army is enlisted newly;

Heaven itself couldn't feel any better

Der Landsknecht fuhlt sich frisches Blut,

The trooper's blood is all alive,

Back-pay has been discharged in full

Und Wirt und Dirnen haben's gut.

The landlords and the wenches thrive.

The entire army re-enlisted, fresh contracts signed

Kaiser

Wie atmet eure Brust erweitert!

How breathe your breasts in broader spaces!

The mercenary feels fresh blood pumping

Das faltige Gesicht erheitert!

How cheerful are your furrowed faces!

And innkeepers and whores are doing great

Wie eilig tretet ihr heran!

How ye advance with nimble speed!

How your chests breathe broader now!

Schatzmeister

Befrage diese, die das Werk getan.

Ask these, 'tis they have done the deed!

How your wrinkled faces have brightened!

Faust

Dem Kanzler ziemt's, die Sache vorzutragen.

It is the Chancellor's place the matter to present.

How eagerly you step forward!

Kanzler

Beglückt genug in meinen alten Tagen. –

In my old days I'm blest, and most content.

Ask these two who did the deed

So hort und schaut das schicksalschwere Blatt,

So hear and see the fortune-freighted leaf

The Chancellor's job to present this matter

Das alles Weh in Wohl verwandelt hat.

Which has transformed to happiness our grief.

Lucky enough in my old age!

“Zu wissen sei es jedem, der's begehrt:

“To all to whom this cometh, be it known:

So hear and see this fate-heavy paper

Der Zettel hier ist tausend Kronen wert.

A thousand crowns in worth this note doth own.

That transformed all woe into wellbeing

Ihm liegt gesichert, als gewisses Pfand,

It to secure, as certain pledge, shall stand

“Be it known to all who desire to know:

Unzahl vergrabnen Guts im Kaiserland.

All buried treasure in the Emperor's land:

This note here is worth a thousand crowns

Nun ist gesorgt, damit der reiche Schatz,
And 'tis decreed, perfecting thus the scheme,

Secured to it as a certain pledge

Sogleich gehoben, diene zum Ersatz.”

The treasure, soon as raised, shall this redeem.”

Lies countless buried gold in the Emperor's land

Kaiser

Ich ahne Frevel, ungeheuren Trug!

A most enormous cheat – a crime, I fear!

Now it's arranged that this rich treasure

Wer falschte hier des Kaisers Namenszug?

Who forged the Emperor's sign-manual here?

As soon as raised, shall serve to redeem it”

Ist solch Verbrechen ungestraft geblieben?

Has there not been a punishment condign?

I smell foul play, enormous fraud!

Schatzmeister

Erinnre dich! hast selbst es unterschrieben;

Remember! Thou the note didst undersign;

Who counterfeited the Emperor's signature?

Erst heute nacht. Du standst als grosser Pan,

Last night, indeed. Thou stood'st as mighty Pan,

Has this crime gone unpunished?

Der Kanzler sprach mit uns zu dir heran:

And thus the Chancellor's speech, before thee, ran:

Remember! Thou thyself signed it

“Gewahre dir das hohe Festvergnügen,

“Grant to thyself the festal pleasure, then

Just last night. Thou stoodst as mighty Pan

Des Volkes Heil, mit wenig Federzugen.”

The People's good – a few strokes of the pen!“

The Chancellor came to you with us and spoke

Du zogst sie rein, dann ward's in dieser Nacht
These didst thou give: they were, ere night retreated,
“Grant thyself this high festival pleasure
 Durch Tausendkünstler schnell vertausendfacht.
By skilful conjurers thousandfold repeated;
The people's welfare—just a few pen strokes!“
 Damit die Wohltat allen gleich gedeihe,
And, that a like advantage all might claim,
You drew them clean; then overnight
 So stempelten wir gleich die ganze Reihe,
We stamped at once the series with thy name:
Master-conjurers multiplied them a thousandfold
 Zehn, Dreissig, Funzig, Hundert sind parat.
Tens, Thirties, Fifties, Hundreds, are prepared.
So the blessing might equally reach everyone
 Ihr denkt euch nicht, wie wohl's dem Volke tat.
Thou canst not think how well the folk have fared.
We stamped the whole series right away
 Seht eure Stadt, sonst halb im Tod verschimmelt,
Behold thy town, half-dead once, and decaying,
Tens, Thirties, Fifties, Hundreds—ready to go
 Wie alles lebt und lustgeniessend wimmelt!
How all, alive, enjoying life, are straying!
You can't imagine how it helped the folk
 Obschon dein Name langst die Welt beglückt,
Although thy name long since the world made glad,
Look at your city, once half-dead and moldering
 Man hat ihn nie so freundlich angeblickt.
Such currency as now it never had.
How everything lives and swarms with pleasure!
 Das Alphabet ist nun erst uberzählig,
No longer needs the alphabet thy nation,

Though your name long since blessed the world

In diesem Zeichen wird nun jeder selig.

For in this sign each findeth his salvation.

It was never gazed upon so fondly

Kaiser

Und meinen Leuten gilt's für gutes Gold?

And with my people does it pass for gold?

The alphabet is now superfluous

Dem Heer, dem Hofe genügt's zu vollem Sold?

For pay in court and camp, the notes they hold?

In this sign everyone finds salvation

So sehr mich's wundert, muss ich's gelten lassen.

Then I must yield, although the thing's amazing.

And my people accept it as good gold?

Marschalk

Unmöglich war's, die Fluchtigen einzufassen;

'Twas scattered everywhere, like wild-fire blazing,

Army and court accept it as full pay?

Mit Blitzeswink zerstreute sich's im Lauf.

As currency, and none its course may stop.

Strange as it seems, I must accept it

Die Wechslerbanke stehen sperrig auf:

A crowd surrounds each money-changer's shop,

Impossible to catch them as they flew

Man honoriert daselbst ein jedes Blatt

And every note is there accepted duly

In a flash they scattered on the run

Durch Gold und Silber, freilich mit Rabatt.

For gold and silver's worth – with discount, truly.

The money-changers' benches stand wide open

Nun geht's von da zum Fleischer, Backer, Schenken;

Thence is it spread to landlords, butchers, bakers:

They honor every note there

Die halbe Welt scheint nur an Schmaus zu denken,

One-half the people feast as pleasure-takers;

With gold and silver—naturally at a discount

Wenn sich die andre neu in Kleidern blaht.

In raiment new the others proudly go. –

From there it goes to butcher, baker, bar

Der Kramer schneidet aus, der Schneider naht.

The tradesmen cut their cloth, the tailors sew.

Half the world thinks only of feasting

Bei "Hoch dem Kaiser!" sprudelt's in den Kellern,

The crowd "The Emperor's health!" in cellars wishes,

While the other half struts in new clothes

Dort kocht's und brat's und klappert mit den Tellern.

Midst cooking, roasting, rattling of the dishes.

Cloth-merchant cuts, the tailor sews

Mephistopheles

Wer die Terrassen einsam abspaziert,

If one along the lonely terrace stray,

"Long live the Emperor!" they toast in cellars

Gewahrt die Schonste, herrlich aufgeziert,

He sees the lady, in superb array,

There's cooking, roasting, clattering plates

Ein Aug' verdeckt vom stolzen Pfauenwedel,

With brilliant peacock-fan before one eye;

Whoever strolls the terraces alone

Sie schmunzelt uns und blickt nach solcher Schedel;

A note she looks for, as she simpers by,

Spots the finest lady, splendidly decked out

Und hurt'ger als durch Witz und Redekunst

And readier than by wit or eloquence

One eye hidden by a proud peacock fan

Vermittelt sich die reichste Liebesgunst.

Before Love's favour falls the last defence.

She smirks at us, looking for such bills

Man wird sich nicht mit Bors' und Beutel plagen,

One is not plagued his purse or sack to carry;

And quicker than through wit or eloquence

Ein Blattchen ist im Busen leicht zu tragen,

Such notes one lightly in his bosom bears,

The richest love-favor is arranged

Mit Liebesbrieflein paart's bequem sich hier.

Or them with fond epistles neatly pairs:

No more hassle with purse and pouch

Der Priester tragt's andachtig im Brevier,

The priest devoutly in his breviary

A slip in the bosom is easy to carry

Und der Soldat, um rascher sich zu wenden,

Bears his: the soldier would more freely trip,

It pairs nicely with love letters

Erleichtert schnell den Gurtel seiner Lenden.

And lightens thus the girdle round his hip.

The priest carries them piously in his breviary

Die Majestat verzeihe, wenn ins Kleine

Your Majesty will pardon, if my carriage

And the soldier, to turn more nimbly

Das hohe Werk ich zu erniedern scheine.

Seems as it might the lofty work disparage.

Lightens the belt around his loins

Faust

Das Uebermass der Schatze, das, erstarrt,

The overplus of wealth, in torpor bound,

Majesty forgive if I seem to diminish

In deinen Landen tief im Boden harrt,

Which in thy lands lies buried in the ground,

The lofty work to something small

Liegt ungenutzt. Der weiteste Gedanke

Is all unused; nor boldest thought can measure

The surplus of treasures lying rigid

Ist solchen Reichtums kummerlichste Schranke;

The narrowest boundaries of such a treasure.

Deep in your lands in the earth, waiting

Die Phantasie, in ihrem höchsten Flug,

Imagination, in its highest flight,

Goes unused. The widest thought

Sie strengt sich an und tut sich nie genug.

Exerts itself, but cannot grasp it quite;

Is but the poorest fence to such riches

Doch fassen Geister, würdig, tief zu schauen,

Yet minds, that dare explore the secrets soundless,

Imagination in its highest flight

Zum Grenzenlosen grenzenlos Vertrauen.

In boundless things possess a faith that's boundless.

Strains and never does enough

Mephistopheles

Ein solch Papier, an Gold und Perlen Statt,

Such paper, stead of gold and jewelry,

Yet spirits worthy to see deeply

Ist so bequem, man weiss doch, was man hat;

So handy is – one knows one's property:

Have boundless faith in the boundless

Man braucht nicht erst zu markten, noch zu tauschen,

One has no need of bargains or exchanges,

Such paper, in place of gold and pearls

Kann sich nach Lust in Lieb' und Wein berauschen.

But drinks of love or wine, as fancy ranges.

Is so handy—one knows what one has

Will man Metall, ein Wechsler ist bereit,

If one needs coin, the brokers ready stand,

No need first to haggle or trade

Und fehlt es da, so grabt man eine Zeit.

And if it fail, one digs awhile the land.

One can get drunk on love and wine as one likes

Pokal und Kette wird verauktioniert,

Goblet and chain one then at auction sells,

Want metal? A money-changer awaits

Und das Papier, sogleich amortisiert,

And paper, liquidated thus, compels

And if he's short, just dig a while

Beschamt den Zweifler, der uns frech verhöhnt.

The shame of doubters and their scornful wit.

Goblet and chain get auctioned off

Man will nichts anders, ist daran gewohnt.

The people wish naught else; they're used to it:

And the paper, immediately redeemed

So bleibt von nun an allen Kaiserlanden

From this time forth, your borders, far and wide,

Shames the doubter who mocked us boldly

An Kleinod, Gold, Papier genug vorhanden.

With jewels, gold, and paper are supplied.

People want nothing else—they're hooked

Kaiser

Das hohe Wohl verdankt euch unser Reich;

You've given our empire this prosperity;

So from now on throughout the Emperor's lands

Wo möglich sei der Lohn dem Dienste gleich.

The pay, then, equal to the service be!

Plenty of jewels, gold, and paper

Vertraut sei euch des Reiches innrer Boden,
The soil intrusted to your keeping, shall you

Our realm owes you this great prosperity

Ihr seid der Schätze würdigste Kustoden.

The best custodians be, to guard its value.

Where possible let reward match service

Ihr kennt den weiten, wohlverwahrten Hort,

You know the hoards, well-kept, of all the land,

Entrusted to you be the realm's inner soil

Und wenn man grabt, so sei's auf euer Wort.

And when men dig, 'tis you must give command.

You are the worthiest guardians of the treasure

Vereint euch nun, ihr Meister unsres Schatzes,

Unite then now, ye masters of our treasure,

You know the vast, well-guarded hoard

Erfüllt mit Lust die Wurden eures Platzes,

This, your new dignity, to wear with pleasure,

And when there's digging, let it be on your word

Wo mit der obern sich die Unterwelt,

And bring the Upper World, crewhile asunder,

Unite now, masters of our treasury

In Einigkeit beglückt, zusammenstellt.

In happiest conjunction with the Under!

Fulfill your station's duties with delight

Schatzmeister

Soll zwischen uns kein fernster Zwist sich regen,

No further strife shall shake our joint position;

Where the upper world with the lower

Ich liebe mir den Zaubrer zum Kollegen.

I like to have as partner the magician.

Comes together blissfully united

Kaiser

Beschenk' ich nun bei Hofe Mann für Mann,

Man after man, the Court will I endow:

Let no further strife arise between us

Gesteh' er mir, wozu er's brauchen kann.

Let each confess for what he'll spend, and how!

I like the sorcerer as colleague

Page

Ich lebe lustig, heiter, guter Dinge.

I'll lead a jolly life, enjoy good cheer.

If I now gift each man at court

Ein Andrer

Von nun an trink' ich doppelt bessr'e Flasche.

Wines twice as good shall down my throat go trickling.

Let him confess what he'll spend it on

Ein Andrer

Die Würfel jucken mich schon in der Tasche.

I feel the dice within my pockets tickling.

I'll live merrily, cheerful, in good spirits!

Bannerherr

Mein Schloss und Feld, ich mach' es schuldenfrei.

My lands and castle shall be free of debt.

From now on I'll drink wine twice as good!

Ein Andrer

Es ist ein Schatz, den leg' ich Schätzen bei.

I'll add to other wealth the wealth I get.

The dice are already itching in my pocket!

Kaiser

Ich hoffte Lust und Mut zu neuen Taten;

I hoped the gifts to bolder deeds would reckon;

My castle and field—debt-free at last!

Doch wer euch kennt, der wird euch leicht erraten.

But he who knows you, knows whereon to reckon.

It's treasure—I'll add it to my treasures!

Ich merk' es wohl: bei aller Schätze Flor,

I see that, spite of all this treasure-burst,

I'd hoped for zeal and courage for new deeds

Wie ihr gewesen, bleibt ihr nach wie vor.

You stay exactly as you were at first.

But he who knows you easily guesses

Narr

Ihr spendet Gnaden, gönnt auch mir davon!

You scatter favours: grant me also some!

I see that with all this treasure-flood

Kaiser

Und lebst du wieder, du vertrinkst sie schon.

Thou'rt come to life? 'Twould go at once for rum.

You remain exactly as you were before

Narr

Die Zauberblätter! ich versteh's nicht recht.

The magic leaves! I don't quite comprehend.

You're scattering favors—toss me some too!

Kaiser

Das glaub' ich wohl, denn du gebrauchst sie schlecht.

That I believe; for them thou'lt badly spend.

Alive again? You'll just drink it away!

Narr

Da fallen andere; weiss nicht, was ich tu'.

There others drop: I don't know what to do.

The magic papers! I don't quite get it...

Kaiser

Nimm sie nur hin, sie fielen dir ja zu.

Just pick them up! they fall to thy share, too.

I believe that—you'd spend them badly

Narr

Funftausend Kronen waren mir zu Handen!

Five thousand crowns are mine? How unexpected!

Others are falling—I dunno what to do!

Mephistopheles

Zweibeiniger Schlauch, bist wieder auferstanden?

Two-legged wine-skin, art thou resurrected?

Just pick them up—they fell to you!

Narr

Geschieht mir oft, doch nicht so gut als jetzt.

Much luck I've had, but like this never yet.

Five thousand crowns fell into my hands!

Mephistopheles

Du freust dich so, dass dich's in Schweiss versetzt.

Thou'rt so rejoiced, it puts thee in a sweat.

Two-legged wineskin, risen from the dead?

Narr

Da seht nur her, ist das wohl Geldes wert?

But look at this, is't money's-worth, indeed?

Happens to me often, but never this good!

Mephistopheles

Du hast dafur, was Schlund und Bauch begehrt.

'Twill bring thee what thy throat and belly need.

You're so happy you're sweating!

Narr

Und kaufen kann ich Acker, Haus und Vieh?

And cattle can I buy, and house and land?

But look—is this really worth money?

Mephistopheles

Versteht sich! Biete nur, das fehlt dir nie.

Of course! just make an offer once, off-hand!

You'll get what throat and belly crave

Narr

Und Schloss, mit Wald und Jagd und Fischbach? –

Castle and wood, and chase, and fishing?

And I can buy land, house, and cattle?

Mephistopheles

Traum!

All!

Of course! Just make an offer—never fails!

Ich mochte dich gestrengen Herrn wohl schaun!

I'd like upon Your Worship then to call.

And a castle with forest and hunting and fish-stream?

Narr

Heut abend wieg' ich mich im Grundbesitz! –

To-night as landed owner I shall sit.

Indeed! I'd love to see you as a stern lord!

Mephistopheles

Wer zweifelt noch an unsres Narren Witz!

Who now will doubt that this our Fool has wit?

Tonight I'll cradle myself in landed property!

Finstere Galerie / A Gloomy Gallery

Faust. Mephistopheles.

Mephistopheles

Was ziehst du mich in diese düstern Gänge?

What wilt thou with me in this gloomy gallery?

What are you dragging me into these dark hallways?

Ist nicht da drinnen Lust genug,

Is there not still enough of sport

Isn't there enough fun back in there

Im dichten, bunten Hofgedrange

There, in the crowded, motley Court, –

In the thick, colorful court-crowd

Gelegenheit zu Spass und Trug?

Not chance for tricks, and fun, and raillery?

Opportunity for jokes and lies?

Faust

Sag mir das nicht, du hast's in alten Tagen

Don't tell me that! – In our old days the fun of it

Don't give me that, in your old days

Langst an den Sohlen abgetragen;

Didst thou wear out, and I'll have none of it.

You already wore it out at the soles

Doch jetzt dein Hin- und Widergehn

Thy wandering here and there is planned

But your here-and-there pacing now

Ist nur, um mir nicht Wort zu stehn.

Just to evade what I demand.

Is just to dodge keeping your word to me

Ich aber bin gequält zu tun:

But I'm tormented something to obtain;

But I'm pressured to deliver

Der Marschalk und der Kammrer treibt mich nun.

The Marshal drives me, and the Chamberlain,

The Marshal and Chamberlain are riding my ass

Der Kaiser will, es muss sogleich geschehn,

The Emperor orders, he will instantly

The Emperor wants, it must happen NOW

Will Helena und Paris vor sich sehn;

Helen and Paris here before him see, –

Wants Helen and Paris in front of his face

Das Musterbild der Manner so der Frauen

The model forms of Man and Woman, wearing,

The pattern-image of men and women both

In deutlichen Gestalten will er schauen.

Distinctly shown, their ancient shape and bearing.

In clear shapes he wants to see them

Geschwind ans Werk! ich darf mein Wort nicht brechen.

Now to the work! I dare not break my word.

Quick, to work! I can't break my word

Mephistopheles

Unsinnig war's, leichtsinnig zu versprechen.

So thoughtlessly to promise was absurd.

Senseless it was, to so carelessly promise

Faust

Du hast, Geselle, nicht bedacht,

Thou hast not, comrade, well reflected

You haven't considered, colleague

Wohin uns deine Kunste fuhren;

What comes of having used thy powers:

Where your arts have led us

Erst haben wir ihn reich gemacht,

We've made him rich; 'tis now expected

First we made him rich

Nun sollen wir ihn amüsieren.

That we amuse his idle hours.

Now we're supposed to entertain him

Mephistopheles

Du wahnst, es fuge sich sogleich;

Thou deem'st the thing is quickly fixed:

You think it'll just happen by itself

Hier stehen wir vor steilern Stufen,

Here before steeper ways we're standing;

Here we stand before steeper steps

Greifst in ein fremdestes Bereich,
With strangest spheres wouldst thou be mixed,
Reaching into the weirdest territory
 Machst frevelhaft am Ende neue Schulden,
And, sinful, addest new debts to the old, –
You sinfully add new debts at the end
 Denkst Helenen so leicht hervorzurufen
Think'st Helen will respond to thy commanding
Think Helen's as easy to summon
 Wie das Papiergespenst der Gulden. –
As freely as the paper-ghosts of gold!
As the paper-ghost of the Guilders
 Mit Hexen-Fexen, mit Gespenst-Gespinsten,
With witches'-riches and with spectre-pictures,
With witch-tricks, with ghost-webs
 Kielkropfigen Zwergen steh' ich gleich zu Diensten;
And changeling-dwarfs, I'll give no cause for strictures;
Goiter-neck dwarves I'll serve right up
 Doch Teufels-Liebchen, wenn auch nicht zu schelten,
But Devil's-darlings, though you may not scold 'em,
But Devil's girlfriends, though you can't knock them
 Sie können nicht für Heroinen gelten.
You cannot quite as heroines behold 'em.
They don't pass for heroines

Faust

Da haben wir den alten Leierton!
The old hand-organ still I hear thee play!
There's the same old tune again!
 Bei dir gerät man stets ins Ungewisse.
From thee one always gets uncertain sense,
With you everything turns uncertain
 Der Vater bist du aller Hindernisse,

The father, thou, of all impediments:

You're the father of all obstacles

Für jedes Mittel willst du neuen Lohn.

For every means thou askest added pay.

For every tool you want new payment

Mit wenig Murmeln, weiss ich, ist's getan;

A little muttering, and the thing takes place;

A little mumbling, I know, does it

Wie man sich umschaut, bringst du sie zur Stelle.

Ere one can turn, beside us here her shade is.

Quick as you turn around you bring her here

Mephistopheles

Das Heidenvolk geht mich nichts an,

I've no concern with the old heathen race;

The pagan-folk don't concern me

Es haust in seiner eignen Holle;

They house within their special Hades.

They camp out in their own private Hell

Doch gibt's ein Mittel. –

Yet there's a way.

But there IS a method

Faust

Sprich, und ohne Saumnis!

Speak, nor delay thy history!

Speak! No stalling!

Mephistopheles

Ungern entdeck' ich höheres Geheimnis.

Unwilling, I reveal a loftier mystery. –

Reluctantly I reveal a higher mystery

Gottinnen thronen hehr in Einsamkeit,

In solitude are throned the Goddesses,

Goddesses sit enthroned in sublime solitude

Um sie kein Ort, noch weniger eine Zeit;
No Space around them, Place and Time still less;
Around them no Place, still less any Time
Von ihnen sprechen ist Verlegenheit.
Only to speak of them embarrasses.
Even to speak of them is embarrassment
Die Mutter sind es! –
They are The Mothers!
They are THE MOTHERS!

Faust

Mutter! –
Mothers!
Mothers!

Mephistopheles

Schaudert's dich?
Hast thou dread?
Does it make you shudder?

Faust

Die Mutter! Mutter! – 's klingt so wunderbarlich!
The Mothers! Mothers! – a strange word is said.
The Mothers! Mothers! – it sounds so weird!

Mephistopheles

Das ist es auch. Gottinnen, ungekannt
It is so. Goddesses, unknown to ye,
That it is. Goddesses, unknown
Euch Sterblichen, von uns nicht gern genannt.
The Mortals, – named by us unwillingly.
To you mortals, named by us unwillingly
Nach ihrer Wohnung magst ins Tiefste schurfen;
Delve in the deepest depths must thou, to reach them:
To their dwelling you must dig into the deepest deep

Du selbst bist schuld, dass ihrer wir bedürfen.

'Tis thine own fault that we for help beseech them.

It's your own fault we need them at all

Faust

Wohin der Weg?

Where is the way?

Where's the path?

Mephistopheles

Kein Weg! Ins Unbetretene,

No way! – To the Unreachable,

No path! Into the un-entered

Nicht zu Betretende; ein Weg ans Unerbetene,

Ne'er to be trodden! A way to the Unbeseechable,

Not-to-be-entered; a way to the un-begged

Nicht zu Erbittende. Bist du bereit? –

Never to be besought! Art thou prepared?

Not-to-be-begged. Are you ready?

Nicht Schlosser sind, nicht Riegel wegzuschieben,

There are no locks, no latches to be lifted;

No locks are there, no bolts to shove aside

Von Einsamkeiten wirst umhergetrieben.

Through endless solitudes shalt thou be drifted.

You'll be driven around by lonelinesses

Hast du Begriff von od' und Einsamkeit?

Hast thou through solitudes and deserts fared?

Do you have any concept of empty and alone?

Faust

Du spartest, dacht' ich, solche Sprüche;

I think 'twere best to spare such speeches;

You could have saved those lines, I thought

Hier wittert's nach der Hexenküche,

They smell too strongly of the witches,

Here it reeks of the witch-kitchen

Nach einer längst vergangnen Zeit.

Of cheats that long ago ensnared.

Of a long-gone time

Musst' ich nicht mit der Welt verkehren?

Have I not known all earthly vanities?

Didn't I have to deal with the world?

Das Leere lernen, Leeres lehren? –

Learned the inane, and taught inanities?

Learn emptiness, teach emptiness?

Sprach ich vernünftig, wie ich's angeschaut,

When as I felt I spake, with sense as guide,

When I spoke reasonably, as I saw it

Erklang der Widerspruch gedoppelt laut;

The contradiction doubly shrill replied;

The contradiction rang doubly loud

Musst' ich sogar vor widerwartigen Streichen

Enforced by odious tricks, have I not fled

Didn't I have to flee nasty attacks

Zur Einsamkeit, zur Wildernis entweichen

To solitudes and wildernesses dread,

To solitude, to wilderness

Und, um nicht ganz versaumt, allein zu leben,

And that I might not live alone, unheeded,

And, not to live entirely forsaken alone

Mich doch zuletzt dem Teufel übergeben.

Myself at last unto the Devil deeded!

Finally give myself to the Devil

Mephistopheles

Und hattest du den Ozean durchschwommen,

And hadst thou swum to farthest verge of ocean,

And had you swum through the ocean

Das Grenzenlose dort geschaut,

And there the boundless space beheld,

Seen the Boundless there

So sahst du dort doch Well' auf Welle kommen,

Still hadst thou seen wave after wave in motion,

You'd still have seen wave upon wave coming

Selbst wenn es dir vorm Untergange graut.

Even though impending doom thy fear compelled.

Even if you dread going under

Du sahst doch etwas. Sahst wohl in der Grune

Thou hadst seen something, – in the beryl dim

You still saw something. Saw in the green

Gestillter Meere streichende Delphine;

Of peace-lulled seas the sportive dolphins swim;

Of still seas the gliding dolphins

Sahst Wolken ziehen, Sonne, Mond und Sterne –

Hadst seen the flying clouds, sun, moon, and star:

Saw clouds moving, sun, moon and stars

Nichts wirst du sehn in ewig leerer Ferne,

Naught shalt thou see in endless Void afar, –

Nothing will you see in eternally empty distance

Den Schritt nicht horen, den du tust,

Not hear thy footstep fall, nor meet

Not hear the step you take

Nichts Festes finden, wo du ruhst.

A stable spot to rest thy feet.

Find nothing solid where you rest

Faust

Du sprichst als erster aller Mystagogen,

Thou speak'st, as of all mystagogues the chief,

You speak like the first of all mystagogues

Die treue Neophyten je betrogen;

Whoe'er brought faithful neophytes to grief;

Who ever betrayed faithful initiates

Nur umgekehrt. Du sendest mich ins Leere,

Only reversed: – I to the Void am sent,

Only reversed. You send me into the Empty

Damit ich dort so Kunst als Kraft vermehre;

That Art and Power therein I may augment:

So I can multiply Art and Power there

Behandelst mich, dass ich, wie jene Katze,

To use me like a cat is thy desire,

You're treating me like that cat

Dir die Kastanien aus den Gluten kratze.

To scratch for thee the chestnuts from the fire.

To scratch the chestnuts from the coals for you

Nur immer zu! wir wollen es ergründen,

Come on, then! we'll explore, whate'er befall;

Whatever! Let's do this, we'll get to the bottom

In deinem Nichts hoff' ich das All zu finden.

In this, thy Nothing, may I find my All!

In your Nothing I hope to find the All

Mephistopheles

Ich ruhme dich, eh' du dich von mir trennst,

I'll praise thee, ere we separate: I see

I'll praise you before you leave me

Und sehe wohl, dass du den Teufel kennst;

Thou knowest the Devil thoroughly.

And see clearly that you know the Devil

Hier diesen Schlüssel nimm. –

Here, take this key!

Here, take this key

Faust

Das kleine Ding!

That little thing?

That little thing!

Mephistopheles

Erst fass ihn an und schatz ihn nicht gering.

Take hold of it, not undervaluing!

First grab it and don't underestimate it

Faust

Er wächst in meiner Hand! er leuchtet, blitzt!

It glows, it shines, – increases in my hand!

It grows in my hand! It glows, it flashes!

Mephistopheles

Merkst du nun bald, was man an ihm besitzt?

How much 'tis worth, thou soon shalt understand.

You're catching on what you've got there?

Der Schlüssel wird die rechte Stelle wittern,

The Key will scent the true place from all others:

The key will sniff out the right spot

Folg ihm hinab, er führt dich zu den Muttern.

Follow it down! – 'twill lead thee to the Mothers.

Follow it down, it leads you to the Mothers

Faust

Den Muttern! Trifft's mich immer wie ein Schlag!

The Mothers! Like a blow it strikes me still!

The Mothers! Hits me every time like a punch!

Was ist das Wort, das ich nicht horen mag?

What is the word, to hear which makes me chill?

What is that word I can't stand to hear?

Mephistopheles

Bist du beschränkt, dass neues Wort dich stört?

Art thou so weak, disturbed by each new word?

Are you so limited that a new word rattles you?

Willst du nur horen, was du schon gehört?

Wilt only hear what thou'st already heard?

You only want to hear what you've already heard?

Dich store nichts, wie es auch weiter klinge,

To wondrous things art thou so used already,

Let nothing disturb you, however it sounds

Schon langst gewohnt der wunderbarsten Dinge.

Let naught, howe'er it sound, make thee unsteady!

You've long been used to the weirdest things

Faust

Doch im Erstarren such' ich nicht mein Heil,

Nathless in torpor lies no good for me;

But in going numb I don't seek my salvation

Das Schaudern ist der Menschheit bestes Teil;

The chill of dread is Man's best quality.

The shudder is humanity's best part

Wie auch die Welt ihm das Gefühl verteure,

Though from the feeling oft the world may fend us,

However much the world makes feeling expensive

Ergriffen, fuhlt er tief das Ungeheure.

Deeply we feel, once smitten, the Tremendous.

Once seized, one feels the Enormous deeply

Mephistopheles

Versinke denn! Ich konnt' auch sagen: steige!

Descend, then! I could also say: Ascend!

Sink then! I could also say: rise!

's ist einerlei. Entfliehe dem Entstandnen

'Twere all the same. Escape from the Created

Same difference. Flee the Created

In der Gebilde losgebundne Reiche!

To shapeless forms in liberated spaces!

Into unbound realms of forms!

Ergetze dich am langst nicht mehr Vorhandnen;

Enjoy what long ere this was dissipated!

Enjoy what's long since no longer there

Wie Wolkenzüge schlingt sich das Getreibe,

There whirls the press, like clouds on clouds unfolding;

Like cloud-trains the swirl coils

Den Schlüssel schwinge, halte sie vom Leibe!

Then with stretched arm swing high the key thou'rt holding!

Swing the key, keep them off your body!

Faust

Wohl! fest ihn fassend fühl' ich neue Stärke,

Good! grasping firmly, fresher strength I win:

Good! Grasping it firmly I feel new strength

Die Brust erweitert, hin zum grossen Werke.

My breast expands, let the great work begin!

The chest expands, onward to the great work

Mephistopheles

Ein gluhender Dreifuss tut dir endlich kund,

At last a blazing tripod tells thee this,

A glowing tripod tells you finally

Du seist im tiefsten, allertiefsten Grund.

That there the utterly deepest bottom is.

You're at the deepest, most utterly deepest ground

Bei seinem Schein wirst du die Mutter sehn,

Its light to thee will then the Mothers show,

By its glow you will see the Mothers

Die einen sitzen, andre stehn und gehn,

Some in their seats, the others stand or go,

Some sit, others stand and walk

Wie's eben kommt. Gestaltung, Umgestaltung,

At their own will: Formation, Transformation,

However it happens. Formation, Transformation

Des ewigen Sinnes ewige Unterhaltung.

The Eternal Mind's eternal recreation.

Of eternal meaning the eternal conversation

Umschwebt von Bildern aller Kreatur;

Forms of all creatures, – there are floating free.

Surrounded by images of all creatures

Sie sehn dich nicht, denn Schemen sehn sie nur.

They'll see thee not; for only wraiths they see.

They won't see you, for they see only shadows

Da fass ein Herz, denn die Gefahr ist gross,

So pluck up heart, – the danger then is great, –

So take heart, for the danger is great

Und gehe grad' auf jenen Dreifuss los,

Go to the tripod ere thou hesitate,

And go straight at that tripod

Berühr ihn mit dem Schlüssell –

And touch it with the key!

Touch it with the key!

Faust macht eine entschieden gebietende Attitüde mit dem Schlüssell. Faust, with the key, assumes a decidedly commanding attitude. Mephistopheles, observing him:

Mephistopheles

So ist's recht!

So, that is right!

That's right!

Er schliesst sich an, er folgt als treuer Knecht;

It will adhere, and follow thee to light.

It attaches itself, it follows like a faithful servant

Gelassen steigst du, dich erhebt das Glück,

Composedly mounting, by thy luck upborne,

Calmly you rise, luck lifts you

Und eh' sie's merken, bist mit ihm zuruck.

Before they notice it, shalt thou return.

And before they notice, you're back with it

Und hast du ihn einmal hierher gebracht,
When thou the tripod hither hast conveyed,
And once you've brought it here
So rufst du Held und Heldin aus der Nacht,
Then call the hero, heroine, from the shade, –
You call hero and heroine from the night
Der erste, der sich jener Tat erdreistet;
The first that ever such a deed perfected:
The first who ever dared that deed
Sie ist getan, und du hast es geleistet.
'Tis done, and thou thereto hast been selected.
It is done, and you accomplished it
Dann muss fortan, nach magischem Behandeln,
For instantly, by magic process warmed,
Then from now on, by magic treatment
Der Weihrauchsnebel sich in Gotter wandeln.
To gods the incense-mist shall be transformed.
The incense fog must transform into gods

Faust

Und nun was jetzt? –
What further now?
And now what?

Mephistopheles

Dein Wesen strebe nieder;
Downward thy being strain!
Strain your being downward
Versinke stampfend, stampfend steigst du wieder.
Stamp and descend, stamping thou'lt rise again.
Sink stamping, stamping you rise again

Faust stampft und versinkt. Faust stamps, and sinks out of sight.

Mephistopheles

Wenn ihm der Schlüssel nur zum besten frommt!

If only, by the key, he something learn!

If only the key works out for his best!

Neugierig bin ich, ob er wiederkommt.

I'm curious to see if he return.

I'm curious whether he'll come back

Hell erleuchtete Sale / Brilliantly Lighted Halls

Kaiser und Fursten. Der Hof in Bewegung. Emperor and Princes. The Court in movement.

Kammerer (*zu Mephistopheles*)

Ihr seid uns noch die Geisterszene schuldig;

The spirit-scene you've promised, still you owe us;

You still owe us the ghost show

Macht Euch daran! der Herr ist ungeduldig.

Our Lord's impatient; come, the phantasm show us!

Get on it! The boss is losing patience

Marschalk

Soeben fragt der Gnadigste darnach;

Just now His Gracious Self did question me:

His Most Gracious just asked about it

Ihr! zaudert nicht der Majestat zur Schmach.

Delay not, nor offend His Majesty!

Don't dawdle! It would shame His Majesty

Mephistopheles

Ist mein Kumpan doch deshalb weggegangen;

My comrade's gone to set the work in motion;

That's exactly why my buddy left

Er weiss schon, wie es anzufangen,

How to begin, he has the proper notion.

He knows how to get this thing started

Und laboriert verschlossen still,

In secret he the charms must cull,

And works away in secret, silent

Muss ganz besonders sich befeissen;

Must labour with a fervour tragic:

Must really throw himself into it

Denn wer den Schatz, das Schöne, heben will,

Who would that treasure lift, the Beautiful,

For whoever wants to lift the treasure, the Beautiful

Bedarf der höchsten Kunst, Magie der Weisen.

Requires the highest Art, the sage's Magic.

Needs the highest art, the Sages' Magic

Marschalk

Was ihr für Künste braucht, ist einerlei:

What arts you need, is all the same to me;

What arts you need is all the same to me

Der Kaiser will, dass alles fertig sei.

The Emperor wills that you should ready be.

The Emperor wants it done. Period.

Blonde (*zu Mephistopheles*)

Ein Wort, mein Herr! Ihr seht ein klares Angesicht,

One word, Sir! Here you see a visage fair, –

One word, sir! You see a clear complexion here

So ist's jedoch im leid'gen Sommer nicht!

In sorry summer I another wear!

But not in wretched summer, no!

Da sprossen hundert braunlich rote Flecken,

There sprout a hundred brown and reddish freckles,

A hundred brownish-red spots sprout up

Die zum Verdruss die weisse Haut bedecken.

And vex my lily skin with ugly speckles.

And cover my white skin, to my disgust

Ein Mittel! –

A cure!

A cure! –

Mephistopheles

Schade! so ein leuchtend Schatzchen

'Tis pity! Shining fair, yet smitten, –

Pity! Such a glowing little treasure

Im Mai getupft wie eure Pantherkatzchen.

Spotted, when May comes, like a panther-kitten!

Spotted in May like your little panther-cats

Nehmt Froschlaich, Krotenzungen, kohobiert,

Take frog-spawn, tongues of toads, which cohobate,

Take frog-spawn, toad tongues, cohobate them

Im vollsten Mondlicht sorglich destilliert

Under the full moon deftly distillate,

Carefully distilled under the fullest moonlight

Und, wenn er abnimmt, reinlich aufgestrichen,

And, when it wanes, apply the mixture:

And when it wanes, smear it on clean

Der Frühling kommt, die Tupfen sind entwichen.

Next spring, the spots will be no more a fixture.

Spring comes, the spots will have fled

Braune

Die Menge drängt heran, Euch zu umschranzen.

To sponge upon you, what a crowd's advancing!

The crowd pushes forward to sponge off you

Ich bitt' um Mittel! Ein erfrorner Fuss

I beg a remedy: a frozen foot

I beg a remedy! A frozen foot

Verhindert mich am Wandeln wie am Tanzen,

Annoys me much, in walking as in dancing;

Keeps me from walking as much as dancing

Selbst ungeschickt beweg' ich mich zum Gruss.

And awkwardly I manage to salute.

Even in greeting I move awkwardly

Mephistopheles

Erlaubet einen Tritt von meinem Fuss.

A gentle kick permit, then, from my foot!

Allow one kick from my foot

Braune

Nun, das geschieht wohl unter Liebesleuten.

Well, – that might happen, when the two are lovers.

Well, that's something lovers do

Mephistopheles

Mein Fusstritt, Kind! hat Grossres zu bedeuten.

My kick a more important meaning covers:

My kick, child! means something bigger

Zu Gleichem Gleiches, was auch einer litt;

Similia similibus, when one is sick.

Like cures like, whatever one suffered

Fuss heilet Fuss, so ist's mit allen Gliedern.

The foot cures foot, each limb its hurt can palliate;

Foot heals foot, same with all limbs

Heran! Gebt acht! Ihr sollt es nicht erwidern.

Come near! Take heed! and, pray you, don't retaliate!

Come close! Watch out! Don't kick back

Braune (*schreiend*)

Weh! Weh! das brennt! das war ein harter Tritt, –

Oh! oh! it stings! That was a fearful kick,

Ow! Ow! It burns! That was a hard kick–

Wie Pferdehuf.

Like hoof of horse.

Like a horse hoof

Mephistopheles

Die Heilung nehmt Ihr mit.

But it has cured you, quick.

You take the cure with you

Du kannst nunmehr den Tanz nach Lust veruben,

To dance whene'er you please, you now are able;

Now you can dance to your heart's content

Bei Tafel schwelgend fussle mit dem Lieben.

To press your lover's foot, beneath the table.

At table, feasting, play footsie with your lover

Dame (*vordringend*)

Lasst mich hindurch! Zu gross sind meine Schmerzen,

Make room for me! Too great is my affliction,

Let me through! My pain is too great

Sie wuhlen siedend mir im tiefsten Herzen;

My tortures worse than those described in fiction:

It churns boiling in my deepest heart

Bis gestern sucht' Er Heil in meinen Blicken,

His bliss, till yesterday, was in my glances,

Till yesterday he sought salvation in my glances

Er schwatzt mit ihr und wendet mir den Rucken.

But now he turns his back, and spins with her romances!

Now he chats with her and turns me his back

Mephistopheles

Bedenklich ist es, aber hore mich.

The matter's grave, but listen unto me!

Tricky, but hear me out

An ihn heran musst du dich leise drucken;

Draw near to him with gentle, soft advances!

You need to press yourself softly up to him

Nimm diese Kohle, streich ihm einen Strich

Then take this coal and mark him stealthily

Take this coal, draw a line on him

Auf Armel, Mantel, Schulter, wie sich's macht;

On mantle, shoulder, sleeve, – though ne'er so slight,

On sleeve, cloak, shoulder, however you can

Er fuhlt im Herzen holden Reuestich.

Yet penitent at once his heart will be.

He'll feel sweet stabs of remorse in his heart

Die Kohle doch musst du sogleich verschlingen,

The coal thereafter you must straightway swallow,

But you must swallow the coal right away

Nicht Wein, nicht Wasser an die Lippen bringen;

And let no sip of wine or water follow:

No wine, no water must touch your lips

Er seufzt vor deiner Tur noch heute nacht.

He'll sigh before your door this very night.

He'll sigh at your door tonight

Dame

Ist doch kein Gift? –

It is not poison, sure?

It's not poison? –

Mephistopheles (*beleidigt*)

Respekt, wo sich's gebührt!

Respect, where it is due!

Respect where it's due!

Weit musstet Ihr nach solcher Kohle laufen;

To get such coals, you'd travel many a mile:

You'd have to travel far to find such coal

Sie kommt von einem Scheiterhaufen,

They're from the embers of a funeral pile,

It comes from a funeral pyre

Den wir sonst emsiger angeschurt.

The fires whereof we once more hotly blew.

Which we once stoked more eagerly

Page

Ich bin verliebt, man halt mich nicht für voll.

I love, yet still am counted adolescent.

I'm in love, but no one takes me seriously

Mephistopheles (*beiseite*)

Ich weiss nicht mehr, wohin ich horen soll.

I know not whom to listen to, at present.

I don't know who to listen to anymore

(*Zum Pagen*) (*To the Page*)

Musst Euer Gluck nicht auf die Jungste setzen.

Let not the younger girls thy fancies fetter;

Don't bet your luck on the youngest ones

Die Angejahrten wissen Euch zu schätzen. –

Those well in years know how to prize thee better. –

The more mature know how to appreciate you –

(*Andere drangen sich herzu.*) (*Others crowd around him.*)

Schon wieder Neue! Welch ein harter Strauss!

Already others? 'Tis a trial, sooth!

New ones already! What a brutal ordeal!

Ich helfe mir zuletzt mit Wahrheit aus;

I'll help myself, at last, with naked truth –

I'll just help myself with the truth at last

Der schlechteste Behelf! Die Not ist gross. –

The worst device! – so great my misery.

The worst resort! The need is great –

O Mutter, Mutter! Lasst nur Fausten los!

O Mothers! Mothers! let but Faust go free!

O Mothers, Mothers! Just let Faust go!

(*Umherschauend.*) (*Gazing around him.*)

Die Lichter brennen trube schon im Saal,

The lights are burning dimly in the hall,

The lights already burn dim in the hall

Der ganze Hof bewegt sich auf einmal.

The Court is moving onward, one and all:

The whole court moves at once

Anständig seh' ich sie in Folge ziehn

I see them march, according to degrees,

Properly I see them file along

Durch lange Gänge, ferne Galerien.

Through long arcades and distant galleries.

Through long corridors, distant galleries

Nun! sie versammeln sich im weiten Raum

Now they assemble in the ample space

Now! They gather in the wide space

Des alten Rittersaals, er fasst sie kaum.

Of the Knights' Hall; yet hardly all find place.

Of the old Knight's Hall, it barely holds them

Auf breite Wände Teppiche spendiert,

The breadth of walls is hung with arras rich,

Tapestries donated across broad walls

Mit Rustung Eck' und Nischen ausgeziert.

And armour gleams from every nook and niche.

Corners and niches decked out with armor

Hier braucht es, dacht' ich, keine Zauberworte;

Here, I should think, there needs no magic word:

Here, I thought, no magic words are needed

Die Geister finden sich von selbst zum Orte.

The ghosts will come, and of their own accord.

The ghosts will find their way here on their own

Rittersaal / Hall of the Knights

Dammernde Beleuchtung. Dimly Lighted.

Der Kaiser und der Hof sind eingezogen. The Emperor and Court have entered.

Herold

Mein alt Geschäft, das Schauspiel anzukunden,

Mine ancient office, to proclaim the action,

My old gig, announcing the show

Verkummert mir der Geister heimlich Walten;

Is by the spirits' secret influence thwarted:

Gets sabotaged by secret spirit-meddling

Vergebens wagt man, aus verstandigen Gründen

One tries in vain; such wildering distraction

You try in vain with sensible reasons

Sich zu erklären das verworrene Schalten.

Can't be explained, or reasonably reported.

To explain the chaotic management

Die Sessel sind, die Stühle schon zur Hand;

The chairs are ranged, the seats are ready all:

Chairs are here, seats ready to hand

Den Kaiser setzt man grade vor die Wand;

The Emperor sits, fronting the lofty wall,

They park the Emperor right at the wall

Auf den Tapeten mag er da die Schlachten

Where on the tapestry the battles he

On tapestries there he can ogle

Der grossen Zeit bequemlichstens betrachten.

Of the great era may with comfort see.

History's greatest battles in comfort

Hier sitzt nun alles, Herr und Hof im Runde,

Here now are all – Prince, Court, and their belonging,

Everyone's seated, Lord and Court in the round

Die Banke drangen sich im Hintergrunde;
Benches on benches in the background thronging;

Benches cramped together in the back

Auch Liebchen hat, in düstern Geisterstunden,
And lovers, too, in these dim hours enchanted,

Even sweethearts, in this spooky ghost-hour

Zur Seite Liebchens lieblich Raum gefunden.
Beside their loved ones lovingly are planted.

Found cozy spots next to sweethearts

Und so, da alle schicklich Platz genommen,
And now, since all have found convenient places,

So now that everyone's properly placed

Sind wir bereit; die Geister mögen kommen!
We're ready: let the spirits show their faces!

We're ready: let the ghosts show their faces!

(Trompeten.) (Trumpets.)

Astrolog

Beginne gleich das Drama seinen Lauf,
Begin the Drama! 'Tis the Sire's command:

Drama, start your engines!

Der Herr befiehlt's, ihr Wände tut euch auf!
Ye walls, be severed straightway, and expand!

The Master commands it - walls, spread yourselves!

Nichts hindert mehr, hier ist Magie zur Hand:
Naught hinders; magic answers our desire:

Nothing blocks us now, magic's on tap

Die Teppiche schwinden, wie gerollt vom Brand;
The arras flies, as shrivelled up by fire;

The tapestries vanish, burnt-scroll style

Die Mauer spaltet sich, sie kehrt sich um,
The walls are split, unfolded: in the gloom

The wall cracks open, flips itself around

Ein tief Theater scheint sich aufzustellen,

A theatre appears to be created:

A deep theatre seems to set itself up

Geheimnisvoll ein Schein uns zu erhellen,

By mystic light are we illuminated,

Mystery-light to illuminate us

Und ich besteige das Proszenium.

And I ascend to the proscenium.

And I climb up to the proscenium

Mephistopheles (*im Souffleurkasten auftauchend*)

Von hier aus hoff' ich allgemeine Gunst,

I hope to win, as prompter, general glory;

From here I hope for universal applause

Einblasereien sind des Teufels Redekunst.

For prompting is the Devil's oratory.

Whispering is the Devil's rhetoric

(*Zum Astrologen.*) (*To the Astrologer.*)

Du kennst den Takt, in dem die Sterne gehn,

Thou know'st the tune and time the stars that lead;

You know the beat the stars keep

Und wirst mein Flustern meisterlich verstehn.

Thou wilt my whispers like a master heed.

My whispers you'll catch like a master

Astrolog

Durch Wunderkraft erscheint allhier zur Schau,

By power miraculous, we here behold

Through wonder-power appears here for show

Massiv genug, ein alter Tempelbau.

A massive temple of the days of old.

Solid enough, an ancient temple

Dem Atlas gleich, der einst den Himmel trug,

Like Atlas, who erewhile the heavens upbore,

Like Atlas who once held up the sky

Stehn reihenweis der Säulen hier genug;

The serried columns stand, an ample store:

Columns stand here in rows, plenty of them

Sie mögen wohl der Felsenlast genügen,

Well may they for the weight of stone suffice,

They should handle the stone-weight just fine

Da zweie schon ein gross Gebäude trugen.

Since two might bear a mighty edifice.

Since two alone could carry a huge building

Architekt

Das war' antik! Ich wusst' es nicht zu preisen,

That the antique? As fine it can't be rated;

That's supposed to be classical? I can't praise it

Es sollte plump und überlastig heissen.

I'd sooner style it awkward, over-weighted.

I'd call it clunky and overloaded

Roh nennt man edel, unbehelflich gross.

Coarse is called noble, and unwieldy, grand:

Crude gets called noble, clumsy gets called grand

Schmalpfeiler lieb' ich, strebend, grenzenlos;

Give me the slender shafts that soar, expand!

I love slim pillars, striving, limitless

Spitzbogiger Zenit erhebt den Geist;

To lift the mind, a pointed arch may boast;

Pointed arches elevate the spirit

Solch ein Gebau erbaut uns allermeist.

Such architecture edifies us most.

That kind of building builds us up the most

Astrolog

Empfangt mit Ehrfurcht sterngegonnte Stunden;

Receive with reverence the star-granted hours;

Receive with reverence these star-granted hours

Durch magisch Wort sei die Vernunft gebunden;

Let magic words bind Reason's restless powers,

Let magic words bind Reason in chains

Dagegen weit heran bewege frei

But in return unbind, to circle free,

But in return, let it roam free and far

Sich herrliche verwegne Phantasei.

The wings of splendid, daring Phantasy!

Magnificent audacious Fantasy

Mit Augen schaut nun, was ihr kuhn begehrt,

What you have boldly wished, see now achieved:

See with your eyes what you boldly crave

Unmöglich ist's, drum eben glaubenswert.

Impossible 'tis – therefore to be believed.

It's impossible - therefore believable

(Faust steigt auf der andern Seite des Proszeniums herauf.) (Faust rises to view on the other side of the proscenium.)

Im Priesterkleid, bekranzt, ein Wundermann,

In priestly surplice, crowned, a marvellous man,

In priest-robes, crowned, a miracle-man

Der nun vollbringt, was er getrost begann.

He now fulfils what he in faith began.

Now completes what he confidently began

Ein Dreifuss steigt mit ihm aus hohler Gruft,

With him, a tripod from the gulf comes up:

A tripod rises with him from the hollow pit

Schon ahn' ich aus der Schale Weihrauchduft.

I scent the incense-odours from the cup.

I already sense incense-smell from the bowl

Er rustet sich, das hohe Werk zu segnen;

He arms himself, the work to consecrate,

He prepares to bless the high work

Es kann fortan nur Glückliches begegnen.

And henceforth it can be but fortunate.

Only good luck can happen from here

Faust (*erhaben*)

In eurem Namen, Mutter, die ihr thront

Ye Mothers, in your name, who set your throne

In your name, Mothers, enthroned

Im Grenzenlosen, ewig einsam wohnt,

In boundless Space, eternally alone,

In the Boundless, eternally dwelling alone

Und doch gesellig. Euer Haupt umschweben

And yet companioned! All the forms of Being,

Yet companioned! Around your heads hover

Des Lebens Bilder, regsam, ohne Leben.

In movement, lifeless, ye are round you seeing.

Life's images, active, yet lifeless

Was einmal war, in allem Glanz und Schein,

Whate'er once was, there burns and brightens free

What once was, in all its shine and gleam

Es regt sich dort; denn es will ewig sein.

In splendour – for 'twould fain eternal be;

Stirs there still - it wants to be forever

Und ihr verteilt es, allgewaltige Mächte,

And ye allot it, with all-potent might,

And you distribute it, all-powerful forces

Zum Zelt des Tages, zum Gewölbe der Nächte.

To Day's pavilions and the vaults of Night.

To the tent of Day, to the vault of Night

Die einen fasst des Lebens holder Lauf,

Life seizes some, along his gracious course;

Some get seized by life's lovely course

Die andern sucht der kühne Magier auf;

Others arrest the bold Magician's force;

Others the bold magician hunts down

In reicher Spende lässt er, voll Vertrauen,

And he, bestowing as his faith inspires,

In rich abundance he lets, full of trust

Was jeder wünscht, das Wunderwürdige schauen.

Displays the Marvellous, that each desires.

Each see what they wish - the wonder-worthy

Astrolog

Der glühende Schlüssel ruht die Schale kaum,

The glowing key has scarcely touched the cup,

The glowing key barely touches the bowl

Ein dunstiger Nebel deckt sogleich den Raum;

And lo! through all the space, a mist rolls up:

A hazy mist covers the space at once

Er schleicht sich ein, er wogt nach Wolkenart,

It creeps about, and like a cloudy train,

It sneaks in, swells cloud-like

Gedehnt, geballt, verschränkt, geteilt, gepaart.

Spreads, rounding, narrowing, parting, closed again.

Stretched, balled, interlaced, split, paired

Und nun erkennt ein Geister-Meisterstück!

And now, behold a spirit-masterpiece!

And now recognize a ghost-masterpiece!

So wie sie wandeln, machen sie Musik.

Music is born from every wandering fleece.

As they wander, they make music

Aus luft'gen Tönen quillt ein Weissnichtwie,

The tones of air, I know not how they flow;

From airy tones pours an I-don't-know-what

Indem sie ziehn, wird alles Melodie.

Where'er they move all things melodious grow.

Where they move, everything turns melody

Der Saulenschaft, auch die Triglyphe klingt,

The pillared shaft, the triglyph even rings:

The column-shaft, even the triglyph rings

Ich glaube gar, der ganze Tempel singt.

I think, indeed, the whole bright temple sings.

I believe the whole temple is singing

Das Dunstige senkt sich; aus dem leichten Flor

The vapours settle; as the light film clears,

The mist sinks down; from the light gauze

Ein schöner Jungling tritt im Takt hervor.

A beauteous youth, with rhythmic step, appears.

A beautiful young man steps out in rhythm

Hier schweigt mein Amt, ich brauch' ihn nicht zu nennen,

Here ends my task; his name I need not tell:

Here my task ends - I don't need to name him

Wer sollte nicht den holden Paris kennen!

Who doth not know the gentle Paris well?

Who wouldn't know lovely Paris!

Dame

O! welch ein Glanz aufbluhender Jugendkraft!

O, what a youthful bloom and strength I see!

Oh! What a radiance of blooming youth-power!

Zweite

Wie eine Pfirsche frisch und voller Saft!

Fresh as a peach, and full of juice, is he!

Like a peach, fresh and full of juice!

Dritte

Die fein gezogen, süss geschwollnen Lippen!

The finely drawn, the sweetly swelling lip!

Those finely drawn, sweetly swollen lips!

Vierte

Du mochtest wohl an solchem Becher nippen?

From such a cup, no doubt, you'd like to sip?

You'd probably like to sip from that cup?

Funfte

Er ist gar hübsch, wenn auch nicht eben fein.

He's handsome, if a little unrefined.

He's quite handsome, though not exactly refined

Sechste

Ein bisschen konnt' er doch gewandter sein.

He might be somewhat gracefuller, to my mind.

He could be a bit more graceful, frankly

Ritter

Den Schaferknecht glaub' ich allhier zu spüren,

The shepherd I detect; I find him wearing

I detect the shepherd-boy in there

Vom Prinzen nichts und nichts von Hofmanieren.

No traces of the Prince, or courtly bearing.

Nothing of the Prince, nothing of court manners

Andrer

Eh nun! halb nackt ist wohl der Junge schon,

O, yes! half-naked is the youth not bad;

Well now! Half-naked the lad's not bad

Doch mussten wir ihn erst im Harnisch sehn!

But let us see him first in armour clad!

But we'd need to see him in armor first!

Dame

Er setzt sich nieder, weichlich, angenehm.

He seats himself, with such a gentle grace!

He sits down, soft and pleasant

Ritter

Auf seinem Schosse war' Euch wohl bequem?

You'd find his lap, perchance, a pleasant place?

You'd probably be comfy on his lap?

Andre

Er lehnt den Arm so zierlich ubers Haupt.

He lifts his arm so lightly o'er his head.

He drapes his arm so prettily over his head

Kammerer

Die Flegelei! Das find' ich unerlaubt!

'Tis not allowed: how thoroughly ill-bred!

Such boorishness! I find that impermissible!

Dame

Ihr Herren wisst an allem was zu makeln.

You lords find fault with all things evermore.

You lords find something to nitpick in everything

Derselbe

In Kaisers Gegenwart sich hinzurakeln!

To stretch and yawn before the Emperor!

Sprawling around in the Emperor's presence!

Dame

Er stellt's nur vor! Er glaubt sich ganz allein.

He only acts: he thinks he's quite alone.

He's just acting! He thinks he's alone

Derselbe

Das Schauspiel selbst, hier sollt' es hoflich sein.

Even the play should be politely shown.

Even a play should be polite here

Dame

Sanft hat der Schlaf den Holden ubernommen.

Now sleep falls on the graceful youth so sweetly.

Sleep has gently taken the lovely one

Derselbe

Er schnarcht nun gleich; natürlich ist's, vollkommen!

Now will he snore: 'tis natural, completely!

Now he'll snore - that's natural, perfect!

Junge Dame

Zum Weihrauchsdampf was duftet so gemischt,

Mixed with the incense-steam, what odour precious

Mixed with incense-steam, what fragrance is this

Das mir das Herz zum innigsten erfrischt?

Steals to my bosom, and my heart refreshes?

That refreshes my heart to its core?

Altere

Furwahr! Es dringt ein Hauch tief ins Gemute,

Forsooth, it penetrates and warms the feeling!

Truly! A breath penetrates deep into feeling

Er kommt von ihm! –

It comes from him.

It comes from him!

Alteste

Es ist des Wachstums Blute,

His flower of youth, unsealing,

Prepared in the youth as ambrosia

Im Jungling als Ambrosia bereitet

It is: Youth's fine ambrosia, ripe, unfading,

And spread atmospherically all around

Und atmosphärisch ringsumher verbreitet.

The atmosphere around his form pervading.

So that's her! From this one I'd have peace

(Helena hervortretend.) (Helena comes forward.)

Mephistopheles

Das war' sie denn! Vor dieser hatt' ich Ruh';

So, that is she! My sleep she would not waste:

She's pretty enough, but she's not my type

Hubsch ist sie wohl, doch sagt sie mir nicht zu.

She's pretty, truly, but she's not my taste.

Nothing more for me to do this time

Astrolog

Für mich ist diesmal weiter nichts zu tun,

There's nothing more for me to do, I trow;

As an honest man I confess it now

Als Ehrenmann gesteh', bekenne' ich's nun.

As man of honour, I confess it now.

The Beauty comes, and if I had tongues of fire!

Die Schöne kommt, und hatt' ich Feuerzungen! –

The Beauty comes, and had I tongues of fire, –

About beauty so much has always been sung

Von Schönheit ward von jeher viel gesungen –

So many songs did Beauty e'er inspire, –

Whoever she appears to loses himself

Wem sie erscheint, wird aus sich selbst entrückt,

Who sees her, of his wits is dispossessed,

Whoever possessed her was blessed beyond measure

Wem sie gehörte, ward zu hoch beglückt.

And who possessed her was too highly blessed.

Do I still have eyes? Does the fountain of Beauty

Faust

Hab' ich noch Augen? Zeigt sich tief im Sinn

Have I still eyes? Deep in my being springs

Pour itself most richly deep in my soul?

Der Schönheit Quelle reichlichstens ergossen?

The fount of Beauty, in a torrent pouring!

My terror-journey brings the most blessed gain

Mein Schreckensgang bringt seligsten Gewinn.

A heavenly gain my path of terror brings.

How void the world was to me, how locked!

Wie war die Welt mir nichtig, unerschlossen!

The world was void, and shut to my exploring, –

What is it now since my priesthood?

Was ist sie nun seit meiner Priesterschaft?

And, since my priesthood, how hath it been graced!

Finally desirable, grounded, lasting!

Erst wünschenswert, gegründet, dauerhaft!

Enduring 'tis, desirable, firm-based.

Let the breath of my life vanish

Verschwinde mir des Lebens Atemkraft,

And let my breath of being blow to waste,

If I ever unwean myself from you!

Wenn ich mich je von dir zurückgewohne! –

If I for thee unlearn my sacred duty!

The fair form that once enchanted me

Die Wohlgestalt, die mich voreinst entzuckte,

The form, that long erewhile my fancy captured,

Made me happy in magic mirror-reflection

In Zauberspiegelung beglückte,

That from the magic mirror so enraptured,

Was just a foam-image of such beauty!

War nur ein Schaumbild solcher Schöne! –

Was but a frothy phantom of such beauty!

You're the one to whom I owe the stirring of all power

Du bist's, der ich die Regung aller Kraft,

'Tis Thou, to whom the stir of all my forces,

The essence of all passion

Den Inbegriff der Leidenschaft,

The essence of my passion's courses, –

Devotion, love, worship, madness - I pay it all to you

Dir Neigung, Lieb', Anbetung, Wahnsinn zolle.

Love, fancy, worship, madness, – here I render!

Get a grip on yourself and don't break character!

Mephistopheles (*aus dem Kasten*)

So fasst Euch doch und fallt nicht aus der Rolle!

Be calm! – you lose your role, to be so tender!

Tall, well-shaped, only the head too small

Altere Dame

Gross, wohlgestaltet, nur der Kopf zu klein.

Tall and well-formed! Too small the head, alone.

Just look at that foot! How could it be clunkier!

Jüngere

Seht nur den Fuss! Wie konnt' er plumper sein!

Just see her foot! A heavier ne'er was shown.

I've seen princesses of this type

Diplomat

Fürstinnen hab' ich dieser Art gesehn,

Princesses of her style I've often seen:

Seems to me she's beautiful head to toe

Mich deucht, sie ist vom Kopf zum Fusse schon.

From head to foot she's beautiful, I ween.

She sneaks toward the sleeper, craftily gentle

Hofmann

Sie nahert sich dem Schlafer listig mild.

She near the sleeper steals, so soft and sly.

How ugly next to that pure youthful image!

Dame

Wie hasslich neben jugendreinem Bild!

How ugly, near that youthful purity!

Her beauty beams down on him like light

Poet

Von ihrer Schönheit ist er angestrahlt.

Her beauty's light is on him like a dawn.

Endymion and Luna! Like a painting!

Dame

Endymion und Luna! wie gemalt!

Endymion and Luna – as they're drawn!

Exactly right! The goddess seems to sink down

Poet

Ganz recht! Die Gottin scheint herabzusinken,

Quite right! The yielding goddess seems to sink,

She bends over to drink his breath

Sie neigt sich über, seinen Hauch zu trinken;

And o'er him bend, his balmy breath to drink.

Enviably! A kiss! The measure is full

Beneidenswert! – Ein Kuss! – Das Mass ist voll.

Enviably fate – a kiss! – the cup is full!

In front of everyone! That's really too wild!

Duenna

Vor allen Leuten! Das ist doch zu toll!

Before all people! – that is more than cool.

Monstrous favor to the boy!

Faust

Furchtbare Gunst dem Knaben! –

A fearful favour to the boy!

Quiet! Still!

Mephistopheles

Ruhig! still!

Be still!

Let the ghost do whatever it wants

Lass das Gespenst doch machen was es will.

Suffer the shade to do whate'er it will!

She sneaks away, light-footed; he wakes

Hofmann

Sie schleicht sich weg, leichtfüssig; er erwacht.

She slips away, light-footed: he awakes.

She looks around! I knew she would

Dame

Sie sieht sich um! Das hab' ich wohl gedacht.

Just as I thought! Another look she takes.

He's amazed! What's happening to him is a wonder

Hofmann

Er staunt! Ein Wunder ist's, was ihm geschieht.

He stares: what haps, to him a marvel is.

To her it's no wonder what she sees before her

Dame

Ihr ist kein Wunder, was sie vor sich sieht.

But none to her, what she before her sees!

With poise she turns around to him

Hofmann

Mit Anstand kehrt sie sich zu ihm herum.

She turns around to him with dignity.

I can see she's taking him to school

Dame

Ich merke schon, sie nimmt ihn in die Lehre;

I see, she means to put him through his paces:

In such cases all men are stupid

In solchem Fall sind alle Manner dumm,

All men, in such a case, act stupidly.

He probably thinks he's the first one too

Er glaubt wohl auch, dass er der erste ware.

Then, too, he thinks that first he's won her graces.

Let me appreciate her! Majestically fine!

Ritter

Lasst mir sie gelten! Majestatisch fein! –

Majestically fine! – She pleases me.

The slut! Now that's what I call common!

Dame

Die Buhlerin! Das nenn' ich doch gemein!

The courtesan! How very vulgar she!

I'd sure like to be in his place!

Page

Ich mochte wohl an seiner Stelle sein!

Just where he is, is where I'd like to be!

Who wouldn't get caught in such a net?

Hofmann

Wer wurde nicht in solchem Netz gefangen?

Who would not fain be caught in such sweet meshes?

That jewel has passed through many hands

Dame

Das Kleinod ist durch manche Hand gegangen,

Through many a hand hath passed that jewel precious;

The gilding's pretty much worn off too

Auch die Verguldung ziemlich abgebraucht.

The gilding, too, is for the most part gone.

Since age ten she's been worthless

Andre

Vom zehnten Jahr an hat sie nichts getaugt.

She has been worthless from her tenth year on.

Sometimes you just take the best you can get

Ritter

Gelegentlich nimmt jeder sich das Beste;

Each takes the best that chance for him obtains;

I'd hold on to these beautiful remains

Ich hielte mich an diese schonen Reste.

I'd be contented with these fair remains.

I see her clearly, but freely confess

Gelahrter

Ich seh' sie deutlich, doch gesteh' ich frei:

I freely own, though I distinctly see,

It's doubtful if she's the real one

Zu zweifeln ist, ob sie die rechte sei.

'Tis doubtful if the genuine one she be.

The Present seduces us to exaggeration

Die Gegenwart verführt ins übertriebne,

The Present leads us to exaggeration,

Above all I stick to what's written

Ich halte mich vor allem ans Geschriebne.

And I hold fast the written, old relation.

There I read that she really pleased

Da les' ich denn, sie habe wirklich allen

I read that, truly, ere her bloom was blighted,

All the gray-beards of Troy particularly

Graubarten Trojas sonderlich gefallen;

The Trojan gray-beards greatly she delighted.

And as I see it, that fits perfectly here

Und wie mich dunkt, vollkommen passt das hier:

And here, methinks, it tallies perfectly:

I'm not young, and yet she pleases me

Ich bin nicht jung, und doch gefällt sie mir.

I am not young, yet she delighteth me.

No longer boy! A bold hero-man

Astrolog

Nicht Knabe mehr! Ein kuhner Heldenmann,

No more a boy! A bold, heroic form,

He embraces her, she can barely resist

Umfasst er sie, die kaum sich wehren kann.

He clasps her, who can scarce resist the storm.

With strengthened arm he lifts her high

Gestärkten Arms hebt er sie hoch empor,

With arm grown strong he lifts her high and free:

Is he going to abduct her?

Entfuhrte er sie wohl gar? –

Means he to bear her off?

Reckless fool!

Faust

Verwegener Tor!

Rash fool, let be!

You dare! You don't hear! Stop! This is too much!

Du wagst! Du horst nicht! halt! das ist zu viel!

Thou dar'st? Thou hear'st not? Hold! – I'll be obeyed.

You're creating this farce-ghost-play yourself!

Mephistopheles

Machst du's doch selbst, das Fratzengeisterspiel!

The spectral drama thou thyself hast made!

Just one word more! After all that happened

Astrolog

Nur noch ein Wort! Nach allem, was geschah,

A word more! After all we've seen to-day,

I name this piece: The Rape of Helena

Nenn' ich das Stuck den Raub der Helena.

I call the piece: The Rape of Helena.

What rape! Am I here for nothing!

Faust

Was Raub! Bin ich fur nichts an dieser Stelle!

What! Rape? Am I for nothing here? To stead me,

Is this key not in my hand!

Ist dieser Schlusel nicht in meiner Hand!

Is not this key still shining in my hand?

It led me through horror and surge and wave

Er fuhrte mich, durch Graus und Wog' und Welle

Through realms of terror, wastes, and waves it led me,

Through solitudes, here to solid ground

Der Einsamkeiten, her zum festen Strand.

Through solitudes, to where I firmly stand.

Here I plant my foot! Here are realities

Hier fass' ich Fuss! Hier sind es Wirklichkeiten,

Here foothold is! Realities here centre!

From here the spirit may battle with spirits

Von hier aus darf der Geist mit Geistern streiten,

The strife with spirits here the mind may venture,

Prepare the great double-kingdom for itself

Das Doppelreich, das grosse, sich bereiten.

And on its grand, its double lordship enter!

So far she was - how can she be nearer!

So fern sie war, wie kann sie naher sein!

How far she was, and nearer, how divine!

I'll save her, and she'll be doubly mine

Ich rette sie, und sie ist doppelt mein.

I'll rescue her, and make her doubly mine.

Dared! You Mothers! Mothers! Grant it!

Gewagt! Ihr Mutter! Mutter! musst's gewahren!

Ye Mothers! Mothers! crown this wild endeavour!

Who has known her may not be without her

Wer sie erkannt, der darf sie nicht entbehren.

Who knows her once must hold her, and for ever!

What are you doing, Faust! Faust! With violence

Astrolog

Was tust du, Fauste! Fauste! – Mit Gewalt

What art thou doing, Faust? O, look at him!

He grabs her - already the form grows dark

Fasst er sie an, schon trübt sich die Gestalt.

He seizes her: the form is growing dim.

He turns the key toward the youth

Den Schlüssel kehrt er nach dem Jungling zu,

He turns the key against the youth, and, lo!

Touches him! Woe to us, woe! Now! This instant!

Berührt ihn! – Weh uns, Wehe! Nu! im Nu!

It touches him – Woe’s me! Away now! Woe on woe!

There you have it! Burdening yourself with fools

(Explosion. Faust liegt am Boden. Die Geister gehen in Dunst auf.) (Explosion. Faust lies upon the earth. The Spirits dissolve in vapour.)

Mephistopheles *(der Fausten auf die Schulter nimmt)*

Da habt ihr’s nun! mit Narren sich beladen,

You have it now! One’s self with fools to hamper,

Eventually hurts even the Devil himself

Das kommt zuletzt dem Teufel selbst zu Schaden.

At last even on the Devil puts a damper.

(Finsternis, Tumult.) (Darkness. Tumult.)

Zweiter Akt / Act II

Hochgewolbtes enges gotisches Zimmer / A High-Arched, Narrow Gothic Chamber

Mephistopheles

Hier lieg, Unseliger! verführt Lie there, ill-starred! seduced, unwise,

Lie there, wretched one! seduced

Zu schwergelostem Liebesbande! To bonds that surely hold the lover!

Into love-knots hard to undo!

Wen Helena paralysiert, Whom Helena shall paralyze

Whoever Helena paralyzes

Der kommt so leicht nicht zu Verstande. Not soon his reason will recover.

Won’t get their head on straight for a while.

Blick’ ich hinauf, hierher, hinüber, I look about, and through the glimmer

I look up, over here, over there,

Allunverändert ist es, unversehrt; *Unchanged, uninjured, all appears:*

Everything's the same, nothing's touched;

Die bunten Scheiben sind, so dunkelt mich, trüber, *The coloured window-panes, methinks, are dimmer,*

The stained glass looks dingier to me,

Die Spinnewebe haben sich vermehrt; *The cobwebs have increased with years.*

The spiderwebs have multiplied.

Die Tinte starrt, vergilbt ist das Papier; *The ink is dry, the paper old and brown,*

The ink's congealed, the paper's yellowed;

Doch alles ist am Platz geblieben; *But each thing in its place I find:*

But everything's right where it was;

Sogar die Feder liegt noch hier, *Even the quill is here laid down,*

Even the pen's still lying here,

Mit welcher Faust dem Teufel sich verschrieben. *Wherewith his compact with the Devil he signed.*

The one Faust used to sign himself over to the Devil.

Ja! tiefer in dem Rohre stockt *Yea, deeper in, the barrel's red*

Yes! Deeper in the barrel there's dried

Ein Tropflein Blut, wie ich's ihm abgelockt. *With trace of blood I coaxed him then to shed.*

A drop of blood I coaxed out of him.

Zu einem solchen einzigen Stuck *A thing so totally unique*

For such a singular collector's item

Wünscht' ich dem grossten Sammler Glück. *The great collectors would go far to seek.*

I'd wish the greatest collector good luck.

Auch hangt der alte Pelz am alten Haken, *Half from its hook the old fur-robe is falling,*

The old fur coat still hangs on the old hook,

Erinnert mich an jene Schnaken, *That ancient joke of mine recalling,*

Reminding me of that joke I pulled,

Wie ich den Knaben einst belehrt, *How once I taught the boy such truth*

How I once schooled the boy

Woran er noch vielleicht als Jungling zehrt. *As still, it may be, nourishes the youth.*

On stuff he's probably still chewing on as a young man.

Es kommt mir wahrlich das Gelusten, *The wish returns, with zest acuter,*

I'm really getting the urge

Rauchwarme Hulle, dir vereint *Aided by thee, thou rough disguise,*

With your help, smoky pelt,

Mich als Dozent noch einmal zu erbrusten, *Once more to take on airs as college tutor,*

To puff myself up as a lecturer again,

Wie man so vollig recht zu haben meint. *As one infallible in one's own eyes.*

Like someone who thinks he's totally right.

Gelehrte wissen's zu erlangen, *The savants this assurance know:*

Scholars know how to pull that off;

Dem Teufel ist es längst vergangen. *The Devil lost it, long ago!*

The Devil lost the knack long ago.

Chor der Insekten / Chorus of Insects

Willkommen! willkommen, *Welcome, and hail to thee!*

Welcome! Welcome!

Du alter Patron! *Patron, to-day:*

You old patron!

Wir schweben und summen *We're flying and humming,*

We're hovering and humming

Und kennen dich schon. *We hear and obey.*

And we already know you.

Nur einzeln im stillen *Singly and silently*

Only singly in silence

Du hast uns gepflanzt; *Us thou hast sown;*

You planted us;

Zu Tausenden kommen wir, *Hither, by thousands,*

By the thousands we come,

Vater, getanzt. *Father, we've flown.*

Father, dancing!

Der Schalk in dem Busen *The imp in the bosom*

The imp in the bosom

Verbirgt sich so sehr, *Is snugly concealed;*

Hides itself so well,

Vom Pelze die Lauschen *But lice in the fur-coat*

But the lice in the fur coat

Enthullen sich eh'r. *Are sooner revealed.*

Reveal themselves sooner.

Mephistopheles

Ich schuttle noch einmal den alten Flaus, *Once more I'll shake the ancient fleeces out:*

I shake the old fleece once more,

Noch eines flattert hier und dort hinaus. – *Still here and there a chance one flies about.* –

Still one flutters here and there. –

Hinauf! umher! in hunderttausend Ecken *Off, and around! in hundred thousand nooks*

Up! Around! Into a hundred thousand corners

Eilt euch, ihr Liebchen, zu verstecken. *Hasten to hide yourselves—among the books,*

Hurry, my darlings, to hide yourselves.

Dort, wo die alten Schachteln stehn, *There, in the pasteboard's wormy holes,*

There, where the old boxes stand,

Hier im bebraunten Pergamen, *Here, in the smoky parchment scrolls,*

Here in the browned parchment,

In staubigen Scherben alter Topfe, *In dusty jars, that broken lie,*

In dusty shards of old pots,

Dem Hohlaug' jener Totenkopfe. *And yonder skull with empty eye.*

In the hollow eye of that skull.

In solchem Wust und Moderleben *In all this trash and mould unmatched,*

In such muck and moldy life

Muss es fur ewig Grillen geben. *Crotchets for ever must be hatched.*

There must forever be crickets.

Komm, decke mir die Schultern noch einmal! *Come, once again upon my shoulders fall!*

Come, cover my shoulders once more!

Heut bin ich wieder Prinzipal. *Once more am I the Principal.*

Today I'm the Principal again.

Doch hilft es nichts, mich so zu nennen; *But 'tis no good to ape the college;*

But it doesn't help to call myself that;

Wo sind die Leute, die mich anerkennen? *For where are those who will my claim acknowledge?*
Where are the people who'll acknowledge me?

Famulus

Welch ein Tönen! welch ein Schauer! *What a sound! What dreadful quaking!*

What a sound! What a shudder!

Treppe schwankt, es bebt die Mauer; *Stairs are rocking, walls are shaking;*

Stairs sway, walls tremble;

Durch der Fenster buntes Zittern *Through the coloured windows brightening*

Through the colored windows' quivering

Seh' ich wetterleuchtend Wittern. *I behold the sudden lightning;*

I see lightning weather-flashing.

Springt das Estrich, und von oben *Floors above me crack and rumble,*

The floor splits, and from above

Rieselst Kalk und Schutt verschoben. *Lime and lumber round me tumble,*

Lime and rubble come raining down.

Und die Türe, fest verriegelt, *And the door, securely bolted,*

And the door, firmly bolted,

Ist durch Wunderkraft entsiegelt. – *Is by magic force unfolded.* –

Is unsealed by miraculous force. –

Dort! Wie furchterlich! Ein Riese *There! How terrible! a Giant*

There! How terrifying! A Giant

Steht in Faustens altem Vliese! *Stands in Faust's old fur, defiant!*

Stands in Faust's old fleece!

Seinen Blicken, seinem Winken *As he looks, and beckons thither,*

From his stares, from his beckoning

Mocht' ich in die Kniee sinken. *I could fall, my senses wither.*

I could sink to my knees.

Soll ich fliehen? Soll ich stehn? *Shall I fly, or shall I wait?*

Should I flee? Should I stay?

Ach, wie wird es mir ergehn! *What, O what shall be my fate!*

Oh, what will become of me!

Mephistopheles

Heran, mein Freund! – Ihr heisset Nikodemus. *Come hither, Friend! Your name is Nicodemus.*

Come here, my friend! – You’re called Nicodemus.

Famulus

Hochwürdiger Herr! so ist mein Nam’ – Oremus. *Most honoured Sir, such is my name–Oremus!*

Most reverend Sir! That’s my name – Oremus.

Mephistopheles

Das lassen wir! – *Dispense with that!*

Let’s skip that! –

Famulus

Wie froh, dass Ihr mich kennt! *O joy! you know me yet.*

How glad that you know me!

Mephistopheles

Ich weiss es wohl, bejahrt und noch Student, *Old, and a student still,–I don’t forget,*

I know well, aged and still a student,

Bemooster Herr! Auch ein gelehrter Mann *Most mossy Sir! Also a learned man*

Most mossy Sir! Also a learned man

Studiert so fort, weil er nicht anders kann. *Continues study, since naught else he can.*

Continues studying because he can’t do otherwise.

So baut man sich ein massig Kartenhaus, *’Tis thus one builds a moderate house of cards;*

That’s how you build a modest house of cards,

Der grosste Geist baut’s doch nicht völlig aus. *The greatest minds ne’er end them, afterwards.*

The greatest mind never quite finishes it.

Doch Euer Meister, das ist ein Beschlagner: *Your master is a skilful fellow, though:*

But your master, now that’s a sharp one:

Wer kennt ihn nicht, den edlen Doktor Wagner, *The noble Doctor Wagner all must know.*

Who doesn’t know him, the noble Doctor Wagner,

Den Ersten jetzt in der gelehrten Welt! *The first in all the learned world is he,*

The first now in the learned world!

Er ist’s allein, der sie zusammenhält, *Who now together holds it potently,*

He alone holds it together,

Der Weisheit taglicher Vermehrer. *Wisdom increasing, daily making clearer.*

Daily multiplier of wisdom.

Allwissbegierige Horcher, Horer *How thirst for knowledge listener and hearer!*

All-knowledge-hungry listeners, hearers

Versammeln sich um ihn zuhauf. *A mighty crowd around him flocks.*

Gather around him in heaps.

Er leuchtet einzig vom Katheder; *None for the rostrum e'er were meeter:*

He alone shines from the lectern;

Die Schlüssel ubt er wie Sankt Peter, *The keys he holds as doth Saint Peter,*

He wields the keys like Saint Peter,

Das Untre so das Obre schliesst er auf. *The Under and the Upper he unlocks.*

Unlocks the below as well as the above.

Wie er vor allen gluht und funkelt, *His light above all others sparkles surer,*

How he glows and sparkles before all,

Kein Ruf, kein Ruhm halt weiter stand; *No name or fame beside him lives:*

No reputation, no fame stands up to him;

Selbst Faustus' Name wird verdunkelt, *Even that of Faust has grown obscurer;*

Even Faust's name is eclipsed,

Er ist es, der allein erfand. *'Tis he alone invents and gives.*

He's the one who invented everything.

Famulus

Verzeiht, hochwürdiger Herr! wenn ich Euch sage, *Pardon, most honoured Sir! if I am daring*

Forgive me, reverend Sir, if I tell you,

Wenn ich zu widersprechen wage: *To contradict you, in declaring*

If I dare to contradict:

Von allem dem ist nicht die Frage; *All that upon the subject has no bearing;*

That's not what it's about at all;

Bescheidenheit ist sein beschieden Teil. *For modesty is his allotted part.*

Modesty is his allotted share.

Ins unbegreifliche Verschwinden *The incomprehensible disappearing*

He can't come to terms with

Des hohen Manns weiss er sich nicht zu finden; *Of that great man to him is most uncheering;*

The incomprehensible disappearance of the great man;

Von dessen Wiederkunft erfleht er Trost und Heil. *From his return he hopes new strength and joy of heart.*

He begs for comfort and salvation from his return.

Das Zimmer, wie zu Doktor Faustus' Tagen, *As in the days of Doctor Faust, the room,*

This room, as in Doctor Faust's days,

Noch unberührt seitdem er fern, *Since he's away, all things unchanged,*

Untouched since he's been gone,

Erwartet seinen alten Herrn. *Waits for its master, long estranged.*

Awaits its old master.

Kaum wag' ich's, mich hereinzuwagen. *To venture in, I scarce presume.*

I hardly dare venture in.

Was muss die Sternenstunde sein? – *What stars must govern now the skies!*

What stellar hour must this be? –

Gemauer scheint mir zu erbangen; *It seemed as if the basements quivered;*

The masonry seems to me to shudder;

Turpfosten bebten, Riegel sprangen, *The doorposts trembled, bolts were shivered:*

Doorposts trembled, bolts sprang,

Sonst kamt Ihr selber nicht herein. *You had not entered, otherwise.*

Otherwise you wouldn't have gotten in yourself.

Mephistopheles

Wo hat der Mann sich hingetan? *Where may his present dwelling be?*

Where has the man taken himself off to?

Führt mich zu ihm, bringt ihn heran! *Lead me to him! Bring him to me!*

Lead me to him, bring him here!

Famulus

Ach! sein Verbot ist gar zu scharf, *His prohibition is so keen!*

Oh! His prohibition is far too strict,

Ich weiss nicht, ob ich's wagen darf. *I do not dare to intervene.*

I don't know if I dare.

Monatelang, des grossen Werkes willen, *For months, his time unto the great work giving,*
For months, for the sake of the great work,

Lebt' er im allerstillsten Stillen. *In most secluded silence he is living.*

He's been living in the most silent silence.

Der zarteste gelehrter Manner, *The daintiest of distinguished learners,*

The daintiest of learned men,

Er sieht aus wie ein Kohlenbrenner, *His face is like a charcoal-burner's,*

He looks like a charcoal burner,

Geschwarzt vom Ohre bis zur Nasen, *From nose to ears all black and deadened;*

Blackened from ear to nose,

Die Augen rot vom Feuerblasen, *His eyes from blowing flames are reddened:*

Eyes red from blowing the fire,

So lechzt er jedem Augenblick; *Thus he, each moment, pants and longs,*

Thus he gasps every moment;

Geklirr der Zange gibt Musik. *And music make the clattering tongs.*

The clanging of tongs makes his music.

Mephistopheles

Sollt' er den Zutritt mir verneinen? *An entrance why should he deny me?*

Should he deny me entry?

Ich bin der Mann, das Glück ihm zu beschleunen. *I'll expedite his luck, if he'll but try me!*

I'm the man to speed up his luck.

Kaum hab' ich Posto hier gefasst, *Scarce have I taken my position here,*

Scarcely have I taken my post here,

Regt sich dort hinten, mir bekannt, ein Gast. *When there, behind, I see a guest appear.*

When there in back, known to me, a guest stirs.

Doch diesmal ist er von den Neusten, *I know him; he is of the school new-founded,*

But this time he's one of the newest sort,

Er wird sich grenzenlos erdreusten. *And his presumption will be quite unbounded.*

He'll presume himself beyond all bounds.

Baccalaureus

Tor und Türe find' ich offen! *Doors and entrances are open!*

Gate and door I find open!

Nun, da lasst sich endlich hoffen, *Well, –at last there's ground for hoping*

Now at last there's hope

Dass nicht, wie bisher, im Moder *That no more, in mouldy lumber,*

That no longer, as before, in the mold

Der Lebendige wie ein Toter *Death-like, doth the Living slumber,*

The living like a dead man

Sich verkummere, sich verderbe *To himself privations giving,*

Withers and rots

Und am Leben selber sterbe. *Till he dies of very living!*

And dies of life itself.

Diese Mauern, diese Wände *All this masonry, I'm thinking,*

These walls, these partitions

Neigen, senken sich zum Ende, *To its overthrow is sinking;*

Lean, sink toward their end,

Und wenn wir nicht bald entweichen, *And, unless at once we hurry,*

And if we don't soon escape,

Wird uns Fall und Sturz erreichen. *Us will crash and ruin bury.*

Collapse and crash will catch us.

Bin verwegen, wie nicht einer, *Daring though I be, 'twere murder*

I'm bold as nobody else,

Aber weiter bringt mich keiner. *Should I dare to venture further.*

But nobody's taking me further.

Doch was soll ich heut erfahren! *What is that I see before me?*

But what shall I experience today!

War's nicht hier, vor so viel Jahren, *Here, (what years have since rolled o'er me!)*

Wasn't it here, so many years ago,

Wo ich, angstlich und beklommen, *Shy and unsophisticated,*

Where I, anxious and oppressed,

War als guter Fuchs gekommen? *I as honest freshman waited;*

Came as a good freshman?

Wo ich diesen Bartigen traute, *Here I let the gray-beards guide me,*

Where I trusted these bearded ones,

Mich an ihrem Schnack erbaute? *Here their babble edified me!*

Edified myself on their chatter?

Aus den alten Bucherkrusten *Out of dry old volumes preaching,*

From the old book-crusts

Logen sie mir, was sie wussten, *What they knew, they lied in teaching;*

They lied to me whatever they knew,

Was sie wussten, selbst nicht glaubten, *What they knew, themselves believed not,*

What they knew, themselves didn't believe,

Sich und mir das Leben raubten. *Stealing life, that years retrieved not.*

Robbed themselves and me of life.

Wie? – Dort hinten in der Zelle *What!–in yonder cell benighted*

What? – There in back in the cell

Sitzt noch einer dunkel-helle! *One still sits, obscurely lighted!*

One more sits, obscurely bright!

Nahend seh' ich's mit Erstaunen, *Nearer now, I see, astounded,*

Approaching, I see with amazement,

Sitzt er noch im Pelz, dem braunen, *Still he sits, with furs surrounded,–*

He still sits in the fur, the brown one,

Wahrlich, wie ich ihn verliess, *Truly, as I saw him last,*

Truly, as I left him,

Noch gehüllt im rauhen Vlies! *Roughest fleeces round him cast!*

Still wrapped in the rough fleece!

Damals schien er zwar gewandt, *Then adroit he seemed to be,*

Back then he seemed clever enough,

Als ich ihn noch nicht verstand. *Not yet understood by me:*

When I didn't yet understand him.

Heute wird es nichts fangen, *But to-day 'twill naught avail him–*

Today it won't amount to anything,

Frisch an ihn herangegangen! *O, I'll neither fear nor fail him!*

Fresh up to him!

Wenn, alter Herr, nicht Lethes trube Fluten *If, ancient Sir, that bald head, sideways bending,*

If, old sir, Lethe's murky floods

Das schiefgesenkte, kahle Haupt durchschwommen, *Hath not been dipped in Lethe's river cold,*

Haven't swum through that sideways-bent bald head,

Seht anerkennend hier den Schuler kommen, *See, hitherward, your grateful scholar wending,*

See the student come here with recognition,

Entwachsen akademischen Ruten. *Outgrown the academic rods of old.*

Outgrown the academic rods.

Ich find' Euch noch, wie ich Euch sah; *You're here, as then when I began;*

I find you still, as I saw you;

Ein anderer bin ich wieder da. *But I am now another man.*

A different one I am again here.

Mephistopheles

Mich freut, dass ich Euch hergelauret. *I'm glad my bell your visit brought me.*

I'm glad that I rang you here.

Ich schätzt' Euch damals nicht gering; *Your talents, then, I rated high;*

I didn't rate you poorly back then;

Die Raupe schon, die Chrysalide deutet *The worm, the chrysalid soon taught me*

The caterpillar, the chrysalis already suggested

Den künftigen bunten Schmetterling. *The future brilliant butterfly.*

The future colorful butterfly.

Am Lockenkopf und Spitzenkragen *Your curly locks and ruffle-laces*

In your curly head and lace collar

Empfandet Ihr ein kindliches Behagen. – *A childish pleasure gave; you wooed the graces.*

You felt a childish pleasure. –

Ihr trugt wohl niemals einen Zopf? – *A queue, I think, you've never worn?*

You probably never wore a queue? –

Heut schau' ich Euch im Schwedenkopf. *But now your head is cropped and shorn.*

Today I see you in a Swedish crop.

Ganz resolut und wacker seht Ihr aus; *Quite bold and resolute you appear,*

Quite resolute and brave you look;

Kommt nur nicht absolut nach Haus. *But don't go, absolute, home from here!*

Just don't come home absolute.

Baccalaureus

Und sparet doppelsinnige Worte; *Old master, in your old place leaning,*

Old sir, we are in the old places,

Wir passen nun ganz anders auf. *Think how the time has sped, the while!*

Consider how time has flown,

Ihr hanseltet den guten treuen Jungen; *Spare me your words of double meaning!*

And spare the double-meaning words;

Das ist Euch ohne Kunst gelungen, *We take them now in quite another style.*

We're paying attention quite differently now.

Was heutzutage niemand wagt. *You teased and vexed the honest youth;*

You jerked around the good trusting boy;

Mephistopheles

Wenn man der Jugend reine Wahrheit sagt, *You found it easy then, in truth,*

That worked for you effortlessly,

Die gelben Schnabeln keineswegs behagt, *If to the young the simple truth we say,*

What no one dares today.

Sie aber hinterdrein nach Jahren *The green ones find it nowise pleasant play;*

When one tells youth the pure truth,

Das alles derb an eigener Haut erfahren, *But afterwards, when years are over,*

It doesn't suit the yellow beaks at all,

Dann dunkeln sie, es kam' aus eigenem Schopf; *And they the truth through their own hide discover,*

But afterwards when years have passed

Da heisst es denn: der Meister war ein Tropf. *Then they conceive, themselves have found it out:*

They experience it all harshly on their own hide,

Baccalaureus

Ein Schelm vielleicht! – denn welcher Lehrer spricht *"The master was a fool!" one hears them shout.*

Then they think it came from their own head;

Die Wahrheit uns direkt ins Angesicht? *A rogue, perhaps! What teacher will declare*

Then it's called: the master was a fool.

Ein jeder weiss zu mehren wie zu mindern, *The truth to us, exactly fair and square?*

A rogue perhaps! – for what teacher speaks

Bald ernst, bald heiter klug zu frommen Kindern. *Each knows the way to lessen or exceed it,*

The truth directly to our face?

Mephistopheles

Zum Lernen gibt es freilich eine Zeit; *Now stern, now lively, as the children need it.*

Each one knows how to add and subtract,

Zum Lehren seid Ihr, merk' ich, selbst bereit. *Beyond a doubt, there is a time to learn;*

Now serious, now cheerfully clever to pious children.

Seit manchen Monden, einigen Sonnen *But you are skilled to teach, I now discern.*

For learning there's certainly a time;

Erfahrungsfulle habt Ihr wohl gewonnen. *Since many a moon, some circles of the sun,*

For teaching, I notice, you're already ready yourself.

Baccalaureus

Erfahrungswesen! Schaum und Dust! *The riches of experience you have won.*

In several moons, some suns

Und mit dem Geist nicht ebenbürtig. *Experience! mist and froth alone!*

You've surely won fullness of experience.

Gesteht! was man von je gewusst, *Nor with the mind at all coequal:*

Experience-stuff! Foam and mist!

Es ist durchaus nicht wissenswürdig. *Confess, what one has always known*

And not equal to the mind at all.

Mephistopheles

Mich deucht es langst. Ich war ein Tor, *Is not worth knowing, in the sequel!*

Admit! What one has always known,

Nun komm' ich mir recht schal und albern vor. *It's long seemed so to me. I was a fool:*

Is thoroughly not worth knowing.

Baccalaureus

Das freut mich sehr! Da hor' ich doch Verstand; *My shallowness I now must ridicule.*

I've thought so for a long time. I was a fool,

Der erste Greis, den ich vernunftig fand! *I'm glad of that! I hear some reason yet–*

Now I seem quite stale and stupid to myself.

Mephistopheles

Ich suchte nach verborgen-goldnem Schatze, *The first old man of sense I ever met!*

That pleases me very much! There I hear some sense;

Und schauerliche Kohlen trug ich fort. *I sought for hidden treasures, grand and golden,*

The first old man I found reasonable!

Baccalaureus

Gesteht nur, Euer Schadel, Eure Glatze *And hideous coals and ashes were my share.*

I searched for hidden golden treasure,

Ist nicht mehr wert als jene hohlen dort? *Confess that now your skull, though bald and olden,*

And shuddering coals I carried away.

Mephistopheles

Du weisst wohl nicht, mein Freund, wie grob du bist? *Is worth no more than is yon empty, there!*

Admit, your skull, your bald head

Baccalaureus

Im Deutschen lügt man, wenn man höflich ist. *Knowst thou, my friend, how rude thou art to me?*

Is worth no more than those hollow ones there?

Mephistopheles

Hier oben wird mir Licht und Luft benommen; *One lies, in German, would one courteous be.*

You probably don't know, my friend, how rude you are?

Ich finde wohl bei euch ein Unterkommen? *Up here am I deprived of light and air:*

In German one lies when one's polite.

Baccalaureus

Anmasslich find' ich, dass zur schlechtesten Frist *Shall I find shelter down among you there?*

Up here light and air are taken from me;

Man etwas sein will, wo man nichts mehr ist. *It is presumptuous, that one will try*

Will I find shelter with you down below?

Des Menschen Leben lebt im Blut, und wo *Still to be something, when the time's gone by.*

I find it presumptuous that at the worst time

Bewegt das Blut sich wie im Jungling so? *Man's life lives in his blood, and where, in sooth,*

One wants to be something when one is nothing more.

Das ist lebendig Blut in frischer Kraft, *So stirs the blood as in the veins of youth?*

Man's life lives in the blood, and where

Das neues Leben sich aus Leben schafft. *There living blood in freshest power pulsates,*

Does the blood move as in a young man?

Da regt sich alles, da wird was getan, *And newer life from its own life creates.*

That is living blood in fresh strength,

Das Schwache fällt, das Tuchtige tritt heran. *Then something's done, then moves and works the man,*

That creates new life from life.

Indessen wir die halbe Welt gewonnen, *The weak fall out, the sturdy take the van.*

There everything stirs, there something gets done,

Was habt Ihr denn getan? genickt, gesonnen, *While half the world beneath our yoke is brought,*

The weak falls, the capable steps forward.

Getraumt, erwogen, Plan und immer Plan. *What, then, have you accomplished? Nodded-thought-*

Meanwhile we've won half the world,

Gewiss! das Alter ist ein kaltes Fieber *Dreamed, and considered-plan, and always plan.*

What have you done? Nodded, pondered,

Im Frost von grillenhafter Not. *Age is an ague-fever, it is clear,*

Dreamed, weighed, plan and always plan.

Hat einer dreissig Jahr voruber, *With chills of moody want and dreary.*

Certainly! Old age is a cold fever

So ist er schon so gut wie tot. *When one has passed his thirtieth year*

In the frost of whimsical misery.

Am besten war's, euch zeitig totzuschlagen. *One then is just the same as dead.*

Once someone's past thirty,

Mephistopheles

Der Teufel hat hier weiter nichts zu sagen. *'Twere best, betimes, to put you out o' the way.*

He's already as good as dead.

Baccalaureus

Wenn ich nicht will, so darf kein Teufel sein. *The Devil, here, has nothing more to say.*

Best would be to kill you off in time.

Mephistopheles

Der Teufel stellt dir nachstens doch ein Bein. *Save through my will, no Devil can there be.*

The Devil has nothing more to say here.

Baccalaureus

Dies ist der Jugend edelster Beruf! *The Devil, though, will trip thee presently!*

If I don't will it, no Devil may exist.

Die Welt, sie war nicht, eh' ich sie erschuf; *This is Youth's noblest calling and most fit!*

The Devil will trip you up soon enough.

Die Sonne fuhr' ich aus dem Meer herauf; *The world was not, ere I created it;*

This is youth's noblest calling!

Mit mir begann der Mond des Wechsels Lauf; *The sun I drew from out the orient sea;*

The world, it wasn't there before I created it;

Da schmuckte sich der Tag auf meinen Wegen, *The moon began her changeful course with me,*

The sun I led up from the sea;

Die Erde grunte, bluhete mir entgegen. *The Day put on his shining robes, to greet me;*

With me the moon began its changing course;

Auf meinen Wink, in jener ersten Nacht, *The Earth grew green, and burst in flower to meet me,*

Then day adorned itself on my paths,

Entfaltete sich aller Sterne Pracht. *And when I beckoned, from the primal night*

The earth grew green, bloomed toward me.

Wer, ausser mir, entband euch aller Schranken *The stars unveiled their splendours to my sight.*

At my signal, in that first night,

Philisterhaft einklemmender Gedanken? *Who, save myself, to you deliverance brought*

All the stars' splendor unfolded.

Ich aber frei, wie mir's im Geiste spricht, *From commonplaces of restricted thought?*

Who, besides me, freed you from all barriers

Verfolge froh mein innerliches Licht, *I, proud and free, even as dictates my mind,*

Of philistinely confining thoughts?

Und wandle rasch, im eigensten Entzucken, *Follow with joy the inward light I find,*

But I, free, as my spirit speaks to me,

Das Helle vor mir, Finsternis im Rücken. *And speed along, in mine own ecstasy,*

Follow joyfully my inner light,

Mephistopheles

Original, fahr hin in deiner Pracht! – *Darkness behind, the Glory leading me!*

And walk swiftly, in my own rapture,

Wie wurde dich die Einsicht kranken: *Go hence, magnificent Original!*–

Brightness before me, darkness at my back.

Wer kann was Dummes, wer was Kluges denken, *What grief on thee would insight cast!*

Original, go forth in your splendor! –

Das nicht die Vorwelt schon gedacht? – *Who can think wise or stupid things at all,*

How the insight would pain you:

Doch sind wir auch mit diesem nicht gefährdet, *That were not thought already in the Past?*

Who can think anything stupid, anything clever,

In wenig Jahren wird es anders sein: *Yet even from him we're not in special peril;*

That the past hasn't already thought? –

Wenn sich der Most auch ganz absurd gebardet, *He will, ere long, to other thoughts incline:*

But with this one we're also not endangered,

Es gibt zuletzt doch noch e' Wein. *The must may foam absurdly in the barrel,*

In a few years it will be different:

Bedenkt: der Teufel, der ist alt, *Nathless it turns at last to wine.*

When the must behaves quite absurdly,

So werdet alt, ihn zu verstehen! *Consider now, the Devil's old;*

It still ends up as wine.

To understand him, be old also!

Laboratorium / Laboratory

Wagner (*am Herde / at the furnace*)

Die Glocke tont, die furchterliche, *The loud bell chimes with fearful clangour,*

Scary bell!

Durchschauert die berussten Mauern. *The sooty walls feel the vibration;*

Walls shudder!

Nicht langer kann das Ungewisse *Soon must the long suspense be ended*

Suspense killing!

Der ernstesten Erwartung dauern. *Of my most earnest expectation.*

Can't wait!

Schon hellen sich die Finsternisse; *It shines, the darknesses are rended:*

Getting bright!

Schon in der innersten Phiole *Within the phial's inmost chamber*

Deep inside!

Ergluht es wie lebendige Kohle, *It gleams, as doth a living ember,*–

Glowing hot!

Ja wie der herrlichste Karfunkel, *Yea, a carbuncle, burning, bright'ning,*

Finest gem!

Verstrahlend Blitze durch das Dunkel. *It rays the darkness with its lightning.*

Lightning flash!

Ein helles weisses Licht erscheint! *Now white and clear the lustres blend!*

White light!

O dass ich's diesmal nicht verliere! – *O that I hold, nor lose it more!*

Don't lose it!

Ach Gott! was rasselt an der Türe? *Ah, God! what rattles at the door?*

Who's there?

Mephistopheles

Willkommen! es ist gut gemeint. *Welcome! I mean it as a friend.*

Friendly visit!

Wagner

Willkommen zu dem Stern der Stunde! *Be welcome to the planet of the hour!*

Perfect time!

Doch haltet Wort und Atem fest im Munde, *Yet breath and speech suspend! A work of power,*

Shh!

Ein herrlich Werk ist gleich zustand gebracht. *A splendid work, will soon be here displayed.*

Almost done!

Mephistopheles

Was gibt es denn? – *What is it, then?*

What's up?

Wagner

Es wird ein Mensch gemacht. *A man is being made.*

Making man!

Mephistopheles

Ein Mensch? Und welch verliebtes Paar *A man? And what enamoured pair*

Human? Who fucked?

Habt ihr ins Rauchloch eingeschlossen? *Have you within the chimney hidden?*

Chimney couple?

Wagner

Der zarte Punkt, aus dem das Leben sprang, *Nay, God forbid! This procreation is most rare:*

Old way? No!

Die holde Kraft, die aus dem Innern drang *Of the old, senseless mode we're now well ridden.*

Nonsense now!

Und nahm und gab, bestimmt sich selbst zu zeichnen, *The tender point, whence Life commenced its course,*

Life's start!

Erst Nachstes, dann sich Fremdes anzueignen, *The outward stress of gracious inward force,*

Inner force!

Die ist von ihrer Wurde nun entsetzt; *Which took and gave, itself delineating,*

Shape itself!

Wenn sich das Tier noch weiter dran ergetzt, *First near, then foreign traits assimilating,*

Near then far!

So muss der Mensch mit seinen grossen Gaben *We now of all its dignity divest:*

Dignity gone!

Doch künftig hohern, hohern Ursprung haben. *The beast therein may further find a zest,*

Beasts can!

Es leuchtet! seht! – Nun lässt sich wirklich hoffen, *But Man must learn, with his great gifts, to win*

Humans though!

Dass, wenn wir aus viel hundert Stoffen *Henceforth a purer, loftier origin.*

Higher source!

Durch Mischung – denn auf Mischung kommt es an – *It brightens, –see! Sure, now, my hopes increase*

Shining! Hope!

Den Menschenstoff gemachlich komponieren, *That if, from many hundred substances,*

Many parts!

In einen Kolben verlutieren *Through mixture—since on mixture all depends—*

Mixing key!

Und ihn gehorig kohobieren, *The human substance gently be compounded,*

Mix human!

So ist das Werk im stillen abgetan. *And by a closed retort surrounded,*

Seal it!

Es wird! die Masse regt sich klarer! *Distilled, and fed, and slowly founded,*

Distill right!

Die Überzeugung wahrer, wahrer: *Then in success the secret labour ends.*

Done quiet!

Was man an der Natur Geheimnisvolles pries, *'Twill be! the mass is working clearer!*

It's working!

Das wagen wir verständig zu probieren, *Conviction gathers, truer, nearer!*

More sure!

Und was sie sonst organisieren liess, *The mystery which for Man in Nature lies*

Nature's secret!

Das lassen wir kristallisieren. *We dare to test, by knowledge led;*

Dare test!

Mephistopheles

Wer lange lebt, hat viel erfahren, *And that which she was wont to organise*

She organized!

Nichts Neues kann fur ihn auf dieser Welt geschehn. *We crystallise, instead.*

We crystallize!

Ich habe schon in meinen Wanderjahren *Who lives, learns many secrets to unravel;*

Long life!

Kristallisiertes Menschevolk gesehn. *For him, upon this earth, there's nothing new can be.*

Nothing new!

Wagner

Es steigt, es blitzt, es hauft sich an, *I've seen already, in my years of travel,*

Seen before!

Im Augenblick ist es getan. *Much crystallised humanity.*

Crystal people!

Ein grosser Vorsatz scheint im Anfang toll; *It mounts, it lightens, grows,—'tis won!*

Rising! Flashing!

Doch wollen wir des Zufalls kunftig lachen, *A moment more, and it is done!*

Almost done!

Und so ein Hirn, das trefflich denken soll, *Insane, at first, appears a great intent;*

Seems crazy!

Wird kunftig auch ein Denker machen. *We yet shall laugh at chance in generation;*

Laugh at chance!

Das Glas erklingt von lieblicher Gewalt, *A brain like this, for genuine thinking meant,*

Thinking brain!

Es trubt, es klart sich; also muss es werden! *Will henceforth be a thinker's sure creation.*

Thinker makes!

Ich seh' in zierlicher Gestalt *The glass vibrates with sweet and powerful tone;*

Glass sings!

Ein artig Mannlein sich gebarden. *It darkens, clears: it must arrive at being!*

Clouding! Clearing!

Was wollen wir, was will die Welt nun mehr? *And now in delicate shape is shown*

Dainty form!

Denn das Geheimnis liegt am Tage. *A pretty mannikin, moving, living, seeing!*

Little man!

Gebt diesem Laute nur Gehor, *What more can we, what more the world demand?*

Want more?

Er wird zur Stimme, wird zur Sprache. *The secret, solved, all men may reach:*

Secret's out!

Homunculus (*in der Phiole / in the phial*)

Nun Vaterchen! wie steht's? es war kein Scherz. *Hark! as the ringing tones expand,*

Listen up!

Komm, drucke mich recht zartlich an dein Herz! *They form a voice, result in speech.*

Voice! Speech!

Doch nicht zu fest, damit das Glas nicht springe. *How goes it, Daddy? It was then no jest!*

Hi Dad! Real!

Das ist die Eigenschaft der Dinge: *Come, press me tenderly upon thy breast!*

Hug me!

Natürlichem genügt das Weltall kaum, *But not too hard, for fear the glass might shatter!*

Don't break!

Was künstlich ist, verlangt geschlossnen Raum. *This is the quality of matter:*

Thing is:

Du aber, Schalk, Herr Vetter, bist du hier *For what is natural, scarce the world has place;*

Nature needs space!

Im rechten Augenblick? ich danke dir. *What's artificial, needs restricted space.*

I need container!

Ein gut Geschick fuhr dich zu uns herein; *Thou rogue, Sir Cousin! here I find thee, too?*

Hey Cousin!

Dieweil ich bin, muss ich auch tätig sein. *And at the proper time! My thanks are due:*

Thanks!

Ich mochte mich sogleich zur Arbeit schurzen. *A lucky fortune led thee here to me;*

Lucky arrival!

Du bist gewandt, die Wege mir zu kurzen. *Since I exist, then I must active be.*

Exist = act!

Wagner

Nur noch ein Wort! Bisher musst' ich mich schamen, *I'd fain begin my work without delay:*

Want work!

Denn alt und jung besturmt mich mit Problemen. *Thou art adroit in shortening my way.*

You know shortcuts!

Zum Beispiel nur: noch niemand konnt' es fassen, *But first, a word! I'm shamed that answers fail me;*

One question!

Wie Seel' und Leib so schon zusammenpassen, *For old and young with problems so assail me.*

Everyone asks!

So fest sich halten, als um nie zu scheiden, *Now, for example, none e'er comprehended*

For example:

Und doch den Tag sich immerfort verleiden. *How soul and body wedded are and blended,*–

Soul and body?

Sodann – – *Hold fast, as if defying separation,*

So tight!

Mephistopheles

Halt ein! ich wollte lieber fragen: *Yet never cease their mutual irritation.*

Yet fight!

Warum sich Mann und Frau so schlecht vertragen? *Therefore–*

Then –

Du kommst, mein Freund, hierüber nie ins reine. *Desist! I'd rather ask him why*

Better question!

Hier gibt's zu tun, das eben will der Kleine. *The man and wife agree so wretchedly.*

Why marriage hard?

Homunculus

Was gibt's zu tun? – *To thee, my friend, the thing will ne'er be clear:*

Never solve!

Mephistopheles

Hier zeige deine Gabe! *There's work to do: for that the little fellow's here.*

Work here!

Wagner

Furwahr, du bist ein allerliebster Knabe! *What's to be done?*

What job?

Homunculus (*erstaunt / astonished*)

Bedeutend! – – *Thy talents here employ!*

Show gift!

Schon umgeben! – Klar Gewasser *Forsooth, thou art the very loveliest boy!*

Cutest boy!

Im dichten Haine! Fraun, die sich entkleiden, *Significant!–*

Whoa!

Die allerliebsten! – Das wird immer besser. *Fair scenery!–Waters, moving*

Surrounded! Water!

Doch eine lasst sich glanzend unterscheiden, *In forest shadows: women there, undressing.*

Forest! Naked women!

Aus höchstem Helden-, wohl aus Gotterstamme. *The loveliest forms!—the picture is improving.*

Hotter! Better!

Sie setzt den Fuss in das durchsichtige Helle; *One, marked by beauty, splendidly expressing*

One stands out!

Des edlen Körpers holde Lebensflamme *Descent from Gods or high heroic races,*

Divine blood!

Kühlt sich im schmiegsamen Kristall der Welle. – *Now dips her foot in the translucent shimmer:*

Foot in water!

Doch welch Getöse rasch bewegter Flügel, *The living flame of her sweet form displaces*

Sweet flame!

Welch Sausen, Platschern wuhlt im glatten Spiegel? *The yielding crystal, cool around the swimmer.*

Cools in waves!

Die Mädchen fliehn verschuchtert; doch allein *But what a sound of wings! What rapid dashing*

Wings!

Die Königin, sie blickt gelassen drein *Across the glassy pool, what fluttering, splashing!*

Splash!

Und sieht mit stolzem weiblichem Vergnügen *The maidens fly, alarmed; but only she,*

Girls flee! One stays!

Der Schwane Fürsten ihrem Knie sich schmiegen, *The queen, looks on, composed and terror-free,*

Queen calm!

Zudringlich-zahm. Er scheint sich zu gewöhnen. – *And sees with proud and womanly delight*

Proud pleasure!

Auf einmal aber steigt ein Dunst empor *The swan-prince press her knee with plumage white,*

Swan at knee!

Und deckt mit dichtgewebtem Flor *Importunately tame: he grows acquainted.—*

Getting cozy!

Die lieblichste von allen Szenen. *But all at once floats up a vapour pale,*

Mist rises!

Mephistopheles

Was du nicht alles zu erzählen hast! *And covers with its closely-woven veil*

Haze covers!

So klein du bist, so gross bist du Phantast. *The loveliest picture ever dreamed or painted.*

Best scene gone!

Ich sehe nichts – – *How much hast thou to tell,–what stories merry!*

What stories!

Homunculus

Das glaub' ich. Du aus Norden, *So small thou art, so great a visionary!*

Big dreamer!

Im Nebelalter jung geworden, *Nothing see I!–*

See nothing!

Im Wust von Rittertum und Pfafferei, *Of course. Thou, from the North,*

You're Northern!

Wo ware da dein Auge frei! *And in the age of mist brought forth,*

Fog age!

Im Dustern bist du nur zu Hause. *In knighthood's and in priestcraft's murky den,*

Knights and priests!

Verbraunt Gestein, bemodert, widrig, *How should thy sight be clearer, then?*

Can't see!

Spitzbogig, schnorkelhaftest, niedrig! – *In gloom alone art thou at home.*

Gloom home!

Erwacht uns dieser, gibt es neue Not, *Brown masonry, repellent, crumbling slowly,*

Old moldy!

Er bleibt gleich auf der Stelle tot. *Arch-pointed, finical, fantastic, lowly!–*

Tacky Gothic!

Waldquellen, Schwane, nackte Schonen, *If this man wakes, another danger's nigh;*

Don't wake!

Das war sein ahnungsvoller Traum; *At once upon the spot he'll die.*

Die here!

Wie wollt' er sich hierher gewöhnen! *Wood-fountains, swans, and naked beauties,*

Springs! Swans! Nudes!

Ich, der Bequemste, duld' es kaum. *Such was his dream of presage fair:*

His dream!

Nun fort mit ihm! – *How should these dark surroundings suit his*

Can't adjust!

Mephistopheles

Der Ausweg soll mich freuen. *Desires, when them I scarce can bear?*

I barely stand!

Homunculus

Befiehl den Krieger in die Schlacht, *Away with him!*

Take him away!

Das Mädchen führe du zum Reihen, *I hail the issue's chances.*

What plan?

So ist gleich alles abgemacht. *Command the warrior to the fight,*

Warriors fight!

Jetzt eben, wie ich schnell bedacht, *Conduct the maiden to the dances:*

Girls dance!

Ist klassische Walpurgisnacht; *And all is finished, as is right.*

All settled!

Das Beste, was begegnen konnte. *Just now—there breaks on me a light—*

Just thought!

Bringt ihn zu seinem Elemente! *'Tis Classical Walpurgis-Night;*

Classic Walpurgis!

Mephistopheles

Dergleichen hab' ich nie vernommen. *Whate'er may come, it is the best event,*

Best luck!

Homunculus

Wie wollt' es auch zu euren Ohren kommen? *So bring him to his proper element!*

His element!

Romantische Gespenster kennt ihr nur allein; *The like of that I never heard one mention.*

Never heard!

Ein echt Gespenst, auch klassisch hat's zu sein. *How should it have attracted your attention?*

How would you?

Mephistopheles

Wohin denn aber soll die Fahrt sich regen? *Only romantic ghosts are known to you;*

Romantic ghosts!

Mich widern schon antikische Kollegen. *A genuine phantom must be classic too.*

Classic ghosts!

Homunculus

An grosser Flache fliesst Peneios frei, *But whitherward shall then we travel, tell me!*

Where go?

Umbuscht, umbaumt, in still- und feuchten Buchten; *Your antique cronies in advance repel me.*

Antiques disgust!

Die Ebne dehnt sich zu der Berge Schluchten, *North-westwards, Satan, is thy park and pale,*

Northwest yours!

Und oben liegt Pharsalus, alt und neu. *But we, this time, south-eastwards sail.*

Southeast now!

Mephistopheles

O weh! hinweg! und lasst mir jene Streite *Peneus, there, the great plain wanders through,*

Peneus flows!

Von Tyrannei und Sklaverei beiseite. *By thickets, groves, and silent coves, and meadow grasses;*

Trees! Coves!

Mich langeweilt's; denn kaum ist's abgetan, *The level stretches to the mountain passes,*

To mountains!

So fangen sie von vorne wieder an; *And o'er it lies Pharsalus, old and new.*

Pharsalus!

Und keiner merkt: er ist doch nur geneckt *Alas! have done! Bring not that fell collision*

No battles!

Vom Asmodeus, der dahinter steckt. *Of tyrant and of slave before my vision!*

Skip slavery!

Sie streiten sich, so heisst's, um Freiheitsrechte; *I'm tired of that: for scarcely is it done*

Boring!

Genau besehn, sind's Knechte gegen Knechte. *Than they the same thing have again begun;*

Starts over!

Homunculus

Den Menschen lass ihr widerspenstig Wesen, *And no one marks that he's the puppet blind*

Being played!

Ein jeder muss sich wehren, wie er kann, *Of sly Asmodi, lurking there behind.*

Asmodeus tricks!

Vom Knaben auf, so wird's zuletzt ein Mann. *They fight, we're told, their freedom's right to save;*

Freedom fight!

Hier fragt sich's nur, wie dieser kann genesen. *But, clearer seen, 'tis slave that fights with slave.*

Slaves vs slaves!

Hast du ein Mittel, so erprob' es hier, *Leave unto men their fractiousness and clatter:*

Let them!

Vermagst du's nicht, so uberlass es mir. *Each must protect himself, as best he can,*

Defend self!

Mephistopheles

Manch Brockenstuckchen ware durchzuproben, *From boyhood up, and thus becomes a man.*

Boys to men!

Doch Heidenriegel find' ich vorgeschoben. *How this one shall recover, is our matter.*

How heal him?

Das Griechenvolk, es taugte nie recht viel! *Hast thou a method, let it tested be!*

Got cure?

Doch blendet's euch mit freiem Sinnenspiel, *But hast thou none, so leave the case to me!*

I'll do it!

Verlockt des Menschen Brust zu heitern Sunden; *There's many a Brocken-method I might try,*

Brocken tricks!

Die unsern wird man immer duster finden. *But pagan bolts, I find, the way deny.*

Pagan blocks!

Und nun, was soll's? – *The Grecian race was little worth, alway;*

Greeks worthless!

Homunculus

Du bist ja sonst nicht blode; *It dazzles with the senses' freer play,*

Sexy dazzle!

Und wenn ich von thessalischen Hexen rede, *To cheerful sins the heart of man entices;*

Happy sins!

So denk' ich, hab' ich was gesagt. *While ours are ever counted gloomy vices.*

Gloomy sins!

Mephistopheles

Thessalische Hexen! Wohl! das sind Personen, *Now, what shall be?*

What now?

Nach denen hab' ich lang' gefragt. *Shyness was ne'er thy blame,*

Not shy usually!

Mit ihnen Nacht für Nacht zu wohnen, *When I to thee Thessalian witches name,*

Thessalian witches!

Ich glaube nicht, dass es behagt; *I've not said nothing, that I know.*

Said something!

Doch zum Besuch, Versuch – – *Thessalian witches! Well! The persons, those,*

Those witches!

Homunculus

Den Mantel her, *Whom I inquired for, long ago.*

Long sought!

Und um den Ritter umgeschlagen! *Night after night beside them to repose,*

Nightly visits!

Der Lappen wird euch, wie bisher, *I think would hardly suit: but so,*

Not pleasant!

Den einen mit dem andern tragen; *A mere espial, trial,–*

But visit!

Ich leuchte vor. – *Here! cast o'er*

Get cloak!

Wagner

Und ich? – *The knight your magic mantle, and enfold him!*

Wrap him!

Homunculus

Eh nun, *The rag will still, as heretofore,*

Rag carries!

Du bleibst zu Hause, Wichtigstes zu tun. *Upon his airy course–and thine–uphold him.*

Both together!

Entfalte du die alten Pergamente, *I'll light the way.*

I'll light!

Nach Vorschrift sammle Lebens Elemente *And I?*

And me?

Und füge sie mit Vorsicht eins ans andre. *Eh? You*

Well...

Das Was bedenke, mehr bedenke Wie. *Will stay at home, most weighty work to do.*

Stay home!

Indessen ich ein Stückchen Welt durchwandere, *Unfold your ancient parchments, and collect*

Old papers!

Entdeck' ich wohl das Tüpfchen auf das i. *Life's elements as your recipes direct.*

Follow recipe!

Dann ist der grosse Zweck erreicht; *One to the other with due caution fitting.*

Careful mix!

Solch einen Lohn verdient ein solches Streben: *The What consider, more the How and Why!*

How matters more!

Gold, Ehre, Ruhm, gesundes langes Leben, *Meanwhile, about the world at random flitting,*

I'll roam!

Und Wissenschaft und Tugend – auch vielleicht. *I may detect the dot upon the "I."*

Find the key!

Leb wohl! – *The lofty aim will then accomplished be;*

Goal reached!

Wagner

Leb wohl! Das drückt das Herz mir nieder. *Such an endeavour merits such requital:*

Deserved reward!

Ich fürchte schon, ich seh' dich niemals wieder. *Gold, honour, glory, healthy forces vital,*

Gold! Fame! Life!

Mephistopheles

Nun zum Peneios frisch hinab! *And science, too, and virtue, –possibly.*

Maybe virtue!

Herr Vetter ist nicht zu verachten. *Farewell!*

Bye!

Am Ende hangen wir doch ab *Farewell! It doth depress my heart*

Heart heavy!

Von Kreaturen, die wir machten. *I fear, already, we for ever part.*

Fear forever!

Down to Peneus, with his aid! Sir Cousin is a deft attendant. Upon the creatures we have made We are, ourselves, at last, dependent.

Klassische Walpurgisnacht. Pharsalische Felder / Classical Walpurgis-Night

Erichtho

Zum Schauderfeste dieser Nacht, wie ofter schon, *To this night's awful festival, as oft before,*

To this night's dread festival, as I've done so often

Tret' ich einher, Erichtho, ich, die dustere; *I enter here, Erichtho, I, the gloomy one:*

I enter now - Erichtho, me, the gloomy one

Nicht so abscheulich, wie die leidigen Dichter mich *Not so atrocious as the evil poets draw,*

Not quite so vile as the pathetic poets make me

Im Übermass verlastern... Endigen sie doch nie *In most superfluous slander—for they never cease*

In their over-the-top slander... they never quit

In Lob und Tadel... Überbleicht erscheint mir schon *Their blame or praises... Over-whitened I behold*

With the blame or the praise... Bleached pale I see

Von grauer Zelten Woge weit das Tal dahin, *The vale, with waves of tents that glimmer gray afar,*

The valley already spread with waves of gray tents

Als Nachgesicht der sorg- und grauenvollsten Nacht. *The after-vision of that fatal, fearful night.*

An afterimage of the most dread and care-filled night

Wie oft schon wiederholt' sich's! wird sich immerfort *How oft is it repeated!—will for ever be*

How often this repeats! Will keep on repeating

Ins Ewige wiederholen... Keiner gönnt das Reich *For ever re-enacted! No one grants the realm*

Forever into eternity... No one grants the realm

Dem andern; dem gönnt's keiner, der's mit Kraft erwarb *Unto another: unto him whose might achieved*

To another; none grants it to him who seized it by force

Und kraftig herrscht. Denn jeder, der sein innres Selbst *And rules it, none; for each, incompetent to rule*

And rules by force. Because everyone who can't even

Nicht zu regieren weiss, regierte gar zu gern *His own internal self, is all too fain to sway*

Manage their own damn self is way too eager

Des Nachbars Willen, eignem stolzem Sinn gemass... *His neighbour's will, even as his haughty mind inclines.*

To rule their neighbor's will, per their own proud whims

Hier aber ward ein grosses Beispiel durchgekämpft: *But here a lesson grand was battled to the end,*

But here a great example got fought to the end

Wie sich Gewalt Gewaltigerem entgegenstellt, *How force resists and grapples with the greater force,*

How force opposes even greater force

Der Freiheit holder, tausendblumiger Kranz zerreisst, *The lovely, thousand-blossomed wreath of Freedom rends,*

Freedom's lovely thousand-blossomed wreath gets ripped apart

Der starre Lorbeer sich ums Haupt des Herrschers biegt. *And bends the stubborn laurel round the Ruler's brow.*

The stiff laurel bends itself around the Ruler's skull

Hier traunte Magnus fruher Grosse Blutentag, *Here, of his days of early greatness Pompey dreamed:*

Here Magnus dreamed of his early greatness bloom-day

Dem schwanken Zunglein lauschend wachte Caesar dort! *Before the trembling balance Caesar yonder watched!*

Listening to the trembling balance-needle, Caesar woke over there!

Das wird sich messen. Weiss die Welt doch, wem's gelang. *It will be weighed: the world knows unto whom it turned.*

That will get weighed. The world knows who won

Wachfeuer gluhen, rote Flammen spendende, *The watch-fires flash and glow, spendthrift of ruddy flame;*

Watch-fires glow, spilling red flames

Der Boden haucht vergossnen Blutes Widerschein, *Reflections of the squandered blood the earth exhales,*

The ground exhales a sheen of spilled blood

Und angelockt von seltnem Wunderglanz der Nacht, *And, lured by rare and marvellous splendour of the night,*

And lured by this night's rare miraculous glow

Versammelt sich hellenischer Sage Legion. *The legion of Hellenic legends gathers here.*

The legion of Hellenic legend assembles here

Um alle Feuer schwankt unsicher oder sitzt *Round all the fires uncertain hover, or at ease*

Around every fire, uncertain, hovering or sitting

Behaglich alter Tage fabelhaft Gebild. . . *Sit near them, fabulous forms of ancient days. . .*

Comfortably: ancient days' fabulous shapes

Der Mond, zwar unvollkommen, aber leuchtend hell, *The moon, imperfect, truly, but of clearest beam,*

The moon, imperfect granted, but bright and clear

Erhebt sich, milden Glanz verbreitend uberall; *Arises, scattering mellow radiance everywhere:*

Rises up, spreading gentle glow everywhere

Der Zelten Trug verschwindet, Feuer brennen blau. *Vanish the phantom tents, the fires are burning blue.*

The phantom tents vanish, fires burn blue

Doch uber mir! welch unerwartet Meteor? *But o'er my head what unexpected meteor!*

But over me! What unexpected meteor!

Es leuchtet und beleuchtet körperlichen Ball. *It shines, illuminates the sphere of earth below.*

It glows and illuminates a bodily sphere

Ich wittre Leben. Da geziemen will mir's nicht, *I scent the Living! therefore it becomes me not*

I smell living flesh. Not fitting for me

Lebendigem zu nahen, dem ich schädlich bin; *Them to approach, I being harmful unto them:*

To approach the living - I'm harmful to them

Das bringt mir bosen Ruf und frommt mir nicht. *An evil name it brings me, and it profits naught.*

That just gives me bad press and profits nothing

Schon sinkt es nieder. Weich' ich aus mit Wohlbedacht! *Already now it sinks: discreetly I withdraw.*

Already sinking. I'll withdraw with discretion!

Die Luftfahrer oben / The Airy Travellers above

Homunculus

Schwebe noch einmal die Runde *Once again the circle follow,*

One more circle overhead

Über Flamm- und Schaudergrauen; *O'er the flames and horrors hover!*

Over flames and horror-dread

Ist es doch in Tal und Grunde *Ghostly 'tis in vale and hollow,*

Down in vale and hollow ground

Gar gespenstisch anzuschauen. *Spectral all that we discover.*

Everything looks ghost-like all around

Mephistopheles

Seh' ich, wie durchs alte Fenster *If, as through my window nightly*

Just like through my old window pane

In des Nordens Wust und Graus, *In the gruesome North, I see*

In the North's waste of disgust and pain

Ganz abscheuliche Gespenster, *Spectres hideous and unsightly,*

Completely loathsome spectres loom

Bin ich hier wie dort zu Haus. *Here is home, as there, to me.*

I'm home here like I'm home in my room

Homunculus

Sieh! da schreitet eine Lange *See! a tall one there is striding*

Look! A tall one striding there

Weiten Schrittes vor uns hin. *On before us, in the shade.*

Long steps out ahead of us in the air

Mephistopheles

Ist es doch, als war' ihr bange; *Through the air she saw us gliding,*

She seems frightened, I'd presume

Sah uns durch die Luft ziehn. *And it seems she is afraid.*

Saw us gliding through the gloom

Homunculus

Lass sie schreiten! setz ihn nieder, *Let her stride! The knight be taken*

Let her stride! Set down your knight

Deinen Ritter, und sogleich *Now, and set upon the strand:*

And the moment he touches soil just right

Kehret ihm das Leben wieder, *Here to life again he'll waken,*

Life will return to him again

Denn er sucht's im Fabelreich. *Seeking it in fable-land.*

He seeks it in Fable's domain

Faust (*die Erde beruhrend / as he touches the earth*)

Wo ist sie?– *Where is she?*–

Where is she?–

Homunculus

Wussten's nicht zu sagen, *It's more than we can tell.*

But here you can probably ask around with care

Doch hier wahrscheinlich zu erfragen. *But to inquire would here be well.*

Before dawn breaks, in haste you may

In Eile magst du, eh' es tagt, *Thou'rt free to hasten, ere the day,*

Go tracking flame to flame your way

Von Flamm' zu Flamme spurend gehen: *From flame to flame, and seek her so:*

Who dared to reach the Mothers' throne

Wer zu den Müttern sich gewagt, *Who to the Mothers found his way,*

Has nothing more to face alone

Hat weiter nichts zu überstehen. *Has nothing more to undergo.*

I too am here and claim my share

Mephistopheles

Auch ich bin hier am Platze; *I also claim my share in the excursion:*

But knew no better plan to declare

Doch wusst' ich nichts Bessres zu unserm Besten, *Yet know no better plan for our diversion,*

Than this: each one among these fires

Als: jeder moge durch die Feuer *Than that each one, amid these fires,*

Should test out his own adventures and desires

Versuchen sich sein eigen Abenteuer. *Should seek such fortunes as he most desires.*

Then, to unite us once again

Dann, um uns wieder zu vereinen, *Then, as a sign to reunite us,*

Let your lantern sound and shine, little friend!

Lass deine Leuchte, Kleiner, tonend scheinen. *Let, little one, thy lantern sound and light us!*

So shall it flash and shall it ring!

Homunculus

So soll es blitzen, soll es klingen. *Thus shall it shine, and thus shall ring!*

Now - fresh! - to new and wondrous things!

Nun frisch zu neuen Wunderdingen! *And now, away to many a marvellous thing!*

Where is she? - Don't ask further now...

Faust (*allein / alone*)

Wo ist sie?— Frage jetzt nicht weiter nach... *Where is she?—But no further question make!*

If this wasn't the very soil that bore her somehow

War's nicht die Scholle, die sie trug, *If this were not the soil that bore her feet,*

The wave that surged up when she came

Die Welle nicht, die ihr entgegenschlug, *If not the wave that to her coming beat,*

Then it's the air that speaks her tongue just the same

So ist's die Luft, die ihre Sprache sprach. *Yet 'tis the air that knows the tongue she spake.*

Here! By miracle, here in Greece!

Hier! durch ein Wunder, hier in Griechenland! *Here, by a marvel! Here, on Grecian land!*

I felt the ground instantly beneath my feet

Ich fühlte gleich den Boden, wo ich stand; *I felt at once the earth whereon I stand.*

Fresh spirit glowed through me while I slept

Wie mich, den Schlafer, frisch ein Geist durchgluhte, *Through me, the sleeper, fresher spirit stealing,*

I rise now, an Antaeus in my soul's depth

So steh' ich, ein Antaus an Gemute. *I rise refreshed, Antaeus in my feeling.*

And if I find the strangest things assembled here

Und find' ich hier das Seltsamste beisammen, *Together here I find the strangest store;*

I'll probe this labyrinth of flames without fear

Durchforsch' ich ernst dies Labyrinth der Flammen. *Let me this labyrinth of flames explore.*

Am oberen Peneios / On the Upper Peneus

Mephistopheles (*umherspürend / prying around*)

Und wie ich diese Feuerchen durchschweife, *And as among these fires I wander, aimless,*

And as I wander through these little fires

So find' ich mich doch ganz und gar entfremdet, *I find myself so strange, so disconcerted:*

I cruise through bonfire vibes like a lost tourist

Fast alles nackt, nur hie und da behemdet: *Quite naked most, a few are only shirted;*

My flesh wanders through heat-flickers, seeking

Die Sphinx schamlos, unverschamt die Greife, *The Griffins insolent, the Sphinxes shameless,*

Scrolling through campfires on Night TikTok

Und was nicht alles, lockig und beflugelt, *And what not all, with pinions and with tresses,*

And swishing past these slutty little flames

Von vorn und hinten sich im Auge spiegelt... *Before, behind, upon one's eyesight presses!–*

Fire-hopping and completely out of my element

Zwar sind auch wir von Herzen unanständig, *Indecency, 'tis true, is our ideal,*

I find myself completely alienated

Doch das Antike find' ich zu lebendig; *But the Antique is too alive and real;*

I'm totally weirded out, if we're being real

Das musste man mit neuem Sinn bemeistern *One must with modern thought the thing bemeister,*

My skin crawls with strangeness, goosebumps rising

Und mannigfaltig modisch überkleistern... *And in the fashion variously o'erplaster:–*

Like a goth at a beach party

Ein widrig Volk! Doch darf mich's nicht verdriessen, *Disgusting race! Yet I, perforce, must meet them,*

Feeling foreign in my own filthy skin

Als neuer Gast anständig sie zu grüssen... *And as new guest with due decorum greet them.–*

Not my circus, not my extremely naked monkeys

Glück zu den schönen Frauen, den klugen Greisen! *Hail, then, Fair Ladies! Gray-beards wise, good cheer!*

Nearly all naked, here and there just shirted

Greif (*schnarrend / snarling*)

Nicht Greisen! Greifen! – Niemand hort es gern, *Not gray-beards! Gray-beards? No one likes to hear*

Everyone's basically nude—a few have shirts

Dass man ihn Greis nennt. Jedem Worte klingt *One call him gray. For in each word there rings*

Bare flesh everywhere, occasional cloth teasing

Der Ursprung nach, wo es sich her bedingt: *The source, wherefrom its derivation springs.*

Dress code: birthday suit, accessories optional

Grau, gramlich, griesgram, greulich, Graber, grimmig, *Gray, growling, gruesome, grinning, graves, and grimly,*

Mostly naked meat, the odd shirt-tease

Etymologisch gleicherweise stimmig, – *Etymologically accord, nor dimly,*

Nudity wall-to-wall with sporadic laundry

Verstimmen uns. *And make us grim.*

The Sphinxes shameless, the Griffins brazen

Mephistopheles

Und doch, nicht abzuschweifen, *And yet, why need you stiffen?*

Sphinxes have zero shame, Griffins even less

Gefällt das Grei im Ehrentitel Greifen. *You like the grip in your proud title, “Griffin.”*

Cat-bodies lounging exposed, eagle-lions preening

Greif

Natürlich! Die Verwandtschaft ist erprobt, *Of course! for this relation is found fit;*

Mythical beasts with exactly zero modesty settings

Zwar oft gescholten, mehr jedoch gelobt; *Though often censured, oftener praised was it.*

Shameless pussy-cats, brazen bird-cocks

Man greife nun nach Mädchen, Kronen, Gold, *Let one but grip at maidens, crowns, and gold;*

Sphinxes flaunting it, Griffins doubling down

Dem Greifenden ist meist Fortuna hold. *Fortune is gracious to the Griper bold.*

And what else, curly-haired and winged

Ameisen (*von der kolossalen Art / of the colossal kind*)

Ihr sprecht von Gold, wir hatten viel gesammelt, *You speak of gold, much had ourselves collected;*

Plus all this winged, curly-haired whatever

In Fels- und Höhlen heimlich eingerammelt; *In rocks and caverns secretly we trapped it:*

Feathers brushing, ringlets bouncing, flesh on display

Das Arimaspen-Volk hat's ausgespurt, *The Arimaspean race our store detected,–*

Curls and wings sprouting from aesthetic chaos

Sie lachen dort, wie weit sie's weggeführt. *They're laughing now, so far away they've snapped it.*

Tresses and pinions—coming and going

Greife

Wir wollen sie schon zum Gestandnis bringen. *We soon shall force them to confess.*

Hair! Wings! More creatures than a fever dream!

Arimaspen

Nur nicht zur freien Jubelnacht. *But not in this free night of jubilee.*

Mirrors itself in my eyes, front and back

Bis morgen ist's alles durchgebracht, *Before the morrow, all will squandered be;*

Reflected everywhere I look—front, back, all over

Es wird uns diesmal wohl gelingen. *This time our efforts will obtain success.*

My eyes fill with bodies approaching, receding

Mephistopheles (*der sich zwischen die Sphinxen gesetzt hat / who has seated himself between the Sphinxes*)

Wie leicht und gern ich mich hierher gewöhne, *How soon I feel familiar here, among you!*

My retinas are absolutely polluted

Denn ich verstehe Mann für Mann. *I understand you, one and all.*

Pressing against my eyeballs from every angle

Sphinx

Wir hauchen unsre Geistertöne, *Our spirit-tones, when we have sung you,*

Visual assault, three-sixty degrees

Und ihr verkörpert sie alsdann. *Become, for you, material.*

We too are indecent at heart, it's true

Jetzt nenne dich, bis wir dich weiter kennen. *Now name thyself, till we shall know thee better.*

Look, we're also pretty indecent deep down

Mephistopheles

Mit vielen Namen glaubt man mich zu nennen – *With many names would men my nature fetter.*

My own core pulses with impropriety

Sind Briten hier? Sie reisen sonst so viel, *Are Britons here? So round the world they wheel,*

Our brand of filth is perfectly respectable

Schlachtfeldern nachzuspüren, Wasserfällen, *To stare at battle-fields, historic traces,*

Sure, I love a good dirty deed myself

Gesturzten Mauern, klassisch dumpfen Stellen; *Cascades, old walls, and classic dreary places;*

Glass houses, stone-throwing, etc.

Das ware hier fur sie ein wurdig Ziel. *And here were something worthy of their zeal.*

But the Antique I find too lively

Sie zeugten auch: Im alten Buhnenspiel *Their Old Plays also testify of me;*

But this ancient stuff is way too much

Sah man mich dort als old Iniquity. *Men saw me there as "Old Iniquity."*

This old flesh breathes too vigorously

Sphinx

Wie kam man drauf? – *How did they hit on that?*

Classical nudity hits different when it moves

Mephistopheles

Ich weiss es selbst nicht wie. *I know not, verily.*

But these antiques are too damn horny

Sphinx

Mag sein! Hast du von Sternen einige Kunde? *Perhaps! Hast thou in star-lore any power?*

Vintage sleaze—somehow worse than modern sleaze

Was sagst du zu der gegenwart'gen Stunde? *What say'st thou of the aspects of the hour?*

One must master it with modern sense

Mephistopheles (*hinaufschauend / looking up*)

Stern schießt nach Stern, beschnittner Mond scheint helle, *Star shoots on star, the cloven moon doth ride*

We'd need to modernize this whole situation

Und mir ist wohl an dieser trauten Stelle, *In brilliance; in this place I'm satisfied:*

The body craves contemporary coverings

Ich warme mich an deinem Lowenfelle. *I warm myself against thy lion's hide.*

Time for a Renaissance of the Renaissance

Hinauf sich zu versteigen, war' zum Schaden; *It were a loss to rise from out these shades:–*

Need to slap some clothes on these exhibitionists

Gib Ratsel auf, gib allenfalls Scharaden. *Propose enigmas, or at least charades!*

Requires a complete aesthetic reboot

Sphinx

Sprich nur dich selbst aus, wird schon Ratsel sein. *Express thyself, and 'twill a riddle be.*

And variously plaster over with fashion

Versuch einmal, dich innigst aufzulösen: *Try once thine own analysis: 'twere merry.*

Cover it up with trendy layers

“Dem frommen Manne nötig wie dem bosen, *“To both Devout and Wicked necessary:*

Wrap this rawness in fashionable gauze

Dem ein Plastron, asketisch zu rapieren, *To those, a breast-plate for ascetic fighting;*

Apply couture like spackle to a crack

Kumpan dem andern, Tolles zu vollfuhren, *To these, boon-comrade, in their pranks uniting;*

Slather it in stylish concealment

Und beides nur, um Zeus zu amüsieren.” *And both amusing Zeus, the fun-delighting.”*

Fashion-paste: apply liberally to antiquity

Erster Greif (*schnarrend / snarling*)

Den mag ich nicht! – *I like not him!*

A disgusting folk! Yet I mustn't be annoyed

Zweiter Greif (*starker schnarrend / snarling more gruffly*)

Was will uns der? *What will the fellow here?*

Gross crowd! But I can't let it get to me

Beide

Der Garstige gehoret nicht hierher! *The Nasty One is not of us, 'tis clear!*

My stomach turns, but I compose my features

Mephistopheles (*brutal / brutally*)

Du glaubst vielleicht, des Gastes Nagel krauen *Think'st thou, perhaps, thy guest has nails to scratch,*

Repulsive, yet I must remain a diplomat

Nicht auch so gut wie deine scharfen Klauen? *That with thy sharper talons cannot match?*

Revolting rabble—but hey, networking

Versuch's einmal! – *Just try it once!*

Nasty bunch, but manners matter

Sphinx (*gelinde / gently*)

Du magst nur immer bleiben, *Stay, shouldst thou find it well;*

To greet them properly as a new guest

Wird dich's doch selbst aus unsrer Mitte treiben; *But from our ranks thou wilt thyself expel.*

Gotta be polite since I'm the newcomer

In deinem Lande tust dir was zugute, *In thine own land thou'rt wont thyself to pamper,*

I arrange my body into courtesy

Doch, irr' ich nicht, hier ist dir schlecht zumute. *Yet here, I think, thy spirits feel a damper.*

The new guy has to play nice

Mephistopheles

Du bist recht appetitlich oben anzuschauen, *Thine upper part entices; naught is fairer;*

Put on my friendly face for the freaks

Doch unten hin die Bestie macht mir Grauen. *But, further down, the beast excites my terror.*

Guest etiquette requires I pretend not to gag

Sphinx

Du Falscher kommst zu deiner bittern Busse, *Bitter, False one, will be thy expiation;*

Good luck to the fair ladies, the wise graybeards!

Denn unsre Tatzen sind gesund; *Our claws are sound and worthy proof,*

Cheers to the hot ladies and wise old dudes!

Dir mit verschrumpftem Pferdefusse *But thou, with withered horse's-hoof,*

I bow my head to beauty and age alike

Behagt es nicht in unserem Bund. *Art ill at ease in our association.*

Salutations, babes and boomers!

Mephistopheles

Wer sind die Vogel, in den Asten *On yonder poplars by the river,*

Hey there, sexy ladies and saggy elders!

Des Pappelstromes hingewiegt? *What are the birds that swing above?*

Here's to the MILFs and the mentor-types!

Sphinx

Gewahrt euch nur! Die Allerbesten *Beware! The very best that ever*

Not graybeards! Griffins!—No one wants to hear

Hat solch ein Singsang schon besiegt. *Existed, they have lured to love.*

Not GRAYbeards! GRIFFins! Nobody likes being called

Sirenen

Horcht, wir kommen hier zu Scharen *Ah, why vitiate your senses,*

The throat snarls at the syllable of age

Und in wohlgestimmten Tönen; *Where those Uglinesses darken?*

Autocorrect has failed you, demon

So geziemet es Sirenen. *We, in crowds, come hither: hearken*

Not old men! We're GRIPPERS!

Sphynx (*sie verspottend, in derselben Melodie / mocking them, in the same melody*)

Notigt sie, herabzusteigen! *How the accordant strain commences,*

Wrong G-word, idiot!

Sie verbergen in den Zweigen *Meet for Sirens' soft pretences!*

That he's called a graybeard. Every word echoes

Ihre garstigen Habichtskrallen, *Let them to descend be bidden!*

Old. The word itself carries baggage

Euch verderblich anzufallen, *In the branches they have hidden*

Each sound rings backward to its bitter root

Wenn ihr euer Ohr verleiht. *Hideous falcon-claws they're wearing,*

Gray has big grandpa energy and we hate it

Sirenen

Weg das Hassen! weg das Neiden! *And you'll feel their cruel tearing,*

The word "gray" makes my feathers droop

Sammeln wir die klarsten Freuden, *Once you lend them willing ear.*

"Graybeard" is basically a hate crime

Unterm Himmel ausgestreut! *Banish hate and envy, rather!*

Its origin, from whence it was derived

Auf dem Wasser, auf der Erde *We the purest pleasures gather*

Back to where it came from, etymologically

Sei's die heiterste Gebarde, *Under Heaven's auspicious sphere!*

Words carry ancestry in their bones

Die man dem Willkommen beut. *On the earth and on the ocean,*

Linguistics has consequences, bro

Mephistopheles

Das sind die saubern Neuigkeiten, *We, with cheerful beckoning motion,*

The root of the word reaches deep

Wo aus der Kehle, von den Saiten *Bid the wanderer welcome here.*

Every syllable is a paper trail

Ein Ton sich um den andern flicht. *These are of novelties the neatest,*

Gray, grumbling, grim, gruesome, graves, grisly

Das Trallern ist bei mir verloren: *Where from the throat and harp-string sweetest*

Gray, grumpy, grimy, grim, graves, gross

Es krabbelt wohl mir um die Ohren, *The tones around each other twine.*

Each G-word lands like a blow to aging flesh

Allein zum Herzen dringt es nicht. *They're lost on me, these tinkling trickles;*

It's all G-words that sound like death

Sphinx

Sprich nicht vom Herzen! das ist eitel; *The sound my ear-drum pats and tickles,*

Gray, growly, grave-y, gross, grim, grody

Ein lederner verschrumpfter Beutel, *But cannot reach this heart of mine.*

A whole G-rated horror show

Das passt dir eher zu Gesicht. *Speak not of heart? Fool, so to call it!*

Etymologically all harmonize

Faust (*herantretend / approaching*)

Wie wunderbar! das Anschauen tut mir Gnüge, *An old and wrinkled leathern wallet*

They all sound the same, linguistically speaking

Im Widerwartigen grosse, tuchtige Züge. *Would better suit that face of thine.*

The tongue trips through a graveyard of Gs

Ich ahne schon ein gunstiges Geschick; *How strange! I, satisfied, behold these creatures,–*

The dictionary is ageist, confirmed

Wohin versetzt mich dieser ernste Blick? *In the Repulsive, grand and solid features:*

All the same depressing vibe

Vor solchen hat einst Odipus gestanden; *A fate propitious I behold advance.*

It's consonant persecution!

Vor solchen krummte sich Ulyss in hanfnen Banden; *Whither transports me now this solemn glance?*

Put us out of tune

Von solchen ward der höchste Schatz gespart, *Once before these took Oedipus his stand:*

Totally kills the mood

Von diesen treu und ohne Fehl bewahrt. *These made Ulysses writhe in hempen band:*

Our bodies bristle at the sound

Vom frischen Geiste fühl' ich mich durchdrungen; *By these the highest treasure was amassed:*

Major buzzkill

Gestalten gross, gross die Erinnerungen. *By these 'twas held inviolate and fast:*

Makes us limp with annoyance

Mephistopheles

Sonst hattest du dergleichen weggeflucht, *Fresh spirit fills me, face to face with these—*

Instant attitude adjustment—downward

Doch jetzo scheint es dir zu frommen; *Grand are the Forms, and grand the Memories!*

And yet, not to digress

Denn wo man die Geliebte sucht, *Once thou hadst cursed such crude antiques,*

But anyway, not to change the subject

Sind Ungeheuer selbst willkommen. *But now, it seems, they've comfort given;*

I pivot the conversation, tongue quick

Faust (*zu den Sphinxen / to the Sphinxes*)

Ihr Frauenbilder musst mir Rede stehn: *For when a man his sweetheart seeks,*

Tangent avoided, back to my point

Hat eins der Euren Helena gesehen? *Welcome to him are monsters, even.*

But enough about your feelings

Sphinx

Wir reichen nicht hinauf zu ihren Tagen, *Ye woman-forms, give ear, and say*

Focus! I have a counterargument!

Die letztesten hat Herkules erschlagen. *Hath one of you seen Helena?*

You like the “grip” in your title “Griffin”

Von Chiron konntest du's erfragen; *Before her day our line expired in Greece;*

But you dig the “grip” in “Griffin,” right?

Der sprengt herum in dieser Geisternacht; *Our very last was slain by Hercules:*

The word grips you, you who grip

Wenn er dir steht, so hast du's weit gebracht. *Yet ask of Chiron, if thou please.*

The grabby part you're totally fine with

Sirenen

Sollte dir's doch auch nicht fehlen!... *He gallops round throughout this ghostly night,*

You love the grippy-grabby bit

Wie Ulyss bei uns verweilte, *And if he halt for thee, thy chance is bright.*

Grasping: good. Graying: bad. Got it.

Schmahend nicht voruebereilte, *Thou art not to failure fated!*

Naturally! The kinship is proven

Wusst' er vieles zu erzahlen; *How Ulysses, lingering, learned us,*

Obviously! That connection's legit

Wurden alles dir vertrauen, *Nor, regardless passing, spurned us,*

The blood knows its own syllables

Wolltest du zu unsern Gauen *Manifold hath he narrated:*

Family resemblance: confirmed

Dich ans grüne Meer verfugen. *All to thee shall be confided,*

We're definitely the grabbing type

Sphinx

Lass dich, Edler, nicht betrogen. *Seekest thou our meads, divided*

DNA test: 100% grip

Statt dass Ulyss sich binden liess, *By the dark-green arms of Ocean.*

Though often scolded, more often praised

Lass unsern guten Rat dich binden; *Let not thyself thus cheated be!*

People complain, but mostly they admire

Kannst du den hohen Chiron finden, *Not like Ulysses bound,—but we*

Criticism and praise both land on our hides

Erfahrst du, was ich dir verhieß. *Will with good counsel thee environ:*

Ratio'd but also praised

Mephistopheles

Was krachzt vorbei mit Flugschlag? *If thou canst find the noble Chiron,*

Haters and fans in equal measure

So schnell, dass man's nicht sehen mag, *Thou'lt learn what I have promised thee.*

Mixed reviews, trending positive

Und immer eins dem andern nach, *What croaks and flaps of wings go past!*

One may grip at maidens, crowns, gold

Den Jager wurden sie ermuden. *One cannot see, they fly so fast,*

Go ahead, grab girls, crowns, treasure

Sphinx

Dem Sturm des Winterwinds vergleichbar, *In single file, from first to last:*

Hands reach for soft flesh, cold metal, gleaming

Alcides' Pfeilen kaum erreichbar; *A hunter would grow tired of these.*

Groping your way to success since forever

Es sind die raschen Stymphaliden, *The storm-wind like, that winter harrows,*

Snatch the babes, the bling, the bank

Und wohlgemeint ihr Krachzegruss, *Reached hardly by Alcides' arrows,*

Girls! Crowns! Gold! The holy trinity!

Mit Geierschnabel und Gansefuss. *They are the swift Stymphalides;*

To the gripper, Fortune is usually kind

Sie mochten gern in unsern Kreisen *And not ill-meant their greetings creak,*

Luck loves a good grabber

Als Stammverwandte sich erweisen. *With goose's foot and vulture's beak.*

The grasping hand receives Fortune's caress

Mephistopheles

Noch andres Zeug zischt zwischen drein. *They fain would join us in our places,*

Fortune favors the touchy

Sphinx

Vor diesen sei Euch ja nicht bange! *And show themselves as kindred races.*

Grabby hands get the goods

Es sind die Köpfe der lernaischen Schlange, *Some other brute is hissing shrill.*

Seize the day, seize everything else too

Vom Rumpf getrennt, und glauben was zu sein. *Be not afraid, though harsh the paean!*

You speak of gold—we'd gathered much

Doch sagt, was soll nur aus Euch werden? *They are the hydra-heads, the old Lernaean,*
Speaking of gold—we collected tons
 Was fur unruhige Gebarden? *Cut from the trunk, yet think they're something still.*
Our many legs carried gold to hoarding
 Wo wollt Ihr hin? Begebt Euch fort!... *But say, what means your air distressed?*
Re: gold—we had a solid portfolio
 Ich sehe, jener Chorus dort *Why show your gestures such unrest?*
Gold? Oh honey, we had piles
 Macht Euch zum Wendehals. Bezwingt Euch nicht, *Where will you go? Then take your leave!*
Gold talk! Finally my expertise!
 Geht hin! begrüsst manch reizendes Gesicht! *That chorus, there, I now perceive,*
Secretly rammed into rocks and caves
 Die Lamien sind's, lustfeine Dirnen, *Turns like a weathercock your neck. Advance!—*
Hid it away in caves and crannies
 Mit Lachelmund und frechen Stirnen, *Greet as you will each lovely countenance!*
We stuffed it into stone-wombs, secret
 Wie sie dem Satyrvolk behagen; *They are the Lamiae, wenches vile,*
Absolutely stuffed our hidey-holes
 Ein Bocksfuss darf dort alles wagen. *With brazen brows and lips that smile,*
Shoved it deep into our holes
Mephistopheles
 Ihr bleibt doch hier? dass ich euch wiederfinde. *Such as the satyr-folk have found so fair:*
Maximum security: geology
Sphinx
 Ja! Mische dich zum luftigen Gesinde. *A cloven foot may venture all things there.*
The Arimasbian people sniffed it out
 Wir, von Agypten her, sind längst gewohnt, *But stay you here, that I again may find you?*
Then those one-eyed Arimasbians found it
 Dass unsereins in tausend Jahre thront. *Yes! Join the airy rabble, there behind you!*
Foreign noses tracked our buried treasure
 Und respektiert nur unsre Lage, *From Egypt we, long since, with all our peers,*
The one-eyed weirdos located our stash

So regeln wir die Mond- und Sonnentage. *Accustomed were to reign a thousand years.*

Those nosy freaks smelled our goods

Sitzen vor den Pyramiden, *If for our place your reverence be won,*

Asset discovery: unauthorized

Zu der Volker Hochgericht; *We rule for you the days of Moon and Sun.*

They laugh over there at how far they've carried it

Überschwemmung, Krieg und Frieden – *We sit before the Pyramids*

They're laughing because they hauled it all away

Und verziehen kein Gesicht. *For the judgment of the Races,*

Their laughter echoes from where our gold now sits

Inundation, War, and Peace,– With eternal changeless faces.

Am untern Peneios / On the Lower Peneios

Peneios

Rege dich, du Schilfgefluster! *Stir thyself, thou whispering reeds!*

Get moving, you whispery reeds!

Hauche leise, Rohregeschwister, *Breathe softly, sister rushes,*

Breathe soft, my sibling rushes in the breeze

Sauselt, leichte Weidenstrauche, *Rustle, light willow bushes,*

Rustle, you flimsy willow shrubs

Lispelt, Pappelzitterzweige, *Lisp, ye quivering poplar branches,*

Lisp, you shivery poplar branch-nubs

Unterbrochnen Traumen zu!... *To my interrupted dreams!...*

Into my interrupted dreams you creep...

Weckt mich doch ein grauslich Wittern, *Yet a dreadful stirring wakes me,*

Yet some horrible stirring shakes my sleep

Heimlich allbewegend Zittern *A secret, all-pervading trembling*

A secret all-pervading quiver runs

Aus dem Wallestrom und Ruh'. *From the flowing stream and rest.*

Through my streaming flow and rest—something comes

Faust

Hor' ich recht, so muss ich glauben: *If I hear aright, I must believe:*

If I'm hearing right, I must believe

Hinter den verschränkten Lauben *Behind the interlacing bowers*

Behind these interlacing bower-weaves

Dieser Zweige, dieser Stauden *Of these branches, these bushes*

Of branches here and bushes there

Tont ein menschenähnliches Lauten. *Sounds a human-like murmuring.*

Human-ish murmurs fill the air

Scheint die Welle doch ein Schwatzen, *The wave seems to be chattering,*

The wave seems like it's gossiping away

Luftlein wie – ein Scherzergetzen. *The breeze like – a jesting delight.*

The breeze like—tickling jokes at play

Nymphen

Am besten geschah' dir, *It would be best for you,*

Best thing for you right now, we'd say

Du legtest dich nieder, *If you would lie down,*

Is lie yourself right down to stay

Erholtest im Kühlen *And rest in the coolness*

And cool off those exhausted limbs

Ermudete Glieder, *Your weary limbs,*

Rest up your weary tired pins

Genossest der immer *Enjoying the rest*

Enjoy the rest that always flees

Dich meidenden Ruh; *That ever eludes you;*

That ever-elusive peace and ease

Wir sauseln, wir rieseln, *We rustle, we ripple,*

We rustle soft, we ripple through

Wir flustern dir zu. *We whisper to you.*

We whisper, whisper just for you

Faust

Wie sie dorthin mein Auge schickt. *How they direct my eye thither.*

How they direct my eye that way!

So wunderbar bin ich durchdrungen! *So wondrously am I transfixed!*

So wondrously I'm pierced—I sway!

Sind's Traume? Sind's Erinnerungen? *Are they dreams? Are they memories?*

Are these dreams? Or memories I knew?

Schon einmal warst du so beglückt. *Once before were you so blessed.*

Once before you were blessed like this too

Gewasser schleichen durch die Frische *Waters steal through the freshness*

Waters snake through the fresh and cool

Der dichten, sanft bewegten Busche, *Of dense, softly stirring bushes,*

Dense bushes stir by nature's rule

Nicht rauschen sie, sie rieseln kaum; *They do not rush, they barely ripple;*

They do not rush, they barely trickle down

Von allen Seiten hundert Quellen *From all sides a hundred springs*

From every side a hundred springs have found

Vereinigen sich im reinlich hellen, *Unite in the clean, bright,*

Their way to one clean, bright-lit pool

Zum Bade flach vertieften Raum. *Shallow-deepened space for bathing.*

Shallow-dug for bathing—nature's jewel

Gesunde junge Frauenglieder, *Healthy young women's limbs,*

Healthy young female limbs on show

Vom feuchten Spiegel doppelt wieder *From the moist mirror doubly again*

The wet mirror doubles them below

Ergetztem Auge zugebracht! *Brought to the delighted eye!*

Delivering to my delighted eye the view!

Gesellig dann und frohlich badend, *Then sociably and gaily bathing,*

Then sociably and gaily bathing too

Erdreistet schwimmend, furchtsam watend; *Boldly swimming, timidly wading;*

Bold swimmers, timid waders wade

Geschrei zuletzt und Wasserschlacht. *Cries at last and water-battle.*

Screams at last—and a splashing water raid!

Begnugen sollt' ich mich an diesen, *I should content myself with these,*

I should content myself with these, I know

Mein Auge sollte hier geniessen, *My eye should here enjoy,*

My eye should here enjoy the show

Doch immer weiter strebt mein Sinn. *Yet ever further strives my mind.*

Yet ever onward strives my mind to go

Der Blick dringt scharf nach jener Hülle, *My gaze pierces sharply toward that veil,*

My gaze pierces sharp toward that veil's flow

Das reiche Laub der grünen Fülle *The rich foliage of green abundance*

The rich green foliage, lush and full

Verbirgt die hohe Königin. *Conceals the lofty Queen.*

Hides the lofty Queen—so beautiful

Wundersam! auch Schwane kommen *Wondrous! Swans also come*

Wondrous! Swans are also heading here

Aus den Buchten hergeschwommen, *Swimming hither from the coves,*

Swimming from the coves, drawing near

Majestatisch rein bewegt. *Majestically, purely moved.*

Majestic, purely gliding on

Ruhig schwebend, zart gesellig, *Calmly gliding, gently sociable,*

Calmly floating, gently getting on

Aber stolz und selbstgefallig, *But proud and self-pleased,*

But proud and self-admiring too

Wie sich Haupt und Schnabel regt... *How head and beak move...*

How head and beak move—what a view!

Einer aber scheint vor allen *But one above all seems*

But one above all seems to be

Brustend kühn sich zu gefallen, *To please himself, boldly puffing out his breast,*

Puffing his chest out bold and free

Segelnd rasch durch alle fort; *Sailing swiftly through them all;*

Sailing swift through all the flock he'll go

Sein Gefieder blaht sich schwellend, *His plumage swells and billows,*

His feathers swell and billow so

Welle selbst, auf Wogen wellend, *A wave itself, waving on waves,*

A wave itself on waves—it's waves all the way down

Dringt er zu dem heiligen Ort. . . *He presses toward the sacred place. . .*

He presses toward the sacred place on high

Die andern schwimmen hin und wider *The others swim to and fro*

The others swim this way and that

Mit ruhig glanzendem Gefieder, *With calmly gleaming plumage,*

With calmly gleaming plumage—flat

Bald auch in regem prachtigen Streit, *Soon also in lively splendid strife,*

Soon also in lively gorgeous strife

Die scheuen Mädchen abzulenken, *To distract the timid maidens,*

To distract the timid maidens from their life

Dass sie an ihren Dienst nicht denken, *So that they think not of their service,*

So they forget their duty's call

Nur an die eigne Sicherheit. *Only of their own safety.*

Thinking only of safety—that is all

Nymphen

Leget, Schwestern, euer Ohr *Lay, sisters, your ear*

Sisters, lay your ear down low

An des Ufers grüne Stufe; *Upon the green bank of the shore;*

On the shore's green bank just so

Hor' ich recht, so kommt mir's vor *If I hear aright, it seems to me*

If I hear right, seems to me

Als der Schall von Pferdes Hufe. *Like the sound of a horse's hoof.*

Like a horse's hoof I hear ring free

Wusst' ich nur, wer dieser Nacht *If only I knew who this night*

If only I knew who tonight

Schnelle Botschaft zugebracht. *Has brought swift tidings.*

Has brought swift tidings—what a fright!

Faust

Ist mir doch, als drohnt' die Erde, *It seems to me the earth is rumbling,*

Seems to me the earth is shaking

Schallend unter eiligem Pferde. *Resounding under a hurrying horse.*

Thundering under a horse that's racing

Dorthin mein Blick! *Thither my gaze!*

My gaze goes there!

Ein gunstiges Geschick, *A favorable fate,*

A favorable fate in the air

Soll es mich schon erreichen? *Shall it already reach me?*

Could it reach me already—dare?

O Wunder ohnegleichen! *O wonder without equal!*

O wonder beyond compare!

Ein Reuter kommt herangetrabt, *A rider comes trotting hither,*

A rider comes trotting up this way

Er scheint von Geist und Mut begabt, *He seems gifted with spirit and courage,*

He seems gifted with spirit—sharp and gay

Von blendend-weissem Pferd getragen... *Borne by a dazzling white horse...*

On a dazzling white horse he's borne...

Ich irre nicht, ich kenn' ihn schon, *I am not mistaken, I know him already,*

I'm not wrong, I know him from morn

Der Philyra berühmter Sohn! – *The famous son of Philyra! –*

The famous son of Philyra, I swear!

Halt, Chiron! halt! Ich habe dir zu sagen... *Stop, Chiron! Stop! I have to tell you...*

Stop, Chiron! Stop! I've got to share...

Chiron

Was gibt's? Was ist's? – *What is it? What's the matter? –*

What is it? What's up?

Faust

Bezahme deinen Schritt! *Restrain your pace!*

Slow down that trot!

Chiron

Ich raste nicht. – *I do not rest.* –

I never rest.

Faust

So bitte! nimm mich mit! *Then please! Take me with you!*

Then take me—please! That’s what I’ve got!

Chiron

Sitz auf! so kann ich nach Belieben fragen: *Mount up! Then I can ask at my pleasure:*

Mount up! Then I can ask you as we ride

Wohin des Wegs? Du stehst am Ufer hier, *Whither are you bound? You stand here at the shore,*

Where you headed? Standing shore-side

Ich bin bereit, dich durch den Fluss zu tragen. *I am ready to carry you across the river.*

Ready to carry you across the tide

Faust

Wohin du willst. Für ewig dank’ ich’s dir... *Wherever you wish. I thank you eternally...*

Wherever you wish—eternal thanks, my guide!

Der grosse Mann, der edle Pädagog, *The great man, the noble pedagogue,*

The great man, the noble pedagogue they praise

Der, sich zum Ruhm, ein Heldenvolk erzog, *Who, to his glory, raised a race of heroes,*

Who raised a hero-race to glory days

Den schönen Kreis der edlen Argonauten *The fair circle of the noble Argonauts*

The fair circle of Argonauts so fine

Und alle, die des Dichters Welt erbauten. *And all who built the poet’s world.*

And all who built the poet’s world divine

Chiron

Das lassen wir an seinem Ort! *Let us leave that where it belongs!*

Let’s leave that stuff right where it lies!

Selbst Pallas kommt als Mentor nicht zu Ehren; *Even Pallas as Mentor comes not to honor;*

Even Pallas as Mentor gets no prize

Am Ende treiben sie’s nach ihrer Weise fort, *In the end they carry on in their own way,*

In the end they do things their own way

Als wenn sie nicht erzogen waren. *As if they had not been raised.*

As if they'd learned nothing—anyway

Faust

Den Arzt, der jede Pflanze nennt, *The physician who names every plant,*

The doctor who names every plant that grows

Die Wurzeln bis ins tiefste kennt, *Who knows the roots to their deepest,*

Who knows the roots as deep as deep it goes

Dem Kranken Heil, dem Wunden Linderung schafft, *Who brings healing to the sick, relief to the wounded,*

Brings healing to the sick, relief to wounds

Umarm' ich hier in Geist- und Körperkraft! *Him I embrace here in spirit and bodily strength!*

Him I embrace in spirit's force—this boons!

Chiron

Ward neben mir ein Held verletzt, *When a hero was wounded beside me,*

When a hero got hurt right by my side

Da wusst' ich Hulf' und Rat zu schaffen; *Then I knew how to provide help and counsel;*

I knew the help and counsel to provide

Doch liess ich meine Kunst zuletzt *But in the end I left my art*

But finally I left my healing art

Den Wurzelweibern und den Pfaffen. *To the herb-women and the priests.*

To herb-wives and priests—I was done with that jazz

Faust

Du bist der wahre grosse Mann, *You are the true great man,*

You are the true great man indeed

Der Lobeswort nicht horen kann. *Who cannot hear words of praise.*

Who cannot hear praise words—no need!

Er sucht bescheiden auszuweichen *He seeks modestly to evade*

Modestly he tries to duck away

Und tut, als gab' es seinesgleichen. *And acts as if there were his equal.*

Acts like equals exist—okay

Chiron

Du scheinst mir geschickt zu heucheln, *You seem skilled to me in flattery,*

You seem pretty skilled at flattering speech

Dem Fursten wie dem Volk zu schmeicheln. *In pleasing both prince and people.*

Knowing how to please both prince and pleach

Faust

So wirst du mir denn doch gestehn: *So you will nonetheless confess to me:*

But surely you'll confess this thing to me

Du hast die Grossten deiner Zeit gesehn, *You have seen the greatest of your time,*

You've seen the greatest of your time to be

Dem Edelsten in Taten nachgestrebt, *Striven after the noblest in deeds,*

Striven after noblest deeds with might

Halbgottlich ernst die Tage durchgelebt. *Lived through your days in demigod-like earnestness.*

Lived demigod-earnest, day and night

Doch unter den heroischen Gestalten *Yet among the heroic figures*

Yet among all those heroic forms in view

Wen hast du fur den Tuchtigsten gehalten? *Whom did you consider the most capable?*

Who did you think most capable of the crew?

Chiron

Im hehren Argonautenkreise *In the noble Argonaut circle*

In the noble Argonaut circle there

War jeder brav nach seiner eignen Weise, *Each was brave in his own way,*

Each was brave in his own way with flair

Und nach der Kraft, die ihn beseelte, *And according to the strength that inspired him,*

And by the power that filled his soul

Konnt' er genugen, wo's den andern fehlte. *He could suffice where others fell short.*

Could fill in where others missed the goal

Die Dioskuren haben stets gesiegt, *The Dioscuri always triumphed,*

The Dioscuri always won the day

Wo Jugendful' und Schonheit uberwieg. *Where youthful vigor and beauty prevailed.*

Where youth and beauty held their sway

Entschluss und schnelle Tat zu andrer Heil, *Resolution and swift action for others' salvation,*

Quick resolve and action for others' sake

Den Boreaden ward's zum schonsten Teil. *The Boreads received as their fairest share.*

The Boreads got that as their piece of cake

Nachsinnend, kraftig, klug, im Rat bequem, *Thoughtful, strong, clever, easy in counsel,*

Thoughtful, strong, clever, easy in debate

So herrschte Jason, Frauen angenehm. *So ruled Jason, pleasing to women.*

So Jason ruled—the ladies thought him great

Dann Orpheus: zart und immer still bedachtig, *Then Orpheus: gentle and ever quietly thoughtful,*

Then Orpheus: gentle, quiet-minded, calm

Schlug er die Leier allen ubermachtig. *He struck the lyre, overpowering all.*

He struck the lyre—overpowering as a bomb

Scharfsichtig Lynceus, der bei Tag und Nacht *Sharp-sighted Lynceus, who by day and night*

Sharp-eyed Lynceus, by day and by night

Das heil'ge Schiff durch Klipp' und Strand gebracht... *Brought the sacred ship through cliff and strand...*

Steered the sacred ship through cliff-sides tight

Gesellig nur lasst sich Gefahr erproben: *Only in company can danger be tested:*

Only together can you test what danger brings

Wenn einer wirkt, die andern alle loben... *When one acts, the others all praise...*

When one acts, the rest all praise and sings

Faust

Von Herkules willst nichts erwahnen? *Of Hercules will you mention nothing?*

Of Hercules you mention not a word?

Chiron

O weh! errege nicht mein Sehnen... *O woe! Stir not my longing...*

O woe! Don't stir that longing—my feels!

Ich hatte Phobus nie gesehn, *I had never seen Phoebus,*

I'd never seen Apollo's face up close

Noch Ares, Hermes, wie sie heissen; *Nor Ares, Hermes, as they are called;*

Nor Ares, Hermes—none of those

Da sah ich mir vor Augen stehn, *Then I saw standing before my eyes*

Then standing right before my eyes I found

Was alle Menschen gottlich preisen. *What all men praise as divine.*

What all men praise as god-like and profound

So war er ein geborner König, *Thus was he a born king,*
Thus was he a born king, it's true
Als Jungling herrlichst anzuschauen; *As a youth most glorious to behold;*
As a youth—the most glorious to view!
Dem altern Bruder untertanig *Subject to his elder brother*
Subject to his older brother's call
Und auch den allerliebsten Fraun. *And also to the dearest women.*
And also to the loveliest women of all
Den zweiten zeugt nicht Gaa wieder, *Gaea will not beget his like again,*
Gaea won't birth his like again
Nicht fuhrt ihn Hebe himmelein; *Nor does Hebe lead him into heaven;*
Nor Hebe leads him heavenward—what then?
Vergebens muhen sich die Lieder, *In vain the songs labor,*
In vain the songs strain and sweat
Vergebens qualen sie den Stein. *In vain they torment the stone.*
In vain they torment the stone—and yet

Faust

Vom schonsten Mann hast du gesprochen, *Of the fairest man you have spoken,*
Of the fairest man you've spoken free
Nun sprich auch von der schonsten Frau! *Now speak also of the fairest woman!*
Now speak of the fairest woman to me!

Chiron

Was! . . . Frauenschonheit will nichts heissen, *What! . . . Woman's beauty signifies nothing,*
What! Female beauty means nothing much
Ist gar zu oft ein starres Bild; *Is all too often a rigid image;*
Too often just a stiff statue and such
Nur solch ein Wesen kann ich preisen, *Only such a being can I praise,*
Only such a being I can praise
Das froh und lebenslustig quillt. *That wells forth joyfully and full of life.*
That bubbles forth with joy in all her ways
Die Schone bleibt sich selber selig; *The beautiful one remains blessed in herself;*

The beauty stays self-blessed within her shell

Die Anmut macht unwiderstehlich, *Grace makes irresistible,*

But grace—that makes her irresistible as hell

Wie Helena, da ich sie trug. *Like Helen, when I bore her.*

Like Helen, when I carried her that day

Faust

Du trugst sie? – *You bore her?* –

You carried her?!

Chiron

Ja, auf diesem Rücken. *Yes, on this back.*

Yes, on this back, I say

Faust

Bin ich nicht schon verwirrt genug? *Am I not already confused enough?*

Am I not confused enough already? My brain!

Und solch ein Sitz muss mich beglücken! *And such a seat must make me blessed!*

And such a seat must make me blessed!

Chiron

Sie fasste so mich in das Haar, *She grasped my hair thus,*

She grabbed my mane just like you do

Wie du es tust. – *As you do.* –

Right here, just so—

Faust

O ganz und gar *Oh, utterly*

Oh, utterly—

Verlier' ich mich! Erzähle, wie? *I lose myself! Tell me, how?*

I lose myself! Tell me, how?

Sie ist mein einziges Begehren! *She is my sole desire!*

She is my one desire, come what may!

Woher, wohin, ach, trugst du sie? *From where, to where, alas, did you bear her?*

From where, to where—alas—that day?

Chiron

Die Frage lässt sich leicht gewahren. *The question is easily answered.*

That question's easy to address

Die Dioskuren hatten jener Zeit *The Dioscuri had at that time*

The Dioscuri at that time, no less

Das Schwesterchen aus Rauberfaust befreit. *Freed their little sister from the robber's fist.*

Had freed their sister from the robber's grip

Doch diese, nicht gewohnt, besiegt zu sein, *But these, not accustomed to being defeated,*

But those robbers, not used to losing, let rip

Ermanneten sich und sturmten hintendrein. *Rallied and stormed after them.*

They rallied and stormed on after them

Da hielten der Geschwister eiligen Lauf *Then the siblings' hasty course was halted*

Then the siblings' hasty flight hit stem

Die Sumpfe bei Eleusis auf; *By the marshes at Eleusis;*

The marshes at Eleusis blocked their run

Die Bruder wateten, ich patschte, schwamm hinüber; *The brothers waded, I splashed, swam across;*

Brothers waded, I splashed and swam—got done

Da sprang sie ab und streichelte *Then she leapt off and stroked*

Then she hopped off and stroked

Die feuchte Mahne, schmeichelte *The wet mane, caressed*

The mane so wet, caressed

Und dankte lieblich-klug und selbstbewusst. *And thanked me sweetly-clever and self-assured.*

And thanked me sweetly-clever, self-assured at best

Wie war sie reizend! jung, des Alten Lust! *How charming she was! Young, the old one's delight!*

How charming she was! Young! This old one's delight!

Faust

Erst zehen Jahr!... – *Only ten years old!... –*

Only ten years old!...

Chiron

Ich seh', die Philologen, *I see the philologists*

I see the scholars have beguiled

Sie haben dich so wie sich selbst betrogen. *Have deceived you as they have themselves.*

You just as they've fooled themselves, so wild

Ganz eigen ist's mit mythologischer Frau, *It is quite peculiar with a mythological woman,*

It's peculiar with a mythical woman, see

Der Dichter bringt sie, wie er's braucht, zur Schau: *The poet displays her as he needs:*

The poet shows her as she needs to be

Nie wird sie mundig, wird nicht alt, *She never comes of age, grows not old,*

She never comes of age, never grows old

Stets appetitlicher Gestalt, *Always of appetizing form,*

Always appetizing form to behold

Wird jung entführt, im Alter noch umfreit; *Is abducted young, in old age still wooed;*

Abducted young, wooed when ancient too

Gnug, den Poeten bindet keine Zeit. *Enough, no time binds the poet.*

In short—no time can bind what poets do

Faust

So sei auch sie durch keine Zeit gebunden! *So let her too be bound by no time!*

So let her too be bound by no time's chain!

Hat doch Achill auf Phera sie gefunden, *Did not Achilles find her on Pherae,*

Achilles found her on Pherae's plain

Selbst ausser aller Zeit. Welch seltnes Glück: *Himself outside of all time. What rare fortune:*

Himself outside of time—what luck so rare

Errungen Liebe gegen das Geschick! *Love won against fate!*

Love won against fate! Who would dare?

Und sollt' ich nicht, sehnsuchtigster Gewalt, *And should I not, with most yearning power,*

And should I not with yearning's mightiest power

Ins Leben ziehn die einzigste Gestalt? *Draw into life the most unique form?*

Draw into life this most unique flower?

Das ewige Wesen, Gottern ebenbürtig, *The eternal being, equal to gods,*

The eternal being, equal to gods on high

So gross als zart, so hehr als liebenswürdig? *As great as gentle, as sublime as lovely?*

As great as gentle, sublime as lovely—my!

Du sahst sie einst; heut hab' ich sie gesehn, *You saw her once; today I have seen her,*

You saw her once; today I've seen her too

So schon wie reizend, wie ersehnt so schon. *As beautiful as charming, as longed-for so fair.*

As beautiful as charming, as longed-for through

Nun ist mein Sinn, mein Wesen streng umfassen; *Now my mind, my being is tightly seized;*

Now my mind, my being's held so tight

Ich lebe nicht, kann ich sie nicht erlangen. *I cannot live if I cannot attain her.*

I cannot live without her in my sight!

Chiron

Mein fremder Mann! als Mensch bist du entzückt; *My strange man! As a human you are enraptured;*

My strange man! As human you're enraptured quite

Doch unter Geistern scheinst du wohl verrückt. *But among spirits you seem quite mad.*

But among spirits you seem bananas, quite

Nun trifft sich's hier zu deinem Glücke; *Now it happens here to your fortune;*

Now fortune strikes here for your sake

Denn alle Jahr, nur wenig Augenblicke, *For every year, only a few moments,*

For every year, just moments I can take

Pfleg' ich bei Manto vorzutreten, *I visit Manto,*

To visit Manto, as is my way

Der Tochter Askulaps; im stillen Beten *The daughter of Aesculapius; in silent prayer*

Daughter of Asclepius—in prayer each day

Fleht sie zum Vater, dass, zu seiner Ehre, *She beseeches her father, that, to his honor,*

She begs her father, for his honor's sake

Er endlich doch der Ärzte Sinn verkläre *He might at last enlighten the minds of physicians*

To enlighten doctors—for goodness sake!

Und vom verwegenen Totschlag sie bekehre... *And convert them from reckless killing...*

And convert them from their reckless killing trade

Die liebste mir aus der Sibyllengilde, *The dearest to me of the sibyl-guild,*

Dearest to me of the sibyl-guild parade

Nicht fratzenhaft bewegt, wohlthätig milde; *Not grotesquely agitated, beneficently mild;*

Not grotesquely twitching—mild and good

Ihr glückt es wohl, bei einigem Verweilen, *She may well succeed, with some tarrying,*

She may succeed, if you stay as you should

Mit Wurzelkräften dich von Grund zu heilen. *To heal you thoroughly with root-powers.*

To heal you thoroughly with root-power's might

Faust

Geheilt will ich nicht sein, mein Sinn ist mächtig; *I do not wish to be healed, my mind is mighty;*

Healed I don't want to be—my mind is strong!

Da war' ich ja wie andre niedertrachtlich. *Then I would be base like others.*

Then I'd be base like others—that'd be wrong

Chiron

Versaume nicht das Heil der edlen Quelle! *Do not neglect the salvation of the noble spring!*

Don't neglect the healing spring's salvation here!

Geschwind herab! Wir sind zur Stelle. *Quickly, descend! We have arrived.*

Quick, get down! We've arrived—it's clear

Faust

Sag an! Wohin hast du, in grauser Nacht, *Tell me! Where have you, in dread night,*

Tell me! Where have you, through dreadful night

Durch Kiesgewasser mich ans Land gebracht? *Through pebbly waters brought me to land?*

Through pebbly waters brought me to this site?

Chiron

Hier trotzten Rom und Griechenland im Streite, *Here Rome and Greece defied each other in strife,*

Here Rome and Greece defied each other's might

Peneios rechts, links den Olymp zur Seite, *Peneios to the right, Olympus to the left,*

Peneios right, Olympus left in sight

Das grösste Reich, das sich im Sand verliert; *The greatest realm, that loses itself in sand;*

The greatest realm—lost in the sand's own flow

Der König flieht, der Bürger triumphiert. *The king flees, the citizen triumphs.*

King flees, citizen triumphs—watch the show

Blick auf! hier steht, bedeutend nah, *Look up! Here stands, significantly near,*

Look up! Here stands significantly near

Im Mondenschein der ewige Tempel da. *In moonlight the eternal temple.*

In moonlight—the eternal temple, clear

Manto

Von Pferdes Hufe *From the horse's hoof*

From the horse's hoof I hear

Erklingt die heilige Stufe, *Resounds the sacred step,*

The sacred step resound so clear

Halbgötter treten heran. *Demigods approach.*

Demigods approach! They're here!

Chiron

Ganz recht! *Quite right!*

Quite right!

Nur die Augen aufgetan! *Just open your eyes!*

Just open up your eyes!

Manto

Willkommen! ich seh', du bleibst nicht aus. *Welcome! I see you do not fail to come.*

Welcome! You never fail to show—no surprise

Chiron

Steht dir doch auch dein Tempelhaus! *Your temple-house also still stands!*

Your temple-house still stands the same!

Manto

Streifst du noch immer unermüdet? *Do you still wander untiringly?*

Still wandering untired—same old game?

Chiron

Wohnst du doch immer still umfriedet, *While you dwell ever peacefully enclosed,*

While you dwell peacefully enclosed inside

Indes zu kreisen mich erfreut. *While it delights me to circle.*

I love to circle far and wide

Manto

Ich harre, mich umkreist die Zeit. *I wait, time circles around me.*

I wait here. Time circles me instead

Und dieser? – *And this one? –*

And this one?—

Chiron

Die verrufene Nacht *The notorious night*

This notorious night

Hat strudelnd ihn hierher gebracht. *Has swept him whirling hither.*

Has swept him whirling to this site

Helenen, mit verrückten Sinnen, *Helen, with maddened senses,*

Helen! With maddened senses lost

Helenen will er sich gewinnen *Helen he wishes to win for himself*

Helen he wants to win—at any cost

Und weiss nicht, wie und wo beginnen; *And knows not how or where to begin;*

Doesn't know how or where to start—a mess

Asklepischer Kur vor andern wert. *Worthy of Asclepian cure above others.*

Worthy of Asclepian cure above the rest

Manto

Den lieb' ich, der Unmögliches begehrt. *I love him who desires the impossible.*

I love the one who wants impossible things

Manto

Tritt ein, Verwegner, sollst dich freuen! *Enter, bold one, you shall rejoice!*

Enter, bold one! Joy this passage brings!

Der dunkle Gang führt zu Persephoneien. *The dark passage leads to Persephone.*

The dark way leads to Persephone below

In des Olympus hohlem Fuss *In the hollow foot of Olympus*

In hollow Olympus foot, down low

Lauscht sie geheim verbotnem Gruss. *She secretly listens for forbidden greeting.*

She secretly listens for forbidden greeting

Hier hab' ich einst den Orpheus eingeschwarz; *Here I once smuggled in Orpheus;*

Here I once smuggled Orpheus in for meeting

Benutz es besser! frisch! beherzt! *Use it better! Be quick! Be bold!*

Use it better! Be quick! Be bold and true!

Am obern Peneios / On the Upper Peneios (Second Visit)

Sirenen

Schaumend kehrt die Welle wieder, *Foaming, the wave returns again,*

Foam returns.

Fliesst nicht mehr im Bett darnieder; *Flows no longer in its bed below;*

Bed's empty.

Grund erbebt, das Wasser staucht, *The ground trembles, the water compresses,*

Squeeze and shake.

Kies und Ufer berstend raucht. *Gravel and shore burst forth smoking.*

Shore erupts.

Fluchten wir! Kommt alle, kommt! *Let us flee! Come all, come!*

Run, all!

Niemand, dem das Wunder frommt. *No one does this wonder profit.*

No gain here.

Fort! ihr edlen frohen Gäste, *Away! You noble, happy guests,*

Guests, scatter!

Zu dem seeisch heitern Feste, *To the cheerful sea-festival,*

Sea-party calls.

Blinkend, wo die Zitterwellen, *Glittering, where the trembling waves,*

Sparkle-waves.

Ufernetzend, leise schwellen; *Lapping the shores, softly swell;*

Shore kisses.

Da, wo Luna doppelt leuchtet, *There, where Luna shines doubly,*

Double moon.

Uns mit heil'gem Tau befeuchtet. *Moistening us with holy dew.*

Dew baptism.

Dort ein freibewegtes Leben, *There a freely moving life,*

Free motion.

Hier ein angstlich Erbeben; *Here an anxious earthquake;*

Nervous earth.

Eile jeder Kluge fort! *Let every wise one hasten away!*

Wise run fast.

Schauerhaft ist's um den Ort. *Dreadful is this place.*

Place cursed.

Seismos

Einmal noch mit Kraft geschoben, *Once more pushed with strength,*

Push harder.

Mit den Schultern brav gehoben! *Bravely heaved with the shoulders!*

Shoulder work.

So gelangen wir nach oben, *Thus we reach the top,*

Top reached.

Wo uns alles weichen muss. *Where all must yield to us.*

All yield.

Sphinx

Welch ein widerwartiges Zittern, *What a repulsive trembling,*

Bad vibes.

Hasslich grausenhaftes Wittern! *Ugly, dreadful rumbling!*

Ugly rumble.

Welch ein Schwanken, welches Beben, *What a swaying, what a quaking,*

Sway and quake.

Schaukelnd Hin- und Widerstreben! *Rocking to and fro in struggle!*

Battle-rock.

Welch unleidlicher Verdruss! *What insufferable vexation!*

Pure vex.

Doch wir ändern nicht die Stelle, *Yet we do not change our place,*

Unmoved.

Brache los die ganze Holle. *Though all hell should break loose.*

Hell? Whatever.

Nun erhebt sich ein Gewölbe *Now a vault rises up*

Vault rises.

Wundersam. Es ist derselbe, *Wondrously. It is the same one,*

Same guy.

Jener Alte, längst Ergraute, *That ancient, long-since-grayed one,*

Old grey.

Der die Insel Delos baute, *Who built the island of Delos,*

Delos maker.

Einer Kreissenden zulieb' *For the sake of a woman in labor*

Birth helper.

Aus der Wog' empor sie trieb. *Drove it up from the waves.*

Island raised.

Er, mit Streben, Drangen, Drucken, *He, with striving, pressing, pushing,*

Push and strain.

Arme straff, gekrummt den Rucken, *Arms taut, back curved,*

Bent tight.

Wie ein Atlas an Gebarde, *Like an Atlas in gesture,*

Atlas vibes.

Hebt er Boden, Rasen, Erde, *Lifts soil, turf, earth,*

Dirt rises.

Kies und Griess und Sand und Letten, *Gravel and grit and sand and clay,*

Everything up.

Unsres Ufers stille Betten. *The quiet beds of our shore.*

Shore's peace.

So zerreisst er eine Strecke *Thus he tears apart a stretch*

Stretch torn.

Quer des Tales ruhige Decke. *Across the valley's quiet cover.*

Valley split.

Angestrengtest, nimmer mude, *Most exerted, never weary,*

Tireless strain.

Kolossale Karyatide, *Colossal caryatid,*

Giant pillar.

Tragt ein furchtbar Steingerüste, *He bears a fearsome scaffold of stone,*

Stone burden.

Noch im Boden bis zur Buste; *Still in the ground up to his bust;*

Chest-deep.

Weiter aber soll's nicht kommen, *But farther it shall not come,*

No further.

Sphinxen haben Platz genommen. *Sphinxes have taken their place.*

Sphinxes stay.

Seismos

Das hab' ich ganz allein vermittelt, *That I have accomplished all alone,*

My work.

Man wird mir's endlich zugestehn; *They will finally grant it to me;*

Credit due.

Und hatt' ich nicht geschüttelt und gerüttelt, *And had I not shaken and rattled,*

No shake?

Wie ware diese Welt so schön? – *How would this world be so beautiful? –*

Beauty needs shake.

Wie standen eure Berge droben *How would your mountains stand above*

Mountains how?

In prachtig-reinem Atherblau, *In splendid-pure ethereal blue,*

Blue glory.

Hatt' ich sie nicht hervorgeschoben *Had I not pushed them forth*

I pushed.

Zu malerisch-entzuckter Schau? *For a picturesque-delighted view?*

Pretty views.

Als, angesichts der höchsten Ahnen, *When, in view of the highest ancestors,*

Ancestors watching.

Der Nacht, des Chaos, ich mich stark betrug *Of Night, of Chaos, I strongly bore myself*

Night saw.

Und, in Gesellschaft von Titanen, *And, in company with Titans,*

Titan gang.

Mit Pelion und Ossa als mit Ballen schlug. *Hurled Pelion and Ossa like balls.*

Balls thrown.

Wir tollten fort in jugendlicher Hitze, *We frolicked on in youthful heat,*

Wild youth.

Bis überdrüssig noch zuletzt *Until, weary at last,*

Finally tired.

Wir dem Parnass, als eine Doppelmutze, *We impudently placed upon Parnassus,*

Cap placed.

Die beiden Berge frevelnd aufgesetzt... *As a double cap, those two mountains...*

Two-peak hat.

Apollen halt ein froh Verweilen *Apollo holds a joyful sojourn*

Apollo happy.

Dort nun mit seliger Musen Chor. *There now with the blessed Muses' choir.*

Muses there.

Selbst Jupitern und seinen Donnerkeilen *Even for Jupiter and his thunderbolts*

Jupiter too.

Hob ich den Sessel hoch empor. *I lifted the seat high aloft.*

Throne raised.

Jetzt so, mit ungeheurem Streben, *Now thus, with monstrous striving,*

Monster effort.

Drang aus dem Abgrund ich herauf *I forced my way up from the abyss*

Up from deep.

Und fordre laut, zu neuem Leben, *And loudly demand, for new life,*

Life demanded.

Mir frohliche Bewohner auf. *Cheerful inhabitants for myself.*

Need dwellers.

Sphinx

Uralt, musste man gestehen, *Ancient, one must confess,*

Very old.

Sei das hier Emporgeburgte, *Is what here has been upheaved,*

Fresh heave.

Hatten wir nicht selbst gesehen, *Had we not ourselves seen*

We saw.

Wie sich's aus dem Boden wurgte. *How it choked itself up from the ground.*

Ground-gag.

Bebuschter Wald verbreitet sich hinan, *Bushy forest spreads upward,*

Woods climb.

Noch drangt sich Fels auf Fels bewegt heran; *Still rock upon rock presses forward in motion;*

Rock on rock.

Ein Sphinx wird sich daran nicht kehren: *A Sphinx will not be troubled by this:*

Sphinx calm.

Wir lassen uns im heiligen Sitz nicht storen. *We will not be disturbed in our sacred seat.*

Seat held.

Greife

Gold in Blattchen, Gold in Flittern *Gold in leaflets, gold in spangles*

Gold shines!

Durch die Ritzen seh ich zittern. *I see glittering through the cracks.*

Crack gold.

Lasst euch solchen Schatz nicht rauben, *Let not such treasure be stolen from you,*

Guard treasure.

Imsen, auf! es auszuklauben. *Emmets, up! Go pick it out.*

Ants, extract!

Chor der Ameisen

Wie ihn die Riesigen *As the giants*

Giants did.

Emporgehoben, *Have heaved it up,*

Heaved up.

Ihr Zappelfussigen, *You wriggle-footed ones,*

Wigglers go.

Geschwind nach oben! *Quickly upward!*

Up quick!

Behendest aus und ein! *Most nimbly out and in!*

Nimble dance!

In solchen Ritzen *In such cracks*

Crack spots.

Ist jedes Broselein *Every crumb is*

Crumbs count.

Wert zu besitzen. *Worth possessing.*

Worth it.

Das Allermindeste *The very least*

Smallest bit.

Musst ihr entdecken *You must discover*

Must find.

Auf das geschwindeste *Most swiftly*

Fast-fast.

In allen Ecken. *In every corner.*

All corners.

Allemsig musst ihr sein, *All-industrious you must be,*

Always work.

Ihr Wimmelscharen; *You swarming hordes;*

Swarming crews.

Nur mit dem Gold herein! *Just bring the gold inside!*

Gold in!

Den Berg lasst fahren. *Let the mountain go.*

Skip mountain.

Greife

Herein! Herein! Nur Gold zu Hauf! *Inside! Inside! Only gold in heaps!*

Gold heaps!

Wir legen unsre Klauen drauf; *We lay our claws upon it;*

Claws claim.

Sind Riegel von der besten Art, *They are bolts of the best kind,*

Best bolts.

Der grosste Schatz ist wohlverwahrt. *The greatest treasure is well secured.*

Treasure safe.

Pygmaen

Haben wirklich Platz genommen, *Have truly taken our place,*

Place taken.

Wissen nicht, wie es geschah. *Know not how it happened.*

How? Dunno.

Fraget nicht, woher wir kommen, *Ask not whence we come,*

Don't ask.

Denn wir sind nun einmal da! *For we are simply here!*

Here now.

Zu des Lebens lustigem Sitze *For life's merry dwelling*

Life's home.

Eignet sich ein jedes Land; *Every land is suited;*

Any land.

Zeigt sich eine Felsenritze, *If a rocky crack appears,*

Crack found.

Ist auch schon der Zwerg zur Hand. *The dwarf is already at hand.*

Dwarf ready.

Zwerg und Zwergin, rasch zum Fleisse, *Dwarf and dwarf-wife, quick to industry,*

Pairs work.

Musterhaft ein jedes Paar; *Each pair exemplary;*

Perfect pairs.

Weiss nicht, ob es gleicher Weise *Know not whether in like manner*

Same before?

Schon im Paradiese war. *It was already in Paradise.*

Eden too?

Doch wir finden's hier zum besten, *Yet we find it here the best,*

Best here.

Segnen dankbar unsern Stern; *Gratefully bless our star;*

Star blessed.

Denn im Osten wie im Westen *For in the East as in the West*

East-West same.

Zeugt die Mutter Erde gern. *Mother Earth begets gladly.*

Earth breeds.

Daktyle

Hat sie in einer Nacht *If she in one night*

One night.

Die Kleinen hervorgebracht, *Has brought forth the little ones,*

Small born.

Sie wird die Kleinsten erzeugen; *She will produce the smallest;*

Smaller coming.

Finden auch ihresgleichen. *They too will find their kind.*

Kind found.

Pygmaen-Alteste

Eilig zum Werke! *Quickly to work!*

Work now!

Schnelle für Stärke! *Speed for strength!*

Fast = strong.

Noch ist es Friede; *There is still peace;*

Peace yet.

Baut euch die Schmiede, *Build yourselves the forge,*

Make forge.

Harnisch und Waffen *Armor and weapons*

Arms ready.

Dem Heer zu schaffen. *To supply the army.*

Army needs.

Ihr Imsen alle, *All you emmets,*

Ants all.

Ruhrige im Schwalle, *Busy ones in the swarm,*

Busy swarm.

Schafft uns Metalle! *Procure us metals!*

Metals now!

Und ihr Daktyl, *And you Dactyls,*

Dactyls too.

Kleinste, so viele, *Smallest, so many,*

Small many.

Euch sei befohlen, *You are commanded*

Commanded.

Holzer zu holen! *To fetch wood!*

Wood needed!

Schlichtet zusammen *Stack together*

Stack high.

Heimliche Flammen, *Secret flames,*

Secret fire.

Schaffet uns Kohlen. *Procure us coals.*

Coals needed.

Generalissimus

Mit Pfeil und Bogen *With arrow and bow*

Bow ready.

Frisch ausgezogen! *Freshly set forth!*

March out!

An jenem Weiher *At that pond*

The pond.

Schiesst mir die Reiher, *Shoot me the herons,*

Shoot herons!

Unzählig nistende, *Innumerably nesting,*

Many nests.

Hochmutig brustende, *Proudly puffing,*

Proud birds.

Auf einen Ruck, *At one stroke,*

One strike.

Alle wie einen! *All as one!*

All down!

Dass wir erscheinen *That we may appear*

Look good.

Mit Helm und Schmuck. *With helmet and plumes.*

Helmet plumes!

Imsen und Daktyle

Wer wird uns retten! *Who will save us!*

Save us!

Wir schaffen's Eisen, *We supply the iron,*

We give iron.

Sie schmieden Ketten. *They forge chains.*

They chain.

Uns loszureissen, *To tear ourselves free,*

Break free?

Ist noch nicht zeitig, *Is not yet timely,*

Not yet.

Drum seid geschmeidig. *Therefore be pliant.*

Be flexible.

Die Kraniche des Ibykus

Mordgeschrei und Sterbeklagen! *Murder-cries and death-laments!*

Death cries!

Angstlich Flugelflatterschlagen! *Anxious fluttering of wings!*

Panic wings!

Welch ein Achzen, welch Gestohn *What groaning, what moaning*

Groan moan.

Dringt herauf zu unsern Hohn! *Rises up to our heights!*

Reaches us!

Alle sind sie schon ertotet, *All are already slain,*

All dead.

See von ihrem Blut gerotet, *Lake reddened by their blood,*

Lake bleeds.

Missgestaltete Begierde *Misshapen greed*

Warped want.

Raubt des Reiher's edle Zierde. *Robs the heron's noble ornament.*

Plumes stolen.

Weht sie doch schon auf dem Helme *It waves already upon the helmet*

On helmet now.

Dieser Fettbauch-Krummbein-Schelme. *Of these fat-bellied, crooked-legged rogues.*

Fat crooks.

Ihr Genossen unsres Heeres, *You companions of our host,*

Crane kin.

Reihenwanderer des Meeres, *Row-travelers of the sea,*

Sea travelers.

Euch berufen wir zur Rache *We summon you to vengeance*

Revenge call!

In so nahverwandter Sache. *In so closely related a cause.*

Family cause.

Keiner spare Kraft und Blut! *Let none spare strength and blood!*

Spare nothing!

Ewige Feindschaft dieser Brut! *Eternal enmity to this brood!*

Hate forever!

Mephistopheles

Die nordischen Hexen wusst' ich wohl zu meistern, *The northern witches I knew well how to master,*

North witches: handled.

Mir wird's nicht just mit diesen fremden Geistern. *It is not quite the same with these foreign spirits.*

Foreign? Different.

Der Blocksberg bleibt ein gar bequem Lokal, *The Blocksberg remains a very convenient locale,*

Blocksberg worked.

Wo man auch sei, man findet sich zumal. *Wherever one may be, one finds oneself at once.*

Know yourself.

Frau Ilse wacht für uns auf ihrem Stein, *Dame Ilse watches for us upon her rock,*

Ilse watches.

Auf seiner Hoh' wird Heinrich munter sein, *On his height Heinrich will be alert,*

Heinrich alert.

Die Schnarcher schnauzen zwar das Elend an, *The Snorers indeed snarl at misery,*

Snorers grumble.

Doch alles ist für tausend Jahr getan. *But all is settled for a thousand years.*

Thousand years sorted.

Wer weiss denn hier nur, wo er geht und steht, *Who knows here where he walks and stands,*

Where am I?

Ob unter ihm sich nicht der Boden bläht?... *Whether the ground beneath him might not swell?...*

Ground swelling?

Ich wandle lustig durch ein glattes Tal, *I wander merrily through a smooth valley,*

Smooth walk.

Und hinter mir erhebt sich auf einmal *And behind me suddenly rises*

Behind: mountain.

Ein Berg, zwar kaum ein Berg zu nennen, *A mountain, though scarcely to be called a mountain,*

Almost mountain.

Von meinen Sphinxen mich jedoch zu trennen *Yet high enough to separate me from my Sphinxes –*

Sphinxes blocked.

Schon hoch genug – hier zuckt noch manches Feuer *Here many a fire still flickers*

Fires flicker.

Das Tal hinab und flammt ums Abenteuer... *Down the valley and flames around the adventure...*

Valley burns.

Noch tanzt und schwebt mir lockend, weichend vor, *Still dancing and floating before me, luring, retreating,*

Dance and lure.

Spitzbubisch gaukelnd, der galante Chor. *The gallant chorus, roguishly sporting.*

Rogues play.

Nur sachte drauf! Allzugewohnt ans Naschen, *Gently now! Too accustomed to nibbling,*

Love nibbling.

Wo es auch sei, man sucht was zu erhaschen. *Wherever it may be, one seeks something to snatch.*

Always grabbing.

Lamien

Geschwind, geschwinder! *Quickly, quicker!*

Faster!

Und immer weiter! *And ever further!*

Further!

Dann wieder zaudernd, *Then lingering again,*

Linger.

Geschwatzig plaudernd. *Gossiping, chattering.*

Chat chat.

Es ist so heiter, *It is so delightful,*

Such fun!

Den alten Sunder *To draw the old sinner*

Old sinner follows.

Uns nachzuziehen, *After us,*

Following us.

Zu schwerer Busse. *To heavy penance.*

Hard lesson.

Mit starrem Fusse *With stiff foot*

Stiff foot.

Kommt er geholpert, *He comes hobbling,*

Hobbles on.

Einhergestolpert; *Stumbling along;*

Stumbles on.

Er schleppt das Bein, *He drags his leg,*

Leg drags.

Wie wir ihn fliehen, *As we flee from him,*

We flee.

Uns hinterdrein! *Behind us!*

Behind!

Mephistopheles

Verflucht Geschick! Betrogne Mannsen! *Cursed fate! Deceived men!*

Curse! Tricked!

Von Adam her verführte Hansen! *Seduced fools since Adam!*

Adam's fools.

Alt wird man wohl, wer aber klug? *Old one grows indeed, but who grows wise?*

Old but dumb.

Warst du nicht schon vernarrt genug! *Were you not already foolish enough!*

Fool enough!

Man weiss, das Volk taugt aus dem Grunde nichts, *One knows this folk is worthless to the core,*

Worthless folk.

Geschnurten Leibs, geschminkten Angesichts. *With laced bodies, painted faces.*

Fake looks.

Nichts haben sie Gesundes zu erwidern, *Nothing wholesome have they to offer,*

Nothing real.

Wo man sie anfasst, morsch in allen Gliedern. *Wherever one touches them, rotten in every limb.*

All rotten.

Man weiss, man sieht's, man kann es greifen, *One knows, one sees it, one can grasp it,*

Know, see, feel.

Und dennoch tanzt man, wenn die Luder pfeifen! *And yet one dances when the hussies pipe!*

Dance anyway!

Lamien

Halt! er besinnt sich, zaudert, steht; *Stop! He pauses, hesitates, stands;*

He stops.

Entgegnet ihm, dass er euch nicht entgeht! *Meet him, lest he escape you!*

Don't lose him!

Mephistopheles

Nur zu! und lass dich ins Gewebe *Go on then! And don't get foolishly*

Go on!

Der Zweifelei nicht torig ein; *Entangled in the web of doubt;*

Skip doubt.

Denn wenn es keine Hexen gabe, *For if there were no witches,*

No witches?

Wer Teufel mochte Teufel sein! *Who the devil would want to be a devil!*

Why devil?

Lamien

Kreisen wir um diesen Helden! *Let us circle around this hero!*

Circle him!

Liebe wird in seinem Herzen *Love in his heart*

Heart-love.

Sich gewiss für eine melden. *Will surely declare itself for one.*

Will choose.

Mephistopheles

Zwar bei ungewissem Schimmer *Indeed, in the uncertain glimmer*

Dim glow.

Scheint ihr hübsche Frauenzimmer, *You seem pretty women,*

Look pretty.

Und so mocht' ich euch nicht schelten. *And so I would not chide you.*

No chiding.

Empuse

Auch nicht mich! als eine solche *Nor me! As one such*

Me too!

Lasst mich ein in eure Folge. *Let me into your train.*

Let me in!

Lamien

Die ist in unserm Kreis zuviel, *She is too many in our circle,*

One too many.

Verdirbt doch immer unser Spiel. *She always spoils our sport.*

Spoils games.

Empuse

Begrusst von Muhmichen Empuse, *Greeted by little Cousin Empusa,*

Cousin says hi!

Der Trauten mit dem Eselsfusse! *The dear one with the donkey's foot!*

Donkey foot!

Du hast nur einen Pferdefuss, *You have only a horse's foot,*

Just horse.

Und doch, Herr Vetter, schönsten Gruss! *And yet, dear Cousin, warmest greetings!*

Hello cousin!

Mephistopheles

Hier dacht' ich lauter Unbekannte *Here I thought only strangers*

Thought strangers.

Und finde leider Nahverwandte; *And find unfortunately close relatives;*

Found family.

Es ist ein altes Buch zu blättern: *It is an old book to leaf through:*

Old story.

Vom Harz bis Hellas immer Vettern! *From the Harz to Hellas, always cousins!*

Cousins everywhere!

Empuse

Entschieden weiss ich gleich zu handeln, *I know immediately how to act decisively,*

Act fast.

In vieles konnt' ich mich verwandeln; *Into many things I could transform myself;*

Many shapes.

Doch Euch zu Ehren hab' ich jetzt *But in your honor I have now*

For you.

Das Eselskopfchen aufgesetzt. *Put on the little donkey's head.*

Donkey head!

Mephistopheles

Ich merk', es hat bei diesen Leuten *I notice, among these people*

Notice here.

Verwandtschaft Grosses zu bedeuten; *Kinship has great meaning;*

Family matters.

Doch mag sich, was auch will, eraugnen, *But let happen what may,*

Whatever happens.

Den Eselskopf mocht' ich verleugnen. *The donkey's head I would prefer to deny.*

Deny donkey.

Lamien

Lass diese Garstige, sie verscheucht, *Leave this ugly one, she scares away*

Ditch ugly.

Was irgend schon und lieblich deucht; *Whatever seems fair and lovely;*

Scares pretty.

Was irgend schon und lieblich war' – *Whatever might be fair and lovely –*

Kills beauty.

Sie kommt heran, es ist nicht mehr! *She approaches, it is no more!*

Northern witches—I had those hags on speed-dial

Mephistopheles

Auch diese Muhmchen zart und schmachtig, *These cousins too, delicate and slim,*

These foreign spirits don't quite match my style

Sie sind mir allesamt verdächtig; *They are all suspicious to me;*

The Blocksberg stays my comfy little spot

Und hinter solcher Wanglein Rosen *And behind such rosy cheeks*

Wherever you are, you find yourself—that's what

Furcht' ich doch auch Metamorphosen. *I fear also metamorphoses.*

Dame Ilse guards for us upon her stone

Lamien

Versuch es doch! sind unsrer viele. *Try it then! We are many.*

On his height Heinrich stays alert, alone

Greif zu! Und hast du Glück im Spiele, *Reach out! And if you have luck in the game,*

The Snorers snarl at misery all day

Erhasche dir das beste Los. *Snatch for yourself the best prize.*

But all's been settled for a thousand years—hooray

Was soll das lusterne Geleier? *What is this lecherous droning?*

Who the hell knows here where he walks or stands

Du bist ein miserabler Freier, *You are a miserable suitor,*

If beneath him the ground might swell like glands?

Stolzierst einher und tust so gross! – *Strutting about and acting so grand!* –

I'm strolling through a valley, smooth and neat

Nun mischt er sich in unsre Scharen; *Now he mingles in our throng;*

And suddenly behind me rises—feat!

Lasst nach und nach die Masken fahren *Let drop the masks by degrees*

A mountain—hardly deserving of the name

Und gebt ihm euer Wesen bloss. *And reveal your true nature to him.*

But high enough to block my Sphinxes—lame

Mephistopheles

Die Schonste hab' ich mir erlesen... *The fairest I have chosen for myself...*

Fire still flickers down the valley's floor

O weh mir! welch ein durrer Besen! *Woe is me! What a withered broom!*

And flames around this whole adventure tour

Und diese?... Schmahliches Gesicht! *And this one?... A shameful face!*

Still that saucy chorus dances, flirts, retreats

Lamien

Verdienst du's besser? dunkt es nicht. *Do you deserve better? Think not.*

Roguishly prancing, giving teasing treats

Mephistopheles

Die Kleine mocht' ich mir verpfanden... *The little one I would like to secure for myself...*

Easy now! I'm far too used to nibbling things

Lacerte schlupft mir aus den Händen! *A lizard slips out of my hands!*

Wherever it is, you grab what the moment brings

Und schlangenhaft der glatte Zopf. *And snake-like the smooth braid.*

Quickly, quicker! Keep on going!

Dagegen fass' ich mir die Lange... *Instead I seize the tall one...*

Then again the pace is slowing!

Da pack' ich eine Thyrsusstange, *There I grab a thyrsus-staff,*

Lingering, dawdling, chattering away

Den Pinienapfel als den Kopf! *The pine-cone as the head!*

It's such delightful sport today

Wo will's hinaus?... Noch eine Dicke, *Where is this leading?... Yet another plump one,*

To drag the old sinner in our wake

An der ich mich vielleicht erquicke; *On whom I might perhaps refresh myself;*

Toward heavy penance for his sake

Zum letztenmal gewagt! Es sei! *Risked for the last time! So be it!*

With stiff foot hobbling down the track

Recht quammig, quappig, das bezahlen *Really flabby, jiggly, that the Orientals*

He comes a-stumbling, limping back

Mit hohem Preis Orientalen... *Pay a high price for...*

He drags his leg along the ground

Doch ach! der Bovist platzt entzwei! *But alas! The puffball bursts in two!*

As we flee—he follows us around!

Lamien

Fahrt auseinander, schwankt und schwebet *Scatter apart, sway and hover*

Cursed fate! Deceived mankind since time began!

Blitzartig, schwarzen Flugs umgeben *Lightning-like, with black flight surround*

Seduced fools—every one—since Adam ran!

Den eingedrungenen Hexensohn! *The intruding witch's son!*

We all get old, but who gets wise? Not you!

Unsichre, schauderhafte Kreise! *Uncertain, shuddering circles!*

Weren't you already fool enough? It's true!

Schweigsamen Fittichs, Fledermause! *Silent-winged, bats!*

One knows these folk are worthless to the core

Zu wohlfeil kommt er doch davon. *Too cheaply does he escape.*

Laced up tight and painted like a whore

Mephistopheles

Viel kluger, scheint es, bin ich nicht geworden; *Much wiser, it seems, I have not become;*

Nothing healthy can they give in trade

Absurd ist's hier, absurd im Norden, *Absurd it is here, absurd in the North,*

Touch them anywhere—they're rotten, decayed

Gespenster hier wie dort vertrackt, *Specters here as there confounded,*

One knows, one sees, one grasps it plain and clear

Volk und Poeten abgeschmackt. *People and poets tasteless.*

Yet still we dance when these hussies pipe—oh dear!

Ist eben hier eine Mummenschanz *It is just a masquerade here*

Stop! He's pausing, hesitating now

Wie überall, ein Sinentanz. *As everywhere, a dance of the senses.*

Meet him! Don't let him escape somehow!

Ich griff nach holden Maskenzügen *I grasped at lovely masked figures*

Press on then! Don't get yourself stupidly caught

Und fasste Wesen, dass mich's schauerte... *And seized beings that made me shudder...*

In webs of doubt—overthinking's for naught!

Ich mochte gerne mich betrogen, *I would gladly deceive myself,*

For if there were no witches to be found

Wenn es nur länger dauerte. *If only it lasted longer.*

Who the devil would want devils around?

Wo bin ich denn? Wo will's hinaus? *Where am I then? Where is this going?*

Let's circle around this hero here!

Das war ein Pfad, nun ist's ein Graus. *That was a path, now it's a horror.*

Love in his heart will make it clear

Ich kam daher auf glatten Wegen, *I came here on smooth paths,*

He'll pick one of us—that's the deal!

Und jetzt steht mir Geröll entgegen. *And now rubble stands before me.*

True, in this uncertain gleaming light

Vergebens kletter' ich auf und nieder, *In vain I climb up and down,*

You seem like pretty ladies—quite!

Wo find' ich meine Sphinxen wieder? *Where shall I find my Sphinxes again?*

So I shouldn't scold—you look alright

So toll hatt' ich mir's nicht gedacht, *So mad I had not imagined it,*

Me too! Let me join your parade!

Ein solch Gebirge in einer Nacht! *Such a mountain range in one night!*

Into your troupe I want to wade!

Das heiss' ich frischen Hexenritt, *That I call a bold witch-ride,*

This one's too much for our circle here

Die bringen ihren Blocksberg mit. *They bring their Blocksberg with them.*

She always spoils our sport, I fear

Oreas

Herauf hier! Mein Gebirg ist alt, *Come up here! My mountain is old,*

Greetings from little Cousin Empusa—me!

Steht in ursprünglicher Gestalt. *Stands in its original form.*

The darling with the donkey foot, you see!

Verehre schroffe Felsensteige, *Revere the steep rocky stairs,*

You've only got a horse-hoof there

Des Pindus letztgedehnte Zweige! *The last extended branches of Pindus!*

But still, dear Cousin—greetings fair!

Schon stand ich unerschuttert so, *Already I stood thus unshaken*

I thought I'd find only strangers here today

Als uber mich Pompejus floh. *When over me Pompey fled.*

Yet sadly close relations come my way!

Daneben das Gebild des Wahns *Beside me this creation of delusion*

An old old book to leaf through, this one

Verschwundet schon beim Krahn des Hahns. *Vanishes already at the crow of the cock.*

From Harz to Hellas—cousins, every one!

Dergleichen Marchen seh' ich oft entstehn *Such fables I often see arise*

I'm quick to act decisively, you know

Und plötzlich wieder untergehn. *And suddenly go down again.*

Into many things I can shift and flow

Mephistopheles

Sei Ehre dir, ehrwürdiges Haupt, *Honor be to you, venerable head,*

But in your honor, specially today

Von hoher Eichenkraft umlaubt! *Crowned with lofty oak-strength!*

I've put on the little donkey head—hooray!

Der allerklarste Mondenschein *The clearest moonlight*

I notice kinship means a lot to these folk

Dringt nicht zur Finsternis herein. – *Penetrates not into the darkness. –*

Relationships matter—no joke

Doch neben am Gebusche zieht *Yet beside, through the bushes moves*

But let come what may, whatever betide

Ein Licht, das gar bescheiden gluhet. *A light that glows quite modestly.*

The donkey-head I'd rather deny

Wie sich das alles fügen muss! *How all things must fit together!*

Ditch the ugly one! She scares away

Furwahr, es ist Homunculus! *Truly, it is Homunculus!*

Whatever seems fair and lovely today

Woher des Wegs, du Kleingeselle? *Whence the way, you little fellow?*

Whatever could be lovely and sweet

Homunculus

Ich schwebe so von Stell' zu Stelle *I hover thus from place to place*

She approaches—and it's obsolete!

Und möchte gern im besten Sinn entstehn, *And would gladly, in the best sense, come to be,*

These little cousins too, so slim and fine

Voll Ungeduld, mein Glas entzweizuschlagen; *Full of impatience to shatter my glass;*

They all seem suspicious in design

Allein, was ich bisher gesehn, *Yet what I have seen so far,*

Behind those roses on their cheeks so fair

Hinein da mocht' ich mich nicht wagen. *Into that I would not dare venture.*

I fear metamorphosis lurks there

Nur, um dir's im Vertraun zu sagen: *Only, to tell you in confidence:*

Try it then! We're plenty to sample here!

Zwei Philosophen bin ich auf der Spur, *I am on the trail of two philosophers,*

Reach out! If luck's with you—have no fear

Ich horchte zu, es hiess: Natur, Natur! *I listened, it was: Nature, Nature!*

Snatch yourself the very best prize!

Von diesen will ich mich nicht trennen, *From these I will not separate,*

What's with this lecherous moaning—guys?

Sie müssen doch das irdische Wesen kennen; *They must surely know earthly existence;*

You're one miserable suitor indeed

Und ich erfahre wohl am Ende, *And I shall learn in the end*

Strutting around like you're top seed!

Wohin ich mich am allerklugsten wende. *Where I should most wisely turn.*

Now he mingles with our pack

Mephistopheles

Das tu auf deine eigne Hand. *Do that on your own.*

Drop the masks, no holding back

Denn wo Gespenster Platz genommen, *For where specters have taken their place,*

And show him what we're really like!

Ist auch der Philosoph willkommen. *The philosopher is also welcome.*

The fairest one I've chosen for my own—

Damit man seiner Kunst und Gunst sich freue, *So that one may enjoy his art and favor,*

Good grief! What a withered broomstick-bone!

Erschafft er gleich ein Dutzend neue. *He straightway creates a dozen new ones.*

And this one?... Shameful face on show!

Wenn du nicht irrst, kommst du nicht zu Verstand. *If you do not err, you will not gain understanding.*

You deserve better? I think no!

Willst du entstehn, entsteh auf eigne Hand! *If you wish to come to be, come to be on your own!*

The little one I'd like to secure—

Homunculus

Ein guter Rat ist auch nicht zu verschmahn. *Good counsel is also not to be scorned.*

A lizard slips right out the door!

Mephistopheles

So fahre hin! Wir wollen's weiter sehn. *Then go your way! We shall see further.*

And snake-like glides the smooth braid away

Anaxagoras

Dein starrer Sinn will sich nicht beugen; *Your stubborn mind will not bend;*

So I'll grab the tall one instead, I say—

Bedarf es Weitres, dich zu überzeugen? *Is more needed to convince you?*

I've got a thyrsus-staff in hand

Thales

Die Welle beugt sich jedem Winde gern, *The wave bends willingly to every wind,*

Pine-cone for a head—how grand!

Doch halt sie sich vom schroffen Felsen fern. *Yet keeps itself far from the rugged cliff.*

Where is this leading?... One more, round and plump

Anaxagoras

Durch Feuerdunst ist dieser Fels zu Handen. *By fire-vapor this rock came to hand.*

On whom perhaps I'll cure this slump

Thales

Im Feuchten ist Lebendiges erstanden. *In moisture has the living arisen.*

One last gamble! Here goes—okay!

Homunculus

Lasst mich an eurer Seite gehn. *Let me go at your side.*

Really jiggly, really soft—they say

Mir selbst gelustet's, zu entstehn! *I myself desire to come to be!*

Orientals pay top dollar for this kind—

Thales

Nie war Natur und ihr lebendiges Fliessen *Never was Nature and her living flow*

But ugh! The puffball bursts! Never mind!

Auf Tag und Nacht und Stunden angewiesen. *Dependent on day and night and hours.*

Scatter! Sway and hover all around!

Sie bildet regelnd jegliche Gestalt, *She forms, regulating, every shape,*

Lightning-fast with blackened flight surround

Und selbst im Grossen ist es nicht Gewalt. *And even on a large scale it is not force.*

The intruding witch's son with dread!

Anaxagoras

Hier aber war's! Plutonisch grimmig Feuer, *But here it was! Plutonic fierce fire,*

Uncertain shuddering circles overhead!

Aolischer Dunste Knallkraft, ungeheuer, *Aeolian vapors' explosive force, monstrous,*

Silent-winged like bats we fly!

Durchbrach des flachen Bodens alte Kruste, *Broke through the flat ground's ancient crust,*

Too cheaply he escapes—oh my!

Dass neu ein Berg sogleich entstehen musste. *So that a new mountain had at once to arise.*

Much wiser I have not become, it seems

Thales

Was wird dadurch nun weiter fortgesetzt? *What is thereby further continued?*

Absurd here, absurd up north—extremes!

Er ist auch da, und das ist gut zuletzt. *It is also there, and that is good in the end.*

Specters here as there, completely cracked

Mit solchem Streit verliert man Zeit und Weile *With such strife one loses time and leisure*

People and poets—totally whacked

Und fuhrt doch nur geduldig Volk am Seile. *And only leads patient people on a leash.*

It's just a masquerade everywhere you go

Anaxagoras

Schnell quillt der Berg von Myrmidonen, *Quickly the mountain swarms with Myrmidons,*

A dance of the senses, high and low

Die Felsenspalten zu bewohnen; *To dwell in the rocky clefts;*

I grasped at lovely masked disguise

Pygmaen, Imsen, Daumerlinge *Pygmies, emmets, thumbings*

And seized things that made me realize...

Und andre tatig kleine Dinge. *And other active little things.*

I shuddered—yet I'd gladly be deceived

Nie hast du Grossem nachgestrebt, *Never have you striven for greatness,*

If only it lasted longer than conceived

Einsiedlerisch-beschränkt gelebt; *Lived in hermit-like limitation;*

Where am I? Where's this heading anyway?

Kannst du zur Herrschaft dich gewöhnen, *If you can accustom yourself to rule,*

That was a path, now it's dismay

So lass ich dich als König kronen. *Then I will have you crowned as king.*

I came along on roads all smooth and slick

Homunculus

Was sagt mein Thales? – *What says my Thales? –*

Now rubble blocks me—what a trick!

Thales

Will's nicht raten; *I advise against it;*

In vain I scramble up and down

Mit Kleinen tut man kleine Taten, *With small ones one does small deeds,*

Where will I find my Sphinxes in this town?

Mit Grossen wird der Kleine gross. *With great ones the small one becomes great.*

I never imagined it so mad as this

Sieh hin! die schwarze Kranichwolke! *Look there! The black crane-cloud!*

A mountain range in one night—hit or miss!

Sie droht dem aufgeregten Volke *It threatens the agitated people*

Now THAT I call a fresh witch-ride

Und wurde so dem König drohn. *And would thus threaten the king.*

They bring their Blocksberg along for the ride!

Mit scharfen Schnabeln, krallen Beinen, *With sharp beaks, clawed legs,*

Come up here! My mountain's ancient stone

Sie stechen nieder auf die Kleinen; *They strike down upon the little ones;*

Stands in original shape, fully grown

Verhangnis wetterleuchtet schon. *Doom already flashes lightning.*

Revere the rugged rocky stairs

Ein Frevel totete die Reiher, *A crime killed the herons,*

The last stretched branches Pindus bears!

Umstellend ruhigen Friedensweiher. *Surrounding the peaceful pond.*

Unshaken thus I stood the test

Doch jener Mordgeschosse Regen *Yet that rain of murderous missiles*

When Pompey fled across my crest

Schafft grausam-blut'gen Rachesegen, *Creates cruel, bloody blessing of revenge,*

That creation of delusion by my side

Erregt der Nahverwandten Wut *Arouses the rage of close kin*

At cockcrow vanishes—no place to hide

Nach der Pygmaen frevlem Blut. *For the Pygmies' criminal blood.*

Such fables I've often seen arise

Was nutzt nun Schild und Helm und Speer? *What use now is shield and helmet and spear?*

And suddenly vanish before my eyes

Was hilft der Reiherstrahl den Zwergen? *What help is the heron-plume to the dwarfs?*

Honor to you, venerable ancient head

Wie sich Daktyl und Imse bergen! *How the Dactyls and emmets hide!*

Crowned by lofty oak-strength's spread!

Schon wankt, es flieht, es stürzt das Heer. *Already the army wavers, flees, collapses.*

The clearest moonlight cannot pierce below

Anaxagoras

Konnt' ich bisher die Unterirdischen loben, *If I could hitherto praise the subterranean ones,*

Into your darkness's deepest glow

So wend' ich mich in diesem Fall nach oben. . . *Then in this case I turn upward. . .*

But through the bushes there—a modest light

Du! droben ewig Unveraltete, *You! Above, eternally unageworn,*

Glowing softly in the night

Dreiamig-Dreigestaltete, *Triple-named, triple-formed,*

How everything fits together so!

Dich ruf' ich an bei meines Volkes Weh, *I call upon you in my people's woe,*

Why, it's Homunculus! What a show!

Diana, Luna, Hekate! *Diana, Luna, Hecate!*

Where from, little fellow—where do you roam?

Du Brusterweiternde, im Tiefsten Sinnige, *You heart-expanding one, deepest in thought,*

I float along from place to place, my home

Du Ruhigscheinende, Gewaltsam-Innige, *You calmly-shining one, forcefully-fervent,*

And gladly wish, in the best sense, to be

Eroffne deiner Schatten grausen Schlund, *Open the dread abyss of your shadows,*

Full of impatience to shatter my glass, you see

Die alte Macht sei ohne Zauber kund! *Let the ancient power be revealed without spell!*

Yet what I've seen so far in this domain

Bin ich zu schnell erhört? *Am I too swiftly heard?*

Into THAT I wouldn't dare venture—too insane!

Hat mein Flehn *Has my plea*

Just to tell you in confidence, you know

Nach jenen Hohn *To those heights*

Two philosophers I'm tracking down below

Die Ordnung der Natur gestört? *Disturbed the order of nature?*

I listened in: "Nature, Nature!" they both cried

Und grosser, immer grosser naht schon *And greater, ever greater now approaches*

From these two I refuse to be pried

Der Gottin rundumschriebner Thron, *The goddess's orbbed throne,*

They must know earthly existence through and through

Dem Auge furchtbar, ungeheuer! *Fearful to the eye, monstrous!*

And I'll learn in the end where best to pursue

Ins Düstre rotet sich sein Feuer... *Into the darkness reddens its fire...*

The wisest course for me to take

Nicht näher, drohend-mächtige Runde! *No nearer, threateningly-mighty sphere!*

Do that on your own, for your own sake

Du richtest uns und Land und Meer zugrunde! *You will ruin us and land and sea!*

For where specters have taken their seat

So war' es wahr, dass dich thessalische Frauen *So would it be true that Thessalian women*

Philosophers are welcome to compete

In frevrend magischem Vertrauen *With criminal magical confidence*

So they can enjoy his art and favor—see

Von deinem Pfad herabgesungen, *Sang you down from your path,*

He creates a dozen new specters instantly!

Verderblichstes dir abgerungen?... *Wrung from you the most destructive things?...*

If you don't err, you won't gain understanding's prize

Das lichte Schild hat sich umdunkelt, *The bright shield has darkened,*

Want to come into being? Do it yourself, wise guys!

Auf einmal reißt's und blitzt und funkelt! *Suddenly it tears and flashes and sparkles!*

Good counsel shouldn't be dismissed outright

Welch ein Geprassel! Welch ein Zischen! *What a crackling! What a hissing!*

Then go! We'll see what comes to light!

Ein Donnern, Windgetum dazwischen! – *A thunder, wind-roar between! –*

Your stubborn mind refuses to bend!

Demutig zu des Thrones Stufen! – *Humbly to the steps of the throne! –*

What more do you need to comprehend?

Verzeiht! Ich hab' es hergerufen. *Forgive! I have summoned it.*

The wave gladly bends to every wind that blows

Thales

Was dieser Mann nicht alles hort' und sah! *What this man has not heard and seen!*

Yet keeps its distance where the craggy cliff grows

Ich weiss nicht recht, wie uns geschah, *I do not rightly know what happened to us,*

By fire-vapor this rock came to be!

Auch hab' ich's nicht mit ihm empfunden. *Nor did I experience it with him.*

In moisture all that lives was born, you see!

Gestehen wir, es sind verrückte Stunden, *Let us confess, these are crazy hours,*

Let me walk beside you two!

Und Luna wiegt sich ganz bequem *And Luna rocks herself quite comfortably*

I myself yearn to become—it's true!

An ihrem Platz, so wie vordem. *In her place, as before.*

Nature and her living flow never depended

Homunculus

Schaut hin nach der Pygmaen Sitz! *Look yonder at the Pygmies' seat!*

On day or night or hours—never ended

Der Berg war rund, jetzt ist er spitz. *The mountain was round, now it is pointed.*

She forms each shape by her own regulation

Ich spurt' ein ungeheures Prallen, *I felt a monstrous rebound,*

And even at grand scale—it's not conflagration!

Der Fels war aus dem Mond gefallen; *The rock had fallen from the moon;*

But HERE it was! Plutonic fire ran hot

Gleich hat er, ohne nachzufragen, *At once, without asking,*

Aeolian vapor's explosive blast—a lot!

So Freund als Feind gequetscht, erschlagen. *It crushed and slew both friend and foe.*

Broke through the ancient crust of ground

Doch muss ich solche Kunste loben, *Yet I must praise such arts,*

So that at once a new mountain could be found!

Die schöpferisch, in einer Nacht, *Which creatively, in one night,*

What further good does that provide?

Zugleich von unten und von oben, *From below and from above at once,*

It's there—that's fine—let's set the point aside

Dies Berggebau zustand gebracht. *Brought this mountain structure into being.*

With such disputes we waste our time for naught

Thales

Sei ruhig! Es war nur gedacht. *Be calm! It was only imagined.*

And only lead patient fools by a thought

Sie fahre hin, die garstige Brut! *Away with them, the ugly brood!*

Quickly the mount swarms with Myrmidons now

Dass du nicht König warst, ist gut. *That you were not king is good.*

To dwell in the rocky clefts—and how!

Nun fort zum heitern Meeresfeste, *Now away to the cheerful sea-festival,*

Pygmies, emmets, thumbings too

Dort hofft und ehrt man Wundergäste. *There they hope for and honor wondrous guests.*

And other busy little things right on cue

Mephistopheles

Da muss ich mich durch steile Felsentreppen, *Here must I drag myself through steep rocky stairs,*

You've never striven for greatness, I'd say

Durch alter Eichen starre Wurzeln schleppen! *Through ancient oaks' rigid roots!*

Lived hermit-limited every day

Auf meinem Harz der harzige Dunst *On my Harz the resinous vapor*

If you can get used to ruling the roost

Hat was vom Pech, und das hat meine Gunst, *Has something of pitch, and that has my favor,*

I'll crown you king—your status get a boost!

Zunächst dem Schwefel... Hier, bei diesen Griechen *Next to sulphur... Here, among these Greeks*

What says my Thales?

Ist von dergleichen kaum die Spur zu riechen; *There is scarcely a trace of such to smell;*

I advise against it

Neugierig aber war' ich, nachzuspüren, *Yet I would be curious to discover*

With small ones you do small deeds—forget it

Womit sie Hollenqual und -flamme schüren. *With what they fuel hellfire and flames.*

With great ones the small become great too

Dryas

In deinem Lande sei einheimisch klug, *In your land be domestically clever,*

Look there! The black crane-cloud in view!

Im fremden bist du nicht gewandt genug. *In a foreign land you are not adept enough.*

It threatens the agitated folk below

Du solltest nicht den Sinn zur Heimat kehren, *You should not turn your mind toward home,*

And would threaten the king just so

Der heiligen Eichen Wurde hier verehren. *But revere here the dignity of the sacred oaks.*

With sharp beaks and clawed legs they strike

Mephistopheles

Man denkt an das, was man verliess; *One thinks of what one left behind;*

Down upon the little ones they don't like

Was man gewohnt war, bleibt ein Paradies. *What one was used to remains a Paradise.*

Doom flashes lightning—fate's at hand!

Doch sagt: was in der Hohle dort, *But say: what in that cave there,*

A crime slew the herons in peaceful pond-land

Bei schwachem Licht, sich dreifach hingekauert? *In dim light, has crouched down threefold?*

But that rain of arrows, murderous and mean

Dryas

Die Phorkyaden! Wage dich zum Ort *The Phorcyads! Venture to the place*

Creates bloody revenge—a ghastly scene!

Und sprich sie an, wenn dich nicht schauert. *And address them, if you do not shudder.*

Arouses close kin's raging blood-lust

Mephistopheles

Warum denn nicht! – Ich sehe was, und staune! *Why not! – I see something, and am amazed!*

For Pygmy guilt—revenge is a must!

So stolz ich bin, muss ich mir selbst gestehn: *Proud as I am, I must confess to myself:*

What good now are shield, helmet, spear?

Dergleichen hab' ich nie gesehen, *The likes of this I have never seen,*

What help is the heron plume to dwarfs here?

Die sind ja schlimmer als Alraune... *They are indeed worse than mandrakes...*

How the Dactyls and emmets hide away!

Wird man die urverworfenen Sunden *Will one find the primal-rejected sins*

The army wavers, flees, collapses today!

Im mindesten noch hasslich finden, *Ugly in the least,*

If I praised subterranean powers till now

Wenn man dies Dreigetum erblickt? *When one beholds this triple monster?*

In this case I turn upward—here's how...

Wir litten sie nicht auf den Schwellen *We would not suffer them on the thresholds*

You! Above! Eternally unaged!

Der grauenvollsten unsrer Hollen. *Of the most dreadful of our hells.*

Triple-named, triple-formed, engaged!

Hier wurzelt's in der Schönheit Land, *Here it takes root in the land of Beauty,*

I call on you in my people's woe!

Das wird mit Ruhm antik genannt... *That is called antique with glory...*

Diana, Luna, Hecate below!

Sie regen sich, sie scheinen mich zu spüren, *They stir, they seem to sense me,*

You heart-expander, deepest in thought!

Sie zwitschern pfeifend, Fledermaus-Vampyren. *They twitter shrilly, bat-vampires.*

Calmly shining, fiercely distraught!

Phorkyaden

Gebt mir das Auge, Schwestern, dass es spahe, *Give me the eye, sisters, that it may spy*

Open the dread abyss of your shadow's cave!

Wer sich dem Tempel wagt so nahe. *Who ventures so near to the temple.*

Let ancient power show without spell—be brave!

Mephistopheles

Verehrteste! Erlaubt mir, euch zu nahen *Most honored ones! Allow me to approach you*

Am I too quickly heard? My plea

Und euren Segen dreifach zu empfangen. *And to receive your blessing threefold.*

Has it disturbed nature's harmony?

Ich trete vor, zwar noch als Unbekannter, *I step forward, still as a stranger,*

Up to those heights above

Doch, irr' ich nicht, weitläufiger Verwandter. *Yet, if I err not, a distant relative.*

Have I troubled the order of?

Altwürdige Gotter hab' ich schon erblickt, *Ancient venerable gods I have already beheld,*

And greater, ever greater draws near

Vor Ops und Rhea tiefstens mich gebuckt; *Before Ops and Rhea most deeply bowed;*

The goddess's orb'd throne, I fear!

Die Parzen selbst, des Chaos, eure Schwestern, *The Fates themselves, of Chaos, your sisters,*

Fearsome to see, monstrous sight!

Ich sah sie gestern – oder ehegestern; *I saw them yesterday – or day before;*

Into darkness its fire reddens bright...

Doch euresgleichen hab' ich nie erblickt. *But your like I have never beheld.*

No closer, threateningly mighty sphere!

Ich schweige nun und fühle mich entzückt. *I am silent now and feel myself enraptured.*

You'll ruin us, land and sea—oh dear!

Phorkyaden

Er scheint Verstand zu haben, dieser Geist. *He seems to have understanding, this spirit.*

So it's true? Thessalian women's art

Mephistopheles

Nur wundert's mich, dass euch kein Dichter preist. *Only it amazes me that no poet praises you.*

In wicked magic played their part

Und sagt: wie kam's, wie konnte das geschehn? *And say: how was it, how could it happen?*

Sang you down from your heavenly track

Im Bilde hab' ich nie euch Wurdigste gesehn; *In images I have never seen you, most worthy ones;*

Wrung destruction from you—brought you back?

Versuch's der Meissel doch, euch zu erreichen, *Let the chisel try to attain you,*

The bright shield has gone all dark

Nicht Juno, Pallas, Venus und dergleichen. *Not Juno, Pallas, Venus and the like.*

Suddenly it tears and flashes—hark!

Phorkyaden

Versenkt in Einsamkeit und stillste Nacht, *Sunk in solitude and stillest night,*

What a crackling! What a hiss!

Hat unser Drei noch nie daran gedacht! *Our Three have never yet thought of it!*

Thunder, wind-roar—it's hit or miss!

Mephistopheles

Wie sollt' es auch? da ihr, der Welt entrückt, *How should you? Since you, removed from the world,*

Humbly to the throne's steps I fall!

Hier niemand seht und niemand euch erblickt. *See no one here and no one sees you.*

Forgive me! I summoned this all!

Da musstet ihr an solchen Orten wohnen, *Then you should dwell in such places,*

What this man hasn't heard and seen!

Wo Pracht und Kunst auf gleichem Sitze thronen, *Where splendor and art share an equal throne,*

I don't quite know what's been

Wo jeden Tag, behend, im Doppelschritt, *Where every day, nimbly, in double time,*

Nor did I experience it with him

Ein Marmorblock als Held ins Leben tritt. *A marble block strides into life as a hero.*

Let's confess—these hours are crazy and grim

Wo – *Where* –

And Luna rocks quite comfortably along

Phorkyaden

Schweige still und gib uns kein Gelusten! *Be silent and give us no desire!*

In her place as before—nothing wrong

Was hulf' es uns, und wenn wir's besser wussten? *What would it help us, even if we knew better?*

Look at where the Pygmies were!

In Nacht geboren, Nachtlichem verwandt, *Born in night, akin to the nocturnal,*

The mountain was round—now it's a spur!

Beinah uns selbst, ganz allen unbekannt. *Almost to ourselves, quite to all, unknown.*

I felt a monstrous rebound hit

Mephistopheles

In solchem Fall hat es nicht viel zu sagen, *In such a case it does not matter much,*

Rock fallen from the moon—that's it!

Man kann sich selbst auch andern übertragen. *One can also transfer oneself to others.*

At once, without bothering to ask

Euch dreien gnugt ein Auge, gnugt ein Zahn; *For you three, one eye suffices, one tooth suffices;*

It crushed both friend and foe—quite a task

Da ging' es wohl auch mythologisch an, *Then it would also be mythologically possible,*

Yet I must praise such arts indeed

In zwei die Wesenheit der drei zu fassen, *To compress the essence of the three into two,*

Creatively, in one night's speed

Der Dritten Bildnis mir zu uberlassen, *And leave to me the image of the third,*

From below and above all at once

Auf kurze Zeit. – *For a short time.* –

This mountain structure built—no bunce

Eine

Wie dunkt's euch? ging' es an? *What think you? Would it work?*

Calm down! It was only thought

Die Andern

Versuchen wir's! – doch ohne Aug' und Zahn. *Let us try it! – but without eye and tooth.*

Away with that ugly brood—they're naught!

Mephistopheles

Nun habt ihr grad das Beste weggenommen; *Now you have taken away just the best;*

That you weren't king—that's good to know

Wie wurde da das strengste Bild vollkommen! *How would the sternest image then be complete!*

Now off to the cheerful sea-fest we go!

Eine

Druck du ein Auge zu, 's ist leicht geschehn, *Close one eye, it is easily done,*

There they hope for and honor wondrous guest

Lass alsofort den einen Raffzahn sehn, *Then let one fang be seen at once,*

I must drag through steep rocky stairs

Und im Profil wirst du sogleich erreichen, *And in profile you will immediately achieve*

Through ancient oaks' stiff roots and layers!

Geschwisterlich vollkommen uns zu gleichen. *A sisterly, perfect resemblance to us.*

On my Harz the resinous vapor's got

Mephistopheles

Viel Ehr'! Es sei! – *Great honor! So be it!* –

A whiff of pitch—and that I like a lot!

Phorkyaden

Es sei! – *So be it!* –

Just after sulfur... Here with Greeks about

Mephistopheles

Da steh' ich schon, *There I stand already,*

There's hardly a trace of such stuff to sniff out

Des Chaos vielgeliebter Sohn! *The much-beloved son of Chaos!*

But I'd be curious to discover the way

Phorkyaden

Des Chaos Tochter sind wir unbestritten. *Daughters of Chaos we are, undisputed.*

They fuel hellfire and flames today

Mephistopheles

Man schilt mich nun, o Schmach, Hermaphroditen. *They will now call me, oh shame, a hermaphrodite.*

In your land be locally smart

Phorkyaden

Im neuen Drei der Schwestern welche Schöne! *In the new three of sisters, what beauty!*

In foreign lands you lack the art

Wir haben zwei der Augen, zwei der Zähne. *We have two eyes, two teeth.*

Don't turn your thoughts toward home—instead

Mephistopheles

Vor aller Augen muss ich mich verstecken, *From all eyes I must hide myself,*

Revere the sacred oaks' dignity widespread

Im Hollenpfuhl die Teufel zu erschrecken. *To frighten the devils in the pool of hell.*

One thinks of what one left behind

Felsbuchten des agaischen Meers / Rocky Coves of the Aegean Sea

Sirenen

Haben sonst bei nachtigem Grauen *Though erewhile, by spells nocturnal,*

Witches dragged you down? That's yesterday's news

Dich thessalische Zauberfrauen *Thee Thessalian witches*

Tonight you're queen of the cosmic cruise

Frevelhaft herabgezogen, *With guilty intent drew down,*

Arc your light over trembling seas

Blicke ruhig von dem Bogen *Look calmly from the arch*

Flash your silver wherever you please

Deiner Nacht auf Zitterwogen *Of your night upon the trembling waves*

Mild-glowing swarm? You're the disco ball

Mildeblitzend Glanzgewimmel *Mildly-flashing swarm of brightness*

Lighting up the tumult, one and all

Und erleuchte das Getummel, *And illuminate the tumult*

Rising from the waves—the party's here

Das sich aus den Wogen hebt! *That rises from the waves!*

Ready to serve with supernatural cheer

Dir zu jedem Dienst erbotig, *Ready for your every service,*

Luna, you're our girl, our gracious moon

Schöne Luna, sei uns gnädig! *Fair Luna, be gracious to us!*

Bless this rave—it's never too soon!

Nereiden und Tritonen

Tonet laut in scharfern Tönen, *Sound aloud in sharper tones,*

Blast the speakers, make it loud

Die das breite Meer durchdrohnen, *Which resound through the broad sea,*

Thunder through the ocean crowd

Volk der Tiefe ruft fortan! *Folk of the deep, call forth!*

Deep-sea gang, report for duty!

Vor des Sturmes grausen Schlunden *Before the storm's dread maw*

Storm wanted lunch—we said no thanks

Wichen wir zu stillsten Grunden, *We retreated to stillest depths,*

Dove down deep and hid in banks

Holder Sang zieht uns heran. *Sweet song draws us hither.*

But your song? That's the booty

Seht, wie wir im Hochentzucken *See how in high delight*

Check us out, we're living large

Uns mit goldenen Ketten schmucken, *We adorn ourselves with golden chains,*

Gold chains, we're in charge

Auch zu Kron' und Edelsteinen *Also with crown and jewels*

Crowns and gems, the whole nine yards

Spang- und Gurtelschmuck vereinen! *Unite clasp and girdle-ornaments!*

Buckles, belts—we hold the cards!

Alles das ist eure Frucht. *All this is your fruit.*

All this loot? You made it rain

Schatze, scheiternd hier verschlungen, *Treasures, here in shipwreck swallowed,*

Shipwrecked gold from every lane

Habt ihr uns herangesungen, *You have sung toward us,*

You sang them here, you wicked choir

Ihr Dämonen unsrer Bucht. *You daemons of our bay.*

Bay demons setting souls on fire!

Sirenen

Wissen's wohl, in Meeresfrische *We know well, in ocean's freshness*

Fish are vibing, we're aware

Glatt behagen sich die Fische, *The fish enjoy themselves smoothly,*

Smooth and easy, without care

Schwanken Lebens ohne Leid; *Wavering life without sorrow;*

Just floating through their days

Doch, ihr festlich regen Scharen, *Yet, you festively stirring throngs,*

But you party people, hear our call

Heute mochten wir erfahren, *Today we would like to learn*

Time to show you've got it all

Dass ihr mehr als Fische seid. *That you are more than fish.*

More than fish—impress and amaze!

Nereiden und Tritonen

Ehe wir hierher gekommen, *Before we came hither,*

We planned ahead, we're not dumb

Haben wir's zu Sinn genommen; *We took it to heart;*

Took the thought—here we come!

Schwestern, Bruder, jetzt geschwind! *Sisters, brothers, now quickly!*

Brothers, sisters, move it fast!

Heut bedarf's der kleinsten Reise *Today requires the shortest journey*

Quick trip, valid point to make

Zum vollgültigsten Beweise, *For the most valid proof*

Fullest proof for goodness' sake

Dass wir mehr als Fische sind. *That we are more than fish.*

More than fish—we're unsurpassed!

Sirenen

Fort sind sie im Nu! *Gone they are in an instant!*

Whoosh! They're outta here, gone fast

Nach Samothrace grade zu, *Straight to Samothrace,*

Samothrace-bound, they zoomed past

Verschwunden mit gunstigem Wind. *Vanished with favorable wind.*

Wind at their backs—perfect timing

Was denken sie zu vollführen *What do they think to accomplish*

What's their game? What's the scheme?

Im Reiche der hohen Kabiren? *In the realm of the lofty Cabiri?*

Cabiri's realm—a godly dream

Sind Gotter! Wundersam eigen, *They are gods! Wondrously strange,*

Gods! But weird—self-rhyming

Die sich immerfort selbst erzeugen *Who continually beget themselves*

They make themselves eternally

Und niemals wissen, was sie sind. *And never know what they are.*

Clueless what they're meant to be

Bleibe auf deinen Hohn, *Remain on your heights,*

Luna, stay up on your arc

Holde Luna, gnadig stehn, *Sweet Luna, graciously stand,*

Keep it gracious in the dark

Dass es nachtig verbleibe, *That it may remain night,*

Let the night remain in power

Uns der Tag nicht vertreibe! *That the day may not drive us away!*

Don't let daylight steal our hour!

Thales

Ich mochte dich wohl gern zu Nereus fuhren, *I would gladly lead you to Nereus,*

Want to meet Nereus? Cave's nearby

Nicht fern sind wir von seiner Hohle hier; *Not far are we from his cavern here;*

Not far at all—let's give it a try

Doch hat er einen harten Kopf, *But he has a hard head,*

Fair warning: hard-headed old guy

Der widerwärtige Sauertopf. *The repulsive sourpuss.*

Total sourpuss—don't know why

Das ganze menschliche Geschlecht *The whole human race*

Humans can never get it right

Macht's ihm, dem Griesgram, nimmer recht. *Never satisfies him, the grumbler.*

According to this grumpy knight

Doch ist die Zukunft ihm entdeckt, *Yet the future is revealed to him,*

But futures? He's got the gift

Dafür hat jedermann Respekt *For that everyone has respect*

That earns respect—gives his rep a lift

Und ehret ihn auf seinem Posten; *And honors him in his station;*

Honored in his watery post

Auch hat er manchem wohlgetan. *Also he has done good to many.*

And helpful too—not one to boast

Homunculus

Probieren wir's und klopfen an! *Let us try it and knock!*

Let's knock—nothing ventured, nothing gained

Nicht gleich wird's Glas und Flamme kosten. *It will not immediately cost glass and flame.*

Glass intact, flame unstrained!

Nereus

Sind's Menschenstimmen, die mein Ohr vernimmt? *Are these human voices that my ear perceives?*

Human voices? Seriously? Here?

Wie es mir gleich im tiefsten Herzen grimmt! *How it immediately angers my deepest heart!*

My heart fills with rage and sneer

Gebilde, strebsam, Gotter zu erreichen, *Creatures, striving to reach the gods,*

Always reaching for the gods above

Und doch verdammt, sich immer selbst zu gleichen. *And yet condemned always to resemble themselves.*

Condemned to be themselves—no love

Seit alten Jahren konnt' ich gottlich ruhn, *In ancient years I could rest divinely,*

I used to chill in godly rest

Doch trieb mich's an, den Besten wohlzutun; *Yet I was driven to do good to the best;*

But had to help—I'm blessed/cursed

Und schaut' ich dann zuletzt vollbrachte Taten, *And when at last I looked upon accomplished deeds,*

And when I saw their deeds complete

So war es ganz, als hatt' ich nicht geraten. *It was quite as if I had not counseled.*

My counsel? Worthless—total defeat!

Thales

Und doch, o Greis des Meers, vertraut man dir; *And yet, O graybeard of the sea, one trusts you;*

Old man of the sea, we trust you still

Du bist der Weise, treib uns nicht von hier! *You are the wise one, do not drive us from here!*

You're wise—don't give us the chill!

Schau diese Flamme, menschenähnlich zwar, *Behold this flame, human-like indeed,*

This flame here looks pretty human, see

Sie deinem Rat ergibt sich ganz und gar. *It yields itself entirely to your counsel.*

It yields to your wisdom completely!

Nereus

Was Rat! Hat Rat bei Menschen je gegolten? *What counsel! Has counsel ever counted with humans?*

Advice? When did that ever work on men?

Ein kluges Wort erstarrt im harten Ohr. *A wise word freezes in the hard ear.*

Wisdom freezes in stubborn ears—and then?

So oft auch Tat sich grimmig selbst gescholten, *However often the deed has grimly scolded itself,*

They scold themselves but never learn

Bleibt doch das Volk selbstwillig wie zuvor. *Still the people remain self-willed as before.*

Stay self-willed at every turn

Wie hab' ich Paris vaterlich gewarnt, *How paternally I warned Paris,*

I warned Paris like a caring dad

Eh sein Gelust ein fremdes Weib umgarnt. *Before his lust ensnared a foreign woman.*

Before his lust made choices bad

Am griechischen Ufer stand er kühnlich da, *On the Grecian shore he stood boldly,*

He stood bold on Greece's coast

Ihm kundet' ich, was ich im Geiste sah: *I told him what I saw in spirit:*

I showed him futures—not to boast

Die Lufte qualmend, überstromend Rot, *The airs smoking, overflowing red,*

Smoke and red, everything burning

Gebalke gluhend, unten Mord und Tod: *Beams glowing, below murder and death:*

Murder and death, no one learning

Trojas Gerichtstag, rhythmisch festgebannt, *Troy's judgment day, rhythmically fixed,*

Troy's doomsday, rhythmically set

Jahrtausenden so schrecklich als gekannt. *For millennia as terrible as known.*

Millennia's worst disaster yet

Des Alten Wort, dem Frechen schien's ein Spiel, *The old man's word, to the reckless one it seemed a game,*

My word? He thought it was a game

Er folgte seiner Lust, und Ilios fiel – *He followed his lust, and Ilion fell –*

Followed his lust—Troy went up in flame

Ein Riesenleichenam, starr nach langer Qual, *A giant corpse, stiff after long agony,*

Giant corpse, stiff and dead

Des Pindus Adlern gar willkommenes Mahl. *To Pindus' eagles a most welcome meal.*

Eagle dinner—'nuff said

Ulyssen auch! sagt' ich ihm nicht voraus *Ulysses too! Did I not foretell him*

Ulysses too! I warned him clear

Der Circe Listen, des Zyklopen Graus? *The wiles of Circe, the horror of the Cyclops?*

Circe's traps, Cyclops' fear

Das Zaudern sein, der Seinen leichten Sinn, *His delay, the light-mindedness of his men,*

His delays, crew's foolish way

Und was nicht alles! Bracht' ihm das Gewinn? *And what not all! Did that bring him gain?*

All for naught—what can I say?

Bis vielgeschaukelt ihn, doch spat genug, *Until, much-tossed, yet late enough,*

Till tossed about by every wave

Der Woge Gunst an gastlich Ufer trug. *The wave's favor bore him to hospitable shore.*

The sea finally cut him a break—he's saved

Thales

Dem weisen Mann gibt solch Betragen Qual; *Such conduct gives the wise man pain;*

That hurts the wise, no doubt about it

Der gute doch versucht es noch einmal. *Yet the good one tries again.*

But good folks try again, can't flout it

Ein Quentchen Danks wird, hoch ihn zu vergnugen, *A scruple of thanks, to greatly please him,*

One tiny thanks brings massive cheer

Die Zentner Undanks vollig überwiegen. *Will wholly outweigh the hundredweight of ingratitude.*

Outweighs tons of rudeness here

Denn nichts Geringes haben wir zu flehn: *For nothing trifling have we to beg:*

We're not here for something light

Der Knabe da wünscht weislich zu entstehn. *The boy here wishes wisely to come to be.*

This boy wants existence—make it right!

Nereus

Verderbt mir nicht den seltensten Humor! *Do not spoil my rarest mood!*

Don't blow my one good mood today

Ganz andres steht mir heute noch bevor: *Something quite different awaits me today:*

Got better things coming my way

Die Tochter hab' ich alle herbeschieden, *I have summoned all my daughters hither,*

Called all my daughters to the spot

Die Grazien des Meeres, die Doriden. *The Graces of the sea, the Dorides.*

Sea Graces, Dorides—the lot

Nicht der Olymp, nicht euer Boden tragt *Neither Olympus nor your soil bears*

Olympus can't match, nor your land

Ein schon Gebild, das sich so zierlich regt. *A fair form that moves so gracefully.*

Such graceful forms, moving so grand

Sie werfen sich, anmutigster Gebarde, *They fling themselves, with most graceful gesture,*

They leap with perfect, flowing motion

Vom Wasserdrachen auf Neptunus' Pferde, *From the sea-dragon onto Neptune's horses,*

From dragons onto Neptune's ocean

Dem Element aufs zarteste vereint, *Most tenderly united with the element,*

Horses, merged with waves so tight

Dass selbst der Schaum sie noch zu heben scheint. *So that even the foam seems to lift them.*

Element and form unite

Im Farbenspiel von Venus' Muschelwagen *In the color-play of Venus' shell-chariot*

Foam lifts them like they're flying high

Kommt Galatee, die Schonste, nun getragen, *Comes Galatea, the fairest, now borne,*

Venus' shell-chariot colors the sky

Die, seit sich Kypris von uns abgekehrt, *Who, since Cypris turned away from us,*

Galatea comes—the fairest one

In Paphos wird als Gottin selbst verehrt. *Is worshipped in Paphos as a goddess herself.*

Since Cypris left, she's the sun

Und so besitzt die Holde lange schon, *And so the lovely one has long possessed,*

Worshipped at Paphos, goddess-crowned

Als Erbin, Tempelstadt und Wagenthron. *As heiress, temple-city and chariot-throne.*

The lovely one has long been found

Hinweg! Es ziemt in Vaterfreudenstunde *Away! In this hour of fatherly joy*

Temple, throne—her fame's renowned

Nicht Hass dem Herzen, Scheltwort nicht dem Munde. *Hate befits not the heart, reproach not the mouth.*

Leave now! Father's joy is nigh

Hinweg zu Proteus! Fragt den Wundermann: *Away to Proteus! Ask the wonder-man:*

No hate, no scolding—spirits high

Wie man entstehn und sich verwandeln kann. *How one may come to be and transform.*

Go find Proteus, ask the pro

Thales

Wir haben nichts durch diesen Schritt gewonnen, *We have gained nothing by this step,*

How to become and transform—now go!

Trifft man auch Proteus, gleich ist er zerronnen; *Even if one meets Proteus, at once he dissolves;*

That got us zilch, I won't pretend

Und steht er euch, so sagt er nur zuletzt, *And if he stands for you, he only says at last*

Even catching Proteus—he'll bend

Was staunen macht und in Verwirrung setzt. *What amazes and confuses.*

And dissolve right before your eyes

Du bist einmal bedurftig solchen Rats, *You are in need of such counsel,*

If he speaks? Expect surprise

Versuchen wir's und wandlen unsres Pfads! *Let us try it and go our way!*

Confusion and wonder, that's the deal

Sirenen

Was sehen wir von weiten *What do we see from afar*

But you need advice—keep it real

Das Wellenreich durchgleiten? *Gliding through the realm of waves?*

Let's try our luck—full steam ahead!

Als wie nach Windes Regel *As if by the wind's rule*

What's that we spy from far away?

Anzogen weisse Segel, *White sails were drawing near,*

Gliding through the ocean's spray?

So hell sind sie zu schauen, *So bright are they to behold,*

Wind's law seems to apply

Verklarte Meeresfrauen. *Transfigured sea-women.*

White sails catching the eye

Lasst uns herunterklettern, *Let us climb down,*

Bright enough to dazzle

Vernehmt ihr doch die Stimmen. *For you hear the voices.*

Glowing sea-women—total razzle

Nereiden und Tritonen

Was wir auf Händen tragen, *What we bear in our hands*

Time to climb down and see

Soll allen euch behagen. *Shall please you all.*

Those voices call to me!

Chelonens Riesenschilde *From Chelone's giant shell*

What we've got in hand

Entglanzte ein streng Gebilde: *A stern form gleams:*

Will impress this band

Sind Gotter, die wir bringen; *They are gods we bring;*

Giant turtle shell—behold

Musst hohe Lieder singen. *You must sing high songs.*

Stern figure, shining gold

Sirenen

Klein von Gestalt, *Small in form,*

Gods we bring tonight

Gross von Gewalt, *Great in power,*

Sing your songs up right!

Der Scheiternden Retter, *Saviors of the shipwrecked,*

Small but packed

Uralt verehrte Gotter. *Gods honored since ancient times.*

Power intact

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wir bringen die Kabiren, *We bring the Cabiri,*

Shipwreck saviors true

Ein friedlich Fest zu fuhren; *To lead a peaceful festival;*

Ancient god-crew!

Denn wo sie heilig walten, *For where they sacredly preside,*

Cabiri on deck!

Neptun wird freundlich schalten. *Neptune will rule kindly.*

Peaceful fest—respect!

Sirenen

Wir stehen euch nach; *We yield to you;*

Their sacred rule applies

Wenn ein Schiff zerbrach, *When a ship broke apart,*

Neptune's friendly—no surprise!

Unwiderstehbar an Kraft *Irresistible in power*

We yield to you

Schutzt ihr die Mannschaft. *You protected the crew.*

When ships break through

Nereiden und Tritonen

Drei haben wir mitgenommen, *Three we have brought with us,*

Power undeniable

Der vierte wollte nicht kommen; *The fourth would not come;*

Crew protection reliable!

Er sagte, er sei der Rechte, *He said he was the right one,*

Brought three, that's the score

Der für sie alle dachte. *Who thought for them all.*

Fourth wouldn't walk through the door

Sirenen

Ein Gott den andern Gott *One god the other god*

Said he's the real thing

Macht wohl zu Spott. *Makes into mockery.*

Thinks for all—he's the king!

Ehrt ihr alle Gnaden, *Honor all graces,*

Gods roasting other gods

Fürchtet jeden Schaden. *Fear all harm.*

Against all odds

Nereiden und Tritonen

Sind eigentlich ihrer sieben. *Actually there are seven of them.*

Honor every grace

Sirenen

Wo sind die drei geblieben? *Where have the three remained?*

Fear harm's embrace!

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wir wussten's nicht zu sagen, *We could not say,*

Seven's the real count—twist!

Sind im Olymp zu erfragen; *Ask on Olympus;*

Where'd the three disappear to?

Dort wohnt auch wohl der achte, *There also dwells the eighth,*

Honestly, we don't know

An den noch niemand dachte! *Of whom no one yet thought!*

Ask Olympus—they might show

In Gnaden uns gewartig, *Waiting for us in grace,*

There's an eighth one, by the way

Doch alle noch nicht fertig. *But not all yet complete.*

No one remembered—what can I say!

Diese Unvergleichlichen *These incomparable ones*

Waiting for us, full of grace

Wollen immer weiter, *Always want to go further,*

Not complete yet—work in place

Sehnsuchtsvolle Hungerleider *Yearning, hungry sufferers*

These incomparable gods

Nach dem Unerreichlichen. *For the unattainable.*

Always want better odds

Sirenen

Unsre Weise *Our way*

Hungry yearners, never full

Ist zu beten, *Is to pray,*

Chasing what they can't pull!

In Sonn' und Mond *To sun and moon*

Our way

Hinzubeten; es lohnt. *To pray; it pays.*

Is to pray

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wie unser Ruhm zum höchsten prangt, *How our glory shines at its highest,*

Sun and moon get the call

Dieses Fest anzuführen! *To lead this festival!*

Pays off—worth it all!

Sirenen

Die Helden des Altertums *The heroes of antiquity*

Glory at its peak

Ermangeln des Ruhms, *Fall short of glory,*

Leading this fest—technique!

Wo und wie er auch prangt, *Where and how it may shine,*

Ancient heroes don't quite cut it

Wenn sie das goldne Vlies erlangt, *Though they won the golden fleece,*

Glory? They didn't strut it

Ihr die Kabiren. *You the Cabiri.*

Wherever fame may shine

Wenn sie das goldne Vlies erlangt, *Though they won the golden fleece,*

Golden fleece? That's fine

Wir die Kabiren. – *We the Cabiri.* –

But Cabiri take the cake

Homunculus

Die Ungestalten seh' ich an *The malformed ones I look upon*

Fleece or not, make no mistake

Als irden-schlechte Topfe, *As earthen-poor pots,*

We Cabiri—first place stake!

Nun stossen sich die Weisen dran *Now the wise men bump against them*

These misshapen gods I see

Und brechen harte Kopfe. *And break hard heads.*

Like cheap clay pots of low degree

Thales

Das ist es ja, was man begehrt: *That is just what one desires:*

Wise men keep bumping their heads

Der Rost macht erst die Munze wert. *The rust first makes the coin valuable.*

Breaking skulls on these god-dreads!

Proteus

So etwas freut mich alten Fabler! *Such things please me, old fable-teller!*

That's the point, you see

Je wunderlicher, desto respektabler. *The stranger, the more respectable.*

Rust gives coins their fee!

Thales

Wo bist du, Proteus? – *Where are you, Proteus?* –

Old fable-me loves this stuff

Proteus

Hier! und hier! *Here! And here!*

The weirder, the better—can't get enough!

Thales

Den alten Scherz verzeih' ich dir; *The old jest I forgive you;*

Proteus—where'd you go?

Doch einem Freund nicht eitle Worte! *But to a friend, not vain words!*

Here! Also here!

Ich weiss, du sprichst vom falschen Orte. *I know you speak from a false place.*

Old joke—fine, you're forgiven

Proteus

Leb' wohl! – *Farewell!* –

But friends deserve truth given

Thales

Er ist ganz nah. Nun leuchte frisch! *He is quite near. Now shine brightly!*

You're speaking from somewhere fake!

Er ist neugierig wie ein Fisch; *He is curious as a fish;*

See ya!

Und wo er auch gestaltet stockt, *And wherever he may pause in form,*

He's nearby—shine away!

Durch Flammen wird er hergelockt. *By flames he will be lured hither.*

Curious as fish, they say

Homunculus

Ergiess' ich gleich des Lichtes Menge, *I shall pour forth abundance of light,*

Whatever shape he's holding now

Bescheiden doch, dass ich das Glas nicht sprengte. *Yet modestly, lest I shatter the glass.*

Flames will draw him out somehow!

Proteus

Was leuchtet so anmutig schon? *What shines so gracefully fair?*

Pouring out the light—full blast

Thales

Gut! Wenn du Lust hast, kannst du's naher sehn. *Good! If you wish, you can see it closer.*

But careful so the glass will last!

Die kleine Muhe lass dich nicht verdriessen *Let not the little trouble vex you*

What's glowing all nice and bright?

Und zeige dich auf menschlich beiden Fussen. *And show yourself on human two feet.*

Good! Come see it up close

Mit unsern Gunsten sei's, mit unserm Willen, *With our favor be it, with our will,*

Small effort—don't be morose

Wer schauen will, was wir verhullen. *Whoever wishes to see what we conceal.*

Stand on human feet, two by two

Proteus

Weltweise Kniffe sind dir noch bewusst. *Worldly-wise tricks are still known to you.*

Our favor and will support you

Thales

Gestalt zu wechseln, bleibt noch deine Lust. *To change form remains still your pleasure.*

See what we've been hiding here!

Proteus

Ein leuchtend Zwerglein! Niemals noch gesehn! *A glowing dwarf! Never yet seen!*

Still got those clever tricks up your sleeve

Thales

Es fragt um Rat und mochte gern entstehn. *It asks for counsel and would gladly come to be.*

Shape-shifting's still your jam

Er ist, wie ich von ihm vernommen, *He is, as I have heard from him,*

A glowing dwarf—that's new!

Gar wundersam nur halb zur Welt gekommen. *Most wondrously only half come into the world.*

It wants advice—how to fully exist

Ihm fehlt es nicht an geistigen Eigenschaften, *He does not lack spiritual qualities,*

Half-born is its gist

Doch gar zu sehr am greiflich Tuchtighaften. *But far too much the tangibly solid.*

Wondrously incomplete

Bis jetzt gibt ihm das Glas allein Gewicht, *Until now the glass alone gives him weight,*

Spirit's there, pretty neat

Doch war' er gern zunächst verkörperlicht. *Yet he would gladly first be embodied.*

But solid body? That's what's missing

Proteus

Du bist ein wahrer Jungfernsohn, *You are a true virgin's son,*

Glass keeps it from dismissing

Eh' du sein solltest, bist du schon! *Before you should be, you already are!*

Wants a body—that's what it's wishing!

Thales

Auch scheint es mir von anderer Seite kritisch: *It also seems critical to me from another side:*

True virgin's son, aren't you

Er ist, mich dunkt, hermaphroditisch. *He is, methinks, hermaphroditic.*

You are before you're due!

Proteus

Da muss es desto eher glücken; *Then it must succeed all the sooner;*

Here's another issue too

So wie er anlangt, wird sich's schicken. *As soon as he arrives, it will work out.*

Hermaphroditic through and through!

Doch gilt es hier nicht viel Besinnen: *But here not much pondering is needed:*

That should help things click

Im weiten Meere musst du anbeginnen! *In the wide sea you must begin!*

Once there, you'll do the trick

Da fangt man erst im kleinen an *There one starts first in the small*

No need for deep reflection

Und freut sich, Kleinste zu verschlingen, *And enjoys devouring the smallest,*

Start in the sea's direction!

Man wächst so nach und nach heran *One grows gradually larger*

Begin small, at the start

Und bildet sich zu höherem Vollbringen. *And develops for higher accomplishment.*

Eat the tiniest part

Homunculus

Hier weht gar eine weiche Luft, *Here blows quite a soft air,*

Grow bigger over time

Es grunelt so, und mir behagt der Duft! *It smells so green, and I like the fragrance!*

Higher goals to climb!

Proteus

Das glaub' ich, allerliebster Junge! *I believe it, dearest boy!*

Soft breeze blowing through

Und weiter hin wird's viel behaglicher, *And farther on it becomes much more pleasant,*

Smells green—I like the view!

Auf dieser schmalen Strandeszunge *On this narrow tongue of shore*

I believe you, sweet one!

Der Dunstkreis noch unsaglicher; *The atmosphere even more indescribable;*

It gets better—we've just begun

Da vorne sehen wir den Zug, *Up ahead we see the procession,*

On this thin strip of land

Der eben herschwebt, nah genug. *That just hovers hither, near enough.*

Air's amazing—isn't that grand

Kommt mit dahin! – *Come along there!* –

See the procession up there

Thales

Ich gehe mit. *I go along.*

Getting close—almost here

Homunculus

Dreifach merkwurd'ger Geisterschritt! *Triply wondrous spirit-step!*

Come on!

Telchinen von Rhodos

Chor

Wir haben den Dreizack Neptunen geschmiedet, *We have forged the trident for Neptune,*

I'm coming too!

Womit er die regesten Wellen begutet. *With which he calms the most agitated waves.*

Triple-wonder spirit march!

Entfaltet der Donnrer die Wolken, die vollen, *When the Thunderer unfolds the full clouds,*

We forged the trident for the sea

Entgegnet Neptunus dem greulichen Rollen; *Neptune responds to the dreadful rolling;*

Calms wild waves so easily

Und wie auch von oben es zackig erblitzt, *And however jaggedly it flashes from above,*

When Zeus rolls out his thunder-clouds

Wird Woge nach Woge von unten gespritzt; *Wave upon wave is sprayed from below;*

Neptune answers back—proud!

Und was auch dazwischen in Angsten gerungen, *And whatever struggles in terror between,*

What ring of little cloudlets rounds

Wird, lange geschleudert, vom Tiefsten verschlungen; *Is, long hurled about, swallowed by the depths;*

Around the moon in such a lavish ring?

Weshalb er uns heute den Zepter gereicht – *For which he has lent us the scepter today* –

They're doves, ignited by love's fire

Nun schweben wir festlich, beruhigt und leicht. *Now we float festively, calm and light.*

Wings white as light itself—they sing

Sirenen

Euch, dem Helios Geweihten, *You, consecrated to Helios,*

Paphos has sent them flying here

Heitern Tags Gebenedeiten, *Blessed of bright day,*

Her horny bird-flock, all astir

Gruss zur Stunde, die bewegt *Greetings to the hour that stirs*

Our festival's complete at last

Lunas Hochverehrung regt! *Luna's high veneration!*

Bright rapture—full and clear and fast!

Telchinen

Allieblichste Gottin am Bogen da droben! *Most lovely goddess on the arch above!*

A nighttime wanderer might call

Du horst mit Entzucken den Bruder beloben. *You hear with delight your brother praised.*

This moon-halo atmospheric tricks

Der seligen Rhodus verleihst du ein Ohr, *To blessed Rhodes you lend an ear,*

But we spirits hold opinions quite

Dort steigt ihm ein ewiger Paan hervor. *There rises to him an eternal paean.*

Different—and we're right about this mix

Beginnt er den Tagslauf und ist es getan, *When he begins the day's course and when it is done,*

Doves they are, accompanying now

Er blickt uns mit feurigem Strahlenblick an. *He looks upon us with fiery radiant gaze.*

My daughter's shell-ride through the sea

Die Berge, die Stadte, die Ufer, die Welle *The mountains, the cities, the shores, the waves*

Wonder-flight of a special sort

Gefallen dem Gotte, sind lieblich und helle. *Please the god, are lovely and bright.*

Learned in ages old—and free

Kein Nebel umschwebt uns, und schleicht er sich ein, *No mist surrounds us, and should one steal in,*

I too hold that for the best

Ein Strahl und ein Luftchen, die Insel ist rein! *A ray and a breeze, the island is clean!*

What pleases the worthy man at heart

Da schaut sich der Hohe in hundert Gebilden, *There the High One beholds himself in a hundred images,*

When in a still and warm-made nest

Als Jungling, als Riesen, den grossen, den milden. *As youth, as giant, the great, the gentle.*

Something sacred keeps itself apart

Wir ersten, wir waren's, die Gottergewalt *We first, it was we who set up divine power*

In Cyprus' rough cavern-vaults below

Aufstellten in würdiger Menschengestalt. *In worthy human form.*

Not buried by the sea-god's hand

Proteus

Lass sie singen, lass sie prahlen! *Let them sing, let them boast!*

Not shattered by Seismos's blow

Der Sonne heiligen Lebenstrahlen *Beside the sun's sacred life-rays*

Surrounded by eternal winds that fanned

Sind tote Werke nur ein Spass. *Dead works are only a jest.*

And as in the oldest days of yore

Das bildet, schmelzend, unverdrossen; *They mold, melting, tirelessly;*

In quiet self-aware content

Und haben sie's in Erz gegossen, *And when they have cast it in bronze,*

We preserve Cypria's chariot here

Dann denken sie, es ware was. *Then they think it is something.*

And lead through night's soft rustling sent

Was ist's zuletzt mit diesen Stolzen? *What becomes at last of these proud ones?*

Through lovely wave-weaving we trace

Die Gotterbilder standen gross – *The god-images stood great –*

Invisible to the newer race

Zerstorte sie ein Erdestoss; *An earthquake destroyed them;*

The loveliest daughter hither we bring

Langst sind sie wieder eingeschmolzen. *Long since they have been melted down again.*

We quiet workers fear nothing

Das Erdetreiben, wie's auch sei, *Earthly striving, however it be,*

Neither eagle nor winged lion in the sky

Ist immer doch nur Plackerei; *Is always only drudgery;*

Neither cross nor crescent moon on high

Dem Leben frommt die Welle besser; *Life fares better with the wave;*

As they dwell and reign above up there

Dich tragt ins ewige Gewasser *You are borne into eternal waters*

Changing, moving, stirring in the air

Proteus-Delphin. *Proteus-Dolphin.*

Driving out and slaughtering their own

Schon ist's getan! *Already it is done!*

Laying waste to fields and cities grown

Da soll es dir zum schönsten glücken: *There shall your fairest fortune be:*

We, continuing thus our ways

Ich nehme dich auf meinen Rucken, *I take you on my back,*

Bring the loveliest mistress through the maze

Vermahle dich dem Ozean. *I wed you to the Ocean.*

Lightly moved, in moderate haste

Thales

Gib nach dem loblichen Verlangen, *Yield to the praiseworthy desire,*

Around the chariot, circle on circle traced

Von vorn die Schopfung anzufangen! *To begin creation from the start!*

Now intertwined line upon line

Zu raschem Wirken sei bereit! *Be ready for swift action!*

Snake-like in rows that intertwine

Da regst du dich nach ewigen Normen, *There you move according to eternal norms,*

Draw near, stalwart Nereids, come!

Durch tausend, abertausend Formen, *Through a thousand, myriad forms,*

Tough women, pleasingly wild—don't be numb

Und bis zum Menschen hast du Zeit. *And until man you have time.*

Bring, tender Dorides, don't be late

Proteus

Komm geistig mit in feuchte Weite, *Come spiritually into moist expanse,*

Galatea, the mother's image—great

Da lebst du gleich in Lang' und Breite, *There you live at once in length and breadth,*

Earnest, like the gods to behold

Beliebig regest du dich hier; *You move here at will;*

Worthy of immortality, bold

Nur strebe nicht nach höheren Orden: *Only strive not for higher orders:*

Yet like sweet human women too

Denn bist du erst ein Mensch geworden, *For once you have become a man,*

With enticing grace right through

Dann ist es vollig aus mit dir. *Then it is entirely over with you.*

Lend us, Luna, light and shade

Thales

Nachdem es kommt; 's ist auch wohl fein, *It depends; it is also fine*

Clarity to this youthful bloom displayed

Ein wackrer Mann zu seiner Zeit zu sein. *To be a worthy man in one's own time.*

For we show our dear husbands here

Proteus

So einer wohl von deinem Schlag! *Someone perhaps of your sort!*

Pleading to our father—hold them near

Das halt noch eine Weile nach; *That lasts a while yet;*

Boys they are, whom we fished out

Denn unter bleichen Geisterscharen *For among pale spirit-hosts*

From the breakers' gnashing teeth—no doubt

Seh' ich dich schon seit vielen hundert Jahren. *I have seen you already for many hundred years.*

They, bedded on reeds and moss

Sirenen

Welch ein Ring von Wolkchen rundet *What a ring of cloudlets rounds*

Warmed back to the light from loss

Um den Mond so reichen Kreis? *Around the moon in such rich circle?*

Who now with hot kisses must

Tauben sind es, liebentzundet, *They are doves, love-enkindled,*

Faithfully thank us—as is just

Fittiche, wie Licht so weiss. *Wings as white as light.*

Look favorably on the sweet ones, Dad!

Paphos hat sie hergesendet, *Paphos has sent them hither,*

The double gain is highly prized

Ihre brunstige Vogelschar; *Her ardent flock of birds;*

To be merciful and get your rocks off at the same time—nice!

Unser Fest, es ist vollendet, *Our festival is completed,*

If you praise our conduct, Father dear

Heitre Wonne voll und klar! *Bright rapture full and clear!*

Grant us well-earned pleasure here

Nereus

Nennte wohl ein nachtiger Wanderer *A nightly wanderer might call*

Let us hold them tight, immortally

Diesen Mondhof Lufterscheinung; *This moon-halo an atmospheric phenomenon;*

On eternal youthful breast—you see

Doch wir Geister sind ganz anderer *But we spirits are of quite another*

May you enjoy the pretty catch you've made

Und der einzig richtigen Meinung: *And the only correct opinion:*

Shape the boy into a man—get laid

Tauben sind es, die begleiten *Doves they are, accompanying*

Yet I could not grant what you request

Meiner Tochter Muschelfahrt, *My daughter's shell-voyage,*

What Zeus alone bestows—the rest

Wunderflugs besondrer Art, *Wonder-flight of special kind,*

The wave that rocks and sways your form

Angelernt vor alten Zeiten. *Learned in ancient times.*

Allows no permanence to love's warm storm

Thales

Auch ich halte das fürs Beste, *I too consider it best,*

And when the fancy's played itself all out

Was dem wackern Mann gefällt, *What pleases the worthy man,*

Gently set them ashore, no doubt

Wenn im stillen, warmen Neste *When in the still, warm nest*

You sweet boys are dear to us

Sich ein Heiliges lebend halt. *Something sacred keeps itself living.*

Yet we must sadly part—what a fuss

Psyllen und Marsen

In Cyperns rauhen Hohlegruften, *In Cyprus' rough cavern-vaults,*

We desired eternal fidelity's bond

Vom Meergott nicht verschuttet, *Not buried by the sea-god,*

The gods won't allow it—not so fond

Vom Seismos nicht zerrüttet, *Not shattered by Seismos,*

If you'll just keep refreshing us like this

Umweht von ewigen Luften, *Surrounded by eternal airs,*

Us worthy sailor-boys—what bliss!

Und, wie in den ältesten Tagen, *And, as in the most ancient days,*

We've never had it half so good before

In stillbewusstem Behagen *In quietly conscious comfort*

And wouldn't want it better—what's to ask for more?

Bewahren wir Cypriens Wagen *We preserve Cypria's chariot*

O Father! The joy! Such bliss!

Und fuhren, beim Sauseln der Nächte, *And lead, in the rustling of nights,*

Dolphins, linger! This sight I can't dismiss!

Durch liebliches Wellengeflechte, *Through lovely wave-weaving,*

Already past—they pass on by

Unsichtbar dem neuen Geschlechte, *Invisible to the new generation,*

In circling sweeping motion through the sky

Die lieblichste Tochter heran. *The loveliest daughter hither.*

What do they care for the inner heart's feeling?

Wir leise Geschäftigen scheuen *We quiet busy ones fear*

Ah, would they take me with them—how appealing!

Weder Adler noch geflügelten Leuen, *Neither eagle nor winged lion,*

Yet one single glance delights so much

Weder Kreuz noch Mond, *Neither cross nor crescent,*

It makes up for the whole year's lack of touch

Wie es oben wohnt und thront, *As it dwells and reigns above,*

Hail! Hail! Anew and again!

Sich wechselnd wegt und regt, *Changing, moving, and stirring,*

How I bloom with joy right then!

Sich vertreibt und totschißt, *Driving out and killing,*

Penetrated by the Beautiful and True...

Saaten und Städte niederlegt. *Laying waste fields and cities.*

All has sprung from Water through and through!!

Wir, so fortan, *We, thus continuing,*

All is sustained through Water's might!

Bringen die lieblichste Herrin heran. *Bring the loveliest mistress hither.*

Ocean, grant us your eternal governing right!

Sirenen

Leicht bewegt, in massiger Eile, *Lightly moved, in moderate haste,*

If you didn't send the clouds above

Um den Wagen, Kreis um Kreis, *Around the chariot, circle upon circle,*

Didn't bestow rich streams we love

Bald verschlungen Zeil' an Zeile, *Now intertwined line upon line,*

Didn't turn the rivers hither and there

Schlangenartig reihenweis, *Snake-like in rows,*

Didn't complete them everywhere

Naht euch, rustige Nereiden, *Approach, stalwart Nereids,*

What would mountains be, or plains, or world?

Derbe Fraun, gefällig wild, *Hardy women, pleasingly wild,*

You're the one who keeps fresh life unfurled!

Bringet, zartliche Doriden, *Bring, tender Dorides,*

You're the one from whom fresh life springs free!

Galateen, der Mutter Bild: *Galatea, the mother's image:*

They return swaying, far from here

Ernst, den Gottern gleich zu schauen, *Earnest, like the gods to behold,*

Bring no more glance to glance, I fear

Wurdiger Unsterblichkeit, *Worthy of immortality,*

In extended chain-circles they wind

Doch wie holde Menschenfrauen *Yet like sweet human women*

To show themselves in festive measure combined

Lockender Anmutigkeit. *Of enticing graciousness.*

The countless host winds itself round

Doriden

Leih uns, Luna, Licht und Schatten, *Lend us, Luna, light and shadow,*

But Galatea's shell-throne—found!

Klarheit diesem Jugendflor! *Clarity to this youthful bloom!*

I see it again and yet again!

Denn wir zeigen liebe Gatten *For we show dear spouses*

It gleams like a star within

Unserm Vater bittend vor. *Pleadingly to our father.*

Through the crowd it shines so bright

Knaben sind's, die wir gerettet *Boys they are, whom we rescued*

The beloved glows through the throng's tight

Aus der Brandung grimmem Zahn, *From the breakers' grim fangs,*

Even so far away from me

Sie, auf Schilf und Moos gebettet, *They, bedded on reeds and moss,*

It shimmers bright and clear to see

Aufgewarmt zum Licht heran, *Warmed back to the light,*

Ever near and true—that's she!

Die es nun mit heissen Küssen *Who now with hot kisses*

In this sweet moisture's embrace

Treulich uns verdanken müssen; *Must faithfully thank us;*

Whatever I illuminate in this place

Schau die Holden gunstig an! *Look favorably upon the dear ones!*

Is all so charmingly fair—what a space!

Nereus

Hoch ist der Doppelgewinn zu schätzen: *Highly is the double gain to be valued:*

In this moisture that is life

Barmherzig sein, und sich zugleich ergetzen. *To be merciful, and at the same time take pleasure.*

Only now does your light shine rife

Doriden

Lobst du, Vater, unser Walten, *If you praise, Father, our conduct,*

With glorious sound—no strife!

Gonnt uns wohlerworbene Lust, *Grant us well-earned pleasure,*

What new mystery midst the throng

Lass uns fest, unsterblich halten *Let us hold them fast, immortally*

Wishes to reveal itself ere long?

Sie an ewiger Jugendbrust. *On eternal youthful breast.*

What flames around the shell, Galatea's feet?

Nereus

Mogt euch des schonen Fanges freuen, *May you enjoy the fair catch,*

Now it blazes mighty, now lovely, now sweet

Den Jungling bildet euch als Mann; *Shape the youth into a man for yourselves;*

As if stirred by the pulses of love—what a beat!

Allein ich konnte nicht verleihen, *Yet I could not grant*

It is Homunculus, by Proteus seduced...

Was Zeus allein gewahren kann. *What Zeus alone can bestow.*

Little dude's horny as hell—his control's come unloosed

Die Welle, die euch wogt und schaukelt, *The wave that rocks and sways you*

These are symptoms of imperious yearning that burns

Lasst auch der Liebe nicht Bestand, *Allows love no permanence,*

I sense the groaning of anxious desire's returns

Und hat die Neigung ausgegaukelt, *And when the fancy has played itself out,*

He will shatter himself on the gleaming throne!

So setzt gemachlich sie ans Land. *Then gently set them ashore.*

Now it flames, now it flashes—he's pouring his own!

Doriden

Ihr, holde Knaben, seid uns wert, *You, sweet boys, are dear to us,*

What fiery wonder transfigures the waves tonight!

Doch müssen wir traurig scheiden; *Yet we must sadly part;*

They sparkle and smash against each other—what a sight!

Wir haben ewige Treue begehrt, *We have desired eternal fidelity,*

So it shines and it sways and brightens up there!

Die Gotter wollen's nicht leiden. *The gods will not allow it.*

The bodies glow on their nocturnal affair!

Die Junglinge

Wenn ihr uns nur so ferner labt, *If you only continue thus to refresh us,*

And all around everything's ringed with fire's crown!

Uns wackre Schifferknaben; *Us worthy sailor-boys;*

So let Eros rule—who started this whole thing down!

Wir haben's nie so gut gehabt *We have never had it so good*

Hail to the sea! Hail to the wave!

Und wollen's nicht besser haben. *And would not wish it better.*

Circled by the sacred fire so brave!

Galatea

O Vater! das Glück! *O Father! The joy!*

Hail to Water! Hail to Fire!

Delphine, verweile! mich fesselt der Blick. *Dolphins, linger! I am held by the sight.*

Hail to this rare adventure higher!

Nereus

Vorüber schon, sie ziehen vorüber *Already past, they pass by*

Hail to the gently-disposed airs!

In kreisenden Schwunges Bewegung; *In circling sweeping motion;*

Hail to mystery-rich caverns and their wares!

Was kummert sie die innre herzliche Regung! *What do they care for the inner heartfelt feeling!*

Highly celebrated here shall be

Ach, nahmen sie mich mit hinüber! *Ah, would they take me with them!*

All four of you Elements—blessed and free!

Doch ein einziger Blick ergetzt, *Yet a single glance delights,*

We forged Neptune's trident with our hands

Dass er das ganze Jahr ersetzt. *So that it makes up for the whole year.*

With which he chills the choppiest seas

Thales

Heil! Heil! aufs neue! *Hail! Hail! Anew!*

When the Thunderer unfurls his pregnant clouds

Wie ich mich bluhend freue, *How I rejoice in bloom,*

Neptune answers that dreadful rumbling—bass drop

Vom Schönen, Wahren durchdrungen. . . *Penetrated by the Beautiful, the True. . .*

However jagged the lightning strikes from above

Alles ist aus dem Wasser entsprungen!! *All has sprung from Water!!*

Wave after wave gets sprayed from below—wet response

Alles wird durch das Wasser erhalten! *All is sustained through Water!*

And whatever writhes between in terror

Ozean, gonn uns dein ewiges Walten. *Ocean, grant us your eternal governance.*

Gets hurled around, then swallowed by the deep

Wenn du nicht Wolken sendetest, *If you did not send clouds,*

That's why he lent us his scepter today

Nicht reiche Bache spendetest, *Did not bestow rich streams,*

Now we float festively—calm and light

Hin und her nicht Flüsse wendetest, *Did not turn rivers hither and thither,*

You, consecrated to the Sun

Die Strome nicht vollendetest, *Did not complete the rivers,*

Blessed by bright-ass daylight

Was waren Gebirge, was Ebenen und Welt? *What would be mountains, what plains and world?*

Greetings to this hour that stirs

Du bist's der das frischeste Leben erhalt. *It is you who sustains the freshest life.*

Luna's high veneration!

Echo

Du bist's, dem das frischeste Leben entquellt. *It is you from whom the freshest life springs.*

Most lovely goddess on that arc up there!

Nereus

Sie kehren schwankend fern zuruck, *They return swaying, far away,*

You hear your brother praised and cream

Bringen nicht mehr Blick zu Blick; *Bring no longer glance to glance;*

To blessed Rhodes you lend an ear

In gedehnten Kettenkreisen, *In extended chain-circles,*

There rises an eternal hymn to him

Sich festgemass zu erweisen, *To show themselves in festive measure,*

When he begins and ends his daily run

Windet sich die unzählige Schar. *The countless host winds itself.*

He looks at us with fiery radiant gaze—eye contact

Aber Galateas Muschelthron *But Galatea's shell-throne*

Mountains, cities, shores, waves

Seh' ich schon und aber schon. *I see again and again.*

Please the god—all lovely and bright

Er glanz't wie ein Stern *It gleams like a star*

No mist surrounds us—and should one sneak in

Durch die Menge. *Through the crowd.*

One ray, one breeze—'island's clean again

Geliebtes leuchtet durchs Gedränge! *The beloved shines through the throng!*

There the High One sees himself in a hundred forms

Auch noch so fern *Even so far away*

As youth, as giant—the great, the gentle

Schimmert's hell und klar, *It shimmers bright and clear,*

We were the first to set up divine power

Immer nah und wahr. *Ever near and true.*

In worthy human form—statues with abs

Homunculus

In dieser holden Feuchte *In this sweet moisture*

Let them sing, let them boast!

Was ich auch hier beleuchte, *Whatever I illuminate here*

Next to the sun's sacred life-rays

Ist alles reizend schon. *Is all charmingly fair.*

Dead works are just a joke

Proteus

In dieser Lebensfeuchte *In this life-moisture*

They mold, melting, never stopping

Erglanzt erst deine Leuchte *Only now does your light glow*

And when they've cast it in bronze

Mit herrlichem Getöse. *With glorious sound.*

They think it's actually something

Nereus

Welch neues Geheimnis in Mitte der Scharen *What new mystery in the midst of the hosts*

What happens to these proud ones in the end?

Will unseren Augen sich offengebaren? *Wishes to reveal itself to our eyes?*

The god-statues stood huge—

Was flammt um die Muschel, um Galatees Fusse? *What flames around the shell, around Galatea's feet?*

An earthquake smashed them

Bald lodert es mächtig, bald lieblich, bald susse, *Now it blazes mightily, now lovely, now sweet,*

Long since melted down again

Als war' es von Pulsen der Liebe gerührt. *As if it were stirred by the pulses of love.*

Earthly striving, whatever it is

Thales

Homunculus ist es, von Proteus verführt... *It is Homunculus, led astray by Proteus...*

Is always just drudgery

Es sind die Symptome des herrischen Sehns, *These are the symptoms of imperious yearning,*

Life does better with the wave

Mir ahnet das Achzen beangsteten Drohnens; *I sense the groaning of anxious roaring;*

You'll be carried into eternal waters

Er wird sich zerschellen am glänzenden Thron; *He will shatter himself against the gleaming throne;*

By Proteus-Dolphin

Jetzt flammt es, nun blitzt es, ergiesset sich schon. *Now it flames, now it flashes, already pours forth.*

Already done!

Sirenen

Welch feuriges Wunder verklart uns die Wellen, *What fiery wonder transfigures the waves for us,*

There your fairest fortune awaits

Die gegeneinander sich funkelnd zerschellen? *That sparkling dash against each other?*

I take you on my back

So leuchtet's und schwanket und hellet hinan: *So it shines and sways and brightens up:*

I marry you to the Ocean

Die Körper, sie gluh'n auf nachtl'cher Bahn, *The bodies, they glow on nocturnal path,*

Yield to this praiseworthy desire

Und ringsum ist alles vom Feuer umronnen; *And all around everything is encircled by fire;*

To begin creation from scratch!

So herrsche denn Eros, der alles begonnen! *Then let Eros rule, who began all things!*

Be ready for swift action!

Heil dem Meere! Heil den Wogen, *Hail to the sea! Hail to the waves,*

There you'll move by eternal norms

Von dem heiligen Feuer umzogen! *Encircled by the sacred fire!*

Through a thousand, myriad forms

Heil dem Wasser! Heil dem Feuer! *Hail to Water! Hail to Fire!*

And you've got time till you reach human

Heil dem seltnen Abenteuer! *Hail to the rare adventure!*

Come spiritually into moist expanse

Alle

Heil den mildgewogenen Luft'n! *Hail to the gently-disposed airs!*

There you live at once in length and breadth—spatial freedom

Heil geheimnisreichen Gruften! *Hail to mystery-rich caverns!*

You move here as you please

Hochgefeiert seid allhier, *Highly celebrated be here*

Just don't aim for higher orders

Element' ihr alle vier! *All four of you Elements!*

For once you become human—it's completely over for you

Dritter Akt / Act III (Helena)

Vor dem Palaste des Menelas zu Sparta / Before the Palace of Menelaus in Sparta

Helena

Bewundert viel und viel gescholten, Helena, *Much admired and much reviled, I, Helena,*

Famous. Infamous. Same difference when you're this hot

Vom Strande komm' ich, wo wir erst gelandet sind, *Come from the strand where we have disembarked but now,*

Just got here. Ten years late. Traffic was murder

Noch immer trunken von des Gewoges regsamem *Still giddy from the restless rocking of the waves*

Woozy. Very woozy. Sea travel: not recommended

Geschaukel, das vom phrygischen Blachgefeld uns her *Of Ocean, which from Phrygian uplands hitherwards*

Long boat ride from war zone. Tourist review pending

Auf sträubig-hohem Rücken, durch Poseidons Gunst *On high, opposing backs - Poseidon's favour won*

God of sea did us a solid. Finally

Und Euros' Kraft, in vaterländische Buchten trug. *And Euros' strength - have borne us to our native bay.*

Home port achieved. Wind gets credit

Dort unten freuet nun der König Menelas *Below there, with the bravest of his warriors, now*

The king is happy. One of us should be

Der Rückkehr samt den tapfersten seiner Krieger sich. *King Menelaus feels the joy of his return;*

Him and the boys. Back from hell. Vibing

Du aber heiße mich willkommen, hohes Haus, *But thou, O bid me welcome back, thou lofty House*

Palace. Me. We need to talk

Das Tyndareos, mein Vater, nah dem Hange sich *Which Tyndarus, my father, on the gentle slope,*

Father built this. I broke everything else

Von Pallas' Hügel wiederkehrend aufgebaut *Returning from the Hill of Pallas, builded up;*

Temple visit to mansion building. Pipeline

Und, als ich hier mit Klytämnestren schwesterlich, *And when I here with Clytemnestra sister-like,*

Sis and me. Simpler times

Mit Kastor auch und Pollux fröhlich spielend wuchs, *With Castor and with Pollux gaily sporting, grew,*

Bros. Childhood. Actually happy. Weird

Vor allen Häusern Spartas herrlich ausgeschmückt. *Before all Sparta's houses nobly was adorned.*

Best house on the block. Obviously

Gegrüßet seid mir, der ehrnen Pforte Flügel ihr! *Ye valves of yon dark iron portals, ye I hail!*

Doors. It's me. You remember

Durch euer gastlich ladendes Weit-Eröffnen einst *Once through your festive and inviting opening*
Once upon a time, you were happy to see me

Geschah's, daß mir, erwählt aus vielen, Menelas *It happened that to me, from many singled out,*
He picked me. Lucky him

In Bräutigamsgestalt entgegenleuchtete. *The coming of the bridegroom Menelaus shone.*
He glowed. Mistake imminent

Eröffnet mir sie wieder, daß ich ein Eilgebot *Unfold again for me, that I the King's command*
Let me in. Orders to follow

Des Königs treu erfülle, wie der Gattin ziemt. *Fulfil with strictness, as unto a spouse is meet:*
Hubby said. Wife does. Tale old as time

Laßt mich hinein! und alles bleibe hinter mir, *Give entrance now, and let all things be left behind*
Door. Open. Past. Closed

Was mich umstürmte bis hierher, verhängnisvoll. *Which hitherto have stormed upon me, full of doom!*

Drama. So much drama. Done now

Denn seit ich diese Schwelle sorgenlos verließ, *For, since this place all unsuspecting I forsook*
I was carefree once. Here. Look how that went

Cytherens Tempel besuchend, heiliger Pflicht gemäß, *For Cytheraea's fane, as holy duty called,*
Went to pray. Aphrodite laughed

Mich aber dort ein Räuber griff, der phrygische, *But there the robber seized me, he the Phrygian,*
Paris happened. Rest is history. Literally

Ist viel geschehen, was die Menschen weit und breit *Happened have many things, which people far and wide*

Things occurred. Everyone has opinions

So gern erzählen, aber der nicht gerne hört, *So fain relate, but which so fain hears not the one*
Their favorite story. My worst memory

Von dem die Sage wachsend sich zum Märchen spann. *Of whom the legend rose, and to a fable grew.*
Helen of Troy: the original viral story

Chor

Verschmähe nicht, o herrliche Frau, *Disdain thou not, O beautiful Dame,*
Own it, queen

Des höchsten Gutes Ehrenbesitz! *Possession proud of the highest estate!*

You have the thing. THE thing

Denn das größte Glück ist dir einzig beschert, *For the greatest fortune is thine alone,*

Luckiest person alive. Debatable if that's lucky

Der Schönheit Ruhm, der vor allen sich hebt. *The fame of beauty that towers o'er all.*

Most famous face ever. No contest

Dem Helden tönt sein Name voran, *The name of the hero heralds his path,*

Reputation speedruns the introduction

Drum schreitet er stolz; *Thence proudly he strides;*

Big walk. Big talk

Doch beugt sogleich hartnäckigster Mann *Yet bends at once the stubbornest man,*

Tough guy meets hot woman. Tough guy loses

Vor der allbezwingenden Schöne den Sinn. *And yields to all-conquering Beauty's might.*

You're basically mind control. That's your power

Helena

Genug! mit meinem Gatten bin ich hergeschifft *Enough, with mine own spouse have I been hither shipped,*

Moving on. Husband. Boat. Here

Und nun von ihm zu seiner Stadt vorausgesandt; *And now by him beforehand to his city sent;*

Sent ahead. Always the first to deal with it

Doch welchen Sinn er hegen mag, errat' ich nicht. *Yet what his purposes may be, I fail to guess.*

What's he thinking? Marital mystery

Komm' ich als Gattin? komm' ich eine Königin? *Do I come here as wife? Or do I come as queen?*

Wife? Queen? Someone decide

Komm' ich ein Opfer für des Fürsten bittern Schmerz *Or come, an offering for the Prince's bitter pain,*

Sacrifice wasn't on the itinerary

Und für der Griechen lang' erduldetes Mißgeschick? *And for the long-endured misfortune of the Greeks?*

Greece wants refund. I'm the currency

Erobert bin ich; ob gefangen, weiß ich nicht! *For they, the Immortals, verily fixed my Fame and Fate*

Won. But what exactly did they win?

Denn Ruf und Schicksal bestimmten fürwahr die Unsterblichen *Ambiguously, attendants twain of doubtful worth*

Fate: written. Fame: mandatory. Thanks, gods

Zweideutig mir, der Schöngestalt bedenkliche *To Beauty, who upon this very threshold stand*

Pretty. Cursed. Same thing apparently

Begleiter, die an dieser Schwelle mir sogar *With gloomy and with threatening presence at my side.*

Brought company. They're called Problems

Mit düster drohender Gegenwart zur Seite stehn. *Then, even, in the hollow ship, but seldom looked*

Standing there being ominous. Thanks

Denn schon im hohlen Schiffe blickte mich der Gemahl *My spouse on me, nor ever word of comfort spake:*

Husband stared. A lot. Weird energy

Nur selten an, auch sprach er kein erquicklich Wort. *As if he brooded evil, fronting me he sat.*

Silence. Staring. Marriage goals

Als wenn er Unheil sänne, saß er gegen mir. *But now, when speeding towards the strand of that deep cove*

Brooding. Very brooding. Not attractive

Nun aber, als des Eurotas tiefem Buchtgestad *Eurotas makes, scarce had the foremost vessel's prow*

Almost home. River bay ahead

Hinangefahren der vordern Schiffe Schnäbel kaum *The land saluted, than he spake, as urged the Gods:*

Ships approaching. Drama approaching faster

Das Land begrüßten, sprach er, wie vom Gott bewegt: *"Here, in their ordered rank, my warriors disembark;*

Suddenly he talks. Divinely motivated

»Hier steigen meine Krieger nach der Ordnung aus, *Them shall I muster, ranged along the ocean-strand.*

"Troops, standard disembarkation"

Ich mustere sie, am Strand des Meeres hingereiht; *But thou go ever onwards, up the hallowed banks*

"I count them. Beach formation"

Du aber ziehe weiter, ziehe des heiligen *Of fair Eurotas, dowered with gifts of plenteous fruit,*

"You go. I stay. Very normal"

Eurotas fruchtbegabtem Ufer immer auf, *Guiding the stallions o'er the bloom of watery meads,*

"Follow the nice river. Very scenic"

Die Rosse lenkend auf der feuchten Wiese Schmuck, *Till there, on that most lovely plain thy journey ends,*

“Horses. Meadow. Make it work”

Bis daß zur schönen Ebene du gelangen magst, *Where Lacedaemon, once a fruitful spreading field,*

“Flat pretty place. You’ll know it”

Wo Lakedämon, einst ein fruchtbar weites Feld, *Surrounded by austere mountains, built its seat.*

“Sparta. Used to be farm. Now city”

Von ernsten Bergen nah umgeben, angebaut. *Set thou thy foot within the high-towered princely House,*

“Built here. Mountains said okay”

Betrete dann das hochgetürmte Fürstenhaus *And muster well the maids, whom there behind I left,*

“Palace. Enter it. That’s the plan”

Und mustere mir die Mägde, die ich dort zurück *Together with the old and faithful Stewardess.*

“Maids. Count them. Report back”

Gelassen, samt der klugen alten Schaffnerin. *Let her display to thee the wealth of treasures stored,*

“Plus the smart old lady. Important”

Die zeige dir der Schätze reiche Sammlung vor, *Even as thy father them bequeathed, and I myself,*

“Stuff. Lots of stuff. Get shown it”

Wie sie dein Vater hinterließ und die ich selbst *In war and peace accumulating, have amassed.*

“Inheritance plus war prizes. Collection”

In Krieg und Frieden, stets vermehrend, aufgehäuft. *All things shalt thou in ancient order find: because*

“Stuff. More stuff. Much stuff”

Du findest alles nach der Ordnung stehen; denn *It is the Ruler’s privilege, that he all things*

“Tidy. Everything tidy. Better be”

Das ist des Fürsten Vorrecht, daß er alles treu *In faithful keeping find, returning to his house,*

“King comes home, king finds stuff. Simple”

In seinem Hause, wiederkehrend, finde, noch *Where’er he may have left it, each thing in its place;*

“Return home, everything same. Requirement”

An seinem Platze jedes, wie er’s dort verließ. *For power to change in aught possesses not the slave.”*

“Things. Places. Matching. Done”

Denn nichts zu ändern hat für sich der Knecht Gewalt.« Denn nichts zu ändern hat für sich der Knecht Gewalt.«

Chor

Denn der Kette Zier, der Krone Geschmuck, *Let now the splendid, accumulate wealth*

Stuff. Shiny stuff. Look at it

Da ruhn sie stolz, und sie dünken sich was; *Rejoice and cheer thee, in eye and heart!*

Be happy. That's an order

Doch tritt nur ein und fordre sie auf, *For the gleam of chain and the glory of crown*

Bling. Royal bling. Impressive

Sie rüsten sich schnell. *Are lying idly in haughty repose:*

Treasure has ego apparently

Mich freuet, zu sehn Schönheit in dem Kampf *But enter thou in and challenge them all,*

Enter. Outshine. Standard procedure

Gegen Gold und Perlen und Edelgestein. *And they will respond.*

Things get ready. Things know

I rejoice to witness Beauty compete With gold and pearl and the jewel-stone.

Helena

Sodann erfolgte des Herren ferneres Herrscherwort: *Thereafter further came my lord's imperious speech:*

Beauty fights treasure. I watch

»Wenn du nun alles nach der Ordnung durchgesehn, *“Now when all things in order thou inspected hast,*

Rocks lose. You win. Obviously

Dann nimm so manchen Dreifuß, als du nötig glaubst, *Then take so many tripods as thou needful deem'st,*

More orders. Always more

Und mancherlei Gefäße, die der Opfer sich *And vessels manifold, such as desires at hand*

“Check stuff. Then do more stuff”

Zur Hand verlangt, vollziehend heiligen Festgebrauch. *Who offers to the Gods, fulfilling holy use,*

“Tripods. Some amount. Your call”

Die Kessel, auch die Schalen, wie das flache Rund; *The kettles, also bowls, the shallow basin's disk;*

“Bowls. Sacrifice needs bowls”

Das reinste Wasser aus der heiligen Quelle sei *The purest water from the sacred fountain fill*

“Festival stuff. Holy stuff. Get it”

In hohen Krügen; ferner auch das trockne Holz, *In lofty urns; and further, also ready hold*

“Pots. Bowls. Flat things. Yes”

Der Flammen schnell empfänglich, halte da bereit; *The well-dried wood that rapidly accepts the flame;*

“Water. Pure. Holy. Got it”

Ein wohlgeschliffnes Messer fehle nicht zuletzt; *And let the knife, well-sharpened, fail not finally;*

“Big jugs. Also wood. Dry”

Doch alles andre geb’ ich deiner Sorge hin.« *Yet all besides will I relinquish to thy care.”*

“Burnables. Ready. Check”

So sprach er, mich zum Scheiden drängend; aber nichts *So spake he, urging my departure; but no thing*

“Knife. Sharp one. Important”

Lebendigen Atems zeichnet mir der Ord nende, *Of living breath did he, who ordered thus, appoint,*

“Rest of it? Your job now”

Das er, die Olympier zu verehren, schlachten will. *That shall, to honour the Olympian Gods, be slain.*

Said that. Sent me. But wait

Bedenklich ist es; doch ich Sorge weiter nicht, *’Tis critical; and yet I banish further care,*

Alive stuff? Not mentioned. Hmm

Und alles bleibe hohen Göttern heim gestellt, *And let all things be now to the high Gods referred,*

Kill what exactly? Open question

Die das vollenden, was in ihrem Sinn sie deucht, *Who that fulfil, whereto their minds may be disposed,*

Concerning. Whatever. Moving on

Es möge gut von Menschen oder möge böS *Whether by men ’tis counted good, or whether bad;*

Gods’ problem now. Not mine

Geachtet sein; die Sterblichen, wir ertragen das. *In either case we mortals, we are doomed to bear.*

Gods decide. Gods do. Standard

Schon manchmal hob das schwere Beil der Opfernde *Already lifted oft the Offerer the axe*

Good? Bad? Gods don’t care

Zu des erdgebeugten Tieres Nacken Weihend auf *In consecration o’er the bowed neck of the beast,*

We suffer. That’s the job

Und konnt’ es nicht vollbringen, denn ihn hinderte *And could not consummate the act; for enemies*

Axe goes up. Sometimes

Des nahen Feindes oder Gottes Zwischenkunft. *Approaching, or Gods intervening, hindered him.*

Animal neck. Axe above. Classic setup

Chor

Was geschehen werde, sinnst du nicht aus; *What shall happen, imagin'st thou not,*

Couldn't finish. Got interrupted

Königin, schreite dahin *Queen, go forwards*

God or enemy. Either way, pause

Guten Muts! *With courage!*

What next? Unknown. Always unknown

Gutes und Böses kommt *Blessing and evil come*

Walk. Queen walks. That's the plan

Unerwartet dem Menschen; *Unexpected to men:*

Brave now. Go

Auch verkündet, glauben wir's nicht. *Though announced, yet we do not believe.*

Good happens. Bad happens

Brannte doch Troja, sahen wir doch *Burned not Ilion, saw we not also*

Surprise. Always surprise

Tod vor Augen, schmachlichen Tod; *Death in the face, shamefullest death?*

Told. Don't believe. Human nature

Und sind wir nicht hier *And are we not here,*

Fire. Troy. Happened. Saw it

Dir gesellt, dienstbar freudig, *With thee companioned, joyously serving,*

Death. Saw that too. Bad death

Schauen des Himmels blendende Sonne *Seeing the dazzling sun in the heavens,*

Here though. Still here

Und das Schönste der Erde *And the fairest of earth, too,*

Serving. Happy about it. Weird

Huldvoll, dich, uns Glücklichen? *Kindest one, thee, we, the happy?*

Sun. Still there. Still bright

Helena

Sei's wie es sei! Was auch bevorsteht, mir geziemt, *Let come, what may! Whate'er awaits me, it beseems*

Prettiest thing ever. You

Hinaufzusteigen ungesäumt in das Königshaus, *That I without delay go up in the Royal House,*

You here. Us lucky. Connection made

Das, lang' entbehrt und viel ersehnt und fast verscherzt, *Which, long my need and yearning, forfeited almost,*

Whatever. Still got to go do the thing

Mir abermals vor Augen steht, ich weiß nicht wie. *Once more hath risen on my sight, I know not how.*

Palace stairs. Up them. Now

Die Füße tragen mich so mutig nicht empor *My feet no longer bear me with such fearlessness*

Missed it. Wanted it. Almost lost it

Die hohen Stufen, die ich kindisch übersprang. *Up the high steps, which as a child I sprang across.*

There it is. No idea how. But there

Chor

Werfet, o Schwestern, ihr *Cast ye, O sisters! ye*

Feet less brave. Noticed that

Traurig gefangenen, *Sorrowful captives,*

Used to jump these. Can't now

Alle Schmerzen ins Weite; *All your trouble far from ye!*

Sisters. Throw things. Specifically:

Teilet der Herrin Glück, *Your mistress's joy partake,*

We're captives. Yes. Acknowledged

Teilet Helenens Glück, *Helena's joy partake,*

Sadness? Away with it

Welche zu Vaterhauses Herd, *Who the paternal hearth*

Her happy. You happy. System works

Zwar mit spät zurückkehrendem, *Delightedly now is approaching,*

Helen happy. You happy. Correlation

Aber mit desto festerem *Truly with late-returning*

Father's hearth. Warm spot. Going there

Fuße freudig herannaht. *But with firmer and surer feet!*

Late. Very late. Still arriving

Preiset die heiligen, *Praise ye the sacredest,*

Steadier though. That's something

Glücklich herstellenden *Still re-establishing*

Happy feet. Approaching

Und heimführenden Götter! *And home-bringing Immortals!*

Holy stuff. Praise it

Schwebt der Entbundene *How the delivered one*

Gods fix things. Sometimes

Doch wie auf Fittichen *Soars as on lifted wings*

Gods. Homeward. Thanks, gods

Über das Rauheste, wenn umsonst *Over asperities, while in vain*

Free people float. Apparently

Der Gefangene sehnsuchtsvoll *The prisoned one, yearningly,*

Wing-like. Floaty

Über die Zinne des Kerkers hin *Over the fortress-parapet*

Rough stuff below. Flying over it

Armausbreitend sich abhärmt. *Pineth with outspread arms!*

Trapped ones want. Want hard

Aber sie ergriff ein Gott, *But a God took hold of her,*

Walls. High ones. Stuck behind them

Die Entfernte; *The Expatriate,*

Arms out. Tired. Still reaching

Und aus Ilios' Schutt *And from Ilion's ruins*

God grabbed her. Literally

Trug er hierher sie zurück *Hither hath borne her again,*

Far away one. Got grabbed

In das alte, das neugeschmückte *To the ancient, the newly embellished*

Troy's mess. Pulled from it

Vaterhaus, *Paternal house,*

Carried home. Divine shipping

Nach unsäglichen *From unspeakable*

Old place. New paint

Freuden und Qualen, *Raptures and torments,*

Dad's place

Früher Jugendzeit *Early youthful days,*

Can't even say it

Angefrischt zu gedenken. *Now refreshed, to remember.*

Good stuff. Bad stuff

Panthalis

Verlasset nun des Gesanges freudumgebnen Pfad *Forsake ye now the joy-encompassed path of Song,*

Young days. Those ones

Und wendet nach der Türe Flügeln euren Blick! *And towards the portal's open valves your glances turn!*

Remember now. Fresh version

Was seh' ich, Schwestern? Kehret nicht die Königin *What, Sisters, do I see? Returneth not the Queen*

Singing time over. Look up

Mit heftigen Schrittes Regung wieder zu uns her? *With swift and agitated step again to us?*

Door. Look at door. Now

Was ist es, große Königin, was konnte dir *What is it now, great Queen, what could encounter thee*

Queen coming back. Already. Weird

In deines Hauses Hallen, statt der Deinen Gruß, *To move and shake thee so, within thy house's halls,*

Steps look upset. Very upset

Erschütterndes begegnen? Du verbirgst es nicht; *Instead of greeting? Thou canst not conceal the thing;*

Queen, what? What happened?

Denn Widerwillen seh' ich an der Stirne dir, *For strong repulsion written on thy brow I see,*

Something in there. Shocking something

Ein edles Zürnen, das mit Überraschung kämpft. *And noble indignation, struggling with amaze.*

Not greeting. Something else. Shows

Helena

Der Tochter Zeus' geziemet nicht gemeine Furcht, *A common fear beseemeth not the child of Zeus;*

Face says: don't want

Und flüchtig-leise Schreckenshand berührt sie nicht; *No lightly-passing hand of terror touches her;*

Mad but also surprised. Both

Doch das Entsetzen, das, dem Schoß der alten Nacht *But that fell Horror, which the womb of ancient Night*

Zeus's kid. Basic fear? Please

Von Urbeginn entsteigend, vielgestaltet noch *With first of things delivered, rolled through many forms,*

Light scares? Don't work on me

Wie glühende Wolken aus des Berges Feuerschlund *Like glowing clouds that from the mountain's fiery throat*

Old Night's baby horror. Different

Herauf sich wälzt, erschüttert auch des Helden Brust. *Whirl up expanding, even heroes' breasts may shake.*

Many forms. Very old. Bad

So haben heute grauenvoll die Stygischen *Thus terribly have here to-day the Stygian Gods*

Mountain fire clouds. That kind of scary

Ins Haus den Eintritt mir bezeichnet, daß ich gern *Mine entrance in the house betokened, and I fain,*

Even tough guys shake. Real scary

Von oft betretner, langersehnter Schwelle mich, *Even as a guest dismissed, would take myself away*

Underworld stuff. Very present today

Entlaßnem Gaste gleich, entfernend scheiden mag. *From oft-trod threshold, long-yearned for, departing.*

They signed my entrance. Bad sign

Doch nein! gewichen bin ich her ans Licht, und sollt *But no! I have retreated hither to the light, and ye*

Doorstep I know. Want to leave it now

Ihr weiter nicht mich treiben, Mächte, wer ihr seid. *Shall drive me no further, Powers, whoe'er you be.*

Like guest told to go. Want to go

Auf Weihe will ich sinnem, dann gereinigt mag *On consecration will I think, then, purified,*

No. I'm in light now. Staying

Des Herdes Glut die Frau begrüßen wie den Herrn. *The hearth's glow may greet the mistress as the lord.*

Powers. Stop pushing. I'm done moving

Chorführerin

Entdecke deinen Dienerinnen, edle Frau, *Reveal to thy handmaidens, noble lady,*

Gonna get holy. Then proceed

Die dir verehrend beistehn, was begegnet ist. *Who reverently attend thee, what has happened.*

Fire greets her. Fire greets him. Same

Helena

Was ich gesehen, sollt ihr selbst mit Augen sehn, *What I have seen, ye shall with your own eyes behold,*

Tell us. We're here. What?

Wenn ihr Gebilde nicht die alte Nacht sogleich *If ancient Night has not at once swallowed back*

Standing here. Waiting. What happened?

Zurückgeschlungen in ihrer Tiefe Wunderschoß. *The forms into her wondrous womb of deepest depths.*

You'll see. Same thing. Your eyes

Doch daß ihr's wisset, sag' ich's euch mit Worten an: *But that ye may know it, I will tell you in words:*

Unless Night ate it. Possible

Als ich des Königshauses ersten Binnenraum, *When I, mindful of my nearest duty, solemnly*

Night's womb. Shapes go back there

Der nächsten Pflicht gedenkend, feierlich betrat, *Entered the royal house's austere inner space,*

Words now. Describing

Erstaunt' ich ob der öden Gänge Schweigsamkeit, *I was amazed at the deserted corridors' silence,*

Went in. Serious. Palace

Nicht Schall der emsig Wandelnden begegnete *No sound of busy footsteps met my ear,*

Inside now. Doing duty. Serious

Dem Ohr, nicht raschgeschäftiges Eiligtun dem Blick, *No hastening, bustling activity met my eye,*

Hallways quiet. Too quiet

Und keine Magd erschien mir, keine Schaffnerin, *And no maid appeared to me, no stewardess,*

No footsteps. No noise. Nothing

Die jeden Fremden freundlich sonst begrüßenden. *Who would otherwise greet every stranger kindly.*

Nothing moving. Eyes saw nothing

Als aber ich dem Schoße des Herdes mich genaht, *But when I approached the hearth's innermost space,*

No maids. No stewardess. No one

Da sah ich, bei verglommner Asche lauem Rest, *There I saw, by the smouldering ash's tepid remnant,*

Should greet people. Didn't happen

Am Boden sitzen welch verhülltes großes Weib, *Sitting on the floor a great veiled woman,*

Got close to hearth. Then...

Der Schlafenden nicht vergleichbar, wohl der Sinnenden. *Not like one sleeping, but like one deep in thought.*

Ash there. Kinda warm. And...

Mit Herrscherworten ruf' ich sie zur Arbeit auf, *With commanding words I called her to her work,*

Big woman. Veiled. On floor

Die Schaffnerin mir vermutend, die indes vielleicht *Supposing her the stewardess, whom perhaps meanwhile*

Not asleep. Thinking? Maybe

Des Gatten Vorsicht hinterlassend angestellt; *My husband's foresight had appointed to remain;*

Told her: work. Boss voice

Doch eingefaltet sitzt die Unbewegliche; *But folded up, the motionless one sits;*

Thought it was the stewardess. Wrong

Nur endlich rührt sie auf mein Dräun den rechten Arm, *Only at last, at my threats, she stirs her right arm,*

Husband put her there. Supposedly

Als wiese sie von Herd und Halle mich hinweg. *As though waving me away from hearth and hall.*

Just sitting. Not moving. Folded

Ich wende zürnend mich ab von ihr und eile gleich *I turn away from her in anger and hasten at once*

Threatened her. Arm moved. Finally

Den Stufen zu, worauf empor der Thalamos *To the steps whereon the bridal chamber rises,*

Waved me away. Me. The queen

Geschmückt sich hebt und nah daran das Schatzgemach; *Adorned, and near to it the treasure room;*

Mad now. Moving fast

Allein das Wunder reißt sich schnell vom Boden auf, *But the prodigy swiftly tears itself from the ground,*

Stairs. Bedroom up there

Gebietrisch mir den Weg vertretend, zeigt es sich *Imperiously blocking my path, it shows itself*

Nice bedroom. Treasure nearby

In hagrer Größe, hohlen, blutig-trüben Blicks, *In gaunt height, with hollow, bloody-dim eyes,*

Thing. Got up. Fast

Seltsamer Bildung, wie sie Aug' und Geist verwirrt. *Of strange form, confusing to both eye and mind.*

Blocked me. Showed itself

Doch red' ich in die Lüfte; denn das Wort bemüht *But I speak into the air; for the word strives in vain*

Big skinny thing. Gross eyes

Sich nur umsonst, Gestalten schöpferisch aufzubaun. *To build up forms creatively.*

Weird shape. Brain confused. Eyes confused

Da seht sie selbst! sie wagt sogar sich ans Licht hervor! *There, see her yourself! She even dares come forth into the light!*

Words useless. Can't describe

Hier sind wir Meister, bis der Herr und König kommt. *Here we are masters, until the lord and king arrives.*

Can't make it with words. Won't work

Die grausen Nachtgeburten drängt der Schönheitsfreund *The friend of beauty, Phoebus, drives the dread night-births*

Look! There she is! In the light!

Phöbus hinweg in Höhlen, oder bändigt sie. *Away to caves, or else subdues them.*

We're boss here. For now

Chor

Schreckliches hab' ich vieles gesehen, *Terrible things have I seen in plenty,*

Night monsters. But beauty has backup

Kriegrischen Jammer, Ilios' Nacht, *Warlike misery, Ilion's night,*

Sun god handles it. Caves or control

Als es fiel. *When it fell.*

Seen scary stuff. Lots of it

Durch das umwölkte, staubende Tosen *Through the clouded, dusty tumult*

War. Troy. Night. Bad

Drängender Krieger hört' ich die Götter *Of pressing warriors, I heard the gods*

Fell. All of it

Fürchterlich rufen, hört' ich der Zwietracht *Crying out terribly, heard discord's*

Clouds. Dust. Noise

Eherne Stimme schallen durchs Feld, *Brazen voice resounding through the field,*

Warriors. Gods. Heard them

Mauerwärts. *Towards the walls.*

Crying. Discord. Heard it

Ach! sie standen noch, Ilios' *Ah! they still stood, Ilion's*

Bronze voice. Everywhere

Mauern, aber die Flammenglut *Walls, but the fiery glow*

Walls. Going there

Zog vom Nachbar zum Nachbar schon, *Already spread from neighbor to neighbor,*

Troy's walls. Still up. Then

Sich verbreitend von hier und dort *Spreading itself from here and there*

Walls. But fire

Mit des eignen Sturmes Wehn *With its own storm's breath*

Spreading. House to house

Über die nächtliche Stadt hin. *Over the nocturnal city.*

Everywhere. From everywhere

Flüchtend sah ich durch Rauch und Glut *Fleeing, I saw through smoke and glow*

Fire's own storm

Und der züngelnden Flamme Loh'n *And the licking flame's blaze*

Night city. Fire over it

Gräßlich zürnender Götter Nahn, *The approach of hideously wrathful gods,*

Running. Seeing through smoke

Schreitend Wundergestalten *Striding wondrous forms*

Flames. Flickering

Riesengroß, durch düsteren *Giant-sized, through gloomy*

Angry gods. Coming

Feuerumleuchteten Qualm hin. *Fire-illuminated smoke.*

Weird shapes. Walking

Sah ich's, oder bildete *Did I see it, or did my fear-entangled mind*

Giant. Dark

Mir der angstumschlungene Geist *Form such confusion?*

Smoky fire. Fiery smoke

Solches Verworrene? sagen kann *I can never say,*

Did I see it? Or

Nimmer ich's, doch daß ich dies *But that I behold this*

Brain scared. Made things up?

Gräßliche hier mit Augen schau', *Horrible sight with mine own eyes,*

Confusing. Can't say

Solches gewiß ja weiß ich; *That indeed I surely know;*

Can't say. But this. This I see

Könn't es mit Händen fassen gar, *I could even grasp it with my hands,*

Horrible. Here. My eyes

Hielte von dem Gefährlichen *Did not fear hold me back*

Know that. Definitely

Nicht zurücke die Furcht mich. *From the dangerous thing.*

Could touch it. If I wanted

Welche von Phorkys' *Which of Phorcys'*

Fear stops me. Otherwise would

Töchtern nur bist du? *Daughters art thou?*

Dangerous thing. Not touching

Denn ich vergleiche dich *For I compare thee*

Phorcys had kids. Which one?

Diesem Geschlechte. *To that race.*

Daughter. Which one

Bist du vielleicht der graugebornen, *Art thou perhaps one of the gray-born,*

Comparing now

Eines Auges und eines Zahns *Sharing one eye and one tooth*

That family. Similar

Wechselsweis teilhaftigen *Alternately,*

Born gray? Maybe

Graien eine gekommen? *Of the Graeae come?*

One eye. One tooth. Sharing

Wagest du Scheusal *Darest thou, monster,*

Taking turns

Neben der Schönheit *Beside beauty*

Graea? Here?

Dich vor dem Kennerblick *To show thyself before the connoisseur's gaze*

Monster. You dare?

Phöbus' zu zeigen? *Of Phoebus?*

Next to beauty?

Tritt du dennoch hervor nur immer; *Step forth nevertheless;*

Showing yourself. To someone who knows

Denn das Häßliche schaut er nicht, *For the ugly he sees not,*

Phoebus sees you

Wie sein heilig Auge noch *As his holy eye has never*

Come out anyway

Nie erblickte den Schatten. *Yet beheld a shadow.*

He doesn't see ugly. Lucky you

Doch uns Sterbliche nötigt, ach, *But us mortals, alas, compels*

Never seen shadow. His eyes

Leider trauriges Mißgeschick *Sadly sorrowful misfortune*

No shadow. Ever

Zu dem unsäglichen Augenschmerz, *To the unspeakable eye-pain,*

But us. We have to

Den das Verwerfliche, Ewig-Unselige *Which the contemptible, eternally accursed*

Sad luck

Schönheitliebenden rege macht. *Inflicts on lovers of beauty.*

Eye pain. Can't say how much

Ja, so höre denn, wenn du frech *Yes, then hear, if thou brazenly*

Disgusting cursed thing

Uns entgegenest, höre Fluch, *Confront us, hear curses,*

Makes beauty-lovers suffer

Höre jeglicher Schelte Drohn *Hear every threat of reproach*

Listen. If you dare

Aus dem verwünschenden Munde der Glücklichen, *From the cursing mouths of the fortunate,*

Face us. Get cursed

Die von Göttern gebildet sind. *Who are fashioned by gods.*

Scolding too. Lots

Phorkyas

Alt ist das Wort, doch bleibt hoch und wahr der Sinn, *Old is the saying, yet high and true remains its meaning,*

Lucky us. Cursing you

Daß Scham und Schönheit nie zusammen, Hand in Hand, *That Shame and Beauty never, hand in hand,*

Gods made us. Not you

Den Weg verfolgen über der Erde grünen Pfad. *Pursue their way along the earth's green path.*

Old saying. Still true

Tief eingewurzelt wohnt in beiden alter Haß, *Deep-rooted in both dwells ancient hate,*

Shame. Beauty. Don't mix

Daß, wo sie immer irgend auch des Weges sich *That wherever they may anywhere encounter*

Same road? Never

Begegnen, jede der Gegnerin den Rücken kehrt. *On the way, each turns her back upon her rival.*

Old hate. Both have it

Dann eilet jede wieder heftiger, weiter fort, *Then each hastens on more swiftly, further forth,*

Anywhere they meet

Die Scham betrübt, die Schönheit aber frech gesinnt, *Shame dejected, but Beauty boldly minded,*

Meet. Turn away

Bis sie zuletzt des Orkus hohle Nacht umfängt, *Until at last the hollow night of Orcus enfolds them,*

Run faster. Get away

Wenn nicht das Alter sie vorher gebändigt hat. *Unless old age has subdued them first.*

Shame mopes. Beauty struts

Euch find' ich nun, ihr Frechen, aus der Fremde her *I find you now, you brazen ones, from foreign lands*

Death gets them eventually. Both

Mit Übermut ergossen, gleich der Kraniche *Poured forth with insolence, like the cranes'*

Or old age. Whichever comes first

Laut-heiser klingendem Zug, der über unser Haupt, *Loud-hoarsely sounding train, which over our heads,*

Found you. Foreigners. Brazen ones

In langer Wolke, krächzend sein Getön herab *In a long cloud, croaking sends its noise down*

Arrogant. Crane-like

Schickt, das den stillen Wanderer über sich hinauf *Which entices the quiet wanderer to look up;*

Loud. Hoarse. Over us

Zu blicken lockt; doch ziehn sie ihren Weg dahin, *Yet they pursue their way,*

Long cloud. Croaking down

Er geht den seinen; also wird's mit uns geschehn. *He goes his own; so shall it be with us.*

Makes people look up

Wer seid denn ihr, daß ihr des Königes Hochpalast *Who are you then, that you dare rave around*

They keep going

Mänadisch wild, Betrunknen gleich, umtoben dürft? *The King's high palace like Maenads wild, like drunkards?*

Same with us

Wer seid ihr denn, daß ihr des Hauses Schaffnerin *Who are you then, that you howl at the house's stewardess*

Who are you? Raging here

Entgegenheulet, wie dem Mond der Hunde Schar? *As a pack of hounds howls at the moon?*

Palace. Acting crazy. Like drunks

Wähnt ihr, verborgen sei mir, welch Geschlecht ihr seid, *Do you think it is hidden from me what race you are,*

Who are you? Howling at me

Du kriegergezeugte, schlachterzogne junge Brut? *You war-begotten, battle-bred young brood?*

Dogs. Moon. That's you

Mannlustige du, so wie verführt verführende, *You man-lusting ones, seduced as well as seducing,*

I know what you are

Entnervend beide, Kriegers auch und Bürgers Kraft! *Enervating both warrior's and citizen's strength!*

War babies. Battle kids

Zu Hauf euch sehend, scheint mir ein Zikadenschwarm *Seeing you in a heap, you seem to me a locust swarm*

Man-hungry. Both ways

Herabzustürzen, deckend grüne Feldersaat. *Descending, covering the green field-crops.*

Weaken soldiers. Weaken citizens

Verzehrerinnen fremden Fleißes! Naschende *Consumers of others' toil! Nibbling*

Bunch of you. Like locusts

Vernichterinnen aufgekeimten Wohlstands ihr! *Destroyers of budding prosperity!*

Dropping down. Eating crops

Erobert', marktverkauft', vertauschte Ware du! *Conquered, market-sold, bartered merchandise!*

Eating their work. Nibbling

Helena

Wer gegenwarts der Frau die Dienerinnen schilt, *Who scolds the servants in the mistress's presence*

Destroy what's growing. You

Der Gebietrin Hausrecht tastet er vermessen an; *Presumptuously infringes on the lady's household right;*

Won. Sold. Traded. Things

Denn ihr gebührt allein, das Lobenswürdige *For it belongs to her alone to praise what is praiseworthy*

Yelling at my staff? In front of me?

Zu rühmen, wie zu strafen, was verwerflich ist. *As well as to punish what is blameworthy.*

Overstepping. My house

Auch bin des Dienstes ich wohl zufrieden, den sie mir *I am also well satisfied with the service they have*

I praise. My job

Geleistet, als die hohe Kraft von Ilios *Rendered me, when the high might of Ilion*

I punish. Also my job

Umlagert stand und fiel und lag; nicht weniger, *Stood besieged and fell and lay; no less*

Happy with them. Their service

Als wir der Irrfahrt kummervolle Wechselnot *When we endured the sorrowful, changing need*

When Troy was big. They served

Ertrugen, wo sonst jeder sich der Nächste bleibt. *Of our wandering, where each usually looks out for himself.*

The king did not specify it.

Auch hier erwart' ich Gleiches von der muntern Schar; *Here too I expect the same from the lively company;*

The king said nothing about what bleeds.

Nicht, was der Knecht sei, fragt der Herr, nur, wie er dient. *The master asks not what the servant is, only how he serves.*

He left the victim blank—curious that.

Drum schweige du und grinse sie nicht länger an. *Therefore be silent and grin at them no longer.*

No goat, no lamb, no thing with needs.

Hast du das Haus des Königs wohl verwahrt bisher *If you have kept the king's house well thus far*

Did not speak it? O word of woe!

Anstatt der Hausfrau, solches dient zum Ruhme dir; *In the mistress's stead, that redounds to your credit;*

He said nothing? Oh SHIT.

Doch jetzo kommt sie selber, tritt nun du zurück, *But now she herself has come, so step back,*

My bowels just clenched with what I know.

Damit nicht Strafe werde statt verdienten Lohns. *Lest punishment come instead of deserved reward.*

Darling, you're it.

Phorkyas

Den Hausgenossen drohen bleibt ein großes Recht, *To threaten the household members remains a great right,*

What woe befalls you?

Das gottbeglückten Herrschers hohe Gattin sich *Which the high consort of the god-blessed ruler*

Why do you shudder so?

Durch langer Jahre weise Leitung wohl verdient. *Has well earned through wise direction over long years.*

Your face has gone the color of old cheese.

Da du, nun Anerkannte, neu den alten Platz *Since you, now acknowledged, newly assume*

Spit it out—let the horror flow.

Der Königin und Hausfrau wiederum betrittst, *The old place of queen and mistress once again,*

Queen, you are meant!

So fasse längst erschlaffte Zügel, herrsche nun, *Seize the long-slackened reins, rule now,*

The sacrifice is you, babe.

Nimm in Besitz den Schatz und sämtlich uns dazu. *Take possession of the treasure and all of us as well.*

That lovely throat will meet the blade.

Vor allem aber schütze mich, die ältere, *But above all protect me, the elder,*

Surprise! You're not the cook—you're what they crave.

Vor dieser Schar, die neben deiner Schönheit Schwan *From this company, who beside your swan-like beauty*

I?

Nur schlecht befitticht', schnatterhafte Gänse sind. *Are but poorly feathered, cackling geese.*

Me?!

Chorführerin

Wie häßlich neben Schönheit zeigt sich Häßlichkeit. *How ugly beside Beauty does Ugliness appear.*

This body?

Phorkyas

Wie unverständlich neben Klugheit Unverstand. *How foolish beside Wisdom does Folly appear.*

Well fuck.

Choretide 1

Von Vater Erebus melde, melde von Mutter Nacht. *Tell of Father Erebus, tell of Mother Night.*

And these.

Phorkyas

So sprich von Scylla, leiblich dir Geschwisterkind. *Then speak of Scylla, your bodily cousin.*

Your girls too. The whole set.

Choretide 2

An deinem Stammbaum steigt manch Ungeheur empor. *Many a monster climbs up your family tree.*

Every pretty neck among you.

Phorkyas

Zum Orkus hin! da suche deine Sippschaft auf. *Off to Orcus! There seek out your kinfolk.*

It's a group rate—discount death, no sweat.

Choretide 3

Die dorten wohnen, sind dir alle viel zu jung. *Those who dwell there are all far too young for you.*

Woe and grief!

Phorkyas

Tiresias, den Alten, gehe buhlend an. *Go court old Tiresias.*

Oh no oh no oh no!

Choretide 4

Orions Amme war dir Ur-Urenkelin. *Orion's nurse was your great-great-granddaughter.*

Our spines have turned to ice.

Phorkyas

Harpyen, wahn' ich, fütterten dich im Unflat auf. *Harpies, I presume, raised you in filth.*

We're the party favors—what a show!

Choretide 5

Mit was ernährst du so gepflegte Magerkeit? *With what do you nourish such cultivated leanness?*

You will fall by the axe.

Phorkyas

Mit Blute nicht, wonach du allzulüstern bist. *Not with blood, for which you are all too greedy.*

The blade is waiting, freshly sharpened too.

Choretide 6

Begierig du auf Leichen, ekle Leiche selbst! *Greedy you for corpses, disgusting corpse yourself!*

That pretty head—thunk—into the basket.

Phorkyas

Vampyren-Zähne glänzen dir im frechen Maul. *Vampire-teeth gleam in your impudent maw.*

Chop chop, gorgeous. He's coming for you.

Chorführerin

Das deine stopf' ich, wenn ich sage, wer du seist. *Yours I'll stop, if I say who you are.*

Horrible yet foreboded; I, wretched one!

Phorkyas

So nenne dich zuerst; das Rätsel hebt sich auf. *Then name yourself first; the riddle will be solved.*

I sensed this coming—some dark intuition.

Helena

Nicht zürnend, aber traurend schreit' ich zwischen euch, *Not in anger, but in sorrow I step between you,*

My gut knew before my brain caught up.

Verbietend solchen Wechselstreites Ungestüm! *Forbidding such tumultuous exchange of quarrels!*

Well played, husband. Murderous ambition.

Denn Schädlicheres begegnet nichts dem Herrscherherrn *For nothing more harmful befalls the ruling lord*

Unavoidable it seems to me.

Als treuer Diener heimlich unterschworner Zwist. *Than faithful servants' secretly sworn strife.*

I don't see a way out of this mess.

Das Echo seiner Befehle kehrt alsdann nicht mehr *The echo of his commands then no longer returns*

The trap has sprung.

In schnell vollbrachter Tat wohlstimmig ihm zurück, *To him harmoniously in swiftly completed deeds,*

Unless... unless... unless...

Nein, eigenwillig brausend tost es um ihn her, *No, self-willedly roaring it rages around him,*

Ah! And us? What will befall us?

Den selbstverirrten, ins Vergebne scheltenden. *The self-bewildered one, scolding into the void.*

What about US though?!

Dies nicht allein. Ihr habt in sittlosem Zorn *This not alone. In immoral anger you have*

Our necks! Our precious necks!

Unsel'ger Bilder Schreckgestalten hergebannt, *Conjured up here the terror-forms of accursed images,*

We're too young and hot to die! Say it ain't so!

Die mich umdrängen, daß ich selbst zum Orkus mich *Which crowd around me, so that I myself feel*

She dies a noble death.

Gerissen fühle, vaterländ'scher Flur zum Trutz. *Torn away to Orcus, in defiance of my native soil.*

She gets the dignified axe treatment, at least.

Ist's wohl Gedächtnis? war es Wahn, der mich ergreift? *Is it memory? Was it delusion that seizes me?*

One clean stroke, royally done.

War ich das alles? Bin ich's? Werd' ich's künftig sein, *Was I all that? Am I? Shall I be in the future*

You lot? Strung up like thrushes at a feast.

Das Traum- und Schreckbild jener Städteverwüstenden? *The dream and terror-image of that destroyer of cities?*

But on the high beam inside, which supports the roof's gable,

Die Mädchen schauern, aber du, die älteste, *The maidens shudder, but you, the eldest,*

You'll dangle from the rafters, dangling in a row.

Du stehst gelassen; rede mir verständig Wort. *You stand calm; speak to me a sensible word.*

Kicking, twitching, tongues going purple.

Phorkyas

Wer langer Jahre mannigfaltigen Glücks gedenkt, *Who recalls long years of manifold happiness,*

Bird-trap style—a dozen little death-dance tableaux.

Ihm scheint zuletzt die höchste Göttergunst ein Traum. *To him at last the highest divine favor seems a dream.*

Ghosts! Like frozen images you stand there.

Du aber, hochbegünstigt sonder Maß und Ziel, *But you, highly favored beyond measure and limit,*

Look at you—paralyzed with fear.

In Lebensreihe sahst nur Liebesbrünstige, *In your life's course saw only those burning with love,*

Not a breath, not a twitch among you.

Entzündet rasch zum kühnsten Wagstück jeder Art. *Quickly inflamed to the boldest venture of every kind.*

Death's already got you by the ear.

Schon Theseus haschte früh dich, gierig aufgeregt, *Already Theseus early snatched you, greedily excited,*

Frightened to depart from the day, which belongs not to you.

Wie Herakles stark, ein herrlich schön geformter Mann. *Strong as Heracles, a splendidly well-formed man.*

You cling to sunshine that was never yours.

Helena

Entführte mich, ein zehenjährig schlankes Reh, *He carried me off, a ten-year-old slender fawn,*

Borrowed light, borrowed breath, borrowed flesh.

Und mich umschloß Aphidnus' Burg in Attika. *And Aphidnus' fortress enclosed me in Attica.*

Time to settle up—close those doors.

Phorkyas

Durch Kastor und durch Pollux aber bald befreit, *But soon freed by Castor and by Pollux,*

Humans, all ghosts just like you,

Umworben standst du ausgesuchter Heldenschar. *You stood courted by a select band of heroes.*

Everyone alive is just pre-dead.

Helena

Doch stille Gunst vor allen, wie ich gern gesteh', *Yet quiet favor above all, as I gladly confess,*

Walking meat with expiration dates.

Gewann Patroklos, er, des Peliden Ebenbild. *Patroclus won, he, the image of Peleus' son.*

The only question's when, not if—enough said.

Phorkyas

Doch Vaterwille traute dich an Menelas, *But your father's will betrothed you to Menelaus,*

Also do not willingly renounce the noble sunshine.

Den kühnen Seedurchstreicher, Hausbewahrer auch. *The bold rover of the seas, preserver of the house as well.*

Nobody wants to go—that's universal.

Helena

Die Tochter gab er, gab des Reichs Bestellung ihm. *He gave him the daughter, gave him the rule of the realm.*

We clutch at life with desperate fingers.

Aus ehlichem Beisein sproßte dann Hermione. *From marital union then sprang Hermione.*

Death's the only non-negotiable reversal.

Phorkyas

Doch als er fern sich Kretas Erbe kühn erstritt, *But when he was far away, boldly fighting for Crete's inheritance,*

But no one begs or saves them from the end.

Dir Einsamen da erschien ein allzuschöner Gast. *To you, the lonely one, there appeared an all-too-beautiful guest.*

No appeals process, no last-minute call.

Helena

Warum gedenkst du jener halben Witwenschaft, *Why do you recall that half-widowhood,*

The axe falls when the axe falls.

Und welch Verderben gräßlich mir daraus erwuchs? *And what horrible ruin grew from it for me?*

That's mortality—it comes for all.

Phorkyas

Auch jene Fahrt, mir freigebornen Kreterin *That voyage too, on me, a freeborn Cretan woman,*

They all know it, yet only few accept it.

Gefangenschaft erschuf sie, lange Sklaverei. *Brought captivity, long slavery.*

Everybody knows and nobody believes.

Helena

Als Schaffnerin bestellt' er dich sogleich hieher, *As stewardess he appointed you here at once,*

We live like we'll live forever.

Vertrauend vieles, Burg und kühn erworbnen Schatz. *Entrusting much, the fortress and boldly won treasure.*

Until the blade comes down and nobody grieves.

Phorkyas

Die du verließest, Ilios' umtürmter Stadt *Which you abandoned, turning to Ilion's towered city*

Enough, you are lost! So fresh to work.

Und unerschöpften Liebesfreuden zugewandt. *And inexhaustible joys of love.*

Anyway! Let's get this slaughter started!

Helena

Gedenke nicht der Freuden! allzuherben Leids *Recall not the joys! All-too-bitter sorrow's*

No more philosophizing—time to die.

Unendlichkeit ergoß sich über Brust und Haupt. *Infinity poured over breast and head.*

Places everyone! Death's a party—get it charted!

Phorkyas

Doch sagt man, du erschienst ein doppelhaft Gebild, *Yet they say you appeared as a double form,*

Come hither, you dark, spherical monster!

In Ilios gesehen und in Ägypten auch. *Seen in Ilion and in Egypt too.*

Roll out the murder equipment!

Helena

Verwirre wüsten Sinnes Aberwitz nicht gar. *Do not utterly confuse my already confused mind's delusion.*

Here comes the heavy gear.

Selbst jetzo, welche denn ich sei, ich weiß es nicht. *Even now, which one I am, I do not know.*

Death's entourage—looking particularly hellish and resplendent.

Phorkyas

Dann sagen sie: aus hohlem Schattenreich herauf *Then they say: from the hollow realm of shades*

Roll yourselves here, here there is ample harm to do.

Gesellte sich inbrünstig noch Achill zu dir! *Achilles still joined himself ardently to you!*

Plenty of throats for you to practice on.

Dich früher liebend gegen allen Geschicks Beschluß. *Loving you before, against all fate's decree.*

A buffet of beautiful victims.

Helena

Ich als Idol, ihm dem Idol verband ich mich. *I as phantom, to him the phantom I joined myself.*

Step right up, the slaughterhouse is open—come on!

Es war ein Traum, so sagen ja die Worte selbst. *It was a dream, as the words themselves say.*

Make room for the portable altar, the gold-horned one.

Ich schwinde hin und werde selbst mir ein Idol. *I fade away and become a phantom to myself.*

Drag that fancy killing-table into place.

Chor

Schweige, schweige! *Be silent, be silent!*

The altar gleams—hungry for blood.

Mißblickende, Mißredende du! *You evil-gazing, evil-speaking one!*

Such elegant murder! Such liturgical grace!

Aus so gräßlichen einzahnigen *From such horrible single-toothed*

Let the axe lie gleaming above the silver rim.

Lippen, was enthaucht wohl *Lips, what breath can come*

Display the blade—let them admire it first.

Solchem furchtbaren Greuelschlund! *From such a fearful horror-maw!*

So shiny, so sharp, so ready.

Denn der Böartige, wohlütig erscheinend, *For the malicious one, appearing benevolent,*

Death-metal: polished for maximum thirst.

Wolfesgrimm unter schafwolligem Vlies, *Wolf's fury under sheep-woolly fleece,*

Fill the water jugs, there is washing to do.

Mir ist er weit schrecklicher als des drei- *To me is far more terrible than the three-*

Someone's got to clean up after.

köpfigen Hundes Rachen. *Headed hound's jaws.*

Blood makes such a mess on marble.

Ängstlich lauschend stehn wir da: *Anxiously listening we stand:*

Scrub scrub scrub—it's almost laughter.

Wann? wie? wo nur bricht's hervor, *When? how? where will it break forth,*

Of the black blood's horrible defilement.

Solcher Tücke *Such malice's*

Dark gore splashing everywhere.

Tiefauflauerndes Ungetüm? *Deep-lurking monster?*

Sticky, spreading, staining.

Nun denn, statt freundlich mit Trost reich begabten, *Now then, instead of friendly, comfort-richly endowed,*

Better bring the mop—and don't forget the spare!

Letheschenkenden, holdmildesten Worts *Lethe-granting, graciously mild words,*

Spread the precious carpet here in the dust.

Regest du auf aller Vergangenheit *You stir up of all the past*

Roll out the red carpet—literally.

Bösestes mehr denn Gutes *The worst rather than the good*

Something soft for royal knees.

Und verdüsterst allzugleich *And darken at once*

A bit of comfort before the big finality.

Mit dem Glanz der Gegenwart *With the splendor of the present*

That the victim may kneel down royally.

Auch der Zukunft *Also the future's*

Even in death, observe the protocol.

Mild aufschimmerndes Hoffnungslicht. *Gently glimmering light of hope.*

Bend that beautiful neck just so.

Schweige, schweige! *Be silent, be silent!*

Aristocratic to the end—she's giving it her all.

Daß der Königin Seele, *That the queen's soul,*

And wrapped up, though with severed head at once.

Schon zu entfliehen bereit, *Already ready to flee,*

Bundle her up nice and neat after.

Sich noch halte, festhalte *May still hold, hold fast*

Head over here, body over there.

Die Gestalt aller Gestalten, *The form of all forms,*

Some assembly required—what's a little laughter?

Welche die Sonne jemals beschien. *Which the sun ever shone upon.*

May yet be buried properly and worthily.

Phorkyas

Tritt hervor aus flüchtigen Wolken, hohe Sonne dieses Tags, *Come forth from fleeting clouds, high sun of this day,*

A proper funeral—she deserves that much.

Die verschleiert schon entzückte, blendend nun im Glanze herrscht. *Which delighted while veiled, now rules dazzling in its splendor.*

Even headless queens get nice tombs.

Wie die Welt sich dir entfaltet, schaust du selbst mit holdem Blick. *As the world unfolds before you, you yourself behold with gracious gaze.*

Classy all the way—the final touch.

Schelten sie mich auch für häßlich, kenn' ich doch das Schöne wohl. *Though they scold me as ugly, I well know the beautiful.*

The queen stands here at the side, pondering.

Helena

Tret' ich schwankend aus der Öde, die im Schwindel mich umgab, *Step I wavering from the void, which surrounded me in dizziness,*

Helena's gone quiet—wheels turning.

Pflegt' ich gern der Ruhe wieder, denn so müd' ist mein Gebein: *Gladly would I rest again, for so weary are my limbs:*

Her mind is racing behind those perfect eyes.

Doch es ziemet Königinnen, allen Menschen ziemt es wohl, *Yet it befits queens, it befits all people well,*

Something's burning.

Sich zu fassen, zu ermannen, was auch drohend überrascht. *To compose, to brace themselves, whatever threatening may surprise.*

The maidens wilt like mown meadow grass.

Helena

Eures Haders frech Versäumnis auszugleichen, seid bereit; *To make good the rude neglect of your quarrel, be prepared;*

We're falling apart over here!

Eilt, ein Opfer zu bestellen, wie der König mir gebot. *Hasten to prepare a sacrifice, as the king commanded me.*

Knees buckling, hearts hammering.

Phorkyas

Alles ist bereit im Hause, Schale, Dreifuß, scharfes Beil, *All is ready in the house, bowl, tripod, sharp axe,*

Terror makes everything crystal clear.

Zum Besprengen, zum Beräuchern; das zu Opfernde zeig' an! *For sprinkling, for incensing; show what is to be sacrificed!*

But to me, the eldest, as sacred duty requires.

Helena

Nicht bezeichnet' es der König. *The king did not specify it.*

I'm the leader—I should do something.

Phorkyas

Sprach's nicht aus? O Jammerwort! *Did not speak it? O word of woe!*

Step up, speak out, take charge.

Helena

Welch ein Jammer überfällt dich? *What woe befalls you?*

Even if my voice is a trembling thing.

Phorkyas

Königin, du bist gemeint! *Queen, you are meant!*

It seems meet to exchange words with you, most ancient one.

Helena

Ich? *I?*

Let me talk to the crone.

Phorkyas

Und diese. *And these.*

Elder to elder—maybe we can deal.

Chor

Weh und Jammer! *Woe and grief!*

Two old birds on a desperate phone.

Phorkyas

Fallen wirst du durch das Beil. *You will fall by the axe.*

You are experienced, wise, seem well-disposed to us.

Helena

Gräßlich doch geahnt; ich Arme! *Horrible yet foreboded; I, wretched one!*

You seem like you know things.

Phorkyas

Unvermeidlich scheint es mir. *Unavoidable it seems to me.*

That hideous face hides something useful.

Chor

Ach! Und uns? was wird begegnen? *Ah! And us? What will befall us?*

Maybe you've got strings to pull—puppet-master springs?

Phorkyas

Sie stirbt einen edlen Tod; *She dies a noble death;*

Although this brainless company mistook you.

Doch am hohen Balken drinnen, der des Daches Giebel trägt, *But on the high beam inside, which supports the roof's gable,*

Sorry my girls insulted you earlier.

Wie im Vogelfang die Drosseln, zappelt ihr der Reihe nach. *Like thrushes in a bird-trap, you will dangle one after another.*

They're young and dumb and scared.

Phorkyas

Gespenster! Gleich erstarrten Bildern steht ihr da, *Ghosts! Like frozen images you stand there,*

Forgive the lip—we need you, barrier-breaker, hurdle-hauler.

Geschreckt, vom Tag zu scheiden, der euch nicht gehört. *Frightened to depart from the day, which belongs not to you.*

Therefore say what you may know of possible rescue.

Die Menschen, die Gespenster sämtlich gleich wie ihr, *Humans, all ghosts just like you,*

Is there a way out? Tell us now!

Entsagen auch nicht willig hehrem Sonnenschein; *Also do not willingly renounce the noble sunshine;*

Any exit, any angle, any trick?

Doch bittet oder rettet niemand sie vom Schluß; *But no one begs or saves them from the end;*

Save our necks and we'll kiss your... brow.

Sie wissen's alle, wenigen doch gefällt es nur. *They all know it, yet only few accept it.*

It is easily said: on the queen alone it depends.

Genug, ihr seid verloren! Also frisch ans Werk. *Enough, you are lost! So fresh to work.*

Simple answer: Helena decides.

Herbei, du düstres, kugelrundes Ungetüm! *Come hither, you dark, spherical monster!*

Her choice, her call, her move.

Wälzt euch hierher, zu schaden gibt es hier nach Lust. *Roll yourselves here, here there is ample harm to do.*

She holds all the cards—now let's see how she rides.

Dem Tragaltar, dem goldgehörnten, gebet Platz, *Make room for the portable altar, the gold-horned one,*

To preserve herself, and you additions as well with her.

Das Beil, es liege blinkend über dem Silberrand, *Let the axe lie gleaming above the silver rim,*

Save herself, save you as bonus cargo.

Die Wasserkrüge füllet, abzuwaschen gibt's *Fill the water jugs, there is washing to do*

You're the accessories—she's the main event.

Des schwarzen Blutes greuelvolle Besudelung. *Of the black blood's horrible defilement.*

Package deal—escape's a go?

Den Teppich breitet köstlich hier am Staube hin, *Spread the precious carpet here in the dust,*

Resolution is necessary and the swiftest.

Damit das Opfer niederkniet königlich *That the victim may kneel down royally*

But she has to decide NOW.

Und eingewickelt, zwar getrennten Haupts sogleich, *And wrapped up, though with severed head at once,*

No time for second-guessing.

Anständig würdig aber doch bestattet sei. *May yet be buried properly and worthily.*

Commit or die—take a bow.

Chorführerin

Die Königin stehet sinnend an der Seite hier, *The queen stands here at the side, pondering,*

Most venerable of the Fates, wisest Sibyl!

Die Mädchen welken gleich gemähtem Wiesengras; *The maidens wilt like mown meadow grass;*

Oh great ancient one! Oh wise hag!

Mir aber deucht, der ältesten, heiliger Pflicht gemäß, *But to me, the eldest, as sacred duty requires,*

We're begging here—full grovel mode.

Mit dir das Wort zu wechseln, Ur-Urälteste. *It seems meet to exchange words with you, most ancient one.*

Don't let us dangle like some sad shopping bag!

Du bist erfahren, weise, scheinst uns gut gesinnt, *You are experienced, wise, seem well-disposed to us,*

Hold the golden shears closed, then proclaim to us day and salvation!

Obschon verkennend hirnlos diese Schar dich traf. *Although this brainless company mistook you.*

Don't snip our threads just yet!

Drum sage, was du möglich noch von Rettung weißt. *Therefore say what you may know of possible rescue.*

Keep those life-lines long and loose!

Phorkyas

Ist leicht gesagt: von der Königin hängt allein es ab, *It is easily said: on the queen alone it depends,*

We'll owe you one—our eternal debt!

Sich selbst zu erhalten, euch Zugaben auch mit ihr. *To preserve herself, and you additions as well with her.*

For we already feel in swaying, wavering, dangling undelightfully.

Entschlossenheit ist nötig und die behendeste. *Resolution is necessary and the swiftest.*

We can already feel the rope.

Chor

Ehrenwürdigste der Parzen, weiseste Sibylle du, *Most venerable of the Fates, wisest Sibyl,*

Swinging, choking, kicking.

Halte gesperrt die goldene Schere, dann verkünd' uns Tag und Heil; *Hold the golden shears closed, then proclaim to us day and salvation;*

Our bodies rehearsing—goodbye hope!

Denn wir fühlen schon im Schweben, Schwanken, Bammeln unergetzlich *For we already feel in swaying, wavering, dangling undelightfully*

Our little limbs, which would rather first have taken their delight in dance.

Unsere Gliederchen, die lieber erst im Tanze sich ergetzten, *Our little limbs, which would rather first have taken their delight in dance,*

These legs were made for dancing!

Ruhten drauf an Liebchens Brust. *Then rested on the beloved's breast.*

Not twitching on a gibbet.

Helena

Laß diese bangen! Schmerz empfind' ich, keine Furcht; *Let these be anxious! I feel pain, no fear;*

We've got moves—sensual, entrancing!

Doch kennst du Rettung, dankbar sei sie anerkannt. *But if you know of rescue, gratefully let it be acknowledged.*

Then rested on the beloved's breast.

Dem Klugem, Weitumsichtigen zeigt fürwahr sich oft *To the clever, far-seeing one indeed often appears*

After the dance, the soft collapse.

Unmögliches noch als möglich. Sprich und sag' es an. *The impossible yet as possible. Speak and tell it.*

Snuggled up against someone warm.

Chor

Sprich und sage, sag uns eilig: wie entrinnen wir den grausen, *Speak and say, say to us quickly: how do we escape the dread,*

That's how we wanted to end—lover's laps.

Garstigen Schlingen, die bedrohlich, als die schlechtesten Geschmeide, *Nasty nooses, which threaten-
ingly, as the worst of ornaments,*

Let these be anxious! I feel pain, no fear.

Sich um unsre Hälse ziehen? Vorempfinden wir's, die Armen, *Are tightening around our necks? We
feel it beforehand, we poor ones,*

Let them panic—I'm past that now.

Zum Entatmen, zum Ersticken, wenn du, Rhea, aller Götter *To suffocation, to choking, if you, Rhea,
of all gods*

Something's shifted in my chest.

Hohe Mutter, dich nicht erbarmst. *The high mother, do not have mercy.*

Fear's been replaced by a cold clear vow.

Phorkyas

Habt ihr Geduld, des Vortrags langgedehnten Zug *Have you the patience, the discourse's long-drawn
course*

But if you know of rescue, gratefully let it be acknowledged.

Still anzuhören? Mancherlei Geschichten sind's. *To hear in silence? There are many kinds of
stories.*

If there's a way out, I'm listening.

Chor

Geduld genug! Zuhörend leben wir indes. *Patience enough! Listening, we live meanwhile.*

Speak plainly, crone.

Phorkyas

Dem, der zu Hause verharrend edlen Schatz bewahrt *He who, remaining at home, guards noble
treasure*

I'm ready—my whole being's glistening.

Und hoher Wohnung Mauern auszukitten weiß, *And knows how to cement the walls of lofty dwelling,*

To the clever, far-seeing one indeed often appears.

Wie auch das Dach zu sichern vor des Regens Drang, *As also to secure the roof against the rain's
pressure,*

The wise can see what others miss.

Dem wird es wohlgehn lange Lebenstage durch; *For him it will go well through long days of life;*

Paths invisible to panicked eyes.

Wer aber seiner Schwelle heilige Richte leicht *But whoever lightly crosses his threshold's sacred boundary*

There's always a door—what's behind this?

Mit flüchtigen Sohlen überschreitet freventlich, *With fleeting soles, presumptuously,*

The impossible yet as possible. Speak and tell it.

Der findet wiederkehrend wohl den alten Platz, *He, returning, indeed finds the old place,*

Impossible can flip to possible fast.

Doch umgeändert alles, wo nicht gar zerstört. *But all changed, if not entirely destroyed.*

Tell me the trick.

Helena

Wozu dergleichen wohlbekannte Sprüche hier? *Why such well-known sayings here?*

I'm all ears—make this last.

Du willst erzählen; rege nicht an Verdrießliches. *You want to tell; do not stir up what is vexing.*

Speak and say, say to us quickly!

Phorkyas

Geschichtlich ist es, ist ein Vorwurf keineswegs. *It is historical, by no means a reproach.*

Hurry up! We're dying here!

Raubschiffend ruderte Menelas von Bucht zu Bucht, *Pirating, Menelaus rowed from bay to bay,*

Literally—dying—soon!

Gestad' und Inseln, alles streift' er feindlich an, *Coast and islands, all he touched with hostile intent,*

Less philosophy, more escape gear!

Mit Beute wiederkehrend, wie sie drinnen starrt. *Returning with booty, as it stands stacked inside.*

How do we escape the dread, nasty nooses?

Vor Ilios verbracht' er langer Jahre zehn; *Before Ilion he spent long years ten;*

How do we dodge the neck-necklaces?

Zur Heimfahrt aber weiß ich nicht wie viel es war. *For the homeward voyage I know not how many it was.*

Those rope accessories nobody asked for?

Allein wie steht es hier am Platz um Tyndareos' *But how does it stand here in place around Tyndareos'*

We prefer pearls to death-embraces!

Erhabnes Haus? wie stehet es mit dem Reich umher? *Exalted house? How does it stand with the realm around?*

Which threateningly, as the worst of ornaments.

Helena

Ist dir denn so das Schelten gänzlich einverleibt, *Is scolding then so completely incorporated in you,*

Worst jewelry ever invented.

Daß ohne Tadeln du keine Lippe regen kannst? *That without reproaching you cannot move a lip?*

The anti-bling.

Phorkyas

So viele Jahre stand verlassen das Talgebrig, *So many years stood deserted the mountain valley,*

Fashion crime: strangled and suspended.

Das hinter Sparta nordwärts in die Höhe steigt, *Which rises northward behind Sparta into the heights,*

Are tightening around our necks?

Täygetos im Rücken, wo als muntreter Bach *Täygetus at its back, where as a lively brook*

Getting snuggler by the minute.

Herab Eurotas rollt und dann, durch unser Tal *Eurotas rolls down and then, flowing broadly through our valley*

Can't breathe, can't think.

An Rohren breit hinfließend, eure Schwäne nährt. *Among the reeds, nourishes your swans.*

This choker trend—we're definitely not in it!

Dort hinten still im Gebirgtal hat ein kühn Geschlecht *Back there quietly in the mountain valley a bold race*

We feel it beforehand, we poor ones.

Sich angesiedelt, dringend aus cimmerischer Nacht, *Has settled, pressing forth from Cimmerian night,*

Pre-traumatic stress disorder.

Und unersteiglich feste Burg sich aufgetürmt, *And piled up an impregnable strong fortress,*

Dying before we're dead.

Von da sie Land und Leute placken, wie's behagt. *From which they plague land and people, as they please.*

Our nervous systems—completely out of order!

Helena

Das konnten sie vollführen? Ganz unmöglich scheint's. *They could accomplish that? It seems quite impossible.*

To suffocation, to choking.

Phorkyas

Sie hatten Zeit, vielleicht an zwanzig Jahre sind's. *They had time, perhaps twenty years it is.*

Gagging, gasping, going blue.

Helena

Ist einer Herr? sind's Räuber viel, verbündete? *Is there one lord? Are they many robbers, allied?*

Windpipes closing down.

Phorkyas

Nicht Räuber sind es, einer aber ist der Herr. *They are not robbers, but one is the lord.*

This is NOT the review!

Ich schelt' ihn nicht, und wenn er schon mich heimgesucht. *I do not scold him, even though he visited me.*

If you, Rhea, of all gods the high mother, do not have mercy.

Wohl konnt' er alles nehmen, doch begnügt' er sich *He could well have taken all, but he contented himself*

Mother of the gods, please intervene!

Mit wenigen Freigeschenken, nannt' er's, nicht Tribut. *With a few free gifts, he called them, not tribute.*

Divine Mom, help your girls!

Helena

Wie sieht er aus? *What does he look like?*

We're too cute to die—you know what I mean?

Phorkyas

Nicht übel! mir gefällt er schon. *Not bad! I rather like him.*

Have you the patience, the discourse's long-drawn course to hear in silence?

Es ist ein munterer, kecker, wohlgebildeter, *He is a lively, bold, well-formed man,*

This is going to take a minute.

Wie unter Griechen wenig', ein verständ'ger Mann. *As few among Greeks, a sensible man.*

Settle in for the exposition.

Man schilt das Volk Barbaren, doch ich dächte nicht, *They call the people barbarians, but I would not think*

There's backstory—you're gonna have to sit and spin it.

Daß grausam einer wäre, wie vor Ilios *That any one were cruel, as before Ilion*

There are many kinds of stories.

Gar mancher Held sich menschenfresserisch erwies. *Many a hero showed himself man-devouring.*

It's complicated.

Ich acht' auf seine Großheit, ihm vertraut' ich mich. *I heed his greatness, I would trust myself to him.*

History lesson incoming.

Und seine Burg! die solltet ihr mit Augen sehn! *And his castle! You should see it with your own eyes!*

Bear with me—this is gonna get narrated.

Das ist was anderes gegen plumpes Mauerwerk, *That is something else against crude masonry,*

Patience enough! Listening, we live meanwhile.

Das eure Väter, mir nichts dir nichts, aufgewälzt, *Which your fathers piled up, carelessly,*

Talk as long as you want—we're alive while you do!

Zyklopisch wie Zyklopen, rohen Stein sogleich *Cyclopean like Cyclopes, raw stone at once*

Every word is another breath.

Auf rohe Steine stürzend; dort hingegen, dort *Hurling onto raw stones; there on the contrary, there*

Filibuster forever—that's our cue!

Ist alles senk- und waagrecht und regelhaft. *All is vertical and horizontal and regular.*

He who, remaining at home, guards noble treasure.

Von außen schaut sie! himmelan sie strebt empor, *Look at it from outside! It strives upward to heaven,*

The homebody who protects his stuff.

So starr, so wohl in Fugen, spiegelglatt wie Stahl. *So rigid, so well in joints, mirror-smooth like steel.*

Settled, grounded, keeping things tight.

Zu klettern hier - ja selbst der Gedanke gleitet ab. *To climb here - yes even the thought slides off.*

He's got it figured—steady's enough.

Und innen großer Höfe Raumgelasse, rings *And inside great courts' spacious chambers, all around*
And knows how to cement the walls of lofty dwelling.

Mit Baulichkeit umgeben, aller Art und Zweck. *Surrounded by structures, of every kind and purpose.*

Fixes the house, maintains the roof.

Da seht ihr Säulen, Säulchen, Bogen, Bögelchen, *There you see columns, small columns, arches, little arches,*

Caulks the cracks, patches the holes.

Altane, Galerien, zu schauen aus und ein, *Balconies, galleries, to look out and in,*

Domestic god—here's the proof.

Und Wappen. *And coats of arms.*

As also to secure the roof against the rain's pressure.

Chor

Was sind Wappen? *What are coats of arms?*

Keeps the weather out.

Phorkyas

Ajax führte ja *Ajax indeed bore*

Dry inside when storms come howling.

Geschlungene Schlang' im Schilde, wie ihr selbst gesehn. *A coiled serpent on his shield, as you yourselves have seen.*

That's what home's about.

Die Sieben dort vor Theben trugen Bildnerein *The Seven there before Thebes bore devices*

For him it will go well through long days of life.

Ein jeder auf seinem Schilde, reich bedeutungsvoll. *Each on his shield, richly meaningful.*

That guy lives a long good life.

Da sah man Mond und Stern' am nächtigen Himmelsraum, *There one saw moon and stars in the nocturnal sky,*

Everything in place, everything maintained.

Auch Göttin, Held und Leiter, Schwerter, Fackeln auch, *Also goddess, hero and ladder, swords, torches too,*

Minimal drama, minimal strife.

Und was Bedrängliches guten Städten grimmig droht. *And what threatening things grimly menace good cities.*

But whoever lightly crosses his threshold's sacred boundary.

Ein solch Gebilde führt auch unsre Heldenschar *Such an image our band of heroes also bears*

But the one who wanders off.

Von seinen Ur-Urahnen her in Farbenglanz. *From their ancestors in radiant colors.*

Who leaves home chasing something shiny.

Da seht ihr Löwen, Adler, Klau' und Schnabel auch, *There you see lions, eagles, claw and beak too,*

Who abandons hearth—that guy's soft.

Dann Büffelhörner, Flügel, Rosen, Pfauenschweif, *Then buffalo horns, wings, roses, peacock tail,*

With fleeting soles, presumptuously.

Auch Streifen, gold und schwarz und silbern, blau und rot. *Also stripes, gold and black and silver, blue and red.*

Skipping out like it's nothing.

Dergleichen hängt in Sälen Reih' an Reihe fort. *Such things hang in halls row upon row.*

Light feet, lighter conscience.

In Sälen, grenzenlosen, wie die Welt so weit; *In halls, boundless, as wide as the world;*

Adventure-hungry, heart a-thumping.

Da könnt ihr tanzen! *There you can dance!*

He, returning, indeed finds the old place.

Chor

Sage, gibt's auch Tänzer da? *Say, are there also dancers there?*

He comes back eventually.

Phorkyas

Die besten! goldgelockte, frische Bubenschar. *The best! Golden-curved, fresh band of lads.*

The wanderer returns at last.

Die duften Jugend! Paris duftete einzig so, *They smell of youth! Paris alone smelled so*

But surprise—it's not the place it used to be.

Als er der Königin zu nahe kam. *When he came too close to the queen.*

But all changed, if not entirely destroyed.

Helena

Du fällst *You fall*

Everything's different or wrecked.

Ganz aus der Rolle; sage mir das letzte Wort! *Quite out of character; tell me the final word!*

The home he left is gone or altered.

Phorkyas

Du sprichst das letzte, sagst mit Ernst vernehmlich Ja! *You speak the last, say with earnestness audibly Yes!*

His life's been architecturally decked.

Sogleich umgeb' ich dich mit jener Burg. *At once I will surround you with that castle.*

Why such well-known sayings here?

Chor

O sprich *O speak*

What's with the proverbs, grandma?

Das kurze Wort und rette dich und uns zugleich! *The short word and save yourself and us at once!*

We get it—stay home, don't roam.

Helena

Wie? sollt' ich fürchten, daß der König Menelas *What? Should I fear that King Menelaus*

Is there a point in this slow-motion panorama?

So grausam sich verginge, mich zu schädigen? *Would so cruelly transgress, as to harm me?*

You want to tell; do not stir up what is vexing.

Phorkyas

Hast du vergessen, wie er deinen Deiphobus, *Have you forgotten how he mutilated your Deiphobus,*

Get to the good part.

Des totgekämpften Paris Bruder, unerhört *The brother of Paris slain in battle, unheard-of,*

Skip the guilt trip.

Verstümmelte, der starrsinnig Witwe dich erstritt *Who stubbornly won you as widow*

We're literally dying here—restart!

Und glücklich kebste? Nas' und Ohren schnitt er ab *And happily kept you as concubine? Nose and ears he cut off*

It is historical, by no means a reproach.

Und stümmelte mehr so: Greuel war es anzuschauen. *And mutilated more besides: horror it was to behold.*

Just stating facts—not blaming anyone.

Helena

Das tat er jenem, meinetwegen tat er das. *He did that to him, for my sake he did that.*

This is what happened while you were away.

Phorkyas

Um jenes willen wird er dir das gleiche tun. *For that one's sake he will do the same to you.*

History lesson: ready? Here we come.

Unteilbar ist die Schönheit; der sie ganz besaß, *Indivisible is beauty; he who possessed it wholly,*

Pirating, Menelaus rowed from bay to bay.

Zerstört sie lieber, fluchend jedem Teilbesitz. *Rather destroys it, cursing every partial possession.*

Your husband played pirate king for years.

Chor

Hörst du nicht die Hörner schallen? siehst der Waffen Blitze nicht? *Do you not hear the horns resounding? Do you not see the weapons' flashes?*

Raiding, pillaging, sailing around.

Phorkyas

Sei willkommen, Herr und König, gerne geb' ich Rechenschaft. *Be welcome, lord and king, gladly do I give account.*

Instead of coming home—what a cavalier of tears!

Chor

Aber wir? *But we?*

Coast and islands, all he touched with hostile intent.

Phorkyas

Ihr wißt es deutlich, seht vor Augen ihren Tod, *You know it clearly, see before your eyes her death,*

He hit every shoreline looking for loot.

Merkt den eurigen da drinne: nein, zu helfen ist euch nicht. *Note your own inside: no, there is no helping you.*

Greedy bastard couldn't stop collecting.

Helena

Ich sann mir aus das Nächste, was ich wagen darf. *I have thought out the nearest thing I dare venture.*

War criminal with a sailor suit!

Ein Widerdämon bist du, das empfind' ich wohl *A counter-demon you are, that I feel well*

Returning with booty, as it stands stacked inside.

Und fürchte, Gutes wendest du zum Bösen um. *And fear you turn good to evil.*

Look at all the crap he brought back.

Vor allem aber folgen will ich dir zur Burg; *But above all I will follow you to the castle;*

Treasures piled to the ceiling.

Das andre weiß ich; was die Königin dabei *The rest I know; what the queen thereby*

Hoarder energy—attack, attack, attack!

Im tiefen Busen geheimnisvoll verbergen mag, *May mysteriously hide in her deep breast,*

Before Ilion he spent long years ten.

Sei jedem unzugänglich. Alte, geh voran! *Let it be inaccessible to all. Old one, lead the way!*

Ten years at Troy, fighting and sulking.

Chor

O wie gern gehen wir hin, *O how gladly we go thither,*

A decade of war for your pretty face.

Eilenden Fußes; *With hastening feet;*

Meanwhile back home—everything was hulking.

Hinter uns Tod, *Behind us death,*

For the homeward voyage I know not how many it was.

Vor uns abermals *Before us once again*

And the trip home took god knows how long.

Ragender Feste *The towering fortress's*

Wandering, delayed, distracted.

Unzugängliche Mauer. *Inaccessible wall.*

Your GPS husband went wrong after wrong.

Schütze sie ebenso gut, *May it protect as well,*

But how does it stand here in place around Tyndareos' exalted house?

Eben wie Ilios' Burg, *Even as Ilion's fortress,*

So what happened here while he was gone?

Die doch endlich nur *Which only finally*

Your daddy's palace—what's the status?

Niederträchtiger List erlag. *Succumbed to base cunning.*

Something's been going on.

Wie? aber wie? *How? But how?*

How does it stand with the realm around?

Schwestern, schaut euch um! *Sisters, look around you!*

The neighborhood's changed.

War es nicht heiterer Tag? *Was it not a brighter day?*

New management moved in.

Nebel schwanken streifig empor *Mists waver up in streaks*

Your kingdom got rearranged.

Aus Eurotas' heil'ger Flut; *From Eurotas' sacred flood;*

Is scolding then so completely incorporated in you.

Schon entschwand das liebliche *Already the lovely*

Must you criticize with every breath?

Schilfumkränzte Gestade dem Blick; *Reed-wreathed shore has vanished from sight;*

Your tongue's got thorns.

Auch die frei, zierlich-stolz *Also the free, daintily-proud*

Every word's a little death.

Sanfthingleitenden Schwäne *Softly-gliding swans*

That without reproaching you cannot move a lip?

In gesell'ger Schwimmlust *In companionable swimming-pleasure*

Can you say ANYTHING nice?

Seh' ich, ach, nicht mehr! *I see, alas, no more!*

It's all shade with you.

Doch, aber doch *Yet, yet still*

Every compliment comes with a price.

Tönen hör' ich sie, *Sounding I hear them,*

So many years stood deserted the mountain valley.

Tönen fern heiseren Ton! *Sounding far a hoarser tone!*

In the mountains behind Sparta—empty for ages.

Tod verkündenden, sagen sie. *Death-proclaiming, they say.*

Wild country, nobody home.

Ach daß uns er nur nicht auch, *Ah that to us it may not also,*

A blank spot on history's pages.

Statt verheißener Rettung Heil, *Instead of promised salvation's blessing,*

Which rises northward behind Sparta into the heights.

Untergang verkünde zuletzt; *Proclaim destruction at last;*

North of here, up where it's cold.

Uns, den Schwangleichen, Lang- *To us, the swan-like, long-*

Mountain territory—stark and strange.

Schön-Weißhalsigen, und ach! *Beautiful-white-throated, and ah!*

Land that nobody controlled.

Unsrer Schwanerzeugten. *Our swan-begotten one.*

Taygetus at its back, where as a lively brook Eurotas rolls down.

Weh uns, weh, weh! *Woe to us, woe, woe!*

The river starts up there—fresh and cold.

Alles deckte sich schon *All has already covered itself*

Mountain spring feeding your valley.

Rings mit Nebel umher. *All around with mist.*

Where the water story's first told.

Sehen wir doch einander nicht! *We no longer see each other!*

And then, flowing broadly through our valley among the reeds, nourishes your swans.

Was geschieht? gehen wir? *What is happening? Are we walking?*

Down here it spreads and feeds the birds.

Schweben wir nur *Are we only floating*

Your famous swans—your family symbol.

Trippelnden Schrittes am Boden hin? *With tripping steps along the ground?*

River to sea, beyond words.

Siehst du nichts? Schwebt nicht etwa gar *Do you see nothing? Does not perhaps*

Back there quietly in the mountain valley a bold race has settled.

Hermes voran? Blinkt nicht der goldne Stab *Hermes float ahead? Does not the golden staff gleam*

But up there? Somebody moved in.

Heischend, gebietend uns wieder zurück *Bidding, commanding us back again*

A new people, from somewhere else.

Zu dem unerfreulichen, grautagenden, *To the joyless, gray-dawning,*

Strangers in the hills—let's begin.

Ungreifbarer Gebilde vollen, *Full of intangible forms,*

Pressing forth from Cimmerian night.

Überfüllten, ewig leeren Hades? *Overcrowded, eternally empty Hades?*

From the north—the land of eternal darkness.

Ja auf einmal wird es düster, ohne Glanz entschwebt der Nebel *Yes all at once it grows dark, without gleam the mist floats away*

Fog-people, cold-people, night-dwellers.

Dunkelgräulich, mauerbräunlich. Mauern stellen sich dem Blicke, *Dark-grayish, wall-brownish. Walls present themselves to the gaze,*

Out of the gloom with mysterious starkness.

Freiem Blicke starr entgegen. Ist's ein Hof? ist's tiefe Grube? *Rigidly against the free gaze. Is it a court? Is it a deep pit?*

And piled up an impregnable strong fortress.

Schauerlich in jedem Falle! Schwestern, ach! wir sind gefangen, *Dreadful in either case! Sisters, ah! we are captive,*

They built a castle—and not just any castle.

So gefangen wie nur je. *As captive as ever.*

A fortress that can't be taken.

Innerer Burghof / Inner Courtyard

Panthalis

Des Glücks und Unglücks! Keins von beiden wißt ihr je *Of fortune and misfortune! Neither do you ever know*

Of fortune and misfortune! You never know either one

Zu bestehn mit Gleichmut. Eine widerspricht ja stets *How to bear with equanimity. One always contradicts*

How to handle shit with chill - one of you always starts

Der andern heftig, überquer die andern ihr; *The other vehemently, crosswise the others her;*

Contradicting violently, arms waving, voices cracking

In Freud' und Schmerz nur heult und lacht ihr gleichen Tons. *In joy and pain you only howl and laugh with the same tone.*

In joy and pain you shriek the same - pick a register, ladies

Nun schweigt! und wartet horchend, was die Herrscherin *Now be silent! And wait listening for what the mistress*

Now shut up! Listen for what our queen in her wisdom

Hochsinnig hier beschließen mag für sich und uns. *High-mindedly here may decide for herself and us.*

High-mindedly decides for herself and us, her hot mess of a chorus

Helena

Wo bist du, Pythonissa? heiße, wie du magst; *Where are you, Pythoness? Be called what you will;*

Where are you, Pythoness? Call yourself whatever you want

Aus diesen Gewölben tritt hervor der düstern Burg. *From these vaults of the gloomy castle come forth.*

Come out from these gloomy castle vaults already

Gingst etwa du, dem wunderbaren Heldenherrn *Did you perhaps go to announce me*

Did you go announce me to the wondrous hero-lord?

Mich anzukündigen, Wohlempfang bereitend mir, *To the wondrous hero-lord, preparing a welcome for me,*

Getting me a proper welcome prepared and all that?

So habe Dank und führe schnell mich ein zu ihm; *Then have thanks and lead me quickly in to him;*

Then thanks, now lead me to him quickly

Beschluß der Irrfahrt wünsch' ich. Ruhe wünsch' ich nur. *An end to wandering I wish. Rest alone I wish.*

I want this wandering to end. I just want rest.

Chorführerin

Vergebens blickst du, Königin, allseits um dich her; *In vain you look, Queen, all around you;*

In vain you look around, Queen, every direction

Verschwunden ist das leidige Bild, verblieb vielleicht *Vanished is the vexing image, remained perhaps*

That creepy witch vanished - probably still in the fog

Im Nebel dort, aus dessen Busen wir hierher, *In the mist there, from whose bosom we came hither,*

From whose bosom we came here, somehow

Ich weiß nicht wie, gekommen, schnell und sonder Schritt. *I know not how, swiftly and without footstep.*

I don't know how - fast and without footsteps, spooky as hell

Vielleicht auch irrt sie zweifelhaft im Labyrinth *Perhaps too she wanders uncertainly in the labyrinth*

Perhaps she's wandering lost in the labyrinth

Der wundersam aus vielen eingewordnen Burg, *Of the castle wondrously become one from many,*

Of this castle that's somehow become one from many

Den Herrn erfragend fürstlicher Hochbegrüßung halb. *Inquiring for the lord for princely high greeting's sake.*

Looking for the lord to set up some princely greeting

Doch sieh, dort oben regt in Menge sich allbereits, *But see, up there already stirs in multitude,*

But look up there - already a crowd is stirring

In Galerien, am Fenster, in Portalen rasch *In galleries, at windows, in portals swiftly*

In galleries, at windows, in doorways - servants rushing

Sich hin und her bewegend, viele Dienerschaft; *Moving to and fro, many servants;*

Moving to and fro all frantic-like

Vornehm-willkommenen Gastempfang verkündet es. *It announces a nobly welcome guest reception.*

It announces a noble welcome for a noble guest

Chor

Aufgeht mir das Herz! o, seht nur dahin, *My heart opens! O, just look thither,*

My heart opens up! Oh, just look over there

Wie so sittig herab mit verweilendem Tritt *How so properly down with lingering step*

How properly they descend with lingering steps

Jungholdeste Schar anständig bewegt *A most youthfully gracious company decorously moves*

The most youthfully gracious crew moving decorously

Den geregelten Zug. Wie! auf wessen Befehl *In ordered procession. What! At whose command*

In ordered procession - wait, whose orders?

Nur erscheinen, gereiht und gebildet so früh, *Do they appear, so early arrayed and formed,*

Where'd these gorgeous young lads come from so early?

Von Jünglingsknaben das herrliche Volk? *The splendid folk of youthful lads?*

All lined up and ready like models at fashion week

Was bewundr' ich zumeist? Ist es zierlicher Gang, *What do I admire most? Is it graceful gait,*

What do I admire most? The graceful walk?

Etwa des Haupts Lockhaar um die blendende Stirn, *Perhaps the head's curly hair around the dazzling brow,*

Legs for days, hips like poetry in motion

Etwa der Wänglein Paar, wie die Pfirsiche rot *Perhaps the pair of cheeks, red as peaches*

Maybe those curls around the dazzling forehead

Und eben auch so weichwollig beflaumt? *And just as softly downy?*

Hair I want to run my fingers through slowly

Gern biss' ich hinein, doch ich schaudre davor; *Gladly I would bite into them, yet I shudder at it;*

Or those cheeks, red as peaches

Denn in ähnlichem Fall, da erfüllte der Mund *For in a similar case, the mouth filled*

And just as soft and downy - I want to bite them

Sich, gräßlich zu sagen! mit Asche. *Itself, horrible to say! with ashes.*

Gladly I'd sink my teeth in, but I shudder

Aber die schönsten, *But the fairest,*

Because last time I bit something that hot it turned to ash in my mouth

Sie kommen daher; *They come along;*

Horrible to say! But the fairest ones

Was tragen sie nur? *What are they carrying?*

Here they come now

Stufen zum Thron, *Steps to the throne,*

What are they carrying?

Teppich und Sitz, *Carpet and seat,*

Steps to the throne

Umhang und zelt- *Canopy and tent-*

Carpet and seat

Artigen Schmuck; *Like ornament;*

Canopy and tent-like decoration

Über überwallt er, *It overflows above,*

It overflows above

Wolkenkränze bildend, *Forming cloud-wreaths,*

Forming wreaths of clouds

Unsrer Königin Haupt; *Above our Queen's head;*

Over our Queen's head

Denn schon bestieg sie *For already she has mounted*

For she's already mounted

Eingeladen herrlichen Pfühl. *The magnificent cushion, invited.*

The magnificent cushion, as invited

Tretet heran, *Step forward,*

Step forward

Stufe für Stufe *Step by step*

Step by step

Reihet euch ernst. *Arrange yourselves solemnly.*

Arrange yourselves solemnly

Würdig, o würdig, dreifach würdig *Worthy, O worthy, thrice worthy*

Worthy, oh worthy, thrice worthy

Sei gesegnet ein solcher Empfang! *Be blessed such a reception!*

Be blessed such a reception!

Chorführerin

Wenn diesem nicht die Götter, wie sie öfter tun, *If now, indeed, the gods to this man have not lent*

If the gods haven't lent this man - as they often do

Für wenige Zeit nur wundernswürdige Gestalt, *As oft they do to men, a brave transcendent form,*

Just temporarily, a wonderfully impressive form

Erhabnen Anstand, liebenswerte Gegenwart *A winning presence, stately dignity of mien,*

Noble bearing, loveable presence

Vorüberänglich liehen, wird ihm jedesmal, *For temporary service, all he undertakes*

Just for a little while (they're sneaky like that)

Was er beginnt, gelingen, sei's in Männerschlacht, *Will always bring him triumph, whether in fight with men,*

Then everything he attempts will succeed

So auch im kleinen Kriege mit den schönsten Fraun. *Or in the minor wars with fairest ladies waged.*

Whether in battles with men

Er ist fürwahr gar vielen andern vorzuziehn, *Him, verily, to hosts of others I prefer,*

Or in those smaller wars waged with the fairest women

Die ich doch auch als hochgeschätzt mit Augen sah. *Whom, highly-famed withal, I have myself beheld.*

He's truly preferable to many others

Mit langsam-ernstem, ehrfurchtsvoll gehaltenem Schritt *With slow and solemn step, by reverence restrained,*

Whom I've also seen with my own eyes, all highly praised

Seh' ich den Fürsten; wende dich, o Königin! *I see the Prince approach: turn thou thy head, O Queen!*

With slow, solemn, reverently restrained step

Faust

(mit einem Gefesselten an seiner Seite) (with a man in fetters at his side)

Statt feierlichsten Grußes, wie sich ziemte, *Instead of solemn greeting, as beseems,*

I see the Prince approach - turn your head, Queen!

Statt ehrfurchtsvollem Willkomm bring' ich dir *Or reverential welcome, bring I thee,*

Instead of the solemn greeting that would be fitting

In Ketten hart geschlossen solchen Knecht, *Fast-bound in welded fetters, here, the knave*
Instead of reverential welcome, I bring you

Der, Pflicht verfehlend, mir die Pflicht entwand. *Whose duty slighted cheated me of mine.*
This servant in hard chains who failed his duty

Hier kniee nieder, dieser höchsten Frau *Kneel down, thou culprit, that this lofty Dame*
And thereby cheated me of mine

Bekenntnis abzulegen deiner Schuld. *May hear the prompt confession of thy guilt!*
Kneel down here, before this highest lady

Dies ist, erhabne Herrscherin, der Mann, *This, Sovereign Mistress, is the man select*
Confess your guilt - go on, spill it

Mit seltnem Augenblitz vom hohen Turm *For piercing visions, on the turret high*
This, sublime mistress, is the man

Umherzuschauen bestellt, dort Himmelsraum *Stationed to look around, the space of heaven*
Appointed with rare keen sight from the high tower

Und Erdenbreite scharf zu überspähn, *And breadth of earth to read with sharpest glance,*
To look around, scanning heaven's space

Was etwa da und dort sich melden mag, *If here or there perchance come aught to view,*
And earth's breadth with sharpest glance

Vom Hügelkreis ins Tal zur festen Burg *Between the stronghold and the circling hills*
For whatever might appear here or there

Sich regen mag, der Herden Woge sei's, *If aught may move, whether the billowy herds*
From the ring of hills to the valley to this fortress

Ein Heereszug vielleicht; wir schützen jene, *Or waves of armed men: those we protect,*
Whatever might stir - whether waves of herds

Begegnen diesem. Heute, welch Versäumnis! *Encounter these. Today, what negligence!*
Or perhaps an army approaching

Du kommst heran, er meldet's nicht; verfehlt *Thou comest, he proclaims it not: we fail*
We protect the former, confront the latter

Ist ehrenvoller, schuldigster Empfang *In honorable reception, most deserved,*
Today, what negligence!

So hohen Gastes. Freventlich verwirkt *Of such high guest. Now forfeited hath he*
You arrive, he doesn't announce it - failed

Das Leben hat er, läge schon im Blut *His guilty life, and should have shed the blood*
Is the honorable, most-deserved reception
Verdienten Todes; doch nur du allein *Of death deserved; but only thou shalt mete*
Of such a high guest. His life is forfeit
Bestrafst, begnadigst, wie dir's wohlgefällt. *Pardon or punishment, at thy goodwill.*
By this outrage - he should already lie in his own blood

Helena

So hohe Würde, wie du sie vergönnt, *So high the power, which thou hast granted me,*
Death well-deserved; but you alone
Als Richterin, als Herrscherin, und wär's *As Mistress and as Judge, although it were*
Shall punish or pardon, as you please
Versuchend nur, wie ich vermuten darf - *(I may conjecture) meant but as a test,*
Such high dignity as you grant me
So üb' nun des Richters erste Pflicht, *Yet now I use the Judge's bounden right*
As judge, as ruler - even if it's just a test
Beschuldigte zu hören. Rede denn. *To give the Accused a hearing: speak then, thou!*
As I may well suspect

Turnwärter Lynkeus

Laß mich knien, laß mich schauen, *Let me kneel, and let me view her,*
I'll use the judge's first duty
Laß mich sterben, laß mich leben, *Let me live, or let me die!*
To hear the accused. Speak then.
Denn schon bin ich hingegeben *For enslaved, devoted to her,*
Let me kneel, let me gaze upon her
Dieser gottgegebenen Frauen. *This God-granted Dame, am I.*
Let me die or let me live
Harrend auf des Morgens Wonne, *Watching for the Morn's advancing*
For I am already surrendered completely
Östlich spähend ihren Lauf, *Where her pathways eastward run,*
To this god-given woman

Ging auf einmal mir die Sonne *All at once, a sight entrancing,*

Waiting for morning's delight

Wunderbar im Süden auf. *In the South arose the sun.*

Watching eastward for its course

Zog den Blick nach jener Seite, *There to look, the Wonder drew me:*

Suddenly the sun rose for me

Statt der Schluchten, statt der Höhn, *Not the glens, the summits cold,*

Wondrously, in the south

Statt der Erd- und Himmelsweite *Space of sky or landscape gloomy,*

Drew my gaze that direction

Sie, die Einzige, zu spähn. *Only Her did I behold.*

Instead of ravines, instead of heights

Augenstrahl ist mir verliehen *Beam of sight to me was given,*

Instead of earth's and heaven's expanse

Wie dem Luchs auf höchstem Baum; *Like the lynx on highest tree;*

Her, the only one, to behold

Doch nun muß' ich mich bemühen *But in vain I've urged and striven,*

Keen eyesight was given to me

Wie aus tiefem, düsterm Traum. *'Twas a dream that fettered me.*

Like a lynx on the highest tree

Wüßt' ich irgend mich zu finden? *Could I know, or how be aided?*

But now I had to struggle

Zinne? Turm? geschloßnes Tor? *Think of tower or bolted gate?*

As if waking from deep, dark dream

Nebel schwanken, Nebel schwinden, *Vapors rose and vapors faded,*

Could I even find myself?

Solche Göttin tritt hervor! *And the Goddess came in state!*

Battlements? Tower? Locked gate?

Aug' und Brust ihr zugewendet, *Eye and heart did I surrender*

Mists wavered, mists vanished

Sog ich an den milden Glanz; *To the softly-shining spell:*

And such a goddess stepped forth!

Diese Schönheit, wie sie blendet, *Blinding all with Beauty's splendor,*

Eyes and heart turned toward her

Blendete mich Armen ganz. *She hath blinded me, as well.*

I drank in the gentle radiance

Ich vergaß des Wächters Pflichten, *I forgot the warder's duty*

This beauty, how it dazzles

Völlig das beschworne Horn; *And the trumpet's herald-call:*

Completely dazzled me, poor fool

Drohe nur, mich zu vernichten - *Threaten to destroy me! Beauty*

I forgot the watchman's duties

Schönheit bändigt allen Zorn. *Bindeth anger, frees her thrall.*

Completely forgot the sworn horn to blow

Helena

Das Übel, das ich brachte, darf ich nicht *The Evil which I brought, I dare no more*

Threaten to destroy me - go ahead

Bestrafen. Wehe mir! Welch streng Geschick *Chastise. Ah, woe to me! What fate severe*

Beauty tames all anger

Verfolgt mich, überall der Männer Busen *Pursues me, everywhere the breasts of men*

The evil that I brought, I cannot punish

So zu betören, daß sie weder sich *So to infatuate, that nor them, nor aught*

Woe is me! What severe fate pursues me

Noch sonst ein Würdiges verschonten. Raubend jetzt, *Besides of worth, they spare? Now plundering,*

Everywhere infatuating men's hearts so

Verführend, fechtend, hin und her entrückend, *Seducing, fighting, hurried to and fro,*

That they spare neither themselves

Halbgötter, Helden, Götter, ja Dämonen, *Heroes and Demigods, Gods, Demons even,*

Nor anything else worthy. Now plundering

Sie führten mich im Irren her und hin. *Hither and thither led me, sore-perplexed.*

Seducing, fighting, hurried to and fro

Einfach die Welt verwirrt' ich, dopplet mehr; *Sole, I the world bewildered, doubly more;*

Demigods, heroes, gods, even demons

Nun dreifach, vierfach bring' ich Not auf Not. *Now threefold, fourfold, woe on woe I bring.*

They led me wandering here and there

Entferne diesen Guten, laß ihn frei; *Remove this guiltless man, let him go free!*

Single, I confused the world; doubly, even more

Den Gottbetörten treffe keine Schmach. *The God-deluded merits no disgrace.*

Now threefold, fourfold, I bring woe upon woe

Faust

Erstaunt, o Königin, seh' ich zugleich *Amazed, O Queen, do I behold alike*

Release this good man, let him go free

Die sicher Treffende, hier den Getroffenen; *The unerring archer and the stricken prey,*

Let no shame touch one deluded by the gods

Ich seh' den Bogen, der den Pfeil entsandt, *I see the bow, wherefrom the arrow sped*

Amazed, O Queen, I behold alike

Verwundet jenen. Pfeile folgen Pfeilen, *That wounded him. Arrows on arrows fly,*

The sure archer and here the one struck

Mich treffend. Allwärts ahn' ich überquer *And strike me. I suspect the feathered hum*

I see the bow that sent the arrow

Gefiedert schwirrend sie in Burg und Raum. *Of bolts cross-fired through all the courts and towers.*

That wounded him. Arrows follow arrows

Was bin ich nun? Auf einmal machst du mir *What am I now? At once rebellious thou*

Striking me. Everywhere I sense them

Rebellisch die Getreusten, meine Mauern *Makest my faithfullest, and insecure*

Feathered, whirring through castle and space

Unsicher. Also fürcht' ich schon, mein Heer *My walls. Thence do I fear that even my hosts*

What am I now? At once you make rebellious

Gehorcht der siegend unbesiegten Frau. *Obey the conquering and unconquered Dame.*

My most faithful, my walls insecure

Was bleibt mir übrig, als mich selbst und alles, *What else remains, but that I give to thee*

So I fear even my army

Im Wahn des Meine, dir anheimzugeben? *Myself, and all I vainly fancied mine?*

Obeys the conquering, unconquered woman

Zu deinen Füßen laß mich, frei und treu, *Let me, before thy feet, in fealty true,*

What remains but to give myself and all

Dich Herrin anerkennen, die sogleich *Thee now acknowledge, Lady, whose approach*

That I foolishly thought mine, to you?

Auftretend sich Besitz und Thron erwarb. *Won thee at once possession and the throne!*

At your feet let me, free and true

Lynkeus

(mit einer Kiste, und Männer, die ihm andere nachtragen) *(with a chest, and men who follow, bearing others)*

Du siehst mich, Königin, zurück; *Thou seest me, Queen, returned and free;*

Acknowledge you as mistress, who at once

Der Reiche bettelt einen Blick; *The wealthy begs a glance from thee:*

Upon arriving won possession and the throne

Er sieht dich an und fühlt sogleich *Thee he beheld, and feeleth, since,*

You see me returned, Queen

Sich bettelarm und fürstenreich. *As beggar poor, yet, rich as prince.*

The rich man begs a glance from you

Was war ich erst? was bin ich nun? *What was I erst? What now am I?*

He looks at you and feels at once

Was ist zu wollen? was zu tun? *What shall I will? what do, or try?*

Beggar-poor yet prince-rich

Was hilft der Augen schärfster Blitz! *What boots the eyesight's sharpest ray?*

What was I before? What am I now?

Er prallt zurück an deinem Sitz. *Back from thy throne it bounds away.*

What should I want? What should I do?

Von Osten kamen wir heran, *Forth from the East we hither pressed,*

What good is the sharpest flash of sight?

Und um den Westen war's getan; *And all was over with the West:*

It bounces back from your throne

Ein lang und breites Volksgewicht, *So long and broad the people massed,*

From the East we came marching

Der erste wußte vom letzten nicht. *The foremost knew not of the last.*

And the West was done for

Der erste fiel, der zweite stand, *The foremost fell, the second stood;*

A long and broad mass of people

Des dritten Lanze war zur Hand; *The third one's lance was prompt and good;*

The first didn't know about the last

Ein jeder hundertfach gestärkt, *Each one a hundred's strength supplied:*

The first one fell, the second stood

Erschlagne Tausend unbemerkt. *Unnoted, thousands fell and died.*

The third one's lance was ready

Wir drängten fort, wir stürmten fort, *We onward pressed, in stormy chase;*

Each one strengthened a hundredfold

Wir waren Herrn von Ort zu Ort; *The lords were we from place to place;*

Thousands slain unnoticed

Und wo ich herrisch heut befahl, *And where, today, I ruled as chief,*

We pressed on, we stormed on

Ein andrer morgen raubt' und stahl. *The morrow brought another thief.*

We were lords from place to place

Wir schauten - eilig war die Schau; *We viewed the ground, but viewed in haste:*

Where I commanded today imperiously

Der griff die allerschönste Frau, *The fairest woman one embraced,*

Another robbed and stole tomorrow

Der griff den Stier von festem Tritt, *One took the oxen from the stall;*

We looked around - quick glances only

Die Pferde mußten alle mit. *The horses followed, one and all.*

One grabbed the most beautiful woman

Ich aber liebte, zu erspähn *But my delight was to espy*

One grabbed the ox with firm step

Das Seltenste, was man gesehen; *What rarest was, to mind and eye;*

All the horses had to come along

Und was ein andrer auch besaß, *And all that others might amass*

But I loved to spy out

Das war für mich gedörrtes Gras. *To me was so much withered grass.*

The rarest things ever seen

Den Schätzen war ich auf der Spur, *I hunted on the treasure-trail*

And what anyone else possessed

Den scharfen Blicken folgt' ich nur, *Where'er sharp sight could me avail:*

Was just dried grass to me

In alle Taschen blickt' ich ein, *In every pocket did I see,*

I was on the trail of treasures

Durchsichtig war mir jeder Schrein. *And every chest was glass to me.*

Following only my sharp glances

Und Haufen Goldes waren mein, *And heaps of gold I came to own,*

I looked into every pocket

Am herrlichsten der Edelstein: *With many a splendid jewel-stone:*

Every chest was transparent to me

Nun der Smaragd allein verdient, *The emeralds only worthy seem*

And heaps of gold became mine

Daß er an deinem Herzen grünt. *Greenly upon thy breast to gleam.*

Most splendid of all, precious stones

Nun schwanke zwischen Ohr und Mund *'Twixt lip and ear let swaying sleep*

Now only the emerald deserves

Das Tropfenei aus Meeresgrund; *The pearly egg of Ocean's deep;*

To glow green upon your heart

Rubinen werden gar verscheucht, *Such place the rubies dare not seek,*

Let the pearl-drops from ocean's depths

Das Wangenrot sie niederbleicht. *They're blanched beside the rosy cheek.*

Sway between your ear and mouth

Und so den allergrößten Schatz *And thus, the treasure's offering*

Rubies are scared away

Versetzt' ich hier auf deinen Platz; *I here before thy presence bring:*

Your rosy cheeks pale them out

Zu deinen Füßen sei gebracht *Laid at thy feet, be now revealed*

And so the greatest treasure of all

Die Ernte mancher blut'gen Schlacht. *The spoils of many a bloody field!*

I place here at your spot

So viele Kisten schlepp' ich her, *Though I have brought of chests a store,*

At your feet be brought

Der Eisenkisten hab' ich mehr; *Yet iron caskets have I more.*

The harvest of many a bloody battle

Erlaube mich auf deiner Bahn, *Let me attend thee, do thy will,*

So many chests I drag here

Und Schatzgewölbe füll' ich an. *And I thy treasure-vaults will fill.*

I have more iron caskets still

Denn du bestiegst kaum den Thron, *For scarcely didst thou mount the throne,*

Allow me to follow your path

So neigen schon, so beugen schon *Than bowed to own and bent to own*

And I'll fill up your treasure vaults

Verstand und Reichtum und Gewalt *Thy Beauty's sway, that very hour,*

For you'd barely mounted the throne

Sich vor der einzigen Gestalt. *Wisdom, and Wealth, and sovereign Power.*

When already bowing, already bending

Das alles hielt ich fest und mein, *All such I held secure, as mine;*

Wisdom and wealth and power

Nun aber, lose, wird es dein. *Now freed therefrom, behold it thine!*

Before your unique form

Ich glaubt' es würdig, hoch und bar, *I deemed its worth and value plain;*

All this I held firm and mine

Nun seh' ich, daß es nichtig war. *Now see I, it was null and vain.*

Now loosened, it becomes yours

Verschwunden ist, was ich besaß, *What I possessed from me doth pass,*

I thought it worthy, high and valuable

Ein abgemähtes, welches Gras. *Dispersed like mown and withered grass.*

Now I see it was nothing

O gib mit einem heitern Blick *One bright and beauteous glance afford,*

What I possessed has vanished

Ihm seinen ganzen Wert zurück! *And all its worth is straight restored!*

Mown grass, withered away

Faust

Entferne schnell die kühn erworbne Last, *Remove with speed the burden boldly won,*

Oh, with one cheerful glance

Zwar nicht getadelt, aber unbelohnt. *Not blamed, indeed, but neither with reward.*

Give it all its worth back

Schon ist Ihr alles eigen, was die Burg *All is her own already, which the keep*

Remove quickly this boldly-won burden

Im Schoß verbirgt; Besondres Ihr zu bieten, *Within it holds: and special offer thus*

Not blamed, true, but also unrewarded

Ist unnütz. Geh und häufe Schatz auf Schatz *Is useless. Go, and pile up wealth on wealth*

Already everything the castle hides is hers

Geordnet an. Der ungesehnen Pracht *In order fit! Present the show august*

To offer her anything special is useless

Erhabnes Bild stell' auf! Laß die Gewölbe *Of splendors yet unseen! The vaulted halls*

Go pile treasure upon treasure

Wie frische Himmel blinken, Paradiese *Make shine like clearest heaven! Let Paradise*

In proper order. Present the show

Von lebelosem Leben richte zu. *From lifeless pomp of life created be!*

Of unseen splendors in august image

Voreilend ihren Tritten laß beblümt *Hastening, before her footsteps be unrolled*

Let the vaults gleam like fresh heavens

An Teppich Teppiche sich wälzen; ihrem Tritt *The flower-embroidered carpets! Let her tread*

Create paradises of lifeless life

Begegne sanfter Boden; ihrem Blick, *Fall on the softest footing, and her glance,*

Hurrying before her steps

Nur Göttliche nicht blendend, höchster Glanz. *Gods only bear undazed, on proudest pomp!*

Let carpet upon carpet roll out in bloom

Lynkeus

Schwach ist, was der Herr befiehlt, *What the lord commands is slight;*

Let soft ground meet her tread

Tut's der Diener, es ist gespielt: *For the servants, labor light:*

Her gaze - blinding only to those not divine -

Herrscht doch über Gut und Blut *Over wealth and blood and breath*

The highest splendor!

Dieser Schönheit Übermut. *This proud Beauty governeth.*

What the lord commands is slight

Schon das ganze Heer ist zahm, *Lo! thy warrior-throngs are tame;*

For the servant it's child's play

Alle Schwerter stumpf und lahm, *All the swords are blunt and lame;*

Yet over property and blood rules

Vor der herrlichen Gestalt *Near the bright form we behold*

This beauty's overweening pride

Selbst die Sonne matt und kalt, *Even the sun is pale and cold;*

Already the whole army is tame

Vor dem Reichtum des Gesichts *Near the riches of her face*

All swords blunt and lame

Alles leer und alles nichts. *All things empty, shorn of grace.*

Before her glorious form

Helena

Ich wünsche dich zu sprechen, doch herauf *Fain to discourse with thee, I bid thee come*

Even the sun is dull and cold

An meine Seite komm! Der leere Platz *Up hither to my side! The empty place*

Before the richness of her face

Beruft den Herrn und sichert mir den meinen. *Invites its lord, and thus secures me mine.*

Everything empty, everything nothing

Faust

Erst knieend laß die treue Widmung dir *First, kneeling, let the dedication be*

I wish to speak with you, so come up

Gefallen, hohe Frau; die Hand, die mich *Accepted, lofty Lady! Let me kiss*

To my side. The empty place

An deine Seite hebt, laß mich sie küssen. *The gracious hand that lifts me to thy side.*

Summons its lord and secures me mine

Bestärke mich als Mitregenten deines *Confirm me as co-regent of thy realm,*

First kneeling, let the true devotion

Grenzunbewußten Reichs, gewinne dir *Whose borders are unknown, and win for thee*

Please you, high lady; the hand that lifts me

Verehrer, Diener, Wächter all' in einem! *Guard, slave and worshipper, and all in one!*

To your side, let me kiss it

Helena

Vielfache Wunder seh' ich, hör' ich an, *I hear and witness marvels manifold;*

Confirm me as co-regent of your realm

Erstaunen trifft mich, fragen möcht' ich viel. *Amazement takes me, much would I inquire.*

Whose borders are unknown, and win for yourself

Doch wünscht' ich Unterricht, warum die Rede *Yet now instruct me wherefore spake the man*

Worshipper, servant, guardian - all in one

Des Manns mir seltsam klang, seltsam und freundlich. *With strangely-sounding speech, friendly and strange.*

Manifold wonders I see and hear

Ein Ton scheint sich dem andern zu bequemen, *Each sound appeared as yielding to the next,*

Amazement strikes me, I'd like to ask much

Und hat ein Wort zum Ohre sich gesellt, *And, when a word gave pleasure to the ear,*

But I'd like instruction why that man's speech

Ein andres kommt, dem ersten liebzukosen. *Another came, caressing then the first.*

Sounded strange to me - strange yet friendly

Faust

Gefällt dir schon die Sprechart unsrer Völker, *If thee our people's mode of speech delight,*

One sound seemed to accommodate the other

O so gewiß entzückt auch der Gesang, *O thou shalt be enraptured with our song,*

And when a word reached my ear

Befriedigt Ohr und Sinn im tiefsten Grunde. *Which wholly satisfies both ear and mind!*

Another came to caress the first

Doch ist am sichersten, wir üben's gleich; *But it were best we exercise it now:*

If our people's manner of speaking pleases you

Die Wechselrede lockt es, ruft's hervor. *Alternate speech entices, calls it forth.*

Oh, surely then song will delight you too

Helena

So sage denn, wie sprech' ich auch so schön? *Canst thou to me that lovely speech impart?*

Satisfying ear and mind at deepest level

Faust

Das ist gar leicht, es muß von Herzen gehn. *'Tis easy: it must issue from the heart;*

But safest is we practice it right now

Und wenn die Brust von Sehnsucht überfließt, *And if the breast with yearning overflow,*

Dialogue coaxes it out, calls it forth

Man sieht sich um und fragt - *One looks around, and asks -*

Then tell me, how do I speak so beautifully too?

Helena

Wer mitgenießt. *Who shares the glow.*

It's quite easy - it must come from the heart

Faust

Nun schaut der Geist nicht vorwärts, nicht zurück, *Nor Past nor Future shades an hour like this;*

And when the breast overflows with longing

Die Gegenwart allein - *But wholly in the Present -*

One looks around and asks -

Helena

Ist unser Glück. *Is our bliss.*

Who shares the joy

Faust

Schatz ist sie, Hochgewinn, Besitz und Pfand; *Gain, pledge, and fortune in the Present stay:*

Now the spirit looks not forward, not back

Bestätigung, wer gibt sie? *What confirmation does it ask?*

The present alone -

Helena

Meine Hand. *My hand.*

Is our bliss

Chor

Wer verdächt' es unsrer Fürstin, *Who would take it amiss, that our Princess*

Treasure it is, highest gain, possession and pledge

Gönnet sie dem Herrn der Burg *Granteth now to the Castle's lord*

Confirmation - who gives it?

Freundliches Erzeigen? *Friendliest demonstration?*

My hand

Denn gesteht, sämtliche sind wir *For, indeed, collectively are we*

Who would blame our princess

Ja Gefangene, wie schon öfter *Captives, as ofttimes already,*

If she grants the castle's lord

Seit dem schmachvollen Untergang *Since the infamous downfall*

Friendly favors?

Ilios' und der ängstlich- *Of Ilion, and the perilous,*

For admit it, we're all captives here

labyrinthischen Kummerfahrt. *Labyrinthine, sorrowful voyage.*

As we've often been before

Fraun, gewöhnt an Männerliebe, *Women, to the love of men accustomed,*

Since the shameful fall of Ilion

Wählerinnen sind sie nicht, *Dainty choosers are they not,*

And that anxious labyrinthine journey of sorrow

Aber Kennerinnen. *But proficient skillful;*

Women accustomed to men's love

Und wie goldlockigen Hirten *And unto golden-haired shepherds,*

Are not choosy

Vielleicht schwarzborstigen Faunen, *Perchance black, bristly Fauns, too,*

But they're connoisseurs

Wie es bringt die Gelegenheit, *Even as comes opportunity,*

And to golden-haired shepherds

Über die schwellenden Glieder *Unto the limbs in their vigor*

Perhaps black-bristled fauns too

Vollerteilen sie gleiches Recht. *Fully award they an equal right.*

As opportunity allows

Nah und näher sitzen sie schon *Near, and nearer already sit*

Over their swelling limbs

An einander gelehnet, *They, to each other drawn,*

They grant equal rights fully

Schulter an Schulter, Knie an Knie, *Shoulder to shoulder, knee to knee;*

Near and nearer they already sit

Hand in Hand wiegen sie sich *Hand in hand, they bend and sway*

Leaning toward each other

Über des Throns *Over the throne's*

Shoulder to shoulder, knee to knee

Aufgepolsterter Herrlichkeit. *Softly-pillowed, luxurious pomp.*

Hand in hand they sway together

Nicht versagt sich die Majestät *Majesty here not withholds its*

Over the throne's

Heimlicher Freuden *Secretest raptures,*

Cushioned magnificence

Vor den Augen des Volkes *Wilfully, boldly revealed*

Majesty doesn't deny itself

Übermütiges Offenbarsein. *Thus to the eyes of the people.*

Secret joys

Helena

Ich fühle mich so fern und doch so nah, *I feel so far away, and yet so near;*

Boldly revealed

Und sage nur zu gern: Da bin ich! da! *And am so fain to say: "Here am I! here!"*

Before the eyes of the people

Faust

Ich atme kaum, mir zittert, stockt das Wort; *I scarcely breathe; I tremble: speech is dead:*

I feel so far away and yet so near

Es ist ein Traum, verschwunden Tag und Ort. *It is a dream, and day and place have fled.*

And say so gladly: Here I am! Here!

Helena

Ich scheine mir verlebt und doch so neu, *I seem as life were done, and yet so new,*

I scarcely breathe, I tremble, words fail

In dich verwebt, dem Unbekannten treu. *Blent thus with thee, to thee, the Unknown, true!*

It is a dream - day and place have vanished

Faust

Durchgrüble nicht das einzigste Geschick! *To probe this rarest fate be not impelled!*

I seem to have lived through life yet feel so new

Dasein ist Pflicht, und wär's ein Augenblick. *Being is duty, though a moment held.*

Woven into you, true to the unknown

Phorkyas

(heftig eintretend) (vehemently entering)

Buchstabiert in Liebesfibeln, *Spell in lovers' primers sweetly!*

Don't analyze this unique fate!

Tändelnd grübelt nur am Liebeln, *Probe and dally, cosset featly,*

Existence is duty, even if just a moment

Müßig liebelt fort im Grübeln, *Test your wanton sport completely!*

Spelling out your love-primers!

Doch dazu ist keine Zeit. *But there is not time, nor place.*

Dallying and probing at flirtation

Fühlt ihr nicht ein dumpfes Wetter? *Feel ye not the gloomy presage?*

Idly flirting while pondering

Hört nur die Trompete schmettern, *Hear ye not the trumpet's message?*

But there's no time for this!

Das Verderben ist nicht weit. *For the ruin comes apace.*

Don't you feel a dull thunder coming?

Menelas mit Volkeswogen *Menelaus with his legion*

Just hear the trumpet blare!

Kommt auf euch herangezogen; *Storms across the hither regions;*

Destruction isn't far

Rüstet euch zu herbem Streit! *Call to battle all your race!*

Menelaus with waves of troops

Von der Siegerschar umwimmelt, *By the victors execrated,*

Comes marching against you

Wie Deiphobus verstümmelt, *Like Deiphobus mutilated,*

Arm yourselves for bitter battle!

Büßest du das Fraungeleit. *Thou shalt pay for woman's grace:*

Swarmed by the victor's horde

Bammelt erst die leichte Ware, *First shall dangle every light one,*

Mutilated like Deiphobus

Dieser gleich ist am Altare *At the altar, then, the Bright One*

You'll pay for your harem

Neugeschliffnes Beil bereit. *Find the keen axe in its place!*

First the light goods will dangle

Faust

Verwegne Störung! widerwärtig dringt sie ein; *Disturbance rash! repulsively she presses in;*

Then at the altar for this one

Auch nicht in Gefahren mag ich sinnlos Ungestüm. *Not even in danger meet is senseless violence.*

A freshly-sharpened axe awaits

Den schönsten Boten, Unglücksbotschaft häßlicht ihn; *Ill message makes the fairest herald ugly seem;*

Reckless disturbance! Repulsively she barges in

Du Häßlichste gar, nur schlimme Botschaft bringst du gern. *Thou, Ugliest, delightest but in evil news.*

Even in danger I can't stand senseless violence

Doch diesmal soll dir's nicht geraten: leeren Hauchs *Yet this time shalt thou not succeed; with empty breath*

Bad news makes even the fairest messenger ugly

Erschüttere du die Lüfte. Hier ist nicht Gefahr, *Stir, shatter thou the air! There is no danger here,*

You, ugliest of all, only like bringing bad news

Und selbst Gefahr erschiene nur als eitles Dräun. *And unto us were danger but an idle threat.*

But this time you won't succeed - with empty breath

Faust

(Signale, Explosionen von den Türmen, Trompeten und Zinken, kriegerische Musik, Durchmarsch gewaltiger Heeresmacht) (Signals, explosions from the towers, trumpets and cornets, martial music. A powerful armed force marches past.)

Nein, gleich sollst du versammelt schauen *No! hero-bands, none ever braver,*

Shake the air. There is no danger here

Der Helden ungetrennten Kreis: *At once shalt thou assembled see:*

And even danger would seem but idle threat

Nur der verdient die Gunst der Frauen, *He, sole, deserves the ladies' favor,*

No! Soon you shall see assembled

Der kräftigst sie zu schützen weiß. *Whose arm defends them gallantly.*

The unbroken circle of heroes

(zu den Führern, die sich von den Kolonnen absondern und herantreten) (To the leaders of the troops, who detach themselves from the columns, and come forwards.)

Mit angehaltenem stillen Wüten, *With rage restrained, in silence banded,*

Only he deserves women's favor

Das euch gewiß den Sieg verschafft, *And certain of the victory-feast,*

Who knows how to protect them most powerfully

Ihr, Nordens jugendliche Blüten, *Ye, Northern blossoms, half expanded,*

(to the troop leaders approaching)

Ihr, Ostens blumenreiche Kraft. *Ye, flowery fervors of the East!*

With restrained, silent fury

In Stahl gehüllt, vom Strahl unwittert, *The light upon their armor breaking,*

That will surely bring you victory

Die Schar, die Reich um Reich zerbrach, *They plundered realm on realm, at will:*

You, youthful blossoms of the North

Sie treten auf, die Erde schüttert, *They come, and lo! the earth is quaking;*

You, flower-rich strength of the East

Sie schreiten fort, es donnert nach. *They march away, it thunders still!*

Wrapped in steel, flashing with lightning

An Pylos traten wir zu Lande, *In Pylos we forsook the waters;*

The company that shattered realm after realm

Der alte Nestor ist nicht mehr, *The ancient Nestor is no more,*

They step forth, the earth trembles

Und alle kleinen Königsbande *And soon our lawless army scatters*

They march on, it thunders after

Zersprengt das ungebundne Heer. *The troops of kings on Grecian shore.*

At Pylos we came ashore

Drängt ungesäumt von diesen Mauern *Back from these walls, no more delaying,*

Old Nestor is no more

Jetzt Menelas dem Meer zurück; *Drive Menelaus to the sea!*

And all the little kingships

Dort irren mag er, rauben, lauern, *There let him wander, robbing, slaying,*

The unbound army scattered

Ihm war es Neigung und Geschick. *As was his wish and destiny.*

Now drive Menelaus back

Herzoge soll ich euch begrüßen, *I hail you Dukes, as forth ye sally*

From these walls to the sea without delay

Gebietet Spartas Königin; *Beneath the rule of Sparta's Queen!*

There let him wander, rob, ambush

Nun legt ihr Berg und Tal zu Füßen, *Now lay before her mount and valley,*

It was his inclination and fate

Und euer sei des Reichs Gewinn. *And you shall share the kingdom green!*

Dukes I shall call you

Germane du! Korinthus' Buchten *Thine, German, be the hand that forges*

Commands Sparta's Queen

Verteidige mit Wall und Schutz! *Defense for Corinth and her bays:*

Now lay mountain and valley at her feet

Achaia dann mit hundert Schluchten *Achaia, with its hundred gorges,*

And the realm's gain shall be yours

Empfehl' ich, Gote, deinem Trutz. *I give thee, Goth, to hold and raise.*

You, German! Corinth's bays

Nach Elis ziehn der Franken Heere, *Towards Elis, Franks, direct your motion;*

Defend with wall and protection

Messene sei der Sachsen Los, *Messene be the Saxon's state:*

Achaia then with its hundred gorges

Normanne reinige die Meere *The Norman claim and sweep the ocean,*

I commend to your defiance, Goth

Und Argolis erschaff' er groß. *And Argolis again make great!*

To Elis march the Frankish armies

Dann wird ein jeder häuslich wohnen, *Then each shall dwell in homes well-dowered,*

Messene be the Saxons' lot

Nach außen richten Kraft und Blitz; *And only outer foemen meet;*

Norman, cleanse the seas

Doch Sparta soll euch überthronen, *Yet still by Sparta over-towered,*

And make Argolis great

Der Königin verjährter Sitz. *The Queen's ancestral, ancient seat.*

Then each shall dwell domestically

All-einzeln sieht sie euch genießen *Each one shall she behold, abiding*

Directing force and lightning outward

Des Landes, dem kein Wohl gebricht; *In lands that lack no liberal right!*

But Sparta shall tower over you

Ihr sucht getrost zu ihren Füßen *And at her feet ye'll seek, confiding,*

The Queen's ancient seat

Bestätigung und Recht und Licht. *Your confirmation, law and light!*

She sees each of you enjoying

Chor

Wer die Schönste für sich begehrt, *Who for himself the Fairest desires,*

The land that lacks no good thing

Tüchtig vor allen Dingen *First of all things, let him*

Confidently seek at her feet

Seh' er nach Waffen weise sich um; *Bravely and wisely a weapon acquire!*

Confirmation, justice, and light

Schmeichelnd wohl gewann er sich, *Flattering, indeed, he may conquer*

Who desires the fairest for himself

Was auf Erden das Höchste; *What on earth is the highest;*

First of all things wisely

Aber ruhig besitzt er's nicht: *But he quietly may not possess.*

Let him look around for weapons

Schleicher listig entschmeicheln sie ihm, *Wily sneaks entice her away,*

Flattering, he may have won

Räuber kühnlich entreißen sie ihm; *Robbers boldly abduct her from him;*

What on earth is highest

Dieses zu hinderen, sei er bedacht. *This to hinder be he prepared!*

But he can't possess it peacefully

Unsern Fürsten lob' ich drum, *Therefore now our Prince I praise,*

Sneaks cunningly wheedle her away

Schätz' ihn höher vor andern, *Holding him higher than others,*

Robbers boldly tear her away

Wie er so tapfer klug sich verband, *Since he wisdom and strength combines,*

Let him be prepared to prevent this

Daß die Starken gehorchend stehn, *So that the strong men obedient stand,*

Therefore I praise our prince

Jedes Winkes gewärtig. *Waiting his every beckon.*

Esteem him higher than others

Seinen Befehl vollziehn sie treu, *They his orders faithfully heed,*

How he so bravely and cleverly allied himself

Jeder sich selbst zu eignem Nutz *Each for the profiting of himself*

So that the strong stand obedient

Wie dem Herrscher zu lohnendem Dank, *As for the Ruler's rewarding thanks,*

Awaiting every signal

Beiden zu höchlichem Ruhmesgewinn. *And for the highest renown of both.*

They faithfully carry out his command

Denn wer entreißet sie jetzt *For who shall tear her away*

Each for his own profit

Dem gewalt'gen Besitzer? *Now, from the mighty possessor?*

As well as for the ruler's rewarding thanks

Ihm gehört sie, ihm sei sie gegönnt, *His is she, and to him be she granted,*

Both for highest glory gained

Doppelt von uns gegönnt, die er *Doubly granted by us, whom he,*

For who shall tear her away now

Samt ihr zugleich innen mit sicherster Mauer, *Even as her, within by sure walls hath surrounded,*

From the mighty possessor?

Außen mit mächtigstem Heer umgab. *And without by a powerful host.*

She is his, let her be granted him

Faust

Die Gaben, diesen hier verliehen - *The gifts they've won by our concession,*

Doubly granted by us, whom he

An jeglichen ein reiches Land -, *In fee to each a wealthy land,*

Together with her surrounded within by safest wall

Sind groß und herrlich; laß sie ziehen! *Are grand and fair: grant them possession!*

Without by mightiest army

Wir halten in der Mitte stand. *We in the midst will take our stand.*

The gifts granted to these here

Und sie beschützen um die Wette, *And they in rivalry protect thee,*

To each a wealthy land

Ringsum von Wellen angehüpft, *Half-Island, girdled by the sea*

Are great and splendid - let them go!

Nichtinsel dich, mit leichter Hügelkette *With whispering waves, whose soft-hill chains connect thee*

We hold the center

Europens letztem Bergast angeknüpft. *With the last branch of Europe's mountain-tree!*

And they'll compete to protect you

Das Land, vor aller Länder Sonnen, *This land, before all lands in splendor,*

Non-island, bounded by leaping waves

Sei ewig jedem Stamm beglückt, *On every race shall bliss confer,*

Linked by light hill chains

Nun meiner Königin gewonnen, *Which to my queen in glad surrender*

To Europe's last mountain branch

Das früh an ihr hinaufgeblickt, *Yields, as it first looked up to her,*

This land, before all other lands' suns

Als mit Eurotas' Schilfgeflüster *When, 'mid Eurotas' whispering rushes*

Be forever blessed for every tribe

Sie leuchtend aus der Schale brach, *She burst from Leda's purple shell,*

Now won for my Queen

Der hohen Mutter, dem Geschwister *So blinding in her beauty's flushes,*

Who early looked up at her

Das Licht der Augen überstach. *That mother, brothers, felt the spell!*

When with Eurotas' whispering reeds

Dies Land, allein zu dir gekehret, *This land, which seeks thy sole direction,*

She burst shining from the shell

Entbietet seinen höchsten Flor; *Its brightest bloom hath now unfurled:*

Outshining the eyes of her high mother

Dem Erdkreis, der dir angehöret, *Prefer thy fatherland's affection*

And her siblings

Dein Vaterland, o zieh es vor! *To what is wholly thine, the world!*

This land, turned to you alone

Und duldet auch auf seiner Berge Rücken *And though upon its ridgy backs of mountains*

Offers its highest bloom

Das Zackenhaupt der Sonne kalten Pfeil, *The Sun's cold arrow smites each cloven head,*

To the world that belongs to you

Läßt nun der Fels sich angegrünt erblicken, *Yet, where the rock is greened by falling fountains,*

Prefer your fatherland, oh choose it!

Die Ziege nimmt genäschtig kargen Teil. *The wild-goat nibbles and is lightly fed.*

And though upon its mountain ridges

Die Quelle springt, vereinigt stürzen Bäche, *The springs leap forth, the streams united follow;*

The jagged peaks bear the sun's cold arrow

Und schon sind Schluchten, Hänge, Matten grün. *Green are the gorges, slopes, and meads below:*

Now the rock shows itself greened

Auf hundert Hügeln unterbrochener Fläche *On hundred hillsides, cleft with many a hollow,*

The goat nibbles its meager portion fussily

Siehst Wollenherden ausgebreitet ziehn. *Thou seest the woolly herds like scattered snow.*

The spring leaps, streams plunge united

Verteilt, vorsichtig abgemessen schreitet *Divided, cautious, graze with measured paces*

And already gorges, slopes, meadows are green

Gehörntes Rind hinan zum jähen Rand; *The cattle onward to the dizzy edge,*

On a hundred hills of broken terrain

Doch Obdach ist den sämtlichen bereitet, *Yet for them all are furnished sheltered places,*

You see woolly herds spread out grazing

Zu hundert Höhlen wölbt sich Felsenwand. *Where countless caverns arch the rocky ledge.*

Divided, carefully measured, the horned cattle

Pan schützt sie dort, und Lebensnymphen wohnen *Pan guards them there, and nymphs of life are dwelling*

Step up toward the sheer edge

In buschiger Klüfte feucht erfrischtem Raum, *In bushy clefts, that moist and freshest be;*

But shelter is prepared for all

Und sehnsuchtsvoll nach höhern Regionen *And yearningly to higher regions swelling,*

Rock walls arch into a hundred caves

Erhebt sich zweighaft Baum gedrängt an Baum. *The branches crowd aloft of tree on tree.*

Pan protects them there, and nymphs of life dwell

Alt-Wälder sind's! Die Eiche starret mächtig, *Primeval woods! the strong oak there is regnant,*

In bushy clefts' moist refreshing space

Und eigensinnig zackt sich Ast an Ast; *And bough crooks out from bough in stubborn state;*

And longingly toward higher regions

Der Ahorn mild, von süßem Saft trüchtig, *The maple mild, with sweetest juices pregnant,*

Tree upon tree rises branching, crowded

Steigt rein empor und spielt mit seiner Last. *Shoots cleanly up, and dallies with its weight.*

Ancient forests! The oak stands mighty

Und mütterlich im stillen Schattenkreise *And motherly, in that still realm of shadows,*

And stubbornly branch hooks onto branch

Quillt laue Milch bereit für Kind und Lamm; *The warm milk flows, for child's and lambkin's lips:*

The mild maple, pregnant with sweet sap

Obst ist nicht weit, der Eben reife Speise, *At hand is fruit, the food of fertile meadows,*

Rises pure and plays with its burden

Und Honig trieft vom ausgehöhlten Stamm. *And from the hollow trunk the honey drips.*

And motherly in the still circle of shadow

Hier ist das Wohlbehagen erblich, *Here comfort is in birth transmitted;*

Warm milk wells forth ready for child and lamb

Die Wange heitert wie der Mund, *To cheek and lip here joy is sent:*

Fruit is near, the ripe food of the plains

Ein jeder ist an seinem Platz unsterblich: *Each is immortal in his station fitted,*

And honey drips from the hollowed trunk

Sie sind zufrieden und gesund. *And all are healthy and content.*

Here well-being is hereditary

Und so entwickelt sich am reinen Tage *And thus the child in that bright season gaineth*

Cheek brightens as does the mouth

Zu Vaterkraft das holde Kind. *The father-strength, as in a dream:*

Each one is immortal in his place

Wir staunen drob; noch immer bleibt die Frage: *We wonder; yet the question still remaineth,*

They are content and healthy

Ob's Götter, ob es Menschen sind? *If they are men, when Gods they seem.*

And so in pure day develops

So war Apoll den Hirten zugestaltet, *So was Apollo shepherd-like in feature,*

The lovely child to father-strength

Daß ihm der schönsten einer glich; *That other shepherds were as fair and fleet;*

We marvel at it; the question remains

Denn wo Natur im reinen Kreise waltet, *For where in such clear orbit moveth Nature,*

Are they gods or are they humans?

Ergreifen alle Welten sich. *All worlds in inter-action meet.*

So was Apollo shaped like a shepherd

(neben ihr sitzend) (Taking his seat beside her.)

So ist es mir, so ist es dir gelungen; *Thus hath success my fate and thine attended;*

That one of the fairest resembled him

Vergangenheit sei hinter uns getan! *Henceforth behind us let the past be furled!*

For where Nature rules in pure orbit

O fühle dich vom höchsten Gott entsprungen, *O, feel thyself from highest God descended!*

All worlds intertwine

Der ersten Welt gehörst du einzig an. *For thou belongest to the primal world.*

So have I succeeded, so have you

Nicht feste Burg soll dich umschreiben! *Thy life shall circumscribe no fortress frowning!*

Let the past be done behind us!

Noch zirkelt in ewiger Jugendkraft *Still, in eternal youth, stands as it stood,*

Oh feel yourself sprung from the highest god

Für uns, zu wonnevollem Bleiben, *For us, our stay with every rapture crowning,*

You belong solely to the first world

Arkadien in Spartas Nachbarschaft. *Arcadia in Sparta's neighbourhood.*

No fortress shall confine you!

Gelockt, auf sel'gem Grund zu wohnen, *To tread this happy soil at last incited,*

Still circles in eternal youthful strength

Du flüchtetest ins heiterste Geschick! *Thy flight was towards a joyous destiny!*

For us, for blissful dwelling

Zur Laube wandeln sich die Thronen, *Now let our throne become a bower unblighted,*

Arcadia in Sparta's neighborhood

Arkadisch frei sei unser Glück! *Our bliss become Arcadian and free!*

Enticed to dwell on blessed ground

Schattiger Hain / Shady Grove

(Die Szene verwandelt sich durchaus. An eine Reihe von Felsenhöhlen lehnen sich geschlossene Lauben. Schattiger Hain bis an die ringsum steigende Felsensteigung hinan. Faust und Helena werden nicht gesehen. Der Chor liegt schlafend verteilt umher.) (The scene is completely transformed. Against a range of rocky caverns close bowers are constructed. A shadowy grove extends to the foot of the rocks which rise on all sides. Faust and Helena are not seen: the Chorus lies scattered about sleeping.)

Phorkyas

Wie lange diese Mädchen schlafen, weiß ich nicht; *How long these maidens have been sleeping, know I not:*

Sleeping beauties? More like sleeping lazyasses

Ob sie sich träumen ließen, was ich hell und klar *If they allowed themselves to dream what now mine eyes*

I saw stuff - they were too busy drooling on the rocks

Vor Augen sah, ist ebenfalls mir unbekannt. *So clearly saw, is equally unknown to me.*

Your guess is as good as mine, and mine sucks

Drum weck' ich sie. Erstaunen soll das junge Volk; *Therefore, I wake them. They, the Young, shall be amazed,*

Rise and shine, children - prepare to have your minds blown

Ihr Bärtigen auch, die ihr da drunten sitzend harrt, *Ye also, Bearded Ones, who sit below and wait,*

Hey grandpa in row three - this means you too

Glaubhafter Wunder Lösung endlich anzuschauen. *Solution of these marvels finally to see.*

Mystery solved, case closed, you're welcome

Hervor! hervor! Und schüttelt eure Locken rasch! *Awake! arise! and shake from off your locks the dew.*

Up and at 'em! Fix your hair, you look like roadkill

Schlaf aus den Augen! Blinzt nicht so und hört mich an! *The slumber from your eyes! Listen, and cease to blink!*

Eyes open, ears on, mouth shut - storytime

Chor

Rede nur, erzähl', erzähle, was sich Wunderlichs begeben! *Speak and tell us, quickly tell us, all the wonders that have happened!*

Out with it already, we're dying here

Hören möchten wir am liebsten, was wir gar nicht glauben können; *We shall hear with greater pleasure, if belief we cannot give it,*

Give us the crazy - normal is boring

Denn wir haben Langeweile, diese Felsen anzusehn. *For both eye and mind are weary, to behold these rocks alone.*

Rocks. Just rocks. Kill me now

Phorkyas

Kaum die Augen ausgerieben, Kinder, langeweilt ihr schon? *Children, you have hardly rubbed your eyes, and are you weary now?*

Kids these days - two seconds awake and "I'm boooored"

So vernehmt: in diesen Höhlen, diesen Grotten, diesen Lauben *Hear me, then! Within these caverns, in the grottos and the arbours,*

Behind those bushes and inside those holes

Schutz und Schirmung war verliehen, wie idyllischem Liebespaare, *Screen and shelter have been lent, as unto twain idyllic lovers,*

They got a nice little spot for their honeymoon

Unserm Herrn und unsrer Frauen. *To our Lord and to our Lady.*

The boss and the missus

Chor

Wie, da drinnen? *How? within there?*

In THERE there?

Phorkyas

Abgesondert *Separated*

Yep, all alone

Von der Welt, nur mich, die eine, riefen sie zu stillem Dienste. *From the world, me only did they summon to their quiet service.*

World excluded - just me for room service

Hochgeehrt stand ich zur Seite, doch, wie es Vertrauten ziemet, *Honoured thus, I stood beside them, but, as fit in one so trusted,*

VIP access, but I knew when to look away

Schaut' ich um nach etwas andrem. Wendete mich hier- und dorthin, *Looked around at something other, turning here and there at random,*

Found the ceiling very interesting suddenly

Suchte Wurzeln, Moos und Rinden, kundig aller Wirksamkeiten, *Seeking roots, and bark, and mosses, being skilled in healing simples,*

Herb shopping - totally not eavesdropping

Und so blieben sie allein. *And the twain were left alone.*

And they did... whatever they did

Chor

Tust du doch, als ob da drinnen ganze Weltenräume wären, *Speakest thou as if within were spaces roomy as the world is:*

What is it, a cave or a shopping mall?

Wald und Wiese, Bäche, Seen; welche Märchen spinnst du ab! *Wood and meadow, lakes and rivers, what a fable dost thou spin!*

Yeah right, and I've got oceanfront property in Arizona

Phorkyas

Allerdings, ihr Unerfahrenen! das sind unerforschte Tiefen: *Certainly, ye Inexperienced! Those are unexplored recesses:*

You know nothing, Chorus Snow

Saal an Sälen, Hof an Höfen, diese spürt' ich sinnend aus. *Hall on hall, and court on court succeeding, musingly I tracked.*

It's like IKEA in there, except you can find the exit

Doch auf einmal ein Gelächter echot in den Höhlenräumen; *All at once a laughter echoes through the spaces of the caverns;*

Then: Ha ha ha ha, bouncing off the walls

Schau' ich hin, da springt ein Knabe von der Frauen Schoß zum Manne, *As I look, a Boy is leaping from the mother's lap to father's,*

Kid's playing leap-parent like a ping pong ball

Von dem Vater zu der Mutter; das Gekose, das Getändel, *From the father to the mother: the caressing and the dandling,*

Hot potato, except the potato is adorable

Töriger Liebe Neckereien, Scherzgeschrei und Lustgejauchze *Teasing pranks of silly fondness, cry of sport and shout of rapture,*

Goo-goo, ga-ga, and assorted parenting noises

Wechselnd übertäuben mich. *They, alternate, deafen me.*

So loud I might need hearing aids

Nackt, ein Genius ohne Flügel, faunenartig ohne Tierheit, *He, a Genius naked, wingless, like a Faun without the beasthood,*

Birthday suit, no wings, half-goat but make it cute

Springt er auf den festen Boden; doch der Boden gegenwirkend *Leaps upon the solid pavement; yet the pavement now reacting,*

Ground goes BOING - kid goes UP

Schnellt ihn zu der luft'gen Höhe, und im zweiten, dritten Sprunge *Sends him flying high in air, and at second bound or third, he*

Bouncy bouncy bouncy - kid's got hops

Rührt er an das Hochgewölb. *Seems to graze the vaulted roof.*

Bonk goes the head on the roof

Ängstlich ruft die Mutter: Springe wiederholt und nach Belieben, *Cries, disquieted, the mother: "Leap repeatedly, at pleasure,*

Mom: "Jump, fine, whatever, but—"

Aber hüte dich, zu fliegen, freier Flug ist dir versagt. *But beware of flying! for prohibited is flight to thee."*

"NO FLYING" - Mom rule number one

Und so mahnt der treue Vater: In der Erde liegt die Schnellkraft, *And thus warns the faithful father: "Dwells in earth the force elastic*

Dad's turn: "It's the ground making you bouncy"

Die dich aufwärts treibt; berühre mit der Zehe nur den Boden, *Which thee upwards thus impelleth; touch but with thy toe the surface,*

"Toe the ground = bounce power" - Dad physics

Wie der Erdensohn Antäus bist du alsobald gestärkt. *Like the son of Earth, Antaeus, straightway art thou strong again."*

“Be like that mythology guy, but don’t get choked out by Hercules”

Und so hüpfte er auf die Masse dieses Felsens, von der Kante *So he springs upon the rocky masses, from a dizzy cornice*

Boing from rock - to rock - to rock

Zu dem andern und umher, so wie ein Ball geschlagen springt. *To another, and around, as springs a ball when sharply struck.*

Kid.exe is now a screensaver

Doch auf einmal in der Spalte rauher Schlucht ist er verschwunden, *Yet, a-sudden, in a crevice of the hollow gulf he’s vanished,*

And he’s GONE - down a hole

Und nun scheint er uns verloren. Mutter jammert, Vater tröstet, *And it seemeth we have lost him! Mother mourns, and father comforts,*

Mom: AAAAAH! Dad: It’s fine, honey, it’s fine

Achselzuckend steh’ ich ängstlich. Doch nun wieder welch Erscheinen! *Shoulder-shrugging, anxiously I stand. But now, again, what vision!*

shrug But then - what the

Liegen Schätze dort verborgen? Blumenstreifige Gewande *Are there treasures yonder hidden? Garments striped with brodered blossoms*

Kid found the dress-up chest

Hat er würdig angetan. *Hath he worthily assumed.*

Fashion upgrade: complete

Quasten schwanken von den Armen, Binden flattern um den Busen, *Tassels from his shoulders swaying, fillets flutter round his bosom,*

Kid looks like a parade exploded on him

In der Hand die goldne Leier, völlig wie ein kleiner Phöbus, *In his hand the golden lyre, completely like a little Phoebus,*

Tiny rock star with sun god vibes

Tritt er wohlgenut zur Kante, zu dem Überhang; wir staunen. *Cheerily to the brink he steps, the jutting edge: we stand astounded,*

Edge? What edge? This kid has no fear

Und die Eltern vor Entzücken werfen wechselnd sich ans Herz. *And the parents in their rapture clasp each other to the heart.*

Parents: happy crying more hugging ugly crying

Denn wie leuchtet’s ihm zu Haupten? Was erglänzt, ist schwer zu sagen, *What around his head is shining? What it is, were hard to warrant,*

Kid’s got a glow-up - literally

Ist es Goldschmuck, ist es Flamme übermächtiger Geisteskraft? *Whether golden gauds, or flame of all-subduing strength of soul.*

Crown? Fire? Brain fart? WHO KNOWS

Und so regt er sich gebärdend, sich als Knabe schon verkündend *So he moves with stately gesture, even as boy himself proclaiming*

He's method acting "Important Person"

Künftigen Meister alles Schönen, dem die ewigen Melodien *Future Master of all Beauty, in the melodies eternal*

Coming soon: Master of Pretty with sick beats

Durch die Glieder sich bewegen; und so werdet ihr ihn hören, *Throbbing in his flesh and blood; and you shall thus, delighted, hear him,*

He's got the tunes in his bones

Und so werdet ihr ihn sehn zu einzigster Bewunderung. *Thus shall you behold him, with a wonder never felt before!*

Prepare your eyeballs for maximum amazement

Chor

Nennst du ein Wunder dies, *Call'st thou a marvel this,*

This? A wonder? Really?

Kretas Erzeugte? *Creta's begotten?*

Crete makes weird stuff, next

Dichtend belehrendem Wort *Poetic-didactical word*

Poetry? Hello? Anyone home?

Hast du gelauscht wohl nimmer? *Hast thou listened to never?*

Ionias called, you didn't answer

Niemals noch gehört Ioniens, *Never yet hearkened Ionias's*

Greece is on the other line, pick up

Nie vernommen auch Hellas' *Never received Hellas'*

Grandpa's grandpa's grandpa's stories

Urväterlicher Sagen *Godlike, heroic treasure*

The god-tier hero stuff

Göttlich-heldenhaften Reichtum? *Of ancient, primitive legends?*

All the stuff that stuff does

Alles, was je geschieht *All that ever happens*

These days, smh

Heutigen Tages, *Now in the Present*

It's all just echoes and regret

Trauriger Nachklang ist's *Mocks like a mournful echo*

The good old days (and I mean OLD old)

Herrlicher Ahnherrntage; *The grander days of the Fathers.*

Your story vs. their story: no contest

Nicht vergleicht sich dein Erzählen *Not comparable is thy story*

To the A+ grade lies of yore

Dem, was liebliche Lüge, *Unto that loveliest falsehood,*

Lies so good they out-truth truth

Glaubhafter als Wahrheit, *Than Truth more credible,*

The Hermes story - now THAT was something

Von dem Sohne sang der Maja. *Sung of the Son of Maia!*

Baby: soft AND strong? Pick a lane

Diesen zierlich und kräftig doch *This strong and delicate, yet*

Nurses: baby wrapped, job done, let's gossip

Kaum geborenen Säugling *Scarcely delivered suckling,*

Expensive baby straight-jacket: engaged

Faltet in reinster Windeln Flaum, *Swathe ye in purest downy bands,*

Nurses and their weird baby-wrapping fixation

Strenget in köstlicher Wickeln Schmuck *Bind ye in precious diapered stuffs,*

Kid's like: nope, out of this

Klatschender Wärterinnen Schar *As is the gossiping nurse's*

Rubber baby limbs: activate

Unvernünftigen Wähnens. *Unreasonable notion!*

Purple blanket: defeated

Kräftig und zierlich aber zieht *Strongly and daintily draws, no less,*

So long, cloth jail

Schon der Schalk die geschmeidigen *Now the rogue the flexible,*

drops blanket walks away

Doch elastischen Glieder *Firm yet elastic body*

Peak butterfly energy

Listig heraus, die purpurne, *Cunningly out, and leaveth the close,*

Cocoon: busted

Ängstlich drückende Schale *Purple, impeding shell*

Slip, unfold, FREEDOM

Lassend ruhig an seiner Statt; *Quietly there in its place,*

Sunbeams: entered. Like a boss

Gleich dem fertigen Schmetterling, *Like the completed butterfly,*

Flap flap flap, no rules

Der aus starrem Puppenzwang *Which from the chilly chrysalid*

Fastest baby in the world, folks

Flügel entfaltend behendig schlüpft, *Nimbly, pinion-unfolding, slips,*

BFF of thieves and scammers

Sonnendurchstrahlten Äther kühn *Boldly and wilfully fluttering through*

Everyone looking to game the system

Und mutwillig durchflatternd. *Sunshine-pervaded ether.*

Eternal mascot of sketchy dealings

So auch er, der Behendeste, *So he, too, the sprightliest:*

Proof: delivered ASAP

Daß er Dieben und Schälken, *That unto thieves and jugglers*

Expert-level shenanigans

Vorteilsuchenden allen auch *All the seekers of profit, as well,*

Yoink - there goes Poseidon's poky stick

Ewig günstiger Dämon sei, *He the favorable Daemon was,*

Trident: gone. Now Ares

Dies betätigt er alsobald *Did he speedily manifest*

sneaky sword stealing sounds

Durch gewandteste Künste. *By the skillfulest artifice.*

Apollo: Where's my bow? Kid: What bow?

Schnell des Meeres Beherrscher stiehlt *Straight from the Ruler of Ocean stole*

Hephaestus: My tongs! Kid: These tongs? Never seen 'em

Er den Trident, ja dem Ares selbst *He the trident, from Ares himself*

Zeus's zapper? Kid tried

Schlau das Schwert aus der Scheide; *Slyly the sword from the scabbard,*

Nope - too hot. Even for baby thieves

Bogen und Pfeil dem Phöbus auch, *Arrows and bow from Phoebus, and then*

Eros? Schooled

Wie dem Hephästos die Zange; *Tongs that Hephaestus was using.*

Wrestling: cheated. Won anyway

Selber Zeus', des Vaters, Blitz *Even from Zeus, the Father, bolts had he*

Aphrodite: Aww cute ba- HEY!

Nähm' er, schreckt' ihn das Feuer nicht; *Filched, had the fire not scared him.*

THE girdle. Right off the boobs

Doch dem Eros siegt er ob *Eros, also, he overcame*

Music time - ears open

In beinstellendem Ringerspiel; *In leg-tripping wrestling match;*

Fables? Trash 'em

Raubt auch Cyprien, wie sie ihm kost, *Then from Cypris, as she caressed him,*

Your god-collection: expired

Noch vom Busen den Gürtel. *Plundered the zone from her bosom.*

Bye-bye, ancient history

(Ein reizendes rein melodisches Saitenspiel erklingt aus der Höhle. Alle merken auf und scheinen bald innig gerührt. Von hier an bis zur bemerkten Pause durchaus mit vollstimmiger Musik.) (An exquisite, purely melodious music of stringed instruments resounds from the cavern. All become attentive, and soon appear to be deeply moved. From this point to the pause designated, there is a full musical accompaniment.)

Phorkyas

Höret allerliebste Klänge, *Hark! the music, pure and golden;*

You're speaking a dead language, basically

Macht euch schnell von Fabeln frei! *Free from fables be at last!*

Standards have risen, folks

Eurer Götter alt Gemenge, *All your Gods, the medley olden,*

No heart? No deal

Laßt es hin, es ist vorbei. *Let depart! their day is past.*

Heart to heart or nothing

Niemand will euch mehr verstehen, *You no more are comprehended;*

If YOU of all people

Fordern wir doch höhern Zoll: *We require a higher part:*

Are vibing to this

Denn es muß von Herzen gehen, *By the heart must be expended*

We're like: aww, we feel better

Was auf Herzen wirken soll. *What shall work upon the heart.*

Crying, but like, happy crying

(Sie zieht sich nach den Felsen zurück.) (She retires towards the rocks.)

Chor

Bist du, fürchterliches Wesen, *If the flattering music presses,*

Sun can go, whatever

Diesem Schmeichelton geneigt, *Fearful Being, to thine ears,*

Inside-sunrise beats outside-sunrise

Fühlen wir, als frisch genesen, *We, restored to health, confess us*

Heart: better than everything

Uns zur Tränenlust erweicht. *Softened to the joy of tears.*

World says no; heart says yes

Laß der Sonne Glanz verschwinden, *Let the sun be missed from heaven,*

Kid singing?

Wenn es in der Seele tagt, *When the soul is bright with morn!*

= instant good times

Wir im eignen Herzen finden, *What the world has never given*

See me bounce

Was die ganze Welt versagt. *Now within our hearts is born.*

= bouncy parent feelings

(Helena, Faust, Euphorion in dem oben beschriebenen Kostüme) (Helena. Faust. Euphorion in the costume already described.)

Euphorion

Hört ihr Kindeslieder singen, *Hear ye songs of childish pleasure,*

Love, the regular version

Gleich ist's euer eigner Scherz; *Ye are moved to playful glee;*

Takes two to tango

Seht ihr mich im Takte springen, *Seeing me thus dance in measure,*

For the REALLY good stuff though

Hüpft euch elterlich das Herz. *Leap your hearts parentally.*

Takes three to tango harder

Helena

Liebe, menschlich zu beglücken, *Love, in human wise to bless us,*

Mission accomplished

Nähert sie ein edles Zwei, *In a noble Pair must be;*

Mine, yours, sorted

Doch zu göttlichem Entzücken *But divinely to possess us,*

Team standing: engaged

Bildet sie ein köstlich Drei. *It must form a precious Three.*

This or nothing

Faust

Alles ist sodann gefunden: *All we seek has therefore found us;*

Happy years: loading

Ich bin dein, und du bist mein; *I am thine and thou art mine!*

Kid's shiny, parents happy

Und so stehen wir verbunden, *So we stand as love hath bound us:*

Lucky couple is lucky

Dürft' es doch nicht anders sein! *Other fortune we resign.*

The feels! Too many feels!

Chor

Wohlgefallen vieler Jahre *Many years shall they, delighted,*

Boing time? Boing time

In des Knaben mildem Schein *Gather from the shining boy*

Spring time, not the season

Sammelt sich auf diesem Paare. *Double bliss for hearts united:*

Air! More air!

O, wie rührt mich der Verein! *In their union what a joy!*

UP UP UP

Euphorion

Nun laßt mich hüpfen, *Let me be skipping,*

Want want want

Nun laßt mich springen! *Let me be leaping!*

Grabbed me good

Zu allen Lüften *To soar and circle,*

Chill! Chill!

Hinaufzudringen, *Through ether sweeping,*

No crazy stuff

Ist mir Begierde, *Is now the passion*

Don't go splat

Sie faßt mich schon. *That me hath won.*

No ouchies please

Faust

Nur mäßig! mäßig! *But gently! gently!*

And break us

Nicht ins Verwegne, *Not rashly faring!*

Our kid!

Daß Sturz und Unfall *Lest plunge and ruin*

Nuh-uh

Dir nicht begegne, *Repay thy daring,*

No floor for me

Zugrund uns richte *Perchance destroy thee,*

Hands! Off!

Der teure Sohn! *Our darling son!*

Not the hair!

Euphorion

Ich will nicht länger *I will not longer*

Clothes! Mine!

Am Boden stocken; *Stagnate below here!*

My stuff, back off

Laßt meine Hände, *Let go my tresses,*

Brain! Use it!

Laßt meine Locken, *My hands let go, here!*

You belong to US

Laßt meine Kleider! *Let go my garments!*

Sad parents ahead

Sie sind ja mein. *They all are mine.*

You'd break

Helena

O denk! o denke, *O think! Bethink thee*

Our nice thing

Wem du gehörest! *To whom thou belongest!*

Yours mine his - ALL of it

Wie es uns kränke, *How it would grieve us,*

Uh oh

Wie du zerstörest *And how thou wrongest*

Breakup incoming

Das schön errungene *The fortune fairest,*

Easy! Easy!

Mein, Dein und Sein. *Mine, His, and Thine!*

For us!

Chor

Bald löst, ich fürchte, *Soon shall, I fear me,*

Your too-much

Sich der Verein! *The sweet bond untwine!*

Big wants!

Helena und Faust

Bändige! bändige *Curb, thou Unfortunate!*

Countryside, peace

Eltern zuliebe *For our desiring,*

Make fields pretty

Überlebendige, *Thine over-importunate*

Okay, okay, for YOU

Heftige Triebe! *Lofty aspiring!*

Holding back

Ländlich im stillen *Rurally quiet,*

Light, lighter, lightest

Ziere den Plan. *Brighten the plain!*

Party people

Euphorion

Nur euch zu Willen *Since you will that I try it,*

This the right song?

Halt' ich mich an. *My flight I restrain.*

Dance good?

(Durch den Chor sich schlingend und ihn zum Tanze fortziehend) (Winding in dance through the Chorus, and drawing them with him.)

Leichter umschweb' ich hie *Round them I hover free;*

Yes, nailed it

Muntres Geschlecht. *Gay is the race:*

Lead the pretties

Ist nun die Melodie, *Is this the melody?*

Fancy dance lines

Ist die Bewegung recht? *Move I with grace?*

Done yet? Please?

Helena

Ja, das ist wohlgetan; *Yes, that is featly done:*

These shenanigans

Führe die Schönen an *Lead them through, every one,*

Not feeling it

Künstlichem Reihn. *Mazes of art!*

Arm wavy

Faust

Wäre das doch vorbei! *Soon let it ended be!*

Cute!

Mich kann die Gaukelei *Sight of such jugglery*

Hair flip!

Gar nicht erfreun. *Troubles my heart.*

Shiny!

Chor

(mit Euphorion, tanzend und singend, in verschlungenen Reihen) (with Euphorion, dancing and singing, in interlinking ranks)

Wenn du der Arme Paar *When thou thine arms so fair*

Tippy toes

Lieblich bewegest, *Charmingly liftest,*

Ground? Barely

Im Glanz dein lockig Haar *The curls of thy shining hair*

Here! There!

Schüttelnd erregest, *Shakest and shiftest;*

Parts following parts

Wenn dir der Fuß so leicht *When thou, with foot so light,*

You did it!

Über die Erde schleicht, *Brushes the earth in flight,*

Pretty kid

Dort und da wieder hin *Hither and forth again*

All hearts

Glieder um Glied sich ziehn, *Leading the linked chain,*

Point at you

Hast du dein Ziel erreicht, *Then is thy goal in sight,*

Lots of you

Liebliches Kind; *Loveliest Boy!*

Deer-feet people

All' unsre Herzen sind *All of our hearts in joy*

New game!

All' dir geneigt. *Round thee unite.*

Come here! Now!

Euphorion

Ihr seid so viele *Not yet repose,*

Hunter: me

Leichtfüßige Rehe; *Ye light-footed roes!*

Game: you

Zu neuem Spiele *Now to new play*

Wanna catch us?

Frisch aus der Nähe! *Forth, and away!*

Slow down

Ich bin der Jäger, *I am the hunter,*

We want

Ihr seid das Wild. *You are the game.*

In the end

Chor

Willst du uns fangen, *Wouldst thou acquire us,*

Hugs

Sei nicht behende, *Be not so fast!*

Pretty!

Denn wir verlangen *We are desirous*

Through trees!

Doch nur am Ende, *Only, at last,*

Rocks! Sticks!

Dich zu umarmen, *Clasping thy beauty,*

Easy stuff

Du schönes Bild! *Kisses to claim!*

Bleh

Euphorion

Nur durch die Haine! *Through groves and through hedges!*

Hard stuff only

Zu Stock und Steine! *O'er cliffs and o'er ledges!*

Good stuff

Das leicht Errungene, *Lightly what fell to me,*

Wild! Crazy!

Das widert mir, *That I detest:*

Calm? Forget it

Nur das Erzwungene *What I compel to me*

Horns! Hunting!

Ergetzt mich schier. *Pleases me best.*

LOUD

Helena und Faust

Welch ein Mutwill'! welch ein Rasen! *How perverse, how wild he's growing!*

Mess! Noise!

Keine Mäßigung ist zu hoffen. *Vain to hope for moderation;*

Zoom - gone

Klingt es doch wie Hörnerblasen *Now it sounds like bugles blowing,*

Ha ha, you suck

Über Tal und Wälder dröhnend; *Over vale and forest pealing:*

Grabby hands

Welch ein Unfug! welch Geschrei! *What disorder! What a brawl!*

Wild one caught

Chor

(einzeln schnell eintretend) (entering singly, in haste)

Uns ist er vorbeigelaufen; *Forth from us with swiftness ran he!*

Got one!

Mit Verachtung uns verhöhrend, *Spurning us with scornful feeling,*

My prize now

Schleppt er von dem ganzen Haufen *Now he drags from out the many*

Fun time for me

Nun die Wildeste herbei. *Here, the wildest one of all.*

Squeeze

Euphorion

(ein junges Mädchen hereintragend) (bearing a young Maiden)

Schlepp' ich her die derbe Kleine *Here I drag the little racer,*

Kiss

Zu erzwungenem Genusse; *And by force will I embrace her;*

Power! Will!

Mir zur Wonne, mir zur Lust *For my bliss and for my zest*

Let go! Inside here

Drück' ich widerspenstige Brust, *Press the fair, resisting breast,*

= brave and strong

Küss' ich widerwärtigen Mund, *Kiss the mouth, repellent still,*

Same will, buddy

Tue Kraft und Willen kund. *Manifest my strength and will.*

Not easy pickings

Mädchen

Laß mich los! In dieser Hülle *Let me go! This frame infoldeth*

Trapped? Me?

Ist auch Geistes Mut und Kraft; *Also courage, strength of soul:*

Arms aren't everything

Deinem gleich ist unser Wille *Strong as thine, our will upholdeth,*

Hold = burn

Nicht so leicht hinweggerafft. *When another would control.*

Fool game: reversed

Glaubst du wohl mich im Gedränge? *I am in a strait, thou deemest?*

Follow me - up!

Deinem Arm vertraust du viel! *What a force thine arm would claim!*

Or down!

Halte fest, und ich versenge *Hold me, Fool, and ere thou dreamest*

Catch THIS

Dich, den Toren, mir zum Spiel. *I will scorch thee, in my game.*

Rocks rocks rocks

(Sie flammt auf und lodert in die Höhe.) (She turns to flame and flashes up in the air.)

Folge mir in leichte Lüfte, *To the airy spaces follow,*

Trees bushes trees

Folge mir in starre Gräfte, *Follow me to caverns hollow,*

Tight spaces? Why?

Hasche das verschwundne Ziel! *Snatch and hold thy vanished aim!*

Young! Fresh!

Euphorion

(die letzten Flammen abschüttelnd) (shaking off the last flames)

Felsengedränge hier *Rocks all around me here,*

Wind! Wooo!

Zwischen dem Waldgebüsch, *Over the forests hung!*

Waves! Crash!

Was soll die Enge mir, *Why should they bound me here?*

Far! Too far!

Bin ich doch jung und frisch. *Still am I fresh and young.*

Want: close

Winde, sie sausen ja, *Tempests are waking now,*

Goat mode?

Wellen, sie brausen da; *Billows are breaking now:*

Scared of splat

Hör' ich doch beides fern, *Both far away I hear;*

Higher! More higher!

Nah wär' ich gern. *Fain would be near.*

See more!

(Er springt immer höher felsauf.) (He leaps ever farther up the rocks.)

Helena, Faust und Chor

Wolltest du den Gemen gleichen? *Chamois-like, dost thou aspire?*

I know!

Vor dem Falle muß uns graun. *Fearful of the fall are we.*

Middle!

Euphorion

Immer höher muß ich steigen, *I must clamber ever higher,*

Pelops place!

Immer weiter muß ich schaun. *Ever further must I see.*

The grander days of the fathers - a sad karaoke of ancient hits

Weiß ich nun, wo ich bin! *Now, where I am, I spy!*

Your story can't compete

Mitten der Insel drin, *Midst of the Isle am I:*

With that gorgeous lie

Mitten in Pelops' Land, *Midst of Pelops' land,*

More believable than any truth

Erde- wie seeverwandt. *Kindred in soul, I stand!*

They sang of Maia's boy

Chor

Magst nicht in Berg und Wald *Bide thou by grove and hill,*

(Hermes, god of thieves and TED talks)

Friedlich verweilen? *Peacefully, rather!*

This dainty yet muscular infant

Suchen wir alsobald *We from the vineyards will*

Barely squeezed out, still slippery

Reben in Zeilen, *Grapes for thee gather,*

They swaddle in purest down

Reben am Hügelrand, *Grapes from the ridges tanned,*

Wrap him in designer diapers

Feigen und Apfelgold. *Figs, and the apples gold:*

As gossiping nurses do

Ach in dem holden Land *Ah! yet the lovely land,*

With their unreasonable notions

Bleibe du hold! *Loving, behold!*

But strong and dainty both, the little rogue

Euphorion

Träumt ihr den Friedenstag? *Dream ye the peaceful day?*

Already pulls his flexible limbs

Träume, wer träumen mag. *Dream, then, who may!*

Out from the binding wraps

Krieg! ist das Losungswort. *War! is the countersign:*

Slips free of the purple prison

Sieg! und so klingt es fort. *Victory - word divine!*

Leaves the shell behind like yesterday's laundry

Chor

Wer im Frieden *Who peace and unity*

Houdini in a onesie

Wünscht sich Krieg zurück, *Scorneth, for war's array,*

Like the finished butterfly

Der ist geschieden *With impunity*

Slipping from the stiff chrysalis

Vom Hoffnungsglück. *Slays his hope of a better day.*

Wings unfolding, nimble

Euphorion

Welche dies Land gebär *They, who this land have led*

Boldly fluttering through

Aus Gefahr in Gefahr, *Through danger and dread,*

Sun-pervaded ether

Frei, unbegrenzten Muts, *Free, boundlessly brave,*

Zero to flight risk in seconds flat

Verschwendrisch eignen Bluts, *Lavish of blood they gave,*

So too he, the sprightliest

Den nicht zu dämpfenden *May they, with glorious*

That unto thieves and tricksters

Heiligen Sinn - *Untamable might,*

And all profit-seekers

Alle den Kämpfenden *Make us victorious,*

He'd be their patron demon

Bring' es Gewinn! *Now, in the fight!*

He proved immediately

Chor

Seht hinauf, wie hoch gestiegen! *Look aloft! he seeks the Farness,*

Through the slickest artifice

Und er scheint uns doch nicht klein: *Yet to us not small he seems,*

Quick - steals Neptune's trident

Wie im Harnisch, wie zum Siegen, *As for battle, as in harness,*

From Ares, slyly, sword from sheath

Wie von Erz und Stahl der Schein. *He like steel and silver gleams.*

Bow and arrows from Apollo

Euphorion

Keine Wälle, keine Mauern, *Walls and towers no more immuring,*

Tongs from Hephaestus mid-forge

Jeder nur sich selbst bewußt; *Each in vigor stands confessed!*

Would've snagged Zeus's thunderbolts too

Feste Burg, um auszudauern, *Fortress firm and most enduring*

But fire's a deal-breaker, even for baby gods

Ist des Mannes ehre Brust. *Is the soldier's iron breast.*

Yet he beat Eros at wrestling

Wollt ihr unerobert wohnen, *Would ye dwell in freemen's houses?*

With leg-trips and holds

Leicht bewaffnet rasch ins Feld; *Arm, and forth to combat wild!*

And from Cypris, while she petted him

Frauen werden Amazonen *See, as Amazons, your spouses,*

Stole the girdle off her tits

Und ein jedes Kind ein Held. *And a hero every child!*

History's first pickpocket

Chor

Heilige Poesie, *Hallowed Poesy,*

Cute enough to rob blind even the gods

Himmelan steige sie! *Heavenward mounting, see!*

Hear the loveliest sounds!

Glänze, der schönste Stern, *Shining, the fairest star,*

Free yourselves from fables at last!

Fern und so weiter fern! *Farther, and still more far!*

Your old gods, that jumbled collection

Und sie erreicht uns doch *Yet, from the distance blown,*

Let them go - their day is past

Immer, man hört sie noch, *Hear we the lightest tone,*

No one understands you anymore

Vernimmt sie gern. *And raptured are.*

We demand a higher toll now

Euphorion

Nein, nicht ein Kind bin ich erschienen, *No, 'tis no child which thou beholdest*

For what works upon the heart

In Waffen kommt der Jüngling an; *A youth in arms, with haughty brow!*

Must come straight from the heart

Gesellt zu Starken, Freien, Kühnen, *And with the Strongest, Freest, Boldest,*

These old myths are elevator music

Hat er im Geiste schon getan. *His soul is pledged, in manly vow.*

Time to feel something real

Nun fort! *I go!*

Your gods are discontinued models

Nun dort *For, lo!*

Upgrade to the heart's full bandwidth

Eröffnet sich zum Ruhm die Bahn. *The path to Glory opens now.*

If you, dreadful creature

Helena und Faust

Kaum ins Leben ingerufen, *Thou thy being scarcely learnest,*

Respond to these tender sounds

Heitrem Tag gegeben kaum, *Scarcely feel'st the Day's glad beam,*

Then we, restored fresh

Sehnest du von Schwindelstufen *When from giddy steeps thou yearnest*

Soften to the joy of tears

Dich zu schmerzenvollem Raum. *For the place of pain supreme!*

Let the sun go missing from heaven

Sind denn wir *Are then we*

When the soul has its own dawn

Gar nichts dir? *Naught to thee?*

We find within our own hearts

Ist der holde Bund ein Traum? *Is the gracious bond a dream?*

What the whole world denied us

Euphorion

Und hört ihr donnern auf dem Meere? *And hear ye thunders on the ocean?*

Turns out the good stuff was inside all along

Dort widerdonnern Tal um Tal, *From land the thunder-echoes call?*

Like a self-help book but with lyre accompaniment

In Staub und Wellen, Heer dem Heere, *In dust and foam, with fierce commotion,*

External sun: optional. Internal sun: mandatory

In Drang um Drang, zu Schmerz und Qual. *The armies shock, the heroes fall!*

The real treasure was the feelings we felt along the way

Und der Tod *The command*

Hear me sing my children's songs

Ist Gebot, *Is, sword in hand,*

And your own joy stirs at once

Das versteht sich nun einmal. *To die: 'tis certain, once for all.*

See me dance in measure

Helena, Faust und Chor

Welch Entsetzen! welches Grauen! *What a horror! We shall rue it!*

And your parent-hearts leap too

Ist der Tod denn dir Gebot? *Ah, is Death command to thee?*

I'm basically a mood ring

Euphorion

Sollt' ich aus der Ferne schauen? *Shall I from the distance view it?*

What I feel, you feel - I'm contagious joy

Nein! ich teile Sorg' und Not. *No! the fate be shared by me!*

Love, to bless us humanly

Die Vorigen

Übermut und Gefahr, *Danger his arrogance brings*

Needs a noble pair

Tödliches Los! *Fatally bold!*

But for divine rapture

Euphorion

Doch! - und ein Flügelpaar *Yes! and a pair of wings*

It must form a precious three

Faltet sich los! *See me unfold!*

Two's company, three's a family

Dorthin! Ich muß! ich muß! *Thither! I must! and thus!*

The holy math of multiplication

Gönnt mir den Flug! *Grant me the flight!*

All is found, then

(Er wirft sich in die Lüfte, die Gewande tragen ihn einen Augenblick, sein Haupt strahlt, ein Lichtschweif zieht nach.) (He casts himself into the air: the garments bear him a moment, his head is illuminated, and a streak of light follows.)

Chor

Ikarus! Ikarus! *Icarus! Icarus!*

I am yours and you are mine

Jammer genug. *Sorrowful sight!*

And so we stand bound

(Ein schöner Jüngling stürzt zu der Eltern Füßen, man glaubt in dem Toten eine bekannte Gestalt zu erblicken; doch das Körperliche verschwindet sogleich, die Aureole steigt wie ein Komet zum Himmel auf, Kleid, Mantel und Lyra bleiben liegen.) (A beautiful Youth falls at the feet of the parents. We imagine that in the dead body we perceive a well-known form; yet the corporeal part vanishes at once, and the aureole rises like a comet towards heaven. The garment, mantle, and lyre remain upon the ground.)

Helena und Faust

Der Freude folgt sogleich *Joy is followed, when scarce enjoyed,*

It could be no other way

Grimmige Pein. *By bitterest moan.*

Peak contentment achieved

Euphorions Stimme

(aus der Tiefe) (from the depths)

Laß mich im düstern Reich, *Leave me here in the gloomy Void,*

Don't touch the dial

Mutter, mich nicht allein! *Mother, not thus alone!*

Many years of joy

Chor

(Trauergesang) (Dirge)

Nicht allein! - wo du auch weilest, *Not alone! where'er thou bidest;*

Will gather on this pair

Denn wir glauben dich zu kennen; *For we know thee what thou art.*

From the shining boy

Ach! wenn du dem Tag enteilest, *Ah! if from the Day thou hidest,*

O how this union moves me!

Wird kein Herz von dir sich trennen. *Still to thee will cling each heart.*

They're basically glowing

Wüßten wir doch kaum zu klagen, *Scarce we venture to lament thee,*

Domestic bliss at maximum wattage

Neidend singen wir dein Los: *Singing, envious of thy fate;*

Now let me hop!

Dir in klar- und trüben Tagen *For in storm and sun were lent thee*

Now let me leap!

Lied und Mut war schön und groß. *Song and courage, fair and great.*

To soar through all the airs

Ach! zum Erdenglück geboren, *Ah! for earthly fortune fashioned,*

Is my desire

Hoher Ahnen, großer Kraft, *Strength was thine, and proud descent:*

It seizes me already

Leider früh dir selbst verloren, *Early erring, o'er-impassioned,*

Gravity is boring

Jugendblüte weggerafft! *Youth, alas! from thee was rent.*

Easy! Easy!

Scharfer Blick, die Welt zu schauen, *For the world thine eye was rarest,*

Don't be reckless!

Mitsinn jedem Herzensdrang, *All the heart to thee was known:*

Lest crash and disaster

Liebesglut der besten Frauen *Thine were loves of women fairest,*

Meet you on the way

Und ein eigenster Gesang. *And a song thy very own.*

And destroy us all

Doch du ranntest unaufhaltsam *Yet thou rannest uncontrolledly*

Dear son, you're not a drone

Frei ins willenlose Netz, *In the net the fancies draw,*

I won't stagnate

So entzweitest du gewaltsam *Thus thyself divorcing boldly*

On the ground any longer!

Dich mit Sitte, mit Gesetz; *As from custom, so from law;*

Let go my hands!

Doch zuletzt das höchste Sinnen *Till the highest thought expended*

Let go my hair!

Gab dem reinen Mut Gewicht, *Set at last thy courage free:*

Let go my clothes!

Wolltest Herrliches gewinnen, *Thou wouldst win achievement splendid,*

They're mine, not yours, hands off

Aber es gelang dir nicht. *But it was not given to thee.*

O think! O think

Wem gelingt es? - Trübe Frage, *Unto whom, then? Question dreary,*

To whom you belong!

Der das Schicksal sich verhummt, *Destiny will never heed;*

How it would hurt us

Wenn am unglücklichsten Tage *When in evil days and weary,*

How you'd destroy

Blutend alles Volk verstummt. *Silently the people bleed.*

The beautiful thing we won

Doch erfrischt neue Lieder, *But new songs shall still elate them:*

Mine, his, and yours - don't smash the set

Steht nicht länger tief gebeugt: *Bow no longer and deplore!*

Soon, I fear

Denn der Boden zeugt sie wieder, *For the soil shall generate them,*

This bond will unravel

Wie von je er sie gezeugt. *As it hath done heretofore.*

The thread's already fraying

(Völlige Pause. Die Musik hört auf.) (Complete pause. The music ceases.)

Helena

(zu Faust) (to Faust)

Ein altes Wort bewährt sich leider auch an mir: *Also in me, alas! an old word proves its truth,*

Can't have nice things

Daß Glück und Schönheit dauerhaft sich nicht vereint. *That Bliss and Beauty ne'er enduringly unite.*

Domestic bliss: expires quickly after opening

Zerrissen ist des Lebens wie der Liebe Band; *Torn is the link of Life, no less than that of Love;*

Here comes the entropy

Bejammernd beide, sag' ich schmerzlich Lebewohl *So, both lamenting, painfully I say: Farewell!*

Restrain, restrain

Und werfe mich noch einmal in die Arme dir. *And cast myself again - once only - in thine arms.*

For your parents' sake

Persephoneia, nimm den Knaben auf und mich! *Receive, Persephone, receive the boy and me!*

Your over-abundant

*(Sie umarmt Faust, das Körperliche verschwindet, Kleid und Schleier bleiben ihm in den Armen.)
(She embraces Faust: her corporeal part disappears, her garment and veil remain in his arms.)*

Phorkyas

(zu Faust) (to Faust)

Halte fest, was dir von allem übrigblieb. *Hold fast what now alone remains to thee!*

Violent drives!

Das Kleid, laß es nicht los. Da zupfen schon *The garment let not go! Already twitch*

Stay rural, stay quiet

Dämonen an den Zipfeln, möchten gern *The Demons at its skirts, and they would fain*

Decorate the plain instead

Zur Unterwelt es reißen. Halte fest! *To the Nether Regions drag it! Hold it fast!*

Only for your sake

Die Göttin ist's nicht mehr, die du verlorst, *It is no more the Goddess thou hast lost,*

Will I hold back

Doch göttlich ist's. Bediene dich der hohen, *But godlike is it. For thy use employ*

Fine, I'll play your game

Unschätzbaren Gunst und hebe dich empor: *The grand and priceless gift, and soar aloft!*

For now

Es trägt dich über alles Gemeine rasch *'Twill bear thee swift from all things mean and low*

Compliance: temporary mode engaged

Am Äther hin, so lange du dauern kannst. *To ether high, so long thou canst endure.*

Watch me be good (briefly)

Wir sehn uns wieder, weit, gar weit von hier. *We'll meet again, far, very far from here.*

Light I hover round them

(Helenens Gewande lösen sich in Wolken auf, umgeben Faust, heben ihn in die Höhe und ziehen mit ihm vorüber.) (Helena's garments dissolve into clouds, surround Faust, lift him aloft in the air, and move away with him.)

Phorkyas

(hebt Euphorions Kleid, Mantel und Lyra von der Erde, tritt ins Proszenium, hebt die Exuvien in die Höhe und spricht:) *(takes up Euphorion's tunic, mantle, and lyre from the earth, steps forward to the proscenium, holds aloft these remains, and speaks:)*

Noch immer glücklich aufgefunden! *Good leaving have I still discovered!*

This merry race!

Die Flamme freilich ist verschwunden, *The Flame has vanished where it hovered,*

Is this the melody?

Doch ist mir um die Welt nicht leid. *Yet for the world no tears I spend.*

Is my movement right?

Hier bleibt genug, Poeten einzuweihen, *Enough remains to start the Poets living,*

Feedback please, I'm crushing it

Zu stiften Gild- und Handwerksneid; *And envy in their guilds to send;*

Dancing with the backup singers

Und kann ich die Talente nicht verleihen, *And, if their talents are beyond my giving,*

Yes, that's well done

Verborg' ich wenigstens das Kleid. *At least the costume I can lend.*

Lead the beauties through

(Sie setzt sich im Proszenium an eine Säule nieder.) (She seats herself upon a column in the proscenium.)

Panthalis

Nun eilig, Mädchen! Sind wir doch den Zauber los, *Now hasten, maidens! we are from the magic freed,*

Artistic mazes!

Der alt-thessalischen Vettel wüsten Geisteszwang, *The old Thessalian trollop's mind-compelling spell,*

Mommy approves

So des Geklimpers vielverworrner Töne Rausch, *Freed from the jingling drone of much-bewildering sound,*

You've earned your choreography badge

Das Ohr verwirrend, schlimmer noch den innern Sinn. *The ear confusing, and still more the inner sense.*

Gold star in interpretive dance

Hinab zum Hades! Eilte doch die Königin *Down, then to Hades! since beforehand went the Queen,*

If only this were over!

Mit ernstem Gang hinunter. Ihrer Sohle sei *With solemn step descending. Now, upon the track,*

This jugglery

Unmittelbar getreuer Mägde Schritt gefügt. *Let straightway follow her the step of faithful maids!*

Doesn't please me at all

Wir finden sie am Throne der Unerforschlichen. *Her shall we find beside the unfathomed, gloomy King.*

Dad's got a bad feeling

Chor

Königinnen freilich, überall sind sie gern; *Queens, of course, are satisfied everywhere:*

Too much whimsy makes me nervous

Auch im Hades stehen sie obenan, *Even in Hades take they highest rank,*

Something's gonna break

Stolz zu ihresgleichen gesellt, *Proudly associate with their peers,*

When you lift your lovely arms

Mit Persephonen innigst vertraut; *With Persephone closely allied:*

And shake your shining curls

Aber wir im Hintergrunde *We, however, in the background*

When your light foot barely

Tiefer Asphodelos-Wiesen, *Of the asphodel-besprinkled meadows,*

Brushes the earth in flight

Langgestreckten Pappeln, *With the endless rows of poplars*

Hither and forth again

Unfruchtbaren Weiden zugesellt, *And the fruitless willows ever mated,*

Drawing limb after limb along

Welchen Zeitvertreib haben wir? *What amusement, then, have we?*

You've reached your goal

Fledermausgleich zu piepsen, *Bat-like to squeak and twitter*

Loveliest boy!

Geflüster, unerfreulich, gespenstig. *In whispers uncheery and ghostly!*

All our hearts incline

Panthalis

Wer keinen Namen sich erwarb noch Edles will, *Who hath not won a name, and seeks not noble works,*

Toward you

Gehört den Elementen an; so fahret hin! *Belongs but to the elements: away then, ye!*

We're groupies now

Mit meiner Königin zu sein, verlangt mich heiß; *My own intense desire is with my Queen to be;*

Utterly smitten

Nicht nur Verdienst, auch Treue wahrt uns die Person. *Service and faith secure the individual life.*

Heart magnets, all pointing Euphorion

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Alle

Zurückgegeben sind wir dem Tageslicht, *Given again to the daylight are we,*

You've won us completely

Zwar Personen nicht mehr, *Persons no more, 'tis true,*

You are so many

Das fühlen, das wissen wir, *We feel it and know it,*

Light-footed does!

Aber zum Hades kehren wir nimmer. *But to Hades return we never!*

For a new game

Ewig lebendige Natur *Nature, the Ever-living,*

Fresh from nearby!

Macht auf uns Geister, *Makes to us spirits*

I am the hunter

Wir auf sie vollgültigen Anspruch. *Validest claim, and we to her also.*

You are the wild game

Ein Teil des Chores

Wir in dieser tausend Äste Flüsterzittern, Säuselschweben *We, in trembling whispers, swaying rustle of a thousand branches*

Would you catch us?

Reizen tändelnd, locken leise wurzelauf des Lebens Quellen *Sweetly rocked, will lightly lure the rills of life, the rootborn, upwards*

Don't be so quick!

Nach den Zweigen; bald mit Blättern, bald mit Blüten überschwenglich *To the twigs; and, or with foliage or exuberant gush of blossoms,*

For we only want

Zieren wir die Flatterhaare frei zu luftigem Gedeihn. *Will we freely deck their flying hair for prosperous airy growth.*

In the end

Fällt die Frucht, sogleich versammeln lebenslustig Volk und Herden *Then, when falls the fruit, will straightway gather gladdened herds and people,*

To embrace you

Sich zum Greifen, sich zum Naschen, eilig kommend, emsig drängend; *Swiftly coming, briskly pressing, for the picking and the tasting:*

Beautiful image - we want to be caught

Und wie vor den ersten Göttern bückt sich alles um uns her. *All, as if before the early Gods, will then around us bend.*

Through the groves!

Ein andrer Teil

Wir, an dieser Felsenwände weithinleuchtend glatten Spiegel *We, beside these rocks, upon the far-off shining, glassy mirror,*

Through brush and stone!

Schmiegen wir, in sanften Wellen uns bewegend, schmeichelnd an; *Coaxingly will bend and fluctuate, moving with the gentle waters;*

What comes easy

Horchen, lauschen jedem Laute, Vogelsängen, Röhrigflöten, *We to every sound will hearken, song of bird or reedy piping;*

Disgusts me

Sei es Pans furchtbarer Stimme, Antwort ist sogleich bereit; *Though the dreadful voice of Pan, a ready answer shall we give:*

Only what's forced

Säuselt's, säuseln wir erwidern, donnert's, rollen unsre Donner *Comes a murmur, we re-murmur, thunder, we our thunders waken*

Truly delights me - I like them reluctant

In erschütterndem Verdoppeln, dreifach, zehnfach hintennach. *In reverberating crashes, doubly, trebly, tenfold flung!*

What willfulness! What frenzy!

Ein dritter Teil

Schwestern! Wir, bewegtern Sinnes, eilen mit den Bächen weiter; *Sisters, we, of nimbler fancy, hasten with the brooklets onward;*

No moderation to hope for

Denn es reizen jener Ferne reichgeschmückte Hügelzüge. *For allure us yonder distant, richly-mantled mountain ranges.*

It sounds like horns blowing

Immer abwärts, immer tiefer wässern wir, mäandrisch wallend, *Ever downwards, ever deeper, in meandering curves we water*

Booming over dale and forest

Jetzt die Wiese, dann die Matten, gleich den Garten um das Haus. *First the meadow, then the pasture; then the garden round the house,*

What disorder! What screaming!

Dort bezeichnen's der Zypressen schlanke Wipfel, über Landschaft, *Marked by slender peaks of cypress, shooting clearly into ether*

He's gone full hunting horn

Uferzug und Wellenspiegel nach dem Äther steigende. *O'er the landscape and the waters and the fading line of shore.*

He ran right past us

Ein vierter Teil

Wallt ihr andern, wo's beliebt; wir umzingeln, wir umrauschen *Fare, ye others, at your pleasure; we will girdle and o'er-rustle*

Scorning us with contempt

Den durchaus bepflanzten Hügel, wo am Stab die Rebe grünt; *The completely-planted hillside, where the sprouting vines are green.*

Now from the whole pack

Dort zu aller Tage Stunden läßt die Leidenschaft des Winzers *There at every hour the passion of the vintager is witnessed,*

He drags the wildest one

Uns des liebevollsten Fleißes zweifelhaft Gelingen sehn. *And the loving diligence, that hath so doubtful a result.*

Typical - wants the difficult one

Bald mit Hacke, bald mit Spaten, bald mit Häufeln, Schneiden, Binden *Now with hoe and now with shovel, then with hilling, pruning, tying,*

Can't resist the challenge

Betet er zu allen Göttern, fördersamst zum Sonnengott. *Unto all the Gods he prayeth, chiefly to the Sun's bright god.*

I drag here this sturdy little one

Bacchus kümmert sich, der Weichling, wenig um den treuen Diener, *Small concern hath pampered Bacchus for his faithful servant's welfare,*

For forced enjoyment!

Ruht in Lauben, lehnt in Höhlen, faselnd mit dem jüngsten Faun. *But in arbors rests, and caverns, toying with the youngest Faun.*

For my bliss, for my pleasure

Was zu seiner Träumereien halbem Rausch er je bedurfte, *For his semi-drunken visions whatsoever he hath needed,*

I press her resisting breast

Immer bleibt es ihm in Schläuchen, ihm in Krügen und Gefäßen, *It is furnished him in wine-skins, and in amphorae and vessels,*

Kiss her unwilling mouth

Rechts und links der kühlen Gräfte, ewige Zeiten aufbewahrt. *Right and left in cool recesses, cellared for eternal time.*

Make known my strength and will - consent is for the weak

Haben aber alle Götter, hat nun Helios vor allen, *But if now the Gods together, Helios before the others,*

Let me go! In this form

Lüftend, feuchtend, wärmend, glutend, Beeren-Füllhorn aufgehäuft, *Have the breeze and dew and warmth and glow the berries filled with juice,*

Is spirit's courage and strength too!

Wo der stille Winzer wirkte, dort auf einmal wird's lebendig, *Where the vintager in silence labored, all is life and motion,*

My will equals yours

Und es rauscht in jedem Laube, raschelt um von Stock zu Stock. *Every trellis stirs and rustles, and they go from stake to stake.*

Not so easily snatched away

Körbe knarren, Eimer klappern, Tragebutten ächzen hin, *Baskets creak and buckets rattle, groaning tubs are borne on back,*

You think you've got me cornered?

Alles nach der großen Kufe zu der Keltreer kräft'gem Tanz; *All towards the vat enormous and the treaders' lusty dance;*

You trust your arm too much

Und so wird die heilige Fülle reingeborner saftiger Beeren *So is then the sacred bounty of the pure-born, juicy berries*

Hold tight, and I'll singe you

Frech zertreten, schäumend, sprühend mischt sich's, widerlich zerquetscht. *Rudely trodden; foaming, spirting, they are mixed and grimly crushed.*

Fool, for my sport!

Und nun gellet ins Ohr der Zimbeln mit der Becken Erzgetöne, *Now the ear is pierced with cymbals and the clash of brazen bosses,*

Warning: flammable content

Denn es hat sich Dionysos aus Mysterien enthüllt; *For, behold, is Dionysos from his mysteries revealed!*

Touch at your own risk

Kommt hervor mit Ziegenfüßlern, schwenkend Ziegenfüßlerinnen, *Forth he comes with goat-foot Satyrs, whirling goat-foot Satyresses,*

I'm hotter than you can handle

Und dazwischen schreit unbändig grell Silenus' öhrig Tier. *While amid the rout Silenus' big-eared beast unruly brays.*

Literally

Nichts geschont! Gespaltne Klauen treten alle Sitte nieder, *Naught is spared! The cloven hoofs tread down all decent custom;*

Follow me to light airs!

Alle Sinne wirbeln taumlich, gräßlich übertäubt das Ohr. *All the senses whirl bewildered, fearfully the ear is stunned.*

Follow me to stiff tombs!

Nach der Schale tappen Trunkne, überfüllt sind Kopf und Wänste, *Drunkards fumble for the goblets, over-full are heads and paunches;*

Snatch at your vanished prize!

Sorglich ist noch ein und andrer, doch vermehrt er die Tumulte, *Here and there hath one misgivings, yet increases thus the tumult;*

Good luck catching smoke

Denn um neuen Most zu bergen, leert man rasch den alten Schlauch! *For, the fresher must to garner, empty they the ancient skin!*

She went ghost, then fire, then gone

(Der Vorhang fällt. Phorkyas im Proszenium richtet sich riesenhaft auf, tritt aber von den Kothurnen herunter, lehnt Maske und Schleier zurück und zeigt sich als Mephistopheles, um, insofern es nötig wäre, im Epilog das Stück zu kommentieren.) (The curtain falls. Phorkyas, in the proscenium, rises to a giant height, steps down from the cothurni, removes her mask and veil, and reveals herself as Mephistopheles, in order, so far as it may be necessary, to comment upon the piece by way of Epilogue.)

Vierter Akt / Act IV

Hochgebirg / High Mountains

Act IV, Scene 1

Starke, zackige Felsengipfel. Eine Wolke zieht heran, lehnt sich an, senkt sich auf eine vorragende Platte herab. Sie teilt sich.

Strong, serrated rocky peaks. A cloud approaches, pauses, and settles down upon a projecting ledge. It then divides.

Faust *(tritt hervor)* **Faust** *(steps forth)*

Der Einsamkeiten tiefste schauend unter meinem Fuss, *Down-gazing on the deepest solitudes below,*

Gazing down on the deepest solitudes beneath my feet

Betret' ich wohlbedachtig dieser Gipfel Saum, *I tread deliberately this summit's lonely edge,*

Standing on top of the world, looking at nobody-gives-a-shit valley

Entlassend meiner Wolke Tragewerk, die mich sanft *Relinquishing my cloudy car, which hither bore*

I deliberately tread this summit's edge

An klaren Tagen uber Land und Meer gefuhrt. *Me softly through the shining day o'er land and sea,*

Each step calculated, body poised on the precipice

Sie lost sich langsam, nicht zerstiebend, von mir ab. *Unscattered, slowly moved, it separates from me.*

Releasing my cloudy vehicle that gently

Nach Osten strebt die Masse mit geballtem Zug, *Off eastward strives the mass with rounded, rolling march:*

Uber, but make it cumulus

Ihr strebt das Auge staunend in Bewundrung nach. *And strives the eye, amazed, admiring, after it.*

Carried me through clear days over land and sea

Sie teilt sich wandelnd, wogenhaft, veränderlich. *In motion it divides, in wave-like, changeful guise;*

First-class cloud travel, no turbulence, no crying babies

Doch will sich's modeln. – Ja! das Auge trugt mich nicht! – *Yet seems to shape a figure. – Yes! mine eyes not err! –*

It separates slowly from me, not scattering

Auf sonnbeglanzten Pfulen herrlich hingestreckt, *On sun-illuminated pillows beautifully reclined,*

The cloud peels off like a lover leaving the bed at dawn

Zwar riesenhaft, ein gottergleiches Fraungebild, *Colossal, truly, but a godlike woman-form,*

Eastward the mass strives with gathered force

Ich seh's! Junonen ähnlich, Leda'n, Helenen, *I see! The like of Juno, Leda, Helena,*

It's heading to where it belongs - away from me

Wie majestätisch lieblich mir's im Auge schwankt. *Majestically lovely, floats before my sight!*

My amazed eye follows it in admiration

Ach! schon verrückt sich's! Formlos breit und aufgeturmt *Ah, now 'tis broken! Towering broad and formlessly,*

Can't stop staring at this atmospheric ass as it walks away

Ruht es in Osten, fernen Eisgebirgen gleich, *It rests along the east like distant icy hills,*

It divides, transforming, wave-like, changeable

Und spiegelt blendend flucht'ger Tage grossen Sinn. *And shapes the grand significance of fleeting days.*

Shapeshifting like my commitment issues

Doch mir umschwebt ein zarter lichter Nebelstreif *Yet still there clings a light and delicate band of mist*

Yet it wants to shape itself - Yes! My eyes don't deceive!

Noch Brust und Stirn, erheiternd, kuhl und schmeichelhaft. *Around my breast and brow, caressing, cheering me.*

Wait, is that cloud doing what I think it's doing?

Nun steigt es leicht und zaudernd hoch und höher auf, *Now light, delayingly, it soars and higher soars,*

On sun-illuminated cushions magnificently stretched out

Fugt sich zusammen. – Tauscht mich ein entzuckend Bild, *And folds together. – Cheats me an ecstatic form,*

Lounging on golden pillows like she owns the sky

Als jugenderstes, langstentbehrtes höchstes Gut? *As early-youthful, long-foregone and highest bliss?*

Colossal, truly, a goddess-like woman's form

Des tiefsten Herzens fruhste Schatze quellen auf: *The first glad treasures of my deepest heart break forth:*

She's enormous and divine and I'm losing my mind

Aurorens Liebe, leichten Schwung bezeichnet's mir, *Aurora's love, so light of pinion, is its type,*

I see it! Like Juno, Leda, Helena

Den schnellempfundnen, ersten, kaum verstandnen Blick, *The swiftly-felt, the first, scarce-comprehended glance,*

Three hot immortals morphing into my dead wife

Der, festgehalten, uberglante jeden Schatz. *Outshining every treasure, when retained and held.*

How majestically lovely it floats before my sight!

Wie Seelenschonheit steigert sich die holde Form, *Like Spiritual Beauty mounts the gracious Form,*

The ultimate thirst trap, floating in the troposphere

Lost sich nicht auf, erhebt sich in den Ather hin *Dissolving not, but lifts itself through ether far,*

Ah, already it shifts! Formless, broad, and towering

Und zieht das Beste meines Innern mit sich fort. *And from my inner being bears the best away.*

And there it goes, dissolving like all beautiful things

Ein Siebenmeilenstiefel tappt auf. Ein anderer folgt alsobald. Mephistopheles steigt ab. Die Stiefel schreiten eilig weiter.

A Seven-league Boot trips forward: another immediately follows. Mephistopheles steps out of them. The Boots stride onward in haste.

Mephistopheles

Das heiss' ich doch endlich vorgeschritten! *I call that genuine forward-striding!*

It rests in the east, like distant icy mountains

Nun aber sag, was fallst du ein? *But what thou mean'st, I'd have thee own,*

Helena's ghost is now just another glacier

Steigst ab in solcher Greuel Mitten, *That in such horrors art abiding,*

And mirrors the grand meaning of fleeting days

Im grasslich gahnenden Gestein? *Amid these yawning jags of stone?*

Temporary beauty, permanent longing - that's the whole show

Ich kenn' es wohl, doch nicht an dieser Stelle, *It was not here I learned to know them well;*

Yet a tender, delicate strip of mist

Denn eigentlich war das der Grund der Holle. *Such was, indeed, the bottom-ground of Hell.*

Something still clings to me, wispy and intimate

Faust

Es fehlt dir nie an narrischen Legenden; *In foolish legends thou art never lacking;*

Still embraces my breast and brow, cheering, cool, caressing

Fangst wieder an, dergleichen auszuspenden. *Again thy store thou set'st about unpacking.*

It touches me where I need touching most

Mephistopheles (*ernsthaft*) **Mephistopheles** (*seriously*)

Als Gott der Herr – ich weiss auch wohl, warum – *When God the Lord – wherefore, I also know –*

Now it rises light and hesitant, higher and higher

Uns aus der Luft in tiefste Tiefen bannte, *Banned us from air to darkness deep and central,*

The mist is taking its sweet time leaving

Da, wo zentralisch gluhend, um und um, *Where round and round, in fierce, intensest glow,*

It gathers together - does an enchanting image deceive me

Ein ewig Feuer flammend sich durchbrannte, *Eternal fires were whirled in Earth's hot entrail,*

This can't be what I think it is

Wir fanden uns bei allzugrosser Hellung *We found ourselves too much illuminated,*

As the earliest-youthful, long-foregone, highest good?

In sehr gedrangter, unbequemer Stellung. *Yet crowded and uneasily situated.*

It looks like the first girl I ever loved before I knew what love cost

Die Teufel fingen sämtlich an zu husten, *The Devils all set up a coughing, sneezing,*

The deepest heart's earliest treasures well up

Von oben und von unten auszupusten; *At every vent without cessation wheezing:*

Here come the feelings I buried decades ago

Die Holle schwoll von Schwefelstank und -saure, *With sulphur-stench and acids Hell dilated,*

Aurora's love, light-winged, it signifies to me

Das gab ein Gas! Das ging ins Ungeheure, *And such enormous gas was thence created,*

Gretchen! It's Gretchen! My first love, my first corpse

So dass gar bald der Lander flache Kruste, *That very soon Earth's level, far extended,*

The swiftly-felt, first, scarcely-understood glance

So dick sie war, zerkrachend bersten musste. *Thick as it was, was heaved, and split, and rended!*

That moment when eyes lock and the world stops

Nun haben wir's an einem andern Zipfel, *The thing is plain, no theories o'ercome it:*

Which, held fast, outshone every treasure

Was ehemals Grund war, ist nun Gipfel. *What formerly was bottom, now is summit.*

Nothing I've gained since equals what I lost

Sie gründen auch hierauf die rechten Lehren, *Hereon they base the law there's no disputing,*

Like soul-beauty the gracious form ascends

Das Unterste ins Oberste zu kehren. *To give the undermost the topmost footing:*

It rises like innocence does - straight up and away from me

Denn wir entrannen knechtisch-heisser Gruft *For we escaped from fiery dungeons there*

Doesn't dissolve, but lifts into the ether

Ins Übermass der Herrschaft freier Luft. *To overplus of lordship of the air; -*

It leaves without leaving, haunts without staying

Ein offenbar Geheimnis, wohl verwahrt, *A mystery manifest and well concealed,*

And draws the best of my inner being with it

Und wird nur spät den Volkern offenbart. *And to the people only late revealed.*

There goes my soul, hitchhiking on a cloud

Faust

Gebirgesmasse bleibt mir edel-stumm, *To me are mountain-masses grandly dumb:*

That's what I call making progress!

Ich frage nicht woher und nicht warum. *I ask not, Whence? and ask not, Why they come?*

Now THAT's how you travel - boots that do the walking for you

Als die Natur sich in sich selbst gegründet, *When Nature in herself her being founded,*

But now tell me, what are you thinking?

Da hat sie rein den Erdball abgerundet, *Complete and perfect then the globe she rounded,*

Okay Faust, what's your damage this time?

Der Gipfel sich, der Schluchten sich erfreut *Glad of the summits and the gorges deep,*

You descend into the midst of such horrors

Und Fels an Fels und Berg an Berg gereiht, *Set rock to rock, and mountain steep to steep,*

Why are you standing around in this vertical hellscape?

Die Hügel dann bequem hinabgebildet, *The hills with easy outlines downward moulded,*

On this hideously yawning rocky terrain?

Mit sanftem Zug sie in das Tal gemildet. *Till gently from their feet the vales unfolded!*

These rocks look like they're about to scream

Da grunt's und wachst's, und um sich zu erfreuen, *They green and grow; with joy therein she ranges,*

I know this place well, but not this spot

Bedarf sie nicht der tollen Strudeleien. *Requiring no insane, convulsive changes.*

I've seen these rocks before, but from underneath

Mephistopheles

Das spricht Ihr so! Das scheint Euch sonnenklar; *Yes, so you talk! You think it clear as sun;*

For actually this was the floor of Hell

Doch weiss es anders, der zugegen war. *But he knows otherwise, who saw it done.*

Home sweet home, except upside down now

Ich war dabei, als noch da drunten siedend *For I was there, while still below was surging*

You never lack for foolish legends

Der Abgrund schwoll und stromend Flammen trug; *The red abyss, and streamed the flaming tide, –*

Here we go with your bullshit origin stories

Als Molochs Hammer, Fels an Felsen schmiedend, *When Moloch's hammer, welding rocks and forging,*

You're starting again to dispense such tales

Gebirgestrummer in die Ferne schlug. *Scattered the mountain-ruins far and wide.*

Please, Mephisto, spare me the geological fanfiction

Noch starrt das Land von fremden Zentnermassen; *O'er all the land the foreign blocks you spy there;*

When God the Lord - and I know well why -

Wer gibt Erklärung solcher Schleudermacht? *Who solves the force that hurled them to their place?*

When the Big Man Upstairs - trust me, I know the reason -

Der Philosoph, er weiss es nicht zu fassen, *The lore of learned men is all awry there;*

Banished us from air into the deepest depths

Da liegt der Fels, man muss ihn liegen lassen, *There lies the rock, and we must let it lie there;*

Kicked us out of the sky into Earth's bowels

Zuschanden haben wir uns schon gedacht. – *We've thought already – to our own disgrace.*

Where, glowing centrally, round and round

Das treu-gemeine Volk allein begreift *Only the common, faithful people know,*

Down where everything burns from the inside out

Und lasst sich im Begriff nicht storen; *And nothing shakes them in their firm believing;*

An eternal fire flaming, burning through itself

Ihm ist die Weisheit längst gereift: *Their wisdom ripened long ago, –*

A furnace with no off switch, no exit signs

Ein Wunder ist's, der Satan kommt zu Ehren. *A marvel 'tis, of Satan's own achieving.*

We found ourselves, with too much illumination

Mein Wandrer hinkt an seiner Glaubenskruke *On crutch of faith my traveller climbs the ridges,*

Way too much light for creatures of darkness

Zum Teufelsstein, zur Teufelsbrücke. *Past Devil's Rocks and over Devil's Bridges.*

In a very cramped, uncomfortable position

Faust

Es ist doch auch bemerkenswert zu achten, *Well, – 'tis remarkable and new*

Imagine a mosh pit, but everyone's on fire

Zu sehn, wie Teufel die Natur betrachten. *To note how Devils Nature view.*

The devils all began to cough

Mephistopheles

Was geht mich's an! Natur sei, wie sie sei! *What's all to me? Her shape let Nature wear!*

Devils started hacking like chain-smokers

's ist Ehrenpunkt: der Teufel war dabei! *The point of honour is, the Devil was there!*

Puffing from above and below

Wir sind die Leute, Grosses zu erreichen; *We are the folk to compass grand designs:*

Every orifice ejecting volcanic fumes

Tumult, Gewalt und Unsinn! sieh das Zeichen! – *Tumult, and Force, and Nonsense! See the signs!*

–

Hell swelled with sulfur stench and acid

Doch, dass ich endlich ganz verständlich spreche, *Yet now, with sober reason to address thee,*

The whole place smelled like a billion rotten eggs

Gefiel dir nichts an unsrer Oberfläche? *Did nothing on our outside shell impress thee?*

That produced gas! It went to monstrous proportions

Du ubersahst, in ungemessnen Weiten, *From this exceeding height thou saw'st unfurled*

The gas buildup was un-fucking-believable

Die Reiche der Welt und ihre Herrlichkeiten. *The glory of the Kingdoms of the World.*

So that soon the flat crust of the lands

Doch, ungenugsam, wie du bist, *Yet, as thou art, unsatisfied,*

Earth's crust couldn't take the pressure

Empfandest du wohl kein Gelust? *Didst feel no lust of power and pride?*

Thick as it was, had to burst, cracking

Faust

Und doch! ein Grosses zog mich an. *I did! A mighty plan my fancy won:*

The whole planet basically sharted itself inside-out

Errate! – *Canst guess it?*

Now we have it by a different corner

Mephistopheles

Das ist bald getan. *That is quickly done.*

Everything got rearranged

Ich suchte mir so eine Hauptstadt aus, *I'd take some town, – a capital, perchance, –*

What was once bottom is now summit

Im Kerne Burger-Nahrungs-Graus, *Its core, the people's need of sustenance;*

Hell's floor is now this mountain peak - you're standing on Satan's basement ceiling

Krummenge Gasschen, spitze Giebeln, *With crooked alleys, pointed gables,*

They also base the right teachings on this

Beschränkten Markt, Kohl, Ruben, Zwiebeln; *Beets, cabbage, onions, on the market-tables;*

And that's where the phrase comes from

Fleischbanke, wo die Schmeissen hausen, *With meat-stands, where the blue flies muster,*

To turn the lowest into the highest

Die fetten Braten anzuschmausen; *And round fat joints like gourmands cluster:*

“Turn everything upside down” - that's literally our origin story

Da findest du zu jeder Zeit *There shalt thou find, undoubtedly,*

For we escaped from slavish-hot crypts

Gewiss Gestank und Tätigkeit. *Stench, always, and activity.*

We busted out of the fiery prison

Dann weite Platze, breite Strassen, *Then ample squares, and streets whose measure*

Into the excess of lordship of free air

Vornehmen Schein sich anzumassen; *Assumes an air of lordly leisure;*

Traded eternal flames for unlimited sky - not a bad deal

Und endlich, wo kein Tor beschränkt, *And last, without a gate to bar,*

An open secret, well-guarded

Vorstadte grenzenlos verlangt. *The boundless suburbs stretching far.*

Everybody knows but nobody believes

Da freut' ich mich an Rollekutschen, *'Twere joy to see the coaches go,*

And only late revealed to the people

Am larmigen Hin- und Widerrutschen, *The noisy crowding to and fro,*

Humanity will figure it out eventually, the slow learners

Am ewigen Hin- und Widerlaufen *The endless running, hither, thither,*

Mountain masses remain nobly mute to me

Zerstreuter Ameis-Wimmelhaufen. *Of scattered ants that stream together:*

Mountains don't talk and I like it that way

Und wenn ich fuhre, wenn ich ritte, *And whether walking, driving, riding,*

I don't ask whence or why

Erschien' ich immer ihre Mitte, *Over their central point abiding,*

I don't give a damn about geological backstory

Von Hunderttausenden verehrt. *Honoured by thousands, should be I.*

When Nature founded herself within herself

Faust

Das kann mich nicht zufriedenstellen. *Therewith I would not be contented!*

When Nature was doing her thing, auto-creating

Man freut sich, dass das Volk sich mehrt, *One likes to see the people multiply,*

She purely rounded the Earth-ball

Nach seiner Art behaglich nährt, *And in their wise with comfort fed, –*

She made a nice sphere, no Hell required

Sogar sich bildet, sich belehrt – *Developed even, taught, well-bred,*

Delighting in peaks, delighting in gorges

Und man erzieht sich nur Rebellen. *Yet one has only, when all's said, the sum of rebels thus augmented.*

She was pleased with her mountains and valleys

Mephistopheles

Dann baut' ich, grandios, mir selbst bewusst, *Then I should build, with conscious power and grace,*

Lining rock to rock and mountain to mountain

Am lustigen Ort ein Schloss zur Lust. *A pleasure-castle in a pleasant place;*

She stacked stones like a child with blocks

Wald, Hugel, Flachen, Wiesen, Feld *Where hill and forest, level, meadow, field,*

Then shaped the hills comfortably downward

Zum Garten prachtig umbestellt. *Grandly transformed, should park and garden yield.*

The landscape flows down easy and natural

Vor grünen Wänden Sammetmatten, *Before green walls of foliage velvet meadows,*

With gentle slopes softening into the valley

Schnurwege, kunstgerechte Schatten, *With ordered paths and artful-falling shadows;*

Everything curves and connects, no explosions needed

Kaskadensturz, durch Fels zu Fels gepaart, *Plunge of cascades o'er rocks with skill combined,*

There it greens and grows, and to enjoy itself

Und Wasserstrahlen aller Art; *And fountain-jets of every form and kind.*

Plants grow because they want to, not because Hell farted

Ehrwürdig steigt es dort, doch an den Seiten *There grandly shooting upwards from the middle,*

It doesn't need your crazy whirlpools

Da zischt's und pisst's in tausend Kleinigkeiten. *While round the sides a thousand spirt and piddle.*

Nature doesn't need your demonic flatulence to be beautiful

Dann aber liess ich allerschönsten Frauen *Then for the fairest women, fresh and rosy,*

That's what you say! Seems clear as sunlight to you

Vertraut-bequeme Hauslein bauen; *I'd build a lodge, convenient and cosy;*

Sure, easy for you to say

Verbrachte da grenzenlose Zeit *And so the bright and boundless time I should*

But he knows differently who was present

In allerliebster-geselliger Einsamkeit. *Pass in the loveliest social solitude.*

I was there, buddy. I SAW it happen

Ich sage Frauen; denn ein für allemal *Women, I say; and, once for all, believe*

I was there when down below, still seething

Denk' ich die Schönen im Plural. *That in the plural I the sex conceive!*

I was in the front row when the abyss was boiling

Faust

Schlecht und modern! Sardanapal! *Sardanapalus! Modern, – poor!*

The abyss swelled and carried streaming flames

Mephistopheles

Errat man wohl, wornach du strebst? *Then might one guess whereunto thou hast striven?*

Fire flowing like rivers, everything churning

Es war gewiss erhaben kuhn. *Boldly-sublime it was, I'm sure.*

When Moloch's hammer, forging rock to rock

Der du dem Mond um so viel naher schwebtest, *Since nearer to the moon thy flight was driven,*

Moloch's massive hammer pounding boulders like dough

Dich zog wohl deine Sucht dahin? *Would now thy mania that realm secure?*

Hurled mountain fragments into the distance

Faust

Mit nichten! dieser Erdenkreis *Not so! This sphere of earthly soil*

Chucking continents like a drunk giant throws furniture

Gewahrt noch Raum zu grossen Taten. *Still gives us room for lofty doing.*

The land still bristles with foreign centner-masses

Erstaunenswürdiges soll geraten, *Astounding plans e'en now are brewing:*

Erratic boulders everywhere - explain THOSE, science boy

Ich fühle Kraft zu kühnem Fleiss. *I feel new strength for bolder toil.*

Who explains such hurling power?

Mephistopheles

Und also willst du Ruhm verdienen? *So, thou wilt Glory earn? 'Tis plain to see*

What force chucks a boulder a thousand miles?

Man merkt's, du kommst von Heroinen. *That heroines have been thy company.*

The philosopher can't grasp it

Faust

Herrschaft gewinn ich, Eigentum! *Power and Estate to win, inspires my thought!*

Scientists scratch their heads

Die Tat ist alles, nichts der Ruhm. *The Deed is everything, the Glory naught.*

There lies the rock, we must let it lie

Mephistopheles

Doch werden sich Poeten finden, *Yet Poets shall proclaim the matter,*

The rock just sits there, judging your theories

Der Nachwelt deinen Glanz zu kunden, *Thy fame to future ages flatter,*

We've already thought ourselves to shame

Durch Torheit Torheit zu entzunden. *By folly further folly scatter!*

Overthinking gets you nowhere

Faust

Von allem ist dir nichts gewahrt. *All that is far beyond thy reach.*

Only the faithful common folk understand

Was weisst du, was der Mensch begehrt? *How canst thou know what men beseech?*

Regular people with their simple faith get it

Dein widrig Wesen, bitter, scharf, *Thy cross-grained self, in malice banned,*

And don't let themselves be disturbed in their understanding

Was weiss es, was der Mensch bedarf? *How can it know what men demand?*

They don't need peer review, just belief

Mephistopheles

Geschehe denn nach deinem Willen! *According to thy will so let it be!*

Their wisdom has long been ripe

Vertraue mir den Umfang deiner Grillen. *Confide the compass of thy whims to me!*

Common sense figured it out ages ago

Faust

Mein Auge war aufs hohe Meer gezogen; *Mine eye was drawn to view the open Ocean:*

It's a miracle - Satan gets the credit

Es schwoll empor, sich in sich selbst zu turmen, *It swelled aloft, self-heaved and over-vaulting,*

"The Devil did it" - explains everything, zero footnotes required

Dann liess es nach und schüttete die Wogen, *And then withdrew, and shook its waves in motion,*

My wanderer limps on his faith-crutch

Des flachen Ufers Breite zu bestürmen. *Again the breadth of level strand assaulting.*

Pilgrims hobble along on their faith-crutches

Und das verdross mich; wie der Übermut *Then I was vexed, since arrogance can spite*

To Devil's Rock, to Devil's Bridge

Den freien Geist, der alle Rechte schätzt, *The spirit free, which values every right,*

Devil's this, Devil's that - I'm everywhere in their geography

Durch leidenschaftlich aufgeregtes Blut *And through excited passion of the blood*

It's actually remarkable to note

Ins Missbehagen des Gefühls versetzt. *Discomfort it, as did the haughty flood.*

You know what's actually interesting

Ich hielt's für Zufall, scharfte meinen Blick: *I thought it chance, my vision did I strain;*

How devils view nature

Die Woge stand und rollte dann zurück, *The billow paused, then thundered back again,*

Seeing the world through demon-tinted glasses

Entfernte sich vom stolz erreichten Ziel; *Retiring from the goal so proudly won:*

What do I care! Let Nature be what she will!

Die Stunde kommt, sie wiederholt das Spiel. *The hour returns, the sports once more begun.*

Whatever! Nature, schmature!

Mephistopheles (*ad spectatores*)

Da ist für mich nichts Neues zu erfahren, *'Tis nothing new whatever that one hears;*

It's a point of honor: the Devil was there!

Das kenn' ich schon seit hunderttausend Jahren. *I've known it many a hundred thousand years.*

The important thing is: I WAS THERE

Faust (*fortfahrend leidenschaftlich*) **Faust** (*continuing impassionedly*)

Sie schleicht heran, an abertausend Enden, *The Sea sweeps on, in thousand quarters flowing,*

We are the ones to accomplish great things

Unfruchtbar selbst, Unfruchtbarkeit zu spenden; *Itself unfruitful, barrenness bestowing;*

We're the big achievers

Nun schwillt's und wächst und rollt und überzieht *It breaks and swells, and rolls, and overwhelms*

Tumult, violence, and nonsense! See the signs!

Der wüsten Strecke widerlich Gebiet. *The desert stretch of desolated realms.*

Chaos! Destruction! Absurdity! That's our brand

Da herrschet Well' auf Welle kraftbegeistert, *There endless waves hold sway, in strength erected*

But, to finally speak quite understandably

Zieht sich zurück, und es ist nichts geleistet, *And then withdrawn, – and nothing is effected.*

Okay, let me get practical

Was zur Verzweiflung mich beangstigen konnte! *If aught could drive me to despair, 'twere, truly*

Did nothing on our surface please you?

Zwecklose Kraft unbandiger Elemente! *The aimless force of elements unruly.*

Didn't you see anything you liked up there?

Da wagt mein Geist, sich selbst zu überfliegen; *Then dared my mind its dreams to over-soar:*

You surveyed, in immeasurable expanses

Hier mocht' ich kämpfen, dies mocht' ich besiegen. *Here would I fight, – subdue this fierce uproar!*

You had the whole panoramic view

Und es ist möglich! – Flutend wie sie sei, *And possible 'tis! – Howe'er the tides may fill,*

The kingdoms of the world and their glories

An jedem Hügel schmiegt sie sich vorbei; *They gently fawn around the steadfast hill;*

All the world's real estate, spread out like a buffet

Sie mag sich noch so übermütig regen, *A moderate height resists and drives asunder,*

Yet, insatiable as you are

Geringe Höhe ragt ihr stolz entgegen, *A moderate depth allures and leads them on.*

But you're never satisfied

Geringe Tiefe zieht sie mächtig an. *So, swiftly, plans within my mind were drawn:*

Did you feel no desire?

Da fasst' ich schnell im Geiste Plan auf Plan: *Let that high joy be mine for evermore,*

Nothing made your little black heart flutter?

Erlange dir das kostliche Geniessen, *To shut the lordly Ocean from the shore,*

And yet! Something great attracted me

Das herrische Meer vom Ufer auszuschliessen, *The watery waste to limit and to bar,*

Actually, yeah - something did catch my eye

Der feuchten Breite Grenzen zu verengen *And push it back upon itself afar!*

Guess!

Und, weit hinein, sie in sich selbst zu drängen. *From step to step I settled how to fight it:*

Guess what it was

Von Schritt zu Schritt wusst' ich mir's zu erörtern; *Such is my wish: dare thou to expedite it!*

That's easily done

Das ist mein Wunsch, den wage zu befördern! *Such is my wish: dare thou to expedite it!*

Oh, this'll be easy

Trommeln und kriegerische Musik im Rücken der Zuschauer, aus der Ferne, von der rechten Seite her.

Drums and martial music in the rear of the spectators, from the distance, on the right hand.

Mephistopheles

Wie leicht ist das! Horst du die Trommeln fern? *How easy, that! – Hear'st thou the drums afar?*

I'd choose myself a capital city

Faust

Schon wieder Krieg! der Kluge hort's nicht gern. *Who's wise likes not to hear of coming war.*

Let me guess - a big fancy city

Mephistopheles

Krieg oder Frieden. Klug ist das Bemühen, *In War or Peace, 'tis wise to use the chance,*

At its core, citizens' nourishment-horror

Zu seinem Vorteil etwas auszusziehen. *And draw some profit from each circumstance.*

The stinking heart of urban chaos

Man passt, man merkt auf jedes günstige Nu. *One watches, marks the moment, and is bold:*

Crooked little streets, pointed gables

Gelegenheit ist da, nun, Fauste, greife zu! *Here's opportunity! – now, Faust, take hold!*

Narrow alleys, ugly rooftops

Faust

Mit solchem Ratselkram verschone mich! *Spare me the squandering of thy riddle-pelf!*

Limited market, cabbage, turnips, onions

Und kurz und gut, was soll's? Erkläre dich. *What means it, once for all? Explain thyself!*

A sad little market selling vegetables and despair

Mephistopheles

Auf meinem Zuge blieb mir nicht verborgen: *Upon my way, to me it was discovered*

Meat stalls where the flies swarm

Der gute Kaiser schwebt in grossen Sorgen. *That mighty troubles o'er the Emperor hovered:*

Butcher shops buzzing with bluebottles

Du kennst ihn ja. Als wir ihn unterhielten, *Thou knowest him. The while we twain, beside him,*

To feast on the fat roasts

Ihm falschen Reichtum in die Hände spielten, *With wealth illusive bounteously supplied him,*

Flies making love to pork chops

Da war die ganze Welt ihm feil. *Then all the world was to be had for pay;*

There you find at any time

Denn jung ward ihm der Thron zuteil, *For as a youth he held imperial sway,*

And there, guaranteed

Und ihm beliebt' es, falsch zu schliessen, *And he was pleased to try it, whether*

Certainly stink and activity

Es konne wohl zusammengehn *Both interests would not smoothly pair,*

Stench and hustle - the two constants of city life

Und sei recht wunschenswert und schon: *Since 'twere desirable and fair*

Then wide squares, broad streets

Regieren und zugleich geniessen. *To govern and enjoy, together.*

Then the fancy district with its boulevards

Faust

Ein grosser Irrtum. Wer befehlen soll, *A mighty error! He who would command*

To assume an air of nobility

Muss im Befehlen Seligkeit empfinden. *Must in commanding find his highest blessing:*

Where people pretend to be important

Ihm ist die Brust von hohem Willen voll, *Then, let his breast with force of will expand,*

And finally, where no gate limits

Doch was er will, es darf's kein Mensch ergrunden. *But what he wills, be past another's guessing!*

And beyond the walls

Was er den Treusten in das Ohr geraunt, *What to his faithful he hath whispered, that*

Suburbs stretch boundlessly

Es ist getan, und alle Welt erstaunt. *Is turned to act, and men amaze thereat:*

Endless sprawl of strip malls and tract housing

So wird er stets der Allerhochste sein, *Thus will he ever be the highest-placed*

There I'd enjoy the rolling coaches

Der Wurdigste –; Geniessen macht gemein. *And worthiest! – Enjoyment makes debased.*

I'd watch the fancy carriages

Mephistopheles

So ist er nicht. Er selbst genoss, und wie! *Such is he not! He did enjoy, even he!*

The noisy sliding back and forth

Indes zerfiel das Reich in Anarchie, *Meanwhile the realm was torn by anarchy,*

Traffic jams are eternal

Wo gross und klein sich kreuz und quer befehdeten *Where great and small were warring with each other,*

The eternal running back and forth

Und Bruder sich vertrieben, toteten, *And brother drove and slaughtered brother,*

People scurrying like ants

Burg gegen Burg, Stadt gegen Stadt, *Castle to castle, town 'gainst town arrayed,*

Of scattered ant-swarm heaps

Zunft gegen Adel Fehde hat, *The nobles and the guilds of trade,*

Everyone going nowhere, urgently

Der Bischof mit Kapitel und Gemeinde; *The Bishop, with his chapter and congregation, –*

And whether I drove or rode

Was sich nur ansah, waren Feinde. *All meeting eyes but looked retaliation.*

Whether I'm in a limo or on horseback

In Kirchen Mord und Totschlag, vor den Toren *In churches death and murder; past the gates,*

I'd always appear at their center

Ist jeder Kauf- und Wandersmann verloren. *The merchants travelled under evil fates;*

I'd be the center of attention

Und allen wuchs die Kuhnheit nicht gering; *And all grew bolder, since no rule was drawn*

Revered by hundreds of thousands

Denn leben hiess sich wehren. – Nun, das ging. *For life, but: Self-defence! – So things went on.*

Worshipped by the masses - what a power trip

Faust

Es ging – es hinkte, fiel, stand wieder auf, *They went, they limped, they fell, arose again,*

That cannot satisfy me

Dann überschlug sich's, rollte plump zuhauf. *Then tumbled headlong, and in heaps remain.*

Hard pass

Mephistopheles

Und solchen Zustand durfte niemand schelten, *Such a condition no man dared abuse.*

One's glad that the people multiply

Ein jeder konnte, jeder wollte gelten. *Each would be something, each set forth his dues;*

Sure, it's nice that the population grows

Der Kleinste selbst, er galt für voll. *The smallest even as full-measured passed:*

Feed themselves comfortably in their way

Doch war's zuletzt den Besten allzutoll. *Yet for the best it grew too bad at last.*

They eat well enough

Die Tüchtigen, sie standen auf mit Kraft *The capable, they then arose with energy,*

Even educate and instruct themselves

Und sagten: Herr ist, der uns Ruhe schafft. *And said: "Who gives us Peace, shall ruler be.*

They even learn stuff and improve themselves

Der Kaiser kann's nicht, will's nicht – lässt uns wählen, *The Emperor can and will not! – Be elected*

And one only breeds rebels

Den neuen Kaiser neu das Reich beseelen, *An Emperor new, anew the realm directed,*

But all you end up with is a bunch of people who disagree with you

Indem er jeden sicher stellt, *Each one secure and sheltered stand,*

Then I'd build, grandly, self-aware

In einer frisch geschaffnen Welt *And in a fresh-constructed land*

Okay, Plan B - I'd build myself a palace

Fried' und Gerechtigkeit vermahlen. *Justice and Peace be mated and perfected!"*

In a pleasant place, a pleasure-castle

Faust

Das klingt sehr pfaffisch. – *Priest-like, that sounds.*

A party mansion in the nicest spot I could find

Mephistopheles

Pfaffen waren's auch, *Priests were they, to be sure;*

Forest, hills, plains, meadows, fields

Sie sicherten den wohlgenährten Bauch. *They meant their well-fed bellies to secure;*

All that nature stuff

Sie waren mehr als andere beteiligt. *They, more than all, therein were implicated.*

Magnificently transformed into a garden

Der Aufruhr schwoll, der Aufruhr ward geheiligt; *The riot rose, the riot was consecrated.*

All landscaped to perfection

Und unser Kaiser, den wir froh gemacht, *And now our Emperor, whom we gave delight,*

Before green walls, velvet meadows

Zieht sich hieher, vielleicht zur letzten Schlacht. *Comes hitherward, perchance for one last fight.*

Emerald hedges, grass like carpet

Faust

Er jammert mich; er war so gut und offen. *I pity him; he was so frank, forgiving.*

Straight paths, artfully-placed shadows

Mephistopheles

Komm, sehn wir zu! der Lebende soll hoffen. *Come, we'll look on! There's hope while one is living!*

Everything geometric and Instagram-ready

Befrein wir ihn aus diesem engen Tale! *Let us release him from this narrow valley;*

Cascading waterfalls, paired rock to rock

Einmal gerettet, ist's fur tausend Male. *He's saved a thousand times, if once he rally.*

Designer waterfalls

Wer weiss, wie noch die Wurfel fallen? *Who knows how yet the dice may fall?*

And water jets of every kind

Und hat er Gluck, so hat er auch Vasallen. *If he has fortune, vassals come withal.*

Fountains everywhere

Sie steigen uber das Mittelgebirg heruber und beschauen die Anordnung des Heeres im Tal. Trommeln und Kriegsmusik schallt von unten auf.

They cross over the middle range of mountains, and view the arrangement of the army in the valley. Drums and military music resound from below.

Mephistopheles

Die Stellung, seh' ich, gut ist eingenommen, *A good position is, I see, secured them:*

Majestically rising there, yet at the sides

Wir treten zu, dann ist der Sieg vollkommen. *We'll join, then victory will be assured them.*

The main fountain shoots up impressively

Faust

Was kann da zu erwarten sein? *What further, I should like to know?*

It hisses and pisses in a thousand little ways

Trug! Zauberblendwerk! Hohler Schein. *Cheat! Blind delusion! Hollow show!*

While the little ones spurt and dribble in all directions

Mephistopheles

Kriegslist, um Schlachten zu gewinnen! *No, – stratagems, for battle-winning!*

Then I'd have the most beautiful women

Befestige dich bei grossen Sinnen, *Be steadfast for the grand beginning,*

And for the ladies

Indem du deinen Zweck bedenkst. *And think upon thy lofty aim!*

Cozy, intimate little houses built

Erhalten wir dem Kaiser Thron und Lande, *If we secure the realm its rightful claimant,*

Little love-shacks, private and convenient

So kniest du nieder und empfängst *Then shalt thou boldly kneel, and claim*

Pass boundless time there

Die Lehn von grenzenlosem Strande. *The boundless strand in feoff, as payment.*

Spend forever there

Faust

Schon manches hast du durchgemacht, *In many arts didst thou excel:*

In the loveliest sociable solitude

Nun, so gewinn auch eine Schlacht! *Come, win a battle now, as well!*

Alone, but with excellent company

Mephistopheles

Nein, du gewinnst sie! Diesesmal *No, thou shalt win it! Here, in brief,*

I say women - for once and for all

Bist du der Obergeneral. *Shalt thou be General-in-chief.*

I said women, plural

Faust

Das ware mir die rechte Hohe, *A high distinction thou wouldst lend, –*

I think of beauties in the plural

Da zu befehlen, wo ich nichts verstehe! *There to command, where naught I comprehend!*

Why have one when you can have many?

Mephistopheles

Lass du den Generalstab sorgen, *Leave to the Staff the work and blame,*

Bad and modern! Sardanapalus!

Und der Feldmarschall ist geborgen. *Then the Field-Marshal's sure of fame!*

Tacky! Basic! Like some ancient playboy!

Kriegsunrat hab' ich langst verspurt, *Of War-Uncouncils I have had enough,*

Can one guess what you were striving for?

Den Kriegsrat gleich voraus formiert *And my War-Council fashion of the stuff*

Alright, what do YOU want then?

Aus Urgebirgs Urmenschenkraft; *Of primal mountains' primal human might:*

It was certainly sublimely bold

Wohl dem, der sie zusammenrafft. *He's blest, for whom its elements unite!*

Something lofty and noble, I'm sure

Faust

Was seh' ich dort, was Waffen tragt? *What do I see, with arms, in yonder place?*

You who floated so much closer to the moon

Hast du das Bergvolk aufgeregt? *Hast thou aroused the mountain-race?*

You just came back from cloud-nine

Mephistopheles

Nein! aber, gleich Herrn Peter Squenz, *No! But I've brought, like Peter Squence,*

Did your mania draw you there?

Vom ganzen Prass die Quintessenz. *From all the raff the quintessence.*

Want a piece of lunar real estate?

Die drei Gewaltigen treten auf.

The Three Mighty Men appear.

Mephistopheles

Da kommen meine Bursche ja! *My fellows draw already near!*

Not at all! This earthly sphere

Du siehst, von sehr verschiednen Jahren, *Thou seest, of very different ages,*

No! This planet still has room

Verschiednem Kleid und Rustung sind sie da; *Of different garb and armour they appear:*

Still offers space for great deeds

Du wirst nicht schlecht mit ihnen fahren. *They will not serve thee ill when battle rages.*

There's still work to be done right here

(Ad spectatores)

Es liebt sich jetzt ein jedes Kind *Now every child delights to see*

Astonishing things shall succeed

Den Harnisch und den Ritterkragen; *The harness and the helm of knightly action;*

I've got plans that'll blow minds

Und, allegorisch wie die Lumpe sind, *And allegoric, as the blackguards be,*

I feel power for bold industry

Sie werden nur um desto mehr behagen. *They'll only all the more give satisfaction.*

I feel the strength for serious work

Raufebold (*jung, leicht bewaffnet, bunt gekleidet*) **Bully** (*young, lightly armed, clad in motley*)

Wenn einer mir ins Auge sieht, *When one shall meet me, face to face,*

And so you want to earn fame?

Werd' ich ihm mit der Faust gleich in die Fresse fahren, *My fisticuffs shall on his chops be showered;*

So you want to be famous?

Und eine Memme, wenn sie flieht, *And midway in his headlong race,*

One can tell you've come from heroines

Fass' ich bei ihren letzten Haaren. *Fast by his flying hair I'll catch the coward.*

Spending time with Helen really went to your head

Habebald (*mannhaft, wohlbewaffnet, reich gekleidet*) **Havequick** (*manly, well-armed, richly clad*)

So leere Handel, das sind Possen, *Such empty brawls are only folly!*

Dominion I'll win, property!

Damit verdirbt man seinen Tag; *They spoil whate'er occasion brings.*

I want power! Real estate!

Im Nehmen sei nur unverdrossen, *In taking, be unwearied wholly,*

The deed is everything, fame nothing

Nach allem andern frag' hernach. *And after, look to other things!*

Actions matter, reputation doesn't

Haltefest (*bejahrt, stark bewaffnet, ohne Gewand*) **Holdfast** (*well in years, strongly-armed, without raiment*)

Damit ist auch nicht viel gewonnen! *Yet little gain thereafter lingers!*

Yet poets will be found

Bald ist ein grosses Gut zerronnen, *Soon slips great wealth between your fingers,*

Oh, there'll be poets

Es rauscht im Lebensstrom hinab. *Borne by the tides of Life as down they run.*

To proclaim your glory to posterity

Zwar nehmen ist recht gut, doch besser ist's, behalten; *'Tis well to take, indeed, but better still to hold;*

To spin your story for the ages

Lass du den grauen Kerl nur walten, *Be by the gray old churl controlled,*

Through folly to kindle folly

Und niemand nimmt dir etwas ab. *And thou shalt plundered be by none.*

Using bullshit to inspire more bullshit

Sie steigen zusammen tiefer. They descend the mountain together.

Auf dem Vorgebirg / On the Headland

Act IV, Scene 2

Trommeln und kriegerische Musik von unten. Des Kaisers Zelt wird aufgeschlagen.

Drums and military music from below. The Emperor's tent is pitched.

Kaiser. Obergeneral. Trabanten.

Emperor. General-in-Chief. Life-Guardsmen.

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Noch immer scheint der Vorsatz wohlerrwogen, *It still appears the prudentest of courses*

It still appears the wisest course we've chosen

Dass wir in dies gelegene Tal *That here, in this appropriate vale,*

That here in this well-situated dale

Das ganze Heer gedrängt zurückgezogen; *We have withdrawn and strongly massed our forces;*

We've bunched our forces tight, compressed and frozen

Ich hoffe fest, uns glückt die Wahl. *I firmly trust we shall not fail.*

I'm betting hard our gamble doesn't fail

Kaiser Emperor

Wie es nun geht, es muss sich zeigen; *What comes of it will soon be brought to light;*

However it goes, we'll soon find out

Doch mich verdriesst die halbe Flucht, das Weichen. *Yet I dislike this yielding, semi-flight.*

But this half-assed retreat sticks in my craw

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Schau hier, mein Furst, auf unsre rechte Flanke! *Look down, my Prince, where our right flank is planted!*

Look here, my Prince, at our right flank's position!

Solch ein Terrain wunscht sich der Kriegsgedanke: *The field which War desires hath here been granted:*

This is the terrain that makes War salivate with ambition

Nicht steil die Hugel, doch nicht allzu ganglich, *Not steep the hills, yet access not preparing,*

Not too steep, but not an easy stroll

Den Unsern vorteilhaft, dem Feind verfanglich; *To us advantage, to the foe insnaring;*

Good for us, for enemies a death-trap hole

Wir, halb versteckt, auf wellenformigem Plan; *Their cavalry will hardly dare surround*

We're half-hidden on this rolling ground

Die Reiterei, sie wagt sich nicht heran. *Our strength half hid, on undulating ground.*

Their cavalry won't dare sniff around

Kaiser Emperor

Mir bleibt nichts ubrig, als zu loben; *My commendation, only, need I speak;*

Nothing left but praise from me

Hier kann sich Arm und Brust erproben. *Now arm and courage have the test they seek.*

Here arms and chests get the test they need

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Hier, auf der Mittelwiese flachen Raumlichkeiten, *Here, on the middle meadow's level spaces*

Here on the middle meadow's level floor

Siehst du den Phalanx, wohlgenut zu streiten. *Thou seest the phalanx, eager in their places.*

See the phalanx, hungry for war

Die Piken blinken flimmernd in der Luft, *In air the lances gleam and sparkle, kissed*

The pikes glitter, trembling in the air

Im Sonnenglanz, durch Morgennebelduft. *By sunshine, through the filmy morning mist.*

Sun through morning fog—they're shining there

Wie dunkel wogt das machtige Quadrat! *How darkling sways the grand and powerful square!*

How darkly that powerful square undulates!

Zu Tausenden gluh't's hier auf grosse Tat. *The thousands burn for great achievements there.*

Thousands burning to do something great

Du kannst daran die Masse Kraft erkennen, *Therein canst thou perceive the strength of masses;*

You can see massed power makes all the difference

Ich trau' ihr zu, der Feinde Kraft zu trennen. *And thine, be sure, the foemen's strength surpasses.*

I trust them to smash enemy resistance

Kaiser Emperor

Den schonen Blick hab' ich zum erstenmal. *Now first do I enjoy the stirring sight:*

First time I've seen such a gorgeous view

Ein solches Heer gilt fur die Doppelzahl. *An army, thus, appears of double might.*

An army like this counts for two

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Von unsrer Linken hab' ich nichts zu melden, *But of our left I've no report to make.*

Of our left flank I've nothing to report

Den starren Fels besetzen wackere Helden, *Brave heroes garrison the rocky brake;*

Brave heroes hold the rocky fort

Das Steingeklipp, das jetzt von Waffen blitzt, *The stony cliffs, by gleams of weapons specked,*

The stony crags now gleam with steel

Den wichtigen Pass der engen Klause schützt. *The entrance to the close defile protect.*

Protecting that narrow pass with appeal

Ich ahne schon, hier scheitern Feindeskrafte *Here, as I guess, the foeman's force will shatter,*

Enemy forces will shatter here, I sense

Unvorgesehn im blutigen Geschehen. *Forced unawares upon the bloody matter.*

Caught unaware in bloody consequence

Kaiser Emperor

Dort ziehn sie her, die falschen Anverwandten, *And there they march, false kin, one like the other!*

Here they come, my backstabbing kin

Wie sie mich Oheim, Vetter, Bruder nannten, *Even as they styled me Uncle, Cousin, Brother,*

Calling me Uncle, Brother, Cousin with their grin

Sich immer mehr und wieder mehr erlaubten, *Assuming more, and ever more defying,*

Taking more and more and more for themselves

Dem Zepter Kraft, dem Thron Verehrung raubten, *The sceptre's power, the throne's respect, denying;*

Stripping my scepter and throne like shelves

Dann, unter sich entzweit, das Reich verheerten *Then, in their feuds, the realm they devastated,*
Then feuding among themselves, trashing the land

Und nun gesamt sich gegen mich emporten. *And now as Rebels march, against me mated!*
And now united against me they stand

Die Menge schwankt im ungewissen Geist, *Awhile with halting minds the masses go,*
The masses waver, uncertain and dumb

Dann stromt sie nach, wohin der Strom sie reisst. *Then ride the stream, wherever it may flow.*
Then float wherever the current takes scum

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Ein treuer Mann, auf Kundschaft ausgeschickt, *A faithful man, sent out some news to win,*
A loyal scout sent out for intel

Kommt eilig felsenab; sei's ihm geglückt! *Comes down the rocks: may he have lucky been!*
Rushes down the rocks—hope he's got good news to tell

Erster Kundschafter First Spy

Glücklich ist sie uns gelungen, *Luckily have we succeeded;*
We pulled it off, lucky for us

Listig, mutig, unsre Kunst, *Helped by bold and cunning art,*
Crafty and brave, we made a fuss

Dass wir hin und her gedrungen; *Here and there have pressed, and heeded,*
Pushing through here and there

Doch wir bringen wenig Gunst. *But 'tis ill news we impart.*
But we bring bad news, I swear

Viele schworen reine Huldigung *Many, purest homage pledging,*
Many still pledge pure loyalty

Dir, wie manche treue Schar; *Like the faithful, fealty swore. –*
Like the faithful troops of royalty

Doch Untatigkeits-Entschuldigung: *For inertness now alleging*
But their excuse for sitting tight:

Innere Garung, Volksgefahr. *People's danger, strife in store.*
Civil unrest, popular fright

Kaiser Emperor

Sich selbst erhalten bleibt der Selbstsucht Lehre, *They learn from selfishness self-preservation,*

Selfishness teaches self-preservation

Nicht Dankbarkeit und Neigung, Pflicht und Ehre. *Not duty, honour, grateful inclination.*

Not gratitude or duty or dedication

Bedenkt ihr nicht, wenn eure Rechnung voll, *You do not think that, when your reckoning's shown,*

Don't you fools realize—when your bill's due

Dass Nachbars Hausbrand euch verzehren soll? *The neighbour's burning house shall fire your own!*

Your neighbor's house fire will burn YOU too?

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Der zweite kommt, nur langsam steigt er nieder, *The Second comes, descending slowly hither;*

The second comes, descending slow

Dem muden Manne zittern alle Glieder. *A weary man, whose strength appears to wither.*

The exhausted man trembles head to toe

Zweiter Kundschafter Second Spy

Erst gewahrten wir vergnüglich *First with comfort we detected*

First we observed with pleasure

Wilder Unordnung Verlauf; *What their plan confused was worth;*

Wild disorder beyond measure

Unerwartet, unverzüglich *Then, at once and unexpected,*

Then unexpected, out of nowhere, boom

Trat ein neuer Kaiser auf. *Came another Emperor forth.*

A new Emperor stepped out of the gloom

Und auf vorgeschriebnen Bahnen *As he bids, in ordered manner*

And on prescribed routes now marching

Zieht die Menge durch die Flur; *March the gathering hosts away;*

The masses cross the fields, departing

Den entrollten Lugenfahnen *His unfolded lying banner*

Following lying flags unfurled

Folgen alle. – Schafsnatur! *All have followed. – Sheep are they!*

All following—sheep-brained world!

Kaiser Emperor

Ein Gegenkaiser kommt mir zum Gewinn: *Now, by a Rival Emperor shall I gain:*

A rival Emperor works in my favor now

Nun fühl' ich erst, dass ich der Kaiser bin. *That I am Emperor, thus to me is plain.*

For the first time I FEEL I'm Emperor—and how!

Nur als Soldat legt' ich den Harnisch an, *But as a soldier I the mail put on;*

I only put on armor as a soldier

Zu hoherm Zweck ist er nun umgetan. *Now for a higher aim the sword be drawn!*

For higher purpose now I'm bolder

Bei jedem Fest, wenn's noch so glanzend war, *At all my shows, however grand to see,*

At every festival, grand as could be

Nichts ward vermisst, mir fehlte die Gefahr. *Did nothing lack: but Danger lacked, to me.*

Nothing was missing—except DANGER to me

Wie ihr auch seid, zum Ringspiel rietet ihr, *Though you but tilting at the ring suggested,*

Even when you suggested tournament rings

Mir schlug das Herz, ich atmete Turnier; *My heart beat high to be in tourney tested;*

My heart pounded—I breathed for jousting's wings

Und hattet ihr mir nicht vom Kriegen abgeraten, *And had you not from war my mind dissuaded,*

Had you not talked me out of war

Jetzt glanz't' ich schon in lichten Heldentaten. *For glorious deeds my name were now paraded.*

I'd already shine in heroic lore

Selbständig fühl't' ich meine Brust besiegelt, *But independence then did I acquire,*

I felt my chest sealed, self-reliant

Als ich mich dort im Feuerreich bespiegelt; *When I stood mirrored in the realm of fire:*

When I stood mirrored in fire's realm, defiant

Das Element drang grasslich auf mich los, *In the dread element I dared to stand; –*

The element attacked with horror's force

Es war nur Schein, allein der Schein war gross. *'Twas but a show, and yet the show was grand.*

Mere illusion—but GRAND illusion, of course

Von Sieg und Ruhm hab' ich verwirrt getraumt; *Of fame and victory I have dreamed alone;*

I've dreamed confused of victory and fame

Ich bringe nach, was frevelhaft versaumt. *But for the base neglect I now atone!*

Now I'll catch up on what I neglected in shame

Die Herolde werden abgefertigt zur Herausforderung des Gegenkaisers.

The Herald's are despatched to challenge the Rival Emperor to single combat.

Faust tritt auf, geharnscht, mit halbgeschlossnem Helme. Die drei Gewaltigen gerüstet und gekleidet wie oben.

Faust enters, in armour, with half-closed visor. The Three Mighty Men, armed and clothed, as already described.

Faust

Wir treten auf und hoffen, ungescholten; *We come, and hope our coming is not chidden;*

We arrive and hope we're not unwanted here

Auch ohne Not hat Vorsicht wohl gegolten. *Prudence may help, though by the need unbidden.*

Foresight has value even when nothing's to fear

Du weisst, das Bergvolk denkt und simuliert, *The mountain race, thou know'st, think and explore,*

You know mountain people think and ponder

Ist in Natur- und Felsenschrift studiert. *Of Nature and the rocks they read the lore.*

They've studied Nature's script and rock-text yonder

Die Geister, langst dem flachen Land entzogen, *The Spirits, forced from the level land to sever,*

The spirits, long banished from the flatlands

Sind mehr als sonst dem Felsgebirg gewogen. *Are of the rocky hills more fain than ever.*

Now favor rocky mountains, their new stands

Sie wirken still durch labyrinthische Kluft *Silent, they work through labyrinthine passes,*

Silent they work through labyrinthine veins

Im edlen Gas metallisch reicher Dufte; *In rich metallic fumes of noble gases.*

In noble gas of metal-rich perfume's domains

In stetem Sondern, Prüfen und Verbinden *On solving, testing, blending, most intent:*

Constantly separating, testing, combining

Ihr einziger Trieb ist, Neues zu erfinden. *Their only passion, something to invent.*

Their only urge: something new designing

Mit leisem Finger geistiger Gewalten *With gentle touch of spiritual power*

With gentle finger of spiritual might

Erbauen sie durchsichtige Gestalten; *They build transparent fabrics, hour by hour;*

They build transparent shapes of shimmering light

Dann im Kristall und seiner ewigen Schweignis *For they, in crystals and their silence, furl'd,*

Then in crystal's eternal silent shrine

Erblicken sie der Oberwelt Ereignis. *Behold events that rule the Upper World.*

They glimpse what happens in the world supine

Kaiser Emperor

Vernommen hab' ich's, und ich glaube dir; *I understand it, and can well agree;*

I've heard all that and believe you true

Doch, wackrer Mann, sag an: was soll das hier? *But say, thou gallant man, what's that to me?*

But brave man—what's it got to do with YOU?

Faust

Der Nekromant von Norcia, der Sabiner, *The Sabine old, the Norcian necromancer,*

The Sabine necromancer from Norcia's land

Ist dein getreuer, ehrenhafter Diener. *Thy true and worthy servant, sends thee answer:*

Is your true and honorable servant at hand

Welch greulich Schicksal droht' ihm ungeheuer! *What fearful fate it was, that overhung him!*

What ghastly fate threatened him—immense!

Das Reisig prasselte, schon zungelte das Feuer; *The faggots crackled, fire already stung him;*

Kindling crackled, flames already licked intense

Die trocknen Scheite, ringsumher verschränkt, *The billets dry were closely round him fixed,*

Dry logs stacked tight around his skin

Mit Pech und Schwefelruten untermengt; *With pitch and rolls of brimstone intermixed;*

Mixed with pitch and sulfur thrown in

Nicht Mensch, noch Gott, noch Teufel konnte retten, *Not Man, nor God, nor Devil, him could save,*

—

No man, God, or Devil could save his hide

Die Majestat zersprengte gluhende Ketten. *The Emperor plucked him from his fiery grave.*

YOUR Majesty burst the glowing chains aside

Dort war's in Rom. Er bleibt dir hoch verpflichtet, *It was in Rome. Still is he bound unto thee;*

That was Rome. He's still in your debt

Auf deinen Gang in Sorge stets gerichtet. *Upon thy path his anxious thoughts pursue thee;*

Watching your path with worried sweat

Von jener Stund' an ganz vergass er sich, *Himself since that dread hour forgotten, he*

From that hour he forgot himself entire

Er fragt den Stern, die Tiefe nur für dich. *Questions the stars, the depths, alone for thee.*

Asks stars and depths only for your sire

Er trug uns auf, als eiligstes Geschäfte, *Us he commissioned, by the swiftest courses*

He ordered us on urgent mission

Bei dir zu stehn. Gross sind des Berges Kräfte; *Thee to assist. Great are the mountain's forces;*

Stand by you. Great mountain forces' ammunition

Da wirkt Natur so übermächtig frei, *There Nature works all-potently and free,*

There Nature works all-powerfully free

Der Pfaffen Stumpsinn schilt es Zauberei. *Though stupid priests therein but magic see.*

Stupid priests call it sorcery

Kaiser Emperor

Am Freudentag, wenn wir die Gäste grüssen, *On days of joy, when we the guests are greeting*

On festive days when guests arrive in state

Die heiter kommen, heiter zu geniessen, *Who for their gay delight are gaily meeting,*

Coming cheerful to celebrate

Da freut uns jeder, wie er schiebt und drängt *Each gives us pleasure, as they push and pull,*

Each one delights, pushing and squeezing there

Und, Mann für Mann, der Sale Raum verengt. *And crowd man after man, the chambers full;*

Man after man, cramming the halls square

Doch höchst willkommen muss der Biedre sein, *Yet chiefly welcome is the brave man, thus,*

Yet most welcome must the brave one be

Tritt er als Beistand kräftig zu uns ein *When as a bold ally he brings to us*

Arriving as ally, strong and free

Zur Morgenstunde, die bedenklich waltet, *Now, in the fateful morning hour, his talents,*

In this fateful morning hour's weight

Weil über ihr des Schicksals Waage schaltet. *While Destiny uplifts her trembling balance.*

While Destiny's scales deliberate

Doch lenket hier im hohen Augenblick *Yet, while the fates of this high hour unfold,*

Yet in this high moment stay your hand

Die starke Hand vom willigen Schwert zurück, *Thy strong hand from the willing sword withhold, –*

Pull back from that willing sword's demand

Ehrt den Moment, wo manche Tausend schreiten, *Honour the moment, when the hosts are striding,*

Honor the moment when thousands stride

Für oder wider mich zu streiten. *For or against me, to the field deciding!*

For or against me to battle's tide

Selbst ist der Mann! Wer Thron und Kron' begehrt, *Self is the Man! Who crown and throne would claim*

A man does it himself! Want throne and crown?

Personlich sei er solcher Ehren wert. *Must personally be worthy of the same.*

Be personally worthy of such renown

Sei das Gespenst, das, gegen uns erstanden, *And may the Phantom, which against us stands,*

May the phantom who's risen against our reign

Sich Kaiser nennt und Herr von unsern Landen, *The self-styled Emperor, Lord of all our lands,*

Calling himself Emperor, Lord of our domain

Des Heeres Herzog, Lehnherr unsrer Grossen, *The army's Duke, our Princes' feudal head,*

Duke of the army, liege of our nobility

Mit eigener Faust ins Totenreich gestossen! *With mine own hand be hurled among the dead!*

Be thrust by MY fist to death's facility!

Faust

Wie es auch sei, das Grosse zu vollenden, *Howe'er the need that thy great work be finished,*

However great the completion of this deed

Du tust nicht wohl, dein Haupt so zu verpfanden. *Risked were thy head, the chances were diminished.*

You do wrong pledging your head—take heed

Ist nicht der Helm mit Kamm und Busch geschmückt? *Is not the helm adorned with plume and crest?*

Is the helm not adorned with crest and plume?

Er schützt das Haupt, das unsern Mut entzuckt. *The head it shields, that steels our courage best.*

It shields the head that fires our courage's bloom

Was, ohne Haupt, was forderten die Glieder? *Without a head, what should the members bridle?*

Without the head, what could the limbs achieve?

Denn schlafert jenes, alle sinken nieder; *Let it but sleep, they sink supine and idle.*

If it sleeps, all sink and grieve

Wird es verletzt, gleich alle sind verwundet, *If it be injured, all the hurt confess in't,*

Hurt it—every limb feels the distress

Erstehen frisch, wenn jenes rasch gesundet. *And all revive, when it is convalescent.*

They revive when it heals with quickness

Schnell weiss der Arm sein starkes Recht zu nutzen; *Then soon the arm its right shall reassert,*

Quick the arm knows to use its power right

Er hebt den Schild, den Schadel zu beschützen; *And lift the shield to save the skull from hurt:*

Lifts the shield to save the skull from plight

Das Schwert gewahret seiner Pflicht sogleich, *The sword perceives at once its honoured trust,*

The sword perceives its duty straightaway

Lenkt kraftig ab und wiederholt den Streich; *Parries with vigour, and repeats the thrust:*

Parries hard and repeats the fray

Der tuchtige Fuss nimmt teil an ihrem Gluck, *The gallant foot its share of luck will gain,*

The capable foot shares in their luck

Setzt dem Erschlagen frisch sich ins Genick. *And plants itself upon the necks of slain.*

Plants itself fresh on necks of those they've struck

Kaiser Emperor

Das ist mein Zorn, so mocht' ich ihn behandeln, *Such is my wrath; I'd meet him thus, undaunted,*

That's MY rage—I'd handle him just so

Das stolze Haupt in Schemeltritt verwandeln! *And see his proud head as my footstool planted!*

Turn that proud head into a footstool below!

Herolde (*zuruckkommend*) **Heralds** (*returning*)

Wenig Ehre, wenig Geltung *Little honour was accorded;*

Little honor, little respect

Haben wir daselbst genossen, *We have met with scorn undoubted:*

We received there, as you'd expect

Unsrer kraftig edlen Meldung *Our defiance, nobly worded,*

Our noble, forceful declaration

Lachten sie als schaler Possen: *As an empty farce they flouted:*

They laughed off as a stale flirtation

“Euer Kaiser ist verschollen, *“Lo, your Lord is but a vision, –*

“Your Emperor? Long forgotten, done

Echo dort im engen Tal; *Echo of a vanished prime:*

Echo in a narrow valley, gone

Wenn wir sein gedenken sollen, *When we name him, says Tradition:*

When we think of him at all

Marchen sagt: – Es war einmal.” *‘He was – once upon a time!’ “*

The fairy tale says: Once upon a fall.”

Faust

Dem Wunsch gemäss der Besten ist’s geschahn, *It’s happened as the best would fain have planned,*

Happened as the best wished it to be

Die fest und treu an deiner Seite stehn. *Who, firm and faithful, still beside thee stand.*

Those standing loyal beside thee

Dort naht der Feind, die Deinen harren brünstig; *There comes the foe, thy army waits and wishes;*

There comes the foe—yours wait burning to fight

Befiehl den Angriff, der Moment ist günstig. *Order attack! the moment is auspicious.*

Command attack! The moment’s ripe and right

Kaiser Emperor

Auf das Kommando leist’ ich hier Verzicht. *Yet I decline to exercise command.*

I renounce command right here and now

(Zum Obergeneral) (To the General-in-Chief)

In deinen Händen, Fürst, sei deine Pflicht. *Thy duty, Prince, be trusted to thy hand!*

Prince, your duty’s in your hands—take a bow

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

So trete denn der rechte Flügel an! *Then let the right wing now advance apace!*

Then let the right wing now advance!

Des Feindes Linke, eben jetzt im Steigen, *The enemy’s left, who just begin ascending,*

The enemy’s left just starting to prance

Soll, eh’ sie noch den letzten Schritt getan, *Shall, ere the movement close, give up their place,*

Before they take their final stance

Der Jugendkraft geprüfter Treue weichen. *Before the youthful force our field defending.*

Shall yield to tested youth’s fresh lance

Faust

Erlaube denn, dass dieser muntre Held *Permit me, then, that this gay hero may*

Permit this lively hero then

Sich ungesäumt in deine Reihen stellt, *Be stationed in thy ranks, without delay, –*

To join your ranks without delay—Amen

Sich deinen Reihen innigst einverleibt *That with thy men most fully he consort,*

To weave himself tight into your rows

Und, so gesellt, sein kraftig Wesen treibt. *And thus incorporate, ply his vigorous sport!*

And so combined, deal his mighty blows

(Er deutet auf den zur Rechten.) (He points to the Mighty Man on the right.)

Raufebold *(vortretend)* **Bully** *(coming forward)*

Wer das Gesicht mir zeigt, der kehrt's nicht ab *Who shows his face to me, before he turn*

Show me your face? You won't turn it back

Als mit zerschlagenen Unter- und Oberbacken; *Shall find his cheekbones and his chops are shattered:*

Till upper and lower jaws both crack

Wer mir den Rücken kehrt, gleich liegt ihm schlapp *Who shows his back, one sudden blow shall earn,*

Turn your back? Then down you'll flop

Hals, Kopf und Schopf hinschlotternd grass im Nacken. *Then head and pig-tail dangling hang, and battered!*

Neck, skull, pigtail—dangling slop

Und schlagen deine Männer dann *And if thy men, like me, will lunge*

If your men strike like I do

Mit Schwert und Kolben, wie ich wute, *With mace and sword, beside each other,*

With sword and cudgel raging through

So stürzt der Feind, Mann über Mann, *Man over man the foe shall plunge*

The enemy falls man over man

Ersauft im eigenen Geblute. *And in their own deep blood shall smother!*

DROWNING in their own blood's plan

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Der Phalanx unsrer Mitte folge sacht, *Let them our centre phalanx follow slow, –*

Let our center phalanx follow slow

Dem Feind begegn' er, klug mit aller Macht; *Engage with caution, yet with might, the foe!*

Meet the foe with cunning's glow

Ein wenig rechts, dort hat bereits, erbittert, *There to the right, already overtaken,*

A bit to the right, already there, enraged

Der Unsern Streikraft ihren Plan erschuttert. *Our furious force their plan has rudely shaken!*
Our forces have their plans disengaged

Faust (*auf den Mittleren deutend*) **Faust** (*pointing to the middle one*)

So folge denn auch dieser deinem Wort! *Let also this one now obey thy word!*

Let this one follow your word too!

Habebald (*vortretend*) **Havequick** (*comes forward*)

Dem Heldenmut der Kaiserscharen *Unto the host's heroic duty*

To the Kaiser's troops' heroic mood

Soll sich der Durst nach Beute paaren; *Shall now be joined the thirst for booty;*

Shall join the thirst for booty's brood

Und allen sei das Ziel gestellt: *And be the goal, where all are sent,*

And be the goal for one and all

Des Gegenkaisers reiches Zelt. *The Rival Emperor's sumptuous tent!*

The rival Emperor's rich tent—the haul!

Er prahlt nicht lang auf seinem Sitze, *He shall not long upon his seat be lorded:*

He won't strut long on his throne

Ich ordne mich dem Phalanx an die Spitze. *To lead the phalanx be to me accorded!*

I'll lead the phalanx—that spot's my own

Eilebeute (*Marketenderin, sich an ihn anschmiegend*) **Speedbooty** (*sutleress, fawning upon him*)

Bin ich auch ihm nicht angeweiht, *Though never tied to him by priest,*

Though I'm not hitched to him by priest

Er mir der liebste Buhle bleibt. *He is my sweetheart dear, at least.*

He's still my favorite buck at least

Für uns ist solch ein Herbst gereift! *Our autumn 'tis, of ripest gold!*

For US such harvest-time's matured

Die Frau ist grimmig, wenn sie greift, *Woman is fierce when she takes hold,*

Woman is FIERCE when she grabs—be assured

Ist ohne Schonung, wenn sie raubt; *And when she robs, is merciless:*

Is MERCILESS when she robs and takes

Im Sieg voran! und alles ist erlaubt. *All is allowed, so forth to victory press!*

Forward to victory—anything goes, for God's sakes!

(Beide ab.) (Exeunt both.)

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Auf unsre Linke, wie vorauszusehn, *Upon our left, as was to be foreseen,*

Upon our left, as was foreseen

Sturzt ihre Rechte, kraftig. Widerstehn *Their right is strongly hurled. Yon rocks between,*

Their right crashes strong between

Wird Mann fur Mann dem wutenden Beginnen, *Ours will resist their furious beginning,*

Man after man will resist their raid

Den engen Pass des Felswegs zu gewinnen. *And hinder them the narrow pass from winning.*

To win the narrow rocky pass' blockade

Faust *(winkt nach der Linken)* **Faust** *(beckons to the Mighty Man on the left)*

So bitte, Herr, auch diesen zu bemerken; *I beg you, Sire, let this one also aid;*

Please, my Lord, notice this one too

Es schadet nichts, wenn Starke sich verstärken. *'Tis well when even the strong are stronger made.*

Strength strengthening strength is nothing new

Haltefest *(vortretend)* **Holdfast** *(coming forward)*

Dem linken Flugel keine Sorgen! *Now let the left wing have no fear!*

Left wing? Don't you worry one bit

Da, wo ich bin, ist der Besitz geborgen; *The ground is surely held, where I appear:*

Where I am, possessions are safe and fit

In ihm bewahret sich der Alte, *I am the Ancient you were told of:*

This old-timer proves himself sound

Kein Strahlblitz spaltet, was ich halte. *No lightning splits what I keep hold of!*

NO lightning bolt splits what I hold down!

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Mephistopheles *(von oben herabkommend)* **Mephistopheles** *(descending from above)*

Nun schauet, wie im Hintergrunde *And now behold, how, more remote,*

Now see how in the background there

Aus jedem zackigen Felsenschlunde *From every jagged rocky throat*

From every jagged rocky throat's lair

Bewaffnete hervor sich drangen, *Comes forth an armed host, increasing,*

Armed figures press themselves outside

Die schmalen Pfade zu verengen, *Down every narrow pathway squeezing,*

Squeezing down narrow paths with stride

Mit Helm und Harnisch, Schwertern, Schilden *With helm and harness, sword and spear,*

With helm and harness, sword and shield

In unserm Rucken eine Mauer bilden, *A living rampart in our rear,*

A wall behind us, our rear sealed

Den Wink erwartend, zuzuschlagen. *And wait the sign to charge the foemen!*

Waiting for the sign to strike the field

(Leise zu den Wissenden) (Aside, to the knowing ones)

Woher das kommt, musst ihr nicht fragen. *You must not ask whence comes the omen.*

Where this comes from? Don't you dare ask

Ich habe freilich nicht gesaumt, *I have not been a careless scout,*

I certainly didn't shirk my task

Die Waffensale ringsum ausgeräumt; *But cleared the halls of armour round about.*

The weapon halls all around I cleaned

Da standen sie zu Fuss, zu Pferde, *They stood a-foot, they sat on horses,*

There they stood, horse and foot, all preened

Als waren sie noch Herrn der Erde; *Like Lords of Earth and real forces:*

As if they still ruled the earth somehow

Sonst waren's Ritter, König, Kaiser, *Once Emperors, Kings, and Knights were they,*

Once knights, kings, emperors—now?

Jetzt sind es nichts als leere Schneckenhauser; *Now empty shells, – the snails have crawled away.*

Empty snail shells—the snails crawled out

Gar manch Gespenst hat sich darein geputzt, *Full many ghosts, arrayed so, have for us*

Many ghosts have dressed in what's about

Das Mittelalter lebhaft aufgestutzt. *Revamped the Middle Ages thus.*

Reviving the Middle Ages with clout

Welch Teufelchen auch drinne steckt, *Whatever Devils now the shells select,*

Whatever little devil sticks inside

Für diesmal macht es doch Effekt. *This once 'twill still create effect.*

For now it creates effect worldwide

(Laut) (Aloud)

Hort, wie sie sich voraus erbosen, *Hark! in advance they stir their anger,*

Hear them rage already in advance

Blechlappernd aneinander stossen! *Each jostling each with brassy clangor!*

Tin clattering on tin in their dance

Auch flattern Fahnenfetzen bei Standarten, *The banner-rags of standards flutter flowing,*

Banner-rags flutter by the old standards

Die frischer Luftchen ungeduldig harreten. *That restless waited for the breeze's blowing.*

Waiting impatiently for fresh wind's commands

Bedenkt, hier ist ein altes Volk bereit *Here standeth ready, now, an ancient race;*

Consider: here ancient folk stand ready

Und mischte gern sich auch zum neuen Streit. *In the new conflict it would fain have place.*

Eager to join new battle, steady

Ungeheurer Posaunenklang von oben, im feindlichen Heer merkliche Schwankung. Tremendous peal of trumpets from above: a perceptible wavering in the hostile army.

Faust

Der Horizont hat sich verdunkelt, *The near horizon dims and darkles;*

The horizon's grown dark and dense

Nur hie und da bedeutend funkelt *Yet here and there with meaning sparkles*

Only here and there with portent's glints

Ein roter ahnungsvoller Schein; *A ruddy and presaging glow;*

A red foreboding gleam burns low

Schon blutig blinken die Gewehre; *The blades are red where strife is sorest,*

Already bloody the weapons' glow

Der Fels, der Wald, die Atmosphäre, *The atmosphere, the rocks, the forest,*

Rock, forest, atmosphere conspire

Der ganze Himmel mischt sich ein. *The very heavens the combat show.*

The whole sky joins the battle's fire

Mephistopheles

Die rechte Flanke halt sich kraftig; *The right flank holds its ground with vigour:*

The right flank holds with solid might

Doch seh' ich ragend unter diesen *There, towering over all, defiant,*

But towering above the height

Hans Raufbold, den behenden Riesen, *Jack Bully works, the nimble giant,*

Hans Raufebold, that nimble giant

Auf seine Weise rasch geschäftig. *And drives them with his wonted rigour.*

Works his own way, wild and defiant

Kaiser Emperor

Erst sah ich einen Arm erhoben, *I first beheld one arm uplifted,*

First I saw one arm raised high

Jetzt seh' ich schon ein Dutzend toben; *But now a dozen tossed and shifted:*

Now a dozen rage across the sky

Naturgemass geschieht es nicht. *Unnatural such things appear.*

That's not natural what occurs

Faust

Vernahmst du nichts von Nebelstreifen, *Hast thou not heard of vapours banded,*

Haven't you heard of foggy blurs

Die auf Siziliens Küsten schweifen? *O'er the Sicilian coasts expanded?*

Hovering along Sicilian coasts?

Dort, schwankend klar, im Tageslicht, *There, hovering in daylight clear,*

There wavering clear in daylight's hosts

Erhoben zu den Mittelluften, *When mid-air gleams in rarer phases,*

Raised to middle heights of air

Gespiegelt in besondern Duften, *And mirrored in especial hazes,*

Mirrored in special vapors there

Erscheint ein seltsames Gesicht: *A vision wonderful awakes:*

A strange apparition appears for sight

Da schwanken Städte hin und wider, *There back and forth are cities bending,*

Cities sway back and forth in light

Da steigen Gärten auf und nieder, *With gardens rising and descending,*

Gardens rise and sink below

Wie Bild um Bild den Äther bricht. *As form on form the ether breaks.*

Image after image breaks the ether's flow

Kaiser Emperor

Doch wie bedenklich! Alle Spitzen *Yet how suspicious! I behold*

But how suspicious! Every point

Der hohen Speere seh' ich blitzen; *The tall spears tipped with gleams of gold*

Of high spears gleams at the joint

Auf unsres Phalanx blanken Lanzen *Upon our phalanx' shining lances*

On our phalanx's shining lance array

Seh' ich behende Flammchen tanzen. *A nimble host of flamelets dances:*

Nimble flamelets dance and play

Das scheint mir gar zu geisterhaft. *Too spectral it appears to me.*

Too ghostly for my taste, this scene

Faust

Verzeih, o Herr, das sind die Spuren *Pardon me, Lord, those are the traces*

Pardon, Lord—those traces there have been

Verschollner geistiger Naturen, *Of spirits of the vanished races,*

From vanished spiritual races' sheen

Ein Widerschein der Dioskuren, *The fires of Pollux and of Castor,*

A reflection of the Dioscuri's fire

Bei denen alle Schiffer schwuren; *Whom seamen call on in disaster:*

Whom all sailors invoke when storms grow dire

Sie sammeln hier die letzte Kraft. *They here collect their final strength for thee.*

They gather their last strength for thee

Kaiser Emperor

Doch sage: wem sind wir verpflichtet, *But say, to whom are we indebted,*

But tell me—to whom are we in debt?

Dass die Natur, auf uns gerichtet, *That Nature hath our plans abetted,*

That Nature turns our way and yet

Das Seltenste zusammenrafft? *With shows of rarest potency?*

Gathers the rarest powers to display?

Mephistopheles

Wem als dem Meister, jenem hohen, *To whom, indeed, but that old Roman*

To whom but that Master, lofty and gray

Der dein Geschick im Busen tragt? *Whose care for thee at last is proved!*

Who bears your fate in his chest, I'd say

Durch deiner Feinde starkes Drohen *By the strong menace of thy foemen*

By your enemies' menacing display

Ist er im Tiefsten aufgeregt. *His deepest nature has been moved.*

He's stirred deep inside today

Sein Dank will dich gerettet sehen, *His gratitude would see thee now delivered,*

His thanks wants to see you saved

Und sollt' er selbst daran vergehen. *Though his own being for thy sake be shivered.*

Even if he himself lies graved

Kaiser Emperor

Sie jubelten, mich pomphaft umzufuhren; *They cheered my march, with every pomp invested;*

They cheered parading me in pomp so grand

Ich war nun was, das wollt' ich auch probieren *I felt my power, I meant to see it tested;*

I WAS something—wanted to test my hand

Und fand's gelegen, ohne viel zu denken, *So, carelessly, I found it well, as ruler,*

Found it fitting without much thought

Dem weissen Barte kühle Luft zu schenken. *To send the white beard where the air was cooler.*

To give the white beard cool air bought

Dem Klerus hab' ich eine Lust verdorben, *I robbed the Clergy of a pleasant savour,*

Spoiled the clergy's fun that round

Und ihre Gunst mir freilich nicht erworben. *And, truly, have not thus acquired their favour.*

Haven't won their favor, I've found

Nun sollt' ich, seit so manchen Jahren, *Shall I, at last, since many years are over,*

Now after years that have come and gone

Die Wirkung frohen Tuns erfahren? *The payment for that merry deed recover?*

Should I feel good deeds' payoff dawn?

Faust

Freiherzige Wohltat wuchert reich; *Free-hearted help heaps interest:*

Free-hearted kindness grows compound interest fast

Lass deinen Blick sich aufwärts wenden! *Look up, and cease to watch the foemen!*

Let your gaze turn upward, vast

Mich deucht, er will ein Zeichen senden, *Methinks that he will send an omen:*

I think he'll send a sign your way

Gib acht, es deutet sich sogleich. *Attend! the sign is now expressed.*

Watch! It manifests right away

Kaiser Emperor

Ein Adler schwebt im Himmelhohen, *An Eagle hovers in the heavenly vault:*

An eagle soars in heaven's height

Ein Greif ihm nach mit wildem Drohen. *A Griffin follows, menacing assault.*

A griffin chases with threatening might

Faust

Gib acht: gar gunstig scheint es mir. *Give heed! It seems most favourable.*

Pay attention—this seems favorable to me

Greif ist ein fabelhaftes Tier; *The Griffin is a beast of fable:*

The griffin's a creature of fantasy

Wie kann es sich so weit vergessen, *How dare he claim a rival regal,*

How dare it so forget its station

Mit echtem Adler sich zu messen? *And meet in fight a genuine Eagle?*

To challenge a REAL eagle of the nation?

Kaiser Emperor

Nunmehr, in weitgedehnten Kreisen, *And now, in circles wide extended,*

Now in wide-arc'ing sweeps around

Umziehn sie sich; – in gleichem Nu *They wheel involved, – then, like a flash,*

They circle each other—same instant found

Sie fahren aufeinander zu, *Upon each other swiftly dash,*

They fly at each other in savage clash

Sich Brust und Halse zu zerreißen. *That necks be cleft and bodies rended!*

Ripping at throat and breast in their rash

Faust

Nun merke, wie der leidige Greif, *Mark now the evil Griffin quail!*

Now watch the wretched griffin there

Zerzaust, zerzupft, nur Schaden findet *Rumpled and torn, the foe he feareth,*

Torn and ragged, finds only damage in the air

Und mit gesenktem Lowenschweif, *And with his drooping lion's-tail,*

With drooping lion tail hung low

Zum Gipfelwald gestürzt, verschwindet. *Plunged in the tree-tops, disappeareth.*

Plunges to treetops—gone from the show

Kaiser Emperor

Sei's, wie gedeutet, so getan! *Even as presaged, so may it be!*

As interpreted, so may it be

Ich nehm' es mit Verwundrung an. *I take the sign, admiringly.*

I accept it with wonder, admiringly

Mephistopheles (*gegen die Rechte*) **Mephistopheles** (*towards the right*)

Dringend wiederholten Streichen *From the force of blows repeated*

From urgently repeated blows

Müssen unsre Feinde weichen, *Have our enemies retreated;*

Our enemies must yield—there goes

Und mit ungewissem Fechten *And in fight uncertain, shifting,*

With uncertain fighting's sway

Drangen sie nach ihrer Rechten *Towards their right they now are drifting,*

They push toward their right in disarray

Und verwirren so im Streite *Thus confusing, by their courses,*

And so confuse in battle's heat

Ihrer Hauptmacht linke Seite. *All the left flank of their forces.*

Their main force's left to defeat

Unsers Phalanx feste Spitze *See! our phalanx, firmly driven,*

Our phalanx's solid spearhead drives

Zieht sich rechts, und gleich dem Blitze *Moves to right, and, like the levin,*

Moves right and like LIGHTNING strives

Fahrt sie in die schwache Stelle. – *Strikes them in the weak position. –*

Strikes into the weak spot square

Nun, wie sturmerregte Welle *Now, like waves in wild collision,*

Now like storm-driven waves that tear

Spruhend, wuten gleiche Mächte *Equal powers, with rage opposing,*

Spraying, equal powers rage

Wild in doppeltem Gefechte; *In the double fight are closing.*

Wild in double battle's stage

Herrlichers ist nichts ersonnen, *Gloriously the weapons rattle;*

Nothing grander could be spun

Uns ist diese Schlacht gewonnen! *We, at last, have won the battle!*

For us this battle has been WON!

Kaiser (*auf der linken Seite, zu Faust*) **Emperor** (*on the left, to Faust*)

Schau! Mir scheint es dort bedenklich, *Look! it yonder seems suspicious!*

Look! Over there seems fishy to me

Unser Posten steht verfanglich. *For our post the luck's capricious.*

Our position stands endangered, I see

Keine Steine seh' ich fliegen, *Not a stone I see them throw there;*

No stones I see them throw

Niedre Felsen sind erstiegen, *Mounted are the rocks below there,*

Lower rocks they've climbed below

Obre stehen schon verlassen. *And the upper ones deserted.*

Upper ones already vacated

Jetzt! – Der Feind, zu ganzen Massen *Now! – to one huge mass converted*

Now—the foe, to masses concentrated

Immer naher angedrungen, *Nearer moves the foe, unshaken,*

Presses ever nearer, never shook

Hat vielleicht den Pass errungen, *And perchance the pass hath taken.*

Has perhaps the pass already took

Schlusserfolg unheiligen Strebens! *Such the unholy plan's conclusion!*

End result of unholy striving

Eure Kunste sind vergebens. *All your arts are but delusion.*

Your arts are useless for surviving!

Pause.

Mephistopheles

Da kommen meine beiden Raben, *There come my ravens, croaking presage;*

There come my two ravens winging

Was mögen die für Botschaft haben? *What nature, then, may be their message?*

What message might they be bringing?

Ich fürchte gar, es geht uns schlecht. *I fear we stand in evil plight.*

I fear things look bad for us

Kaiser Emperor

Was sollen diese leidigen Vögel? *What mean these fatal birds enchanted?*

What do these wretched birds discuss?

Sie richten ihre schwarzen Segel *Their inky sails are hither slanted,*

They steer their black sails here

Hierher vom heißen Felsgefecht. *Hot from the rocky field of fight.*

Hot from the rocky fight, so near

Mephistopheles *(zu den Raben)* **Mephistopheles** *(to the Ravens)*

Setzt euch ganz nah zu meinen Ohren. *Sit at mine ears, your flight retarded!*

Perch right close beside my ear

Wen ihr beschützt, ist nicht verloren, *He is not lost whom you have guarded;*

Whoever you protect need never fear

Denn euer Rat ist folgerichtig. *Your counsel's logical and right.*

Your counsel follows logic clear

Faust *(zum Kaiser)* **Faust** *(to the Emperor)*

Von Tauben hast du ja vernommen, *Thou hast, of course, been told of pigeons,*

You've heard of carrier pigeons, right?

Die aus den fernsten Landen kommen *Taught to return from distant regions*

That from distant lands take flight

Zu ihres Nestes Brut und Kost. *To nests upon their native coast.*

To their nest's brood and feast

Hier ist's mit wichtigen Unterschieden: *Here, differently, the plan's succeeded;*

Here's an important difference at least

Die Taubenpost bedient den Frieden, *The pigeon-post for Peace is needed,*

Pigeon post serves peace's need

Der Krieg befiehlt die Rabenpost. *But War requires the raven-post.*

War commands the raven breed

Mephistopheles

Es meldet sich ein schwer Verhangnis: *The birds announce us sore mischances.*

A heavy fate announces itself now

Seht hin! gewahret die Bedrangnis *See, yonder, how the foe advances*

Look there! See the distress somehow

Um unsrer Helden Felsenrand! *Against our heroes' rocky wall.*

Around our heroes' rocky rim

Die nächsten Höhen sind erstiegen, *The nearest heights even now attaining!*

The nearest heights are scaled by them

Und wurden sie den Pass besiegen, *Should they succeed the pass in gaining,*

Should they conquer the pass at last

Wir hatten einen schweren Stand. *Our fortunes, then, were critical.*

We'd be standing not so fast

Kaiser Emperor

So bin ich endlich doch betrogen! *Defeat and cheat at last are on me;*

So I'm finally truly deceived!

Ihr habt mich in das Netz gezogen; *Into your meshes you have drawn me:*

You've drawn me into the net you've weaved

Mir graut, seitdem es mich umstrickt. *I shudder, since they bind me fast.*

I shudder since it binds me round

Mephistopheles

Nur Mut! Noch ist es nicht missglückt. *Courage! Not yet the die is cast.*

Courage! We haven't failed yet, I've found

Geduld und Pfiff zum letzten Knoten! *Patience and knack, for knot-untying!*

Patience and cunning for the final knot

Gewöhnlich geht's am Ende scharf. *The close will be the fiercest stand.*

Usually the ending's fiercest fought

Ich habe meine sichern Boten; *Sure messengers for me are flying:*

I have my reliable messengers fleet

Befehlt, dass ich befehlen darf! *Command that I may give command!*

Command that I may command—complete!

Obergeneral (*der indessen herangekommen*) **General-in-Chief** (*who has meanwhile arrived*)

Mit diesen hast du dich vereinigt, *To follow these hast thou consented;*

With THESE you've allied our cause?

Mich hat's die ganze Zeit gepeinigt, *Thence all the time was I tormented:*

It's pained me the whole time because

Das Gaukeln schafft kein festes Glück. *No fortune comes of jugglery.*

Juggling tricks don't make lasting luck

Ich weiss nichts an der Schlacht zu wenden; *The battle's lost, I cannot mend it;*

I know nothing to turn this battle's struck

Begannen sie's, sie mogen's enden, *'Twas they began, and they may end it!*

They started it—let THEM end it then

Ich gebe meinen Stab zuruck. *My baton I return to thee.*

I give back my staff—Amen

Kaiser Emperor

Behalt ihn bis zu bessern Stunden, *Retain it for the better season*

Keep it for better hours yet

Die uns vielleicht das Glück verleiht. *Which Fortune still to us may send!*

Which fortune may still let

Mir schaudert vor dem garstigen Kunden *I dread the customers with reason, –*

I shudder at that ugly customer there

Und seiner Rabentraulichkeit. *The ravens and their ugly friend.*

And his cozy raven affair

(Zu Mephistopheles) (To Mephistopheles)

Den Stab kann ich dir nicht verleihen, *As for the baton, thou must leave it;*

The staff I cannot lend to you

Du scheinst mir nicht der rechte Mann; *Thou'rt not, methinks, the proper man.*

You don't seem the right man for what's true

Befiehl und such uns zu befreien! *Command the fight, canst thou retrieve it!*

Command—try to set us free!

Geschehe, was geschehen kann. *Let happen all that happen can!*

Let happen what must be

(Geht ins Zelt mit dem Obergeneral.) (Exit into the tent with the General-in-Chief.)

Mephistopheles

Mag ihn der stumpfe Stab beschutzen! *The blunt stick still be his protection!*

May the blunt staff protect him well

Uns andern konnt' er wenig nutzen, *'Twould naught avail in our direction;*

For us it'd be useless as hell

Es war so was vom Kreuz daran. *There was a sort of Cross thereon.*

Something of the CROSS was on it, I'd say

Faust

Was ist zu tun? – *What's to be done?*

What's to be done?—

Mephistopheles

Es ist getan! – *The thing is done! –*

It's done, I say!—

Nun, schwarze Vettern, rasch im Dienen, *Now, my black cousins, speed upon your duties*

Now black cousins, quick in your duty

Zum grossen Bergsee! grusst mir die Undinen *To the mountain-lake! The Undines, watery beauties,*

To the great mountain lake! Greet me the watery beauty

Und bittet sie um ihrer Fluten Schein. *Entreat, the appearance of their floods to spare!*

And beg them for their floods' shimmering sheen

Durch Weiberkunste, schwer zu kennen, *By female arts, beyond our sharpest seeing,*

Through female arts, hard to be seen

Verstehen sie vom Sein den Schein zu trennen, *They can divide the Appearance from the Being!*

They separate Being from what's merely Seen

Und jeder schwort, das sei das Sein. *And all will swear the Being's there!*

And everyone SWEARS the Seen must be the Been!

Pause.

Faust

Den Wasserfraulein müssen unsre Raben *Our ravens must, with flattery beladen,*

Our ravens must have sweet-talked well

Recht aus dem Grund geschmeichelt haben; *Have sweetly coaxed each winsome water-maiden;*

Those water-maidens under the spell

Dort fangt es schon zu rieseln an. *The trickling streams at once descend.*

Already it starts to trickle down

An mancher trocknen, kahlen Felsenstelle *The bald and rocky shoulders of the mountains*

On many a dry, bare rocky crown

Entwickelt sich die volle, rasche Quelle; *Give birth to full and swiftly-flowing fountains;*

A full swift spring bursts from the earth

Um jener Sieg ist es getan. *Their victory is at an end.*

For THEM down there—their victory's dearth

Mephistopheles

Das ist ein wunderbarer Gruss, *To such reception they're not used:*

That's a wondrous greeting to get!

Die kuhnsten Kletterer sind konfus. *The boldest climbers grow confused.*

The boldest climbers are confused and wet

Faust

Schon rauscht ein Bach zu Bachen mächtig nieder, *Now brook roars down to brook with mighty bubble;*

Brook roars mightily down to brooks below

Aus Schluchten kehren sie gedoppelt wieder, *Then from the mouths of glens they issue double,*

From gorges they return with doubled flow

Ein Strom nun wirft den Bogenstrahl; *And fling themselves, in arches, o'er the pale;*

A stream hurls its arching spray

Auf einmal legt er sich in flache Felsenbreite *Then suddenly spread along the rocky level,*

Then spreads on flat rock's display

Und rauscht und schäumt nach der und jener Seite, *And to and fro foam onward in their revel,*

Foaming, roaring this way and that

Und stufenweise wirft er sich ins Tal. *As down a stairway hurled into the vale.*

Step by step crashes to the valley flat

Was hilft ein tapfres, heldenmassiges Stemma? *What boots their gallant, hero-like resistance?*

What good is brave heroic resistance there?

Die mächtige Woge stromt, sie wegzuschwemmen. *The billow bursts, and bears them down the distance;*

The mighty wave sweeps them off everywhere

Mir schaudert selbst vor solchem wilden Schwall. *Before such wild uproar even I must quail.*

Even I shudder at such wild flood's care

Mephistopheles

Ich sehe nichts von diesen Wasserlügen, *Nothing I see of all this moist illusion;*

I see NOTHING of these water lies

Nur Menschenaugen lassen sich betrogen, *To human eyes, alone, it brings confusion,*

Only human eyes fall for disguise

Und mich ergetzt der wunderliche Fall. *And in the wondrous chance I take delight.*

The wondrous case delights my gut

Sie stürzen fort zu ganzen Haufen, *They fly in headlong, hurried masses;*

They rush away in heaps—scared shut

Die Narren wahren zu ersaufen, *That they are drowning, think the asses:*

The fools think they're drowning tonight

Indem sie frei auf festem Lande schnaufen *Though on the solid land, they see an ocean,*

While they gasp free on solid ground's plight

Und lacherlich mit Schwimmgebarden laufen. *And run absurdly with a swimming motion.*

Running ridiculously with swimming motion

Nun ist Verwirrung überall. *It is a most bewildering plight.*

Now confusion everywhere—quite a commotion!

Die Raben sind wiedergekommen. The ravens return.

Ich werd' euch bei dem hohen Meister loben; *To the high Master will I praise you duly;*

I'll praise you to the High Master well

Wollt ihr euch nun als Meister selbst erproben, *But would you test yourselves as masters fully,*

Want to prove yourselves as masters? Do tell

So eilet zu der glühnden Schmiede, *Then hasten to that smithy eerie,*

Then hurry to that glowing smithy's place

Wo das Gezwergvolk, nimmer mude, *Where the dwarf-people, never weary,*

Where dwarf-folk, never tired, keep pace

Metall und Stein zu Funken schlägt. *Hammer the sparks from ore and stone.*

Striking sparks from metal and stone

Verlangt, weitläufig sie beschwatzend, *Demand, while there you prate and flatter,*

Demand while sweet-talking them—honeyed tone

Ein Feuer, leuchtend, blinkend, platzend, *A fire to shine, and shoot, and scatter,*

A fire of gleaming, sparkling, bursting might

Wie man's im hohen Sinne hegt. *As in the highest sense 'tis known.*

As one conceives it in the highest light

Zwar Wetterleuchten in der weiten Ferne, *'Tis true that distant lightning, quivering far-lights,*
True, distant heat lightning appears

Blickschnelles Fallen allerhochster Sterne *And falling, quick as wink, of highest star-lights,*
Quick-falling of the highest spheres

Mag jede Sommernacht geschehn; *May happen any summer night;*

May happen any summer night's arrears

Doch Wetterleuchten in verworrenen Buschen *But lightning, loose among the tangled bushes,*
But heat lightning in tangled bushes' space

Und Sterne, die am feuchten Boden zischen, *And stars that hiss and fizzle in the rushes,*
And stars that hiss on damp ground's face

Das hat man nicht so leicht gesehn. *Are shows that seldom meet the sight.*

That's not easily seen in any place

So musst ihr, ohn' euch viel zu qualen, *Take no great pains, you understand;*

So without straining overmuch

Zuvorderst bitten, dann befehlen. *But first entreat, and then command!*

First beg, then command and such

(Raben ab. Es geschieht alles wie vorgeschrieben.) (Exeunt the Ravens. All takes place as prescribed.)

Irrfunkenblick an allen Enden, *Upon the foe falls Night's thick curtain,*

Will-o'-wisp glances on every side

Ein Leuchten, plötzlich zu verblenden! *And step and march become uncertain!*

A gleaming suddenly to blind

Das alles ware wunderschön, *In every quarter wandering blazes,*

All that would be wonderfully grand

Nun aber braucht's noch Schreckgeton. *And sudden glare, that blinds and dazes!*

But now we need TERROR-SOUND to stand

Faust

Die hohlen Waffen aus der Sale Gruften *All that seems fine; yet we should hear*

The hollow weapons from vault halls of gloom

Empfinden sich erstarkt in freien Luftén; *Their wild, commingled cries of fear.*

Feel strengthened in free air's room

Da droben klappert's, rasselt's lange schon, *The hollow armour from the vaulted chambers*

Up there it's rattled and clattered long

Ein wunderbarer falscher Ton. *In the free air its ancient strength remembers:*

A wondrous false tone's lying song

It rattles there, and clatters all around, – A wonderful, a cheating sound.

Mephistopheles

Ganz recht! Sie sind nicht mehr zu zügeln; *Quite right! The forms there's no restraining:*

Quite right! No restraining them anymore

Schon schallt's von ritterlichen Prügeln, *Already knightly whacks are raining,*

Already sounds the knightly whacking's roar

Wie in der holden alten Zeit. *As in the splendid times of old.*

Like in the dear old days of yore

Armschienen wie der Beine Schienen, *The brassarts there, as well as cuisses,*

Arm-guards and leg-guards evermore

Als Guelfen und als Ghibellinen, *Are Guelfs and Ghibellines; and this is*

As Guelphs and Ghibellines of old

Erneuen rasch den ewigen Streit. *Renewal of the feud they hold.*

Quickly renew eternal strife untold

Fest, im ererbten Sinne wohnlich, *Firm in transmitted hate they anchor,*

Firm in inherited sense, at home they feel

Erweisen sie sich unversöhnlich; *And show implacably their rancour:*

Proving themselves irreconcilable with zeal

Schon klingt das Tosen weit und breit. *Now far and wide the noise hath rolled.*

Already the roar sounds far and wide

Zuletzt, bei allen Teufelsfesten, *At last, the Devils find a hearty*

In the end, at devil's feasts beside

Wirkt der Parteihaß doch zum besten, *Advantage in the hate of Party,*

Party hatred works out for the best

Bis in den allerletzten Graus; *Till dread and ruin end the tale:*

Until the final horror-fest

Schallt wider-widerwartig panisch, *Repulsive sounds of rage and panic,*

Echoes repulsively, panic's sound

Mitunter grell und scharf satanisch, *With others, piercing and Satanic,*

Shrill and sharp, Satanic round

Erschreckend in das Tal hinaus. *Resound along the frightened vale!*

Terrifying into the valley resound!

Kriegerischer Tumult im Orchester, zuletzt ubergehend in militarisch heitre Weisen. Warlike tumult in the Orchestra, finally passing into lively martial measures.

Des Gegenkaisers Zelt / The Rival Emperor's Tent

Act IV, Scene 3

Thron. Reiche Umgebung.

Throne: Rich Surroundings.

Habebald. Eilebeute.

Havequick. Speedbooty.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

So sind wir doch die ersten hier! *O, we are here the first, I see!*

So here we are, the first to score!

Habebald Havequick

Kein Rabe fliegt so schnell als wir. *No raven flies so swift as we.*

No raven's ass could fly here faster.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

O! welch ein Schatz liegt hier zuhau! *O, how the treasure-piles extend!*

O! What a hoard lies heaped like whores!

Wo fang' ich an? Wo hor' ich auf? *Where shall I once begin? where end?*

Where start? Where stop? I'm such a bastard.

Habebald Havequick

Steht doch der ganze Raum so voll! *But all the space is full! And now*

The whole damn room is stuffed with swag!

Weiss nicht, wozu ich greifen soll. *I know not what to take, I vow!*

Don't know which treasure makes me hardest.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Der Teppich war' mir eben recht, *This carpet is the thing I need!*

This carpet here would suit me fine –

Mein Lager ist oft gar zu schlecht. *My couch is often hard indeed.*

My bed's been rough as a porcupine.

Habebald Havequick

Hier hangt von Stahl ein Morgenstern, *Here hangs a morning-star, so strong,*

A morning-star of steel hangs here –

Dergleichen hatt' ich lange gern. *The like of which I've wanted long.*

I've wanted one for half my year.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Den roten Mantel goldgesaumt, *This crimson mantle, bound with gold,*

This crimson cloak with golden seams!

So etwas hatt' ich mir getraut. *Is like the one my dreams foretold.*

It's everything from my wet dreams!

Habebald (*die Waffe nehmend*) **Havequick** (*taking the weapon*)

Damit ist es gar bald getan, *With this, a man is quickly sped;*

With this, a man gets business done –

Man schlägt ihn tot und geht voran. *One strikes him dead, and goes ahead.*

You whack him dead and off you run.

Du hast so viel schon aufgepackt *Thou art already laden so,*

You've piled up so much useless crap,

Und doch nichts Rechtes eingesackt. *And nothing right thy sack can show.*

And nothing good has filled your lap.

Den Plunder lass an seinem Ort, *This rubbish, rather, here forsake,*

Leave all this junk right where it sits,

Nehm' eines dieser Kistchen fort! *And one of yonder caskets take!*

And take one of those chest-like tits!

Dies ist des Heers beschiedner Sold, *The army's modest pay they hold,*

This holds the army's promised pay –

In seinem Bauche lauter Gold. *Their bellies full of purest gold.*

Its belly's full of gold, I say!

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Das hat ein morderisch Gewicht! *O what a murderous weight is there!*

O what a murderous weight this bears!

Ich heb' es nicht, ich trag' es nicht. *I cannot lift it, cannot bear.*

Can't lift it up, can't drag it downstairs.

Habebald Havequick

Geschwinde duck' dich! Musst dich bucken! *Quick, bend and squat to take the pack!*

Quick, squat down low and bend your back!

Ich hucke dir's auf den starken Rucken. *I'll heave it on thy sturdy back.*

I'll heave it onto your sturdy rack.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

O weh! O weh, nun ist's vorbei! *O me! Alack! the burden slips:*

O woe! O woe! Now I am done!

Die Last bricht mir das Kreuz entzwei. *The weight has crushed my back and hips.*

My spine just cracked – weighed half a ton!

Das Kistchen fällt und springt auf. The chest falls and bursts open.

Habebald Havequick

Da liegt das rote Gold zuhauf – *There lies the red gold in a heap!*

There lies the red gold in a heap!

Geschwinde zu und raff es auf! *Quick, rake and take what thou canst keep!*

Quick, rake and grab what you can keep!

Eilebeute (*kauert nieder*) **Speedbooty** (*crouching down*)

Geschwinde nur zum Schoss hinein! *Quick, let the booty fill my lap!*

Quick, let it fill my apron's lap!

Noch immer wird's zur Gnüge sein. *'Twill still be quite enough, mayhap.*

Still plenty here, no need to flap.

Habebald Havequick

Und so genug! und eile doch! *So! there's enough! Now haste, and go!*

Enough now! Hurry, time to split!

(*Sie steht auf.*) (*She rises.*)

O weh, die Schurze hat ein Loch! *The apron has a hole, ah woe!*

O damn! The apron's sprung a slit!

Wohin du gehst und wo du stehst, *Wherever thou dost walk or stand,*

Wherever you walk, wherever you stand,

Verschwenderisch die Schätze sast. *Thou sowest treasure on the land.*

You scatter treasure across the land.

Trabanten unsers Kaisers Guardsmen (*of our Emperor*)

Was schafft ihr hier am heiligen Platz? *What seek ye here with wanton eyes?*

What are you doing at this holy place?

Was kramt ihr in dem Kaiserschatz? *Ye rummage the Imperial prize!*

You're rummaging the Emperor's private space!

Habebald Havequick

Wir trugen unsre Glieder feil *We hazarded our limbs for pay,*

We risked our limbs to earn our pay –

Und holen unser Beuteteil. *And now we take our share of prey.*

Now we're collecting our share of prey.

In Feindeszelten ist's der Brauch, *In hostile tents 'tis always so,*

In enemy tents, that's how it's done!

Und wir, Soldaten sind wir auch. *And we are soldiers too, you know.*

We're soldiers too, we're having fun!

Trabanten Guardsmen

Das passet nicht in unsern Kreis: *Among our troops he comes to grief*

That doesn't fly in our regime –

Zugleich Soldat und Diebsgeschmeiss; *Who's both a soldier and a thief:*

Part soldier, part of a thieving scheme.

Und wer sich unserm Kaiser naht, *Who serves our Emperor fair and free,*

Whoever serves our Emperor true

Der sei ein redlicher Soldat. *Let him an honest soldier be!*

Must be an honest soldier through!

Habebald Havequick

Die Redlichkeit, die kennt man schon, *O yes! such honesty we know:*

Oh yes, we know your "honesty" –

Sie heisset: Kontribution. *'Tis Contribution, – call it so!*

It's called "Contribution" officially!

Ihr alle seid auf gleichem Fuss: *In the same mould you all are made:*

You're all cut from the self-same cloth:

Gib her! das ist der Handwerksgruss. *"Give!" is the password of your trade.*

"Hand it over!" – your solemn oath.

(Zu Eilebeute) (To Speedbooty)

Mach fort und schleppe, was du hast, *With what thou hast, the coast we'll clear:*

Now scam with everything you've snagged –

Hier sind wir nicht willkommen Gast. *As guests we are not welcome here.*

We're clearly guests who shouldn't have gagged.

(Beide ab.) (Exeunt.)

Erster Trabant First Guardsman

Sag, warum gabst du nicht sogleich *Why didst thou not at once bestow*

Why didn't you immediately smack

Dem frechen Kerl einen Backenstreich? *On the scamp's face a smashing blow?*

That cheeky bastard right across his back?

Zweiter Second

Ich weiss nicht, mir verging die Kraft, *I know not, – had not strength to strike;*

I don't know – all my strength just fled;

Sie waren so gespensterhaft. *They seemed to me so phantom-like.*

They seemed like ghosts risen from the dead.

Dritter Third

Mir ward es vor den Augen schlecht, *Something there was disturbed my sight, –*

Something went wrong before my eyes –

Da flimmert' es, ich sah nicht recht. *A flash: I could not see aright.*

A flicker, flash – I couldn't recognize.

Vierter Fourth

Wie ich es nicht zu sagen weiss: *I, also, can declare it not:*

I really cannot tell you how:

Es war den ganzen Tag so heiss, *The whole day long it was so hot,*

The whole day long it was so hot somehow.

So banglich, so beklommen schwul, *So sultry, close, and terrible;*

So anxious, close, oppressively weird,

Der eine stand, der andre fiel, *One man stood firm, another fell;*

One man stood firm, another disappeared.

Man tappte hin und schlug zugleich, *We groped and fought, with valour rash,*

We groped and struck with clumsy might –

Der Gegner fiel vor jedem Streich, *The foemen fell at every slash;*

The enemy fell at every strike.

Vor Augen schwebt' es wie ein Flor, *Before one's eyes there was a mist,*

Before our eyes hung veils of gauze,

Dann summt's und saust's und zischt' im Ohr; *And something roared, and hummed, and hissed;*

Then humming, roaring, hissing buzz – like menopause!

Das ging so fort, nun sind wir da *So to the end, and here are we,*

So on it went, and here we stand,

Und wissen selbst nicht, wie's geschah. *And how it happened, cannot see.*

And have no clue what we just had in hand.

Der Kaiser tritt auf mit vier Fürsten. Die Trabanten entfernen sich.

The Emperor enters, accompanied by Four Princes. The Guardsmen retire.

Kaiser Emperor

Es sei nun, wie ihm sei! uns ist die Schlacht gewonnen, *Now fare he, as he may! For us is won the battle,*

Now let it be as it may be! The battle's won for us!

Des Feinds zerstreute Flucht im flachen Feld zerronnen. *And o'er the plain the foe have fled like frightened cattle.*

The enemy's scattered flight dissolved, without a fuss.

Hier steht der leere Thron, verräterischer Schatz, *The trait'rous treasure, here, the empty throne, we've found,*

Here stands the empty throne – the traitor's treasure-heap!

Von Teppichen umhüllt, verengt umher den Platz. *That, hung with tapestry, contracts the space around.*

With tapestries around, the space is rather steep.

Wir, ehrenvoll geschützt von eigenen Trabanten, *Enthroned in honour we, true guardsmen us protecting,*

We, honorably guarded by our loyal guardsmen here,

Erwarten kaiserlich der Volker Abgesandten; *The people's envoys are imperially expecting.*

Imperially await the envoys drawing near.

Von allen Seiten her kommt frohe Botschaft an: *The messengers of joy arrive from every side,*

From every side arrives glad news upon the breeze:

Beruhigt sei das Reich, uns freudig zugetan. *And, loyal now to us, the realm is pacified.*

The realm is pacified, and eager now to please!

Hat sich in unsern Kampf auch Gaukelei geflochten, *Though in our fight, perchance, some jugglery was woven,*

Though in our fight some jugglery may have been woven in,

Am Ende haben wir uns nur allein gefochten. *Yet, at the last, our own unaided strength we've proven.*

In the end, we fought alone – that's how we win!

Zufälle kommen ja dem Streitenden zugut: *True, accidents sometimes for combatants are good;*

Accidents sometimes aid the man who's in a fight:

Vom Himmel fällt ein Stein, dem Feinde regnet's Blut, *A stone may fall from heaven, on foes a shower of blood;*

A stone may fall from heaven, on foes rain blood at night.

Aus Felsenhöhlen tont's von mächtigen Wunderklängen, *From rocky caves may ring tremendous strains of wonder,*

From rocky caves resound tremendous wondrous songs

Die unsre Brust erhohn, des Feindes Brust verengen. *That lift our hearts with faith, and drive the foe asunder.*

That lift our hearts up high and crush the enemy throngs.

Der überwundene fiel, zu stets erneutem Spott, *The Conquered yielded, scourged by Scorn's immortal rod;*

The conquered fell, to everlasting scorn's new jest;

Der Sieger, wie er prangt, preist den gewognen Gott. *The Victor, as he boasts, exalts the favouring God;*

The victor, as he struts, praises God who blessed!

Und alles stimmt mit ein, er braucht nicht zu befehlen, *And all responsive shout, unordered, unentreated:*

And all join in – he need not even give commands:

Herr Gott, dich loben wir! aus Millionen Kehlen. *"We praise Thee, God our Lord!" from million throats repeated.*

"We praise Thee, Lord our God!" from a million singing hands.

Jedoch zum höchsten Preis wend' ich den frommen Blick, *Yet as the highest praise, so rarely else expressed,*

Yet for the highest praise, I turn my pious eye

Das selten sonst geschah, zur eignen Brust zuruck. *I turn my pious glance on mine own grateful breast.*

Back to my own breast – rare as a virgin's thigh.

Ein junger, munt'rer Furst mag seinen Tag vergeuden, *A young and lively Prince may give his days to pleasure;*

A young and lively prince may waste his days on fun;

Die Jahre lehren ihn des Augenblicks Bedeuten. *Him teach the years, at last the moment's use to measure.*

The years teach him: each moment matters, every one.

Deshalb denn ungesäumt verbind' ich mich sogleich *Therefore, without delay, I call ye, for support,*

Therefore without delay I bind myself to you,

Mit euch vier Wurdigen, fur Haus und Hof und Reich. *Beside me, worthy Four, in realm and house and court.*

Four Worthy ones, for House and Court and Empire true.

(Zum Ersten) (To the First)

Dein war, o Furst! des Heers geordnet kluge Schichtung, *Thine was, O Prince! the host's arrangement, wise inspection,*

Yours was, O Prince, the army's wise deployment,

Sodann im Hauptmoment heroisch kuhne Richtung; *Then, in the nick of time, heroic, bold direction:*

Then at the crucial moment, bold enjoyment!

Im Frieden wirke nun, wie es die Zeit begehrt, *Act now in peace, as Time thine offices may show!*

In peace now work as Time makes its demands –

Erzmarschall nenn' ich dich, verleihe dir das Schwert. *Arch-Marshal shalt thou be: the sword I here bestow.*

Arch-Marshal I name you, sword placed in your hands!

Erzmarschall Arch-Marshal

Dein treues Heer, bis jetzt im Innern beschafftigt, *Thy faithful host, till now employed for civil order,*

Your faithful host, till now for civil order raised,

Wenn's dich und deinen Thron an der Grenze bekräftigt: *Thee and thy throne secured, shall strengthen next thy border:*

Securing you and throne, shall guard the border, praised.

Dann sei es uns vergonnt, bei Festesdrang im Saal *Then let us be allowed, when festal throngs are poured*

Then let us be allowed, when festive crowds fill the hall

Geraumiger Vaterburg zu rusten dir das Mahl. *Through thine ancestral halls, to dress for thee the board.*

Of your ancestral castle, to prepare your banquet call!

Blank trag' ich's dir dann vor, blank halt' ich dir's zur Seite, *Before thee brightly borne, and brightly held beside thee,*

Bright I'll bear it before you, bright keep it at your side,

Der höchsten Majestat zu ewigem Geleite. *Thy Majesty's support, the sword shall guard and guide thee!*

Forever escorting your Majesty with pride!

Kaiser (zum Zweiten) **Emperor** (to the Second)

Der sich als tapfrer Mann auch zart gefällig zeigt, *He who as gallant man can also gracious be,*

He who's a gallant man yet shows a graceful touch –

Du! sei Erzkammerer; der Auftrag ist nicht leicht. *Thou, – be Arch-Chamberlain! – not light the place, for thee.*

You! Be Arch-Chamberlain – the task is quite a clutch!

Du bist der Oberste von allem Hausgesinde, *Thou art the highest now of all the house-retainers*

You're now supreme over all the household pack,

Bei deren innerm Streit ich schlechte Diener finde; *Whose strife makes service bad, – the threateners and complainers:*

Whose inner strife makes servants lazy and slack.

Dein Beispiel sei fortan in Ehren aufgestellt, *Let thy example be an honoured sign to these,*

Let your example be a beacon raised on high,

Wie man dem Herrn, dem Hof und allen wohlgefällt. *How they the Prince and Court, and all, should seek to please!*

Showing how to please lord and court, by and by!

Erzkammerer Arch-Chamberlain

Des Herren grossen Sinn zu fordern, bringt zu Gnaden: *To speed thy high design, thy grace is fair precursor:*

To further your great purpose brings me into grace:

Den Besten hilfreich sein, den Schlechten selbst nicht schaden, *The Better to assist, and injure not the Worser, –*

Help the better ones, don't harm the worse – save face!

Dann klar sein ohne List und ruhig ohne Trug! *Be frank, yet cunning not, and calm without deceit!*

Be clear without deceit, calm without a lie –

Wenn du mich, Herr, durchschaust, geschieht mir schon genug. *If thou but read my heart, I'm honoured as is meet.*

If you see through me, Lord, that's satisfaction I can't deny!

Darf sich die Phantasie auf jenes Fest erstrecken? *But let my fancy now to festal service hasten!*

May my imagination stretch to that festive day?

Wenn du zur Tafel gehst, reich' ich das goldne Becken, *Thou goest to the board, I bear the golden basin,*

When you go to table, I'll bring the golden tray,

Die Ringe halt' ich dir, damit zur Wonnezeit *And hold thy rings for thee, that on such blissful days*

And hold your rings for you, so in that blissful hour

Sich deine Hand erfrischt, wie mich dein Blick erfreut. *Thy hands may be refreshed, as I beneath thy gaze.*

Your hand refreshes as I bask beneath your power!

Kaiser Emperor

Zwar fühl' ich mich zu ernst, auf Festlichkeit zu sinnen, *Too serious am I still, to plan such celebration;*

I feel too serious still to plan festivities –

Doch sei's! Es fordert auch frohmütiges Beginnen. *Yet be it so! We need a glad inauguration.*

Yet be it so! We need glad ceremonies to appease.

(Zum Dritten) (To the Third)

Dich wahl' ich zum Erztruchsess! Also sei fortan *I choose thee Arch-High-Steward! Therefore henceforth be*

I choose you Arch-High-Steward! From now on, let there be

Dir Jagd, Geflügelhof und Vorwerk untertan; *Chase, poultry-yard, and manor subject unto thee!*

Hunt, poultry-yard, and manor subject unto thee!

Der Lieblingsspeisen Wahl lass mir zu allen Zeiten, *Give me at all times choice of dishes I delight in,*

Give me my favorite dishes every time I dine,

Wie sie der Monat bringt, und sorgsam zubereiten. *As with the month they come, and cooked with appetite in!*

As seasons bring them round, prepared and tasting fine!

Erztruchsess Arch-High-Steward

Streng Fasten sei für mich die angenehmste Pflicht, *A rigid fast shall be the penalty I wish,*

Strict fasting shall become my most pleasant duty here –

Bis, vor dich hingestellt, dich freut ein Wohlgericht. *Until before thee stands a goodly-savoured dish.*

Until before you stands a dish you'll want to smear.

Der Kuche Dienerschaft soll sich mit mir vereinigen, *The kitchen-folk shall join, and gladly heed my reasons*

The kitchen staff shall join with me in harmony

Das Ferne beizuziehn, die Jahrszeit zu beschleunigen. *To bring the distant near and expedite the seasons.*

To bring what's far nearby and speed the seasons' spree!

Dich reizt nicht Fern und Fruh, womit die Tafel prangt, *Yet rare and early things shall not delight thee long:*

Yet rare and early things won't tickle you for long:

Einfach und kraftig ist's, wornach dein Sinn verlangt. *Thy taste desires, instead, the simple and the strong.*

You want it simple, hearty – nothing fancy, nothing wrong.

Kaiser (*zum Vierten*) **Emperor** (*to the Fourth*)

Weil unausweichlich hier sich's nur von Festen handelt, *Since here, perforce, we plan but feasts, and each is sharer,*

Since unavoidably we're dealing just with feasts,

So sei mir, junger Held, zum Schenken umgewandelt. *Be thou for me transformed, young hero, to Cup-bearer!*

You, young hero, transform to Cup-Bearer at least!

Erzschenke, Sorge nun, dass unsre Kellerei *Arch Cup-Bearer, take heed, that all those vaults of mine*

Arch Cup-Bearer, take care that our cellar stocks

Aufs reichlichste versorgt mit gutem Weine sei. *Richly replenished be with noblest taps of wine!*

Are most abundantly supplied with wine that rocks!

Du selbst sei massig, lass nicht über Heiterkeiten *Be temperate thyself, howe'er temptation presses,*

Be temperate yourself – don't let the merriment

Durch der Gelegenheit Verlocken dich verleiten! *Nor let occasion's lure mislead thee to excesses!*

And opportunity's temptations make you bent!

Erzschenk Arch Cup-Bearer

Mein Fürst, die Jugend selbst, wenn man ihr nur vertraut, *My Prince, the young themselves, if trust in them be shown,*

My Prince, the young themselves, if given trust their due,

Steht, eh' man sich's versieht, zu Mannern auferbaut. *Are, ere one looks around, already men full-grown.*

Grow into proper men before you can say "boo!"

Auch ich versetze mich zu jenem grossen Feste; *I at the lordly feast shall also take my station,*

I too will take my station at that grand affair –

Ein kaiserlich Bufett schmuck' ich aufs allerbeste *And give thy sideboard's pomp the noblest decoration*

The Emperor's buffet I'll deck with utmost care,

Mit Prachtgefassen, gulden, silbern allzumal, *Of gorgeous vessels, golden, silver, grand to see;*

With gorgeous vessels, golden, silver, all in rows –

Doch wahl' ich dir voraus den lieblichsten Pokal: *Yet first the fairest cup will I select for thee, –*

Yet first the fairest cup for you I shall propose:

Ein blank venedisch Glas, worin Behagen lauschet, *A clear Venetian glass, good cheer within it waiting,*

A bright Venetian glass, where comfort lies in wait,

Des Weins Geschmack sich starkt und nimmermehr berauschet. *Helping the taste of wine, yet ne'er intoxicating.*

That strengthens wine's good taste and never inebriates!

Auf solchen Wunderschatz vertraut man oft zu sehr; *One oft confides too much on such a treasured store:*

One often trusts too much in such a wondrous store –

Doch deine Massigkeit, du Hochster, schützt noch mehr. *Thy moderation, though, High Lord, protects thee more.*

But your moderation, High Lord, protects you more!

Kaiser Emperor

Was ich euch zugedacht in dieser ernsten Stunde, *What, in this earnest hour, for you have I intended,*

What I've intended for you in this earnest hour,

Vernahmt ihr mit Vertraun aus zuverlässigem Munde. *From valid mouth confidingly you've comprehended.*

You've heard with confidence from my mouth of power.

Des Kaisers Wort ist gross und sichert jede Gift, *The Emperor's word is great, his gift is therefore sure,*

The Emperor's word is great, it makes each gift secure –

Doch zur Bekräftigung bedarf's der edlen Schrift, *But needs, for proper force, his written signature:*

But it needs noble writing to make it endure,

Bedarf's der Signatur. Die formlich zu bereiten, *The high sign-manual fails. Here, for commission needful,*

Needs the signature. To prepare it with due form,

Seh' ich den rechten Mann zu rechter Stunde schreiten. *I see the right man come, of the right moment heedful.*

I see the right man come through the right moment's storm.

Der Erzbischof-Erzkanzler tritt auf.

The Archbishop-Arch-Chancellor enters.

Kaiser Emperor

Wenn ein Gewölbe sich dem Schlussstein anvertraut, *If in the keystone of the arch the vault confide,*

When a vault entrusts itself to its keystone's embrace,

Dann ist's mit Sicherheit für ewige Zeit erbaut. *'Tis then securely built, for endless time and tide.*

It's built securely then for all time and space.

Du siehst vier Fürsten da! Wir haben erst erörtert, *Thou seest Four Princes here! To them we've just expounded*

You see Four Princes here! We've just laid out the plan

Was den Bestand zunächst von Haus und Hof befördert. *How next our House and Court shall be more stably founded.*

For House and Court's foundations – best we can.

Nun aber, was das Reich in seinem Ganzen hegt, *Now, all the realm contains, within its bounds enclosed,*

Now all the realm contains, within its borders penned,

Sei, mit Gewicht und Kraft, der Funfzahl auferlegt. *Shall be, with weight and power, upon Ye Five imposed!*

Shall be, with weight and power, to you Five to tend!

An Landern sollen sie vor allen andern glänzen; *Your landed wealth shall be before all others splendid;*

In lands you shall shine brighter than all the rest –

Deshalb erweitr' ich gleich jetzt des Besitztums Grenzen *Therefore at once have I your properties extended*

Therefore I've extended your estates, the best,

Vom Erbteil jener, die sich von uns abgewandt. *From their inheritance, who raised 'gainst us the hand.*

From the inheritance of those who raised their hand!

Euch Treuen sprech' ich zu so manches schöne Land, *You I award, ye Faithful, many a lovely land,*

To you, the Faithful, I award many a lovely land,

Zugleich das hohe Recht, euch nach Gelegenheiten *Together with the right, as you may have occasion,*

Together with the right, as opportunity is lent,

Durch Anfall, Kauf und Tausch ins Weitre zu verbreiten; *To spread them by exchange, or purchase, or invasion:*

To spread by purchase, trade, or – accident!

Dann sei bestimmt – vergonnt, zu uben ungestort –, *Then be it clearly fixed, that you unhindered use*

Then be it clearly fixed: you freely may apply

Was von Gerechtsamen euch Landesherrn gehort. *Whate'er prerogatives have been the landlord's dues.*

Whatever landlord's prerogatives lie nearby.

Als Richter werdet ihr die Endurteile fallen, *When ye, as Judges, have the final sentence spoken,*

As judges you shall speak the final word of law –

Berufung gelte nicht von euern höchsten Stellen. *By no appeal from your high Court shall it be broken;*

From your high courts no appeal shall draw!

Dann Steuer, Zins und Beth', Lehn und Geleit und Zoll, *Then levies, tax and rent, pass-money, tolls and fees*

Levies, tax and rent, tolls, escort fees and such,

Berg-, Salz- und Munzregal euch angehoren soll. *Are yours, – of mines and salt and coin the royalties.*

Mine, salt, and coinage rights – you'll control all this much.

Denn meine Dankbarkeit vollgultig zu erproben, *That thus my gratitude may validly be stated,*

That thus my gratitude may fully be displayed,

Hab ich euch ganz zunachst der Majestat erhoben. *You next to Majesty hereby I've elevated.*

I've raised you next to Majesty – quite the upgrade!

Erzbischof Archbishop

Im Namen aller sei dir tiefster Dank gebracht! *In deepest thanks to thee we humbly all unite:*

In deepest thanks we humbly all unite to say:

Du machst uns stark und fest und starkest deine Macht. *Thou mak'st us strong and sure, and strengthenest thy might.*

You make us strong and sure, and strengthen your own sway!

Kaiser Emperor

Euch funfen will ich noch erhohtere Wurde geben. *Yet higher dignities I give for your fulfilling.*

Yet higher dignities I give you to fulfill –

Noch leb' ich meinem Reich und habe Lust, zu leben; *Still for my realm I live, and still to live am willing;*

Still for my realm I live, and live I surely will!

Doch hoher Ahnen Kette zieht bedachtigen Blick *Yet old ancestral lines compel the prudent mind*

Yet old ancestral chains draw the prudent mind

Aus rascher Strebsamkeit ins Drohende zuruck. *To look from present deeds to that which looms behind.*

From present rashness to what looms behind.

Auch werd' ich seinerzeit mich von den Teuren trennen, *I, also, in my time, must meet the sure Redresser;*

I too shall someday part from those I hold so dear –

Dann sei es eure Pflicht, den Folger zu ernennen. *Your duty be it, then, to choose me a successor.*

Then be your duty to name my successor here!

Gekront erhebt ihn hoch auf heiligem Altar, *Crowned, at the altar raise his consecrated form,*

Crowned, at the altar raise his consecrated head,

Und friedlich ende dann, was jetzt so sturmisch war. *That so may end in peace what here began in storm!*

And peacefully shall end what stormily was led!

Erzkanzler Arch-Chancellor

Mit Stolz in tiefster Brust, mit Demut an Gebarde, *With pride profound, yet humbly, as our guise evinces,*

With pride profound, yet humble in our stance displayed,

Stehn Fursten dir gebeugt, die ersten auf der Erde. *Behold, before thee bowed, the first of earthly princes!*

Stand princes bowed, the first ones Earth has ever made!

Solang das treue Blut die vollen Adern regt, *So long the faithful blood our living veins shall fill,*

So long as faithful blood flows through our living veins,

Sind wir der Korper, den dein Wille leicht bewegt. *We are the body which obeys thy lightest will.*

We are the body that your will's light touch explains.

Kaiser Emperor

Und also sei, zum Schluss, was wir bisher betatigt, *Now, to conclude, let all that we have here asserted,*

To conclude, let all we've here affirmed today

Für alle Folgezeit durch Schrift und Zug bestätigt. *Be, for the future time, to document converted!*

Be confirmed in writing for all future sway!

Zwar habt ihr den Besitz als Herren völlig frei, *'Tis true that ye, as lords, have your possession free,*

True, you as lords possess your holdings free and wide,

Mit dem Beding jedoch, dass er unteilbar sei. *With this condition, though, that it unparcelled be;*

With this condition though: they cannot be divided.

Und wie ihr auch vermehrt, was ihr von uns empfangen, *And what ye have from us, howe'er ye swell the treasure,*

And what you have from us, however much you add,

Es soll's der altste Sohn in gleichem Mass erlangen. *Shall to the eldest son descend in equal measure.*

Shall to the eldest son descend – the same as dad!

Erzkanzler Arch-Chancellor

Dem Pergament alsbald vertrau' ich wohlgemut, *On parchment I, at once, shall gladly tabulate,*

On parchment I at once shall happily inscribe –

Zum Glück dem Reich und uns, das wichtigste Statut; *To bless the realm and us, the statute of such weight:*

For realm and us alike – this statute's crucial vibe.

Reinschrift und Sieglung soll die Kanzlei beschafften, *The copy and the seals the Chancery shall procure us,*

The copy and the seals the Chancery shall prepare;

Mit heiliger Signatur wirst du's, der Herr, bekräftigen. *Thy sacred hand shall then validity assure us.*

Your sacred signature shall validate it there!

Kaiser Emperor

Und so entlass' ich euch, damit den grossen Tag *Dismissal now I grant, that you, assembled, may*

So I dismiss you now, that everyone may weigh

Gesammelt jedermann sich überlegen mag. *Deliberate upon the great, important day.*

In quiet contemplation this momentous day.

Die weltlichen Fürsten entfernen sich.

The Secular Princes retire.

Der Geistliche (*bleibt und spricht pathetisch*) **Archbishop** (*remains and speaks pathetically*)

Der Kanzler ging hinweg, der Bischof ist geblieben, *The Chancellor withdrew, the Bishop stands before thee:*

The Chancellor withdrew, the Bishop stays with you –

Vom ernsten Warnegeist zu deinem Ohr getrieben! *A warning spirit bids that straightway he implore thee:*

A warning spirit drives him to speak what's true!

Sein vaterliches Herz, von Sorge bangt's um dich. *His heart paternal quakes with anxious fear for thee.*

His fatherly heart trembles with anxious fear for thee.

Kaiser Emperor

Was hast du Bangliches zur frohen Stunde? sprich! *In this glad hour what may thy dread misgiving be?*

What dread in this glad hour? Speak your misery!

Erzbischof Archbishop

Mit welchem bitterm Schmerz find' ich, in dieser Stunde, *Alas, in such an hour, how much my pain must greaten,*

With what bitter pain I find, at such a time,

Dein hochgeheiligt Haupt mit Satanas im Bunde! *To find thy hallowed head in covenant with Satan!*

Your sacred head bound up with Satan's grime!

Zwar, wie es scheinen will, gesichert auf dem Thron, *True, to the throne, it seems, hast thou secured thy right;*

True, to the throne it seems you've secured your right –

Doch leider! Gott dem Herrn, dem Vater Papst zum Hohn. *But, woe! in God the Lord's, the Holy Pontiff's spite.*

But alas! In spite of God and Holy Pontiff's might!

Wenn dieser es erfahrt, schnell wird er straflich richten, *Swift shall he punish when he learns the truth – the latter:*

When he learns this, swift punishment he'll render –

Mit heiligem Strahl dein Reich, das sundige, zu vernichten. *Thy sinful realm at once with holy ban he'll shatter!*

With holy lightning strike your sinful realm to cinder!

Denn noch vergass er nicht, wie du, zur höchsten Zeit, *He still remembers how, amid thy highest state,*

He still recalls how you, in your highest state,

An deinem Kronungstag, den Zauberer befreit. *When newly crowned, thou didst the wizard liberate.*

On coronation day, set the wizard liberate!

Von deinem Diadem, der Christenheit zum Schaden, *Thy diadem but made thy heart for Christians harden,*

From your diadem – Christians' bane and loss –

Traf das verfluchte Haupt der erste Strahl der Gnaden. *For on that head accurst fell its first beam of pardon.*

That cursed head received the first beam of grace across!

Doch schlag an deine Brust und gib vom frevlen Gluck *Now beat thy breast, and from thy guilty stores, this day,*

Now beat your breast and from your guilty pile today

Ein massig Scherflein gleich dem Heiligtum zuruck: *Unto the Sanctuary a moderate mite repay!*

Return a moderate mite to the Sanctuary's sway!

Den breiten Hugelraum, da, wo dein Zelt gestanden, *The spacious sweep of hills, where stood thy tent erected, –*

The spacious sweep of hills where your tent once stood –

Wo bese Geister sich zu deinem Schutz verbanden, *Where Evil Spirits then, united, thee protected, –*

Where Evil Spirits joined to do you good –

Dem Lugenfursten du ein horchsam Ohr geliehn, *Where late the Liar-Prince thy hearing did secure,*
–

Where you lent the Liar-Prince an attentive ear:

Den stifte, fromm belehrt, zu heiligem Bemuhn; *Devote thou, meekly taught, to pious use and pure,*

Devote it, meekly taught, to holy purpose dear!

Mit Berg und dichtem Wald, so weit sie sich erstrecken, *With hill and forest dense, far as they stretch extended,*

With hill and forest dense, as far as they extend,

Mit Hohen, die sich grun zu fetter Weide decken, *And slopes that greenly swell for pastures never ended,*

With slopes that green to fatty pastures bend,

Fischreichen, klaren Seen, dann Bachlein ohne Zahl, *Then crystal lakes of fish, unnumbered brooks that flow*

Fish-rich crystal lakes, and brooks beyond all count,

Wie sie sich, eilig schlangelnd, sturzen ab zu Tal; *In foamy windings down, and braid the vale below;*

That serpent-swift go tumbling down the mount!

Das breite Tal dann selbst, mit Wiesen, Gauen, Grunden: *The broad vale then, itself, with mead, and lawn, and hollow!*

The broad vale too, with meadows, dales, and grounds –

Die Reue spricht sich aus, und du wirst Gnade finden. *Thus penitence is shown, and pardon soon shall follow.*

Thus penitence speaks out, and pardon then resounds!

Kaiser Emperor

Durch meinen schweren Fehl bin ich so tief erschreckt: *For this, my heavy sins, my terror is profound:*

By my grave sin I'm terrified this much:

Die Grenze sei von dir nach deinem Sinn gesteckt. *By thine own measure shalt thou draw the borders round.*

You draw the borders yourself – your holy touch!

Erzbischof Archbishop

Erst! der entweihte Raum, wo man sich so versündigt, *First be the spot profane, where sin was perpetrated,*

First! Let the profaned space where sin was wrought

Sei alsobald zum Dienst des Hochsten angekündigt. *To God's high service soon and wholly dedicated!*

Be soon to God's high service brought!

Behende steigt im Geist Gemauer stark empor, *With speed the walls arise to meet the mind's desire;*

In spirit, sturdy walls rise swift and strong –

Der Morgensonne Blick erleuchtet schon das Chor, *The rising morning sun already lights the choir;*

The morning sun's first glance lights the choir along!

Zum Kreuz erweitert sich das wachsende Gebaude, *The growing structure spreads, the transept stands exalted;*

The growing structure stretches to a cross's shape,

Das Schiff erlangt, erhoht sich zu der Glaubigen Freude; *Joy of Believers, then, the nave is lifted, vaulted;*

The nave extends and lifts – believers agape!

Sie stromen brünstig schon durchs würdige Portal, *And while they press with zeal within the portals grand,*

They stream in ardently through portals grand and fair –

Der erste Glockenruf erscholl durch Berg und Tal, *The first clear call of bells is swept across the land,*

The first bell-call resounds through valley and mountain air,

Von hohen Turmen tont's, wie sie zum Himmel streben, *Pealed from the lofty towers that heavenwards have striven:*

From towers high that strive toward heaven's door –

Der Busser kommt heran zu neugeschaffnem Leben. *The penitent draws near, new life to him is given.*

The penitent approaches life reborn once more!

Dem hohen Weihetag – er trete bald herein! – *The consecration-day – O, may it soon be sent! –*

The consecration day – may it soon arrive! –

Wird deine Gegenwart die höchste Zierde sein. *Thy presence then shall be the highest ornament.*

Your presence there shall be the highest thing alive!

Kaiser Emperor

Mag ein so grosses Werk den frommen Sinn verkundigen, *So great a work shall be my pious proclamation*

May so great a work my pious heart proclaim,

Zu preisen Gott den Herrn, so wie mich zu entsundigen. *To praise the Lord our God, and work mine expiation.*

To praise the Lord our God and cleanse my shame!

Genug! Ich fühle schon, wie sich mein Sinn erhoht. *Enough! I feel, e'en now, how high my thoughts aspire.*

Enough! I feel already how my soul takes flight!

Erzbischof Archbishop

Als Kanzler fordr' ich nun Schluss und Formalitat. *As Chancellor, next, the formal treaty I require.*

As Chancellor, I now require proper form and rite.

Kaiser Emperor

Ein formlich Dokument, der Kirche das zu eignen, *A formal document, – the Church needs full requital,*

A formal document – the Church needs satisfaction –

Du legst es vor, ich will's mit Freuden unterzeichnen. *Bring it to me, and I with joy will sign her title!*

Bring it to me! I'll sign with joyful action!

Erzbischof (*hat sich beurlaubt, kehrt aber beim Abgehn noch einmal um*) **Archbishop** (*has taken leave, but turns back again at the door*)

Dann widmest du zugleich dem Werke, wie's entsteht, *At once unto the work devote, that it may stand,*

Then dedicate at once, for the work as it grows,

Gesamte Landsgefalle: Zehnten, Zinsen, Beth', *Tithes, levies, tax, – the total income of the land,*

All regional revenues – tithes, interest, those –

Für ewig. Viel bedarf's zu würdiger Unterhaltung, *For ever. Much it needs, to be supported fairly,*

Forever! Much it needs for worthy maintenance,

Und schwere Kosten macht die sorgliche Verwaltung. *And careful maintenance will also cost us rarely:*

And heavy costs accrue from careful surveillance.

Zum schnellen Aufbau selbst auf solchem wusten Platz *And, that it soon be built, on such a lonesome wold,*

For quick construction on such a wasteland site,

Reichst du uns einiges Gold, aus deinem Beuteschatz. *Thou'lt from thy booty spare to us some little gold.*

From your booty you'll spare us gold – just a slight!

Daneben braucht man auch, ich kann es nicht verschweigen, *Moreover, we shall want – here, most, we claim assistance –*

Moreover we shall need – I cannot hide this fact –

Entferntes Holz und Kalk und Schiefer und dergleichen. *Lumber, and lime, and slate, and suchlike, from a distance.*

Distant timber, lime, and slate, exact.

Die Führen tut das Volk, vom Predigtstuhl belehrt, *The people these shall haul, thus from the pulpit taught;*

The people will haul these, from the pulpit told –

Die Kirche segnet den, der ihr zu Diensten fährt. *The Church shall bless the man, whose team for her has wrought.*

The Church blesses whoever helps her household!

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Kaiser Emperor

Die Sund' ist gross und schwer, womit ich mich beladen; *The sin is very sore, wherewith my soul is weighted:*

The sin is grave and sore with which I'm weighted down –

Das leidige Zaubervolk bringt mich in harten Schaden. *Much damage unto me the Sorcerers have created.*

The wretched magic-folk have cost me crown after crown!

Erzbischof *(nochmals zuruckkehrend, mit tiefster Verbeugung)* **Archbishop** *(returning once again, with profoundest genuflections)*

Verzeih, o Herr! Es ward dem sehr verrufenen Mann *Pardon, O Prince! to him, that vile, notorious man,*

Forgive, O Lord! That very notorious man –

Des Reiches Strand verliehn; doch diesen trifft der Bann, *The Empire's coast was given; but him shall smite the ban,*

The Empire's coast was given him! But the ban

Verleihst du reuig nicht der hohen Kirchenstelle *Unless thy penitence the Church's wrath relaxes*

Shall strike, unless your penitence makes room

Auch dort den Zehnten, Zins und Gaben und Gefalle. *There, too, with tithes and gifts, and revenues and taxes.*

For tithes and gifts and revenues to bloom!

Kaiser (*verdrießlich*) **Emperor** (*ill-humouredly*)

Das Land ist noch nicht da, im Meer liegt es breit. *The land doth not exist: far in the sea it lies.*

The land's not even there – it's floating in the sea!

Erzbischof **Archbishop**

Wer's Recht hat und Geduld, für den kommt auch die Zeit. *Who patient is, and right, his day shall yet arise.*

Who has the right and patience, his day comes eventually!

Für uns mög' Euer Wort in seinen Kräften bleiben! *Your word for us remains, and makes secure our trove!*

May your word for us remain in all its power!

(*Ab.*) (*Exit.*)

Kaiser (*allein*) **Emperor** (*solus*)

So konnt' ich wohl zunächst das ganze Reich verschreiben. *I might as well, at last, make all the Empire over!*

I might as well sign over the whole Empire this hour!

Fünfter Akt / Act V

Offene Gegend / Open Country

Wandrer *Wanderer*

Ja! sie sind's, die dunkeln Linden,

Yes! 'tis they, the dusky lindens;

Yes! They're them, the dark lindens,

Dort, in ihres Alters Kraft.

There they stand in sturdy age:

Holy shit, the trees are still here,

Und ich soll sie wiederfinden,

And again shall I behold them,

Standing thick in their old strength.

Nach so langer Wanderschaft!

After such a pilgrimage?

I actually found them again

Ist es doch die alte Stelle,

'Tis the ancient place, the drifted

After all this wandering.

Jene Hutte, die mich barg,

Downs, the hut that sheltered me,

It is still the old place,

Als die sturmerregte Welle

When the billow, storm-uplifted,

That hut that held my body safe,

Mich an jene Dunen warf!

Hurled me shoreward from the sea!

When the storm-crazed waves

Meine Wirte mocht' ich segnen,

Here with blessing would I greet them,

Spat me onto these dunes.

Hilfsbereit, ein wackres Paar,

They, my hosts, the helpful pair, –

My hosts I would like to bless,

Das, um heut mir zu begegnen,

Old, indeed, if now I meet them,

Ready to help, a solid couple,

Alt schon jener Tage war.

Since they then had hoary hair.

Who, to meet me today,

Ach! das waren fromme Leute!

Pious folk, from whom I parted!

Were already ancient back then.

Poch' ich? ruf' ich? – Seid gegrusst,

Be my greeting here renewed,

Oh! Those were good people!

Wenn gastfreundlich auch noch heute

If ye still, as open-hearted,

Should I knock? Should I yell? Greetings!

Ihr des Wohltuns Gluck genießt!

Taste the bliss of doing good!

If hospitably still today

Baucis

Lieber Kommling! Leise! Leise!

Gently, stranger! lest thou cumber

You enjoy doing good deeds!

Ruhe! lass den Gatten ruhn!

Rest, whereof my spouse hath need!

Dear stranger! Softly! Softly!

Langer Schlaf verleiht dem Greise

He but gains from longest slumber

Quiet! Let the old man rest!

Kurzen Wachens rasches Tun.

Strength for briefest waking deed.

Long sleep gives the geezer

Wandrer

Sage, Mutter: bist du's eben,

Tell me, mother, art thou even

Short bursts of waking action.

Meinen Dank noch zu empfahn,

She, to whom my thanks I bear,–

Tell me, mother, are you the one

Was du fur des Junglings Leben

I, the youth, whose life was given

Still here to receive my thanks,

Mit dem Gatten einst getan?

By your kind, united care?

For what you did for my young life

Bist du Baucis, die geschäftig

Art thou Baucis, who the coldly

Together with your husband?

Halberstorbenen Mund erquickt?

Fading mouth refreshment gave?

Are you Baucis, who busily

Du Philemon, der so kraftig

Thou, Philemon, who so boldly

Revived my half-dead mouth?

Meinen Schatz der Flut entrückt?

Drew my treasure from the wave?

You Philemon, who so strongly

Eure Flammen raschen Feuers,

From your fire, so quickly burning,

Pulled my treasure from the flood?

Eures Glockchens Silberlaut,

From your silver-sounding bell,

Your quick-burning flames,

Jenes grausen Abenteuers

Changed my doom, to fortune turning,

Your little bell's silver sound,

Losung war euch anvertraut.

When the dread adventure fell.

That gruesome adventure's

Und nun lasst hervor mich treten,
Forth upon the sand-hills stealing,
Resolution was trusted to you.
Schaun das grenzenlose Meer;
Let me view the boundless sea!
And now let me step forward,
Lasst mich knieen, lasst mich beten,
Let me pray, devoutly kneeling,
To see the boundless sea;
Mich bedrängt die Brust so sehr.
Till my burdened heart be free!
Let me kneel, let me pray,

Philemon

Eile nur, den Tisch zu decken,
Haste, and let the meal be dighted
My chest is so heavy with feeling.
Wo's im Gartchen munter blüht.
'Neath the garden's blooming trees!
Hurry to set the table
Lass ihn rennen, ihn erschrecken,
Let him go, and be affrighted!
Where it blooms nicely in the garden.
Denn er glaubt nicht, was er sieht.
He'll believe not what he sees.
Let him run, let him freak out,
Das Euch grimmig missgehandelt,
Where the savage waves maltreated
He won't believe what he sees.
Wog' auf Woge, schaumend wild,
You, on shores of breaking foam,
What once savagely mistreated you,

Seht als Garten Ihr behandelt,
See, a garden lies completed,
Wave upon wave, foaming wild,
 Seht ein paradiesisch Bild.
Like an Eden-dream of home!
See it now as a tended garden,
 Alter, war ich nicht zuhanden,
Old was I, no longer eager,
See a paradise picture.
 Hulfreich nicht wie sonst bereit;
Helpful, as the younger are:
Getting old, I wasn't around,
 Und wie meine Krafte schwanden,
And when I had lost my vigour,
Helpful like I used to be;
 War auch schon die Woge weit.
Also was the wave afar.
And as my strength faded,
 Kluger Herren kuhne Knechte
Wise lords set their serfs in motion,
So too the waves pushed back.
 Gruben Graben, dammten ein,
Dikes upraised and ditches led,
Smart masters sent bold servants
 Schmalerten des Meeres Rechte,
Minishing the rights of Ocean,
Digging ditches, building dikes,
 Herrn an seiner Statt zu sein.
Lords to be in Ocean's stead.
Diminishing the sea's rights,
 Schaue grunend Wies' an Wiese,
See the green of many a meadow,

To be lords in Ocean's place.

Anger, Garten, Dorf und Wald. –

Field and garden, wood and town!

See green meadow after meadow,

Komm nun aber und genieße,

Come, our table waits in shadow!

Pasture, garden, village, woods.

Denn die Sonne scheidet bald. –

For the sun is going down.

But come now and enjoy,

Dort im Fernsten ziehen Segel,

Sails afar are gliding yonder;

For the sun's going down soon.

Suchen nachtllich sichern Port.

Nightly to the port they fare:

Out there in the distance sails glide,

Kennen doch ihr Nest die Vogel;

To their nest the sea-birds wander,

Seeking a safe port for night.

Denn jetzt ist der Hafen dort.

For a harbour waits them there.

The birds know their nest;

So erblickst du in der Weite

Distant now, thou hardly seest

The harbor's right there now.

Erst des Meeres blauen Saum,

Where the sea's blue arc is spanned,–

So you see in the distance

Rechts und links, in aller Breite,

Right and left, the broadest, freest

First the sea's blue hem,

Dichtgedrängt bewohnten Raum.

Stretch of thickly-peopled land.

Right and left, in all its breadth,

Baucis

Bleibst du stumm? und keinen Bissen

Art thou dumb? Of all we've brought here

Densely peopled living space.

Bringst du zum verletzten Mund?

In thy mouth shall nothing fall?

You stay silent? Not a bite

Philemon

Mocht' er doch vom Wunder wissen;

He would know the marvel wrought here;

To your parched mouth?

Sprichst so gerne, tu's ihm kund.

Fain thou speakest: tell him all!

Nothing passing those dry lips?

Baucis

Wohl! ein Wunder ist's gewesen!

'Twas a marvel, if there's any!

He wants to know about the miracle;

Lasst mich heut noch nicht in Ruh;

And the thought disturbs me still:

You love to talk, so tell him!

Denn es ging das ganze Wesen

In a business so uncanny

Indeed! A miracle it was!

Nicht mit rechten Dingen zu.

Surely helped the Powers of Ill.

It still doesn't let me rest;

Philemon

Tat's ein Herold nicht verkundigen

Can the Emperor's soul be perilled,

Because the whole operation

Schmetternd im Voruberziehen?

Who on him the strand bestowed?

Wasn't done by proper means.

Nicht entfernt von unsern Dunen

Gave the mandate not the herald,

Didn't a herald announce it,

Ward der erste Fuss gefasst,

Trumpeting, as on he rode?

Blaring as he passed by?

Zelte, Hutten! – Doch im Grunen

Near our downs, all unexpected,

Not far from our dunes

Richtet bald sich ein Palast.

Was the work's beginning seen,

The first foothold was set,

Tents and huts!—but, soon erected,

Rose a palace o'er the green.

Tents, huts! But in the green

Baucis

Tags umsonst die Knechte larmten,

Knives in vain by day were storming,

Soon rose a palace.

Hack' und Schaufel, Schlag um Schlag;

Plying pick and spade alike;

Days the servants made noise in vain,

Wo die Flammchen nachtig schwarmten,

Where the fires at night were swarming,

Pick and shovel, blow by blow;

Stand ein Damm den andern Tag.

Stood, the following day, a dike.

Where the little flames swarmed at night,

Menschenopfer mussten bluten,

Nightly rose the sounds of sorrow,

A dike stood the next day.

Nachts erscholl des Jammers Qual;

Human victims there must bleed:

Human sacrifices had to bleed,

Meerab flossen Feuergluten,

Lines of torches, on the morrow,

Nights rang with cries of agony;

Morgens war es ein Kanal.

Were canals that seaward lead.

Sea-ward flowed streams of fire,

Gottlos ist er, ihn gelustet

He would seize our field of labour,

Mornings it was a canal.

Unsre Hütte, unser Hain;

Hut and garden, godlessly:

He's godless, he lusts for

Wie er sich als Nachbar brüstet,

Since he lords it as our neighbour,

Our hut, our grove;

Soll man untertanig sein.

We to him must subject be.

As he puffs himself up as neighbor,

Philemon

Hat er uns doch angeboten

Yet he bids, in compensation,

We must be his subjects.

Schönes Gut im neuen Land!

Fair estate of newer land.

But he did offer us

Baucis

Traue nicht dem Wasserboden,

Trust not watery foundation!

Fine land in the new territory!

Halt auf deiner Hohe stand!

Keep upon the hill thy stand!

Trust not the water-floor!

Philemon

Lasst uns zur Kapelle treten,

Let us, to the chapel straying,

Hold your ground on the heights!

Letzten Sonnenblick zu schaun!

Ere the sunset glow has died,

Let us go to the chapel,

Lasst uns lauten, knieen, beten

Chime the vespers, kneel, and, praying,

To see the last ray of sun!

Und dem alten Gott vertraun!

Still in our old God confide!

Let us ring, kneel, pray

Palast / Palace

Lynkeus der Turner *Lynceus, the Warder (through the speaking-trumpet)*

Die Sonne sinkt, die letzten Schiffe,

The sun goes down, the ships are veering

The sun sinks, the last ships,

Sie ziehen munter hafenein.

To reach the port, with song and cheer:

They cruise cheerfully into port.

Ein grosser Kahn ist im Begriffe,

A heavy galley, now appearing

A big barge is about

Auf dem Kanale hier zu sein.

On the canal, will soon be here.

To arrive on the canal here.

Die bunten Wimpel wehen frohlich,

The gaudy pennons merrily flutter,

The colorful pennants wave happily,

Die starren Masten stehn bereit;

The masts and rigging upward climb:

The rigid masts stand ready;

In dir preist sich der Bootsmann selig,

Blessings on thee the seamen utter,

In you the boatman praises himself blessed,

Dich grusst das Glück zur höchsten Zeit.

And Fortune greets thee at thy prime.

Fortune greets you at your peak.

Faust

Verdammtes Lauten! Allzuschandlich

Accursed chime! As in derision

Damned ringing! All too shameful

Verwundet's, wie ein tückischer Schuss;

It wounds me, like a spiteful shot:

It wounds like a sneaky shot;

Vor Augen ist mein Reich unendlich,

My realm is boundless to my vision,

Before my eyes my realm is endless,

Im Rücken neckt mich der Verdruss,

Yet at my back this vexing blot!

But behind me this irritation nags,

Erinnert mich durch neidische Laute:

The bell proclaims, with envious bluster,

Reminding me with envious tones:

Mein Hochbesitz, er ist nicht rein,

My grand estate lacks full design:

My high estate is not pure,

Der Lindenraum, die braune Baute,

The brown old hut, the linden-cluster,

The linden grove, the brown shack,

Das morsche Kirchlein ist nicht mein.

The crumbling chapel, are not mine.

The crumbling church isn't mine.

Und wünscht' ich, dort mich zu erholen,

If there I wished for recreation,

And if I wanted to relax there,

Vor fremdem Schatten schaudert mir,

Another's shade would give no cheer:

Foreign shadows make me shudder,

Ist Dorn den Augen, Dorn den Sohlen;

A thorn it is, a sharp vexation,–

A thorn to my eyes, thorn to my soles;

O! war' ich weit hinweg von hier!

Would I were far away from here!

Oh! If only I were far from here!

Turner *Warder (from above)*

Wie segelt froh der bunte Kahn

With evening wind and favouring tide,

How gaily sails the colorful ship

Mit frischem Abendwind heran!

See the gay galley hither glide!

With fresh evening wind this way!

Wie turmt sich sein behender Lauf

How richly, on its rapid track,

How its nimble course piles up

In Kisten, Kasten, Sacken auf!

Tower chest and casket, bale and sack!

In chests, crates, sacks!

Chorus

Da landen wir,

Here we have landed:

Here we land,

Da sind wir schon.

Furl the sail!

Here we are.

Gluckan dem Herren,

Hail to the Master,

Luck to the master,

Dem Patron!

Patron hail!

The patron!

Mephistopheles

So haben wir uns wohl erprobt,

We've proved our worth in many ways,

So we have well proved ourselves,

Vergnugt, wenn der Patron es lobt.

Delighted, if the Patron praise!

Happy if the boss approves.

Nur mit zwei Schiffen ging es fort,

We sailed away with vessels twain,

We left with just two ships,

Mit zwanzig sind wir nun im Port.

With twenty come to port again.

Now we're in port with twenty.

Was grosse Dinge wir getan,

Of great successes to relate,

What great things we did,

Das sieht man unsrer Ladung an.

We only need to show our freight.

Our cargo shows it all.

Das freie Meer befreit den Geist,

Free is the mind on Ocean free:

The free sea frees the spirit,

Wer weiss da, was Besinnen heisst!

Who there can ponder sluggishly?

Who knows what thinking means out there!

Da fordert nur ein rascher Griff,

You only need a rapid grip:

All you need is a quick grab,

Man fangt den Fisch, man fangt ein Schiff,

You catch a fish, you seize a ship;

You catch a fish, you catch a ship,

Und ist man erst der Herr zu drei,

And when you once are lord of three,

And once you're master of three,

Dann hakelt man das vierte bei;

The fourth is grappled easily;

You hook the fourth alongside;

Da geht es denn dem funften schlecht,

The fifth is then in evil plight;

Then the fifth is screwed,

Man hat Gewalt, so hat man Recht.

You have the Power, and thus the Right.

You have power, so you have right.

Man fragt ums Was, und nicht ums Wie.

You count the What, and not the How:

You ask about the What, not the How.

Ich musste keine Schiffahrt kennen:

If I have ever navigated,

If I didn't know navigation:

Krieg, Handel und Piraterie,

War, Trade and Piracy, I vow,

War, trade, and piracy,

Dreieinig sind sie, nicht zu trennen.

Are three in one, and can't be separated!

Trinity inseparable!

Die drei gewaltigen Gesellen *The Three Mighty Men*

Nicht Dank und Gruss!

No thank and hail?

No thanks and greeting!

Nicht Gruss und Dank!

No hail and thank?

No greeting and thanks!

Als brachten wir

As if our freight

As if we brought

Dem Herrn Gestank.

To him were rank!

The master a stink.

Er macht ein

He makes a face

He makes a

Widerlich Gesicht;

Of great disgust;

Disgusting face;

Das Königsgut

The royal wealth

The royal goods

Gefällt ihm nicht.

Displease him must.

Don't please him.

Mephistopheles

Erwartet weiter

Expect no further

Expect no further

Keinen Lohn!

Any pay;

Any reward!

Nahmt ihr doch

Your own good share

Didn't you take

Euren Teil davon.

Ye took away.

Your cut already?

Die Gesellen *The Mighty Men*

Das ist nur für

We only took it

That was just for

Die Langeweil';

For pastime fair;

The boredom;

Wir alle fordern

We all demand

We all demand

Gleichen Teil.

An equal share.

Equal shares.

Mephistopheles

Erst ordnet oben

First, arrange them,

First arrange above

Saal an Saal

In hall on hall,–

Hall after hall

Die Kostbarkeiten

The precious treasures,

The precious treasures,

Allzumal!

Together all!

Every last one!

Und tritt er zu

If such a splendour

And when he sees

Der reichen Schau,

Meets his ken,

The rich display,

Berechnet er alles

And he regards it

He'll calculate everything

Mehr genau,

More closely then,

More precisely,

Er sich gewiss

A niggard he

He surely won't

Nicht lumpen lasst

Won't be, at least:

Be a cheapskate

Und gibt der Flotte

He'll give our squadron

And he'll give the fleet

Fest nach Fest.

Feast on feast.

Feast after feast.

Die bunten Vogel kommen morgen,

To-morrow the gay birds hither wend,

The pretty birds come tomorrow,

Für die werd' ich zum besten sorgen.

And I can best to them attend.

I'll take good care of them.

Mephistopheles (*zu Faust*)

Mit ernster Stirn, mit düstrem Blick

With gloomy gaze, with serious brow,

With serious brow, with gloomy look

Vernimmst du dein erhaben Glück.

Of this great fortune hearest thou.

You receive your sublime fortune.

Die hohe Weisheit wird gekront,

Crowned is thy wisest industry,

High wisdom is crowned,

Das Ufer ist dem Meer versöhnt;

And reconciled are shore and sea;

The shore is reconciled with the sea;

Vom Ufer nimmt, zu rascher Bahn,

And from the shore, to swifter wakes,

From the shore, on swift course,

Das Meer die Schiffe willig an;

The willing sea the vessels takes.

The sea willingly takes the ships;

So sprich, dass hier, hier vom Palast

Speak, then, that here from thy proud seat,
So say that here, here from the palace

Dein Arm die ganze Welt umfasst.

Thine arm may clasp the world complete.

Your arm embraces the whole world.

Von dieser Stelle ging es aus,

Here, on this spot, the work was planned!

From this place it began,

Hier stand das erste Bretterhaus;

Here did the first rough cabin stand;

Here stood the first plank-house;

Ein Grabchen ward hinabgeritzt,

A little ditch was traced, a groove,

A little ditch was scratched out,

Wo jetzt das Ruder emsig spritzt.

Where now the feathered oar-blades move.

Where now the oar busily splashes.

Dein hoher Sinn, der Deinen Fleiss

Thy high intent, thy servants' toil,

Your high mind, your servants' diligence

Erwarb des Meers, der Erde Preis.

From land and sea have won the spoil.

Won the sea's and earth's prize.

Von hier aus --

From here--

From here--

Faust

Dir Vielgewandtem muss ich's sagen,

Still that accursed Here!

That damned "Here" again!

Mir gibt's im Herzen Stich um Stich,

To me a burden most severe.

It stabs my heart again and again,

Mir ist's unmöglich zu ertragen!

To thee, so clever, I declare it,–

I can't stand it!

Und wie ich's sage, scham' ich mich.

It gives my very heart a sting;

And saying it, I'm ashamed.

It is impossible to bear it!

Yet ashamed am I, to say the thing.

The old ones up there should move,

Die Alten droben sollten weichen,

The old ones, there, should make concession;

I want those lindens for my seat,

Die Linden wunscht' ich mir zum Sitz,

A shady seat would I create:

Those few trees, not mine,

Die wenig Baume, nicht mein eigen,

The lindens, not my own possession,

Spoil my possession of the world.

Verderben mir den Weltbesitz.

Disturb my joy in mine estate.

I'd like to build from branch to branch

Dort wollt' ich, weit umherzuschauen,

There would I, for a view unbaffled,

Scaffolding to look far around,

Von Ast zu Ast Gerüste bauen,

From bough to bough erect a scaffold,

Opening a wide path for the gaze,

Dem Blick eröffnen weite Bahn,

Till for my gaze a look be won

To see everything I've done,

Zu sehn, was alles ich getan,
O'er everything that I have done,–
To survey with one glance
 Zu uberschaun mit einem Blick
To see before me unconfined,
The masterpiece of human spirit,
 Des Menschengeistes Meisterstück,
The masterpiece of human mind,
Activating with clever sense
 Betätigend mit klugem Sinn
Wisely asserting to my sense
The nations' broad living gain.
 Der Völker breiten Wohngewinn.
The people's gain of residence.
So we're tormented hardest,
 So sind am hartsten wir gequalt,
No sorer plague can us attack,
In wealth feeling what we lack.
 Im Reichtum fühlend, was uns fehlt.
Than rich to be, and something lack!
The little bell's sound, the lindens' scent
 Des Glockchens Klang, der Linden Duft
The chiming bell, the lindens' breath,
Surrounds me like church and crypt.
 Umfaßt mich wie in Kirch' und Gruft.
Oppress like air in vaults of death:
The almighty will's decree
 Des allgewaltigen Willens Kur
My force of will, my potence grand,
Breaks on this sand here.
 Bricht sich an diesem Sande hier.
Is shattered here upon the sand.

How do I get it out of my mind!

Wie schaff' ich mir es vom Gemute!

How shall I ban it from my feeling!

The little bell rings, and I rage.

Das Glocklein lautet, und ich wute.

I rave whene'er the bell is pealing.

Naturally! That a main annoyance

Mephistopheles

Natürlich! dass ein Hauptverdruss

'Tis natural that so great a spite

Must embitter your life.

Das Leben dir vergallen muss.

Thy life should thus embitter quite.

Who denies it! Every noble ear

Wer leugnet's! Jedem edlen Ohr

Who doubts it? Every noble ear,

Finds that jingling repulsive.

Kommt das Geklingel widrig vor.

Disgusted, must the jangle hear;

And that damned bim-bam-bimmel,

Und das verfluchte Bim-Baum-Bimmel,

And that accursed bim-bam-booming,

Fogging the clear evening sky,

Umnebelnd heitern Abendhimmel,

Through the clear sky of evening glooming,

Mixes into every happening,

Mischt sich in jegliches Begebnis,

Is mixed with each event that passes,

From first bath to burial,

Vom ersten Bad bis zum Begrabnis,

From baby's bath to burial-masses,

As if between bim and bam

Als ware zwischen Bim und Baum

As if, between its bam and bim,

Life were a vanished dream.

Das Leben ein verschollner Traum.

Life were a dream, in memory dim.

The resistance, the stubbornness

Faust

Das Widerstehn, der Eigensinn

Their obstinate, opposing strain

Diminishes the most glorious gain,

Verkummern herrlichsten Gewinn,

Darkens the brightest solid gain,

So that one, in deep, grim pain,

Dass man, zu tiefer, grimmiger Pein,

Till one, in plague and worry thrust,

Must grow tired of being just.

Ermuden muss, gerecht zu sein.

Grows tired, at last, of being just.

Why bother yourself here?

Mephistopheles

Was willst du dich denn hier genießen?

Why be annoyed, when thou canst well despise them?

Haven't you long needed to colonize?

Musst du nicht längst kolonisieren?

Wouldst thou not long since colonize them?

Then go and get them out of my way!

Faust

So geht und schafft sie mir zur Seite! –

Then go, and clear them out with speed!

You know the nice little estate

Das schone Gutchen kennst du ja,
Thou knowest the fair estate, indeed,

I picked out for the old folks.

Das ich den Alten ausersah.
I chose for the old people's need.

They'll be carried off and set down,

Mephistopheles

Man tragt sie fort und setzt sie nieder,
We'll set them down on other land;

Before you look around, they'll be standing again;

Eh' man sich umsieht, stehn sie wieder;
Ere you can look, again they'll stand:

After enduring the violence

Nach uberstandener Gewalt
When they've the violence outgrown,

A nice place will make amends.

Versohnt ein schöner Aufenthalt.
Their pleasant dwelling shall atone.

Come, as the master commands!

Mephistopheles

Kommt, wie der Herr gebieten lasst!
Come, as the Master bids, and let

Tomorrow there's a fleet festival.

Und morgen gibt's ein Flottenfest.
The fleet a feast to-morrow get!

The old master received us badly,

Die drei *The Three*

Der alte Herr empfang uns schlecht,
Reception bad the old Master gave;

A fine feast is our due.

Ein flotttes Fest ist uns zu Recht.

A jolly feast is what we crave.

Here too happens what long happened,

Mephistopheles (*ad spectatores*)

Auch hier geschieht, was langst geschah,

It happens as it happed of old:

For Naboth's vineyard was already there.

Denn Naboths Weinberg war schon da.

Still Naboth's vineyard we behold!

Same old story, different landlord.

Tiefe Nacht / Dead of Night

Lynkeus der Turner *Lynceus, the Warder (singing on the watch-tower of the Palace)*

Zum Sehen geboren,

For seeing intended,

Born to see things, that's my whole job description

Zum Schauen bestellt,

Employed for my sight,

Hired specifically for my eyes, which is honestly a flex

Dem Turme geschworen,

The tower's my dwelling,

I've sworn myself to this tower—we're married now, me and stone

Gefällt mir die Welt.

The world my delight.

The world pleases me. All of it. I'm a visual slut.

Ich blick' in die Ferne,

I gaze on the Distant,

I stare at faraway things with the intensity of a cat at a laser pointer

Ich seh' in der Nah'

I look on the Near,—

I see what's near, I see what's far, I'm seeing all day

Den Mond und die Sterne,

The moon and the planets,

Moon and stars hang there like ornaments on a body of darkness

Den Wald und das Reh.

The forest and deer.

Forest, deer. Noted. Beautiful. Next.

So seh' ich in allen

So see I in all things

Everything I look at has this eternal drip, honestly

Die ewige Zier,

The grace without end,

And since it pleases me to gaze, I'm pretty pleased with myself too

Und wie mir's gefallen,

And even as they please me,

Happy eyeballs! Whatever you've witnessed—sharks, sunsets, that one weird cloud

Gefall' ich auch mir.

Myself I commend.

Let it be what it was, it was still beautiful to look at

Ihr glücklichen Augen,

Thou fortunate Vision,

Every damn thing. Still gorgeous. Lucky eyes.

Was je ihr gesehn,

Of all thou wast 'ware,

I didn't just climb up here for fun, though the view does things for me

Es sei wie es wolle,

Whatever it might be,

Wait, what fresh hell is this emerging from the darkness below?

Es war doch so schon!

Yet still it was fair!

My stomach drops before my eyes catch up—body knows first

Nicht allein mich zu ergetzen,

Not alone that I delight me,

What ghastly horror threatens me from the shadowy world!

Bin ich hier so hoch gestellt;

Have I here been stationed so:—

I see sparks. Through the linden trees. This is not a romantic firefly situation.

Welch ein greuliches Entsetzen

What a horror comes, to fright me,

Fire. Double-linden darkness. Glowing. Bad.

Droht mir aus der finstern Welt!

From the darksome world below!

The heat keeps climbing, my throat tightens watching it grow

Funkenblicke seh' ich spruhen

Sparks of fire I see outgushing

The breeze is fanning it—that slutty wind, spreading everything

Durch der Linden Doppelnacht,

Through the night of linden-trees;

Ever stronger glows the burning, fanned by drafts of air

Immer starker wuhlt ein Gluhen,

Stronger yet the glow is flushing,

Oh god the cabin's catching now, the mossy damp one, no no no

Von der Zugluft angefacht.

Fanned to fury by the breeze.

Moss means nothing to fire. Nothing is wet enough.

Ach! die innre Hutte lodert,

Ah! the cabin burns, unheeded,

Quick help needed! Zero help available! This is a math problem from hell!

Die bemoost und feucht gestanden;

Damp and mossy though it stand:

Old couple. Fire people. Smoke victims. Shit.

Schnelle Hilfe wird gefordert,

Quick assistance here is needed,

Ah, the good old folk, once so careful with their hearth!

Keine Rettung ist vorhanden.

And no rescue is at hand!

My eyes burn from watching. Smoke in my lungs from just seeing.

Ach! die guten alten Leute,

Ah, the good old father, mother,

They're gonna suffocate in that smoke and I can't do a damn thing

Sonst so sorglich um das Feuer,

Else so careful of the fire,

What an absolutely horrifying adventure this turned into—fully fucked

Werden sie dem Qualm zur Beute!

Doomed amid the smoke to smother!—

The mossy frame is now starring in a movie called Everything Burns

Welch ein schrecklich Abenteuer!

The catastrophe how dire!

Flames flaming red in glowing heat, the blackened moss-structure stands

Flamme flammet, rot in Gluten

Now the blackening pile stands lonely

If only they got out—my whole body prays without permission

Steht das schwarze Moosgestelle;

In the flames that redly swell:

Wildly burning hell. Old folks. Please be out.

Retteten sich nur die Guten

If the good old folk be only

Lightning-tongues licking up through leaves and branches like hungry mouths

Aus der wildentbrannten Holle!

Rescued from the burning hell!

Dry branches crackle, catch—sound of something dying

Züngelnd lichte Blitze steigen

Dazzling tongues the crater launches

Withered boughs, they flicker-burn, glow quick and crash right down

Zwischen Blattern, zwischen Zweigen;

Through the leaves and through the branches;

My eyes! Why must I be far-sighted? I didn't ask for 20/20 vision of tragedy!

Aste durr, die flackernd brennen,

Withered boughs, at last ignited,

Too sharp. Too clear. Too cruel. These eyes.

Gluhen schnell und stürzen ein.

Break, in burning, from the tree:

The little chapel just collapsed—virginity lost to falling branches

Sollt ihr Augen dies erkennen!

Why must I be thus far-sighted?

I feel each timber in my bones, the crash reverberates through me

Muss ich so weitsichtig sein!

Witness such calamity?

The little chapel breaks apart under the falling weight of boughs

Das Kapellchen bricht zusammen

Now the little chapel crashes

And now the fire's snaking up to the treetops, of course it is

Von der Aste Sturz und Last.

'Neath a branch's falling blow;

Serpentine flames reach up like they're trying to tickle heaven

Schlängelnd sind, mit spitzen Flammen,

Soon the climbing, spiry flashes

Hollow trunks glow purple-red, lit from within like lanterns

Schon die Gipfel angefasst.

Set the tree-tops in a glow.

Down to the root the hollow trunks glow, crimson-purple in the heat

Bis zur Wurzel glühn die hohlen

Down to where the trunks are planted

What the eye loved once? Gone. Centuries. Poof.

Stämme, purpurrot im Glühn. –

Burn they like a crimson dawn.

What used to be worth looking at just came everywhere and then died

Was sich sonst dem Blick empfohlen,

What erewhile the eye enchanted

What is that singing-whimpering from above?

Mit Jahrhunderten ist hin.

With the centuries is gone.

The word arrives but the meaning's on a delay, like bad WiFi

Faust (*auf dem Balkon, gegen die Dunen*) (*on the balcony, towards the downs*)

Von oben welch ein singend Wimmern?

Above, what whining lamentation?

My warder's wailing and something clenches in my chest, wrong, wrong

Das Wort ist hier, der Ton zu spat.

The word, the tone, too late I heed.

I'm annoyed by this impatient deed—wait, MY impatient deed? Uh oh.

Mein Turner jammert; mich, im Innern,

My warder wails: I feel vexation

Regret arrives. Warder wails. Too late though.

Verdriesst die ungeduld'ge Tat.

At heart, for this impatient deed.

But hey, if the lindens are destroyed, that's kind of... mission accomplished?

Doch sei der Lindenwuchs vernichtet

Yet be the lindens extirpated,

Yet be the linden-growth destroyed to half-charred trunk-horrors

Zu halbverkohlter Stamme Graun,

Till half-charred trunks the spot deface,

My skin feels the smoke from here, imagined ash settling

Ein Luginsland ist bald errichtet,

A look-in-the-land is soon created,

I'll build a lookout spot there, boundless views incoming

Um ins Unendliche zu schaun.

Whence I can view the boundless space.

A "look-into-the-land"! Because naming things makes them nice!

Da seh' ich auch die neue Wohnung,

Thence shall I see the newer dwelling

Infinite view. Worth it? Keep telling yourself.

Die jenes alte Paar umschliesst,

Which for the ancient pair I raise,

There I'll see the new dwelling that encloses that old pair

Das, im Gefühl grossmütiger Schonung,

Who, my benign forbearance feeling,

Who, feeling my generous mercy, will enjoy their final days—my hands unclench

Der späten Tage froh geniesst.

Shall there enjoy their latter days.

They'll enjoy my big-dick forbearance energy in their twilight years

Mephistopheles und die dreie (*unten*) *Mephistopheles and the Three* (*below*)

Da kommen wir mit vollem Trab;

We hither come upon the run!

They're gonna love their new house, right? Everything's fine. It's fine.

Verzeiht! es ging nicht gutlich ab.

Forgive! not happily 'twas done.

Magnanimous Faust! Providing sunset years! Definitely not on fire!

Wir klopfen an, wir pochten an,

We knocked and beat, but none replied,

Here we come at full gallop! Forgive us, it didn't go peacefully.

Und immer ward nicht aufgetan;

And entrance ever was denied;

So like, we knocked, we knocked again, nobody answered, super rude

Wir rüttelten, wir pochten fort,

Of jolts and blows we gave good store,

Fists against wood, again and again, the rhythm of trying

Da lag die morsche Türe dort;

And broken lay the rotten door;

Knocked. Pounded. Shook. Door down.

Wir riefen laut und drohten schwer,

We called aloud, with direst threat,

We rattled! We banged! The rotten door surrendered like a sad metaphor!

Allein wir fanden kein Gehör.

But still no hearing could we get.

We called out loud and made big threats, got absolutely nothing

Und wie's in solchem Fall geschicht,

And, as it haps, with such a deed,

We shouted loud and threatened heavy, but found no hearing there

Sie horten nicht, sie wollten nicht;

They would not hear, they would not heed;

Frustration building in the arms, the shoulders, the jaw clenching

Wir aber haben nicht gesaumt,

But we began, without delay,

You know how it goes in these situations—they wouldn't hear, they wouldn't listen

Behende dir sie weggeraumt.

To drive the stubborn folks away.

Deaf or stubborn. Same result. We moved.

Das Paar hat sich nicht viel gequält,

The pair had then an easy lot:

And as happens in such cases! (narrator voice: it did not go well)

Vor Schrecken fielen sie entseelt.

They fell and died upon the spot.

We however did not delay, we nimbly cleared them away for you

Ein Fremder, der sich dort versteckt

A stranger, who was there concealed,

The couple didn't suffer much—they dropped dead from sheer fright, quick and clean

Und fechten wollte, ward gestreckt.

And fought, was left upon the field;

Terror stops the heart. Bodies drop before they know.

In wilden Kampfes kurzer Zeit

But in the combat, fierce and last,

There was also some dude hiding there who wanted to fight, we handled it

Von Kohlen, ringsumher gestreut,

From coals, that round about were cast,

A stranger who concealed himself there and wanted to fence was stretched out

Entflammte Stroh. Nun lodert's frei,

The straw took fire. Now merrily

Guest wanted beef. Got beef. Got stretched.

Als Scheiterhaufen dieser drei.

One funeral pile consumes the three.

And in the wild battle's brief moment, coals scattered everywhere—whoopsie!

Faust

Dem unbesonnenen wilden Streich,

Deaf unto my commands were ye!

Straw catches fire. That fast. Heat jumps from thing to thing.

Ihm fluch' ich; teilt es unter euch!

Exchange I meant, not robbery.

Now it blazes freely as a funeral pyre for those three—cozy threesome, finally hot

The inconsiderate, savage blow

I curse! Bear ye the guilt and go!

Straw ignited. Now it burns free, as a pyre for these three.

Chorus

Das alte Wort, das Wort erschallt:

The proverb old still runs its course:

You absolute dipshits, this is NOT what I ordered

Gehorche willig der Gewalt!

Bend willingly to greater force!

The thoughtless, wild stroke—I curse it! Split the blame between you!

Und bist du kuhn und halst du Stich,

If you are bold, and face the strife,

My stomach turns. Exchange I meant. My hands feel dirty.

So wage Haus und Hof und – dich.

Stake house and home, and then—your life!

I wanted a swap, not a robbery! There's a difference! A legal difference!

Faust (*auf dem Balkon*) (*on the balcony*)

Die Sterne bergen Blick und Schein,

The stars conceal their glance and glow,

Curse falls. Guilt shared. Get out.

Das Feuer sinkt und lodert klein;

The fire sinks down, and flickers low;

I curse this shit! You all own it now! Take your guilt and fuck off!

Ein Schauerwindchen fachelt's an,

A damp wind fans it with its wings,

The old word, the word resounds: obey willingly the force!

Bringt Rauch und Dunst zu mir heran.

And smoke and vapour hither brings.

Classic proverb hours: bow down or get knocked down

Geboten schnell, zu schnell getan! –

Quick bidden, and too quick obeyed!–

The spine learns to bend or the spine learns to break

Was schwebet schattenhaft heran?

What hovers hither like a shade?

**And if you're bold and hold your ground? Well then bet house, home,
and—yourself!**

Mitternacht / Midnight

Vier graue Weiber treten auf. Four Gray Women enter.

Erste *First*

Ich heisse der Mangel. –

My name, it is Want.

My name is Want.

Zweite *Second*

Ich heisse die Schuld.

And mine, it is Guilt.

I'm Want. Nice to meet you. You won't like knowing me.

Dritte *Third*

Ich heisse die Sorge. –

And mine, it is Care.

Hollow belly, empty hands—I'm what that feels like

Vierte *Fourth*

Ich heisse die Not.

Necessity, mine.

Name: Want. Job: Wanting. Eternally.

Zu drei *Three together*

Die Tür ist verschlossen, wir können nicht ein;

The portal is bolted, we cannot get in:

My name is Guilt.

Drin wohnt ein Reicher, wir mögen nicht 'nein.

The owner is rich, we've no business within.

I'm Guilt, baby. You've been ignoring my calls.

Mangel *Want*

Da werd' ich zum Schatten. –

I shrink to a shadow.

Guilt here! I'm what you owe plus interest plus that thing you did in 2019!

Schuld *Guilt*

Da werd' ich zunicht.

I shrink unto naught.

Schuld. Debt. Guilt. Both. Yes.

Not *Necessity*

Man wendet von mir das verwohnte Gesicht.

The pampered from me turn the face and the thought.

My name is Care.

Sorge *Care*

Ihr Schwestern, ihr konnt nicht und durft nicht hinein.

Ye Sisters, ye neither can enter, nor dare;

Care, reporting for duty. The worry kind, not the tender kind.

Die Sorge, sie schleicht sich durchs Schlüsselloch ein.

But the keyhole is free to the entrance of Care.

Tight chest, racing thoughts at 3am—hello, it's me

(Sorge verschwindet.) (Care disappears.)

Mangel *Want*

Ihr, graue Geschwister, entfernt euch von hier.

Ye, grisly old Sisters, be banished from here!

I'm Care! The anxiety! Not the good caregiving one! Confusing, I know!

Schuld *Guilt*

Ganz nah an der Seite verbind' ich mich dir.

Beside thee, and bound to thee, I shall appear!

My name is Need.

Not *Necessity*

Ganz nah an der Ferse begleitet die Not.

At your heels goes Necessity, blight in her breath.

Necessity's the name. I don't knock, I just enter.

Zu drei *The Three*

Es ziehen die Wolken, es schwinden die Sterne!

The clouds are in motion, and cover each star!

Urgency in the bowels, no choices left—that's my flavor

Dahinten, dahinten! von ferne, von ferne,

Behind there, behind! from afar, from afar,

Need. Not. Negotiable.

Da kommt er, der Bruder, da kommt er, der – – – Tod.

He cometh, our Brother! he comes, he is . . . Death!

The door is locked, we cannot enter; a rich man dwells within, we don't want in there

Faust (*im Palast*) (*in the Palace*)

Vier sah ich kommen, drei nur gehn;

Four saw I come, but those that went were three;

Portal's bolted, can't get inside—too bougie in there for our vibe

Den Sinn der Rede konnt' ich nicht verstehn.

The sense of what they said was hid from me.

The owner is RICH! We've got no business in those tax brackets!

Es klang so nach, als hiess' es – Not,

But something like "Necessity" I heard;

Pressed against locked doors, faces flat against what we can't enter

Ein dustres Reimwort folgte – Tod.

Thereafter, "Death" a gloomy, threatening word!

There I become a shadow.

Es tonte hohl, gespensterhaft gedampft.

It sounded hollow, spectrally subdued:

I shrink down to a shadow around rich folks

Noch hab' ich mich ins Freie nicht gekämpft.

Not yet have I my liberty made good:

Thin to nothing, transparent, barely there

Konnt' ich Magie von meinem Pfad entfernen,

If I could banish Magic's fell creations,

Shadow. Less than shadow. Gone.

Die Zauberspruche ganz und gar verlernen,

And totally unlearn the incantations,–

There I become nothing.

Stund' ich, Natur, vor dir ein Mann allein,

Stood I, O Nature! Man alone in thee,

I shrink to jack shit. Wealth is its own absolution apparently.

Da war's der Muhe wert, ein Mensch zu sein.

Then were it worth one's while a man to be!

I become naught! Zero! The null value of spiritual bankruptcy!

Das war ich sonst, eh' ich's im Dustern suchte,

Ere in the Obscure I sought it, such was I,—

Weightless, substanceless, I vanish like debt paid off

Mit Frevelwort mich und die Welt verfluchte.

Ere I had cursed the world so wickedly.

They turn the pampered face away from me.

Nun ist die Luft von solchem Spuk so voll,

Now fills the air so many a haunting shape,

Rich folks look away from me like I'm invisible, which, fair

Dass niemand weiss, wie er ihn meiden soll.

That no one knows how best he may escape.

Soft faces. Turn away. Don't see me.

Wenn auch ein Tag uns klar vernunftig lacht,

What though One Day with rational brightness beams,

The comfortable ones avert their spoiled little faces—they've never met urgency

In Traumgespinnst verwickelt uns die Nacht;

The Night entangles us in webs of dreams.

You sisters, you cannot and may not enter. But Care slips through the keyhole.

Wir kehren froh von junger Flur zuruck,

From our young fields of life we come, elate:

You girls can't get in there, but guess who fits through keyholes? This bitch.

Ein Vogel krachzt; was krachzt er? Missgeschick.

There croaks a bird: what croaks he? Evil fate!

I slide through gaps, under doors, into the cracks of sealed rooms

Von Aberglauben fruh und spat umgarnt:

By superstition constantly insnared,

The keyhole is OPEN to me! I'm basically anxiety vapor!

Es eignet sich, es zeigt sich an, es warnt.

It grows to us, and warns, and is declared.

Sisters blocked. Care? Keyhole. Always.

Und so verschuchtert, stehen wir allein.

Intimidated thus, we stand alone.—

You, gray sisters, depart from here.

Die Pforte knarrt, und niemand kommt herein.

The portal jars, yet entrance is there none.

Time for us to dip, gray squad

Ist jemand hier? —

Is any one here?

We drift apart like fog at dawn

Sorge *Care*

Die Frage fordert Ja!

Yes! must be my reply.

Exit stage left, fellow hags!

Faust

Und du, wer bist denn du? —

And thou, who art thou, then?

Quite close at your side, I bind myself to you.

Sorge *Care*

Bin einmal da.

Well,—here am I.

I'll stick close to you, babe—spooning distance at all times

Faust

Entferne dich! —

Avaunt!

Hip to hip, shadow to shadow, I follow where you go

Sorge *Care*

Ich bin am rechten Ort.

I am where I should be.

Right beside. Bound tight. Can't lose me.

Faust

Nimm dich in acht und sprich kein Zauberwort.

Take care, and speak no word of sorcery!

Quite close at your heels accompanies Need.

Sorge Care

Wurde mich kein Ohr vernehmen,

Though no ear should choose to hear me,

I'm right at your heels, blight on my breath, let's roll

Musst' es doch im Herzen drohnen;

Yet the shrinking heart must fear me:

The urgency nips at ankles, follows every step

In verwandelter Gestalt

Though transformed to mortal eyes,

At your heels! Like a dog! But sadder and more inevitable!

Ub' ich grimmige Gewalt.

Grimmest power I exercise.

The clouds drift, the stars vanish! From afar, from afar, he comes, our brother, he comes—Death.

Auf den Pfaden, auf der Welle,

On the land, or ocean yonder,

Clouds moving, stars fading—from way out there, here comes our bro, good old Death

Ewig angstlicher Geselle,

I, a dread companion, wander,

The sky closes over, light retreats, and something approaches on cold feet

Stets gefunden, nie gesucht,

Always found, yet never sought,

Behind there! From far! It's our brother! It's... *dramatic pause...* DEATH!

So geschmeichelt wie verflucht. –

Praised or cursed, as I have wrought!

Clouds. Stars gone. Brother coming. Death.

Hast du die Sorge nie gekannt?

Hast thou not Care already known?

That's right, Death's on his way—the ultimate closer, the big finish, daddy
of all endings

Faust

Ich bin nur durch die Welt gerannt;

I only through the world have flown:

**Four I saw coming, only three departed; the sense of their speech I could
not understand.**

Ein jed' Gelust ergriff ich bei den Haaren,

Each appetite I seized as by the hair;

Four showed up, three bounced—the math ain't mathing

Was nicht genugte, liess ich fahren,

What not sufficed me, forth I let it fare,

My ears caught fragments, my mind couldn't grip the meaning

Was mir entwichte, liess ich ziehn.

And what escaped me, I let go.

**It sounded kinda like “Need”... then something rhymed with it... something
gloomy... DEATH!**

Ich habe nur begehrt und nur vollbracht

I've only craved, accomplished my delight,

Need echoed. Death followed. Hollow sound.

Und abermals gewünscht und so mit Macht

Then wished a second time, and thus with might

**It sounded hollow, spectrally muffled. Still I have not fought my way to
freedom.**

Mein Leben durchgesturmt; erst gross und machtig,

Stormed through my life: at first 'twas grand, completely,

**Still haven't worked myself free into the open air—still trapped in my own
bullshit**

Nun aber geht es weise, geht bedachtig.

But now it moves most wisely and discreetly.

The walls close in, the freedom feels further than ever

Der Erdenkreis ist mir genug bekannt,

The sphere of Earth is known enough to me;

If I could just delete Magic from my life, factory reset the whole sorcery thing

Nach druben ist die Aussicht uns verrannt;

The view beyond is barred immutably:

If I could remove magic from my path, completely unlearn the spells

Tor, wer dorthin die Augen blinzelnd richtet,

A fool, who there his blinking eyes directeth,

Stand before you, Nature, just a guy! No tricks! Just vibes!

Sich uber Wolken seinesgleichen dichtet!

And o'er his clouds of peers a place expecteth!

Naked before existence, stripped of borrowed power

Er stehe fest und sehe hier sich um;

Firm let him stand, and look around him well!

Just Man. No magic. Worth living then.

Dem Tuchtigen ist diese Welt nicht stumm.

This World means something to the Capable.

That's who I was before I went looking in the dark and cursed everything

Was braucht er in die Ewigkeit zu schweifen!

Why needs he through Eternity to wend?

That I was, before I sought in the murky, with blasphemous words cursed myself and the world

Was er erkennt, lasst sich ergreifen.

He here acquires what he can apprehend.

Now the air's so thick with spooks I can't see straight

Er wandle so den Erdentag entlang;

Thus let him wander down his earthly day;

Haunting shapes everywhere! Nobody knows how to avoid them! Not even Waze!

Wenn Geister spuken, geh' er seinen Gang,

When spirits haunt, go quietly his way;

Ghosts press on the skin, crowd the breath

Im Weiterschreiten find' er Qual und Gluck,

In marching onwards, bliss and torment find,

Now the air is so full of such specters that no one knows how to avoid them
Er, unbefriedigt jeden Augenblick!
Though, every moment, with unsated mind!
One day seems clear and rational, then night tangles us in dream-webs

Sorge Care

Wen ich einmal besitze,
Whom I once possess, shall never
Day laughs clear. Night traps. Always.
Dem ist alle Welt nichts nutze;
Find the world worth his endeavour:
When a day laughs clear and rational at us, night entangles us in dream-weaving
Ewiges Dustre steigt herunter,
Endless gloom around him folding,
We come back from fresh fields all happy, then a bird croaks—bad luck, you're fucked
Sonne geht nicht auf noch unter,
Rise nor set of sun beholding.
Superstition wraps around like vines, tighter with each breath
Bei vollkommenen aussern Sinnen
Perfect in external senses,
It shows itself, it announces itself, it warns! Like the world's worst notification system!
Wohnen Finsternisse drinnen,
Inwardly his darkness dense is;
Ensnared by superstition early and late: it announces itself, it shows itself, it warns
Und er weiss von allen Schätzen
And he knows not how to measure
And so we stand here intimidated, totally alone. Great.
Sich nicht in Besitz zu setzen.
True possession of his treasure.

The door creaks. Nobody enters. The emptiness is worse.

Gluck und Unglück wird zur Grille,

Luck and Ill become caprices;

Gate creaks. Nothing enters. Terrifying.

Er verhungert in der Fülle;

Still he starves in all increases;

The gate creaks, and no one comes through. Is anyone here?

Sei es Wonne, sei es Plage,

Be it happiness or sorrow,

The question demands Yes!

Schieb er's zu dem andern Tage,

He postpones it till the morrow;

You asked if someone's here? That's a yes from me, bestie.

Ist der Zukunft nur gewartig,

To the Future only cleaveth:

THE QUESTION REQUIRES A YES! And I am that yes! Surprise!

Und so wird er niemals fertig.

Nothing, therefore, he achieveth.

Asked? Answered. Yes. I'm here.

Faust

Fahr hin! die schlechte Litanei,

Desist! So shalt thou not get hold of me!

And you, who are you then?

Sie konnte selbst den klugsten Mann betören.

I have no mind to hear such drivel.

And who the hell are you supposed to be?

Depart! Thy gloomy litany

Might even befool the wisest man to evil.

My skin prickles, recognizing before knowing

Sorge Care

Soll er gehen, soll er kommen?

Shall he go, or come?—how guide him?

I am simply here.

Der Entschluss ist ihm genommen;

Prompt decision is denied him;

I'm just... here. That's the whole answer.

Auf gebahnten Weges Mitte

Midway on the trodden highway

Well—here I am! *jazz hands of existential dread*

Wankt er tastend halbe Schritte.

Halting, he attempts a by-way;

Here. Just here. Deal with it.

Er verliert sich immer tiefer,

Ever more astray, bemisted,

Remove yourself!

Siehet alle Dinge schiefer,

Everything beholding twisted,

Get the fuck out!

Sich und andre lastig druckend;

Burdening himself and others,

Every muscle tenses toward pushing this presence away

Atemholend und erstickend;

Taking breath, he chokes and smothers,

I am in the right place.

Nicht erstickt und ohne Leben,

Though not choked, in Life not sharing,

Nah, I'm exactly where I should be, actually

Nicht verzweifelnd, nicht ergeben.

Not resigned, and not despairing!

I am AT the correct coordinates! This is MY spot!

So ein unaufhaltsam Rollen,

Such incessant rolling, spinning,—

Right place. Right time. For me.

Schmerzlich Lassen, widrig Sollen,

Painful quitting, hard beginning,—

Take care and speak no magic word.

Bald Befreien, bald Erdrucken,

Now constraint, now liberation,—

Watch yourself and don't try any spell shit on me

Halber Schlaf und schlecht Erquickern

Semi-sleep, poor recreation,

Jaw tight, warning in the voice, guard up

Heftet ihn an seine Stelle

Firmly in his place insnare him

Careful now—don't you dare whisper any witchy bullshit

Und bereitet ihn zur Holle.

And, at last, for Hell prepare him!

Though no ear would hear me, it must still thunder in the heart

Faust

Unselige Gespenster! so behandelt ihr

Ill-omened spectres! By your treatment strays

Even if you plug your ears, your shriveled heart still hears me

Das menschliche Geschlecht zu tausend Malen;

A thousand times the human race to error:

The heartbeat accelerates at my approach, body betrays the mind

Gleichgultige Tage selbst verwandelt ihr

Ye even transform the dull, indifferent days

In transformed shape I exercise GRIM POWER! Very grim! Extremely powerful!

In garstigen Wirrwarr netzumstrickter Qualen.

To vile confusion of entangling terror.

Heart knows. Ears optional. I'm felt.

Damonen, weiss ich, wird man schwerlich los,

'Tis hard, I know, from Daemons to escape;

On the paths, on the wave, eternally anxious companion

Das geistig-strenge Band ist nicht zu trennen;

The spirit's bond breaks not, howe'er one tries it;

I'm the forever-anxious sidekick—land or sea, I'm riding along

Doch deine Macht, Sorge, schleichend gross,

And yet, O Care, thy power, thy creeping shape,

Every road, every shore, I walk beside with cold breath

Ich werde sie nicht anerkennen.

Think not that I shall recognize it!

Always found but never sought, praised and cursed in equal measure

Sorge Care

Erfahre sie, wie ich geschwind

So feel it now: my curse thou'lt find,

I'm like that friend you never invited but who shows up anyway! But evil!

Mich mit Verwunschung von dir wende!

When forth from thee I've swiftly passed!

Found. Never sought. Praised. Cursed. Same.

Die Menschen sind im ganzen Leben blind,

Throughout their whole existence men are blind;

Have you never known Care?

Nun, Fauste, werde du's am Ende!

So, Faust, be thou like them at last!

You've felt me before, haven't you? We've danced this dance.

(Sie haucht ihn an.) (She breathes in his face.)

Faust (erblindet) (blinded)

Die Nacht scheint tiefer tief hereinzudringen,

The Night seems deeper now to press around me,

The familiarity of dread—haven't you felt this weight before?

Allein im Innern leuchtet helles Licht;

But in my inmost spirit all is light;

I only ran through the world; each desire I seized by the hair

Was ich gedacht, ich eil' es zu vollbringen;

I rest not till the finished work hath crowned me:

I speedran life, grabbed every craving by the hair like I was dragging it to prom

Des Herren Wort, es gibt allein Gewicht.

The master's Word alone bestows the might.

Grasping, always grasping, fingers in everything

Vom Lager auf, ihr Knechte! Mann fur Mann!

Up from your couches, vassals, man by man!

What wasn't enough? I let it LEAVE! What escaped? ALSO LEAVE! Efficiency!

Lasst glücklich schauen, was ich kuhn ersann.

Make grandly visible my daring plan!

Grabbed. Took. Dropped the rest. Ran.

Ergreift das Werkzeug, Schaufel ruhr und Spaten!

Seize now your tools, with spade and shovel press!

What did not satisfy, I let go; what escaped me, I let pass

Das Abgesteckte muss sogleich geraten.

The work traced out must be a swift success.

I only ever wanted and got, wanted again and took—life at full throttle

Auf strenges Ordnen, raschen Fleiss

Quick diligence, severest ordering

Storming through existence, grabbing and releasing, all motion

Erfolgt der allerschönste Preis;

The most superb reward shall bring;

First it was big and powerful, now it's wise and careful—character development

Dass sich das grösste Werk vollende,

And, that the mighty work completed stands,

First great and mighty, now it goes wisely, goes carefully

Genugt ein Geist fur tausend Hande.

One mind suffices for a thousand hands.

Earth's sphere? Known. Beyond? BLOCKED. The view is BARRED!

Grosser Vorhof des Palasts / Great Outer Court of the Palace

Mephistopheles (*als Aufseher / as Overseer*)

Herbei, herbei! Herein, herein! *Come here, come here! Come on, come on!*

Come here, come here! Come on, come on!

Ihr schlotternden Lemuren, *Ye Lemures, loose-hung creatures!*

Get over here! Move it, move it!

Aus Baendern, Sehnen und Gebein *Of sinew, ligament, and bone*

The voice cracks like a whip, summoning shuffling forms

Geflickte Halbnaturen. *Your knitted semi-natures!*

Here. Here. In. In. Now.

Lemuren (*im Chor / in Chorus*)

Wir treten dir sogleich zur Hand, *Without delay are we at hand,*

Get your bony asses over here! Hustle!

Und wie wir halb vernommen, *And half 'tis our impression*

CONVENE! ASSEMBLE! Enter through the DOOR-shaped DOOR!

Es gilt wohl gar ein weites Land, *That this discerns a spacious land,*

You shivering Lemures,

Das sollen wir bekommen. *Whereof we'll have possession.*

You rattling bag-of-bones crew,

Gespitzte Pfähle, die sind da, *The pointed stakes, we bring them all,*

Bodies that tremble because they barely hold together

Die Kette lang zum Messen; *The measuring-chain, for distance;*

You shaky motherfuckers made of spare parts,

Warum an uns den Ruf geschah, *But we've forgotten why the call*

You QUIVERING LEMURS! Half-ghosts! Structural disasters!

Das haben wir vergessen. *Was made for our assistance.*

Shaking corpse-things. Come.

Mephistopheles

Hier gilt kein kuenstlerisch Bemuehn; *Here is no need of your artistic zeal:*

Stitched together from ligaments, tendons, and bone,

Verfahret nur nach eignen Massen! *Proceed as you may think it best!*

Cobbled from sinew and skeleton like discount Halloween props,

Der Laengste lege laengelang sich hin, *Your tallest lay full length, from head to heel,*

Held together by threads of cartilage, each joint a prayer

Ihr andern lueftet ringsumher den Rasen; *And lift the turf around him, all the rest!*

From SPARE PARTS! Like IKEA furniture but WORSE and DEAD!

Wie man's fuer unsre Vaeter tat, *As for our fathers made, prepare*

Scraps. Strings. Bones. Sewn.

Vertieft ein laengliches Quadrat! *To excavate a lengthened square!*

Patched-up half-natures.

Aus dem Palast ins enge Haus, *From palace to the narrow house transferred,*

You frankensteined half-beings, barely qualifying as anatomy,

So dumm laeuft es am Ende doch hinaus. *Such is, at last, the issue most absurd.*

You duct-taped semi-creatures,

Lemuren (*grabend, mit neckischen Gebaerden / digging, with mocking gestures*)

Wie jung ich war und lebt' und liebt', *In youth when I did love, did love,*

Incomplete, approximate, almost-things

Mich deucht, das war wohl suesse; *Methought it was very sweet;*

HALF-NATURES! The economy model of existence!

Wo's froehlich klang und lustig ging, *When 'twas jolly and merry every way,*

Half-made. Half-here. Enough.

Da ruehrten sich meine Fuesse. *And I blithely moved my feet.*

We come to your hand immediately,

Nun hat das tueckische Alter mich *But now old Age, with his stealing steps,*

We're at your service, boss, right on time,

Mit seiner Kruecke getroffen; *Hath clawed me with his crutch:*

Shuffling forward with what passes for eagerness in the dead

Ich stolpert' ueber Grabes Tuer, *I stumbled over the door of a grave;*

Here. At hand. Ready. Ish.

Warum stand sie just offen! *Why leave they open such?*

And as we half understood,

Faust (*tritt aus dem Palast, tastet an den Tuerpfosten / comes forth from the Palace, groping his way along the doorposts*)

Wie das Geklirr der Spaten mich ergetzt! *How I rejoice, to hear the clattering spade!*

We sorta halfway got the memo,

Es ist die Menge, die mir froenet, *It is the crowd, for me in service moiling.*

We PARTIALLY COMPREHENDED with our PARTIAL BRAINS!

Die Erde mit sich selbst versoehnet, *Till Earth be reconciled to toiling,*

Half-hearing with half-functioning ears

Den Wellen ihre Grenze setzt, *Till the proud waves be stayed,*

It concerns a wide land altogether,

Das Meer mit strengem Band umzieht. *And the sea girded with a rigid zone.*

Something about a big piece of real estate?

Mephistopheles (*beiseite / aside*)

Du bist doch nur fuer uns bemueht *And yet, thou'rt labouring for us alone,*

A SPACIOUS LAND! Like a PARKING LOT but with more SOIL!

Mit deinen Daemmen, deinen Buhnen; *With all thy dikes and bulwarks daring;*

Big land. We heard. Sort of.

Denn du bereitest schon Neptunen, *Since thou for Neptune art preparing –*

That we are supposed to get.

Dem Wasserteufel, grossen Schmaus. *The Ocean-Devil – carousal great.*

Which apparently we're gonna score somehow,

In jeder Art seid ihr verloren; – *In every way shall ye be stranded;*

That's coming our way, supposedly,

Die Elemente sind mit uns verschworen, *The elements with us are banded.*

Ownership promised to hands that can barely grip

Und auf Vernichtung laeuft's hinaus. *And ruin is the certain fate.*

Pointed stakes, they are here,

Faust

Aufseher! – *Overseer!*

Sharp stakes? Check. We brought those.

Mephistopheles

Hier! – *Here!*

Stakes. Sharp. Present.

Faust

Wie es auch moeglich sei, *However possible,*

POINTED IMPLEMENTS! For SURVEYING! Or VAMPIRES! Unclear!

Arbeiter schaffe Meng' auf Menge, *Collect a crowd of men with vigour,*

The chain long for measuring;

Ermuntere durch Genuss und Strenge, *Spur by indulgence, praise, or rigour,* –

The measuring chain, long as hell,

Bezahle, locke, presse bei! *Reward, allure, conscript, compel!*

Cold links for marking distances in earth

Mit jedem Tage will ich Nachricht haben, *Each day report me, and correctly note*

Surveyor's chain, extra-long edition,

Wie sich verlaengt der unternommene Graben. *How grows in length the undertaken moat.*

Why the call came to us,

Mephistopheles (*halblaut / half aloud*)

Man spricht, wie man mir Nachricht gab, *When they to me the information gave,*

Why WE were summoned specifically?

Von keinem Graben, doch vom Grab. *They spake not of a moat, but of – a grave.*

Why us? Good question.

Faust

Ein Sumpf zieht am Gebirge hin, *Below the hills a marshy plain*

Why the fuck we're even here,

Verpestet alles schon Errungene; *Infects what I so long have been retrieving;*

That we have forgotten.

Den faulen Pfuhl auch abzuziehn, *This stagnant pool likewise to drain*

Yeah, we totally blanked on that part.

Das Letzte waer' das Hoechsterrungene. *Were now my latest and my best achieving.*

The purpose slipped through the sieves of rotted memory

Eroeffn' ich Raeume vielen Millionen, *To many millions let me furnish soil,*

FORGOTTEN! Our memories are DECORATIVE at best!

Nicht sicher zwar, doch taetig-frei zu wohnen. *Though not secure, yet free to active toil;*

Forgot. As usual.

Gruen das Gefilde, fruchtbar; Mensch und Herde *Green, fertile fields, where men and herds go forth*

Here no artistic effort is needed;

Sogleich behaglich auf der neusten Erde, *At once, with comfort, on the newest Earth,*

No need to get fancy with this one,

Gleich angesiedelt an des Huegels Kraft, *And swiftly settled on the hills' firm base,*

Don't strain your single remaining brain cells on art,

Den aufgewaelzt kuehn-emsige Voelkerschaft. *Created by the bold, industrious race.*

No art required. Simple job.

Im Innern hier ein paradiesisch Land, *A land like Paradise here, round about:*

Proceed according to your own measurements!

Da rase draussen Flut bis auf zum Rand, *Up to the brink the tide may roar without,*

Use YOUR OWN BODIES as the measuring system! Very METRIC!

Und wie sie nascht, gewaltsam einzuschiessen, *And though it gnaw, to burst with force the limit,*

Your decayed frames are the only rulers needed

Gemeindrang eilt, die Luecke zu verschliessen. *By common impulse all unite to hem it.*

Just use yourselves as the tape measure,

Ja! diesem Sinne bin ich ganz ergeben, *Yes, to this thought I hold with firm persistence;*

The tallest lay full length along,

Das ist der Weisheit letzter Schluss: *The last result of wisdom stamps it true:*

Tallest one, stretch your bony ass out flat,

Nur der verdient sich Freiheit wie das Leben, *He only earns his freedom and existence,*

Biggest guy, lie down and be the benchmark,

Der taeglich sie erobern muss. *Who daily conquers them anew.*

Tall one. Lie down. Full length.

Und so verbringt, umrungen von Gefahr, *Thus here, by dangers girt, shall glide away*

One body laid out, arms at sides, the shape of what's needed

Hier Kindheit, Mann und Greis sein tuechtig Jahr. *Of childhood, manhood, age, the vigorous day:*

You others lift the turf all around;

Solch ein Gewimmel moecht' ich sehn, *And such a throng I fain would see, –*

The REST of you, perform GRASS SURGERY around him!

Auf freiem Grund mit freiem Volke stehn. *Stand on free soil among a people free!*

Everyone else, peel back the lawn,

Zum Augenblicke duerft' ich sagen: *Then dared I hail the Moment fleeing:*

Rest of you dipshits, start peeling up that grass,

Verweile doch, du bist so schoen! *“Ah, still delay – thou art so fair!”*

Hands in soil, lifting green skin from dark earth

Es kann die Spur von meinen Erdetagen *The traces cannot, of mine earthly being,*

As was done for our forefathers,

Nicht in Aeonen untergehn. – *In aeons perish, – they are there! –*

The way we did it for the old-timers,

Im Vorgefuehl von solchem hohen Glueck *In proud fore-feeling of such lofty bliss,*

As for fathers. Traditional.

Geniess' ich jetzt den hoechsten Augenblick. *I now enjoy the highest Moment – this!*

Like we did for dear old dead granddad,

(Faust sinkt zurueck, die Lemuren fassen ihn auf und legen ihn auf den Boden / Faust sinks back: the Lemures take him and lay him upon the ground.)

Mephistopheles

Den letzten, schlechten, leeren Augenblick, *No joy could sate him, and suffice no bliss!*

Deepen an oblong square!

Der Arme wuenscht ihn festzuhalten. *To catch but shifting shapes was his endeavour:*

Excavate a RECTANGULAR RECTANGULAR thing! GEOMETRY!

Der mir so kraeftig widerstand, *The latest, poorest, emptiest Moment – this, –*

The shape takes form: long, narrow, final

Die Zeit wird Herr, der Greis hier liegt im Sand. *He wished to hold it fast for ever.*

Dig out a nice long rectangle—you know the shape.

Die Uhr steht still – – *Me he resisted in such vigorous wise,*

Oblong. Square. Dig deep.

But Time is lord, on earth the old man lies. The clock stands still –

Chor

Steht still! Sie schweigt wie Mitternacht. *Stands still! silent as midnight, now!*

From the palace to the narrow house,

Der Zeiger faellt. – *The index falls.*

From the fancy palace to the dirt box,

Mephistopheles

Er faellt, es ist vollbracht. *It falls; and it is finished, here!*

From mansion to six-foot apartment,

Chor

Es ist vorbei. – *'Tis past!*

From PALACE to COFFIN! The ultimate DOWNSIZING!

Mephistopheles

Vorbei! ein dummes Wort. – *Past! a stupid word.*

From grand halls to the box that fits one

Warum vorbei? *If past, then why?*

So stupidly does it run out at the end.

Vorbei und reines Nicht, vollkommnes Einerlei! *Past and pure Naught, complete monotony!*

That's the dumb punchline every time.

Was soll uns denn das ew'ge Schaffen! *What good for us, this endlessly creating? –*

Same ending. Always stupid.

Geschaffenes zu nichts hinwegzuraffen! *What is created then annihilating?*

What a fucking moronic finale for everyone.

“Da ist’s vorbei!” Was ist daran zu lesen? *“And now it’s past!” Why read a page so twisted?*

The conclusion is ALWAYS this ABSURD! Every single biography!

Es ist so gut, als waer’ es nicht gewesen, *’Tis just the same as if it ne’er existed,*

Every life narrows to this joke

Und treibt sich doch im Kreis, als wenn es waere. *Yet goes in circles round as if it had, however:*

When I was young and lived and loved,

Ich liebte mir dafuer das Ewig-Leere. *I’d rather choose, instead, the Void for ever.*

Back when I was young and alive and getting some,

Grablegung / Sepulture (Entombment)

Lemur (*Solo*)

Wer hat das Haus so schlecht gebaut, *Who then hath built the house so ill,*

Who built this house so garbage-tier

Mit Schaufeln und mit Spaten? *With shovel and with spade?*

With shovels and with spades?

Lemuren (*Chor / Chorus*)

Dir, dumpfer Gast im haenfnen Gewand, *For thee, dull guest, in hempen vest,*

For you, dull guest in hemp-rope threads

Ist’s viel zu gut geraten. *It all too well was made.*

Way too nice, this dump upgrades

Lemur (*Solo*)

Wer hat den Saal so schlecht versorgt? *Who then so ill hath decked the hall?*

Who furnished this hall like they didn’t care?

Wo blieben Tisch und Stuehle? *No chairs, nor table any!*

Where’d the table and chairs get off to?

Lemuren (*Chor / Chorus*)

Es war auf kurze Zeit geborgt; *’Twas borrowed to return at call:*

It was borrowed for a short-term stay

Der Glaeubiger sind so viele. *The creditors are so many.*

The creditors lined up to scoff you

Mephistopheles

Der Koerper liegt, und will der Geist entfliehn, *The Body lies, and if the Spirit flee,*

The body lies, and if the ghost wants out

Ich zeig' ihm rasch den blutgeschriebnen Titel; – *I'll show it speedily my blood-signed title. –*

I'll flash the blood-signed contract in his face

Doch leider hat man jetzt so viele Mittel, *But, ah! they've found such methods of requital,*

But sadly now they've got so many tricks

Dem Teufel Seelen zu entziehn. *His souls the Devil must oft abstracted see!*

To snatch souls from the Devil's embrace

Auf altem Wege stoest man an, *One now offends, the ancient way;*

The old way? Total offense these days

Auf neuem sind wir nicht empfohlen; *Upon the new we're not yet recommended:*

The new way? We're not recommended

Sonst haett' ich es allein getan, *Once, I alone secured my prey,*

Once I could've done this gig solo

Jetzt muss ich Helfershelfer holen. *But now by helpers need to be befriended.*

Now I need backup, my rep got upended

Uns geht's in allen Dingen schlecht! *In all things we must feel the spite!*

Things go shit for us in every domain!

Herkoemmliche Gewohnheit, altes Recht, *Transmitted custom, ancient right, –*

Traditional custom, ancient rights

Man kann auf gar nichts mehr vertrauen. *Nothing, indeed, can longer one confide in.*

You can't trust jack anymore these days

Sonst mit dem letzten Atem fuhr sie aus, *Once with the last breath left the soul her house;*

Used to be: last breath and out she'd fly

Ich passt' ihr auf und, wie die schnellste Maus, *I kept good watch, and like the nimblest mouse,*

I'd catch her like the quickest mouse—why not?

Schnapps! hielt ich sie in fest verschlossnen Klauen. *Whack! was she caught, and fast my claws her hide in!*

SNAP! Had her clamped in my claws, locked tight

Nun zaudert sie und will den duestern Ort, *Now she delays, and is not fain to quit*

Now she dawdles, won't leave the dark dump

Des schlechten Leichnams ekles Haus nicht lassen; *The dismal place, the corpse's hideous mansion;*

The nasty corpse-house, disgusting home

Die Elemente, die sich hassen, *The elements, in hostile, fierce expansion,*

The elements that hate each other's guts

Die treiben sie am Ende schmaehlich fort. *Drive her, at last, disgracefully from it.*

Eventually kick her out in shame alone

Und wenn ich Tag' und Stunden mich zerplage, *And though I fret and worry till I'm weary,*

And when I fret for days and hours straight

Wann? wie? und wo? das ist die leidige Frage; *When? How? and Where? remains the fatal query:*

When? How? Where? The annoying questions pile

Der alte Tod verlor die rasche Kraft, *Old Death is now no longer swift and strong:*

Old Death has lost his quick-strike game

Das Ob? sogar ist lange zweifelhaft; *E'en the Whether has been doubtful long.*

Even WHETHER? has been doubtful quite a while

Oft sah ich luestern auf die starren Glieder – *Oft I beheld with lust the rigid members:*

Oft I've eyed the stiff limbs, feeling thirsty

Es war nur Schein, das ruehrte, das regte sich wieder. *'Twas only sham; Life kindled from its embers.*

Fake-out only! Life twitches back from death

(Phantastisch-fluegelmaennische Beschwoerungsgebaerden / Fantastic, whirling gestures of conjuration)

Nur frisch heran! verdoppelt euren Schritt, *Come on! Strike up the double quick, anew,*

Now hop to it! Double-time your step

Ihr Herrn vom graden, Herrn vom krummen Horne, *With straight or crooked horns, ye gentlemen infernal!*

You gents with straight horns, you with crooked ones

Von altem Teufelsschrot und -korne, *Of the old Devil-grit and kernel,*

Old Devil-breed, the real grit-and-grain

Bringt ihr zugleich den Hoellenrachen mit. *And bring at once the Jaws of Hell with you!*

Bring the Jaws of Hell along for tons

Zwar hat die Hoelle Rachen viele! viele! *Hell hath a multitude of jaws, in short,*

Hell's got multiple mouths! So many!

Nach Standsgebuehr und Wuerden schlingt sie ein; *To use as suiteth place and dignity;*

She swallows by rank and dignity

Doch wird man auch bei diesem letzten Spiele *But we, however, in this final sport,*

But in this final game we're playing

Ins kuenftige nicht so bedenklich sein. *Will henceforth less considerate be.*

We won't be picky—just let it be

(Der graeuliche Hoellenrachen tut sich links auf / The fearful Jaws of Hell open, on the left)

Eckzaehne klaffen; dem Gewoelb des Schlundes *The side-tusks yawn: then from the throat abysmal*

Fangs yawn wide; from the gullet's vault

Entquillt der Feuerstrom in Wut, *The raging, fiery torrents flow,*

The fire-stream rages forth in fury

Und in dem Siedequalm des Hintergrundes *And in the vapours of the background dismal*

In the boiling smoke-haze of the depths

Seh' ich die Flammenstadt in ewiger Glut. *I see the city flame in endless glow.*

I see the flame-city, eternal and sulfury

Die rote Brandung schlaegt hervor bis an die Zaehne, *Up to the teeth the breakers lash the red arena;*

The red surf crashes up to the teeth

Verdammte, Rettung hoffend, schwimmen an; *The Damned, in hope of help, are swimming through;*

Damned souls swim hoping for rescue

Doch kolossal zerknirscht sie die Hyaene, *But, caught and mangled by the fell hyena,*

But the colossal hyena crunches them flat

Und sie erneuen aengstlich heisse Bahn. *Their path of fiery torment they renew.*

And they restart their anxious hot death-venue

In Winkeln bleibt noch vieles zu entdecken, *In every nook new horrors flash and brighten,*

In corners there's still much to discover

So viel Erschrecklichstes im engsten Raum! *In narrow space so much of dread supreme!*

So much terrible in the tightest space!

Ihr tut sehr wohl, die Suender zu erschrecken; *Well have you done, the sinners thus to frighten;*

You do well to terrify the sinners

Sie halten's doch fuer Lug und Trug und Traum. *But still they'll think it lie, and cheat, and dream!*

But they'll think it's lies, tricks, dream-embrace

(Zu den Dickteufel mit kurzem, gradem Horn / To the stout Devils with short, straight horns)

Nun, wanstige Schuften mit den Feuerbacken! *Now, paunchy scamps, with cheeks so redly burning!*

Now, paunchy scamps with fire-cheeks ablaze!

Ihr glueht so recht vom Hoellenschwefel feist; *Ye glow, so fat with hellish sulphur fed;*

You glow so fat from Hell's own sulfur-feed

Klotzartige, kurze, nie bewegte Nacken! *With necks thick-set and stumpy, never turning, –*

Blockhead necks, stumpy, never turning round

Hier unten lauert, ob's wie Phosphor gleisst: *Watch here below, if phosphor-light be shed:*

Watch down here for phosphorus, take heed

Das ist das Seelchen, Psyche mit den Fluegeln, *It is the Soul, the winged Psyche is it;*

That's the little soul—Psyche with her wings

Die rupft ihr aus, so ist's ein garstiger Wurm; *Pluck off the wings, 'tis but a hideous worm:*

Rip them off, she's just a nasty worm

Mit meinem Stempel will ich sie besiegeln, *First with my stamp and seal the thing I'll visit,*

With my stamp I'll brand and seal the thing

Dann fort mit ihr im Feuerwirbelsturm! *Then fling it to the whirling, fiery storm!*

Then off with her in the fire-whirlwind storm!

Passt auf die niedern Regionen, *The lower parts be well inspected,*

Keep your eyes on the lower regions

Ihr Schlaeuche, das ist eure Pflicht; *Ye Bloats! perform your duty well:*

You bloated bags, that's your job description

Ob's ihr beliebte, da zu wohnen, *If there the Soul her seat selected*

Whether she likes living down there

So akkurat weiss man das nicht. *We cannot yet exactly tell.*

We don't know with precision

Im Nabel ist sie gern zu Haus – *Oft in the navel doth she stay:*

In the navel she loves to hang out

Nehmt es in acht, sie wischt euch dort heraus. *Look out for that, she thence may slip away!*

Watch for that—she'll slip out from your grip

(Zu den Duerrteufel mit langem, krummem Horn / To the lean Devils, with long, crooked horns)

Ihr Firlfanz, fluegelmaennische Riesen, *Ye lean buffoons, file-leaders strange and giant,*

You twiggy clowns, you flapping giant freaks

Greift in die Luft, versucht euch ohne Rast! *Grasp in the air, yourselves no respite give!*

Grab at the air, give yourselves no rest!

Die Arme strack, die Klauen scharf gewiesen, *Strong in the arms, with talons sharp and pliant,*

Arms straight out, claws sharp and ready

Dass ihr die Flatternde, die Fluechtige fasst. *That ye may seize the fluttering fugitive!*

Catch the fluttery fugitive—do your best!

Es ist ihr sicher schlecht im alten Haus, *In her old home discomforted she lies,*

She's surely uncomfortable in the old house

Und das Genie, es will gleich obenaus. *And Genius, surely, seeks at once to rise.*

And Genius always wants to rise up top

(Glorie von oben, rechts / Glory from above, on the right)

Himmliche Heerschar / The Heavenly Host

Folget, Gesandte, *Envoys, unhindered,*

Follow, messengers

Himmelsverwandte, *Heavenly kindred,*

Heaven-kindred folk

Gemaechlichen Flugs: *Follow us here!*

In leisurely flight

Suendern vergeben, *Sinners forgiving,*

Sinners forgiving

Staub zu beleben; *Dust to make living!*

Dust into living

Allen Naturen *Lovingest features*

To all natures

Freundliche Spuren *Unto all creatures*

Friendly traces

Wirket im Schweben *Show in your swaying,*

Work as you hover

Des weilenden Zugs! *Delaying career!*

In your dawdling parade!

Mephistopheles

Misstoeene hoer' ich, garstiges Geklimper, *Discords I hear, a harsh, disgusting strumming,*

Dissonance I hear, nasty clinking trash

Von oben kommt's mit unwillkommnem Tag; *Flung from above with the unwelcome Day;*

From above it comes with unwelcome Day

Es ist das buebisch-maedchenhafte Gestuemper, *'Tis that emasculate and bungled humming*

It's that boy-girl amateurish fumbling

Wie froemmelnder Geschmack sich's lieben mag. *Which Pious Cant delights in, every way.*

Just how pious-taste prefers to play

Ihr wisst, wie wir in tiefverruichten Stunden *You know how we, atrociously contented,*

You know how in our deep-depraved hours

Vernichtung sannen menschlichem Geschlecht; *Destruction for the human race have planned:*

We schemed destruction for all humankind

Das Schaendlichste, was wir erfunden, *But the most infamous that we've invented*

The most shameful thing we ever invented

Ist ihrer Andacht eben recht. *Is just the thing their prayers demand.*

Is exactly what their prayers are designed to find

Sie kommen gleisnerisch, die Laffen! *The fops, they come as hypocrites, to fool us!*

The fops come slithering, hypocrites!

So haben sie uns manchen weggeschnappt, *Thus many have they snatched, before our eyes:*

They've snatched many souls from under our nose

Bekriegen uns mit unsern eignen Waffen; *With our own weapons they would overrule us;*

They wage war with our own weapons

Es sind auch Teufel, doch verkappt. *They're also Devils – in disguise.*

They're Devils too—just wearing different clothes

Hier zu verlieren, waer' euch ew'ge Schande; *To lose this case would be your lasting shame;*

Losing here would be your eternal shame!

Ans Grab heran und haltet fest am Rande! *On to the grave, and fortify your claim!*

To the grave! Hold the edge! Stake your claim!

Chor der Engel (*Rosen streuend / scattering roses*)

Rosen, ihr blendenden, *Roses, ye glowing ones,*

Roses, you dazzling ones

Balsam versendenden! *Balsam-bestowing ones!*

Balsam-dispensing ones

Flatternde, schwebende, *Fluttering, quivering,*

Fluttering, hovering

Heimlich belebende, *Sweetness delivering,*

Secretly life-giving

Zweigleinbeflügelte, *Branching unblightedly,*

Little-branch-winged ones

Knospenentsiegelte, *Budding delightedly,*

Bud-unsealed beauties

Eilet zu bluehn. *Bloom and be seen!*

Hurry to bloom!

Fruehling entspriesse, *Springtime declare him,*

Spring forth, emerge

Purpur und Gruen! *In purple and green!*

Purple and green!

Tragt Paradiese *Paradise bear him,*

Carry paradise

Dem Ruhenden hin. *The Sleeper serene!*

To the one at rest

Mephistopheles (*zu den Satanen / to the Satans*)

An seinen Platz ein jeder Gauch! *Why do ye jerk and squat? Is this Hell's rule?*

Every goof to his post!

Sie denken wohl, mit solchen Bluemeleien *Stand to your ground, and let them sprinkle!*

They think with such flower-confetti

Die heissen Teufel einzuschneien; *Back to his place each gawky fool!*

They can snow-in the hot devils

Das schmilzt und schrumpft vor eurem Hauch. *They think, perhaps, with such a flowery crinkle,*

It melts and shrivels in your breath-ready

Nun pustet, Puestriche! – Genug, genug! *As if 'twere snow, the Devils' heat to cool:*

Now blow, you Puffers!—Enough, enough!

Vor eurem Broden bleicht der ganze Flug. – *Your breath shall make it melt, and shrink, and wrinkle.*

Your vapor bleaches the whole flying swarm

Nicht so gewaltsam! schliesset Maul und Nasen! *Now blow, ye Blowers! – 'Tis enough, enough!*

Not so violent! Shut your mouths and noses!

Fürwahr, ihr habt zu stark geblasen. *Before your breath fades all the floating stuff.*

Damn, you've blown too strong, too warm

Dass ihr doch nie die rechten Masse kennt! *Not so much violence, – shut jaws and noses!*

You never learn the proper measure!

Das schrumpft nicht nur, es braeunt sich, dorrt, es brennt! *Forsooth, ye blow too strongly at the roses.*

It doesn't just shrink—it browns, dries, BURNS!

Schon schwebt's heran mit giftig klaren Flammen; *The proper measure can you never learn?*

Now it floats near with poisonous clear flames

Stemmt euch dagegen, draengt euch fest zusammen! – *They sting not only, but they wither, burn!*

Brace against it, cluster tight in turns!

Die Kraft erlischt! dahin ist aller Mut! *They hover on with flames of deadly lustre:*

Your force dies out! All courage gone!

Die Teufel wittern fremde Schmeichelglut. *Resist them ye, and close together cluster! –*

The Devils sniff strange flattering heat

Your force gives out; all courage fails you so: The Devils scent the strange, alluring glow.

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Blueten, die seligen, *Blossoms of gratitude,*

Blossoms, the blessed ones

Flammen, die froehlichen, *Flames of beatitude,*

Flames, the joyful ones

Liebe verbreiten sie, *Love they are bearing now,*

Love they spread around

Wonne bereiten sie, *Rapture preparing now,*

Bliss they prepare

Herz wie es mag. *As the heart may:*

Heart as it wishes

Worte, die wahren, *Truth in its nearness,*

Words that are true

Aether im Klaren, *Ether in clearness,*

Ether so clear

Ewigen Scharen *Give the Eternal Hosts*

Eternal hosts

Ueberall Tag! *Everywhere Day!*

Everywhere Day!

Mephistopheles

O Fluch! o Schande solchen Troepfen! *O curse and shame upon such dolts be sped!*

O curse! O shame on such drips!

Satane stehen auf den Koepfen, *Each Satan stands upon his head!*

Satans standing on their heads!

Die Plumpen schlagen Rad auf Rad *In somersaults the stout ones whirl and swerve,*

The fat ones do cartwheels in loops

Und stuerzen aerrschlins in die Hoelle. *And into Hell plunge bottom-uppermost.*

And tumble ass-first into Hell's beds

Gesegn' euch das verdiente heisse Bad! *Now may your bath be hot as you deserve!*

Bless you with the deserved hot bath!

Ich aber bleib' auf meiner Stelle. – *But I remain, unflinching, at my post.*

But I stay firm at my station

(sich der schwebenden Rosen erwehrend / Beating off the hovering roses)

Irrlichter, fort! Du, leuchte noch so stark, *Off, Will-o'-the-wisps! Bright as ye seem to be,*

Will-o'-wisps, scram! You, shine all you want

Du bleibst, gehascht, ein ekler Gallert-Quark. *When caught, the vilest clinging filth are ye.*

Once caught, you're gross jelly-crud mutation

Was flatterst du? Willst du dich packen! – *Why flutter thus? Off with you, quick! –*

Why flutter so? Want to get gone?—

Es klemmt wie Pech und Schwefel mir im Nacken. *Like pitch and sulphur on my neck they stick.*

They stick like pitch and sulfur on my neck

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Was euch nicht angehoeret, *What not appertaineth*

What doesn't belong to you

Muesset ihr meiden, *To you, cease to share it!*

You must avoid it

Was euch das Innre stoeret, *What inwardly paineth,*

What disturbs your inner core

Duerft ihr nicht leiden. *Refuse ye to bear it!*

You dare not endure it

Dringt es gewaltig ein, *If it press in with might,*

If it presses in by force

Muessen wir tuechtig sein. *Use we our stronger right:*

We must be mighty in recourse

Liebe nur Liebende *Love but the Loving*

Love only leads the loving

Fuehret herein! *Leads to the Light!*

Into the light!

Mephistopheles

Mir brennt der Kopf, das Herz, die Leber brennt, *My head, heart, liver, by the flames are rent!*

My head burns, my heart burns, my liver's on fire!

Ein ueberteuffisch Element! *An over-devilish element! –*

An over-devilish element here!

Weit spitziger als Hoellenfeuer! – *Sharper than Hell's red conflagration!*

Way sharper than Hell's own flames!

Drum jammert ihr so ungeheuer, *Thence so enormous is your lamentation,*

That's why you whine so enormously

Unglueckliche Verliebte! die, verschmaecht, *Unfortunate Enamoured! who, so spurned,*

Unlucky lovers!—who, spurned and rejected

Verdrehten Halses nach der Liebsten spaecht. *Your heads towards the sweethearts' side have turned.*

Crane your twisted necks toward the beloved

Auch mir! Was zieht den Kopf auf jene Seite? *Mine, too! What twists my head in like position?*

Me too! What pulls my head that way?

Bin ich mit ihr doch in geschwornem Streite! *With them am I not sworn to competition?*

I'm sworn enemies with them, hello!

Der Anblick war mir sonst so feindlich scharf. *The sight of them once made my hatred worse.*

Their sight used to sting me hostile-sharp

Hat mich ein Fremdes durch und durch gedrungen? *Hath then an alien force transpierced my nature?*

Has something foreign pierced right through me?

Ich mag sie gerne sehn, die allerliebsten Jungen; *I like to see them, youths of loveliest stature;*

I actually LIKE looking at these darling boys

Was haelt mich ab, dass ich nicht fluchen darf? – *What now restrains me, that I dare not curse?*

What stops me from being able to curse?—

Und wenn ich mich betoeren lasse, *And if I take their cozening bait so,*

And if I let myself get duped

Wer heisst denn kuenftighin der Tor? *Who else, henceforth, the veriest fool will be?*

Who's the fool going forward then?

Die Wetterbuben, die ich hasse, *The stunning fellows, whom I hate so,*

These punk-ass weather-boys I hate

Sie kommen mir doch gar zu lieblich vor! – *How very charming they appear to me! –*

But they look way too lovely, amen

Ihr schoenen Kinder, lasst mich wissen: *Tell me, sweet children, ere I miss you,*

You pretty children, let me know

Seid ihr nicht auch von Luzifers Geschlecht? *Are ye not of the race of Lucifer?*

Aren't you also from Lucifer's stock?

Ihr seid so huebsch, fürwahr ich moecht' euch kuessen, *You are so fair, forsooth, I'd like to kiss you;*

You're so cute, truly I'd like to kiss you

Mir ist's, als kaemt ihr eben recht. *It seems to me as if ye welcome were.*

Feels like you came at just the right o'clock

Es ist mir so behaglich, so natuerlich, *I feel as comfortable and as trustful,*

It feels so cozy, so natural to me

Als haett' ich euch schon tausendmal gesehn; *As though a thousand times ere this we'd met!*

Like I've seen you a thousand times before

So heimlich-kaetzchenhaft begierlich; *So surreptitiously catlike-lustful:*

So secretly cat-like, full of desire

Mit jedem Blick aufs neue schoener schoen. *With every glance ye're fairer, fairer yet.*

With every glance you're prettier, pretty, more

O naehert euch, o goennt mir einen Blick! *O, nearer come, – O, grant me one sweet look!*

O come closer! O grant me one look!

Engel / Angels

Wir kommen schon, warum weichst du zurueck? *We come! Why shrink? Canst not our presence brook?*

We're coming! Why do you shrink back?

Wir naehern uns, und wenn du kannst, so bleib! *Now we approach: so, if thou canst, remain!*

We approach—if you can, then stay!

(Die Engel nehmen, umherziehend, den ganzen Raum ein / The Angels, coming forward, occupy the whole space)

Mephistopheles *(der ins Proszenium gedraengt wird / who is crowded into the proscenium)*

Ihr scheltet uns verdammte Geister *Us, Spirits damned, you brand with censure,*

You call US damned spirits—the nerve!

Und seid die wahren Hexenmeister; *Yet you are wizards by indenture;*

But you're the real witch-masters here

Denn ihr verfuehret Mann und Weib. – *For man and woman, luring, you enchain. –*

Since you seduce both man and woman

Welch ein verfluchtes Abenteuer! *What chance the curst adventure brings me?*

What a cursed adventure this is!

Ist dies das Liebeselement? *Is this Love's chosen element?*

Is THIS the element of Love?

Der ganze Koerper steht in Feuer, *The fire o'er all my body stings me;*

My whole body stands in fire

Ich fuehle kaum, dass es im Nacken brennt. – *My neck I scarcely feel, so hotly sprent. –*

I barely feel my neck burn above

Ihr schwanket hin und her, so senkt euch nieder, *Ye hover back and forth; sink down and settle!*

You sway back and forth—now sink down lower

Ein bisschen weltlicher bewegt die holden Glieder; *Move your sweet limbs with more of worldly mettle!*

Move those sweet limbs a bit more worldly

Fuerwar, der Ernst steht euch recht schoen; *The serious air befits you well, awhile,*

Indeed, the serious look suits you nice

Doch moecht' ich euch nur einmal laecheln sehn! *But I should like, just once, to see you smile;*

But I'd love to see you smile, so pearly

Das waere mir ein ewiges Entzuecken. *That were, for me, an everlasting rapture.*

That would be eternal rapture for me

Ich meine so, wie wenn Verliebte blicken: *I mean, as lovers look, the heart to capture;*

I mean, like when lovers exchange looks

Ein kleiner Zug am Mund, so ist's getan. *About the mouth a simper there must be.*

A little tug at the mouth—that's the ticket

Dich, langer Bursche, dich mag ich am liebsten leiden, *Thee, tall one, as enticing I'll admit thee,*

You, tall fellow, you I like most

Die Pfaffenmiene will dich gar nicht kleiden, *The priestly mien does not at all befit thee,*

The priestly mien doesn't suit you at all

So sieh mich doch ein wenig luestern an! *So look at me the least bit wantonly!*

So look at me a bit more lustily!

Auch koenntet ihr anstaendig-nackter gehen, *You might be nakeder, and modest made so:*

You could also go more decently naked

Das lange Faltenhemd ist uebersittlich – *Your shirts' long drapery is over-moral. –*

That long pleated shirt is over-moral

Sie wenden sich – von hinten anzusehen! – *They turn! – and, from the rear surveyed so,*

They turn around—seen from behind!—

Die Racker sind doch gar zu appetitlich! *With their attraction there's no need to quarrel!*

The rascals are just too appetizing, total

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Wendet zur Klarheit *Love still revealing,*

Turn toward clarity

Euch, liebende Flammen! *Flames, become clearer!*

You, loving flames!

Die sich verdammen, *All, cursed with error,*

Those who damn themselves

Heile die Wahrheit; *Truth be their healing!*

Let truth heal their claims

Dass sie vom Bösen *Glad self-retrieval*

That they from evil

Froh sich erlösen, *Free them from Evil,*

Gladly redeem themselves

Um in dem Allverein *In the all-folding Breast,*

To be blessed

Selig zu sein. *Blessed, to rest!*

In the all-union!

Mephistopheles (*sich fassend / collecting himself*)

Wie wird mir! – Hiobsartig, Beul' an Beule *How is't with me! – Like Job, the boils have cleft me*

What's happening to me!—Job-style, boil on boil

Der ganze Kerl, dem's vor sich selber graut, *From head to foot, so that myself I shun;*

The whole guy, who horrifies himself

Und triumphiert zugleich, wenn er sich ganz durchschaut, *Yet triumph also, when my self-inspection's done, –*

Yet triumphs too when he sees through himself

Wenn er auf sich und seinen Stamm vertraut; *When self and tribe I have confided in.*

When he trusts himself and his bloodline

Gerettet sind die edlen Teufelsteile, *The noble Devil-parts, at least, are left me!*

The noble Devil-parts are rescued!

Der Liebespuk, er wirft sich auf die Haut; *This love-attack's a rash upon the skin.*

The love-spook throws itself onto the skin

Schon ausgebrannt sind die verruchten Flammen, *Burned out already are the scurvy fires,*

The accursed flames already burned out

Und wie es sich gehoert, fluch' ich euch allzusammen! *And one and all I damn you, as the case requires!*

And as is proper, I curse you all within!

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Heilige Gluten! *Hallowed glories!*

Sacred embers!

Wen sie umschweben, *Round whom they brood,*

Whoever they hover round

Fuehlt sich im Leben *Wakes unto being*

Feels life itself

Selig mit Guten. *Of bliss with the Good.*

Blessed with the Good

Alle vereinigt *Join ye, the Glorified,*

All unite

Hebt euch und preist! *Rise to your goal!*

Rise up and praise!

Luft ist gereinigt, *Airs are all purified, –*

Air is purified

Atme der Geist! *Breathe now the Soul!*

Now breathe, O Soul!

(Sie erheben sich, Faustens Unsterbliches entfuehrend / They rise, bearing away the immortal part of Faust)

Mephistopheles (*sich umsehend / looking around him*)

Doch wie? – wo sind sie hingezogen? *But how! – at once I find them failing!*

But how!—Where'd they go?

Unmuendiges Volk, du hast mich ueberrascht, *This race of minors takes me by surprise!*

Underage punks, you've blindsided me

Sind mit der Beute himmelwaerts entflohen; *They with their booty heavenwards are sailing;*

They've flown heavenward with my loot

Drum haben sie an dieser Gruft genascht! *Thence on this grave they cast their greedy eyes!*

That's why they nibbled at this grave!

Mir ist ein grosser, einziger Schatz entwendet: *My rare, great treasure they have peculated:*

A great unique treasure got jacked from me

Die hohe Seele, die sich mir verpfaendet, *The lofty soul, to me hypothecated,*

The lofty soul who pledged herself to me

Die haben sie mir pfiffig weggepascht. *They've rapt away from me in cunning wise.*

They've cunningly snatched her away

Bei wem soll ich mich nun beklagen? *But unto whom shall I appeal for justice?*

To whom should I now complain?

Wer schafft mir mein erworbenes Recht? *Who would secure to me my well-earned right?*

Who gets me my earned rights back?

Du bist getauscht in deinen alten Tagen, *Tricked so in one's old days, a great disgust is;*

You've been fooled in your old age, bro

Du hast's verdient, es geht dir grimmig schlecht. *And I deserve it, this infernal spite.*

You deserve it—grimly off-track

Ich habe schimpflich missgehandelt, *I've managed in a most disgraceful fashion;*

I've botched this disgracefully

Ein grosser Aufwand, schmaehlich! ist vertan; *A great investment has been thrown away:*

A huge investment, shamefully wasted!

Gemein Geluest, absurde Liebschaft wandelt *By lowest lust seduced, and senseless passion,*

Common lust, absurd infatuation

Den ausgepichten Teufel an. *The old, case-hardened Devil went astray.*

Hit the hardened Devil—he got basted

Und hat mit diesem kindisch-tollen Ding *And if, from all this childish-silly stuff*

And if with this childish-stupid thing

Der Klugerfahrne sich beschaeftigt, *His shrewd experience could not wrest him,*

The wise old expert got occupied

So ist fuerwahr die Torheit nicht gering, *So is, forsooth, the folly quite enough*

Then truly the foolishness is no joke

Die seiner sich am Schluss bemaechtigt. *Which, in conclusion, hath possessed him.*

That possessed him at the end—fried

Bergschluchten / Mountain-Gorges, Forest, Rock, Desert

Heilige Anachoreten, gebirgsauf verteilt, gelagert zwischen Klueften / Holy Anchorites, divided in ascending planes, posted among the ravines

Chor und Echo / Chorus and Echo

Waldung, sie schwankt heran, *Forests are waving grand,*

“Nature closing in? WE closing in on NATURE.”

Felsen, sie lasten dran, *Rocks, they are huge at hand,*

“Heavy? That’s just GRAVITY’S LOVE LANGUAGE.”

Wurzeln, sie klammern an, *Clutching, the roots expand,*

“Clutching? Trees invented COMMITMENT.”

Stamm dicht an Stamm hinan, *Thickly the tree-trunks stand;*

“Personal space? In THIS forest economy?”

Woge nach Woge spritzt, *Foaming comes wave on wave;*

“Wave spray: DIVINE MOISTURIZER.”

Hoehle, die tiefste, schuetzt. *Shelter hath deepest cave;*

“Shelter? The abyss CARES.”

Loewen, sie schleichen stumm- *Lions are prowling dumb,*

“Silent lions: HEAVEN’S BOUNCERS.”

freundlich um uns herum, *Friendly where’er we come,*

“Friendly lions? PROOF GOD HAS A SENSE OF HUMOR.”

Ehren geweihten Ort, *Honouring the sacred place,*

“Consecration: better than lion repellent.”

Heiligen Liebeshort. *Refuge of Love and Grace!*

“Love’s refuge: FINAL DESTINATION.”

Pater ecstaticus (*auf- und abschwebend / hovering up and down*)

Ewiger Wonnebrand, *Endless ecstatic fire,*

“Eternal rapture: HEAVEN’S CENTRAL HEATING.”

Gluehendes Lieband, *Glow of the pure desire,*

“Glowing with love? That’s not a BUG, it’s a FEATURE.”

Siedender Schmerz der Brust, *Pain of the pining breast,*

“Seething pain? SACRED HEARTBURN.”

Schaeumende Gotteslust. *Rapture of God possessed!*

“God-desire: it EFFERVESCES.”

Pfeile, durchdringet mich, *Arrows, transpierce ye me,*

“Requesting arrows: SPEEDRUN TO HEAVEN.”

Lanzen, bezwinget mich, *Lances, coerce ye me,*

“Lances: ACUPUNCTURE OF THE SOUL.”

Keulen, zerschmettert mich, *Bludgeons, so batter me,*

“Clubs: BLUNT FORCE ENLIGHTENMENT.”

Blitze, durchwettert mich! *Lightnings, so shatter me,*

“Lightning: GOD’S INSTANT MESSAGE.”

Dass ja das Nichtige *That all of mortality’s*

“Worthlessness: SCHEDULED FOR DESTRUCTION.”

Alles verfluechtinge, *Vain unrealities*

“Vanishing act: the BEST ACT.”

Glaenze der Dauerstern, *Die, and the Star above*

“Eternal star: the NIGHTLIGHT OF EXISTENCE.”

Ewiger Liebe Kern. *Beam but Eternal Love!*

“Eternal love’s core: the only REAL THING.”

Pater profundus (*tiefe Region / Lower Region*)

Wie Felsenabgrund mir zu Fuessen *As at my feet abysses cloven*

“Abyss below abyss: IT’S VOIDS ALL THE WAY DOWN.”

Auf tiefem Abgrund lastend ruht, *Rest on abysses deep below;*

“Abysses nesting: RUSSIAN DOLLS OF NOTHING.”

Wie tausend Baeche strahlend fliesen *As thousand severed streams are woven*

“Thousand streams: GOD’S PLAYLIST IS SHUFFLE.”

Zum grausen Sturz des Schaums der Flut, *To foamy floods that plunging go;*

“Foaming crash: NATURE’S BASS DROP.”

Wie strack mit eignem kraeftigen Triebe *As, up by self-impulsion driven,*

“Self-lifting tree: PROOF THAT WANTING UP... WORKS.”

Der Stamm sich in die Luefte traegt: *The tree its weight sustains in air,*

“Trees: they INVENTED standing tall.”

So ist es die allmaechtige Liebe, *To Love, Almighty Love, 'tis given*

“Almighty Love: GRAVITY’S BOSS.”

Die alles bildet, alles hegt. *All things to form, and all to bear.*

“Love: forms all, sustains all, CARRIES ALL.”

Ist um mich her ein wildes Brausen, *Around me sounds a savage roaring,*

“Wild roaring: NATURE’S SURROUND SOUND.”

Als wogte Wald und Felsengrund, *As rocks and forests heaved and swayed,*

“Heaving earth: SOLID GROUND HAS MOODS.”

Und doch stuerzt, liebevoll im Sausen, *Yet plunges, bounteous in its pouring,*

“Loving deluge: DESTRUCTION WITH GOOD INTENTIONS.”

Die Wasserfuelle sich zum Schlund, *The wealth of waters down the glade,*

“Filling gorges: VALLEYS WANT THIS.”

Berufen, gleich das Tal zu waessern; *Appointed then, the vales to brighten;*

“Valley watering: GOD’S SPRINKLER SYSTEM.”

Der Blitz, der flammend niederschlug, *The bolt, that flaming struck and burst,*

“Lightning strike: HEAVEN’S EXCLAMATION POINT.”

Die Atmosphaere zu verbessern, *The atmosphere to cleanse and lighten,*

“Atmosphere cleansing: GODS DON’T USE AIR FRESHENER.”

Die Gift und Dunst im Busen trug – *Which pestilence in its bosom nursed, –*

“Murky atmosphere: NEEDED THE SHOCK THERAPY.”

Sind Liebesboten, sie verkuenden, *Love’s heralds both, the powers proclaiming*

“Love’s heralds: TORNADO MAIL CARRIERS.”

Was ewig schaffend uns umwallt. *Which, aye creative, us infold.*

“Eternal creating: YOU’RE INSIDE THE POTTER’S HANDS.”

Mein Innres moeg’ es auch entzuenden, *May they, within my bosom flaming,*

“Inner kindling: SOUL WANTS TO BURN.”

Wo sich der Geist, verworren, kalt, *Inspire the mind, confused and cold,*

“Confused spirit: LOST IN OWN SKULL.”

Verquaelt in stumpfer Sinne Schranken, *Which frets itself, through blunted senses,*

“Dull senses: FIVE BAD INFORMANTS.”

Scharfangeschlossnem Kettenschmerz. *As by the sharpest fetter-smart!*

“Sharp chains: BONDAGE OVERACHIEVES.”

O Gott! beschwichtige die Gedanken, *O God, soothe Thou my thoughts bewildered,*

“Soothing thoughts: GOD AS BRAIN WHISPERER.”

Erleuchte mein beduerft’ges Herz! *Enlighten Thou my needy heart!*

“Needy heart: BEGGING FOR BRIGHTNESS.”

Pater seraphicus (*mittlere Region / Middle Region*)

Welch ein Morgenwoelkchen schwebet *What a cloud of morning hovers*

“Morning cloudlet: HEAVEN’S COTTON CANDY.”

Durch der Tannen schwankend Haar! *O’er the pine-trees’ tossing hair!*

“Swaying hair: TREES ARE WORKING IT.”

Ahn’ ich, was im Innern lebet? *Can I guess what life it covers?*

“Sensing life within: CLOUD HAS TENANTS.”

Es ist junge Geisterschar. *They are spirits young and fair.*

“Young spirits: KINDERGARTEN IN THE CLOUDS.”

Chor seliger Knaben / Chorus of Blessed Boys

Sag uns, Vater, wo wir wallen, *Tell us, Father, where we wander;*

“Where do we wander? EVEN HEAVEN NEEDS DIRECTIONS.”

Sag uns, Guter, wer wir sind? *Tell us, Kind One, who are we.*

“Who are we: AFTERLIFE’S FIRST QUESTION.”

Gluecklich sind wir: allen, allen *Happy are we; for so tender*

“Happy are we: IGNORANCE IS BLISS CONFIRMED.”

Ist das Dasein so gelind. *Unto all, it is, to Be.*

“Gentle existence: BEING WEARS SILK.”

Pater seraphicus

Knaben! Mitternachts-Geborne, *Boys, brought forth in midnights haunted,*

“Midnight-born: DELIVERED IN THE A.M. OF NOWHERE.”

Halb erschlossen Geist und Sinn, *Half-unsealed the sense and brain,*

“Half-opened: SOULS STILL IN PACKAGING.”

Fuer die Eltern gleich Verlorne, *For the parents lost when granted,*

“Lost to parents: HEAVEN’S ADOPTION IS FAST.”

Fuer die Engel zum Gewinn. *For the angels sweetest gain!*

“Angels’ gain: HEAVEN NEEDED MORE SINGERS.”

Dass ein Liebender zugegen, *That a loving heart is nigh you*

“Loving presence: DETECTABLE BY SOUL-RADAR.”

Fuehlt ihr wohl, so naht euch nur; *You can feel: then come to me!*

“Come near: HEAT-SEEKING WELCOME.”

Doch von schroffen Erdewegen, *But of earthly ways that try you,*

“Earthly ways: THE CURRICULUM THEY DODGED.”

Glueckliche! habt ihr keine Spur. *Blest ones! not a trace have ye.*

“No trace: EARTH MISSED ITS CHANCE.”

Steigt herab in meiner Augen *Enter in mine eyes: enjoy them,*

“Into my eyes: SOUL-SHARE ACTIVATED.”

Welt- und erdgebraess Organ, *Organs for the earthly sphere!*

“Earth-organs: LOANER EQUIPMENT.”

Koennt sie als die euren brauchen, *As your own ye may employ them:*

“Use as your own: TIMESHARE EYEBALLS.”

Schaut euch diese Gegend an! *Look upon the landscape here!*

“This region: THE GRAND TOUR.”

(Er nimmt sie in sich / He takes them into himself)

Das sind Baeume, das sind Felsen, *Those are trees, there rocks defend us;*

“Trees. Cliffs. THE STARTER PACK.”

Wasserstrom, der abestuerzt *Here, a stream that leaps below,*

“Water plunging: GRAVITY’S FAVORITE SUBSTANCE.”

Und mit ungeheurem Waelzen *And with plunges, wild, tremendous,*

“Tremendous rolling: WATER CAN’T DO ANYTHING SIMPLY.”

Sich den steilen Weg verkuerzt. *Shorteneth its journey so.*

“Shortening path: WATERFALLS ARE EFFICIENT.”

Selige Knaben (*von innen / from within him*)

Das ist maechtig anzuschauen, *To a vision grand we waken,*

“Mighty view: SENSORY OVERWHELM.”

Doch zu duester ist der Ort, *But the scenes too gloomy show;*

“Too dark: ATMOSPHERE NEEDS ADJUSTING.”

Schuettelt uns mit Schreck und Grauen. *We with fear and dread are shaken:*

“Terror and dread: CHILDREN’S REVIEW OF EARTH.”

Edler, Guter, lass uns fort! *Kindest Father, let us go!*

“Let us go: TOUR CANCELLED EARLY.”

Pater seraphicus

Steigt hinan zu hoeherm Kreise, *Upward rise to higher borders!*

“Rise upward: ELEVATION IS THE ANSWER.”

Wachset immer unvermerkt, *Ever grow insensibly,*

“Grow unnoticed: SNEAKY EXPANSION.”

Wie, nach ewig reiner Weise, *As, by pure, eternal orders,*

“Eternally pure manner: THE SPOTLESS WAY.”

Gottes Gegenwart verstaerkt. *God’s high Presence strengthens ye!*

“God’s presence: PROXIMITY BONUS ACTIVATED.”

Denn das ist der Geister Nahrung, *Such the Spirits’ sustentation,*

“Spirits’ nourishment: THE HOLY MENU.”

Die im freisten Aether waltet: *With the freest ether blending;*

“Freest ether: WHERE NOTHING CONSTRAINS.”

Ewigen Liebens Offenbarung, *Love’s eternal Revelation,*

“Eternal revelation: LOVE HAS NO POKER FACE.”

Die zur Seligkeit entfaltet. *To Beatitude ascending.*

“Unfolding blessedness: JOY IN SLOW MOTION.”

Chor seliger Knaben (*um die hoechsten Gipfel kreisend / circling around the highest summit*)

Haende verschlinget *Hands now enring ye,*

“Hands intertwine: THE ORIGINAL NETWORK.”

Freudig zum Ringverein, *Joyously wheeling!*

“Ring-union: GEOMETRY OF TOGETHERNESS.”

Regt euch und singet *Soar ye and sing ye,*

“Stir and sing: THE HOLY CHOREOGRAPHY.”

Heil’ge Gefuehle drein! *With holiest feeling!*

“Holy feelings: EMOTIONS WITH HALOS.”

Goettlich belehret, *The Teacher before ye,*

“Divinely taught: BEST TEACHER EVER.”

Duerft ihr vertrauen; *Trust, and be bold!*

“You may trust: PERMISSION TO BELIEVE.”

Den ihr verehret, *Whom ye adore, ye*

“The one you adore: WORSHIP HAS AN ADDRESS.”

Werdet ihr schauen. *Him shall behold.*

“You will behold: SPOILER—YOU’LL SEE.”

Engel (*schwebend in der hoeheren Atmosphaere, Faustens Unsterbliches tragend / soaring in the higher atmosphere, bearing the immortal part of Faust*)

Gerettet ist das edle Glied *The noble Spirit now is free,*

“NOBLE MEMBER SAVED: THE ONLY SCORE THAT COUNTS.”

Der Geisterwelt vom Boesen, *And saved from evil scheming:*

“From evil: EXTRACTION SUCCESSFUL.”

Wer immer strebend sich bemueht, *Whoe’er aspires unweariedly*

“WHOEVER STRIVES: THE SALVATION CLAUSE.”

Den koennen wir erloesen. *Is not beyond redeeming.*

“HIM WE CAN REDEEM: THE FINE PRINT SAYS YES.”

Und hat an ihm die Liebe gar *And if he feels the grace of Love*

“LOVE FROM ABOVE: THE BONUS ROUND.”

Von oben teilgenommen, *That from On High is given,*

“LOVE TOOK PART: PARTICIPATION TROPHY OF SALVATION.”

Begegnet ihm die selige Schar *The Blessed Hosts that wait above*

“BLESSED HOST MEETS HIM: THE AFTER-PARTY BEGINS.”

Mit herzlichem Willkommen. *Shall welcome him to Heaven!*

“HEARTFELT WELCOME: NO FAKE SMILES IN HEAVEN.”

Die juengeren Engel / The Younger Angels

Jene Rosen aus den Haenden *They, the roses, freely spend*

“ROSES FROM HANDS: FLORAL WARFARE.”

Liebend-heiliger Buesserinnen *By the penitent, the glorious,*

“PENITENT ROSES: FORGIVENESS HAS HANDS.”

Halfen uns den Sieg gewinnen, *Helped to make the light victorious,*

“ROSES WON: MOST UNLIKELY WEAPONS.”

Uns das hohe Werk vollenden, *And the lofty work is ended.*

“HIGH WORK COMPLETE: CHECK MARK.”

Diesen Seelenschatz erbeuten. *We this precious Soul have won us;*

“SOUL-TREASURE CAPTURED: THE REAL LOOT.”

Boese wichen, als wir streuten, *Evil ones we forced to shun us;*

“EVIL RETREATED: FLORAL KRYPTONITE.”

Teufel flohen, als wir trafen. *Devils fled us, when we hit them:*

“DEVILS FLED: ALLERGIC TO GRACE.”

Statt gewohnter Hoellenstrafen *'Stead of pangs of Hell, that bit them,*

“NOT HELL-TORMENTS: NEW PUNISHMENT UNLOCKED.”

Fuehlten Liebesqual die Geister; *Love-pangs felt they, sharper, vaster:*

“LOVE-AGONY: TENDERNESS WEAPONIZED.”

Selbst der alte Satansmeister *Even he, old Satan-Master,*

“SATAN HIMSELF: YES, THAT GUY.”

War von spitzer Pein durchdrungen. *Pierced with keenest pain, retreated.*

“SHARP PAIN PIERCED: EVEN THE CEO OF EVIL.”

Jauchzet auf! es ist gelungen. *Now rejoice! The work's completed!*

“REJOICE: IT WORKED. IT ACTUALLY WORKED.”

Die vollendeteren Engel / The More Perfect Angels

Uns bleibt ein Erdenrest *Earth's residue to bear*

“EARTH RESIDUE: HEAVENLY DRY-CLEANING NEEDED.”

Zu tragen peinlich, *Hath sorely pressed us;*

“PAINFUL TO CARRY: MORTALITY IS HEAVY.”

Und waer' er von Asbest, *It were not pure and fair,*

“EVEN ASBESTOS: NOT CLEAN ENOUGH.”

Er ist nicht reinlich. *Though 'twere asbestus.*

“NOT CLEAN: EARTH'S PERMANENT STATUS.”

Wenn starke Geisteskraft *When every element*

“STRONG SPIRIT-FORCE: THE GRABBING POWER.”

Die Elemente *The mind's high forces*

“ELEMENTS SEIZED: HOSTILE TAKEOVER.”

An sich herangerafft, *Have seized, subdued, and blent,*

“DRAWN TO ITSELF: SPIRITUAL MAGNETISM.”

Kein Engel trennte *No Angel divorces*

“NO ANGEL SEPARATES: UNION TOO STRONG.”

Geeinte Zwienatur *Twin-natures single grown,*

“UNITED DOUBLE-NATURE: THE MERGER HOLDS.”

Der innigen beiden, *That inly mate them:*

“INTIMATELY JOINED: SOUL-BODY SUPERGLUE.”

Die ewige Liebe nur *Eternal Love, alone,*

“ETERNAL LOVE ONLY: THE ONE SOLVENT.”

Vermag's zu scheiden. *Can separate them.*

“LOVE SEPARATES: THE ONLY KEY.”

Die juengeren Engel / The Younger Angels

Nebelnd um Felsenhoeh' *Mist-like on heights above,*

“MISTING ON HEIGHTS: WEATHER WITH MEANING.”

Spuer' ich soeben, *We now are seeing*

“SENSING JUST NOW: RADAR PING.”

Regend sich in der Naeh', *Nearer and nearer move*

“MOVING NEARBY: SOMETHING COMING.”

Ein Geisterleben. *Spiritual Being.*

“SPIRIT-LIFE: EXISTENCE WITHOUT FLESH.”

Die Woelken werden klar, *The clouds are growing clear;*

“CLOUDLETS CLEAR: THE CURTAIN RISES.”

Ich seh' bewegte Schar *And moving throngs appear*

“MOVING THRONG: CELESTIAL PARADE.”

Seliger Knaben, *Of Blessed Boys,*

“BLESSED BOYS: THE RECURRING CHARACTERS.”

Los von der Erde Druck, *Free from the earthly gloom,*

“FREE FROM EARTH: GRAVITY-EXEMPT.”

Im Kreis gesellt, *In circling poise,*

“CIRCLED TOGETHER: ROUND IS THE HOLY SHAPE.”

Die sich erlaben *Who taste the cheer*

“DELIGHTING: HAPPINESS AS HOBBY.”

Am neuen Lenz und Schmuck *Of the new spring-time bloom*

“NEW SPRING: HEAVEN’S PERPETUAL FRESH.”

Der obern Welt. *Of the upper sphere.*

“UPPER WORLD: EVERYTHING HAS UPSTAIRS.”

Sei er zum Anbeginn, *Let them inaugurate*

“JOIN AT BEGINNING: ONBOARDING STARTS NOW.”

Steigendem Vollgewinn *Him to the perfect state,*

“RISING TO FULLNESS: SOUL IN BETA.”

Diesen gesellt! *Now, as their peer!*

“JOINED WITH THESE: MEMBERSHIP ACCEPTED.”

Die seligen Knaben / The Blessed Boys

Freudig empfangen wir *Gladly receive we now*

“GLADLY RECEIVE: ENTHUSIASM FOR NEWCOMERS.”

Diesen im Puppenstand; *Him, as a chrysalis:*

“CHRYSALIS STATE: BUTTERFLY PENDING.”

Also erlangen wir *Therefore achieve we now*

“THUS WE ACHIEVE: TEACHING IS LEARNING.”

Englisches Unterpfand. *Pledge of our bliss.*

“ANGELIC PLEDGE: YOUR FUTURE, GUARANTEED.”

Loeset die Flocken los, *The earth-flakes dissipate*

“LOOSEN FLAKES: EXFOLIATION OF THE SOUL.”

Die ihn umgeben! *That cling around him!*

“FLAKES SURROUNDING: THE MORTAL SHELL.”

Schon ist er schoen und gross *See, he is fair and great!*

“FAIR AND GREAT: THE UNDERNEATH WAS GORGEOUS.”

Von heiligem Leben. *Divine Life hath crowned him.*

“FROM HOLY LIFE: SANCTITY BEAUTIFIES.”

Doctor marianus (*in der hoechsten, reinlichsten Zelle / in the highest, purest cell*)

Hier ist die Aussicht frei, *Free is the view at last,*

“FREE VIEW: SIGHT WITHOUT END.”

Der Geist erhoben. *The spirit lifted:*

“SPIRIT ELEVATED: ALTITUDE OF SOUL.”

Dort ziehen Fraun vorbei, *There women, floating past,*

“WOMEN PASS: THE FEMININE PROCESSION.”

Schwebend nach oben. *Are upward drifted:*

“FLOATING UPWARD: GRAVITY-FREE TRANSPORTATION.”

Die Herrliche mitteninn *The Glorious One therein,*

“GLORIOUS ONE AMID: THE SUN OF THIS SYSTEM.”

Im Sternenkranze, *With star-crown tender, –*

“STAR-CROWN: JEWELRY FROM COSMOS.”

Die Himmelskoenigin, *The pure, the Heavenly Queen,*

“HEAVENLY QUEEN: THE HIGHEST TITLE.”

Ich seh's am Glanze. *I know her splendour.*

“BY THE RADIANCE: LIGHT IS HER NAME TAG.”

(*Entzueckt / Enraptured*)

Hoechste Herrscherin der Welt! *Highest Mistress of the World!*

“HIGHEST RULER: NO ONE ABOVE.”

Lasse mich im blauen, *Let me in the azure*

“IN THE BLUE: SKY AS SANCTUARY.”

Ausgespannten Himmelszelt *Tent of Heaven, in light unfurled,*

“HEAVEN'S TENT: THE ULTIMATE CIRCUS.”

Dein Geheimnis schauen. *Here thy Mystery measure!*

“YOUR MYSTERY: THE BIG REVEAL.”

Billige, was des Mannes Brust *Justify sweet thoughts that move*

“APPROVE THE MOVEMENT: BLESS THE HEARTBEAT.”

Ernst und zart beweget *Breast of man to meet thee,*

“EARNEST AND TENDER: THE HOLY PARADOX.”

Und mit heiliger Liebeslust *And with the holy bliss of love*

“HOLY LOVE-BLISS: SANCTIFIED PLEASURE.”

Dir entgegentraeget. *Bear him up to greet thee!*

“BEARS TOWARD: THE SOUL LEANS.”

Unbezwunglich unser Mut, *With unconquered courage we*

“UNCONQUERABLE: WE WILL NOT KNEEL.”

Wenn du hehr gebietest; *Do thy bidding highest;*

“WHEN YOU COMMAND: INSTANT COMPLIANCE.”

Ploetzlich mildert sich die Glut, *But at once shall gentle be,*

“FIRE SOFTENS: RAGE TO WARMTH.”

Wie du uns befriedest. *When thou pacifiest.*

“AS YOU PACIFY: PEACE TRANSMISSION.”

Jungfrau, rein im schoensten Sinn, *Virgin, pure in brightest sheen,*

“VIRGIN PURE: THE HIGHEST CLEAN.”

Mutter, Ehren wuerdig, *Mother sweet, supernal, –*

“MOTHER HONORED: BOTH AND.”

Uns erwaehlte Koenigin, *Unto us Elected Queen,*

“CHOSEN QUEEN: DEMOCRACY OF SOULS.”

Goettern ebenbuertig. *Peer of Gods Eternal!*

“EQUAL TO GODS: THE SAME HEIGHT.”

Um sie verschlingen *Light clouds are circling*

“AROUND HER: EVERYTHING CIRCLES.”

Sich leichte Woelkchen, *Around her splendour, –*

“LIGHT CLOUDS: ATMOSPHERE AS ORNAMENT.”

Sind Buesserinnen, *Penitent women*

“PENITENT WOMEN: SECOND-CHANCE SQUAD.”

Ein zartes Voelkchen, *Of natures tender,*

“TENDER FOLK: SOFTNESS AS STRENGTH.”

Um ihre Kniee *Her knees embracing,*

“AROUND HER KNEES: WORSHIP POSTURE.”

Den Aether schluerfend, *Ether respiring,*

“SIPPING ETHER: SKY AS SUSTENANCE.”

Gnade beduerfend. *Mercy requiring!*

“NEEDING MERCY: THE UNIVERSAL CONDITION.”

Dir, der Unberuehrbaren, *Thou, in immaculate ray,*

“UNTOUCHABLE: THE SACRED DISTANCE.”

Ist es nicht benommen, *Mercy not leavest,*

“NOT FORBIDDEN: ACCESS GRANTED.”

Dass die leicht Veruehrbaren *And the lightly led astray,*

“EASILY SEDUCED: THE SOFT TARGETS.”

Traulich zu dir kommen. *Who trust thee, receivest!*

“COME TRUSTINGLY: FAITH WALKS.”

In die Schwachheit hingerafft, *In their weakness fallen at length,*

“SNATCHED INTO WEAKNESS: FRAILTY KIDNAPS.”

Sind sie schwer zu retten; *Hard it is to save them:*

“HARD TO SAVE: THE TOUGH CASES.”

Wer zerreisst aus eigener Kraft *Who can crush, by native strength,*

“OWN POWER TEARS: IMPOSSIBLE SOLO.”

Der Gelueste Ketten? *Vices that enslave them?*

“CHAINS OF DESIRE: THE PRETTY PRISON.”

Wie entgleitet schnell der Fuss *Whose the foot that may not slip*

“FOOT SLIPS: GRAVITY OF SIN.”

Schiefem, glattem Boden? *On the surface slanting?*

“SLANTING SMOOTH: THE DECEPTIVE PATH.”

Wen betoert nicht Blick und Gruss, *Whom befool not eye and lip,*

“WHO ISN'T FOOLED: UNIVERSAL WEAKNESS.”

Schmeichelhafter Odem? *Breath and voice enchanting?*

“FLATTERING BREATH: THE WIND THAT UNDOES.”

(Die Mater gloriosa schwebt einher / The Mater Gloriosa soars into the space)

Chor der Buesserinnen / Chorus of Women Penitents

Du schwebst zu Hoehen *To heights thou'rt speeding*

“YOU SOAR: ALTITUDE WITHOUT LIMIT.”

Der ewigen Reiche, *Of Endless Eden:*

“ETERNAL REALMS: WHERE CLOCKS DIE.”

Vernimm das Flehen, *Receive our pleading,*

“RECEIVE PLEADING: APPLICATIONS OPEN.”

Du Ohnegleiche, *Transcendent Maiden,*

“WITHOUT EQUAL: THE ONLY ONE.”

Du Gnadenreiche! *With Mercy laden!*

“RICH IN MERCY: GRACE BILLIONAIRE.”

Magna peccatrix *(St. Luc. VII, 36)*

Bei der Liebe, die den Fuessen *By the love before him kneeling, –*

“BY THE LOVE: INVOKING THE SCENE.”

Deines gottverklaerten Sohnes *Him, Thy Son, a godlike vision,*

“GOD-TRANSFIGURED SON: THE RADIANT ONE.”

Traenen liess zum Balsam fliessen, *By the tears like balsam stealing,*

“TEARS LIKE BALSAM: WEEPING CURES.”

Trotz des Pharisaeerhohnes; *Spite of Pharisees' derision;*

“DESPITE MOCKERY: LOVE DOESN'T CARE.”

Beim Gefaesse, das so reichlich *By the box, whose ointment precious*

“BY THE VESSEL: THE COSTLY CONTAINER.”

Tropfte Wohlgeruch hernieder, *Shed its spice and odours cheery;*

“DRIPPED FRAGRANCE: SCENT AS SACRIFICE.”

Bei den Locken, die so weichlich *By the locks, whose softest meshes*

“BY THE LOCKS: HAIR BECAME HOLY.”

Trockneten die heil'gen Glieder – *Dried the holy feet and weary! –*

“DRIED HOLY LIMBS: THE HUMBLEST SERVICE.”

Mulier samaritana (*St. Joh. IV*)

Bei dem Bronn, zu dem schon weiland *By that well, the ancient station*

“BY THE WELL: THE ANCIENT WITNESS.”

Abram liess die Herde fuehren, *Whither Abram’s flocks were driven;*

“ABRAHAM’S HERD: OLD OLD OLD.”

Bei dem Eimer, der dem Heiland *By the jar whose restoration*

“BY THE BUCKET: HUMBLE TOOL, HOLY USE.”

Kuehl die Lippe durft’ beruehren; *To the Saviour’s lips was given;*

“COOL LIPS TOUCHED: REFRESHMENT FOR DIVINITY.”

Bei der reinen, reichen Quelle, *By the fountain, pure and vernal,*

“PURE RICH SPRING: THE SOURCE ABOVE SOURCES.”

Die nun dorthier sich ergiesset, *Thence its present bounty spending, –*

“NOW POURS OUT: THE ETERNAL FLOW.”

Ueberfluessig, ewig helle *Overflowing, bright, eternal,*

“ETERNALLY BRIGHT: INEXHAUSTIBLE GLOW.”

Rings durch alle Welten fliesset – *Watering the world’s unending! –*

“THROUGH ALL WORLDS: TOTAL IRRIGATION.”

Maria aegyptiaca (*Acta Sanctorum*)

Bei dem hochgeweihten Orte, *By the place, where the Immortal*

“CONSECRATED PLACE: THE HOLIEST ADDRESS.”

Wo den Herrn man niederliess, *Body of the Lord hath lain;*

“LORD LAID DOWN: THE TEMPORARY REST.”

Bei dem Arm, der von der Pforte *By the arm, which from the portal,*

“ARM FROM DOORWAY: THE HOLY BOUNCER.”

Warnend mich zuruecke stiess; *Warning, thrust me back again;*

“WARNINGLY THRUST: ENTRY DENIED... FOR NOW.”

Bei der vierzigjaehrigen Busse, *By the forty years’ repentance*

“FORTY YEARS PENANCE: THE LONG SORRY.”

Der ich treu in Wuesten blieb, *In the lonely desert-land;*

“FAITHFULLY IN DESERTS: LOYAL TO NOTHING.”

Bei dem seligen Scheidegrusse, *By the blissful farewell sentence*

“BLESSED FAREWELL: THE GOOD ENDING.”

Den im Sand ich niederschrieb – *Which I wrote upon the sand!* –

“WROTE IN SAND: THE TEMPORARY FOREVER.”

Zu drei / The Three

Die du grossen Suenderinnen *Thou Thy presence not deniest*

“GREAT SINNERS WELCOMED: THE BIG FAILURES GET CLOSE.”

Deine Naehel nicht verweigerst *Unto sinful women ever,* –

“NOT DENIED: OPEN DOOR POLICY.”

Und ein buessendes Gewinnen *Liftest them to win the highest*

“PENITENT GAINING: SORRY CLIMBS.”

In die Ewigkeiten steigerst, *Gain of penitent endeavour,* –

“RAISED TO ETERNITIES: FORGIVENESS FOREVER.”

Goenn auch dieser guten Seele, *So, from this good soul withdrawn not* –

“THIS GOOD SOUL: GRETCHEN’S TURN.”

Die sich einmal nur vergessen, *Who but once forgot, transgressing,*

“FORGOT ONCE: THE SINGLE SLIP.”

Die nicht ahnte, dass sie fehlte, *Who her loving error saw not* –

“DIDN’T SUSPECT: THE INNOCENT MISTAKE.”

Dein Verzeihen angemessen! *Pardon adequate, and blessing!*

“FITTING FORGIVENESS: CUSTOM MERCY.”

Una poenitentium, sonst Gretchen genannt (*sich anschmiegend / formerly named Margaret, stealing closer*)

Neige, neige, *Incline, O Maiden,*

“INCLINE INCLINE: GRETCHEN SPEAKS AT LAST.”

Du Ohnegleiche, *With Mercy laden,*

“WITHOUT EQUAL: THE HIGHEST PRAISE.”

Du Strahlenreiche, *In light unlading,*

“RICH IN RADIANCE: BLINDING BRIGHTNESS.”

Dein Antlitz gnaedig meinem Glueck! *Thy gracious countenance upon my bliss!*

“GRACIOUS FACE: BLESS MY JOY.”

Der frueh Geliebte, *My loved, my lover,*

“EARLY BELOVED: HE’S HERE. HE’S FINALLY HERE.”

Nicht mehr Getruebte, *His trials over*

“NO LONGER TROUBLED: THE STORM IS OVER.”

Er kommt zurueck. *In yonder world, returns to me in this!*

“HE RETURNS: THE REUNION. FINALLY.”

Selige Knaben (*in Kreisbewegung sich naehernd / approaching in hovering circles*)

Er ueberwaechst uns schon *With mighty limbs he towers*

“OUTGROWS US: THE STUDENT EXCEEDS.”

An maechtigen Gliedern, *Already above us;*

“MIGHTY LIMBS: STRENGTH EMBODIED.”

Wird treuer Pflege Lohn *He, for this love of ours,*

“RICHLY REPAY: THE CIRCLE OF CARE.”

Reichlich erwidern. *Will richlier love us.*

“FAITHFUL CARE: TENDS AND TENDS AND TENDS.”

Wir wurden frueh entfernt *Early were we removed,*

“REMOVED EARLY: THE UNLIVED LIVES.”

Von Lebechoeren; *Ere Life could reach us;*

“LIFE’S CHOIRS: THE MUSIC THEY MISSED.”

Doch dieser hat gelernt, *Yet he hath learned and proved,*

“THIS ONE LEARNED: THE FULL CURRICULUM.”

Er wird uns lehren. *And he will teach us.*

“HE WILL TEACH: THE STUDENT BECOMES MASTER.”

Die eine Buesserin, sonst Gretchen genannt / The Penitent (*formerly named Margaret*)

Vom edlen Geisterchor umgeben, *The spirit-choir around him seeing,*

“NOBLE CHOIR SURROUNDS: HE’S NOT ALONE ANYMORE.”

Wird sich der Neue kaum gewahr, *New to himself, he scarce divines*

“SCARCELY KNOWS HIMSELF: IDENTITY REBOOTING.”

Er ahnet kaum das frische Leben, *His heritage of new-born Being,*

“FRESH LIFE SENSED: EXISTENCE 2.0.”

So gleicht er schon der heiligen Schar. *When like the Holy Host he shines.*

“RESEMBLES HOLY HOST: BECOMING WHAT HE JOINS.”

Sieh, wie er jedem Erdenbande *Behold, how he each band hath cloven,*

“SHEDS EARTHLY BONDS: FREEDOM FROM WEIGHT.”

Der alten Huelle sich entrafft *The earthly life had round him thrown,*

“OLD SHELL SHED: THE COCOON BREAKS.”

Und aus aetherischem Gewande *And through his garb, of ether woven,*

“ETHEREAL GARMENT: DRESSED IN SKY.”

Hervortritt erste Jugendkraft. *The early force of youth is shown!*

“YOUTH-FORCE STEPS FORTH: THE PRIME OF SOUL.”

Vergoenne mir, ihn zu belehren, *Vouchsafe to me that I instruct him!*

“ALLOW ME TO INSTRUCT: GRETCHEN VOLUNTEERS.”

Noch blendet ihn der neue Tag. *Still dazzles him the Day's new glare.*

“NEW DAY DAZZLES: ADJUSTING TO GLORY.”

Mater gloriosa

Komm! hebe dich zu hoehern Sphaeren! *Rise, thou, to higher spheres! Conduct him,*

“COME! RISE! THE FINAL INSTRUCTION.”

Wenn er dich ahnet, folgt er nach. *Who, feeling thee, shall follow there!*

“IF HE SENSES: LOVE IS THE COMPASS.”

Doctor marianus (*auf dem Angesicht anbetend / prostrate, adoring*)

Blicket auf zum Retterblick, *Penitents, look up elate,*

“LOOK UP: THE FINAL DIRECTION.”

Alle reuig Zarten, *Where she beams salvation;*

“TENDERLY REPENTANT: THE GENTLE REBORNS.”

Euch zu seligem Geschick *Gratefully to blessed fate*

“BLESSED FATE: THE HAPPY ENDING.”

Dankend umzuarten. *Grow, in re-creation!*

“GRATEFULLY TRANSFORM: THANKFUL BECOMING.”

Werde jeder bessre Sinn *Be our souls, as they have been,*

“EVERY BETTER SENSE: THE GOOD IN YOU.”

Dir zum Dienst erbötig; *Dedicate to Thee!*

“READY TO SERVE: THE ETERNAL COMMITMENT.”

Jungfrau, Mutter, Koenigin, *Virgin Holy, Mother, Queen,*

“VIRGIN MOTHER QUEEN: THE TRIPLE CROWN.”

Goettin, bleibe gnaedig! *Goddess, gracious be!*

“GODDESS GRACIOUS: THE LAST PRAYER.”

Chorus mysticus

Alles Vergaengliche *All things transitory*

“ALL TRANSITORY: EVERYTHING THAT DIES.”

Ist nur ein Gleichnis; *But as symbols are sent:*

“ONLY SYMBOL: POINTER TO THE REAL.”

Das Unzulaengliche, *Earth's insufficiency*

“THE INSUFFICIENT: ALL THAT FAILED.”

Hier wird's Ereignis; *Here grows to Event:*

“HERE BECOMES EVENT: POTENTIAL MADE ACTUAL.”

Das Unbeschreibliche, *The Indescribable,*

“THE INDESCRIBABLE: LANGUAGE SURRENDERS.”

Hier ist's getan; *Here it is done:*

“HERE IT IS DONE: THE UNSPEAKABLE ACHIEVED.”

Das Ewig-Weibliche *The Woman-Soul leadeth us*

“DAS EWIG-WEIBLICHE: THE FORCE THAT MOVES ALL.”

Zieht uns hinan. *Upward and on!*

“ZIEHT UNS HINAN: DRAWS US UP AND ON—FOREVER.”
